

In the name of God most Gracious, ever Merciful!

The Beloved and I

Volume 2: Enoch, Jubilees, Joshua,
Judges

Thomas McElwain

New Jubilees Version of Sacred Scripture in
Verse

With Verse Commentaries

Revised Edition

Adams & McElwain Publishers

Copyright © 2007 Adams & McElwain Publishers and Thomas McElwain

First published in two volumes, *The Beloved* and *I* 2005, and *Led of the Beloved*, 2006.

Second edition, 2010

Third and revised edition, 2012

All rights reserved.

No part of this verse commentary on the sacred

Scriptures may be reproduced, transmitted, or stored in a retrieval system,
in any form or by any means, without permission in writing from the publisher.

Published by

Adams & McElwain Publishers

Puijonrinne 7

70200 Kuopio, Finland

ThomasGMcElwain@gmail.com

www.lulu.com

Cover photo by Anna Maria McElwain

Contents

<i>Preface, page 5</i>
<i>Enoch, page 6</i>
<i>Jubilees, page 124</i>
<i>Joshua, page 269</i>
<i>Judges, page 324</i>

Preface

This second volume of *The New Jubilees Version* is written in the same format as the first: a verse translation of the Scripture text interspersed with sonnet-like commentary. The first two books in this volume, however, are little more than versifications, since the original language was consulted only sparingly. The books of Joshua and Judges were translated from the Hebrew in the same way as the Torah in volume one.

There has been an attempt to use italics for all words, phrases and occasionally lines that have been added in commentary to the text within the verse numbered passages themselves. Given that this is a verse rendering, the accuracy achieved by the masterful King James Versions is not attained here, although it goes beyond that of some modern versions.

The Scriptural portions are set in octosyllabic, following the same Turkish tradition. Obviously, besides Turkish poetics, English hymnodic tradition, specifically Long Metre, has been influential. The rhyme scheme is based on the couplet with variation. A hint is taken from Medieval Hebrew poetry as well as Turkish tradition in the predilection for complete identity rhymes, something that is not acceptable in traditional English poetry except in the *sestina*. The poetics is thus a combination of Turkish, English, and medieval Hebrew traditions. Although the syllable count, based on Turkish-style scansion is exact, except for feminine rhymes, it sometimes includes weak syllables, which of course contrasts with normal English scansion. The result is that the entire text of the Scriptures could conceivably be sung to the tunes of Christian Long Metre hymns and many folk tunes in Turkish and other traditions, including such obscure ones as Finnish Kalevala melodies. Of course octosyllabic lines are the most English of all verses since before the time of Chaucer. The challenge is to imbue a translation into that ancient form with any degree of freshness.

The commentaries are distinguished, for the most part, by a form combining features from the Shakespearean sonnet and the Oriental ghazel. It consists of fourteen lines of iambic pentameter, the English heroic line. The rhyme scheme, however, is the same as that for the Scriptural translations, mirroring a ghazel style.

I have gone so far as to assume the original Hebrew cognate of Muhammad behind the Ethiopic in several passages of Enoch and Jubilees. The cognates of Ali and Muhammad quite simply exist in the Hebrew Scriptures, and the reader has a right to know this, whether or not she chooses to apply it prophetically.

I have occasionally translated the Hebrew word *shalom* not as peace, but as Islam, with the view that the word refers, not to a particular religious establishment, but to that peace with God that comes through submission to His revealed will. No implications favouring a religious establishment should be inferred. Indeed, the unbiased reader of the Qur'an will soon become aware that its intention was not to create a new religious tradition, but to call people of all sects back to the faith of Abraham.

This work is unique in several ways. Others have single-handedly translated great bodies of Scripture, although it is fairly rare in this age of committees, at least in such languages as English. A few have even translated large segments of Scripture into verse. Examination of the greater portion of the material in early languages and directly from critical texts is hardly unusual for translators of Scripture. But the combination of critical investigation with translation into verse of such an enormous canonical collection, coupled with extensive mystical commentary in poetic form, is unusual in the Oriental context and even more so in a Western one.

At least since the Protestant Reformation, Scripture has been increasingly perceived as factual literature instead of the more evocative mythical. The fact that so many today perceive Scripture as myth, by which they mean it is not true,

only demonstrates the blind and narrow factuality that has oppressed the human soul in recent centuries. Nothing in post-modern thought mitigates this approach: factuality has merely splintered into the meaningless. It is the conscious attempt of the author and translator to avoid not only the deconstructionist fashion of the present as well as historical conventions and outlooks. But this work does not replace the functions of prose translations, study Bibles, or critical editions. Its unique form implies a different function altogether, yet one that approaches the early usage "to be read in churches." Its intention is to provide a reliable text for the purpose of devotional, liturgical, mystical and perhaps sacramental recitation of Scripture. That does not prevent its being read as poetry or even as a novel. The practice of the author himself is to read the weekly Torah lesson, as found in volume one, on the Sabbath day in congregation, and to use the succeeding volumes devotionally on the other days of the week.

The mysticism at the foundation of this work is the realization that absolute existence belongs to the one God alone. The implication for the identity of the "I" and the unity of humankind ought, with a little contemplation, to become evident. In this context the self of illusion and the Self which is God are in variable tension. The result is sometimes the expression of contempt for institutions and even individuals. This should be understood mainly in terms of the microcosmos of the individual, rather than a projection of suspicion on the world about. To understand these expressions in a literal and exterior sense is to miss the entire point in terms of the self in mystical thought. By the same token, those expressions of love and adoration that may appear to refer to human beings should be understood in the mystical contemplation of the human face, whereby God is apperceived. This danger of misapprehension is well known and is at the root of secretiveness among such mystical groups as Sufis, Kabbalists, and others. One can only pray that the spiritual benefits of this contemplation will

outweigh any detriment that careless reading may experience.

The conscientious and spiritual will immediately see beyond the shiny surface of these waters of revelation to the towers and pinnacles of the jewelled city arising from the seabed below. Let these lines be a springboard for the truly adept to plunge into the refreshing flood. These meditations, by contrast to many readings of the Scriptures, couched in the form of verse dialogues, are conversations or love letters between the Beloved, who once inspired the Scriptures, and the lover who now turns to their contemplation.

The Book of Enoch

The Book of Enoch is a canonical book in the Ethiopian Bible. It disappeared from Jewish interest by the end of the first centuries C.E., perhaps because of its messianic references to the Son of Man (Enoch 46ff.), which were used effectively by Christian apologists. It was later opposed by Christians because of its support for a twelve-month calendar with a focus on the Sabbath, which was becoming less and less acceptable to a Sunday-observing church, and so lost its valued position among most Christians after the council of Laodicea in 364, although it was still found quoted outside the Coptic tradition as late as the eighth century. The twelve-month calendar was also superseded by the intercalated lunar calendar in Rabbinical Judaism, effectively producing another barrier against the books of Enoch and Jubilees. Neither of these considerations applied to the Ethiopian church, which explains why the book survived there without break down to the present day.

Most scholars consider the book of Enoch to have been written in the main during the Maccabean period mid-second century B.C.E., but Ethiopian tradition attributes it to the Prophet Enoch himself. Justin Martyr, Irenaeus, Origen, Clement of Alexandria and Tertullian all considered the book authentic and canonical, mainly

because it is clearly quoted in Jude 14-15. Enoch 39:12 reflects Isaiah 6:3 and Revelation 4:8, to mention only one outstanding example of canonical quotation. The book of Enoch is actually extensively paraphrased in the Greek Scripture, so that to exclude it from the canon while including those books that quote it authoritatively is inconsistent.

My versification relies on direct examination of the Ethiopic text or Greek, Latin and Aramaic fragments only in a very few passages. For the most part I have been dependent on the translation of Richard Laurence and R. H. Charles, or comments of George W. E. Nichelsburg, James C. VanderKam, Richard Laurence, R. H. Charles, George H. Schodde, Geza Vermes and Joshua Williams. In a few matters I have drawn my own conclusions.

Like the Book of Jubilees, the Book of Enoch is unusual in showing a configuration of characteristics in common with the Qur'an. The advanced angelology is the most evident of such aspects, but the similarity to judgement concepts augments that greatly. I find that the expression *eret Hamda* in Psalm 106:24 is reflected in Enoch 89:40, where I translate the expression on that basis as "land of Muhammad", ignoring the Ethiopic. A similar situation applies in Enoch 90:20. Considering that scholars disagree on what the original text might have been, one cannot be dogmatic on such a tenuous detail. The parallel nonetheless exists.

The extent of Enochian mysticism is astounding, being widespread not only in Jewish tradition, but Christianity and Islam as well. As such, this book should be interesting to a wide range of people. Its limited distribution until the 19th century explains, however, the fact that it has so largely been neglected. What follows may be a contribution, not in terms of scholarship, for the commentator can make no claims in that area for an Ethiopic text, but in terms of a literary and mystical contemplation.

The Book of Enoch, set in earliest time
Reveals the history of the world in rhyme

From fallen watchers to ten thousand years
That grace the universe as it appears.
I see with Enoch heaven's tablet set
Portraying revelation in things met
And every action, thought, and word in
 seed
As though a thing eternally decreed,
And yet reflecting every hand's free greed
That springs up in the good or evil deed.
I see with Enoch every passing cloud,
Its rains and snows and dews preaching
 aloud
The glories of Your days and weeks and
 name.
I see with Enoch, my Beloved, Your fame.

Week 1. Section I. Chapters 1-36 The Watchers

Enoch 1

1 The words of Enoch's blessing, by
Which he blessed the elect *in sky*
And righteous *on earth*, who will be
Living in troublous day's decree
When all the wicked and godless
Are to be removed *for redress*.
2 And he took up his parable
And said *heart and mind being full*,
Enoch, a righteous man, whose eyes
Alohim opened *by surprise*,
Saw visions of the Holy One
In the heavens, angels *for fun*
Showed me, and from them I heard all,
And from them understood the call,
But not unto this generation,
But rather for a remote nation
Which is to come. 3 Of the elect
I spoke, and took up my *select*
Parable about them. 4 The great
And holy One will come in state
Out from His dwelling, Alohim
Eternal will tread, it may seem,
Upon the earth, *even upon*
Mount Sinai, [coming *like the dawn*
From His camp] and appearing in
The strength of His power from the sky,
The heaven of heavens. 5 And all *that spy*
It shall be struck with fear, *for sin*
The Watchers shall quake, and great fear
And trembling shall seize far and near
Unto the ends of the earth here.
6 And the high mountains shall be shaken,

And the high hills made low, forsaken,
Shall melt like wax before the flame.
7 Earth shall be wholly rent asunder,
All on earth perish *at His name*,
For judgement upon all *and thunder*.

If Enoch's words were written for a time
And generation remote from his clime,
It must be Ethiopia he means
And the faiths that remain upon its scenes,
And those folk still obscure in Rome and

Greece,
For hardly anyone else reads the fleece.
Or else his words were written for the
world

In the seventh week when the troubled
curled

Upon all flesh shall bow backs under keen
Apostasy darker than that yet seen.
I read the words of Enoch, and I flee
From the great and common apostasy,
The Judeo-Christian Islamic sea
To find in You, Beloved, eternity.

8 But with the righteous He'll make peace,
To protect the elect, increase
Mercy upon them. And they shall
Belong to Alohim, and shall
Prosper, and they shall all be blessed.
And He will help them all *for best*,
And light shall appear to them, and
He'll make peace with them in the land.

But with the righteous people You shall
make
Peace or Islam in all for the world's sake.
The chosen few who give You in Your due
The glory and the praise that will incur
In mercy with each prayer begun to show
That Your divine oneness is here below,
Are those who from the dish belong to
You.

Beloved, I see prosperity at hand
And blessing flowing though all of the
land,
And yet Your light is near invisible
And Your help seems to come to those
whose full

Garners of violence have risen high.
Send down a flame out of the riven sky
Upon the towers of the darkened strand.

9 And indeed, He shall come with ten
Thousands of His holy ones then
To execute judgement on all,
And to destroy ungodly thrall,
And to convict all flesh of all
The works of their ungodliness
That they have wickedly committed,
And of all the hard things *remitted*,
That ungodly sinners confess
Spoken against Him *in badness*.

Before Moses sang of creation's due,
The blessed Enoch knew and sang what's
true

Not only of the judgement of all men,
But of Sinai, and Your appearance then
In thunder and in glory and in cloud
To speak to humankind all in that crowd
In seed and loin, and so I cogitate
Sinai's fair scenes prophetic and not late
With eyes of faith and hearing of the word
That millennium echoed and hearts stirred.
At Sinai You made peace, Beloved, Islam
With all the world to be born in that calm,
And ratified it till like wax again
Shall melt the earth and even hearts of men.

Enoch 2

1 Observe everything that takes place
In the sky, how they change their race,
In orbits, and the luminaries
In the sky, in their functionaries
How they all rise and set in order
Each in its time, without rewarder
Fail not of their appointed order.

When Stonehenge was created it bespoke
The commandment that Enoch once awoke
To write in solace for the lonely sky:
Command to watch the stars go marching
by.

When the earth mounds the Hopewell site
were tall
Against the ravages of western wall
Their ramparts fled not before Your first
call

To see the order of the moon and sigh.
Beloved, all things are now lost in the rate
Of calculation and the greater fate
Of speciality at heaven's gate.
My tin roof magnifies the herd of rain
And dulls the soundings of my human pain,

But closes me off from seeing the train.

2 Look at the earth, and give heed to
What happens on it, things not few,
From first to last, how faithfully
And without change, by God's decree
His works appear to you, 3 see how
The summer and the winter bow
In circuit, the whole earth is filled
With water, clouds and dew distilled
With rain upon it *wonderfully*.

In winter I observe the glowing sky
At mid-morning red on the southern try,
A fire indeed, and yet a frozen flame
That looks down on a world in icy claim,
And praise, Beloved, again Your lovely
name.
In summer when I waken from my sleep
And gaze through darkened trees before the
deep
Glow of the white night sky in the earth's
game
Of whirling at the sun and without shame,
I praise, Beloved, again Your gloried fame.
As seasons pass I linger at the gate
That raises me to gaze on Your estate
And wonder that the incommensurate
Enters the human heart early and late.

Enoch 3

Observe and see how all the trees
In winter seem in their degrees
To wither and shed all their leaves,
But fourteen kinds whose green achieves
Unlost old foliage two or three
Until they all sprout in their leaves.

Fourteen infallibles grace the world's rim,
But few outside the law know her and him.
The evergreen trees still remind my soul,
How far they stretch from this place to their
goal,
Saw-toothed horizon girding half the earth
And showing but a drop of those souls'
worth.
Beloved, let me swim in the air around
The spinning ball of world and hear the
sound
Of Your praise on the lips of tree and
ground

That spread abroad out through the
northlands' bound.

The evergreens still sprout their narrow
leaves

To guide my heart and mind in Your
reprieves,

And strike my soul with loving memory
Of Your true names beneath each greening
tree.

Enoch 4

Again observe the summer days,
Sun above the earth in its rays.
Then seek your shade and shelter from
The sun's heat and its rays that come
On earth with growing, burning heat,
Not to tread on earth with bare feet,
Nor on a rock for intense heat.

In Turkey by the grand Euphrates stream
I meet the coming summer heat and beam.
The young ones all jump off the moving
bus

To dip themselves and cooling from the
fuss

Of pilgrimage within that shadeless brook
And then return to see the driver's look
And hear complaint for every dampened
seat.

Out to the tombs of hajji and to meet
The local saints for sacrifice and feet
That dance out wedding circles on the stone
Too hot to touch, and yet the oaks atone
Where all the little goats are stretched to
eat,
Beloved, meet me in Turkey and once more
We shall feast at Hajji Kuresh tomb door.

Enoch 5

1 Observe how the trees sprout with green
Leaves and bear fruit where they are seen,
So take heed and know all His works,
And recognize He never shirks,
But lives always to make them so.
2 And all His works in this way go
On thus from year to year for aye,
And all the tasks they finish by
Him do not change *under the sun*,
But as ordained, so it is done.

All things of your creation make me see
How from beginning to eternity

You never shirk. Let me not take shirk now
Caressing some graven image's brow,
But constant as the grazing multitude
Of what You made in flower and field and
wood

Take on the round of doing as I should
From week to week and day to night
somehow.

Who knows if nature herself feels
temptation

To part from Your divine set contemplation
To seek a path untrodden, unknown, great?
Who knows if man is unique in his state
Imagining he makes free choice to slate
Originality as his rebate?

3 And look how the sea and the streams
In the same way fulfil their schemes
From His commandments without change.

4 But you, unsteadfast in your range,
Have not done the commands of YHWH,
But you have turned away *to do*
And speak proud and hard words with your
Impure mouths against His great power.

The little horn of Daniel stands up here
To speak words proud and harsh and full of
gear

Against the Most High and Anointed one.
I see that Enoch saw this before done.
The little horn speaks softly, full of grace
And mercy as though coming from Your
face

Today as it proclaims Your law is void
And Sabbath is a day no more employed.
Beloved, let me be like the sea and streams
To keep Your law as faithfully as seems
The waters to run downhill as they flow,
Or beat upon the sand and rocky shore.
Then I shall have pure mouth to say Your
name

And not be guilty of such horrid shame.

You hard-hearted, you'll find no peace.
5 Therefore shall you and without cease
Regret your days, and all the years
Of your life shall perish *in fears*,
And your destruction's years shall be
Multiplied and eternally
In execration, and you shall
Find no mercy. 6 In those days shall
You make your names an eternal

Execration unto all who
Are righteous, and by you all who
Curse, shall curse, and all sinners and
Godless imprecate by your *hand*,
And for you the godless there shall
Be a curse. 7 And all of these . . . shall
Rejoice, and for sins there shall be
Forgiveness of sins, and mercy
And peace and forbearance, there shall
Be salvation unto them, and
A goodly light. On other hand,
For all of you sinners there shall
Be no salvation, but on you
Shall abide a curse hereunto.

It is the matter of cursing that brings
Distinction between princes and their
kings.

All may have sinned but some gain the
release
From guilt and punishment because Your
peace
Falls on those who lift up Your gracious
name

In reverence and in repentance' claim.
Who lift Your name ungodly but to show
Instead of repenting the way they go
Are those who abuse Your name and are
made

To be an imprecation where they stayed.
Beloved, give me salvation that is found
In Your mercy for those who bow to
ground,
And for the ones who lift Your name in
praise
And not to vain idols in babbling craze.

But for the elect there shall be
Light, joy and peace *eternally*,
And they shall inherit the earth.

Both Psalm and Jesus quote this blessed
word

That Your meek ones shall from their
poverty
Arise in faith and hope to fill the sea
With Your praises once their hearts have
been stirred
And once their great salvation has
occurred.

The meek elect reign in light, joy to see
Islam or Your peace and eternally,

Or so I have from that blessed word
inferred.

Belovèd, bless David's pure heart to find
The strength to quote these lovely words
and true.

Bless Jesus for his witness to Your own.
Bless every divine guide sent with the kind
And holy message that brings me to You.
Bless those who bow before Your righteous
throne.

8 And then there'll be bestowed a worth
Of wisdom upon the elect,
And they shall all live and reflect,
And never sin again, not through
Ungodliness or pride to do,
But they who are wise shall be humble.
9 And they shall not be ones to stumble
Transgressing, never shall they sin
All the days of their life *to win*,
Nor die of *the divine* anger
Or wrath, but they'll at last concur
To complete the number of days
Of their life. And their lives shall stay
Increased in peace, and the years of
Their joy shall be added *in love*,
In eternal gladness and peace,
All days of their life shall *not cease*.

I see the morning sky behind the trees
From the bed were I lie waked by the
breeze,
And in their round of growth in green and
blowing,

And in their winter sleep after the sowing,
I see the changeless cycles of Your deep
And sacred universe above my sleep.
The spirits that guard all the marvels of
Your great creation in eternal love
Let nothing fall except by Your command.
So year by year the willows, aspens stand.
The chambered printing of the backlit
green

Is like a vision to my heart unseen,
And in that vision I arise to do
As unceasingly Your will as the view.

Enoch 6

1 And it happened when sons of men
Had multiplied in those times then
Were born to them beautiful and
Lovely daughters, then angels' band,

The children of the sky, saw and
Lusted for them, said each to each,
2 "Come, let us choose us wives *like peach*
From among the children of men
And get us also some children."

The sons of God in Genesis account
Turn out here to be angels in amount.
I might have thought the sons of God were
those

Who minded p's and q's upon their toes
And obeyed every statute that arose
In Your instruction from Your wisdom's
fount.

So son of God is angel, though such are
Created and not born to be a star.
Beloved, a son of man set here below,
I look into the sky to see the show,
And wonder what the angels there aloft
Are thinking about as they gaze down oft
On me and mine. I doubt experiment
In gene splicing is now what angels meant.

3 And Semjaza, who was their leader,
Said to them, "I fear *as a pleader*
That you indeed will not agree
To do this deed, and shall go free,
While I alone shall have to pay
The penalty of a great sin."

4 And they all answered him to say,
"Let us all swear an oath and spin
Upon ourselves curses if we
Abandon this plan treacherously."

This swearing is a thing I must avow
Always results in tragedy somehow.
No wonder the brave dunkards threw the
lot

Of swearers out of dunkard house and plot.
So angels swore to do the wrong together
Despite the change in circumstance or
weather.

Beloved, let me not join in covenant
With any in the city where they rant
Of virtue and perfume. Let me remain
In piety of nature without stain
Of promises I cannot, should not keep.
Let me remain till angels learn to weep.
Beloved, the company is charged with all
The stealth that keeps its wealth within the
stall.

5 Then they swore all together and
 Bound themselves under curses' band.
 6 And they were in all two hundred,
 In days of Jared descended
 Upon the top of Mount Hermon,
 And so they called it Mount Hermon,
 Because they had sworn binding them
 By curses in their stratagem.
 7 And these are the names of their leaders,
 Samlazaz, their leader *of feeders*,
 Araklba, Rameel, as well
 As Kokabel, Tamlel, Ramlel,
 And Danel, and Ezeqeel,
 Baraqijal, and Asael,
 And Armaros, and Batarel,
 Ananel, Zaqllel, Samsapeel,
 Satarel, Turel, Jomjael,
 And Sariel, their chiefs of tens,
Arrayed parade and regimens.

Instinct to reproduce is set by You,
 Beloved, for those created things that do.
 To follow instinct is obeying true,
 But following example of creation
 Instead of staying in the righteous station
 That You appoint, is gross unnaturalness.
 Each in its place is something that You
 bless.
 Each out of place receives the curse of all
 And gets turned out of sacred, blessed hall.
 I see that even holy angels fall,
 Beloved, I flee to You to do Your will
 And so escape the punishment and pill.
 Let me in love obey Your commands still
 As seeing the unseen celestial hill.

Enoch 7

1 And all the others together
 With them took them wives for each fer,
 And each chose for himself one, and
 They started going in the land
 To defile themselves with them, 2 and
 They taught them charms and
 enchantments,
 And the cutting of roots *for sense*,
 And gave knowledge of every plant.
 3 And the *women* became pregnant,
 And each gave birth to great giant,
 And whose height was three thousand ells,
 Who consumed all men's seeds and shells.
 4 When they could no longer keep them,
 The giants turned fast against them,

5 And ate up people, birds, and beasts,
 And reptiles, and fish, in their feasts
 They also ate each other up,
 And washed it down with blood in cup.
 6 So earth itself came to accuse
 The lawless ones *for their abuse*.

The violence that Noah saw before
 The Flood was one of a far greater store
 Than man to man against the dark intruder.
 A threatened man is not a quiet brooder.
 But giants are another thing indeed
 As Hollywood has taught the modern
 breed.

The vision of Enoch is greater yet
 Than what's portrayed, I think, on screen in
 jet.
 The fabled serpent with two heads was not
 One with a greater appetite that got
 Its patron into trouble with its greed.
 Beloved, let me not feed the monster held
 In bosom, loved, and then at last propelled
 Out with loathing for what should have
 been quelled.

Enoch 8

1 And Azazel taught men to make
 Swords, and knives, and shields *for his*
sake,
 And breastplates, and made known to them
 The earth metals and stratagem
 Of working them, and bracelets, and
 Ornaments, and then the demand
 Of antimony, and the way
 To beautify of eyelids *gay*,
 And every kind of costly stone,
 And colourings of root and bone.
 2 And there arose much godlessness,
 And fornication to excess,
 And all of them were led astray,
 And became corrupt in their way.

Azazel is the fallen angel that
 Taught military industry the fat
 Is found in selling fear since human pouch
 For containing fear's never full, I vouch,
 Though stomach is soon filled with wheat
 and corn.

Such policy for marketing was born
 Long before the United States found out
 The profit lay in turning round about
 And selling arms to both sides in the rout.

Such greed and graft was known too long
before
The empire hit upon the British shore
To guide the world to light and bombs
galore.
Beloved, I see the ornaments return
Shining in the light of cities that burn.

3 Semjaza taught enchantments, and
Root-cuttings, Armaros command
To solve enchantments, *the angel*
Baraqijal astrology,
The constellations Kokabel,
Ezeqeel clouds' symmetry,
Araquel the signs of earth,
Shamsiel signs of the sun's *dearth*,
And Sariel the moon in course.
And as men perished *under force*,
They cried *in anguish*, and their cry
Went up, went up into the sky.

The arts of fallen angels still hold sway
Upon the earth I walk from day to day.
Metal and ointments still gain upper hand
For violence and beauty in the land.
And fornication and enchantments find
An eager following of fair and blind.
The sun and moon and stars still tell the
folk
Their future and their fortune at a stroke.
And men in anguish still lift up a prayer,
Mute often for not knowing Your name
there,
And hope oppression might find change of
air.
And after all the centuries I throw
Your hearing is the same both then and
now.
Rise up, Beloved, and take hold of the
plough.

Enoch 9

1 And then Michael, Uriel, and
Raphael, and Gabriel *in band*
Looked down from heaven and saw much
blood
Shed on the earth, the lawless flood
Of what was done on earth. 2 And they
Said one to each other "Earth's way
In desolation cries with voice
Of their weeping up to the choice
Gates of the sky. 3 And now to you,

The holy ones of heaven, view
The souls of men that make their suit,
Saying 'Bring our cause *of dispute*
Before the Most High.'"⁴ And they said,
To the Lord of the ages said
"Lord of lords, God of every god,
King of kings, and Alohim shod
With ages, the throne of Your glory
Stands to all generations' story,
And Your name holy, glorious and
Blessed unto all the ages *grand!*

The four archangels kept four sacred gates
And at their posts stand waiting for estates
Of humankind to rest them in Your will.
They raise the prayers of every Jack and
Bill

Against the evils of both air and earth
Until the floods assuage and become
dearth.

Michael like God opens the gate of law
For Uriel, Your light, to come in awe,
Your healing with Raphael, awareness,
Makes way for Gabriel, hero, to bless
My cries often to You, Beloved, until
They savour of the salt, honey, and fill
Your courts with angel songs that bear
witness.

Beloved, I move among the gates' address.

5 "You've made all things, and have all
power,
And all things are naked in flower
Before Your sight, and You see all
And nothing hides from You at all.
6 "You see what Azazel has done,
Who has taught all the wicked fun
On earth and gave away the deep
Eternal secrets that You keep
In heaven, which men strove to learn,
7 "And Semjaza You did not spurn
To give authority to rule
Over his fellows *played the fool*
And they have gone to human girls
Upon the earth, and slept like churls
With women, 8 "and they have defiled
Themselves, and revealed to them wild,
Wicked sins. 9 "And the women gave
Birth to giants, such to enslave
The whole earth thereby to be filled
With unrighteousness and blood spilled.
10 "And now, indeed, the souls of those

Who have died cry against their foes
Up to the gates of heaven, and their
Lamentations have filled the air,
And cannot cease because of deeds
Of lawlessness done on earth's weeds.
11 "And You know all things before they
Come to pass, and You see the fray,
And You allow them, do not say
To us what we're to do to them
Because of what they haw and hem."

"You've made all things and have all
power" in brief
Is principle of thought before relief
Of any sort of philosophic dream.
You are not just a god of those that seem.
Your deity is not based on the mind
Of humankind in contemplation blind,
Nor is it the expression of the way
The structured mind in myth joins in the
fray.
You're Sovereign simply because what
You made
As Creator was successful and stayed.
Beloved, though lawlessness may raise a
head
Where angels in the past feared not to
tread,
Your reign is still contained in all that
shows
Its face each day to the dawn and the rose.

Enoch 10

1 Then said Most High, Holy and Great,
Sent Uriel to Lemech's son,
2 And told him "Go to Noah's *state*
And tell him in my name to run
And hide, and show him what's to come
Upon the whole country in sum
To be destroyed in a deluge
On the entire land, a flood huge
That will destroy all that's on it.
3 "And now instruct him *not to sit*,
How that he may escape and his
Descendants saved on earth, that is,
For all their generations coming."
4 Again YHWH said to Raphael,
"Bind Azazel hand and foot humming,
And cast him into darkness' *hell*,
And make a hollow in the ground,
Desert which is in Dudael,
And cast him *where he may be found*.

The light of God or Uriel was sent,
Beloved, to Noah to show what was meant
To come upon the earth. The sacred ark
That saved them from the massive flood
and dark

Was manifest the second gate of power
That mediates to humankind the hour
Of divine love. Tariqat is the way
Beyond and within law that saves the day.
It is not enough to keep Your law right,
One must come in the ark, out of the night,
Or perish in obedience' fond hope
That You reward in automatic scope
The outward deed, despite intention to
Seek benefit for self. Noah's light's true.

5 "And place upon him rough and jagged
Rocks, cover him with darkness *ragged*,
And let him stay there and for ever,
Cover his face, light from him sever.

6 "And on the day of judgement great
He shall be cast into his fate
Of fire, heal the earth of corruption
By which angels have made eruption,
7 "And proclaim healing of the earth,
That they may heal plagues on its girth,
And that all sons of men may not
Perish through secret things they got
From the Watchers disclosed and taught
To their sons. 8 "And the whole earth has
Been corrupted through the works as
Were taught by Azazel, his sin."

You sent the healing angel Raphael
To bind Azazel, cast in Dudael
In darkness covered and with covered face
That he might not see what light's in that
place.

For light is everywhere in all creation,
The first thing that You made, illumination.
And even angel faces must be veiled
To keep out light for faith and duty failed.
Azazel taught the world of men to see
The mystic light of evil works and be
Repositories of those darkened arts
That begot bastards from their chosen tarts,
And chained the Zohar to forbidden deeds
Corrupting flesh and forging light-filled
creeds.

9 And to Gabriel said YHWH to win,

“Proceed against the bastards and
The reprobates, against the band
Of fornication, and destroy
The Watchers’ bastard children from
Amongst men *and cause them in sum*
To go out, send them against each
Other in battle to destroy
For length of days they shall not reach,
10 “And no request may they employ
To be granted their fathers on
Their own behalf, for they hope on
To live eternal life, and yet
Five hundred years for each is set.”

The hero of Your reign named Gabriel
Went out by Your command to set a spell
Upon the sons of Watchers and to make
Them destroy one another for their fate.
So from healing awareness for the sake
Of Raphael is changed to something great
In Gabriel the archangel of truth
Who went into the earth and without ruth
To carry out Your divine orders and
Bring in five hundred years the soul and
hand
To bright reality and out of pain
And out of dark illusion’s vast refrain.
Beloved, Your angel unveils at request
Reality and settles on the nest.

11 And YHWH said to Michael, “Go, bind
Semjaza and his fellows *blind*
Who have united themselves to
Women to defile themselves too
With them in all their uncleanness.
12 “And when their sons have killed
likeness
In one another, and they’ve seen
Destruction of their loved ones’ *scene*,
Bind them fast for seventy of
Generations in valleys of
The earth, till their judgement day come
And consummation, till the rum
Judgement eternal take its place.
13 “In those days they shall have to face
Abyss of fire, and the torment
And prison where they shall be sent
Confined for ever. 14 “Who shall be
Condemned, destroyed will then on be
Bound with them to the end of all
Earth’s generations and their call.

For seventy generations, seven weeks
Of time until the day of Judgement peeks,
You bind the wicked Watchers to their fate
Of staying hidden from events of state.
I stand well in the generation’s gate
Of the last week, its second generation
And look out on the great apostate nation
That denies You, Your oneness, and Your
law
And pretends to come to Your throne for
awe
While in gyration of an idol’s claw.
I wait the day and grasp the hour when You
Will shake from my heart and my world the
crew
Of evil and of violence, in dew
Come to fulfil, destroy, tear down, renew.

15 “Destroy all reprobate spirits,
Each son of the Watchers that sits,
Because they have wronged humankind.
16 “Destroy all wrong from face *and mind*
Of all the earth and let every
Evil work come to an end free,
And let the plant of righteousness
And truth appear, it shall progress
A blessing, works of righteousness
And truth shall be planted in truth
And joy for evermore *and ruth.*

Let every son of Watcher born in me
Die forthwith and die for eternity.
The evil work that would turn from Your
grace
In each marsh marigold that stands in
place,
And every basswood beetle showing face,
To raise a pillar on the harvest crust,
I conjure You to turn it all to dust.
Beloved, I seek the breezes that alone
Bent birch and aspen as beneath Your
throne,
And tie the grabbish knot to the unknown,
Until, Beloved, the Watchers cast and
groan.
Beloved, again I fly up with the skit
Of titmouse and play havoc with my wit,
Only returning to the place You sit.

17 “Then all the righteous shall escape,
And they shall live until they shape
Thousands of children, all the days

Of their youth their old age complete
In peace *as Islam at God's feet*.

Let the righteous in me escape the flood
Of Watchers with their sons and fading
blood.

Then the righteous in me be multiplied
In righteous sons before the harsh desried
Desert the wheels among the truly tried
To find the last of the wadi's clear mud.
Let me complete my days, Beloved, so You
Will find my peace and praise always in
view,

To need neither petition nor the due
In penance for the evil things I do.
When last my youth and old age comes to
sprint

Across Your golden street, then take the
hint,

Beloved, that I embrace the fallen star
To ride the chariot to where You are.

18 "And then the whole earth shall be tilled
In righteousness, and all be filled
With planted trees and full of blessing.
And all desirable trees *with dressing*
Shall be planted on it, and they
Shall plant vines on it *in that day*,
And the vine that they plant on it
Shall yield grape juice abundant, fit,
And as for all the seed that's sown,
Each measure shall bear thousand grown,
And each measure of olives yield
Ten presses of oil *in the field*.

The fourteen lovely trees whose leaves do
not

Wither in winter nor dry out and spot
Remain before my visioned eyes to make
Their praises and their passions for Your
sake.

All trees desired and lovely to the eyes
Of Ahmed silently steer toward the skies
To bear the vine that makes the grape juice
run,

To carry bitter olives under sun
Until the fat and fluids of my heart
Rejoice to find that You're not One apart
But intimately reflected upon
The screen of nothingness opened at dawn.
Beloved, I measure out the thousand seed
And find in You the measure that I need.

20 "And cleanse the earth from all
oppression,
From all unrighteousness, *suppression*,
From all sin, from all godlessness,
And all uncleanness to oppress
Upon the earth, destroy from off
The earth *who do wickedly, scoff*.

Oh my Beloved, the prayer of Enoch then
Was without a doubt efficacious when
The flood of waters wiped the earth once
clean

And wickedness disappeared from the
scene.

The promise made with rainbow in the sky
Seemed then a mercy with the glowing try,
But now beyond the wars and pestilence
I return to the prayers of Enoch's tents.

I pray again, as Enoch did of old,
To cleanse both earth and my heart of the
cold

Unwillingness to bow before Your will
And reap the benefit that You have still
For those who pause to know that You are
one
And all on earth in good for You is done.

21 "And all the children of men shall
Become righteous, all nations shall
Offer adoration and shall
Praise Me, and all shall worship Me.
22 "And the earth shall be cleansed and
free

From all defilement, from all sin,
And from all punishment *within*,
And from all torment, and I will
Never again send in its fill
From generation's *very door*
To generations evermore.

I lie submitted and still before You,
An earth, a hill, a sea, horizon's view,
Waiting for that strike from Your hand to
set

The punishment upon my flesh well met
In flood and furnace, till in love I burn
Unquenched by flood waters and what they
earn.

I lie submitted, waiting for the stroke
That shall relieve my soul of sin and
smoke.

The punishment of fire and quick desire
And torment shall raise up funeral pyre
Of all things but Your sacred, final will.
I wait for You uplifted on the hill
That looks out on a hundred islands far
Beneath a setting sun, a moon and star.

Enoch 11

1 "And in those days I'll open up
The store chambers of blessing *cup*
That are in heaven, so's to send
Them down upon the earth *unpenned*
Over the work and labour of
The children of men *whom I love*.
2 "And truth and peace shall be restored
Together through all the days *scored*
Upon the world and throughout all
Men's generations *therewithal*."

I note well, my Beloved, the final state,
The final angel to go and relate,
Returns upon the first and aerial gate,
The gate of law, and Michael stands to rate
The truth in tow, and peace and
righteousness
Flood on the earth, this time a flood to
bless.
Four angels take command, the first to
flood
In Noah's time, to vanquish violent blood
Iniquity, and after that light healing
Upon the earth by the ten plagues of
feeling,
Until the time of Gabriel to stand
Among the empires of a heathen land,
And then at last, as Daniel says, the great
Michael shall stand up for the final fate.

Week 2 Enoch 12

1 Before these things Enoch was hidden,
And none of sons of men *unbidden*
Knew where it was that he was hidden,
2 And where he lived, and what became
Of him, for he was called by name
To work with the Watchers, his days
Were with the holy ones *for praise*.

Beloved, hide me too in the secret cave
Where Enoch is not lost to humble, brave
Elijah, Jesus, and the son of slave
That sped up on the steed to leave the grave
Planned by Abbasid for the fear of throne.

Beloved, hide me too and make me Your
own.

The cradle of both power and wealth I see
Around me like the domain of the flea
Who, though a tiny beast, makes all curs
scream

To waken to reality from dream.

Beloved, hide me too and I shall find there
Beloved Enoch and three to take a share
In the divine light set before Your seat
Where all in secret come to kiss Your feet.

3 I Enoch was blessing the Lord
Of majesty and fiery sword,
The King of the ages. 4 Indeed
The Watchers called on me *with speed*,
Enoch the scribe, and said to me
"Enoch, scribe of righteousness, flee,
Declare to the Watchers of heaven
And those who have left the high heaven,
The holy and eternal place,
And have defiled themselves and face
With women, and have done as do
The children of the earth on cue,
And have taken to themselves wives,
5 "You have accomplished great *contrives*,
Destruction on the earth, and you
Shall have no peace for what you do
Nor forgiveness of sin, and since
They love their sons, they'll come to wince
At the murder of their beloved,
And they shall sorrow for the shoved
Destruction of their children, and
Shall make eternally appeal,
But mercy and peace shall not feel."

The purpose of the occultation then
When Enoch disappeared from among men
Was to take the divine message again
Into the spirit world, the Watchers' spot
And teach them of their coming horrid lot.
The teaching of Enoch to humankind
Is traced out in this book and in this mind.
I do not follow Enoch on his round
Of taking care of devils on the ground,
That is a secret by which human's bound
Is not to tamper without Your command.
I take instead my own self under hand
I learn by their example and their band
To love and obey Your gracious demand.

Enoch 13

1 Enoch went and said "Azazel,
You shall have no peace *for a spell*,
A harsh judgement is laid on you
To put you in custody *too*.

Azazel finds the desert heat and done
In thirst beneath a scorching, slaying sun,
And none but Enoch to rise for the fun
To defend and comfort the Watcher's heart
Who chose to lead the angels from their
part.

Beloved, I come to You and tell a tale
Incriminating Azazel to veil
The ending of experiment and start.
Beloved, I follow Enoch where I see
His flaming cape resound upon the lea,
And hear the secret words and wonder still
That I am caught and stayed upon the hill.
Beloved, seal off my tongue for I have
heard
The whisper of the damning angel's word.

2 Naught shall be given to abate
Your punishment, request you state
Shall not be granted, for the wicked
Things that you've taught, such things
despiked
That you have done in godlessness,
And made of everything a mess,
3 And the unrighteousness and sin
That you have shown to men's *chagrin*."

It takes a bit of courage I would think
To go and talk to devils on the brink.
But then I've got an uncle used to talk
While milking his cows and observing
stock
To devils and try making them repent.
So Enoch might have felt good being sent.
There is no repentance of watchers on
The ages of the world so close to dawn.
Perhaps in times to come, when all is said,
A reconciliation may be bred,
But now the dispensation seems to turn
On letting rebel angels lie and burn.
Beloved, I raise a hat if hat I wear
To Enoch and the courage of the fair.

4 Then I went and spoke to them all
Together, they were under pall
Of fear and trembling seized them *then*.
And they begged me to write again

Petition for them that they might
Find forgiveness *in the Lord's sight*,
And to read their note before YHWH
In heaven. 5 For from then on true
They could not speak *with Him* nor lift
Their eyes up to the heavenly *gift*
For shame of their sins for which they
Had been condemned *upon that day*.

Rebellious Watchers in trembling and fear
Petition Enoch to write for Your ear
That You might forgive them the wicked
plot
They hatched and carried out for what they
got.

Like many after they could not reveal
Their faces to You to repent and heal
For shame of the grave deeds they did
before.

And yet their children know such shame no
more.

If the great giants of experiment
Have been disposed of in the waters sent
Or other means, there are still others plenty
To share rebellious sight in twenty-twenty.
Beloved, with Enoch or without my lay
Is that You look on me with grace today.

6 I wrote their petition appeal,
And the prayer that their spirits feel,
And of their deeds each one regarding
Their requests that, *without retarding*,
7 They should have forgiveness and length.
And I went off and sat *in strength*
Down at the waters of Dan, in
The land of Dan, which is within
The south-west of Hermon, I read
Their petition until I slept.
8 And indeed a dream came and swept
Me up in visions upon me,
And I saw all their penalty,
And a voice came bidding me tell
It to the sons of heaven *in hell*,
And reprimand them. 9 When I woke,
I came to them, *to whom I spoke*,
And they were all sitting together,
Weeping in Abelsjail together,
Which is between Lebanon and
Seneser, with faces in hand.

Though my will is to intercede for those

Who will not grant Your law their flesh and
clothes,
Your mercy has its limits, and it fades
Before rebellious insistence in raids.
Your grace returns, Beloved, from breath to
breath,
But some will turn to darkness and to death
From very kiss of life. The soiled throng
Of the angelic Watchers do the wrong.
Beloved, look on the address of my heart,
South of the Lebanon and in the part
Of Canaan set to Dan, whose skilful hand
Dyes all things purple and who turns
command
Of precious stone and woven works to be
The glory of Your house eternally.

10 And I recounted before them
All the visions I saw in *hem*
Of sleep, and I began to speak
The words of righteousness *they seek*,
And reprimand the heavenly Watchers
For all their sins *and all their botchers*.

The hidden prophet does his task right well
When he goes to speak once to Azazel.
Alas, the angels that from great heaven fell
Into their sin, alas that they appeal
Without result for the reward they feel.
Your grace is given not for tears and pain,
But for those who beneath the summer rain
Stand willingly upon the field of gain
Where You created them and to sustain.
No sacrifice can atone for the sin
Of destruction of the kale and the bin
Divinely placed beneath the angels' span.
I take the warning, I who am a man
Also endowed with tasks to give as can.

Enoch 14

1 The book of words of righteousness,
And of the reprimand *to bless*
The eternal Watchers and by
The command of the Great and High
Holy One in that vision. 2 I
Saw in my sleep what I will now
Say with a tongue of flesh *somehow*
And with the breath of my mouth, which
The Great One has given to men *rich*
To converse with and understand
With the heart. 3 As He has *in band*
Created and given to man power

Of understanding wisdom's shower,
So He's created me also
And given me the power to show
The Watchers, heaven's sons, reprimand.
4 I wrote out your petition, and
In my vision it has appeared
That your petition, *as I feared*,
Will not be granted you throughout
All the days of eternal bout,
And that judgement has *now* been passed
Upon you *all* indeed *at last*,
It will not be granted *as asked*.
5 And from now on you shall not go
Up into heaven, *even masked*,
For all eternity, but low
In bonds of the earth the decree
Has gone forth to bind you to be
For all the days of the world *tree*.

The voice of Enoch follows Your
command,
Beloved, to vouchsafe justice in the land.
He must not fail to curse angelic band
No matter how he hopes the word he
speaks
May be sweet as the honey in the beaks
Of honey-dipper. No man truly will
Curse willingly those sitting on the hill
In misery or power. Each man knows well
His own hour comes beneath death's
whispered spell.
But Enoch the immortal has the right
To bring angelic sorrows to the light.
His tongue is guarded by Your word to stay
Within the measures of the light of day
Illuminating darkness with its ray.

6 Before that you shall have seen how
Your beloved sons die in the row,
And you'll have no pleasure in them,
But they'll fall by the stratagem
Of the sword before you. 7 And your
Petition on their future score
Shall not be granted, nor yet on
Your own, even though you *at dawn*
Weep and pray and speak all the words
Found in my writing *and its herds*.

All takes place by the divine hand of writ,
And no prayer nor tears ever can change it.
The prophecy marks out the course of all
That takes place on the terrestrial ball.

Who have the choice to obey or to scale
The mountain of iniquity avail
Nothing at all to change their chosen fate.
Only grace comes on men because their sin
Was caused by the Watchers, not their own
grin.

Depravity of humankind's a teaching
That gives man more by exuberant
preaching
Than is his true share in the course of
things.

Man is a victim of the powers and kings
Of the airs invisible and their rings.

8 The vision was shown to me thus,
Lo, in the vision nebulous
Invited me and a mist called,
And the course of the stars *installed*
And lightnings sped and hastened me,
And winds in the vision caused me
To fly and lifted me above,
And carried me to heaven *in love*.

The recitation of Your lovely names
Lifts me in vision to where beyond claims
Your heavenly glory waits in glowing
flames.

I ride the lightning from the thunder sound,
The Decalogue still thundering around
Bears me upon its wings as I repeat
The syllables of fire beyond retreat.
The clouds about the mountain bear the
sway
Of swirling visions old from Enoch's day
And without comfort draw me in their
power

Without a shred of hope to win the tower.
I'm laid out beyond consciousness to groan
For being given more than flesh and bone
To rise upon the staff before Your throne.

9 And I went in till I drew near
A wall that is built of the clear
Crystal and bounded round by fire,
And so I there began to fear.

10 And I went in the tongues of fire
And came near a house to enquire,
One great and built of crystals, walls
Of the house were like tessellated
Floor *made* of crystals *there installed*,
And its groundwork was crystal too.

11 Its ceiling was like path *in view*

Of the stars and the lightnings' *crew*,
And between them were cherubim
Of fire, their heaven *to the brim*
Was *clear as* water. 12 Flaming fire
Surrounded *all* the walls *entire*,
And all its portals blazed with fire.
13 And I entered that house, and it
Was hot as fire and cold as fit
Ice, where no delights of life sit.
14 Fear covered me, and trembling came
Upon me. As I quaked *for blame*
And trembled, I fell on my face.

The Quaker, Shaker vision is of old
One that leaves trembling soul both hot and
cold.

I bear the vision to the furthest veil
Not because there is something to avail,
But because I'm caught up here like a leaf
And could descend only by entering grief.
You are not a cold flame that gives the soul
A choice between the dark and utter goal.
You are a lover that with sparkling hand
Takes up caresses that unmake the fanned
Floors of existence and stop at no toll.
Who long for ecstasy are foolish guests
Of the illusions and the veiling nests.
I find in You a peace where nothing rests.

15 And I saw a vision *in place*,
And lo there was a second house,
Greater than the former *for nous*,
And the whole portal stood ajar
Before me, and spectacular
Confected out of flames of fire.
16 And in every way and desire
It so surpassed one to admire,
Magnificence and vast beyond
What I can put in word and bond.

I pass within the bounds of my heart's
place,
The stony chamber hidden from my face,
Where prayer is wont to be made and the
fire
Of sacrifice burn on the altar higher,
And as I enter in the chambered room
I see a deeper house rise from its doom
Whose core is bigger than surrounding
grate,
And in whose love I find love is not late.
Once entered into love my eye abounds

With sights of further rooms above the
grounds
Of nectar, and as my foot enters there
They also give way to a larger stair.
The deeper in the cloistered temple I
The greater Truth resounds against its sky.

17 And its floor *also* was of fire,
And above it were lightnings and
The path of the stars *by command*,
Its ceiling also was aflame.
18 And I looked and saw *to my shame*
Therein a *high and lofty* throne,
Its likeness was as crystal *grown*,
And the wheels of it as the sun
Shining in glory once begun,
And there the sight of cherubim.
19 And from beneath the throne of Him
Came streams of flaming fire undim,
So that I could not look at it.
20 And the Great Glory sat on it,
And His raiment shone more brightly
Than the sun and *in its glory*
Was whiter *far* than any snow.
21 None of the angels *there* could go
In to look at His face because
Of the magnificence *it draws*
And glory and no flesh could look
At Him. 22 A flaming fire there took
Around about Him, and a great
Fire stood before Him *soon and late*,
And none around could come near Him,
23 Ten thousand times ten thousand *grim*
Stood before Him, and yet no need
Of counsellor was His indeed.

Beloved, how I with eager step come in
The temple gate of fire and flame where sin
Is burned away by blazing grace to see
The throne upon a furnace floor and wide
Where in the undimmed light nothing can
hide.
The simple rock-hewn chamber of the heart
Expands to a celestial hall in art
Where angels beyond count stand there to
serve
As long as the eternal arches curve
Above their cantillation-filled prostrations.
I join in the angelic salutations
Until the fires of love devour me whole
And I have no more sacrifice of soul

Extinguished in the loves of all Your
stations.

24 And the most holy ones who were
Near Him did not leave *to confer*
By night nor depart from Him. And
Until then I had been *on land*
Prostrated on my face, trembling,
And YHWH called me, *began to sing*
With His own mouth, and said to me
“Come hear, Enoch, hear my decree.”
25 And one of the holy ones came
To me and woke me *to the flame*,
And He made me rise up, come near
The door, I bowed my face *in fear*.

Beloved, the day is punctuated by
Prostrations of my head and heart, I try
To live between the formal times of prayer
Despite the longing of my soul to share
Prostration at Your throne, again, again.
I lust for prayer as lust for breath most
men.
With each prostration on Your earth it
seems
That my soul hungers for the greater
gleams
Of glory that hide behind the last veil
Just out of reach, and just beyond the pale.
Beloved, the holy ones who bow to You
Do not sleep but repeat Your glories due
By night and day. But sleep outreaches me
To snuff the soul that thirsts eternally.

Enoch 15

1 And He answered and said to me,
And I heard His voice “Fear not *Me*,
Enoch, you righteous man and scribe
Of righteousness *to every tribe*,
Come near and hear My voice. 2 “And go,
Say to the heavenly Watchers so,
Who have sent you to intercede
For them ‘Now you yourselves should
plead
For men, and not men for your *seed*,

Should man plead for an angel on the skid?
Instead angels should plead for human bid,
If what You say is true, Beloved. I see
No fallen Watchers pleading grace for me.
I daresay few there be that intercede
In truth for one another and in need.

Half-hearted are the prayers that raise the
roof
Of church halls and mosques that are given
in proof.
Half-hearted are the prayers, if truth were
told,
A man raises in his own behalf bold
When tempted to rebel against Your law.
A prayer is not made effective by awe.
Beloved, my burning heart turns round
again
To make my wordless prayer a prayer of
men.

3 “Why have you gone out from the high,
Holy, and the eternal sky,
And lain with women, and defiled
Yourselves with men’s daughters *and wild*
And taken to yourselves *such* wives,
And made like earthly child contrives,
Begetting giants *as your* sons?
4 “And though you were of holy ones,
And spirits living life eternal,
You have defiled yourselves *infernally*
With the blood of women, begotten
Children with the blood of flesh *rotten*,
And, just as the children of men,
Have lusted after flesh *again*
And blood as those also who die
And perish. 5 “And therefore have I
Given them wives also that they
Might impregnate them, and that way
Beget children by them, that thus
Nothing might *in the terminus*
Be lacking them on earth. 6 “But you
Were formerly spirits *and true*,
Living eternal life, and not
Dying for generations’ lot
In the world. 7 “And therefore I’ve not
Appointed wives for you *nor sought*,
For as for the ones spiritual
In the sky is their dwelling hall.

The fire of the angelic thought would be
They thought the very finest company
For earthly minds attuned in human breast.
They thought creative judgement was the
best.

Imagination’s glint is siren still
And calls the scientist to foot the bill,
While faithfulness is too far-fetched to
groan

Before the golden stairway and the throne.
Beloved, I see the trembling flesh and take
A vision of its horrors for the sake
Of knowledge and the passion of the snake.
Beloved, I hear the rumbling mesh and
know
The sights beyond the sounds may never
grow
To glory, yet I still applaud the show.

8 “And now, the giants, who have come
From spirits and flesh *in their sum*,
Shall be called evil spirits on
The earth, and on the earth *anon*
Shall be their dwelling. 9 “There have
come

Evil spirits proceeding from
Their bodies, because they are born
From men and *what is not to scorn*
From holy Watchers is their start
And origin, they shall have part
As evil spirits on the earth,
And spirits of evil *in worth*
For what they’ve done they shall be called.

10 “[As for the heavenly spirits stalled,
In heaven shall be their dwelling, but
As for the spirits on earth *shut*
That were born on the earth, on earth
Shall be their dwelling *in its girth*.]

The earth once good and beautiful that
came
From Your word and creating hand, the
same

Is now despite the beauty of its airs
A gaol and prison filled with evil cares,
The spirits that haunt every buttercup
And shed where light is shadows coming
up.

They dwell upon the earth, it is a thing
That cannot be denied, since the cold wing
Is felt upon the summer dewy grass
As well as in the frozen tundra pass.
And yet the evil spirit is a wind
That merely brushes where the angels
sinned
And moves invisibly and shut apart,
While beauty stands unsullied in my heart.

The spirits of giants afflict,
Oppress, destroy, attack, inflict
Battle, and work destruction on

The earth, and cause trouble thereon,
They take no food, but hunger yet,
And thirst, and cause offences met.

The evil spirits that trample the just
And turn the diamond of dawn to mere dust
Hunger but yet take no food, no, nor trust
The water to quench thirst of whetted heel.
The dark wings shiver at the thunder's peal,
The groans arise from where the people
kneel,

But all the air is rife through silent steel
Above the cold and flaking red of rust.
Beloved, I flee to You from every sight
Of mercy and of victims in their plight,
I flee to You above the beating air,
I flee to You upon the golden stair.

My footsteps echo on the star-stemmed
arch

Beyond the sweeping birch and settled
larch.

11 "These spirits shall rise and attack
The children of men *at their back*
And against women, because they
Proceeded from them *in their day*.

All peoples know the evil spirits well
That clamour for sacrifice and the spell
To keep life on an even keel in boat
That ships the silver water on the float.
The rational of Scotsmen perhaps doubts
Existence of the evil spirits' spouts,
But otherwise all peoples have their ways
To appease evil spirits for their days.
Enoch reveals the origin of those
Dark fears in superstition's natural clothes
As actors in a cosmic reel and dance
That towers above the mimicry of prance
In modern psychiatric pseudo-pants.
Exchange the myths for sale in their repose.

Enoch 16

1 "From the days of the slaughter and
Destruction and death *by the hand*
Of the giants, from the selves of
Whose flesh the spirits without love,
Having gone out, destroy without
Incurring blame, thus *without doubt*
They shall destroy until the day
Of consummation *on the way*,
The great judgement in which the age

Shall be consummated *in stage*,
Over the Watchers and godless,
Lo, all shall be finished address.

Mercy is Yours, Beloved, that You still
stand
Above the giants' disburdened fair land.
True, violence still stalks the waiting band
Of innocents beneath the Tigris' strand,
But every giant now that lays me waste
Is fully human, though in steel well-laced.
The ogres pass into the storybooks
For children whose eyes rove the hidden
nooks

Of nurseries till the hour of sleep returns.
No more do dragons scorch the lochs and
burns.

If violence is found, the perpetrator
Is always just a man and nothing greater.
Beloved, I bless You that within my heart
You still send out destruction of sin's part.

2 "And now as for the watchers who
Have sent you here that you may do
Intercession for them, and who
Had lately been in heaven and true,
Say to them 3 "'You have been in heaven,
But all the mysteries *of leaven*
Had not been shown you, and you knew
Worthless ones, and these in your hearts
Of hardness you have made known arts
To the women, and through these things
Of mystery women and *kings*
Of men work great evil on earth.'
4 "Say to them therefore *'In the dearth*
You shall have no peace, *underlings*.'"

The Watchers shall have no Islam or peace
Because the mischiefs of their sons
increase

Upon the earth, and make their punishment.
All beings are punished in what was meant
By their sons, whether for the common
weal

Or for the evil incantations' spiel.
The power of rhetoric still gapes abroad
To rule a world by cantillating rod.
Save my poor soul, Beloved, from rhyme
and rent

That go about the pathways of descent
To stoke the fires of native undesire
Beneath the iron and marbled kingly ire.

I seek, Beloved, that peace and Islam sent
On humankind, and bird and beast unbent.

Enoch 17

1 And they took me and brought me to
A place in which those who were there
Are like a flaming fire *in crew*,
And, when they wished to appear fair,
They came as men. 2 And they brought me
To the place of darkness to be,
And to a mountain that reached up
Its summit to the heavenly cup.

That mountain I have climbed that reaches
to
The fields of everlasting clover dew,
The darkness of the night work and the rate
Of struggle for the sunlight at the gate.
That mountain about sea and flame and air
That despite higher stone still keeps its
share
Of earth beneath the feet of climber there.
Indeed they may appear as men or yet
As sirens in the clover fields to get
A hand upon the passing searcher's
shoulder.

I press on toward the furthest, utmost
boulder.
Beloved, they took me and brought me to
find
The cave of darkness may be home of
blind,
But I seek higher ground though grassed
and vined.

3 And I saw places of the lights
And treasures of the stars *at nights*
And of the thunder and the deep,
Where were a fiery bow *in keep*
And arrows and their quiver, and
A fiery sword *and out of hand*
All the lightnings *upon the land*.
4 And they took me to running waters,
And to the fire of western *daughters*,
That receives setting of the sun.
5 And I came to a river run
With fire in which the fire flows like
Water and runs out in the strike
To the great sea towards the west.
6 I saw immense rivers and best
Came to the great river and to
The huge darkness, and went into

The place where no flesh walks *or grew*.

Beloved, the continents that I have crossed
Are both the physical and spirit's mossed.
The places I have known are those where
met
Are merchants, travellers, customs men to
get
The benefit of every passer-by,
The places I have known are silent tie
To quiet minds and to the weathered vine.
The lands of mind and spirit are both mine.
Wherever I turn in my wanderings
Of meditation or the floundering
Of feet and wings, I find the river there
That takes in its arms everything but me
And draws all back into the silver sea,
And dreams all back into the silent share.

7 I saw the mountains of the dark
Of winter and the place in park
From where flow all the waters stark
Of the deep. 8 I saw all the rivers
Of the earth in their sources' shivers,
And the mouth of Tehowm in spark.

The very sources of creation span
The depths, the dragon depths, for meagre
man
A place unfathomable, cave of light
Of fire and darkness of primordial night.
I follow Enoch's way upon the reach
Of strangely common pebbles on the beach
Unlit by sun or star, the root and ground
Of all imaginable things in sound.
Rivers of fire beneath the mountain peak
That reaches up to heaven at its seek
Draw on the heart of love, the burning heart
Into the darkened columns from the start
Where even there, behind the sacred gloom
You live, Beloved, as though beyond the
tomb.

Enoch 18

1 I saw the treasures of wind,
I saw how He'd made disciplined
The whole creation and the firm
Foundations of the earth, the term
Of the earth's corner-stone, 2 I saw
The four winds *and that bear with awe*
The expanse of the heaven, I saw
How the winds stretch out on the vaults

Of heaven, and have their station *faults*
 Between the sky and earth, 3 these are
 The pillars of the sky *and bar*.
 4 I saw the winds of heaven that turn
 And bring the sun's circuit *to burn*
 And all the stars to their setting.
 5 I saw the winds on the earth's *wing*
 Bear up the clouds, I saw the paths
 Of the angels. 6 I saw the *laths*
 Of the sky's firmament above
 At the end of the earth *to shove*.

Some prove divine the origin of writ
 By how the scientific theories fit
 Into the glowing words of temple gold
 That touches inner chamber with the fold
 Of faith. I think attempts at such are vain,
 And yet I see here set down clear and plain
 Description of the solar wind abroad
 As though men knew the secrets of space
 odd
 Upon the shore. Such words are no more
 proof
 Of inspiration than figures aloof
 That seem to contradict the latest theory
 Are proofs that word is something for the
 leery
 To scoff at. My beloved, I would recite
 Your names merely to come into the light.

And I proceeding saw a place
 That burns by day and in the *race*
Of night, where there are seven hills
 Of splendid stones, three towards the *rills*
 To eastward, and three towards the south.
 7 And as for those towards the *mouth*
 To eastward, one was tinted stone,
 And one was pearl, and jacinth tone
 The last, and those towards the south
 Of red stone. 8 But the middle one
 Reached up to heaven like the throne
 Of God, of alabaster, cone
 Of the throne was of sapphire done.
 9 And there I saw a flaming fire.
 10 And beyond these mountains a *dire*
 Region the end of the great earth,
 There the skies were finished in worth.

How many cities on this earth lay claim
 To lying on the seven hills of their fame?
 It's not just Rome, I've heard the saying
 said

In Tallahassee for a truth to spread.
 It's human to appropriate the dare
 Of every bold and sturdy thing to wear.
 Beloved, I come before the seven hills
 To find the river where the life distils
 In the eternities of heavenly fire.
 Your throne upon its hills is my desire.
 I see the sky bend down upon the earth
 Into the straight horizon with its mirth
 Reducing all to one line at Your feet.
 I see the mountain where all things must
 meet.

11 And there I saw a deep abyss,
 With columns made of heavenly fire,
 And among them columns of fire
 I saw fall, which were beyond measure
 Alike towards the height *and treasure*
 And towards the depth. 12 And beyond this
 Abyss I saw a place that had
 No firmament of heaven *clad*
 Above, no firmly founded earth
 Beneath it, there was upon it
 No water, and no birds found fit,
 But it was waste, horrible place.
 13 I saw there seven stars like *mace*
 Great burning mountains, and to me,
 When I inquired of their degree,
 The angel said 14 "This place is end
 Of heaven and earth to comprehend
 A prison for the stars and host
 Of heaven. 15 "And the stars that boast,
 Rolling over the fire, are they
 That have transgressed commandment's
 way
 Of YHWH in the start of their rising,
 Because they did not for despising
 Come forth at their appointed times.
 16 "And He was angry for their crimes,
 And bound them till the time when their
 Guilt should be finished *on the air*
Even for ten thousand years *fair*."

There where the azure curtain of the sky
 Comes down to meet the horror flashing
 by,
 There is the place of awful punishment
 For the stars that in their courses were sent
 And failed from start to be obedient.
 The decrees of Your heavens are fully
 known

By the courses unwayward stars have
 shown,
 But there is no form nor experiment
 To evidence to scientists the way
 Of creature stars who follow their own day.
 A mythic place it must seem to all men
 Who view the divine orchestrations then.
 Beloved, the vision is a warning light
 To guide the wary through the paths of
 night.

Enoch 19

1 And Uriel said to me “Here
 Shall stand the angels *in their fear*
 Who’ve joined themselves with women’s
gear,
 And their spirits assuming many
 Different forms *as well as any*
 Defile mankind and lead them wrong
 To sacrifice to demons *strong*
 As gods, *here shall they stand*, until
 The day of the great judgement fill
 In which they shall be judged until
 They are made an end of *and nil*.
 2 “And of the angels women too
 Who went astray shall become true
 Sirens.” 3 And I, Enoch, alone
 Saw the vision, the ends full-*blown*
 Of all things, and no man shall see
 As I have seen *eternally*.

No man shall see as Enoch saw that time
 The ends of every good deed and each
 crime,
 But all can see who gaze upon the clear
 That fornication with the spirits near
 Results in gross idolatry or mere
 Cunningly structured, base theologies
 That claim to honour You and praise and
 please,
 And yet fail in obedience’ decree.
 Beloved, I hand to You what pleasures me
 Of brave creations in philosophy,
 And take You at Your word though man of
 flesh
 Can never understand the depths that mesh
 The dark and light reflections in the fresh
 Reverberations of false liturgy.

Week 3. Enoch 20

1 These are the holy angels’ names
 Who watch. 2 Uriel, one and same

Of the holy angels, whose claim
 Is on the world and Tartarus.
 3 Raphael, one felicitous
 Of holy angels, who is over
 The spirits of men *as a drover*.
 4 Raguel, holy angels’ one
 Who takes vengeance *with vengeance done*
 5 On the world of the luminaries.
 6 Michael, one of the holy skerries,
 Set over the best part of man
 And over chaos *in the span*.
 7 Saraqael, one of the holy
 Angels, who is set over lowly
 Spirits, who sin in their own way.
 8 Gabriel, one of the holy *sway*
 Of angels, who is over *lay*
 Of paradise and the serpents
 And the cherubim *in their tents*.
 Remiel, one *not to despise*
 Of the holy angels *in skies*
 Whom God set over those who rise.

The seven archangels each remove a veil
 Till seven all told lie at the feet in scale
 And vistas of the universe arise
 Before the wondering faqir’s opened eyes.
 Your light, Beloved, on Tartarus is needed
 If Uriel is Your light though unheeded.
 Raphael rules humankind’s spirits while
 Raguel heeds the lanterns on the style,
 Michael the fourth rules men, women and
 chaos,
 While Saraqael the sinful spirit laos.
 Gabriel watches Paradise with grim
 Eye on the serpent and the cherubim.
 Remiel only lifts a glittering eye
 On those that rise into the chambered sky.

Enoch 21

1 And I proceeded to where things
 Were chaotic. 2 And in the rings
 I saw there something horrible,
 3 I saw neither a heaven in full
 Nor a firmly founded earth, but
 A place chaotic and unshut.

Chaos is such an idea that the mind
 Though not escaping every form and blind
 Still comes again to the brink to see if
 The thing is truly as it seems or stiff.
 From chaos every man believes arises
 Creation and creator’s desired prizes.

And so I too turn toward chaotic fount
Of poetry and cosmos for account.
Beloved, if all the universe remains
Something of horror for its human pains,
None can escape the mythopoeic view
That makes the shifting patterns out of
dew.

Let me enjoy the empty light and shade
While You know all that You have truly
made.

4 And there I saw the seven stars
Of heaven bound within its bars,
Like great mountains and burning fire.
5 Then I said "For what sin's *desire*
Are they bound, and on what account
Have they been cast upon this mount?"
Then said Uriel, one of those
Holy angels, come to *disclose*
To me, and was chief over them,
He said "Enoch, why do You ask,
The meaning and the stratagem,
And why are You eager for *task*
To *know* truth? 6 "These are of the number
Of heaven's stars, which do encumber
Themselves with disobedience
To YHWH's commandment *given for*
sense,
And are bound here ten thousand years,
Until the time of their arrears
Of sins, are finished *to last cents.* "

Ah my Beloved! Hear of the day to come
When the great stars that make up seven's
sum

Bound in the place of horrors at the brink
Of universe, arise again to think!
Ten thousand years, no more, shall make
their toil

And then the seven stars up from the spoil
Shall ascend to the heavens from the coil,
Majestically, forgiven their trespass,
To take their places on the empty pass
Ten thousand years left dark and sorrowful.
The seven stars, not meek, but dutiful,
Ascend the empty thrones and raise a hand
To shed God's light upon the murky land.
That day I shall not fail to understand.

7 From there I found another place,
Which bore still more horrendous face
Than the preceding, and I saw

A horrible thing *at the draw,*
A great fire there that burned and blazed,
And the place was split down and crazed
As far as the abyss, and full
Of huge descending columns' pull
Of fire, and neither its extent
Nor limit could my eye prevent,
Nor could I fathom. 8 Then I said
"How fearful is this place and dread
To look upon!" 9 Uriel said
To me in answer, who was one
Of the holy angels begun
To be with me, he said to me
"Enoch, why such fear frightfully?"
10 And I answered "Because of this
Fearful place, and because of this
Spectacle of the pain." And he
Said to me "This place is the *free*
Prison of the angels, and here
They will for evermore appear."

Some angels' sins are great enough to mete
Eternal punishment outside the seat
Of universe and light, upon the ground
Unfirm, unformed, where neither sight nor
sound
Greet eye and ear with the familiar dance
Of praise to You, Beloved, in their
advance.

Before the vast and gloomy halls where
they
Suffer for sins unfathomed in my day
My heart recoils, my spirit turns away,
In dumb, motionless prostration to stray.
Read no scroll for my doubts, answer no
quest,

Beloved, at times my ignorance is best,
Since there are caverns of the universe
Too deep for human blessing or for curse.

And yet, Beloved, do not I look on hells
That ring about me in their twinkling bells
Pretending to be life and love and light,
When they instead are caverns of the night?
The pitiful, bleak pain that started from
Auschwitz's quays diffuses here where
come
The tons of people flesh whose work makes
free

To wallow in a blind and festered glee.
Not that I gaze with horror on abyss,
But that I take for granted all of this.

Beloved, in one sweep of awakenings
I spread my soul's silken and copper wings
And rise to circle on the tepid air
Until I meet a current fresh, cold, bare.

Enoch 22

1 From there I found another place,
Where was a hill of hard rock face.
2 And there were four hollows in it,
Deep, wide and very smooth *and fit*.
How smooth are the hollows and deep
And dark to look at *on the steep!*

Four gates there be in life and divine
breath,
Four gates are still the covenant of death.
There is no escape from the pit nor from
The golden stair to heaven where angels
come.

The choice is ever before human eye
To ramp upon the mountains to the sky
Or sink into the fellows of the pit
Where almost all the world will come to sit.
Enoch alone saw that fair death and flew
Out from its talons in refuge to You.
Beloved, I chose the gate of law and love
As long as I have knowing and truth of
Your being, and so when I see the stone
I shall sink there prostrating at Your throne.

3 Then Raphael answered and said
One of holy angels who led,
"These hollow places were created
For this very purpose *and stated*,
That spirits of the dead souls should
Assemble there *as best they could*,
Indeed that all the souls of sons
Of men should gather *from their runs*.

All men assemble each in his own state
To find the judgement where You sit and
wait
Upon the universe that You have made
Until the dawn arises rosed and greyed.
The work of six days at last becomes still,
The fevered stroke of battle on the hill
And glint of plough, and spark of steel once
laid
Is silent before the four places stayed.
From east to west the chain of life goes
round
Until reversal of the sun is found,

And southern winds beat on the humbled
ground,
And northern lights in vast convulsions
sound
The static warning and the soul looks up
To find the waited, unexpected cup.

4 "And these places were made to hold
Them till the day of judgement bold
And till appointed time, the great
Judgement on them *decides their fate*."
I saw a dead man making suit,
And his voice went up *from the root*
To heaven for appeal. 5 And I
Asked Raphael the angel why,
Who was with me, and so said I
To him, 6 "This spirit that makes suit,
Whose is it, whose voice goes and makes
Appeal to heaven?" 7 For their sakes
He answered me saying "This is
The spirit that went forth from his
Abel, whom his brother Cain slew,
And he appeals against him due
Till his seed is destroyed from face
Of *all* the earth, and his seed's place
Has disappeared from seed of men."

I join my cry to Abel's from the ground
And make an everlasting mournful sound
That prophets are elected from the last,
And righteous men forever are outcast.
Beloved, You spoke to Cain and left the
poor
Without protection from the evil spoor.
Now hear his plaint and give justice its way
Now and again upon the judgement day!
The rocky hollows are an evil place
Without a soft pillow or bed to face
The weary centuries of crying high
That You might hear the suit when passing
by.
Yet how familiar have the hollows come
In my heart's centuries without a crumb!

8 Then I asked about it again,
About all the hollows, "Why's one
Divided from the other run?"
9 He answered me and said to me
"These three have been made so freely
That the dead spirits might divide
And find a place where they might hide.
Such separation has been made

For righteous spirits *on parade*,
In which there is a shining spring
Of water *for their refreshing*.
10 “And such has been made for sinners
When they die and are buried fers
In the earth and judgement has not
Been executed in their life,
And they’ve not yet stood in their lot.

O well of Kauthar! My Beloved, let me
Find that well and that river where I see
The rising darkness and the silenced breath,
The weakened heart-beat entranced upon
death!

O lovely spring of which Israel once fair
Sang in the wilderness beyond thirst there,
I follow Moses’ rod and see the spring
That Enoch opened upon every wing
That crowds about Ali’s green pitcher
where
The alabaster fountains shed their share.
Beloved, as I come daily in my stride
To forkings in my pathway on each side,
Let me run straight toward the flowing well
Of living waters where no thirstings spell.

11 “Here their spirits *because of strife*
Shall sit apart in this great pain
Till the great day of judgement *reign*
And punishment and torment come
On those who curse for ever *numb*
And retribution for their spirit.
12 “There He’ll bind them forever *near it*.
And such a separation’s made
For the spirits who make their stayed
Appeal, who make their revelations
About their destruction and rations,
When they were slain in sinners’ days.
13 “Such has been made for human ghosts
Who were not righteous but the *boasts*
Of sinners, who full of transgression,
With transgressors make no confession,
But their spirits shall not be slain
In the day of the judgement plain,
Nor shall they be raised up from there.”
14 Then I blessed YHWH of glory fair
And said “Blessed be my Lord, YHWH of
Righteousness, who rules aye *in love*.”

The quarter caverns laid out in high hell
Challenge the heart to make a ring and
spell.

Beloved, may I in life make my choice well
To have neither a suit against the raging
Nor transgressions without atonement
staging,
To keep me from the waters sweet and pure
Of Kauthar and the modelled green contour
Of alabaster cup bourn in the hand
Of Your lion of God upon the land.
Then I shall bless You too in righteousness
And without plaint before You to address,
Like Enoch, in his living body still,
Went up to open eyes and there to fill
His heart with knowledge of the good and
ill.

Enoch 23

1 From there I found another place
To the west ends of the earth’s space.
2 And I saw there a burning fire
Which ran without rest from desire,
3 And paused not from its course by day
Or by night but ran all the way.
4 And I asked saying “What is this
That does not rest *as though in bliss?*”
Then Raguel, one of the holy
Angels who was with me, *though lowly*,
Answered me and said to me “This
Course of fire that You’ve seen is fire
In the west that goes forth in ire
Against the heavenly lanterns come
And all of the celestial sum.”

Beloved, upon an evening to extol
I stop to meditate and raise my soul
Toward the western sky, and at my flight
I meet Raguel clothed in crimson light
Who spoke to Enoch, not to such as me,
And showed the glories of the western sea
Of fire and flame that jutted from the shore
Of the horizon and in cloud up-bore
The whole of heaven’s light it seemed, and
more.
Pinned like a butterfly or coloured moth
To the grey of my exhibition cloth,
I stop my living to one concentrate
And timeless breath to see the heavens
mate,
Forget perhaps to move again, relate.

Enoch 24

1 From there I saw another place
Of the earth *and the earthly race*,

And he showed me a mountain range
 Of fire that burned day and night *strange*.
 2 And I went beyond it and saw
 Seven mountains gathered for awe
 All differing each from the other,
 And their stones were marvellous, brother,
 And beautiful, magnificent
 Throughout, of glorious ascent,
 And fair to see, three towards the east,
 One set upon the other *creased*,
 And three towards the south, one on
 The other, and deep rough ravines,
 No one of which was laid upon
 Any other among the scenes.

The seven mountains rise behind the fire
 That I cannot pass without choosing dire
 Results upon myself and my own life.
 Beloved, for the fragrance above the strife
 I sacrifice my head, my self, my light,
 And go into the soft-enclosed night.
 The fiery veils are torn to my relief,
 I scale the seven mountains to my grief,
 And stand before the throne to take the fief,
 And find the everlasting dates in sight.
 Beloved, You cast up visions before men
 To bring them to their knees and yet again
 You raise the veils and cast them tumbling
 down
 Upon the blue cobblestones of the town.

3 And the seventh mountain was in
 The middle of these, and though kin,
 Was greater than them all in height,
 Resembling a throne's seat in sight,
 With fragrant trees around the throne.
 4 And among them was a tree grown
 Such as I had never yet smelt,
 Nor was there any of them felt
 Like it, it had a fragrance past
 All fragrances, and its leaves last
 And blossoms and wood never cast.
 5 Its fruit is lovely, and its fruit
 Resembles the dates from palm root.
 Then I said "How lovely's this tree,
 And fragrant, and its leaves to see
 Are fair, and its blooms for delight
 In their appearance *day and night*."
 6 Then Michael, one of the holy
 And honoured angels who's with me,
 And is their leader, answered free.

Beloved, let Michael come to me to say
 What lovely things in fragrance and in day
 The middle tree has for the soul in fruit,
 The blossoms lighting every path for boot.
 The garden once held two trees there in
 choice,
 The one for life, the other giving voice
 To knowing right from wrong within the pit
 Of stony heart each human finds to sit.
 But here the choice is passed, the scented
 leaves
 Warn of no danger beyond Michael's
 sleeves.
 I touch my forehead to the mulchy sod
 Acknowledging both life belongs to God
 And right to turn the justice of earth down.
 Beloved, I find You lurking in the town.

Enoch 25

1 And he said to me "Enoch, why
 Do you ask me of what you spy,
 The fragrance of the growing tree,
 And why would you learn truth from me?"
 2 Then I answered him saying "I
 Wish to know about all I spy,
 But specially about this tree."
 3 And he answered saying to me
 "This high mountain that You have seen,
 Whose summit is beyond like sheen
 Of the *high* throne of Alohim,
 Is His throne, where the Holy Great
 One, YHWH of Glory, sits in state,
 Eternal King, when He shall come
 Down to visit the earth in sum
 With goodness. 4 "As for this fragrant
 Tree, to no mortal shall He grant
 To touch it till the great judgement,
 When He shall take vengeance that's sent
 On all and bring all to its end
 Forever. 5 "Then that *tree* shall spend
 Itself upon the righteous and
 Holy. Its fruit shall be *in hand*
 For food to the elect *that stand*,
 It shall be planted in the place
 Of holiness *for love and grace*,
 The temple of YHWH and the king
 Eternal over everything.

One tree instead of two is set to wait
 The judgement of the world and each
 man's fate.

All come alike to one tree tall and straight,

Filled with leaves healing the righteous and
mate,
But working death eternal on the son
Of wickedness, one reward for things done
Results in life to those who touch Your
throne

And death to those who set for the
unknown.

No mortal hand can touch the leaf or flower
Until the raising of the judgement hour,
And yet my Sabbaths come in judgement
set

Each week and I find the fruit again met
In foretaste of the rising of the bell,
The coming of the ocean and its swell.

6 “They shall rejoice with joy and be
Glad, and they shall enter in the
Holy place, its fragrance shall be
In their bones, and they shall live long
Upon earth, a life such as your
Fathers lived *in the days of yore*,
And in their days shall be no song
Of sorrow or plague or torment,
Calamity shall touch no tent.”

7 Then I blessed Alohim for glory,
The King Eternal, one whose story
Prepared such things for the righteous,
And has created them *and us*
And promised to give them *such glory*.

The reward of the loving heart is not
A mere garden and tree in heavenly plot
Beyond the day of judgement and long
sought,
But in the very heavenly heart of now
That is no chamber of the mortal plough,
For no one living to die can come there
Except through sacrifice of self in prayer.
Who hope alone for the reward in gift
For what they’ve done amid the precious
rift
Shall never taste celestial date and sweet
Although they fall down weeping at Your
feet.

The future bears reward and pleasure for
The soul that now enters the secret door
And lies prostrate beneath the leaves in
store.

Enoch 26

1 From there I went upon the earth

Towards its centre, saw in worth
A blessed place in which there were
Abiding trees whose branches stir
With blossoms. 2 There I saw a holy
Mountain, and there beneath it lowly
And to the east there was a stream
And it flowed south *as if in dream*.

Three stages in the journey that I make
Appear before my soul and eye to take
Me to the harbour of love and the stake
Of Enoch’s tower and hiding place awake.
I wander now upon the rising land
Covered with fourteen evergreens that
stand

In forests unblighted with falling leaf,
Even the birch and aspen without grief
Are clothed and singing in the rising
breeze.

But beyond fragrant wood and fragrant
trees

Rises the mountain where my steps would
freeze

As I rush toward the higher land on stone
To find the living waters at Your throne,
The rest of my reward and its relief.

3 And I saw towards the east another
Mountain some higher than its brother,
And there between the two a deep
And narrow canyon, from the steep
Also ran a stream underneath
The mountain *and upon the heath*.

4 And to the west of it there stood
Another mountain, lower wood
Than the former and not so high,
And there between them deep and dry
A canyon, and where the three hills
End there another deep and dry
Canyon ran. 5 And of all the spills
The ravines were narrow and deep,
Formed of hard rock and made so steep
That trees were not planted to keep.

6 And so I marvelled at the rocks,
And marvelled at the canyons’ stocks,
Indeed, I marvelled in a heap.

Who think with minds too literal to know
Reality beyond the wayward show
Of rock crystal, proteins and H₂O,
Dismiss the vision as nonsense because
They’re certain the earth has by all its laws

No centre, all things being situated
 On one globe that's through all time just
 rotated.
 Not so. Each man knows well enough the
 centre
 Of the earth's where he stands himself and
 bent her.
 For others the world's centre's found to be
 In Mecca, Quds, or Rome at Jubilee.
 My door's threshold in all reality
 Is the world's centre because You and I
 There meet each day beneath the middle
 sky.

Enoch 27

1 Then I said "Why's this blessed land,
 That is wholly filled up with grand
 Trees, here and why is this accursed
 Valley between them *for the worst?*"
 2 Then Uriel, one of the holy
 Angels who was with me though lowly,
 Answered and said "This accursed place
 Is a valley for accursed race
 Forever, here shall be there gathered
 Together all the accursed *tethered*
 Whose lips pronounce words against
 YHWH
 In blasphemy and speak undue
 Things of His glory. Here they'll be
 Gathered together, here shall be
 Their place of judgement. 3 "In last days
 There shall fall on them *for their ways*
 The sight of righteous judgement there
 Before the righteous *in their care*
 Forever, here the merciful
 Shall bless YHWH of glory and full
 The King Eternal. 4 "In the days
 Of judgement for their former ways,
 They shall bless Him for the mercy
 By which He's sentenced them to be."
 5 Then I blessed YHWH of glory and
 Set forth His glory in the land
 And praised His name gloriously.

There is no sin but this, Beloved, I see,
 And that's to speak against Your name and
 fame.
 For this offence and this offence only
 Those in the valley cursed receive their
 blame.
 There is no righteous work by which the
 blessed

Are rewarded to enter into rest
 But this one work, a heart with mercy filled
 And overflowing, from which mercy
 spilled.
 The whole world's made of blasphemers
 and those
 Who have mercy upon the ones You chose.
 The root of every sin is not to know
 The meaning of Your name and not to
 show
 Its glory in the quiet act and word
 Wherein the merciful always concurred.

Enoch 28

1 And from there I went towards the east,
 Into the middle range *at least*
 Of mountains in the desert tract,
 And I saw wilderness *in fact*,
 And it was solitary, full
 Of trees and plants *delectable*.
 2 And water gushed forth from above.
 3 Rushing like an abundant *love*,
 The watercourse towards north-west
 Flowed making clouds and dew to rest
 On every side and there above.

The north-west watercourse is rarely found
 In Palestine upon the Jordan's ground
 And so expresses the exotic round
 Of Egypt and the Oriental sound.
 My whirling turns an eastward cast to go
 Along the birchen forests to the glow
 Of tundras where the north-west waters
 slow
 To meet the northern sea, there I may
 know.
 The desert mountains filled with trees still
 meet
 My eye as I turn myself from defeat
 And follow on the crust to melted snow.
 I disappear to eyes behind my back
 Among the shadows misting up my track
 Within Your heart, Beloved, incognito.

Enoch 29

1 From there I found another place
 In the desert, approached its *trace*
 From the east of this mountain range.
 2 And there I saw *wonders and strange*
 Aromatic trees exhaling
 The fragrance of frankincensing
 And myrrh, and the trees also were

Like an almond tree *at the stir*.

Ah my Beloved, I too have seen the trees
Of desert and of mountain on the breeze,
And of the plain and marshland, I have
seen

The lovely and the giant and the green.

Ah my Beloved, what sweeter perfume
comes

Upon the air by Your trees with their drums
Beating out cantillations made so sweet
That they are heard by eye, and seen by
feet,

And savoured for perfume by hand and
heart

As well as by the nostrils feigning art.

Ah my Beloved, I too have run and danced
Among the sacred trees whose voice has
pranced

To claim and proclaim always more Your
name.

Beloved, I too have savoured cedar flame.

Enoch 30

1 And beyond these, I went toward

The far east, and I saw a *shored*
Valley filled with water in place.

2 And in it there was a *grown* tree,
Like fragrant trees such as mastic.

3 And on the valley sides grown thick
I saw the fragrant cinnamon.

And beyond these my journey's run
Proceeded towards the eastern *sun*.

I sit in the shade of a rock to see
The mighty Euphrates spread before me,
And mark the violence of that quick stream
That comes to me in nightmare and sweet
dream.

I see the many colours shake their cloak
About the evening sky as though in smoke
And regal dance to fire horizon's lie.
And on my lap my friend slumbers the by,
Unconscious that the fragrant trees below
Are threatened by a dam project not slow
To wrest from us the gardens and the peach
And drown at last the apricot from reach.
That high rock is now on the lapping shore
Of the lake backed up by the dam in store.

Enoch 31

1 And I saw other mountains, and

Among them there were groves of trees,
And, *like the scents of Samaraqand*,
There flowed forth nectars *from the lees*
Sarara's and galbanum's *ease*.

2 Beyond these mountains there I saw
Another mountain to the east

Beyond where earth ends, *at the draw*,

Grew aloe-trees, and not the least,

The trees were full of stacte like

To almond trees, and when one burned it,

3 It smelled sweeter than one had earned it,
Than any fragrant odour's feast.

The heathen Canaanites worshipped
beneath

The groves of Palestine, the Celtic heath
And Saxon hope were bound up in the oak.

If any heart's perennial it's one

That turns towards the trees under the sun

To seek the true and hidden. Heathen share

Is right that You have hidden in the fair

Forest the aromatic winds and air.

But even heathen must turn from the tree

To find the heart creating faithfully.

But turning there, You are not far away,

But are found waiting where the aloes stay,
And where the frankincense bears

wondered sway

Upon the wooded hills and fragrant lea.

Enoch 32

1 And after all these fragrant scents,
As I looked towards northern ascents

Over the mountains I saw seven

Mountains full of the nard of heaven

And fragrant trees and cinnamon

And pepper *lying in the sun*.

The four scents that arise upon the days
Numbered in seven to acclaim all my ways

Are four gates of experience in views

Of You, Beloved, in all the sparkling dews.

The sky-nard and the pungent trees awake

To fill with cinnamon anointings' sake

To where the gate of truth springs up to
take

Away my breath and knowing on the wake

Of pepper strewn upon my path and bed.

In pepper at last let my soul be led

To find above the tang and sweet that all

Men must respond like pepper to Your call,

And none are left to flee upon the wall

When time eternal shall break out of stall.

2 And from there I went over tops
Of all these mountains *without stops*,
Far towards the east end of the earth,
And passed above the Erythraean sea
And went far from it *and its girth*,
And passed the angel Zotiel.
And I came to a place to see
The garden of righteousness *well*,
3 And I saw from afar off trees
More numerous than all of these
Trees and the two great trees were there,
Very great, beautiful, and fair
In glory, and magnificent,
And the tree of knowledge *unspent*,
Whose holy fruit they eat and know
Great wisdom. 4 And that tree in show
Is in height like the fir, its leaves
Are like those of the carob's eaves,
5 And its fruit's like clusters on vine,
Very beautiful, and the fine
Fragrance of the tree spreads afar.
6 Then I said 'How lovely *like star*
Is the tree, and how fine to see!'
Then Raphael the holy one,
The angel, who was there with me,
Answered and said to me *to stun*
'This is the tree of wisdom, that
Your ancient father, where he sat,
And aged mother, before you,
Tasted, and learned the wisdom due,
And their eyes were opened, and they
Knew they were naked *in the way*,
Driven from the garden to stray.'

The myth of generations makes the tree
Of knowledge horrid in its memory,
But nothing horrible is found in it,
A tree whose fruit is holy and still fit.
The sin was not in eating of the tree
That was attractive to make the blind see,
But in taking initiative to be
The one to choose the time to take the
wealth
Of secret knowledge and to take in stealth
What You, Beloved, in Your good time
bestow
Upon the soul that's patient and relies
On You for knowledge that will make her
wise.

Who waits on You, Beloved, will come to
know

At times appointed both the yes and no.

Week 4. Enoch 33

1 And from there I went to the ends
Of the earth and saw there great *friends*,
Great beasts, and each one different from
The other, and *I saw* birds come
Also varied in their appearance
And their beauty and their sound's
clearance,

Each one differing from the other.
And to the east of those beasts' *mother*
I saw the ends of the earth where
The sky rests, and the heavenly gates
Open. 2 And I saw the stars there
Come forth from heaven *to their estates*,
And I counted the portals out
Of which the stars came round about,
3 And wrote down all their outlets, for
Each single star and by its door,
According to their number and
Their names, their courses over land
And their positions, and their times
And their months *going round in rhymes*,
As Uriel the holy one
Of the angels who on the run
Was with me and showed me *the fun*.
4 He showed all things to me and wrote
Them down for me, also he wrote
Their names for me, he wrote their laws
And their companies *without flaws*.

Uriel, who's the light of God, first taught
A human being what he'd always sought,
Ability to write, not just to keep
A record for posterity of deep
Sayings, nor notes to help the memory,
But as an art to cherish tenderly.
Beloved, Your hand threw out the spinning
stars
Across the sky and let down the gates' bars
That scattered them in heaven, while
wondering man
Looks helpless on the vastness of the span.
I join my heart to Yours by tracing out
With stylus on the clay what Your stars
shout,
And find myself joined with the divine soul
In heaven above, though only earthly mole.

Enoch 34

1 And from there I went out toward
The north to the earth's ends' accord,
A great contrivance there I saw
And glorious beyond my awe
There at the ends of the whole earth.
2 And here I saw three portals' *girth*
In heaven open in the sky,
Through each of them come forth the high
North winds, and when they blow there's
cold,
Hail, frost, and snow, dew, rain *untold*.
3 And out of one portal they blow
For good, but when they come to show
Through the other two portals, then
It is with violent destruction
Upon the earth for beasts and men,
They blow with violent production.

The arctic winds made swirls about the
snow
And showed where rocks and bushes hid
below
Or not because the snowdrifts were so deep
They left all hidden in their silent sleep.
I take to skis and in the bated breath
Of northwind's pausing, set out daring
death
And without break or turning seal my fate
To find the last fells bottom or be late.
Beloved, the memory of flying once
Reigns still upon my heart to bear the
brunts
Of northwinds ever after. So I hear
The groan, the whistle and call without fear
To sleep safe and warm under snowdrifts
calm
Dreaming of myrrh and frankincense and
palm.

Enoch 35

1 And from there I went towards the west
To the ends of the earth, and saw
There three portals of heavenly best
Open such as I'd seen in awe
Upon the east, the same number
Of portals, and the same number
Of outlets *streaming up in zest*.

Had I been Enoch I might have stopped
here
To say a word of how east might appear,

For I have seen from Kuwait's beaches far
Toward the glowing Indic's rising star
And felt the spray and smelt the dampened
tar
Of fishing boats now stranded on the bar.
And I have looked across the rushing
stream
Of the Euphrates and seen as in dream
The thousand colours before night that
seem
To veil the mystic mountains of the east.
I have looked out and wondered there at
least.
But I am not Enoch, and east is set
Far, far across the forests still unmet
That turn to tundra at the brave banquette.

Enoch 36

1 And from there I went to the south
To the ends of the earthly *mouth*,
And saw there three open sky gates,
And out of them there come dew's states,
And rain and wind. 2 And from there I
Went to the eastern ends of sky,
And saw here the three eastern gates
Of heaven opened and small gates
Above them. Through each of these gates
Pass the stars of heaven on their rates
Toward the west on the path that
Is shown to them. 3 And as I sat
To see I always blessed the Lord
Of glory, and *in His reward*
Continued to bless YHWH of glory
Who has made great and wonders' story,
To show the vastness of His work
To the angels *who do not shirk*
And to the spirits and to men,
That they might praise His work again
And all creation from His hand,
That they might see His tasks of power
And praise His hands' great work *an hour*
And bless Him forever *in band*.

In every way I turn I see come out
The portals of the skies and turn about
The cloudy messengers of hail and rain,
The mists and snows, the breezes on the
plain.
The secret place and net from where the
breath
Of wind arises is guarded with death,
But is seen by the whirling, travelling soul

Who brushes past the miracles to goal.
Beloved, I follow angels where they lead
To heavenly portals on the flying steed
Of air, the gate of law, that moves the reed
To whisper and hum at the wail and cry
Of loon beneath the lowering summer sky.
Beloved, I follow angels on the die.

Section II. Chapters 37-71 The Parables

Enoch 37

1 The second vision that he saw,
The vision of wisdom *in awe*,
Which Enoch son of Jared, son
Of Mahalalel, Cainan's son,
The son of Enos, son of Seth,
The son of Adam, *from God's breath*,
Saw. 2 And this is the beginning
Of the words of wisdom I sing
With voice uplifted and to speak
And say to those who live *to seek*
On earth, hear, you men of old time,
And see, you that come after rime,
The words of the Holy One which
I will speak before the Lord *rich*
Of Spirits, *YHWH*. 3 Better declare
To the men of old time *to share*,
But even from those that come after
We'll not withhold wisdom *in laughter*.

I am no sage of days gone by that I
Stop to hear voice of Enoch from the sky.
Beloved, I am one of the time to come
Since Enoch sang to harp's melodium.
I eagerly await what wisdom shows
In the word that arises up and goes
Beneath the silver thread before the dawn
That binds my world to heaven's glassy
lawn.

I wait for wisdom in the silence of
The stolid firs and pines where turtle-dove
Of my soul coos in patient, pearly search
Of bare and blackened branches of the
birch.

Beloved, my wisdom is a small thing
hatched
In quietnesses by a gate unlatched.

4 Till the present day such wisdom
Has never been given *in sum*
By the Lord of Spirits *and YHWH*
As I've received according to

My insight, and by the good pleasure
Of the Lord of Spirits whose treasure
Of life eternal's given to me.
5 Three parables were shown to me,
And I lifted my voice freely
And told them to those dwelling where
The earth *spreads out fertile and fair*.

I guess, Beloved, these words must be the
proof

The Book of Enoch's not a thing aloof
As scholars say who would place its
redaction

In centuries after painful exaction
Of Babylonian captivity.

The reason I say that's it cannot be
That any parable of Enoch's flight
Could go beyond the wisdom of the sight
Of Your bright flashes on Mount Sinai's
height.

I cannot think a vision dark and known
To one man in acrylic dreams alone
Can best that sermon brief You spoke one
time

In cantillations twittering in rhyme.
Your words are sword splitting marrow and
bone.

Enoch 38

1 The first Parable.
When the righteous assembly comes,
And sinners shall be judged in sums
For their sins, and be driven from
The face of the earth, and shall come
The Righteous one before the eyes
Of the righteous *without disguise*,
Whose works elect hang on the Lord
Of Spirits, and light *like a sword*
Shall appear to the righteous and
The elect on the earth in band,
Where then will be the dwelling place
Of the sinners, and resting place
Of those who have denied the Lord
Of Spirits *and despite His sword?*
2 It had been good for them if they
Had not been born *to see the day*.

The worthy see these words find their
fulfilment

In future days of judgement and their
billment.

But I have seen their very sense and true

Revealed to all upon the mountain's cue.
There was, Beloved, assembly of the just
At Sinai's foot, one driven from the dust
Of Egypt, a band chosen and elect.
They came where Righteous One's eyes
might detect

The secrets of their hearts. Here I reflect
That light like sword is not a future hope
Alone, but all around the hidden scope
Of temples of the heart and Sabbath rests
Denied to those decked out in ties and
vests,
But known to those attired in wool and
rope.

3 When the secrets of the righteous
Shall be revealed and *in the fuss*
The sinners judged, and the godless
Driven from the presence *for mess*
Of the righteous and the elect,
From that time those who in prospect
Possess the earth shall no more be
Powerful and exalted *free*,
4 And they'll not be able to look
At the face of the holy *rook*,
For the Lord of Spirits has caused
His light to appear on and paused
On the face of the holy ones,
The righteous, elect *paragons*.
5 Then shall the kings and mighty perish
And be given into the *garish*
Hands of the righteous and holy.
6 And from then on no one shall seek
For themselves mercy *to the meek*
From the Lord of Spirits, because
Their life is at an end *of clause*.

That judgement may take place upon the
rabble
And kings and presidents and priests that
babble,
The righteous and the holy must learn well
To treat without mercy the infidel.
Meek lambs before the butchers on the
field
Impede the judgement day in that they
yield
To banks of injustices for a day.
Let my soul, my Beloved, strike out and
flay
Oppressor in my own heart and the gay
Trespasser at the grateful voter's door.

In acquiescence true I make the score
Of sins mount up in columns' fire and
more.

Let mercy pass, Beloved, before the face
That makes one thing of punishment and
grace.

Enoch 39

*1 It shall come to pass in those days
That the elect and holy sons
Will descend from high heaven's ways,
And their seed by comparisons
Will become one with sons of men.*

*2 And in those days Enoch again
Received the books of zeal and wrath,
Harsh books that expel from the path.
And mercy shall not be accorded
To them for what they have afforded,
Says the Lord of Spirits and YHWH,
The Lord Creator of the crew.*

3 And in those days a whirlwind carried
Me off from the earth, and set *harried*
Down at the very end of skies.

4 And there I saw *with inward eyes*
Another vision *by surprise*,
The dwelling places of the holy,
And resting places of the lowly
Righteous. 5 Here my eyes saw their place
Of dwelling with His righteous face
Of angels, and their resting place
With the saints. They petitioned and
Interceded and *by command*
Prayed for the flock of humankind,
And righteousness flowed *from behind*
And before them as water, and
Mercy like dew upon the land,
So it is among them forever
And evermore *and failing never*.

Beloved, let me dwell in that place where
dew

Flows out in mercy for the chosen few.
I rest my self and soul, Beloved, in You.
A sweeter night and brighter day I seek
In dancing, Beloved, with You cheek to
cheek.

Though all are chosen to bear vision stains
Of divine oneness in the soulful gains,
But few are freed to see the single path
That joins all souls upon the verdant swathe
That Enoch drew across the sky's last face.
Few enter mercy, though all enter grace.

The vision trails the rivers of the night
To where the hearths flare up upon the
right
And fire and water gush out at the sight.

6a And in that place my eyes *once more*
Saw Chosen One of righteous score
And of faith, 7a and I saw his place
Of dwelling under the wings' *face*
Of the Lord of Spirits and *YHWH*,
The Lord Creator of the crew.

6b And righteousness shall dominate
In his days, and the righteous mate
And elect shall be without number
Before him always *not to slumber.*

7b And all the righteous and elect
Before him shall be strong, *reflect*
As fiery lights, and their mouth shall
Be full of blessing *continual*,
Their lips extol the name of *YHWH*,
The mighty God sovereign and true,
The Lord of Spirits, and before
Him righteousness shall never fail,
Nor uprightness before His door,
As long as righteousness avail.

Ah, shall the righteous and elect be strong?
The sights have changed since I wandered
along.

The strong are nearly always far from right,
The elect are the weak ev'n in Your sight.
The eschatology I doubt unless
It tells a thing that I myself confess
To having heard and seen and known as
true.

Exotic things go far beyond my view.
No matter. Here my lips extol Your name
Without the blessed land, without the claim
Of rest and light upon its sheltered shore.
My lips extol Your name and want no
more.

In this place one or two, but there it seems
The numbers that praise You are beyond
dreams.

8 There I wished to live, and my spirit
Longed for that dwelling place and near it,
And there until now has been my
Portion, for so has it been *high*
Established of me before *YHWH*,
The Lord of Spirits *and their crew.*

9 In those days I praised and extolled

The name of Lord of Spirits bold
With blessings and praises, because
He had destined me for His *laws*
In blessing and glory according
To the good pleasure *YHWH's* affording
Of Spirits. 10 For a long time my
Eyes regarded that place *on high*,
And I blessed Him and praised Him, saying
'Blessed is He, and may He be *staying*
Blessed from the start and evermore.
11 And before Him there is no sore
Ceasing. He knows before the world
Was created what is *unfurled*
For ever and what will be from
Generations always to come.

Beloved, here Your omniscience is
unveiled

Before the view of humans and the taled
Spirits that inhabit created earth
That all may know that You above all
worth

Know fully past and future and the birth
Of timely present in the secret womb
Of every man and woman before doom.
Beloved, if You know all things from their
root

Up to the furthest reach of flower and fruit,
My flight to You from self and from Self
still

Remains the better choice upon the hill
Where granite and quartzite beneath my
step

Shed sparks of light with which I fill my
skept
To see its wicker catch fire at my boot.

12 Those who do not sleep bless You, they
Stand before Your glory and say
Blessing and praise, extol, exclaim
"Holy, holy, holy's the *name*
Of *YHWH* of Spirits, He fills earth
With spirits *true*, *spirits of worth.*"

13 And here my eyes saw all those who
Do not sleep, they stand before *YHWH*
And bless and say 'Blessed be You,
And blessed be the name of *YHWH*
Forever and ever, *the True.*'
And my face was changed *like a book*,
Because I could no longer look.

If Enoch's heart longed for that strong
 retreat,
 Who walked the earth as with sandals
 unmeet,
 Who am I, my Beloved, to dispossess
 The song and gravel You Yourself would
 bless?
 The thrice-said holies brush my ears again
 From here to Isaiah's temple and den,
 As far as Revelation's vastly halls
 Before the seven spirits and their calls.
 I touch the liturgy of temple bright
 Within the hewn and granite of my slight
 And wavered chamber where I sing the
 theme.
 Holies repeat themselves above the dream
 Of firs still green, Beloved, though winter's
 night
 Has come to wrap me up and out of sight.

Enoch 40

1 And after that I saw in *store*
 Thousands of thousands and *what's more*
 Ten thousand times ten thousand, I
 Saw a *great* multitude *stand by*,
 Beyond number and reckoning,
 Who stood before the Lord *and King*
 Of Spirits. 2 And on the four sides
 Where the Lord of Spirits abides,
 I saw four beings, different from
 Those that do not sleep *when they come*,
 And I learned all their names, because
 The angel that went by my jaws
 Made known to me their names, and
 showed
 Me all the hidden things' *abode*.

The vision of St. John upon the isle
 Recaptures the thousands of thousands trial
 Where every spirit made by Your rough
 hand
 To pour out on the earth like the sea-sand
 Appears in multitude upon the land
 Before Your throne where all living must
 stand.
 Beloved I too look out on the new sun
 Of winter that touches the life begun
 Without leaves on the trees by hill and lake.
 I look out on the spirits that You make
 Standing aghast before the judgement stake
 Of ice and frost, and so remember here
 The names of all the angels in their fear

Who join the human tide when they appear.

3 And I heard the voices of those
 Four beings as they uttered shows
 Of praise before the YHWH of glory.
 4 The first voice comes to bless the story
 Of the Lord of Spirits *and YHWH*
 For ever and ever *as due*.

The four beasts the good John saw all
 around
 Your flashing throne and bowing to the
 ground
 Were friends of Enoch long before the
 sound
 Of Torah ever rang to sprightly drum
 In Miriam's hand, since time when it was
 dumb.
 The living creatures that before Your seat
 With many eyes show that all things must
 greet
 Creator with songs cantillated meet.
 The first voice blessed You before John
 was born
 And praise rose on Enoch's ear by the corn
 That was already golden in the year
 That Enoch came without a star to steer.
 Beloved, I join my voice to that first voice
 To make firm and again my sacred choice.

5 And the second voice I heard blessing
 The Elect one and *those addressing*
 The elect ones who depend on
 The Lord of Spirits, *Paragon*.
 6 And the third voice I heard to pray
 And intercede for those whose way
 Is on the earth and supplicate
 In the name of the Lord in state
 Of Spirits. 7 I heard the fourth voice
 Fending off the Satans for choice,
 Forbidding them to come before
 The Lord of Spirits to accuse
 Those who live upon the earth's *floor*.
 8 After I asked *not to refuse*
 The angel of peace who went there
 With me, who showed me everywhere
 What is hidden, "Who are these four
 Beings which I have seen and whose
 Words I have heard and written down?"
 9 And he said to me, "As you choose,
 This first is Michael of renown,
 The merciful, long-suffering; and

The second, who is set in hand
Over all the diseases and
All the wounds of children of men,
Is Raphael; and the third then,
Who is set over all the powers,
Is Gabriel; and of these towers
The fourth, who is set over all
Repentance unto hope to call
Of those who inherit the life
Eternal, is named Phanuel.”
10 And these the four angels will tell
Of the Lord of Spirits *of life*
And the four voices that I heard
In those days *of what had occurred*.

The first of all the books of revelation
That were vouchsafed to prophets in each
nation
Is that of Enoch, who lifted the load
Of prophecy before the Flood and goad.
And here I see his very word set clear
Of the four living beings that came near
The holy throne where You come to
appear.
The revelation once began will fail
Not to keep evidencing visions tale.
What Enoch saw at first appeared to John,
From revelation's fresh perfume of dawn
Until the brilliant afternoon comes on.
And even Muhammad turned round to see
Archangel Gabriel speak out freely.

Enoch 41

1 And after that I beheld all
The secrets of the heavenly *hall*,
And how the kingdom is divided,
And how the actions of *derided*
Men are weighed in the balance then.
2 There I saw the mansions of *men*,
The elect and the mansions of
The saints, and my eyes saw *above*
There all the sinners being driven
From there, which deny the name *given*
Of the Lord of Spirits, and being
Dragged off, and they could not stay seeing
Because of punishment proceeding
From the Lord of Spirits *impeding*.

Beloved, with every breath if not with mind
I utter Your name Huu whether inclined
To praise You or to curse the empty waste
My blindness makes in its illusive taste

Of Your creation's multiplicity.
Beloved, with every breath I say the word
That thunders in the inner soul once stirred,
But if my deafness makes my lips once
mute,
Such things can never in this place refute
The breathing of Your name's soliloquy.
If I deny a moment in despair
Your name though I repeat it on the air,
Drag off my soul to burn in love to You
Where Your glories are too much for my
view.

3 And there my eyes saw mysteries
Of the lightning and of the thunder,
And the secrets of the winds' *wonder*,
How they're divided *in degrees*
To blow over the earth *and seas*,
And the secrets of clouds and dew,
And there I saw from where they grew
Proceeding in that place, from where
They fill the dusty earth *and air*.

The thunder that arose before the mount
Of Sinai and before flood waters' count
Was ever made; the lightning that with
green
And amber echoes lying on the sheen
Of universe; these made the holy grade
To blow over all earth and take the shade
Of secrets of Your law in scent and worth
Before the living creatures of the earth.
The mysteries of thunder and the light
Are never far from any heart in spite
Of cares and all distractions in the fight
To breathe upon a slender thread and slight.
Beloved, I lift my rain-wet face to see
The lightning and the thunder welcome me.

4 And there I saw closed chambers out
Of which the winds divide about,
The chamber of the hail and wind,
The chamber of the mist *unpinned*,
And of the clouds, the cloud thereof
Hovers over the earth *above*
From the beginning of the world.
5 And I saw the chambers *unfurled*
Of the sun and the moon, from which
They proceed and again to which
They come, and their glorious return,
And how one is greater to learn
Than other, and their stately orbit,

And how they do not leave their orbit,
And they add nothing to their orbit
And they take nothing from it, and
They keep faith with each other's hand,
In accordance with oath by which
They are bound together to pitch.

The chambers of the hail and wind have
kissed

The shrouded chambers of my heart and
mist

To find at dawn rising above the cloud
To see the moon replaced and without
shroud

By the obedient sun, whose morning dress
Is scarlet on the far islands' caress.

Beloved, Beloved, the glories of return
To silent morning where the orbits burn
Strike noble fear upon my breast and rate
The world about me with a new estate.

What bird with red breast comes to drink a
bit

From my rain barrel, I look at him sit
And plunge a brief wing in the water, flit
Away on morning wings, such is time's
fate.

6 And first the *noble* sun goes and
Traverses his path by command
Of the Lord of Spirits, whose name
Is mighty and ever the same.

7 And after that I saw the hidden
And the visible path as bidden
Of the moon, and she finishes
The course of her path where she is
In that place by day and by night,

The one holding position *right*
Opposite the other in sight
Of the Lord of Spirits. And they
Give thanks and praise *by night and day*
And do not rest, for to them their
Thanksgiving is rest *everywhere*.

8 For the sun changes often for
A blessing or a curse *on shore*,
And the course of the lunar path
Is light to the righteous and *wrath*
And darkness to the sinners by
The name of YHWH, who made to lie
Division between light and dark,
And divided men's spirits *stark*,
And strengthened the spirits in store
Of the righteous, in name before

His righteousness. 9 For hinders no
Angel and no power can do so,
For He appoints a judge for them
All and He judges *at His hem*
Them all before Him *as they go*.

The clouds run past the face of firmament
Above my chambered table's sacrament
As I look out with in- and outward calm
Upon cathedral spires of cited Psalm.
The day turns on the years and they in turn
Dance with the centuries beyond and burn
Into the holocaustic pyres that make
Millennia upon the piss-ant's wake.
The quiet cloud of quiet day that's now
Still penetrates my heart from Sinai's brow,
And lifts the floated ark beyond the pale
Of gene-spliced monsters drowned to no
avail.

The cloud I see above the inner voice
Rises to judgement day and to rejoice.

Week 5. Enoch 42

1 Wisdom found no place where she might
Live, then a dwelling-place in sight
In the heavens was made her right.

2 Wisdom went forth to make her home
Where the children of human's roam,
And found no dwelling-place with them.
Wisdom returned to heaven *pro tem*,
And took her seat at angels' *hem*.

3 Unrighteousness went out her door,
Whom she sought not she found and more,
And lived with them as the rains pour
Upon the desert and in store
As dew on thirsty land *for shore*.

Tell simple truth and no man will believe,
But look askance at teller to deceive.
Tell fables ever more ridiculous
And they become the truth of populace.
Wisdom is not a widow but old maid
Since all her beauty is a natural shade
Instead of paint and plastic butt and breast.
Unrighteousness is not a wife to test
But more a whore without time to take rest.
One turns upon the circuit of the sun
Dispensing blessings to men on the run.
One dances in the juggle and the crime
Among the groves at Sunday Easter time.
The wise alone distinguish which is one.

Enoch 43

1 And I saw other lightnings and
The stars of heaven, and saw at hand
How He called them all by their names
And they obeyed Him and His claims.
2 And I saw how they are weighed in
An accurate balance *and bin*
By their degrees of light, how wide
Their spaces and when they abide,
And how their revolutions make
The lightning, and their revolution
According to number's *solution*
Of angels, 3 and keep up the stake
Of faith with each *circumlocution*.
And I asked the angel who went
4 With me who showed me what was sent,
"What are these?" And he said to me
"The Lord of Spirits has freely
Showed you their parable, these are
The names of holy ones *by star*
Who live on earth, believe the name
Of the Lord of Spirits *in fame*
For ever and ever *the same*."

Two things remain untouched by sin since
they
Were once created, first the Sabbath day
And second all the flaming stars in sway.
Who plough illusion's soil to meet the sod
And stumble blindly here beneath the rod
Rest in the pristine beauty of the week
When Sabbath once again lifts up its cheek
To be kissed by the searching, working
soul.
Though in my pain I may lose sight the
goal
And founder on a raging shore and reef,
There is no way I can come to full grief
As long as in the sky my star remains
Within obedient circuit without chains
Against the noble blackness of relief.

Enoch 44

Also another thing I saw
In regard to the lightnings *awe*,
How some stars rise and then become
Streaks of lightning and then succumb,
Not parting from their new form's *law*.

The flash of meteor catches human sight
Although it is a fragment of the light

Of sun and star, nor more than spark of
dust.

Its claim to name is in the lightning burst
That trails upon its faint, expiring fight.
The condensation of its time in flight
Tricks human eye to watch the mote apace
Instead of the infinities of grace
Decked out as stars. All tinsels and all
flecks
Of transient beauty counter to perplex
The human heart and eye with promised
die.

The real and permanent, except for gold,
Do not attract from motionless-like sky,
Nor from their timefulness beyond the cold.

Enoch 45

1 This is the second parable
Concerning those who deny full
The name of the dwelling of saints
And the Lord of Spirits *acquaints*.
2 And into heaven they'll not ascend,
And on the earth they shall not bend,
And such shall be the sinners' fate
Who have denied the name *and state*
Of the Lord of Spirits, who are
Thus preserved for the day not far
Of suffering and of tribulation.
3 On that day My Elect one's station
Shall be to sit on glory's throne
And shall try their works *to the bone*,
And their places of rest shall be
Innumerable. Their souls see
To grow strong within them when they
See my elect ones *in the way*,
And those who have called upon My
Glorious name, then I will cause My
Elect one to live among them.
4 And I will transform heaven's *gem*
And make it an eternal blessing
And light and I'll transform the dressing
Of earth and make it too a blessing,
5 And I will cause My elect ones
To live on it, but sinners' *buns*
And evil-doers shall not set
Foot on it. 6 For provided yet
I've satisfied with peace the ones
I've *found* righteous and have caused them
To live before Me *like a gem*,
But for the sinners there shall be
Judgement upon them and with Me,
So that I shall destroy them from

The face of the earth *whence they come*.

The service of remembrance where Your
name

Wavers upon the air in bright acclaim
Is when and where You send Your Elect
one

To grace the work of substantiation.
I sing Your name and suddenly appears
The reigning proof that follows on the
seers.

I hold my tongue, he's hidden once again
And left the dergah floor a barren plain.
The forties enter in with unheard shout
And on the glassy surface whirl about
To reappear with all the humble graces
Of all the world's Imams in shining faces,
From Enoch in his far flung occultation
To the one hidden now beyond elation.

Enoch 46

1 There I saw One Ancient of Days,
And His head was white as conveys
The wool, and with Him was another
Being whose face had *for the brother*
Appearance of a man, his face
Was full of graciousness *apace*,
Like one of the holy angels.

2 I asked the angel who *in spells*
Went with me and showed me all things
Hidden, about that Son of Man,
Who he was, and from whence he springs,
Why he went *according to plan*
With the Ancient of Days? 3 And he
Answered, *the angel* said to me
'This is the Son of Man with whom
Is righteousness, and who *in room*
Reveals all hidden treasures, for
The Lord of Spirits, *YHWH in store*
Has chosen him, and so he stands
Pre-eminent with upright hands
Before the Lord of Spirits, *YHWH*,
For ever *in what he will do*.

Though Daniel saw the Son of Man appear
Before the Ancient of Days without fear,
The vision that he spoke was done before
When Enoch rose to the celestial door.
Enoch searched out the hidden treasures by
The wheel of time and saw the marching
sky
Turn on the hope and weather till the time

When every man and woman knew to
climb

Before Your throne in gentle dervish dress
To find the curtains blown aside and guess
Left from the heart before the glories
shown.

Let me, Beloved, seek out both the
unknown
And the familiar signs of Son of Man
As often and as soon as ever can.

4 This Son of Man whom You have seen
Shall raise up the kings *on the scene*,
And the mighty ones from their thrones,
And loosen reins of wolverine,
And break the sinners' teeth *and bones*.
5 *He'll put down kings from off their
thrones*

And kingdoms, because they do not
Extol and praise Him, *as they ought*,
Nor humbly recognize from where
Their kingdoms came upon them there.

Some say the Son of Man is the Messiah
Not yet appearing on earth as pariah,
And some say he is Jesus Christ who smote
The money-changers with a bit of rope.
It seems to me if latter anecdote
Is true, then I am waiting still with hope
To see him put down kings and raise them
up.

I'm waiting for the pouring out of cup
Of grace and wrath upon the empires of
The earth who rule and reign still without
love.

Beloved, like Enoch of old I remain
Before the vision of the sure and sane
And trust that You write behind every act
Oppressing something of the divine pact.

6 He'll fill the mighty's face with shame.
Darkness shall be their house and game,
And worms shall be their bed, and they
Shall have no hope *at rise of day*

To get up from their beds, because
They do not praise the name *and laws*
Of the Lord of Spirits *called YHWH*.

7 And these are they who *without awe*
Judge heaven's stars, *and raise their hands
Against the Most High*, and tread sands
Of earth and live on it. And all
Their deeds show their unrighteous *hall*,

Their strength rests on their riches' *call*,
 Their faith is in the gods which they
 Have made with their own hands, and they
 Deny the name of the Lord of
 Spirits, *YHWH and the Lord of love*,
 8 And persecute the houses of
 His congregations, who depend
 In faith upon what may portend
 The name of the Lord of Spirits
Called YHWH since it's a name that fits.

Beloved and Ancient One of days, I praise
 Your name alone above the din and craze
 Of those who would set one man in Your
 place.

Illusions pass me by and run apace.
 I join the Son of Man as he lifts voice
 To cantillate Your name and so rejoice.
 So Daniel sang the song that Enoch tuned
 To raise Your name above riot impugned,
 Quoting the gracious words seen twice
 appear

Where Your visions granted to those who
 fear

Strike wonder in the hearts of girls and
 men.

I turn in wonder to inspect again
 The whiteness of Your hair of silver flame.
 Let me be like You, not angel or game!

Enoch 47

1 And in those days the prayer ascends
 From the righteous *with dividends*,
 And the blood of the righteous from
 The earth before the Lord *to come*
 Of Spirits. 2 In those days the saints
 Who live above *without complaints*
 In the skies shall in unison
 Supplicate and pray *with praise won*,
And give thanks and bless the name of
 The Lord of Spirits, *YHWH of love*,
 On behalf of the righteous blood
 Which has been shed, *poured like a flood*,
 And that the righteous prayer may not
 Be in vain *nor ever forgot*
 Before the Lord of Spirits, *YAH*,
 That judgement may be done *by law*
 Unto them, and that they may not
 Always have to suffer their lot.

No text of inspiration is so oft
 Quoted by other Scripture poets soft

As Enoch, the great prophet set aside
 Because his words were too hard to abide.
 St. John remembers the saints supplicating
 Within the heavenly gates Your grace
 awaiting,
 And James writes that the righteous,
 humble prayer
 May not be in vain now or anywhere.
 All those who truly search Your secret
 power

Come before Enoch soon or late an hour.
 Beloved, I hear the cadence of the mill
 Of revelation resounding on hill
 And margin of the rocky lake to fill
 My heart and soul with both the sweet and
 sour.

3 I saw then the Ancient of Days
 When He seated himself *for praise*
 Upon the throne of His glory,
 And the books of the living be
 Opened before His eye to see;
 And all His host which is in heaven
 Above and His counsellors *seven*
 Stood before Him, 4 and the hearts of
 The saints were filled with joy *and love*,
 Because the number of the true
 Had been offered, and the prayer *due*
 Of the righteous had been heard, and
 The blood of the righteous at hand
 Had been required before the Lord
 Of Spirits *at the mouth of sword*.

So Daniel also saw the books once set
 Opened for judgement of the dry and wet.
 I come to Your remembrance, see the
 books

Fall open before Your aspiring looks,
 And see my deeds of the week stand out
 bare

To beg Your grace and mercy everywhere.
 Ah, my Beloved, how often comes that day
 Of judgement upon all flesh in the way,
 How seldom does the spirit stop to know
 That You see all beyond the come and go!
 The rainy Friday eve wraps all about
 In chilled darkness within its cloud and
 pout.

While judgement quietly like the small rain
 Falls on the slumbered canopies in vain.

Enoch 48

1 And in that place I saw the spring
Of righteousness which unfailing
Abounds with wisdom's fountains round,
And all the thirsty drank profound,
And they were filled with wisdom's *sound*,
And their dwellings were with the true
And holy and elected *crew*.

The alabaster cup filled with the dew
In water of life by the radiant tree
Of life brings life each day and night to me.
The alabaster cup quaffed but by few
Is comfort on my march around the town
And through the desert, I know no thirst
brown
Where wisdom's fountain pours down on
my crown
In Enoch's words of warning of the bright
Righteousness. I take that cup without
fright
And sip and sip again before I might
Drink deeply of its nectar while the green
And alabaster vessel I have seen
Is never empty but in Ali's hand
Gives praise to Son of Man and his
command.

2 And at that hour that Son of Man
Was named in the presence *by plan*
Of the Lord of Spirits *and YHWH*,
And his name by Ancient of Days.
3 Indeed, before the sun *had ways*
And the signs were created *too*,
Before the stars of heaven were made,
His name was named before *where stayed*
The Lord of Spirits. 4 He shall be
A staff to the righteous *and free*
Upon which to stay themselves and
Not fall, and he shall be *at hand*
The light of the Gentiles, and hope
Of those troubled at heart *by pope*.

The Son of Man You name before the sun
And stars receive their rewards once begun,
You call him by name when Your Word
went out
To sing the universe into a shout.
And yet though hidden in the cloud and
night
Throughout all ages He has shown Your
might
To righteous eyes able to bear the sight,

A staff upon which Abraham the just
Leant as he viewed the coming ruined dust
Of Sodom and Gomorrah, and a light
To foreign Hittite eyes that travel to
The ends of the earth in longing for You.
Beloved, the Son of Man in secret kept
Whirls on my dergah floor as newly swept.

5 All who live on earth shall fall down
And prostrate before his *renown*,
And praise and bless and celebrate
With song the Lord's of Spirits state.
6 And for this reason he's been chosen
And hidden before Him *unfrozen*,
Before creation of the world
And evermore *from time uncurred*.

Before foundation of the earth the new
And latter-day writer takes up the view.
Before foundation of the earth You set
The hidden name upon the Son's brow met.
Before foundation of the earth and all
The calling of the spirits to their stall,
Beloved, Your word has been the glowing
coal
That warmed things in to their existence'
role.
Beloved, I prostrate at Your wisdom's feet,
And praise the glory that I always meet
In turning on my floor to find the dawn
Kissing the sunset in the life that's drawn
Between the doors of day and night to find
More treasures than all human hands have
mined.

7 The wisdom of the Lord of Spirits
Has revealed him to saints to clear its
Righteousness, for he has preserved
The fate of the true and deserved,
Because they hated and despised
This world of wicked canonized,
And hated all its works and ways
In name of Lord's of Spirits praise;
For in his name they *all* are saved,
According to his pleasure craved
It's been in regard to their life.
8 In these days kings of earth and strife
Shall be cast down in countenance,
And the strong in the land who dance
Because of the works of their hands,
For when their anguish and woe stands
They shall not *be able* to save

Themselves *from coming death and grave*.
 And I will give them over to
 The hands of My elect *and few*,
 As straw in the fire so'll they burn
 Before the face of saints and stern.
 As lead in the water they'll sink
 Before the face of righteous *link*,
 No trace of them more shall be found.
 10 And on the day in which they're ground
 There shall be rest upon the earth,
 And before them they'll fall unworth
 And rise no more. And there shall be
 No one to take their company
 And raise them up, for they've denied
 The Lord of Spirits and His *pride*,
 Messiah. The name of the Lord
 Of Spirits be blessed *and adored*.

Give me, Beloved, to drink the water clear
 That gushes from the righteous spring and
 dear

Where was once named the Son of Man
 and all

The prophets and divine guides in the hall
 To come upon the earth, both straight and
 small.

I sip and once again lift up my voice
 To make between illusions the right choice.
 Beloved, You know the company raised up
 To drink the drougths from alabaster cup,
 The green chalice that whispers on the
 fresh

New air above the dandelions what flesh
 Can never know alone, but must be taught
 By the spirit that every man has sought.
 In chorus, though alone, I sing the plot.

Enoch 49

1 For wisdom is poured out like water,
 And glory does not fail *as daughter*
 Before him and for evermore.

2 For he is mighty in the store
 Of all secrets of righteousness,
 And wickedness *without address*
 Shall disappear like shadow *dance*,
 And shall have no continuance,
 Because the Elect One stands there
 Before the Lord of Spirits *fair*,
 And his glory's for ever, and
 His powers all generations stand.

3 In him the spirit of wisdom dwells,
 And the spirit by insight swells,

Understanding spirit and might,
 And the spirit of those *by right*
 Who fell asleep in righteousness.
 4 And he shall judge secret address,
 And none shall be able to speak
 A lying word before his cheek,
 For he is the Elect one by
 The Lord of Spirits *in the sky*
 According to His pleasure's *spy*.

Wisdom is poured out like the water
 flowing

From the Elect one's alabaster showing
 Of paradisiacal vessels filled
 With nectars sweet from the waters
 unstilled.

Some wait the coming, promised fair
 reward

When justice will fall from its shining
 sword,

But I am satisfied to drink the lot
 Of pearled and diamond waters I have got
 Beneath the lilac bushes and the rose.
 The pains of past and joys of future glows
 Condense, collapse upon my wind-swept
 heath.

My laurels are no more than heather wreath
 Set with the peridot and ruby blooms
 That last an hour or space of breath for
 dooms.

Enoch 50

1 And in those days a change shall take
 Place for the saints' and elect's sake,
 And the light of days shall abide
 On them, and glory *sanctified*
 And honour turn to the saints' *way*,

2 On the day of affliction when
 Evil shall have been given sway
 Treasured up against sinning men.
 And the true shall have victory
 In the name *and eternally*
 Of the Lord of Spirits, and He
 Will cause the others to observe
 That they repent and that they swerve
 From the works of their *evil* hands.

3 They shall have no honour *that stands*
 Through the name of the Lord of Spirits,
 Yet through the name that He inherits
 They'll be saved, Lord of Spirits will
 Have compassion upon them still,
 For His compassion's great. 4 And He

Is righteous in *the clemency*
Of His judgement, and in the sight
Of His glory unrighteous might
Also shall not maintain itself,
At His word unrepentant *elf*
Shall perish *once* before His *right*.
5 And from henceforth I will have no
Mercy on them, *and none to show*,
Says Lord of Spirits *to their woe*.

Compassion, my Beloved, that mercy great
That Enoch swears is above love and hate,
Lays perishing upon the grieving soul
That refuses repentance at the toll
Of trumpet from Sinai's resplendent words.
Your mercy is a two-edged sword on
 sherds.

The victory is not in shout and clash
Nor in the striving of the proud and brash,
But in the quiet cantillation of
Your name, Beloved, a better name of love.
Compassion is divine that saves the weak
From the benign teeth of the ruling sheik.
Your sword, Beloved, divides the
 marrowed bone
And shows the hidden springs where
 You're alone.

Enoch 51

1 In those days shall the earth also
Give back that which might in it go,
And Sheol also shall give back that
Which it has received *where it's at*,
And hell shall render back its due.
5a For in those days *looked for by few*
The Elect One shall *then* appear,
2 And he shall choose the righteous *near*
And holy from among their *cheer*,
For the day has drawn nigh that they
Should be saved *from the wayward way*.
3 The Elect One shall in those days
Sit on My throne, and *to My praise*
His mouth shall pour forth hidden things,
Secrets of wisdom's counsellings,
For the Lord of Spirits has given
Them to him and has gloried of him.
4 And in those days shall mountains leap
Like rams, and the hills also keep
Skipping like lambs content with milk,
And the faces of angels' *silk*
In heaven shall be lighted with joy.
5 And the earth shall rejoice *ahoy*,

And the righteous shall live on it,
And the elect walk thereon *fit*.

David the king and psalmist in his day
Quoted Enoch's fair words and looks and
 way,

The one looking forward to Sinai's sway
As well as Day of Judgement promised
 fair,

The other looking back on Sinai there
And forward to the shaking of the air.
Though hills shall skip and Appalachia laid
Flat for the coming of world's end parade,
I seek the resurrection of the greyed
As well as those cut down in prime to
 sleep,

And even righteous children in the keep.
As I await, Beloved, the promised sweet,
Raise up in me the dead and buried treat,
And like a child the two of us shall meet.

Enoch 52

1 And after those days in that place
Where I had seen the visions' *grace*
Of things hidden, 2 for I had been
Carried off in a whirlwind's *scene*
And they had borne me towards the west,
There my eyes saw the secrets best
Of heaven that shall be, iron mount,
A copper mountain, and a mount
Of silver, and a mount of gold,
And a mount of soft metal *told*,
And a mountain of lead, *behold*.
3 And I asked the angel who went
With me, saying "What things are sent
Before my sight in secret vent?"
4 And he said unto me, "All these
Things you have seen shall serve to please
Dominion of Anointed one
That he might be potent when done
And mighty on the earth *he's won*."

I've seen mountains aplenty made of stone
And one it seems of glass before Your
 throne,

And one of iron as red and rusted bright
As blood, sunset or autumn in Your sight,
But I have not like Enoch seen the flight
Of metal mountains mounting in the light.
Beloved, the vision is a strange one and
A curious thing spread out on the land
That baffles me and silences my song.

In silence I look out upon the long
And shining view that Enoch's words
 invoke.
I look out on the world that You once
 spoke
Into being and find it wonder filled.
Beloved, I stand upon an earth untilled.

5 And that angel of peace replied,
Saying to me, "Wait and abide,
And there shall be revealed to you
All the secret things which *in view*
Surround the Lord of Spirits *due*.
6 "And these mountains which your eyes
 see,
The iron mountain, and the wee
Mountain of copper, and the mount
Of silver, and the golden fount,
The mountain of soft metal, and
The mountain of lead *at a stand*,
All these shall be in sight *and tracks*
Of the Elect one as mere wax,
Before the fire, and like the flow
Of water from above the row,
And they'll be powerless *to go*
Before his feet. 7 "And it shall come
To pass in those days that the sum
Of the saved shall be nil by gold
Or by silver, and none be told
And able to escape *the fold*.
8 "And there shall be no iron for war,
Nor shall one clothe oneself with store
Of a breastplate. And bronze shall be
Of no use, nor tin usefully
Regarded, and lead not desired.
9 "And all these things shall be expired
From off the face of *all* the earth,
When the Elect One shall find birth
Before the face of Lord of Spirits,
Clothed in all of his gracious merits."

The mountains of cold metal harshly ring
To crown the peers of earth both priest and
 king,
And give them both the weapons they
 desire
To stamp the poor and humble in the mire.
The rumour that some faint usurper might
Have stores of precious arms hidden from
 sight
Suffices to create a mother war
And lead the innocent into the gore.

Who stands upon the mountain in the blast
Shall see the coming of the chosen last,
Rejoice to see the steel badge and the cast
Plutonium melt on the painful edge.
The gathered to survive stand on the ledge
Of nothingness to cantillate Your name
Beyond the land the priests and kings
 acclaim.

Week 6. Enoch 53

1 There my eyes saw a deep crevasse
With open mouths, and all who pass
On earth and sea and islands bring
To it gift and present and thing
Of homage, but that deep crevasse
Shall never be filled with the mass.
2 And their hands commit lawless deeds,
And sinners consume all their seeds
Of whom they lawlessly oppress,
Yet the sinners in their distress
Shall be destroyed before the face
Of the Lord of Spirits *in grace*,
And they shall be banished from off
The face of His earth *where they scoff*,
And they'll perish eternally,
Numberless as sand of the sea.

I see the constant run of mill that makes
The user's goods and for consumers' sakes
Produces day and night the ample crass
That is foundation of the present mass
Of status bound to matter instead of
To spirit and ability and love.
I see the constant fun of mill that turns
In its frenetic, feinting dance that burns
The soul diminished in the market place
With desperation clutching at the brace
Of interest and of usury to set
The earth in conflict and in chaos met.
Beloved, the gulf is never filled no matter
How much is poured out by those getting
 fatter.

3 For I saw all the angels of
Punishment dwelling *from above*
Preparing all the vessels of
Satan. 4 I asked the angel of
Peace with me, "For whom do they set
These vessels?" 5 And he said you bet
To me, "They make ready these things
For this world's mighty and its kings,
That they may thereby be destroyed.

6 “And after this the Righteous eyed
And Elect One shall cause the pride
Of his assembly’s house to bide,
From then on they shall be no more
Hindered in the name *or the war*
Of the Lord of Spirits *before*.

7 “And these mountains shall no more
stand

As the earth at his righteous hand,
But hills shall be as water spring,
And the righteous *in everything*
Shall have rest from the sinners’ sting.”

The black pit into which I pour my pride
Is never filled no matter what I hide.
It swallows guns and ships and jewelled
stuff,

Devours the wheat and corn both fine and
rough,

And drinks the wine in floods beyond my
hand.

There’s nothing that dark pit will not
command.

Beloved, I seek a lighter, higher shore
Where nothing’s needed of the wealth and
store

Beyond the crust and tender cup that heal
The soul while giving body what to feel.
Beloved, I find in You a chambered cave
Where I am freed from every patterned
slave

To whirl in peace above the chattered way
That stretches out upon the glimmering
day.

Enoch 54

1 I turned and saw another part
Of the earth, and saw there the heart
Of a deep valley blazing out.
2 And they brought the kings *with a shout*
And the mighty, began to cast
Them into this deep valley *fast*.

Who eat the earth and swell up with the
pride

Of having surplus locked away inside
Will one day be poured in the open jaws
Of the abyss created by their laws
Of survival of fittest with sharp claws.

The valley blazing deep with horrid breath
Reeks rank and smile upon the pallid death
That waits the pillar of civilized world

Already spread before Enoch unfurled,
Already known to stand judged e’er the rate
Of water drowned the first sinful estate.
Beloved, I praise You that Your eye and
hand

Control the dizzy dancing power band
Amplified electronically to stand.

3 And there my eyes saw how they made
These their vessels, iron chains laid
Of immense weight. 4 And so I asked
The angel of peace who was tasked
To go with me, saying “For whom
Are these chains prepared as in doom?”

5 And he said to me “These are made
For hosts of Azazel *who strayed*,
So that they may take them and cast
Them into the abyss *at last*
Of complete condemnation, and
They shall cover their jaws with hand
Like rough stones at the Lord’s command.

6 “And Michael, and Gabriel, and
Raphael, and Phanuel shall take
Hold of them in that great day’s wake,
And cast them on that day into
The burning furnace, that Lord YHWH
May take vengeance on them for their
Unrighteousness in being fair
Subjects to Satan and leading
Astray who live on the earth’s *wing*.”

That lake of fire that in its blazing way
Near blindfold John the Prophet on the day
On Patmos when he saw earth’s columns
sway

Was known to Enoch who also saw cast
Like stones fast in the glowing furnace
blast.

The cosmic vision concentrates at last
In my heart roaring for its judgement part.
I feel the glance of sword, the piercing dart
And bowing pray that Azazel’s crew’s start
That rages rampant on my honeydew
Be thrown into the lake of fire as new.
Beloved, before You cleanse the earth with
fire,

Purify my soul’s gold and its desire
And lift my glowing spark on altar higher.

7 And in those days shall punishment
Come from the Lord of Spirits sent,
And he will open all the vast

Chambers of waters which are cast
Above the heavens, and the springs
Which are beneath their earthen wings.

In Enoch's view the world collapses in
The centuries unbowed by sound and sin,
And judgement of fire meets the cycle vast
Where water from the heavens is downcast.
The whirling dance of judgement in the fire
And water quenches both my love and ire
And I return from dancing in my way
To bow before Your throne where You
bear sway

Over the chorus of the universe.
Your punishment annihilates the curse
Until all things arise, and not the worse,
For punishment of furnace and the brace
Of water tempering the steel by grace.
The world rushes back to its suckling
nurse.

8 And all the waters shall be joined
With the waters, that which is coined
Above the heavens is the male,
9 And the water beneath the pale
Of the earth, it is the female.
And they shall destroy all who live
10 On the earth and all those who live
Under the wings of all the sky.
And when they have admitted why
They have done wickedness on earth,
Then by these they'll perish *from dearth*.

Enoch who saw the coming Flood denied
No punishment to those he would deride.
He named his son according to the sight
Of when the waters would come to their
plight.

The punishment of fire for angels set
Against the divine law and labour met,
And punishment of water for the men
Who followed such angels to hell again.
Vouchsafe me, my Beloved, both
punishments
Of fire and water, till the soul relents
And illusion pass from my flesh and sense.
Let me burn in the fire of loving You,
Beloved, and let Your waters like the dew
Touch my tongue without quenching what I
drew.

Enoch 55

1 And after that Ancient of Days
Was comforted *repenting ways*
And said "In vain have I destroyed
All who live on the earth *employed*."

2 And He swore then by His great name,
"From now on I will not in blame
Do so to all who live on earth,
And I will set a sign of worth
In the sky, and this shall be pledge
Of good faith between Me and hedge
To them for ever, for as long
As heaven is above earth *in song*."

The rainbow is the promise of the pact
Between Yourself, Beloved, after Your act
In destruction by water and the fact
That all flesh drowned above the earthly
tale.

The rainbow is the signal of the sail
Of seven laws to remove violence
From hands of men and from their secret
tents.

And yet the rainbow sent upon the cloud
Is now appropriated to the loud
Acclaim of violence in sound and score
Of writhing in the painful wrath in store.
I flee into the silent ark and wait
The cantillation of all the earth's fate
Beneath the pounding of the shout and
grate.

3 "And this is by My own command.
When I've desired to take in hand
Those ones by angels on the day
Of tribulation and pain's way
Because of this, I will cause My
Chastisement and My wrath to lie
Upon them," says Alohim Lord
Of Spirits, *YHWH, the Great Adored*.

The very angels bend beneath the load
Of punishment in soundings of the goad.
The very angels screech in horror meant
For no ears created upon the spent
Beaches of earth. The very angels wail
Before the rushing of the wind and gale.
Beloved, I laugh to see the futile tear
That wells up in the eye of fusilier
Enchanted by the vision of the saints
Dolled up in dove wings to save by feints.
The leprecausious angels that dot pink
The odes of today cannot help but sink

Upon reality that clothes the night
With star and moon in sleep a guiding light.

4 You mighty kings who live on earth,
You'll have to look at My Elect,
How he sits on the throne of worth
And judges Azazel *abject*,
And all his company, and all
His hosts in the name and the call
Of the Lord of Spirits of all.'

You Yourself, my Beloved, swear mercy
by
The grandeur of Your name beneath the
sky.
By Your name great and solemn so You
swear
That summer breezes shall perfume the air
And winter frosts ornament with delight
The world of briefest day and calmest
night.
But Your Elect, the one they treat of grace,
Will use your blessed name by holy face
To swear off mercy and love's every trace
As he sits on Your throne in judgement's
place.
The choice is mine to make between the
two,
To cantillate Your holy name and true
Either in mercy for a stumbling world
Or as accusatory flag unfurled.

Enoch 56

1 And I saw there the angel hosts
Of punishment walking the coasts,
And they held scourges, they held chains
Of iron and bronze *in their domains*.

Methinks that Enoch must have just
invented
The vision the angelic louts presented.
If he had truly seen the future cast
He would have known that today things
have passed
Beyond the punishment of scourge and
chain.
Today we use the scientific vein
In torture as well as in agriculture.
We are no longer like the pleasant vulture
But more like erudite confessor dad
With chemicals electric to run mad.

No simple iron and bronze can meet the
call
Of modern torture in the judgement hall
Of antiseptic rack of steel and pincer
Upon the living screamer, bleeder, wincer.

2 And I asked the angel of peace
Who went with me, saying increase,
"To whom are these who hold the whips
Going?" 3 And he spoke *with his lips*
To me, "To their elect and ones
Beloved, that they may be *by tonnes*
Cast in the mouth of the abyss
Of the valley. 4 "And finally this
Valley shall be filled with their own
Elect and their beloved *alone*,
And the days of their lives shall be
At an end, and the days of free
Leading astray shall not be reckoned
From then on, *no, not for a second*.
5 "And in those days the angels shall
Return and hurl themselves pell-mell
To the east on the Parthians
And on the Medes, *their partisans*.
They shall stir up the kings, so that
A spirit of unrest come at
Them shall rouse them from off their
thrones,
So that they may burst forth *with groans*
Like lions from their lairs, and like
Hungry wolves at their flocks *to strike*.

First prophecy of toil and trouble here
As Persian kings of Mithra rise to clear
The world of those who worship only You,
They speak in Your name as if they were
true,
But hold out for the trident and the sun.
The mighty and the proud uphold their law
Pretending Your word contains vital flaw
That scholarly research and brazen shop
Will teach the dead letter once how to hop.
In wisdom they shall err in count of days,
And hold as ignorant who follow ways
That You, Beloved, reveal in heart and
stone.
So their success will fail since You with
gun
Sit higher than the world, Sovereign on
throne.

6 "And they shall go up and tread down

Under foot the land *and the town*
 Of his elect ones, *and the land*
 Of his elect ones shall not stand
 Before them but as threshing-floor
 And a highway *filled up with gore*,
 But the city of my righteous
 Shall be a hindrance to their fuss.
 7 "And they shall start to fight among
 Themselves, and their right hand on *rung*
 Shall be strong against themselves, and
 A man shall not know brother's *hand*,
 Nor son his father or his dam,
 Until there be ad nauseam
 Of corpses through their slaughter *field*,
 And their punishment shall not yield.
 8 "In those days Sheol shall ope its jaws,
 And they shall be swallowed *by claws*,
 And their destruction come to pass,
 Sheol shall devour the sinners *crass*
 In sight of the elect *en masse*."

The best news heard since Noah and the
 flood
 Is that the wicked and the great for blood
 Will start to fight among themselves and so
 Leave the oppressed to wait a later show.
 Unfortunately fighting in the pews
 Does not in general release the crews
 Of the oppressed from beyond silver plate.
 The only relief's when the congress' state
 Gets through a bill lost on the lobby's pate.
 But anything to help the people must
 In quick time be repealed and bite the dust.
 That's why I wait for hell to open mouth
 And swallow both the king of north and
 south.

The sceptre itself shall crumble in rust.

Enoch 57

1 And it happened after this that
 I saw a wagon host where sat
 Men riding on them, and they came
 On the east wind, and *on the flame*
 From west to south. 2 Their wagons' sound
 Was heard *aloud and all around*,
 And when this turmoil had occurred
 The saints from heaven by it stirred
 The earth's pillars out from their place,
 And the sound of it made its race
 From one end of the sky unto
 The other in one day's ado.
 3 And they shall all fall down to bring

Worship to Lord of Spirits, *King*.
 So ends second parable's thing.

The visions given to all prophets, that
 In age to come rose, fell where Enoch sat.
 Ezekiel lifted up his eye to see
 The wagons and their wheels eternally
 Rotating on the blessed firmament.
 He saw again the holy vision sent
 To Enoch. My Beloved, beneath the sky
 In ordinary clouds of glory sly
 I turn my sights to bland creation's flame
 To hear them shout too loudly the acclaim.
 The glory of my ordinary days
 Is too filled with Your mercy and Your
 praise.
 That's why You send no miracles in blast
 To overwhelm eyes already downcast.

Enoch 58

1 And I began to speak the third
 Parable concerning the word
 Of the righteous and the elect.
 2 Blessed are you, righteous and elect,
 For glorious you shall be decked.
 3 And the righteous bask in the light
 Of the sun. The elect in sight
 Of life eternal, and the days
 Of their life are unending *praise*,
 And the days of the saints unnumbered.
 4 And they shall seek light unencumbered,
 And find righteousness with the Lord
 Of Spirits, there shall not be sword
 But Islam to the righteous folk
 In Lord Eternal's name awoke.

St. Matthew quotes beatitudes when one
 Called Christ rose on the hill to speak in
 fun,
 And those beatitudes by St. Luke's hint
 Held something of Deuteronomic glint.
 But Moses himself, when he writes the law
 Does not fail to quote Enoch in his awe
 Of blessings and to speak the truth as well
 Of cursings when he comes to break the
 spell.
 Beloved, come and strike down in me what
 fails
 To meet the elect, and lift what prevails
 In my heart hearkening to Your commands.
 Give me the reward of grace from Your
 hands

And I shall praise You beneath star and sun
With Enoch who sees all things since
begun.

5 And after this it shall be said
To saints in heaven they should be fed
With secrets of *their* righteousness,
The heritage of faith *confess*,
For it's become bright as the sun
Upon earth, and the darkness done.
6 And there'll be light that never ends,
They'll find unending time that lends
Destruction from to darkness *and*
The light established by command
And the light of uprightness set
For ever before the Lord yet.

The third great wonder of the sky is peace.
Indeed, if there were peace where the wars
cease,

It would be wonder above all that seen
In every vision's flight and go-between.
The heritage of the faith of peace is
Also a violent and stormy biz,
At least so far. I guess the secret's out
Only in heaven for a saintly shout,
While earth continues in the awful weight
Of dandelions and violets in state,
Unconscious it may seem of all the gore
That lies upon earth's breast and waits in
store.

Beloved, I seek that peace for kith and kin
That lights the Sabbath lamps that burn
within.

Enoch 59

*1 In those days my eyes viewed the hidden
Places of lightnings, and the bidden
Lights, and the judgements that they bear,
And they lighten for blessing where
The Lord of spirits wills, or then
For cursing on dwellings of men.
2 And there I saw the thunder down
In secrets all about the town,
And how when echoing on the sky
Its marching is heard going by,
And he caused me to see judgements
Sent by them where the earth relents,
Whether for good and blessing, or
For a curse according as swore
The Lord of spirits gone before.
3 And after that the mysteries of*

*The lights and lightnings shown above
To me, and how they lighten for
Blessing and satisfying more.*

Enoch 60

A Fragment of the Book of Noah
1 In the year five hundred to show a
Seventh month, on the fourteenth day
Of the month in Enoch's life's way.

The feast of booths that marked the year of
life

Five hundred in Enoch's pathway of strife
Against evil in his own heart that would
Appear if ever evil in such could,
And wickedness in places high and low,
Angelic and human, the swift and slow,
Shows up in revelation on the tongue
Of Noah when he was a man so young.
The revelations of the bright and fair
Who keep the times and calendars to share
With those who love the weeks and
Sabbaths best

Are fraught with love and warnings well
confessed.

Beloved, let me that love and warning here
From Noah and his hearth fire's glowing
cheer.

In that parable I saw how
A mighty quaking made a row
In the high heavens, and the host
Of the Most High, the angels' boast,
A thousand thousands *all by name*,
Ten thousand times ten thousand *came*
To be disquieted with great
Disquiet. 2 The Ancient of Days
Sat on throne of His glory's *praise*,
And the angels and righteous late
Stood all around Him *in their state*.

The heavenly earthquake is a row that few
Living upon the earth now have in view.
Enoch alone living perhaps remarks
In memory the shaking of the parks
Celestial. But ten thousand thousands there
And ten times ten thousand of them to
share
That fright of angels, those beings are
known
To every prophet down at least to clone
Of St. John where he sits admiring stone,

And Daniel who lived before him to plot
Not to bow before king or idol's lot.
Beloved, the sky above me seems serene,
And nothing shakes my wonder grey or
green
That glances at the open heaven's sheen.

3 And then a great trembling seized me,
And fear set on me mightily,
And my loins trembled, and dissolved
Were my kidneys, and it devolved
On me to fall upon my face.
4 And Michael sent another grace
Of angel from among the saints
And he raised me *from my complaints*,
And when he'd raised me up my spirit
Returned, for I had not been near it
To bear the sight of this *great* host,
And the commotion and the most
Wild shaking of the sky. 5 And then
Michael said to me *among men*
"Why are You troubled at the sight?
Until this day, the day of light
In His mercy extended, and
He's been merciful in the land
And patient towards *all* those who live
On earth. 6 "And when the day will give,
And power, punishment, judgement come,
Which the Lord of Spirits in sum
Has made for those who do not bow
Before the righteous law *like sow*,
And for those who deny the right
Judgement, and for those who would take
His name in vain, then for their sake
The day's prepared, for the elect
A covenant, but to inspect
The ways of sinners. 7 "When shall rest
On them the punishment *at best*
Of the Lord of Spirits, it shall
Not rest once to make prodigal
The Lord's of Spirits punishment
Upon all spirits at once sent,
But it shall slay the child with dam,
And child with father *with a slam*.

I interject before Michael's retreat
From casting such delicious words to eat.
The reason I believe that Michael does
Not speak to me like Enoch is because
Unlike Enoch I am not troubled that
Evil should befall wicked where they sat.
My craven heart that cries for justice still

Prevents the word of Michael on my hill,
And keeps that worthy angel silent till
The rumblings of Your vengeance come to
spill

Out on the ways of sinners that rain strife
Upon me and the likes of me in life.
Beloved, only non-violence can save
A man from committing something
unbrave.

Afterwards the judgement shall take
Place by His mercy in the stake
Of His patience." 8 And on that day
Were two monsters parted in twa,
A female named Leviathan,
To live in the abysses span
Of the ocean upon the founts
Of waters. But the male *that mounts*
Is named Behemoth, who resided
With his breast a waste *and derided*
Wilderness named Duidain before
The garden where the elect's shore
Gives dwelling to the righteous, where
My grandfather was caught to bear
And taken up, the seventh from
Adam, the first man whom made come
The Lord of Spirits by creation.
9 And I besought the other ration,
The angel that he should show me
The might of those monsters, and see
How they were parted on one day
And cast, the one into the sway
Of the abysses of the sea,
And the other onto the *free*
Dry land upon the wilderness.
10 And he said to me to confess
'You son of man, herein You seek
To know what's hidden *from the meek*.'

Beloved, how often You have crazed
mankind
With taunts that we're not only deaf but
blind.
Poor Job could not tell the Behemoth's tale
Nor count Leviathan's gross chain of mail.
And yet by Your command our science
seeks
To penetrate the secrets of Your weeks,
And name each creature whereby You are
praised
Among the righteous multitudes amazed.

I too come, my Beloved, where there's no
room

For science to sound out the rising doom,
In reverence and adolescent verve
See straightness lying on creation's curve.
Forgive the roving of the human eye
That sounds the depths of both the earth
and sky.

11 The other angel come with me
To show me what lay hiddenly,
Told me what is first and what last
In the heavens high and upcast,
And in the depth beneath the earth,
And at the ends of heaven's worth,
And on the sky's foundation stone.

12 And the chambers of the winds *hone*,
And how the winds divide *and groan*,
And how they're weighed, with reckoning
grown

In portals, each according to
The strength of the wind *as it grew*,
And magnitude of the moon's lights
According to its fitting rights,
And the divisions of the stars
According to their names *and cars*,
How all divisions have their bars.

13 And the thunders according to
The places where they fall to do,
And all the parts that set among
The lightnings with their lights outstrung,
And their host straightway to obey.

14 For the thunder has place to stay
Assigned while waiting for its peal,
And the thunder and lightning heel
Together, and although not one
And undivided, they both run
Together in one mind and heart
Set aside truly as one part.

No angel speaks to me by day or night
Revealing secrets hidden from my sight,
Perhaps because the secret of my faith
Lies open and revealed to every wraith
In the angelic messages that creep
Out where Enoch and Noah come to sleep.
Beloved, I see the moon climb in the sky,
I see the stars go trembling, passing by,
And find the portals opened where I seek
The suns arising to perform the week
Until the Sabbath day returns to me
To bless my soul with glories wonderfully.

Beloved, the lightning sets me at my toll
To hear the thunder after come to roll.

15 For when the lightning lightens, and
The thunder utters voice *on land*,
The wind makes pause during the peal,
Dividing equally their steel,
For like the sand's the treasury
Of their peals, each one will agree
To be held in bridle *from spree*,
And turned back by the power of wind,
And pushed forward *in pealing din*
In many quarters of the earth.

16 The spirit of the sea is worth
And masculine and strong *in girth*,
According to his mighty strength
He draws it back with rein *at length*,
And in like manner's driven forward
Dispersing in the mountains shoreward
Of earth. 17 And the spirit of frost
Is his own angel *to man's cost*,
And the spirit of hail's a good
Angel and doing as he should.

The spirit of the sea I once invoked,
Beloved, because I was a child provoked.
I saw the emerald of coming waves
That fondled the shoreline and the prone
slaves

Of oysters in their shells and bidding time.
Beloved, the spirit of the sea and rime
Rose before my young eyes to show me
where

The wind came from and how it found my
share.

Beloved, Beloved, my memory still waits
Upon those visions of the ocean's gates,
And finds a lifting of the heart that I
Was taken as a child to hear the sigh
Of the sea spirit where the alligator
Lay by the roadside sleeping until later.

18 And the spirit of snow's forsaken
His chambers by his strength untaken,
There is a special spirit therein,
And that which goes up from its bin
Is like smoke from its frosty shin.

19 The spirit of the mist is not
United with them in their lot,
But has a special chamber, for
Its course is glorious both before
The light and in darkness, and in

Winter and in summer, and in
 Its chamber is an angel's *win*.
 20 As for the spirit of the dew
 It has its dwelling *where it drew*
 At the ends of the heaven, and
 Is hard beside the room and hand
 Of the rain, and its course is in
 Winter and summer, and its pin
 Of clouds and the clouds of the mist
 Are joined, and the one gives the list
 To the other. 21 And when the rain
 Spirit goes out from its domain,
 The angels come and open room
 And lead it out, it shall presume
 To diffuse over all the earth
 Uniting with its waters' girth.
 And when it joins water on earth,
 22 For the waters are for those who
 Live on the earth, for they are *true*
 And nourishment for the earth from
 The Most High who from heaven *is come*,
 Therefore there's measure for the rain,
 And angels take it in their rein.
 22 And these things I saw towards the field
 Of Righteousness, *a garden's yield*.
 And the angel of peace with me
 Said to me "These two monsters be
 Prepared conformably to *see*
 The greatness of Alohim, and
 Shall feed *beneath His mercy's hand . . .*"

The secrets of the snow and mist and field
 Are revelations of Your voice unpeeled
 By angels sent to humankind to say
 The rising hymns of Your creation's day.
 The secret of the reining in of thunder
 And lightning's racing before it in wonder
 Are things vouchsafed to men like me to
 know.

But with that liberty of science show
 There is as well the secret beyond knowing
 That hides well past where human eyes are
 going.

I live, Beloved, between the ecstasy
 Of Your noble creation's discovery
 And the cloud of unknowing and unknown
 That ever hides beneath Your sovereign
 throne.

Enoch 61

1 And I saw in those days how long
 Cords were given those angels *strong*,

And they took to themselves their wings
 And flew towards the northern *stings*.

2 I asked the angel, said to him,
 "Why have those *angels in their vim*
 Taken these cords and gone away?"
 And he said *truly* to me, "They
 Have gone to measure." 3 And the one
 Angel with me said to me "Son,
 These shall bring back the righteous'
 measure

And the ropes of the righteous treasure
 To the righteous, that they may stay
 Themselves *when they bow down to pray*
 On Lord's of Spirits name for ever.

The elect shall begin endeavour
 To live with the elect, and those
 Are the measures which shall enclose
 Faith and shall strengthen righteousness.
 4 "And these measures shall show address
 Of all the secrets of earth's deep,
 And those destroyed by desert *sleep*,
 And those who've been devoured by beast,
 And those who've been consumed
 unceased

By the fish of the sea, so they
 May return and stay on the day
 Of the Elect one, for none shall
 Be destroyed before Spirits' Lord,
 And none can be destroyed *by sword*.

5 "And all who live above *cabal*
 In heaven received command and power
 And one voice and one light like fire."

6 And that One they blessed by their word
 Extolled and lauded undeterred
 With wisdom, and in speaking wise
 And in the spirit of life's *guise*.

Beloved, You have the measure in Your
 hand

Of every soul who sleeps upon the land
 Or in the sea, the breath of the clove flower
 That blesses the hot garden for an hour,
 The soul of dandelion, the hew of birch
 That blooms a day in spring, the row and
 search

Of wild bird cherry that makes drunk the
 air

Before midsummer comes to touch the fair.
 All these souls are not lost, not even mite
 That for a moment lives to find its plight.
 I rest, Beloved, my sleeping soul with You

Who find room in Your heart for breath of dew.
Nothing disappears from Your hand and view.
I turn my darkened eyes towards Your light.

7 And then the Lord of Spirits placed
The Elect one on the throne graced
With glory. 8 And he shall judge all
The works of the holy *in hall*
Above in heaven, and in the *great*
Balance shall their deeds be weighed
freight.

9 And when he shall lift up his face
To judge their secret ways and place
According to word of the name
Of the Lord of Spirits in fame,
And their path according to way
Of righteous judgement *in the sway*
Of the Lord of Spirits, then they
Shall all with one voice speak and pray
To bless, and glorify, extol
And sanctify the name *and role*
Of the Lord of Spirits. 10 And He
Will summon all heaven's host to be,
And all the holy ones above,
And the host of Alohim's *love*,
The Cherubic, Seraphim and
Ophannim, and all angels' hand,
And all the principalities'
Angels *handing down their decrees*,
And the Elect one, and the powers
On the earth over water showers
On that day shall raise one voice, and
Bless, glorify, exalting *stand*
In spirit of the faith, and in
Wisdom's spirit, and *also* in
The spirit of patience, and in
The spirit of mercy, and in
The spirit of judgement and peace,
And in the spirit of *increase*
Of goodness, and in unison
Shall all say "Blessèd is the one,
And may the Lord's of Spirits name
Be blessed for ever, aye the same."

It was not modesty that made the Christ
Jesus call himself, not Son of God spliced
With natures two, divine in charity
And human from his mother's sophistry,
But Son of Man, the Elect by Your throne,

The ruler and the judge of both unknown
And known upon the earth and in the sky.
It was not modesty, not by an eye.
Beloved, I've got enough to do to keep
My footprints in Your great
commandments' deep
Without taking sides in the grand display
Of sectarian dance of roundelay.
But since he loves Your law, I'll love him
too
And follow him as far as it is true.

11 All those who do not sleep aboon
In heaven shall bless Him night *and noon*,
All holy ones in heaven shall bless
Him, and all the elect *confess*
Who live in the garden of life,
And every spirit of light *rife*
Who's able to bless, glorify,
And extol, hallow, sanctify
Your blessed name, and all flesh shall
Exceedingly and musical
Bless and for ever glorify
Your name for ever and for aye.
For great is Lord's of Spirits grace,
He is long-suffering *in this place*,
And all His works and all that He
Created He's revealed to be
To the righteous and the elect
In Lord's of Spirits name *select*.

Some say that You, Beloved, will come a day
To measure in the balances that sway
From right to left what good things I have
done
And what evil escapes me in the sun.
With trepidation I look on the scene
Knowing that time is an illusive dream
And nothing separates me from the grey.
Leave off Your balances of good and bad,
Beloved, and turn around to make me glad.
Instead of balance take angelic cords
To draw the ploughshares and relinquish
swords.
The cords, Beloved, take them to bind my
heart
To Yours, Beloved, to Yours in love and
art,
The cosmic web from finish to the start.

Week 7. Enoch 62

1 And thus YHWH commanded the kings
And the mighty, exalted *rings*,
And those who live on earth, and said
"Open your eyes and lift as led
Your horns if you can recognize
The Elect One come *in this guise*."

2 And Lord of Spirits seated him
On the throne of His glory's *rim*,
And the spirit of righteousness
Was poured out upon him *to bless*,
And the word of his mouth to slay
All sinners, and unrighteous way
Destroy from there before His face.

3 And there shall stand up in that place
All the kings and the mighty *race*,
And the exalted and who hold
The earth, and they shall see how bold
He sits on the throne of his glory,
And righteousness is judged before You,
No lying word's spoken by him.

You set appointed one beside Your throne
To dispense both the grace by which
You're known

And the strange act of violence by which
You throw the wicked rebel in the ditch.
I stand before Your throne, Beloved, and
know

That You have set authorities to show
What You demand of every soul in love.
Grant me that constant vision of above
Where stand occulted Enoch and the later
Appointed leaders and guides for the
greater

Glory of Your name and Your sovereignty.
From my heart's pope and priest set my
soul free,

And from the kingship and lordship I might
Raise up by my own greed and hopeful
spite.

4 Then pain shall come on them with vim
As on a woman in travail,
And she has pain in setting sail
When her child enters mouth of womb,
And she has pain in making room.

How is it Enoch and Noah know so
Much about childbirth, that the pain is slow
To grow within until the head will show
At the mouth of the womb and where the
stretch

Becomes the hardest place in painful fetch?
How can such men of their importance care
About the phases of the child's repair
Towards the light and day, against the
night?

How can such minds in philosophic flight
Come back down to the earth with fine
insight?

Beloved, Your wonder is that You reveal
A sense of human pain at all who steal
A march on human space and human time
Rising above the reach of form and rhyme.

5 And one portion of them shall look
On the other in terror's hook,
And they shall be downcast in face,
And pain shall seize them, when they race
To see that Son of Man upon
His throne of glory, *paragon*.

The blessed St. John when he took a look
At the grand vision and the storybook
Of those who should see Son of Man upon
The throne of glory, the one before dawn
Of night that they had pierced would then
be seized

With pain throughout body and soul
uneased.

Though Enoch saw the thing as well in
note,

And St. John in the book he also wrote,
The thing awaits fulfilment, those who
smote

The lanced side have long gone on in peace
To fertilize the soil and bring increase.
Beloved, I wait the day when all who strike
The innocent and hand on fence like shriek
Shall see their work in pain without release.

6 And the kings and the mighty and
All those who possess the earth's *land*
Shall bless and glorify, extol
Him who has all things in control,
Who was hidden. 7 For from the start
The Son of Man had hidden part,
And the Most High preserved him in
The presence of His might *and din*,
And revealed him to the elect.

8 The congregation of elect
And holy shall be sown, and all
Elect shall stand before him *tall*
On that day. 9 And then all the kings

And mighty and exalted things
And those who rule the earth shall fall
Down before him upon their faces,
And prostrate and set hopes *and graces*
Upon that Son of Man, and beg
And supplicate for mercy's *peg*
At his hands. 10 But that Lord of Spirits
Will so press them that they to clear its
Fear shall go hastily out from
His presence, and their faces bum
Shall be filled with shame, and the dark
Grow deeper on their faces' *mark*.

Indeed the son of Man has hidden part
With the four who were taken from the
start
Without seeing corruption in the grave,
Enoch, Elijah, Jesus and the brave.
That hidden part is known to the elect
Who with their incantation words select
Upon the tongue that reel and in praise find
The secrets of the heart and soul and mind.
The prophecy is true that rulers come
To praise him in their rhetoric and sum,
But I wait still to hear an earnest voice
Praise him and You when there is always
choice

To take an oil refinery and the reins
Of the poor to relieve high living's pains.

11 And He'll deliver them up to
The angels for punishment *due*,
To execute vengeance on them
Because they have oppressed *the hem*
Of His children and His elect
And they shall be a sight select
For the righteous and His elect,
12 They shall rejoice over them, for
The Lord of Spirits' wrath *in store*
Rests on them, and His sword is drunk
With their blood. 13 And the righteous
hunk

And elect shall be saved that day,
And they shall never from that fray
See sinners' and unrighteous face.
14 And Lord of Spirits will abide
Over them, and there by the side
Of Son of Man they'll eat and lie
Down and rise up for ever aye.
15 And the righteous and the elect
Shall have risen from earth *direct*,
And ceased to be of downcast face.

16 And they shall have been clothed apace
With garments of glory, and these
Shall be the garments of life's *ease*
From the Lord of Spirits, and your
Garments shall never grow old more,
Nor your glory pass out before
The Lord of Spirits *on that shore*.

My garments never grow old even now,
Because they're old when I get them
somehow.

I hardly wear a thing that's new and fresh
Since I care little what comes to touch
flesh.

I bide the hidden one and quietly
Bear what evil the rulers make to be,
Knowing their turn to prostrate comes anon
When I shall wake to see the rosy dawn.
Who beg for mercy now will live to see
Their rulers begging outright with a plea,
Or else die in their shapeless poverty
To wake up on the clamour of the day.
Beloved, I bide the hidden ones and stay
Within the kingdom, craven iron and clay.

Enoch 63

1 In those days shall the mighty and
The kings who possess the earth's *land*
Implore to grant them some respite
From His angels of judgement plight
To whom they were delivered, that
They might fall down and worship at
The Lord of Spirits, 2 and confess
Their sins before Him, *for redress*.
And they shall bless and glorify
The Lord of Spirits, and reply,
3 "Blessed is the Lord of Spirits and
The Lord of kings *of every land*,
And Lord of mighty and the Lord
Of the rich, and the Lord adored
And the Lord of wisdom, resplendent
In every secret thing *transcendent*
Your power from generation to
All generations *not a few*,
Your glory for ever and aye,
For deep are Your secrets and sly
And numberless *up to the sky*,
Your righteousness beyond all count.
4 We have now learned it's paramount
To glorify and bless the Lord
Of kings and Him who rules all things."

Let my each breath give glory to Your
 name,
 And let the burning of my fleshly frame
 That takes that breath and makes without a
 shame
 The nourishment my body needs to live,
 Establish in the circle where I give
 My small production of oxide to sieve
 The life of tree and flower and humble
 grass,
 Tenacious of the wind and sun to pass
 Still living through the frozen winter storm,
 A witness to Your secret, numberless
 Blessings and powers that the righteous
 confess.
 Let my life and movement and breath
 inform
 The desert air where I dance and keep fire
 That You alone are Sovereign of the quire.

5 And they shall say "If only we
 Had rest to glorify and be
 Grateful and confess our faith by
 His glory! 6 And now we long sigh
 For some rest but we find it not,
 We follow hard upon the plot
 And achieve naught; and light has vanished
 From before us, darkness unbanished
 Is our house for ever and aye.
 7 "For we have not believed before Him
 Nor glorified the name that bore Him
 Of Lord of Spirits, *glorified*
Not our Lord, but our hope was in
 The sceptre of our kingdom's win,
 And in the glory of our own.
 8 "And in the day of our suffering
 And trouble He does not take wing
 To save us, we find no respite
 For confession that our Lord's right
 In all His works, and in His acts
 Of judgement and His justice' facts,
 And His verdicts have no respect
 Of persons. 9 "And we as reject
 Pass on from before His face on
 Account of our works, and our drawn
 Sins reckoned all in righteousness."
 10 Now they shall to themselves confess,
 "Our souls are full of wicked gain,
 But that does not prevent our pain
 Descending from here on the wane
 Into the burden of Sheol."
 11 And after that their faces' toll

Shall be filled with darkness and shame
 Before that Son of Man *and name*,
 And they shall be driven from out
 His presence with a sword and shout
 Before his face among their rout.
 12 So spoke the Lord of Spirits, "This
 Is ordinance, judgement's abyss
 Regarding the mighty and kings
 And the exalted wanderlings
 And those who possess earth before
 The Lord of Spirits *in His store*."

Who beg for rest or use as an excuse
 They have no rest are just being obtuse.
 You gave, Beloved, rest to women and
 men,

To sons and daughters, to servants again,
 And even to the beasts that plough the
 fields.

You gave to all rest and all that rest yields.
 So there is no excuse on Judgement Day
 For those who failed to keep to Sabbath's
 way.

If we had rest to glorify, they say!
 The sema is a glory where to stay.
 Bend down in close prostration on the eve
 Of Sabbath is a thing that gives reprieve.
 But let me not complain You give no rest,
 Your Sabbath's for both wicked and the
 best.

Enoch 64

1 And other forms I saw secreted
 In that place. I heard *undefeated*
 The voice of the angel who said
 2 "These are the angels who were led
 Down to the earth, and revealed what
 From the children of men was shut
 Seducing the children of men
 Into committing sin *again*."

The secrets of genetics are not lost
 On humankind, both to blessing and cost.
 It's not science itself I ween that's false
 But human hearts that would engage in
 waltz

About abilities to create pain.
 Knowledge is a danger to the insane
 Who do not know to use with wisdom what
 The tree of knowledge places on the putt.
 Angels themselves may make a gesture
 bright

That turns away from good and true and
right.
Beloved, give me not only knowledge but
The wisdom to keep love and truth in sight.
My stopping to speak to a violet's not
What distracts but not seeing flower pot.

Enoch 65

1 And in those days Noah saw earth
That it had sunk down *in its worth*
And its destruction was come near.
2 And so he rose up from his gear
And went out to the ends of earth,
And cried aloud to Enoch his
Grandfather, and Noah *a whiz*
Said three times with a bitter voice,
“Hear me, hear me, hear me *by choice*.”

Noah spoke to the hidden Enoch when
He saw the earth filled with violent men.
He saw destruction near and judgement
sent
Upon both angelic and human vent,
And going to the ends of earth he cried
Three times in bitter cadence on the ride.
I too see earth filled with the violent,
I see destruction on horizon meant
To cleanse the earth with fire of love and
toil
Of judgement wrecked upon the cursèd
soil.
And I too at the end of earth where ice
Envelopes granite and the crumbling gneiss
Call three times to the hidden one to hear
My bitter voice and to my call give ear.

3 And I said to him, ‘Tell me what
It is that’s falling out on earth
That the earth’s in such evil shut
And shaken, lest perhaps my birth
Shall perish with it?’ 4 Then there was
A great commotion on earth’s *draws*,
And a voice was heard out of heaven,
And I fell down on my face driven.
5 And Enoch my grandfather came
And stood beside me *as in blame*,
And said to me “Why have You cried
To me so bitterly and sighed
With weeping? 6 “And command has gone
Out from the presence of YHWH drawn
Concerning those who live on earth
That their destruction’s come to berth

Because they’ve learned the secrets of
The angels *sent from heaven above*,
And the accusers’ violence,
And all their powers *devoid of sense*,
The ones most secret, all the power
Of those who practice magic’s hour,
And witchcraft, and the power of those
Who make molten idols impose
On the whole earth; and how to take
The silver from earth’s dust, to make
The soft metal out of the earth.
7 “For lead and tin are not produced
From the earth like the first *reduced*,
It is a fountain that brings them,
And an angel stands at the hem,
And that angel’s pre-eminent.”

I seek the fountain that’s so near to me
I cannot turn and whirl but touch its fee.
I seek and drink that fountain thirstily
And thirst but more to turn again and be
Ravished by that sweet drought. I think the
store
Of what Messiah said once on the floor
That there’s a well that if one drinks no
more
Shall he thirst, is a fairytale made for
A woman lost in lust instead of faith.
When I drink of Your word, Your breath,
Your name,
I only thirst the more to play Your game.
What was at first a shadow and a wraith
Appearing through the veils of cloud and
mist
Is now an overwhelming to insist.

The rumours are the soft metal in state
Is magic in the way it makes the rate
Of energy and motion escalate.
The rumours are the soft metal is called
By name of mercury by those installed
In alchemy and divinations thrallèd.
The rumours are both rampant and too late
To heal the history of rife and mate.
Beloved, I taste the magic metal won
Upon the Zionitic hill in ton
And revel in the forty days to fill
Permission to climb up the sacred hill
In weddings chemical and magic still
To find the transformation long since done.

8 And after that grandfather sent,

And Enoch took me by the hand
 And raised me up *and made me stand*,
 And said to me, "Go, for I've asked
 The Lord of Spirits of this *masked*
 Commotion on the earth." 9 And He
 Told me, "Because of their degree
 Of wickedness their judgement's been
 Determined and shall not begin
 To be withheld by Me for ever.
 10 "Because of the sorceries *clever*
 Which they've searched out and learned,
 the earth
 And those who live upon its *dearth*
 Shall be destroyed." 11 And these, they've
 no

Place of repentance on the go,
 Because they have shown them what was
 Hidden, and they're damned for that cause;
 But as for you, my son, the Lord
 Of Spirits knows that you've *implored*
Him to be pure, and guiltless of
 Reproach for the secrets *above*.
 12 And He's destined your name to be
 Among the holy *and the free*,
 And will preserve you among those
 Who live on the earth *to its close*,
 And has destined your righteous seed
 Both for kingship and for indeed
 Great honours, from him shall proceed
 A fountain of the righteous and
 Holy without numbers' command.

The secrets that the watchers told to men
 Come back to haunt the human heart and
 den.
 The greatest idols that were ever made
 Of metal rose to military grade.
 Who bow to gold must some day come to
 bow
 To steel and hardened warheads on the
 prow.
 It may take centuries of worshipping
 The Roman armies' rise to take a fling,
 But sure as division of day into
 The gods of all the earth and in man's view
 Takes place, so steel will rise to even score.
 Ah, my Beloved, keep watcher from the
 door!
 I stake my love and worship on the ground
 Beneath a templed dome where I am found.

Enoch 66

1 And after that he showed to me
 The angels of punishment free
 Who are prepared to come and let
 Loose all the powers the waters get
 Which are beneath the earth to bring
 Judgement and a great destroying
 On all who dwell upon the earth.
 2 The Lord of Spirits gave command
 To the angels going to land,
 That they not cause waters to rise
 But should hold them in check thus wise,
 For those angels were over powers
 Of the waters. 3 I left the bowers
 From the presence of Enoch's *flowers*.

The waters of the flood were held in check
 By watchers commanded to keep their neck
 Upon the floodgates till the time to square
 The judgement on the earth, and time to
 spare
 The righteous out of hand. The angels stand
 Awaiting the decree of Your command.
 I touch, Beloved, the faithful loyalty
 Of those angels sent out to make men free
 Of life and lust on the day of decree.
 What seed is it in human heart and heart
 Of watcher angel, that some will depart
 From Your command, while others take
 their place,
 Stand true and stalwart, and enter the race
 When You say go, is it mercy or grace?

Enoch 67

1 In those days word of Alohim
 Came to me, and He said *in dream*
 "Noah, your lot's come up before
 Me, a lot without blame, what's more,
 A lot of love and uprightness.
 2 "And now the angels to address
 Are making a wooden command,
 And when they've completed that band
 I'll place My hand on it to keep,
 And there shall come out from the *deep*
 The seed of life, and change shall set
 On so that the earth will not get
 Deserted of inhabitants.
 4 "And I will make fast and firm plants,
 Your seed by me eternally,
To stand upon the earth and free,
 And I will spread abroad those who
 Live with you, it shall not be few
 And unfruitful on the earth's face,

But it shall be blessed, full of grace
Upon the earth in name of YHWH.”
5 And He will imprison as due
Those angels, who’ve done wickedness,
In that burning valley’s address
Which my grandfather Enoch saw
Before me in the west *in awe*
Among the mountains made of gold
And silver and iron, lead untold
And tin. And I saw that vale in
Which there was powerful chagrin
And convulsion of waters’ *bin*.

The waters boiled upon the earth with strife
So great that Satan himself feared of life
And ran upon the mountains made of gold
And iron and tin, though he had been so
bold

To splice men’s genes with animals and
sold
The right to rule in peace instead of knife.
But You, Beloved, saved in that turgid
game

Noah and his to rise up without blame
And save a seed of humankind on earth.
I am not sure that was an act of worth.
The tribe has scattered far to do its ill,
And is about once more to take the till
And create forms of life that rise to kill.
Are You not sorry now You gave them
berth?

6 And when all this took place, from that
Molten and fiery metal *sat*
And from the convulsion of it
In that place, there was requisite
A smell of sulphur, and it was
Joined with those waters, and in pause
That valley of the angels who
Had led mankind astray in crew
Burned beneath that land. 7 And then
through

Its valleys proceed streams of fire,
Where these angels are punished dire
Who’d led astray who live on earth.
8 But those waters shall *without dearth*
In those days serve for kings and mighty
And the exalted, and the flighty
Who live on earth, and for the healing
Of the body, but for the sealing
Of punishment of spirit, now
Their spirit’s full of lustly vow,

So that they may in body be
Punished, for they’ve *ungratefully*
Denied the Lord of Spirits and
See their punishment on the land
Daily, and yet do not believe
In His name. 9 And at the same rate
As their bodies without reprieve
Burn with severity, the state
Of their spirit will also change
For ever and for ever range,
For before Lord of Spirits none
Shall utter idle word in fun.
10 For judgement shall come down on
them,

Because they trust in stratagem
Of their body’s lust and deny
The Spirit of YHWH *in their lie*.

The sulphur waters that rise up from hell
Where wicked angels are tortured a spell
Are for the healing of the race on earth,
The seed of man and woman saved for
worth.

My grandmother once worked in a hotel
Which kept folk by the waters of such
smell,
And made their beds and folded up their
sheets.

It was a step up from the world that meets
The young girl’s hand who before that
earned bread

By washing the cold bodies of the dead.
I join my voice with the praise of all men
Who sing Your lauds because the springs
again
Boil up with sulphur from hell to release
The healing waters upon men for peace.

11 And those same waters undergo
A change in those days *as they show*,
For when those angels are chastised
In these waters, they are revised
In temperature of water springs,
And when the angels raise *their wings*,
Water becomes cold in the springs.
12 And I heard Michael answer saying
‘This judgement by which angels staying
Are judged is a witness for kings
And mighty ones possessing earth.”
13 Because these waters of judgement
Serve to the healing of the *rent*
Body of the kings and the lust

Of their body, therefore they must
Not see and will not believe that
Those waters will change in the vat
And change into a burning fire
For ever *on their hot desire*.

It's hardly likely that rulers and kings
Find this witness the judging angel brings
Convincing as long as they sit in state
And hold in hand sceptres of others' fate.
Perhaps upon a day when they shall see
The punishment in its catastrophe,
It will be witness, but then is too late.
The problem is that those who rule do not
Have eyes that see the angels on the spot.
Had they such eyes, they would not take
the throne
Where You, Beloved, are sovereign alone.
Judgements on angels, from where humans
stand
Are rumours and the tinkling of the sand
Within crystal hourglass set on moonstone.

Enoch 68

1 And after that my grandfather
Enoch gave me teaching secure
Of all the secrets in the book
In the signs he'd been given to look,
And he put them together for
Me in the words of the book's store
Of parables. 2 And on that day
Michael answered Raphael to say
"The power of the spirit transports
And makes me tremble *in my shorts*
Because of the severity
Of the judgement met secretly,
The judgement of the angels went,
Who can endure severe judgement
Which has been performed, and before
Which they melt away *on the shore?*"
3 And Michael answered again, saying
To Raphael, "Who is *one staying*
Whose heart is not broken by it,
And whose reins are not troubled whit
By this word of judgement gone out
Upon them because *of the clout*
Of those who have thus led them out?"
4 And it happened when he stood there
Before the Lord of Spirits fair,
Michael said to Raphael, "I will
Not take their part under the *still*
Eye of YHWH, for the Lord of Spirits

Has been wroth with them since they cheer
its
Flame as if they were Lord *Supreme*.
5 Therefore all that in hidden dream
Shall come on them for ever aye,
For neither angel nor man's eye
Shall have his portion there, but they
Alone have received judgement's sway."

I stand, Beloved, upon the lichen stone
And look about me on the granite throne
Of silent earth bearing the sighing load
Of birch and fir and pine above the road.
The frail forget-me-not makes hardly pause
To drink the air above eternal laws
Then quietly, in secret strength allow
That all is well, in the world anyhow.
And yet I know that Michael's holy brow
Sweats and his knees tremble to see the
train
Of violence that punishes the strain
Of earth. Bravely Raphael bears the brunt
Of piercing pain, gazing without a grunt.
I hide no eye, Beloved, veiled from the
vain.

Enoch 69

1 And after this judgement they shall
Terrify and make them tremble
Because they have shown this to those
Who live on the earth *in disclose*.
2 And indeed all the names of those
Angels *are these that I disclose*,
The first of them is Samjaza,
The second one Artaqifa,
And the third Armen, and the fourth
Kokabel, and the fifth henceforth
Turael, and the sixth Rumjal,
The seventh Danjal, and the pall
Of the eighth Neqael, the next
And ninth Baraqel, and *perplexed*
The tenth Azazel, the *morose*,
And the eleventh Armaros,
The twelfth Batarjal, the thirteenth
Busasejal, and the fourteenth
Hananel, the fifteenth Turel,
And sixteenth Simapesiel,
The seventeenth Jetrel, and then
The eighteenth Tumaal, again
The nineteenth Turel *as once stated*,
The twentieth Rumaal *mated*,
The twenty-first Azazel *two*.

3 And these are the chiefs in the crew
Of their angels and by their names,
And their chief ones over *the claims*
Of hundreds, fifties and of tens,
Condemned and judged to hellish glens.

Angelic names preserved for all mankind
To mutter incantations for the blind
Of heart, who seek to rule the wind and
tide,
Forgetting that within the heart's to hide
A tempest and a storm of greater power
Not to be ruled by angels in an hour.
Like every soul I too diverted bend
To secret knowledge for a wand to tend.
Illusion of great power who guide a pot
Without hand to pour water where there's
not
Is greater to this apish way than word
Able to change to inner man once stirred.
I see the angels with their secrets bow
In trembling before twittering of vow.

4 The name of the first is Jejon,
That is, the one who led the spawn
Or servants of God all astray,
And brought them down to the earth's way,
Astray through the daughters of men.
5 And the second was named Asbeel,
He God's brawnly saints by the seal
Of evil counsel, led astray
And defiled in men's daughters' way.

Genetic engineering is no feat
Of modern invention alone, a treat
Of the American flag set up over
Laboratory company's dried clover.
Jeqon and Asbeel both deserve the prize
Of Nobel for the scientific guise
They brought out to men and their
daughters when
The angels mixed the genes of lice and
men.
The evil counsel still clouds minds and
eyes
Inciting men wicked things to devise
With tools that might have been lent to
good things
Had they not been subservient to kings
And presidents. Beloved, I see with sorrow
How cunningly, needlessly dies tomorrow.

6 And the third was named Gadreel,
He it is who showed all men well
The blows of death, he led astray
Eve, and then showed *them how to slay*
To the sons of men and the shield
And coat of mail, and sword to wield
For battle, all weapons of death
To the children of men *with breath*.
7 And from his hand they have proceeded
Against those who at last succeeded
To live on the earth from that day
And for ever and aye *in sway*.
8 And the fourth was named Penemue,
He taught the children of men rue
And sweet, and he taught them all things
In the secret of wisdom's springs.
9 And he taught mankind how to write
With ink on paper *to benight*,
Many sinned there eternally
And to this day. 10 For men were not
Created for such purposely,
To give a confirmation taught
To their good faith with pen and ink.
11 For men were created a wink
Exactly like the angels, that
They should continue *where they sat*
Both pure and righteous, and that death,
Destroying everything, could not
Have touched them, but through *evil* plot
Of this their knowledge they expire,
And I'm consumed by its desire.

Illicit sex and slicing up of genes
Is coupled with the secrets of the scenes
Where brother can kill brother with the
throw
Of arms from greater distances in tow.
Both science and amusement find the row
Of sex and violence make the best show.
Perhaps that is the reason that the pen
Is also condemned for the angel's wen.
Beloved, though I replace the quill with
that
Which glows and tinkles in computer vat,
The same sin of the darkened heart may fill
My writing with the dull, angelic bill.
Nay, let me write to praise Your name
alone,
And let that writing of itself atone.

12 And the fifth was named Kasdeja,
And this is he who showed the claw

To children of men, wicked things
 Of spirits and demons' smittings,
 And how to make abortions take
 Away the child for the womb's sake,
 And bites of serpent, and the strike
 Which falls through the noontide heat like
 The son of the serpent whose name
 Is Taba'et. 13 This is the claim
 Of Kasbeel, chief of the oath which
 He showed the saints living in pitch
 Above in glory, and its name
 Is Biqu. 14 This angel laid claim
 On Michael to show him the name
 That's hidden, that he might pronounce
 It in the oath, so that in pounce
 Those might quake before that name and
 Oath who revealed all by command
 That was secret to humankind.
 15 And this is the power that you'll find
 In this oath, for it's strong and stark,
 And he placed this oath Akae *dark*
 In the hand of Michael. 16 And these
 Are the secrets of this oath's ease . . .
 And they are strong through his oath, and
 The heaven was hung before the *grand*
 World was created, and for aye.
 17 And through it the earth has come by
 To be established on the flood,
 And from the secret mountains' bud
 Come beautiful waters, and from
 Creation of the world to come.

Ah many secrets wait the searcher where
 Michael meets watchers in the dismal air.
 The secret of Your name, Beloved, with
 care
 Is hidden from the ear of belle and swain.
 One tells the substance of abortion's power,
 The grinding up the red ash trunk an hour,
 And dipping up the water down the steam
 And brewing all to make the deadly dream.
 Nothing against nature, no, every act
 According to the Tao and its impact,
 Yet all the preparation void of life.
 Beloved, take me out of frenetic strife.
 I see the angels though too large to see,
 I hear their twittering inaudibly.

18 And through that oath the sea was made,
 As its foundation He has laid
 For it the sand against the time
 Of wrath, and it dare not pass on

Beyond it from creation's dawn
 Of the world to eternity.
 19 And through that oath are depths made
 free
 And fast, and abide not to stir
 From their place from eternity
 To eternity. 20 And refer
 Through that oath the sun and moon state
 Their course, and do not deviate
 From ordinance from ancient time
 To the eternal *years of rhyme*.

Beloved, all nature finds its bounds and
 bourns
 Through Your word though the human
 spirit scorns
 To realize that ebb and tide relate
 The wonders of the moon and stars in state.
 The mighty hand that graves the crusty
 earth
 To tremble and to crumble in its berth
 Lets not the orbit stand or dissipate.
 Beloved, with fear the ant and man arise
 To build their temples up toward the skies,
 But only ants fail not to praise Your name
 Arising to rebuild against the claim
 Of human footprint dark upon the ties.
 Only men build the idol's grove to vent
 Its ruin and shame where earth once more
 is spent.

21 And through that oath the stars complete
 Their course, and He calls them replete
 By their names, and they answer Him
 From the eternity *grown dim*.
 22 And in that way spirits of water,
 And of the winds *that might have sought*
 her,
 And of all zephyrs, and their song
 From all the winds' quarters and long.
 23 And there are kept the thunder's voices
 And light of lightnings *that rejoices*,
 And there are kept the rooms of hail
 And chambers of the hoarfrost's mael,
 And chambers of the mist, and too
 The chambers of the rain and dew.

Beloved, though I call up to star by star
 By name invented when angelic car
 Still spoke to men of leaf and root and pain,
 My speaking to the starlight here seems
 vain.

Vega does not deign to respond to me,
And Sirius in all its canine glee
Refuses to look on my task and say
A single word either by night or day.
And yet when I lift voice to wind aloud,
It answers me directly from its cloud,
And all the chambers of the rained and dew
Cry with the mist and hail in praise of You.
Thus in both silence and in voice I find
Echoes in praise of You to human mind.

24 And all these believe and give thanks
Before the Lord of Spirits' ranks,
And glorify with all their power,
And feed upon their thanks each hour,
They thank and glorify, extol
The name of Lord of Spirits' toll
For ever and ever, for aye.

25 And this oath is mighty to fly
Above them and through it *they are*
Preserved and their paths *under star*
Are kept, and their course not destroyed.

26 And there was great joy then employed
Among them, and they blessed and still
Glorified and extolled with will
Because the name of Son of Man
Had been revealed to them by plan.

The secret of Bektash is sought in vain
Who look in manuscript in hill and plain.
The awful word is hidden from the few
Who in their curiosity drink rue.
The word is rather hidden by the way
It stands in every breath and wall and day,
To make the snow, the rain, the grain of
sand

That lightens with the sunlight on the land.
That secret name that's hidden in the breath
Of every human being, birth to death,
Is that word of strength that created earth
And sky and star and sun, all things of
worth.

It can bring blessing or be spoken in
The curse of blasphemy and frightful sin.

27 And he sat on the throne of glory,
And the sum of the judgement story
Was given to the Son of Man,
And he caused the sinners *in scan*
To pass away and be destroyed
From off the face of earth *enjoyed*,
And those who've led the world astray.

28 With chains shall they be bound away,
And in their congregation's stay
Destruction shall with them confined
Destroy their works from earth *designed*.

29 And from henceforth there shall be
naught

Corruptible, Son of Man sought
Appeared, and has seated himself
On the throne of his glory's *shelf*,
And all evil shall pass away
Before his face, and the word's ray
Of Son of Man shall come to be
Before the Lord of Spirits *fee*.

Beloved the one that You appoint of men
To represent Your throne here and again
Is hidden from the power of those who
claim

To rule the world by their election game.
His occultation protects his bare life
From the righteous and good who hold the
knife.

I thank You, my Beloved, I cannot see
The Son of Man appearing on the lea
To walk on lilies of the valley free,
And scatter roses beneath every tree.
I'd be undone by his humility
And rise to strike him down as in the past
When Your appointed rode, a mere outcast.
I thank You for You peace instead of strife.

Week 8. Enoch 70

1 It so occurred after this that
His name which in his lifetime sat
Was raised aloft to Son of Man
And to the Lord of Spirits' plan
From among those who live on earth.
2 And he was raised above in worth
On chariots of the spirit and
His name disappeared from the land.
3 And from that day I was no longer
Numbered amongst them *weak or stronger*,
And he set me between the two
Winds, and between the north and due
West, where the angels took the cords
To measure for me place and hordes
For the elect and righteous ones.
4 I saw there first fathers and *sons*
Of righteousness who from the start
Live in that place *with hand and heart*.

Enoch, it seems, was first called Son of
 Man
 According to Your secret, gracious plan.
 Some prophets and divine guides that
 should come
 Were also designated by that sum.
 Elijah and Ezekiel the one
 Who was also caught up to see the sun,
 The other who saw those great visions too
 That rose inspired upon Enoch's clear
 view,
 Then Jesus Christ preferred that title bare
 Perhaps because he too rose on the air
 Like Enoch and was taken up alive
 To look out on the worlds and how they
 strive.
 Beloved, grant me also to sit beneath
 The feet of Son of Man upon my heath.

Enoch 71

1 And after this my spirit rose
 Translated into heavens I chose,
 And there I saw the holy sons
Or servants of Alohims runs.

My vision rises from the fir-clad slopes
 Behind my cabin where I live in hopes
 And dreams of peace beneath my tragic
 breath
 That weaves a thread of life against the
 death
 That yawns by flesh and blood with each
 heartbeat.
 My vision rises in the heavens to meet
 The holy sons of God each on his seat
 Of stellar weight and power, each in his
 flower
 Of light upon the universe an hour.
 My spirit rises from the aspen wall
 That closes me from seeing stars that fall
 And trains my soul in eye upon the sight
 Of melodies in hues of blue and white
 That penetrate the silences of night.

2 There they were treading flames of fire,
 Their garments were white to admire,
 And their faces shone like the snow.
 3 And I saw two streams of fire go,
 And the light of that fire shone like
 A hyacinth, and *under strike*
 I fell on my face before Lord
 Of Spirits, *the One and adored.*

Celestial beings walk on flames of fire
 In clothing glowing white beyond desire
 And faces shining like the driven snow
 Because the light reflects on them in glow,
 And not because they lack or do not lack
 Skin pigments to make them whiter or
 black.
 Noah himself saw such visions renew,
 And so did St. John when he from the strew
 Rose to see such a Son walking among
 The flaming candlesticks with swordly
 tongue.
 Beloved, though I see little in the way
 Of vision beyond miracle of day,
 I too bow at Your throne where it comes
 down
 To kiss the flaming lake beyond the town.

4 And the archangel Michael seized
 Me by my right hand, and then eased
 Me up and led me forth into
 All the secrets, and *with ado*
 He showed me all the secrets of
 Righteousness *and of divine love.*

Do You believe, Beloved, that Michael
 came
 To show me too the secrets of the game
 Of right acts in a world that's lost its
 shame?
 Indeed, Michael has touched me by the
 hand
 And brought me out upon the desert land
 And made me look abroad from the sea
 sand
 To find the mountain of Your revelation
 Arising still above each tribe and nation
 To show the way that raises to Your
 station.
 The archangel leads every man who will
 Upon the rocky summits from the plain
 To find the divine footprints on the hill
 That lead to secrets of unsummoned gain.
 The archangel Michael takes my hand still.

5 He showed me all the secrets of
 The ends of the sky, all the rooms
 Of all the stars, which all illumines,
 From where they go out by the face
 Of all the saints found in the place.
 6 He translated my spirit to

The heaven of heavens, and there I grew
 To see a structure built of clear
 Crystals there, and between those near
 Crystals were tongues of living fire.
 7 And my spirit saw belt of wire
 Which went around that house of fire,
 And on its four sides were the streams
 Full of the living fire, *it seems*,
 And they went all around that palace.
 And round about *with lifted chalice*
 Were Seraph, Cherub, and Ophan,
 And these are they *gargantuan*
 Who do not sleep but guard the throne
 Of His glory *and His alone*.

I too rise on the wings of wind and fire
 To find the utmost chambers of desire
 Marked out upon the needles of both pine
 And fir that compass me about in line.
 I too find crystal palaces of snow
 Girt with the cold flames of fire here below
 Where on the northern slope of earth I go
 About with whirling steps both quick and
 slow.
 I find the seraph's burning flight to make
 A crimson flash from the rain barrel's
 wake,
 And where the tufted eaters may forsake
 The fire-eyed berries of the mountain ash,
 I see the cherub from my window sash.
 I too guard Your throne with such in my
 stake.

8 And I saw angels who could not
 Be counted *nor their numbers taught*,
 A thousand thousands, and *then more*
 Ten thousand times ten thousand *score*,
 Encircling that house *ever more*.
 And Michael, Raphael, *of four*,
 With Gabriel, and Phanuel's *chore*,
 And holy angels there above
 The heavens, go inside and shove
 Out of that house. 9 And they came out
 From that house, and Michael *with shout*
 And Gabriel, Raphael and last
 Phanuel, and many to cast
 As holy angels without number.
 10 And with them *One never to slumber*
 Ancient of Days, His head as white
 And pure as wool to *human sight*,
 And His raiment not to declare.
 11 And I fell on my face *and bare*,

And my whole body fainted there,
 And my spirit into the air
 Was transfigured, and so I cried
 With a loud voice, and with the tide
 Of power, and blessed and glorified
 And extolled. 12 And these blessings which
 Went from my mouth *and without hitch*
 Were well pleasing before that One
 Ancient of Days *when I'd begun*.
 13 And that Ancient of Days came out
 With Michael and Gabriel about,
 And Raphael and Phanuel,
 Thousands and ten thousands of swell
 Angels without number to tell.... Cf. 46:3ff.

I whirl through the four gates upon the
 earth
 Reflecting all above in heavenly worth.
 The four hidden ones here walk in the wake
 Of archangels upon the shining lake
 Beyond the sun and stars, and yet I take
 A step into the unknown and rise up
 To quaff a slender and celestial cup.
 You paint Yourself to Noah and to see
 The Ancient of Days from Daniel's decree,
 And so turn in flash of eternity
 To show Yourself at last once more to me.
 The fours come out with You to shout and
 sing
 Ten thousand in the fall of a goose wing
 Where palaces of air abound and fling.

14 *The angel* came to me to greet
 Me with His voice, and saying sweet
 To me, "This is the Son of Man
 Who's born into a righteous *plan*,
 And righteousness dwells over him,
 And righteousness *grows never dim*
 From the Ancient of Days for him
 Never to forsake him *nor trim*."
 15 And he said to me, "He proclaims
 To you Islam [peace] in *holy* names
 Of the world to come, for from hence
 Islam's proceeded providence
 Since the creation of the world,
 So shall it be to you unfurled
 For ever and for ever aye.
 16 And all shall walk in his ways nigh
 Since righteousness never forsakes
 Him; with him a safe dwelling makes,
 And with him is their heritage,
 And they shall not be separated

From him for ever and an age.

17 And so there shall be length *instated*
Of days with that Son of Man, and
The righteous have Islam *at hand*
And an upright way in the name
Of the Lord of Spirits to claim
For ever and ever *the same*."

The true faith is established by the one
Elect from Your early ages begun,
Its peace securing the wings of creation,
An upright way in cantillating loud
Your names above the market and the
crowd.

The heritage of Eden on the earth
Is that way called in peace for all it's
worth,

To fill the love and longing known to man
In all the days and places of his span.

Beloved, I sing with angels on the floor
Of slaughter-ground, the earth where they
adore

Your name obeying what Your decree
meant

For them to do throughout a life well-spent.
I bow to Your glory and grace once more.

Section III. Chapters 72-82 The Book of the Heavenly Luminaries.

Enoch 72

1 The book of the courses of lights
Of heaven, the relations' *rights*
Of every one, according to
Their classes, their dominion *due*
And their seasons, and by their names
And places of origin's *flames*,
And by their months, which Uriel,
The holy angel, who a spell
Was with me, who's their guide, showed
me,

And he showed me all exactly
About their laws, and how the years
Of all the world go on into
Eternity, until the new
Creation as fulfilled appears
Which endures till eternity.

2 And this is the first law of lights,
The light of the sun has its rising
In eastern portals, *not surprising*,
Of the sky, and its setting in
The western portals of sky's bin.

It seems that Uriel has lost his way
Since every calendar that holds its sway
Over the earth in every place today
Neglects his guidance and forgets his face.
The stellar bodies that hang over space
And counsel earth to its obedient race
Are not enough to mitigate the loss
Of month and day and year on stone and
moss.

The almanacs pass on and with a toss
Renew the complaints in store for small and
great
Who know no help of heaven nor cantillate
Your praises in their times and in their
state.

Beloved, let me attend to Uriel
And make my own his timely spoken spell.

3 And I saw six portals in which
The sun rises, six portals which
The sun sets in, and the moon rises
And sets in these portals *in guises*,
And the leaders of the stars and
Those whom they lead *as if by hand*,
Six in the east, six in the west,
And all following each other *best*
In precise order, also many
Windows to the right and *if any*
To the left of these portals. 4 And
First there goes forth light great and grand,
Namely the sun, and his circuit
Is like the circumference of sky,
And he's quite filled with exquisite
Light and heat of the fire's ally.

5 The chariot in which he ascends,
The wind drives, and the sun down wends
From heaven and returns through the *feast*
Of the north that it may reach east
And is so guided that he comes
To the right portal *in his sums*
And shines in the surface of heaven.
6 So he rises in first month's leaven
In the great portal, which is fourth
Of those six gates from the east forth.

If Enoch is set in this hemisphere
To northward, it is spring to start the year.
The sun then rises from the portal bright,
The fourth in number and the fourth in
right.

It is a visionary and ideal world

And sky that he describes, Beloved,
unfurled.
Beyond the illusions of measurement,
The calendric computations resent
This happy, holy place beyond the care
Of careless watchers who disturb the air
With their mistakes in love and fortitude.
Beloved, deliver me from wise and rude,
And I shall count Your days instead of
mine,
And know the real beyond the sour wine.

7 And in that fourth portal from which
The sun rises in first month's *pitch*
Are twelve windows opened, from which
Proceeds a flame when they're thrown
wide

In their season *and to abide*.
8 When the sun rises in the sky,
He comes out through that fourth *gate* nigh
For thirty mornings in a row,
And sets precisely in the show
Of the fourth gate in western sky.
9 And during this time day becomes
Each day longer and night *in sums*
Each night is shorter to the morn
Of thirtieth day, *and so is shorn*.
10 On that day the day's longer than
The night by a ninth part *that ran*,
And the day makes precisely ten
Parts and the night eight parts again.

As I follow Your glory on the sway
Of spring from the twelve windows on the
bay,
I walk in flame and beauty on the town,
And taste the melted rubies from the brown
Cast hillside upon which with sure renown
The sun rises and sets to make the day.
I dance among the windows rosy red
And bite the walnut and the grape to bed
The hours of ecstasy before has fled
The melody that makes the purple gay.
Beloved, I dance with twelve and then
return
From flaming dawn to see the evening burn
For having danced my working hours and
stern,
Until the night comes on, but not to stay.

11 And the sun rises from that gate
Number four and sets in estate

Of the fourth, and returns again
To the fifth portal of the east
For thirty mornings, and *increased*
It rises from it and to set
In the fifth portal *when it's met*.
12 And then the day becomes two parts
Longer and makes eleven parts,
And the night becomes shorter and
Turns out to be seven parts *at hand*.
13 And as it returns to the east
It enters the sixth gate increased,
And rises and sets in the gate
Numbered sixth for days at the rate
Of thirty-one mornings because
Of the sign *set to it for laws*.

Why thirty-one mornings and not the same
Number of days in each month for a game?
Ah, my Beloved, You do not change Your
name,
You do not change the times of Your
release
To meet the world upon the humble fleece.
Three months of thirty days make just one
less
Than thirteen weeks of Sabbaths that You
bless,
And so You take the final season's day
To make the season and the Sabbath's way.
I count the rising and the setting sun
And wait with work until the week is done
And Sabbath comes once more upon Your
breath
To bring light, faith and freedom to the
death
Of this world's cry and hope. Beloved,
You've won.

14 On that day the day comes to be
Twice the length of the nightly spree,
And the day turns into twelve parts,
And the night's shortened *from its starts*
To six parts. 15 And the sun goes up
To make the day shorter *to sup*
And the night longer, and the sun
Returns to the east *when it's done*
And enters into the sixth gate,
And rises from it to relate
Thirty mornings. 16 And when are done
Thirty mornings *of rising sun*,
The day decreases by one part
Precisely, and becomes a *smart*

Eleven parts, and the night seven.
17 And the sun goes forth *on the heaven*
From that sixth portal in the west,
And goes to the east *at its best*
And rises in the fifth gate for
Thirty mornings, and sets *once more*
In the west again in the gate
Number five in the western grate.

The thirty mornings of my fasting well
Maintain the twelve sparks of my nightly
spell
To divinate the good upon the swell
Of ridge of rock that shadows where I
dwell
Beside the lilac spring, beside the well.
The thirty mornings shake a hoary head
And look out on the silver lake that's fed
By rains and dews, by the brook shady
spread
Beneath the birch in white and black
unread
To find a haven in the minutes sped.
Beloved, I sing the thirty mornings' tune
To lyrics of Enoch's most ancient rune,
And touch my wind-filled lyre with lively
hope
Strung with silver and golden strings of
rope.

18 On that day the day decreases
By two parts, and the amount is
At ten parts and the night at eight.
19 And the sun goes forth from that gate
Numbered five and sets *delicate*
In the fifth portal of the west,
And rises in the fourth gate best
For thirty-one mornings because
Of its sign, and sets *by its laws*
In the west. 20 On that day the day
Is equalized with night to stay,
And becomes of an equal length,
And the night amounts to the strength
Of nine parts and the day to nine.
21 And the sun rises there to shine
In that gate and set in the west,
Returning to the east abreast
And rises thirty mornings there
In the third portal and to bear
Towards the west to set in air
Of the third portal. 22 On that day
The night becomes longer than day,

And night becomes longer at night,
And day shorter than the daylight
Till the thirtieth morning, and
The night precisely comes in hand
To ten parts and the day to eight.
23 And the sun rises from that gate
Of the third portal and sets in
The third portal in western bin
And then returns into the east,
For thirty mornings and *decreased*
Rises in second eastern gate,
And in like manner sets in state
In the second portal at west
Of the sky. 24 And on that day night
Amounts to eleven parts sight
And the day to seven parts' sway.
25 And the sun rises on that day
From that second gate, and it sets
In the west in the second nets,
And returns to the east into
The first portal for *which it's due*
Thirty-one mornings, and sets in
The first portal in western bin
Of the sky. 26 And on that day night
Becomes longer and takes a right
To double of the day, and night
Adds up exactly to twelve parts
And the day to six. 27 And the *carts*
Of the sun have traversed the parts
Of his orbit and turn again
On those divisions of his *den*
Of orbit, and comes in that gate
Thirty mornings and sets to wait
Also in the west opposite.
28 And on that night the night is fit
To decrease in length by ninth part,
And the night has become at start
Eleven parts and the day seven.
29 And the sun has returned *in heaven*
And gone into the second gate
In the east, and returns *in state*
In the divisions of his rate
For thirty mornings, rising and
Setting. 30 And on that day *expand*
The night decreases in its length,
And the night is ten parts *in strength*
And the day then extends to eight.
31 And on that day and from that gate
The sun rises, then in the west
It sets, and returns *from his quest*
To the east, and rises in third
Portal on mornings as occurred

Thirty-one in all, and sets in
The west of the heaven *to win*.
32 On that day the night must decrease
And amounts to nine parts *in lease*,
And the day to nine parts, and night
Is equal to the day *in light*.

The year, Beloved, that I observe from
here,
Upon the frozen season and its byre,
Is not at night's greatest extent alone
Twice in length of the day's light to atone,
But in arboreal strength supersedes
The hours of day before it which recedes
Into the blackness of eternal night,
Without a sun to rise upon the sight.
You did not show to Enoch shadows that
Ranged on the ptarmigan and where it sat.
Perhaps you mean that no man should live
where
The sun sets in the north and not to share
With night the rulership of reindeer's field.
Yet those who live here are with Your love
steeled.

33 The year is exactly in days
Three hundred sixty-four *ablaze*.
And the length of the day and night,
And shortness of the day and night
Arise, through the rate of the sun
As these distinctions are made run.
34 So it comes that its course becomes
Each day the longer, and its sums
Each night are shorter. 35 This is law
And the course of the sun *in awe*,
And his return as he returns
Sixty times and rises *and burns*,
That is, the great light named the sun
For ever and ever to run.
36 That which rises is the great light,
And so's named according to sight,
According as YHWH commanded.
37 As he rises, so he will skid
To set and does not diminish
Nor rest, but runs day and night's *wish*,
And his light is seven times the brighter
Than that of the moon, which is slighter,
But as regards size they're the same,
Both equal *in the heavenly game*.

The scientists with measurement and crow
Tell me the sun since it began to grow

Is somewhat larger now than seven times
The size of the moon when it's full and
climbs.

The vision You gave to Enoch was not
It seems the scientific kind of plot.
And yet I wonder about all the days,
Three hundred sixty-four in numbered
ways.

It's clear You would have four additional
To make the Sabbaths come out usual.
But why has the earth in its orbit slowed
By more than one day yearly in its load?
Beloved, Your watchers have been shirking
duty
Despite the fact the earth is still a beauty.

Enoch 73

1 And after this law I saw come
Another law dealing in sum
With the smaller light, called the moon.
And its circumference *to festoon*
Is like the circle of the sky,
Its chariot in which it rides by
Is driven by the wind, and light
Is given to it as in right.
2 Its rising and setting in round
Changes month by month *from the ground*,
Its days are like the days of sun,
And when its light is at full run
It adds up to a seventh part
Of the sun's light as set apart.

The men who strode upon the lunar face
Expected more dust than they had to brace.
By calculating the moon's greater age
They thought that dust would mount up on
the page.

But now, the surface of the thing was bare
Despite the fact that there was little air.
Now Enoch knew celestial winds blew
there,

Which does account, I trow, for little share
Of dust upon the mirror of the moon.
Beloved, then blow soon Your celestial
breath

On my stone surfaces to prevent death
Of soul and body where I whirl and see.
Your heavenly wind here is a precious
boon,
Beloved, whisper of Your eternity.

3 And so it rises. And her first

Phase in the east comes out in burst
 Upon the thirtieth morning,
 4 And on that day its light takes wing,
 And constitutes for you the first
 Phase of the moon on thirtieth day
 Together with the sun to sway
 In the gate where it shows its ray.
 5 And the one half of it goes out
 By a seventh part, and no doubt
 Its whole ring's empty, and without
 Light, with the exception of one
 Seventh part of it when it's done,
And the fourteenth part of its light.
 6 And when it receives within sight
 One-seventh part of half its light,
 Its light amounts to one-seventh part
 And the half thereof *for a start.*
 7 And it sets with the sun, and when
 The sun rises the moon again
 Rises with it and receives half
 Of one part of its light *in staff,*
 And in that night and at the start
 Of its morning the moon's *depart*
 Sets with the sun, and is not seen
 That night with its parts of fourteen
 And the half of one of them *seen.*
 8 And it rises upon that day
 With precisely a seventh ray
 In part, and comes forth and recedes
 From the rising of the sun's *steeds,*
 And in its days remaining it
 Becomes bright in the thirteen fit
 Parts *that follow upon its leads.*

Enoch sees all from that small stand and
 view
 That makes the human senses find the dew
 An exquisite mark on the staining grass.
 He's blind to see reality in pass.
 An instrument and theory of the store
 May make one seem the wiser than before,
 But when my looking's done, the universe
 Is still beyond my blessing and my curse.
 Beloved, let me, as my perceptions go
 Through the kaleidoscopic hue and glow
 Know that the painting inspired by the
 show
 Is only figure of the real to know.
 The shadow dance I do not grasp, but slow
 To turn from phantoms to Your portico.

Enoch 74

1 I saw another course, a law
 For it, how according to law
 It goes upon its monthly cycle.
 2 And all these Uriel, *not Michael,*
 The holy angel who is chief
 Of all of them, showed me *in brief*
 Their positions, and I wrote down
 Their positions as *in renown*
 He showed them to me, and I wrote
 Down their months as they came to float,
 And the appearance of their lights
 Till fifteen days set in their sites.
 3 In single seventh parts it makes
 All its light in the eastern *stakes,*
 And in single seventh parts finds
 All its darkness in western *blinds.*

The seventh part is also found in number
 In the seventh day of the week to slumber.
 The seven deacons and the seven prophets
 That grace the faith of temple and its
 sophets,
 The seven pillars hung from seven skies,
 All tell the secrets of the wheres and whys.
 Uriel, guardian of time in space
 Flies out each day to comb the hiding place
 And send the hours upon the human race
 In every kind of unseen divine grace,
 And yet few find his footsteps in a trace.
 Beloved, I dance a ring around the moon
 Devouring the sun custard with a spoon,
 And yet I note that Uriel's come soon.

4 And in certain months it will change
 Its settings, and in further range
 Of certain months it follows on
 Its own peculiar course *toward dawn.*
 5 In two months the moon sets with sun,
 In those two middle gates *to run*
 The third and fourth. 6 It goes out on
 Seven days, and turns about and
 Returns again through the gate hand
 Where the sun rises, and makes all
 Its light, and goes back from the call
 Of the sun, and in eight days goes
 Into the sixth gate from which shows
 The sun. 7 And when the sun goes forth
 From the fourth gate the moon goes forth
 For seven days, until it goes
 From the fifth gate, turns back again
 In seven days into *the glen*
Of the fourth gate and makes its light

For all, and then recedes *from sight*
And enters into the first gate
Upon as many days as eight.

Ah, my Beloved, I too go out like moon
From the fourth gate on seven days and
soon

Return to You to hear the cantillation
Of Your bright names here at my battle-
station.

The sky is clear of every innovation,
With only greynesses about the thread
Of my horizons floating in the lead
Of lake and island. I seek out the moon
In witness of the gate and day come soon
To bring to me the fast celestial boon.

Ah, my Beloved, the speckled and the clear
Of sky and gate of truth when You are near
Are witness and enough to show the way
That I must go or else where I must stay.

8 The *moon* comes back again in days
In number seven into the ways
Of the fourth portal from the which
The sun goes forth *to shine in pitch*.

I seek, Beloved, the coming of the gate
Where four portals in glories turn to wait
The moon of my arising and the state
Of spirit in the Truth that clears the slate.
The turning of the yellow leaf in sort
Graces my rounding footsteps for their
sport.

The shining cobblestones about my fort
Are grey and silver with the rain's report,
The small rain that can tinkle not a sound
That human ears can hear upon the ground,
But only angel ears whose wings are bound
To wind gauze whispering beyond the
found.

Beloved, the fourth gate opens on the view
Of sun and beyond sun nothing but You.

9 So I saw their position, how
The moons rose and the sun in prow
Set in those days. 10 And if five years
Are added up the sun appears
To have a thirty-day surplus
And all the days in calculus
To it for one of those five years,
When they are full, *not in arrears*,
Amount in days to three hundred

And sixty-four. 11 The over-read
Days of the sun and of the stars
Amount to six days, in the bars
Of five years, six days every year
Come to thirty days *at five's cheer*,
And the twelve months then fall behind
The sun and stars to number's mind
Of thirty days. 12 And the sun and
The stars bring in all the command
Of years precisely, so as not
To advance or delay a dot
In their position by a day
Unto eternity's delay,
But fulfil the years in perfection
In three hundred sixty's delection
And four days. 13 In three years there are
One thousand ninety-two days' star,
And in five years one thousand and
Eight hundred twenty days to stand,
So that in eight years *time* there are
Two thousand nine hundred by far
And twelve days. 14 For the moon alone
The days amount in three years grown
To one thousand sixty-two days,
And in five years the moon's relays
Fall fifty days behind the sun,
One thousand seven hundred run
And seventy days, to which sum there
Is to be five added and bare,
One thousand and sixty-two days.

Who try to count the days that Daniel saw
Across the gleaming sky for a new law
Err if they count without a finger claw
Stuck in the book of Enoch at a draw.
It's meaningless to note what Daniel said
If the shores of Enoch remain unread.
Beloved, I count the days and years and
know
That You are above all things in the show,
And while the universe may choose step
slow
Of fast beyond the beat that it should go,
Your law remains the pale that comforts me
And shows me every fast eternity
That shadows on the week at last to bless
Both those who do and know and those
who guess.

15 And in five years there are *to share*
One thousand seven hundred days
And seventy more *to make the blaze*,

So that for the moon the days six
 In eight years amount to the tricks
 Of twenty-one thousand days and
 Eight hundred thirty-two in hand.
 16 [For in eight years it falls behind
 The sun to the amount in kind
 Of eighty days], all the days it
 Falls behind in eight years and fit
 Are eighty. 17 And the year is well
 Finished in pattern by which tell
 The stations of the world and sun,
 Which rise from the gates through which
 run
 The risings of the sun until
 It sets on thirty days *and still*.

The fact is that in eight years calendar
 Of three hundred sixty-four days by far
 Is out is sync with seasons on the run.
 I'd need an extra week before are done
 Eight years. Does this number prevent my
 taking
 A week outside the year of divine making?
 I fear the shallow watchers have been
 basking
 In unpaid holidays without the asking.
 When the year falls behind the equinox
 The sun and moon forget the golden locks
 Of portals indicated in Your score.
 If I follow the portal and the door,
 I must forget a week before arise
 Eight years upon the living of my skies.

Week 9. Enoch 75

1 And the leaders of thousands' heads
 Placed over all creation's *treads*
 And over all the stars, also
 Function with the four days that come
 Between, the intercalary days,
 Not divisible from the show,
 According to the annual sum,
 These give service on the four days
 Which are not reckoned in the ways
 Of the year. 2 And owing to them
 Men go wrong therein, for the gem
 Of those lights truly take their place
 On the stations of earthly race,
 One in the first portal, and one
 In the blessed third gate of heaven,
 One in the fourth portal *to run*,
 And one in the sixth gate, *not seven*,
 And the exactness of the year

Is achieved by its separate three
 Hundred sixty-four stations *clear*.
 3 For the signs and the times *that be*
 And the years and the days showed me
 The angel Uriel, whom YHWH
 Of glory's set for ever there
 Above all the lights of the sky,
 In heaven and in the world *that's nigh*,
 That they should rule upon the fair
 Face of the heaven and be seen *true*
 Upon the earth, and be the chiefs
 For the day and the night reliefs,
 For sun, for moon, and stars, and all
 The ministering creatures' *hall*
 Which make their revolution fall
 In all the chariots of the sky.

Four days disperse in six gates of the sky
 To bring the year even with Sabbaths by
 Four times thirteen, though some might
 wonder why
 Not just as well intercalary day
 In each portal that goes in heaven's sway
 To make the year three hundred sixty-six.
 That would cause only slightly fewer tricks
 To keep the seasons and the sun aligned.
 But Sabbaths keep the total sum confined.
 Two gates are empty and I deal with four
 Not to think that all things are on the score
 Of human knowledge, some things in
 creation
 Are for those fires and flames above my
 station.
 It's all a matter of the human mind.

4 In like manner twelve doors showed he,
 Uriel showed me, open *free*
 In the sun's chariot's circle done
 In the sky, through which rays of sun
 Break through, and from them comes the
 heat
 Upon the earth, when they comply
 To open in appointed seat.
 5 [And for the winds and *for the fly*
 Of the spirit of the dew when
 They are opened, standing open
 In the heavens at *heavens'* ends.]
 6 As for the twelve gates in the sky,
 At the ends of the earth, where fends
 Forth the sun, rises moon, and stars,
 And all the works of heaven's bars
 In the east also in the west,

There are many windows *in crest*
 Open to the left and their right,
 7 And one window at its time bright
 Sends out the warmth, to correspond
 To those doors from which stars beyond
 Come forth according as He has
 Commanded them, wherein, whereas
 They set according to their number.
 8 I saw in the sky chariots *lumber*,
 Running in the world, above those
 Gates in which revolve *sans repose*
 The stars that never set. 9 And one
 Is larger than all the rest *done*,
 And that's the one that runs its course
 Throughout the whole world *source to*
source.

The twelve doors open wide upon the sun
 And leave the world of men a place to run
 While following the abundant delights
 Of divine proof upon our days and nights.
 Beloved, I sing throughout the windowed
 cheer

To find the holy twelve are always near
 Upon the face of dawn or on the light
 Of evening shadowing the lakeside sprite.
 With each hour of the day I pass into
 The canded armouries that come to view
 Along the pebbled marge whose oily leaves
 Perform the duties where no other grieves.
 Beloved, I take twelve steps and then return
 Below the clouds to watch the reed beds
 burn.

Enoch 76

1 And at the ends of the earth I
 Saw twelve gates ope to all the sky,
 From which the winds go forth and blow
 Over the earth. 2 Three of them show
 Open on the face of the sky
Toward the east, and for reply
 Three in the west, and three at right
Towards the south of the sky's light,
 And three *northward* upon the left.
 3 The three first are those of the east,
 And three are of the north *at least*,
 And three [after those on the left]
 Are of the south, and three behest
 Are of the west. 4 Through four of these
 Come winds of blessing and to please,
 And from those eight come hurtful winds
 When sent *among the tamarinds*,

They bring destruction on all earth
 And on the water *for their dearth*,
 And on all who live there *in worth*,
 And on everything which is in
 The water and on land *for kin*.
 5 And the first wind from those portals,
 Called the east wind, comes forth through
 halls
 Of the first portal which is in
 The east, inclining towards the bin
 Southward, from it come desolation,
 Drought, heat, and destruction's conflation.
 6 And through the second portal in
 The middle comes what is fitting,
 And from it there come rain in fine
 And fruitfulness *of tree and vine*
 And the prosperity and dew,
 And through the third portal which true
 Lies toward the north come cold and
 drought.

The three winds lying there upon the east
 Come out to bless and curse the earth at
 least

At times when the air stirs above the hills.
 The cloudy scent arises then and fills
 The atmosphere hung low above the lake
 With blossoming and fruit and time to
 wake.

Who knows where these winds find their
 day of birth
 And origin upon the dampened earth.
 Beloved, blow on my soul returning here
 To find the eastern bar and the path clear
 That whirling in Your love makes and
 remakes.

At the fine rustle of Your wings my fear
 Dispels upon the moving atmosphere
 To find Your breath again among the
 strokes.

7 And after these come forth *unsought*
 The south winds through three portals,
 through
 The first portal of them inclining
 To the east comes out hot wind *whining*.
 8 And through the middle portal next
 To it there come forth the annexed
 Fragrant smells, and dew and the rain,
 Prosperity and health *amain*.
 9 And through the third portal that lies
 Toward the west *in human eyes*

Come forth dew and rain, locusts and
Desolation *upon the land*.

Of the three south winds two are harsh to
man,

One hot and burning and the other's plan
To bring on desolation with the fan
Of locusts. Yet, Beloved, I see Your grace
In Your permission in this time and place
To make of locusts once a tasty treat.

Few now would take advantage of such
meat,

Since pork is sweet and tender, so I'm told,
Though I have kept away from such bright
gold.

With what grace do You temper the hot
wind?

And for that matter with what grace
unpinned

The north wind that's to come? With
waited breath

I am anticipating that small death,
Invigorating punishment unsinned.

10 And after these the north winds, from
The seventh portal towards east come
Dew, rain, locusts and desolation.

11 And from middle portal *and station*
Come in a straight direction health
And the rain and the dew and wealth,
And through the third portal towards west
Come cloud and hoar-frost, and the best
In snow and rain, locusts and dew.

12 And after these [four] are the few
West winds, through the first portal joining
The north come forth with dew and
whining

Hoar-frost, and cold and snow and frost.

13 And from the middle gate unlost
Come forth dew, rain, prosperity
And blessing, and through the last *free*
Portal which joins the south come out
The desolation and the drought,
And burning and destruction's rout.

14 And the twelve portals of the four
Quarters of the sky are in store
Completed, and all their laws and
All their plagues and come to withstand,
All their benefactions in awe
I've shown you, son Methuselah.

The oblique winds all bring the desolation,

While the direct ones are a consolation.
East, south, north, west, all bring the wealth
and health,

While those between sing catastrophic
stealth.

The four gates of my whirling are all clad
With blessings to make human hearts once
glad

Who stooped obliquely to the narrow
breeze

That told an off-key drone of melodies.

Though I turn to the east, the south and
then

To north and west to seek Your face again,
I find Your presence even on the heath
Where grasshoppers come to bless woven
wreath

Of blossoms beyond heather and the rain
That softly wakens earth and not in vain.

Enoch 77

1 And the first quarter's called the east,
Because it is the first, not least
And the second, the south, because
The Most High will descend *for laws*
There, yea, there in quite special sense
Will He who's blessed in every tense
For ever descend. 2 And the west
Quarter is named diminished *quest*,
Because there all the heavenly lamps
Wane and go down *in evening damps*.

3 And the fourth quarter, named *at last*
The north, is into three parts cast,
The first of them is for the dwelling
Of men; the second contains *swelling*
Seas of water, and the abysses
And forests and rivers, *not misses*
The darkness and the clouds, and *last*
The third part has the garden *fast*
Of righteousness. 4 I saw seven high
Mountains, higher *toward the sky*
Than all the mountains on the earth,
And from there comes forth *all it's worth*
Of hoar-frost, days, seasons, and years
All pass away *as it appears*.

To reach the seven mountains on which sits
The secret of the quest bright through the
slits

Of sandstone stinging in the wind and high
Trees guarding every way that passer-by
May find, I must go whirling all around

The portals from which comes celestial
 sound,
 And turn from Sinai on the south and hear
 The Decalogue sweet to the human ear
 To find the glowing west in love and more
 The north with its cold awareness in store.
 From east to east I whirl and in that truth
 Of my beginning with its sincere ruth
 I find my end and goal right where I
 started,
 Though it had been unfound had I not
 parted.

5 I saw seven rivers on the earth
 Larger than all rivers of worth,
 One of them coming from the west
 Pours its waters into the breast
 Of the Great Sea. 6 And these two come
 From the north to the sea and drum
 Their waters in Erythraean Sea
 In the east. 7 Remaining from three,
 Four come forth on the northern side
 To their own sea, two shall abide
 To the Erythraean Sea, and two
 Into the Great Sea and there spew
 Themselves there [and some say, into
 The desert]. 8 Seven great islands I
 Saw in the sea and toward the dry
 Mainland, two in the mainland and
 Five in the Great Sea *and in band*.

From seven mountains clad in sun and
 snow
 I turn to find where seven rivers go,
 And from the rivers of the feast I slow
 To rest upon seven islands on a sea
 Primordial and unspent of symmetry.
 From seven tasks of law I take my will
 And make of it a plain instead of hill
 Where I refresh my face in waters still
 Before I find my island rest to be
 No sleep at all, but waking up for me.
 From seven hard necessities that dawn
 Upon my days of striving with the drawn
 I hear the bells of waterwheel and fawn
 Before I enter that eternity.

Enoch 78

1 And the names of the sun are these,
 The first Orjares, and the frieze
 Of the second is Tomas. 2 And
 The moon has four names, first at hand

Is Asonja, the second manned
 Is Ebla, the third Benase, and
 The fourth Erae. 3 These are the two
 Great sky lights, and their circles stand
 Like the circumference in view
 Of the sky, and the size of their
 Circumference is like *and fair*.

Beloved, I stand aghast that I have not
 Remembered the names of sun in their lot,
 Remarked the four names of the moon to
 plot

Its quarters and its secrets in their slot.
 Beloved, with shame I look into the sky
 That blesses every day I live to try,
 And find the names of all things written
 there

Beneath Your shadow and beneath Your
 care.

The four names secret of the moon guide
 me

Into the ways and gates of symmetry,
 And show me times above the storm's
 decree.

The two names of the sun as they repair
 The fortunes of the glowing of the gate
 Reply to every hope and consummate.

4 In the circumference of the sun
 There are seven parts of light *won*
 Which are added to it more than
 To the moon, and in its sure span
 It is transferred till seventh part
 Of the sun is played out in art.

5 And they set and go in the gates
 Of the west, and where it rotates
 By the north, and come out upon
 The eastern portals *of the dawn*
 On the face of the sky. 6 And when
 The moon rises one-fourteenth part
 Appears and like a heavenly dart,
 [The light becomes full in its *start*],
 On the fourteenth day it achieves
 Its light *as far as it relieves*.

7 And fifteen parts of light are set
 On its account till the day get
 To fifteen in number when its
 Light is accomplished *where it sits*,
 According to the sign of year,
 And it becomes fifteen parts *sheer*,
 And the moon grows by adding of
 The fourteenth parts *as shown above*.

I follow the sun in its seven parts
And try to make out the lines of its arts
Caught in the crucible of hidden starts
Of alchemical marriages and carts.
The myths remain to puzzle every brain
That comes to stare upon the purple plain.
I follow the sun in its seven days
And find the blessings of its harvest maze
To stroke the plough and open up the craze
Of furrows in the wealth of song and
praise.

The Truth remains to court my blind heart's
room

Until my soul retreats from single doom
To find the dew are pungent and the rain
Rises above the peony in bloom.

8 And in its waning it decreases
On the first day to fourteen leases
In parts of its light, on the day
To follow, the second in sway,
To thirteen parts of light, on third
To twelve, on the fourth *undeterred*
To eleven, on fifth to ten,
On the sixth to nine, and so then
On the seventh to eight, and on
The eighth to seven *before dawn*,
On the ninth to six, then to five
Upon the tenth, and to survive
At four upon eleventh *day*,
On the twelfth to three, and in sway
Of the thirteenth to two to last
On the fourteenth day just to cast
The half of a seventh, and all
Her light that's left beyond recall
Disappears on the fifteenth. 9 And
In certain months the month at hand
Has twenty-nine days by command
And once *just* twenty-eight *to stand*.

The moon revolves in cycles by its days
But comes short of the sun's year in its
plays.

The marches of the stars and planets show
Obedience in the ways they choose to go.
The lights increase upon the lunar face
Fifteen days and then return to their place
In twenty-nine or thirty by command
And so all things follow the running sand
That heavenly hour-glass sets on the strand.
Beloved, I too in my returning dance

To whirl about the dergah floor in trance
Obey the law of love to turn toward You
Who at the centre look out on the view,
Blow on Your tea and sip the morning dew.

10 And Uriel showed me again
Another law *and specimen*,
When light is transferred to the moon,
And on which side it's transferred soon
To it by the sun. 11 During all
The period when the visual
Moon is increasing in its light,
It transfers to itself in sight
When lying opposite the sun
During fourteen days *on the run*
[Its light's accomplished in the sky,
And when it is illumined by,
Its light's accomplished full in sky.

The centuries ago that Enoch wrote
The sun and moon were known beyond a
mote.

The eye of Enoch was able to note
The light of moon came from the sun
reflected

And thus shone on the earth palely
completed.

The strange cry of today is that in days
Of old the heathen thinkers in their ways
Where primitive, unwise, unscientific,
But what I read of Enoch is terrific.
Beloved, science and wisdom in this world
Is but reflection of the store unfurled
Of divine grace upon benighted mind
Gleaned by the hearing ear and eye unblind
Traversing secret passages in maze.

12 And on the first day it's called new
Moon, for on that day the light's view
Rises upon it. 13 She becomes
Full moon exactly *in its sums*
On the day when the sun is set
In the west, and from the east yet
It rises at night, and the moon
Shines the whole night through till and
soon

The sun rises over upon
It and the moon is seen *at dawn*
Over against the sun. 14 The side
From where the lights of the moon ride
Out, there again it wanes till all
The light vanishes *at the call*

And all the days of the month are
 At an end, and her circuit's bar
 Is empty, and is void of light.
 15 And three months it makes thirty days,
 And at its time it makes in ways
 Three months of twenty-nine days each,
 In which it comes about to reach
 Its waning in the first time slot,
 And in the first portal it's got
 For one hundred and seventy days
 Added to seven days *for praise*.
 16 And in the time that it goes out
 It appears for three months about
 Of thirty days each, and for three
 Months it appears twenty-nine free.
 17 At night it appears like a man
 For twenty days each time *in span*,
 And by day it appears like heaven,
 And there is nothing else there given
 In it except its light *by plan*.

Enoch slips up revealing in a word
 He knows the moon's light is a thing
 transferred
 From sun, and yet he still breaks out in
 rhyme
 As though the thing were of another clime.
 I too borrow my light and life from You,
 And yet the many look upon the few
 And still remark on wax and wane of light
 On the face of the borrower in plight.
 Beloved, there is no light of sun or moon,
 Or star or anything, but borrowed soon
 From You who with one breath all things
 below
 Send into nothingness after their show.
 Beloved, I wait before eternal face
 To find in nothingness my better place.

Enoch 79

1 And now, my son, I've shown all things
 To you, and the law of the rings
 Of all the stars in heaven is done.
 2 And he showed me all the laws run
 For every day, and every time
 Of bearing rule, and every *clime*
And year, and for its going out,
 And for order ordained about
 It every month and every week,
 3 And waning of the moon to peek
 From the sixth portal, 4 for in this
 Sixth portal its light comes to kiss,

And after that there is the start
 Of the waning and which takes part
 In the first portal in its time,
 Till one hundred and seventy *rhyme*
 With seven days are accomplished,
 Reckoned according to *the wished*
 Weeks, twenty-five *weeks* and two days.
 5 It falls behind the sun and ways
 Of the stars exactly five days
 In the course of one period *run*,
 And when this place which you see's done
 Is its circuit. 6 Such is the frame
 And sketch of every lamp the same
 Which Uriel the archangel,
 Who is their leader, showed me well.

Five days behind in half a year the moon
 Looks to the sun for every blessed boon.
 Rotation of the coils returns aghast
 That every moment from the moment last
 Retards the way and the bright shining goal
 Is ever further from the stricken soul.
 Indeed, Beloved, like moon pale and
 forlorn
 With wavering light, hope growing at the
 horn
 Then slowly fading with the passing days,
 I follow in the distance of Your praise.
 In half a year five days are lost and in
 A year in all ten have escaped the din
 Of rush. I float along the ebbing tide
 And know a new day will come at Your
 side.

Enoch 80

1 In those days angel Uriel
 Answered uttering to me well,
 "Indeed, I've shown you everything,
 Enoch, and I've revealed the spring
 Of all to you that You should see
 This sun and moon, and chiefs freely
 Of the stars of the sky and those
 Who turn them, their tasks and the close
 Of times and their departures' *throes*.
 2 And in the sinners' days the years
 Shall be shortened, and seed appears
 Late on their lands and fields, and all
 Things on the earth in changes fall,
 And shall not appear in their time,
 And the rain be kept back *in clime*
 And the sky shall withhold *it all*.
 3 And in those times the fruits of earth

Shall be backward, and *for the dearth*
 Not grow *and ripen* in their time,
 And the fruits of the trees shall be
 Withheld *from them* in their time's *fee*.
 4 And the moon shall alter its rate,
 And not appear in time, *but late*.
 5 [And in those days the sun shall be
 Seen and it shall journey at eve
 On the edge *and upon the sleeve*
 Of the great chariot in the west]
 And shall shine more brightly *in test*
 Than accords with order of light.
 6 And many chiefs of the stars' night
 Shall transgress the order *prescribed*.
 And these shall alter their *inscribed*
 Orbits and tasks, and not appear
 At the times prescribed to their fear.
 7 And the whole order of the stars
 Shall be concealed from sinners' bars,
 And the thoughts of those on the earth
 Shall err concerning the stars' worth,
 [And they'll be altered from their ways],
 Indeed, they'll err and take their strays
 To be gods. 8 And evil shall be
 Multiplied upon them *freely*,
 And punishment shall come on them
 To destroy all *ad hominem*. "

Who reason that the year made up alone
 Of four times thirteen weeks before Your
 throne
 Is just a fable from the ignorance
 Of times past, are doing a song and dance.
 The year is true, the weeks, and every part,
 But by the prophecy the time will start
 To lag and alter that the sinful race
 May affirm themselves in their doubting
 place.
 The seasons meet their dearth, the stars
 benign
 Fail of their cycles in the grand design.
 For that excuse the masses will resign
 Themselves to fail to keep Your law and
 mine.
 Beloved, give me the sense each year to
 know
 The rising of Your Sabbaths on the go.

Enoch 81

1 And he said to me, "Note, Enoch,
 These heavenly tablets *made of rock*,
 And read what is written thereon,

And mark each single fact there drawn."
 2 I saw the heavenly tablets, and
 Read everything written *by hand*
 And understood everything, and
 Read the book of all mankind's deeds,
 And of all the children *in weeds*
 Of flesh that shall be upon earth
 To furthest generations' worth.

The heavenly tablets writ in words of gold
 And graven in such stone as is not sold
 Reveal the laws You sent to humankind
 As well as those to which mankind is blind,
 Divided from the wisdom by the veils
 That separate the nous from cloudy sails.
 The heavenly tablets tell the divine plan
 Of action and of being for each man
 And woman, child and creature in the
 stroke
 Of universes that You, Beloved, spoke.
 The heavenly tablets in secret and dark
 Tell human choices that flee from the park.
 From Torah to Qur'an the writing goes,
 But none know that writing as Enoch
 knows.

3 And straight away I blessed the great
 Lord King of glory aye in state,
 In that He has made all the works
 Of the world, and I without shirks
 Extolled YHWH because of His way
 Of patience, and blessed Him *that day*
 Because of the children of men.
 4 And after that I said *again*
 "Blessed is the man in righteousness
 The one who dies in his goodness,
 Concerning whom there is no book
 Of unrighteousness written *hook*,
 And against whom no day is set
 For his judgement in what he'll get."
 5 And those seven holy ones brought
 Me and placed me on the earth wrought
 Before the door of my house, and
 Said to me, "Declare all at hand
 To your son Methuselah, and
 Show to all your children that no
 Flesh is righteous in YHWH's bureau,
 For He is their Creator *done*.
 6 One year we'll leave you with your son,
 Till you give your *last* commands, that
 You may teach your children the chat
 And record *it* for them, and bear

Witness to all your children *there*,
And in the second year they'll take
You from their midst. 7 For your heart's
sake

Be strong, for the good shall announce
Righteousness to the good's accounts,
Righteous with righteous shall rejoice,
Congratulating with one voice
Each other. 8 But the sinners shall
Die with the sinners for their sal,
And the apostate shall go down
With the apostate *on the town*.

9 And those who practice righteousness
Shall die on account of the mess
Of deeds of men, and shall be taken
Away because of godless *bacon*."
10 And in those days they ceased to speak
To me, and I came back to seek
My people, blessing YHWH of all
The world, *who holds it in His thrall*.

For one year Enoch taught his craven brood
The glories of the heavenly tablets stewed
In language that they might have
understood,

But did not pass on faithfully as should.
Even Moses when taught to go the way
Of righteousness beyond the reasoned ray
Balked at the action of the led by You.
Let me, Beloved, give all glory to do
And think and be upon this whirling ball
To Your fame in celestial choir stall.
Like Enoch let me glorify Your name
And teach to my descendants holy fame
That created the snow upon the rail
And lifted up the scintillating veil.

Week 10. Enoch 82

1 And now, my son Methuselah,
All these things I recount in awe
To you and write down for your *law*!
And I've revealed to you all things,
And given you books *and writings*
Concerning all these, so preserve,
My son Methuselah, *with nerve*
The books *come* from your father's hand,
And grant them too in every land
To generations' ages spanned.
2 I've given wisdom to you and
To your children, *and children planned*,
That they may give it to their sons
For generations *in their tons*,

This wisdom that passes their thought.
3 And those who understand what's taught
Shall not sleep, but shall listen well
With the ear that they learn to tell
This wisdom, and it shall please those
That taste it more than food they chose.

Indeed, Beloved, this prophecy is true,
I taste Your words more than the manna
due

On breakfast plate or in the gruel store
That waits for me at evening's glowing
door.

And as I taste Your words I'm lifted up
To chew a better morsel, sip a cup
Of finer wine than any other laid
Upon the vineyards my grandfather made.
Indeed, Beloved, the cantillated word
More than all else my human heart has
stirred

And touched it with a flame of love for fire
That goes beyond the brittle flesh desire
To find the god tracks through the snow-
filled trees

Crusty and frozen and without a breeze.

4 Blessed are all righteous, blessed are all
Those who walk in the righteous call
And do not sin as sinners brawl,
In the reckoning of all their
Days in which the sun goes out fair
Across the sky, entering in
And going out from the gates thin
For thirty days with the heads of
Thousands of the order above
Of the stars, together with those
Four which intercalated chose
To divide the four portions of
The year, which lead them and go in
With them four days *without chagrin*.
5 Because of them men shall for fault
Not number them in the assault
Of the whole year, indeed, men shall
Err and not recognize cabal
With accuracy. 6 They belong
To the reckoning of the year
And are truly recorded *wrong*
Unless done so for ever *strong*,
One in the first portal and one
In the third, and one *set to run*
In the fourth and one *set to run*
Upon the sixth, and the year's done

In three hundred sixty-four days.
 7 And the account in all its ways
 Is true, for the lights, months and feasts,
 And years and days *for men and beasts*,
 As shown by Uriel to me,
 To whom the Lord of the whole *free*
 Creation of the world has set
 The host of heaven *not to fret*.
 8 And he has power over night
 And over day in heaven's *sight*
 To cause the lamp to give its light
 To men, sun, moon, and stars, and all
 The powers of the heaven's *thrall*
 Which revolve in the circuits of
 Their chariots *riding above*.
 9 And these are the orders of stars,
 Which set in their places *and bars*,
 And in their seasons *and their times*
 And festivals and monthly *climes*.

Because of the four days indeed men err
 As they determine in hate to defer
 The Sabbath to another day and place.
 But men are not alone to blame to trace
 The year out of the bounds of the days set.
 Who watch the moon cannot find thirty met
 In full for three months in a row, and yet
 The calendar would add a thirty-first.
 Who watch the sun find that the year would
 burst
 Beyond the limits to more than a day.
 Three hundred sixty-four in strict array
 For eight years running clearly goes astray
 From sun and season. We are watchers'
 prey.
 Beloved, guide me beyond the realm of
 cursed.

10 And these are the names of those who
 Lead them, who watch that they go through
 At their times, in order, and in
 Their seasons, in their months, and in
 Their own times of dominion, and
 In their set place *above the land*.
 11 Their four chiefs who divide four parts
 Of the year enter first *in arts*,
 And after them the twelve chiefs of
 The orders who divide above
 The months, and for the three hundred
 And sixty *days* there are heads led
 Over thousands who divide days,
 And for the four inserted days

There are the leaders which divide
 The four parts of the year *beside*.

Who drink the poured out four days from
 the spill
 Of calendar across the faded hill,
 Miss long the hopeful, secret hiding place
 Of the four messengers before the face
 Of dawn in rosy, rampant ghostly range.
 Who forget the inserted days are strange
 In their neglect of time and Sabbath's
 shield
 Of the subordinate and beast in field.
 Beloved, I stake a season and a week
 In my retrieving life from hide and seek
 To find the oil and grape juice and the flour
 Is meet for every treat upon the hour.
 Let the four chiefs divide my sacred tent
 And feed me with the nectars You have
 sent.

12 And these heads over thousands are
 Intercalated between star
 And leading star, each in a station,
 But their chiefs make division's ration.
 13 And these are the names of the chiefs
 Who divide the four parts' *reliefs*
 Of the year which are so ordained,
 Milki'el, Hel'emmelek, and
 Mel'ejal, and Narel *to stand*.
 14 And the names of those who lead them,
 Adnar'el, and beyond his hem
 Ijasusa'el, and one more
 'Elome'el, these three *in store*
 Follow the orders' heads, and there
 Is one that follows the three *fair*
 Chiefs of the orders which go on
 Behind those chiefs of stations *drawn*
 That divide the four yearly parts.
 15 And of the year and at its starts
 Melkejal rises first and rules,
 Who is named Tam'aini *in schools*
 And sun, and all the days of his
 Dominion where his ruling is
 For ninety-one days. 16 And these are
 The signs of *all* the days which are
 To be seen on earth in the days
 Of his dominion, sweat, and *haze*
 Of heat, and calms, and all the trees
 Bear fruit, and leaves are made with ease
 On all the trees, harvest of wheat,
 And the rose-flowers *come to greet*,

And all the flowers that come out
 In the field, but the trees as stout
 Of the winter time lose their leaves.
 17 And these are the names *and reprieves*
 Of the chiefs which are under them,
 Berka'el, Zelebs'el, *a gem*,
 And another who's added head
 Of a thousand, and called instead
 Hilujaseph, and the days of
 The dominion of this one's *glove*
 Are at an end. 18 The next to come
 A chief after him is *the plum*
 Hel'emmelek, and whom one names
 The shining sun *in all its games*,
 And all the days of his light are
 Ninety-one days. 19 And these then are
 The signs of *his* days on the earth,
 A glowing heat and dryness' dearth,
 And the trees ripen their fruits and
 Give all their fruits ripe and to stand,
 And the sheep pair and so conceive,
 And all the fruits of earth at eve
 Of harvest are gathered in, and
 Everything that's in field and land,
 And in the winepress, these things take
 Place in days of his rule and stake.

The angels of the seasons open up
 The year squeezed to be drunk from placid
 cup
 Of alabaster on the frozen shore
 And at the springtime's pleasant open door,
 And in the haze of summer with the dew
 Caught on the lady's mantle and the shoe
 Of chickweed. Only autumn stands askew
 And orders hazy wanderings in the wood
 Of golden falling leaves of brotherhood.
 Beloved, I cantillate the troubled names
 Unfortunate to my tongue in its shames
 That what Adam knew from the day he
 stood
 Is still beyond the knowledge of my claims
 Despite what I do, despite what I should.

20 These are the names, and these the
 orders,
 And the leaders of those head hoarders
 Of thousands, Gida'ljal, Ke'el,
 And He'el, and the name to swell
 By head of thousand, Asfa'el,
 And the days of his rulership
 Are at an end *with the last sip*.

The thirteenth Sabbath marks the sacred
 week
 Where seasons change about and go to seek
 The turning of the year and stop to gain
 The memory of oil, wood, wine and rain.
 I wonder thirteen Sabbath's through the
 time
 Of every season running on my rhyme,
 And in its weeks and days acquire that
 wealth
 That nourishes me and my own in stealth
 Until You come by door and board to stay,
 Visibly granting manna in its ray.
 Beloved, there are both weeks and times I
 fly
 To busy occupations on the sly,
 Forgetting to return in loving fire,
 Yet time and time again to You aspire.

Section IV. Chapters 83-90. The Dream-Visions.

Enoch 83

1 And now, my son Methuselah,
 I'll show you all my visions' awe
 Which I have seen, recounting them
 Before you. 2 Two visions *in stem*
 I saw before I took a wife,
 And the one was quite unlike *life*
 Of the other, the first when I
 Was learning to write *alibi*,
 The second before I took *her*
Who is your mother, to occur
 I saw a vision terrible.
 3 I prayed to YHWH as dutiful
 Regarding them. I'd laid me down
 In the house of grandfather's *town*
 Mahalalel, *when* I saw in
 A vision how the sky *by skin*
 Collapsed and was borne off and fell
 Down on the earth. 4 And when it fell
 To the earth I saw how the earth
 Was swallowed up in great abyss,
And shaken for all it was worth,
 And mountains were held up like this
 On mountains, and hills sank on hills,
 And high trees were rent from their sills,
 And hurled down and sunk in abyss.
 5 At that a word came in my mouth,
 And I lifted up *voice at drouth*
 To shout out loud, and so I said

“The earth is destroyed.” 6 At my bed
My grandfather Mahalalel
Waked me as I lay in his cell,
And said to me “Why do you cry,
My son, in lamentation why?”

The visions of youth before wife is taken
Are often of such character and shaken
As Enoch’s father saw in vast relief
The falling of the sky beyond belief.
His grandson’s life was wrapped up in that
ark

That floated under broken sky to park
On upturned hills under the battle ground
That whipped the firmament out of its
bound.

The shards that flaked along the edge of
sky
Melted in the abyss to hear the cry
Of man and beast before the feast of dry
Upon the wetness of chastisement’s lie.
Beloved, give me no vision more now I
Have grandchild playing in my life’s
compound.

7 And I told him the vision’s spoil
Which I had seen, and at the toil
He told me, “A terrible thing
It is you’ve seen, my son, a sting
Of grave importance is your dream,
A vision of the secrets’ beam
Of all the sin upon the earth,
Which must sink into the abyss
And be destroyed with all of worth,
Indeed, a great destruction’s this.
8 “And now, my son, get up and make
Petition in YHWH’s glory’s sake,
Since You are a believer, that
A remnant may remain who sat
On earth, and that He may not all
Destroy on earth *for its sin’s call.*”

Though I am not a prophet nor his son,
Still I hear the call at the rising sun
And at its setting and at noon and night
To say a prayer for mankind in his plight.
Destruction hangs above all men, a thread
Of breath to seize and reseize, then be
dead.

The sinking to abyss is not alone
For hills and spirits, dinosaurs of stone,
But also for the tender flesh and blood

That still remains after condemning flood.
Beloved, I rise with Enoch and I cry
A whirling sound toward the darkened sky,
And show my face in benedictions past
Before the sun and moon that time may
last.

9 My son, from heaven all this will come
Upon the earth, and on earth come
A great destruction. 10 After that
I rose up and prayed and implored
And begged, and wrote down my *restored*
Prayer for the whole world’s generations,
And I’ll show you all those relations,
My son Methuselah. 11 When I
Had gone below and seen the sky,
And the sun rising in the east,
And the moon setting in the west,
And a few stars, and not the least,
And the whole earth, everything best
As He had known it at the start,
Then I blessed YHWH for judgement’s
part,

And extolled Him because He had
Made the sun to go out *and clad*
From the windows upon the east,
And it ascended *like a beast*
Rising across the face of sky,
And set out and kept going by
The path shown to him *as increased.*

Because of Enoch’s prayer the world exists
After the great Flood came upon the lists.
Had Enoch not made his petition fair
You might, Beloved, have destroyed all the
share

That lived on earth. Sometimes I think the
wrong

Rests on Enoch, on his petition’s song.
Truth is that You in contemplating face
Of humankind could not without a trace
Destroy the vessels that held in the heart
The image of Your own and divine start.
Beloved, the visions that You gave to him
Began the practice of the gear and trim
Of intercession on the world’s far rim.
And so I too take Enoch’s godly part.

Enoch 84

1 And I raised up my *holy* hands
In righteousness and blessed *the stands*
Of the Holy and the Great One,

And spoke with my mouth's breath *when done,*

And with the fleshly tongue which He
Alohim's made for human glee,
To speak with, and He gave them breath
And a tongue *and a shibboleth*
To speak with: 2 Blessed be You, O Lord,
King, great and mighty with Your *sword*,
Lord of the whole sky and creation,
King of kings, Alohim of nation
Each, every one of the whole world.
And Your power and kingship unfurled,
And greatness abide ever aye,
And throughout generations' cry
Is Your dominion, all the sky
Is Your throne for ever, and all
The earth Your footstool *for its sprawl*
For ever and beyond recall.

3 For You have made and You rule all,
And nothing is too hard for You,
Wisdom departs not from the pew
Of Your throne, nor does turn away
From Your presence. And You essay
To know and see and hear all things,
And nothing's hidden from Your wings.

4 And now the angels of Your skies
Are guilty of trespass *in guise*,
And upon the flesh of men bides
Your wrath until the great day's *tides*
Of judgement. 5 And now, Alohim
And Lord and Great King, now I deem
To implore and beseech You to
Fulfil my prayer, to leave me few
In a posterity on earth,
And not destroy all human worth,
And make the earth desert a place,
Eternally desolate face.

6 And now, my Lord, destroy from earth
The flesh that has aroused the birth
Of Your wrath, but the righteous flesh
And upright plant as a plant fresh
Of the eternal seed, and hide
Not Your face from the prayer that sighed
Of Your servant, Lord, *from the tide.*

If Enoch's prayer save some upon the earth
To sing Your praises and for all they're
worth,
It's Enoch's prayer that calls down on the
field
The Flood in punishment, the Flood to
yield

Judgement of death to every corrupt thing
That dares to lift a sinful head to sing.
Plant Your eternal goodness in my breast
And drown the wickedness within me, lest
I fail to return in Your glory to
Your face, but disappear like morning dew
When judgement once more lifts its
righteousness
To see a world in wonder, sin and love
Beneath the mercy of Your own caress.
I look to You alone, and look above.

Enoch 85

1 After I saw another dream,
And I will show to you the dream
In whole, my son. 2 And Enoch raised
His voice and spoke to his son *praised*
Methuselah, 'To you, my son,
Will I speak, hear my words when done.
Incline your ear to the dream-vision
Of your father *without derision*.
4 "Before I took your mother Edna,
I saw in vision on my bed now,
And indeed a bull came out from
The earth, and that bull was in sum
White, and after it came a heifer,
And along with this *on the zephyr*
Came out two more bulls, one of them
Black, and the other red *for gem*.

The birth of Cain and Abel in the straw
Of the manger catches within the craw
And black and red remain the mythic hue
That turns toward the sunset, keeps in view
The morn and night arranged upon the
earth

To find at last a slender, humbler berth.
The birth of Cain and Abel prophesied
The rise of love and mercy, fratricide,
And burial in the abyss of soil.
The birth of Cain and Abel lent to toil
A bitter edge, and grazing in the calm
Light of the pear tree and the fruited palm
Raised worried eyes toward the sound of
sheep
Bleating upon the bosom of their sleep.

4 "And that black bull gored the red one
And pursued him before he'd done
Over the earth, and thereupon
I could no longer see that red
Bull. 5 But that black bull grew *as fed*

And that heifer went with him *led*,
 And I saw that many oxen
 Proceeded from him which as kin
 Resembled and followed him. 6 And
 That cow, that first one, anyhow,
 Went from the presence of that bull
 To look for the red one *in full*,
 But did not find him, and it grieved
 Great lamentation unrelieved
 Over him and sought him. 7 And I
 Looked till that first bull came to her
 And quieted her to aver,
 And from that time onward she cried
 No more. 8 And after that she tried
 To give birth to another white
 Bull, after him and to delight,
 She gave birth to bulls and black cows
 Many in number *as endows*.
 9 And I saw in my sleep that white
 Bull also grew to become wight,
 A great white bull, and from him came
 Out many white bulls of the same.
 10 And they began to reproduce
 Many white bulls to their excuse,
 One following the other's game.

The Son of Man, the first in Your great
 plan,
 Is pictured here as a great white bull's scan,
 Though well known as Seth in the sacred
 Script
 Wherein I have so often for faith dipped
 And come away with rather doubt and
 glories
 To blind my sight with captivating stories.
 Adam and Eve are taught and the first two
 As practice copies bit the dust and grew
 To be the father of all evil lore.
 I flee to Seth and the wide open door
 Of cantillating Your names as I sigh
 About the earthly floor and singly fly.
 Beloved, I raise a hovering voice to sing
 The lays of that first requisitioning.

Enoch 86

1 And again I saw as I slept,
 With my eyes I saw heaven kept
 Above, and indeed a star fell
 Down from the sky *as in a well*,
 And it arose and ate and grazed
 Among those oxen *to be praised*.
 2 And after that I saw the large

And the black oxen *that had charged*,
 And indeed they all changed their stalls
 And pastures and their cattle *brawls*,
 And started living with each other.
 3 Again I saw in vision, *brother*,
 And looked toward the sky, and lo,
 I saw many stars go below
 And throw themselves down from the sky
 To that first star, and they *with cry*
 Became bulls with those cattle and
 Grazed with them *there upon the land*.

I saw a star fall from the heavenly dark
 And land with loathing on the cherished
 park,
 Bitter as wormwood in the repetition
 That St. John gave it in his recognition.
 The falling star among the heathen here
 Is worth a single wish and with that cheer
 The dying go to bed without a tear.
 I saw a star fall from the spangled sky
 And tear across the wake of singled eye
 To share the pride of hoof until the night
 Crept over with the coming of the light.
 The falling star is baleful, gives not hope
 To elephant or tiger, antelope
 Or even jackal on the grassy slope.

4 And I looked at them and I saw,
 And indeed they put out the haw
 Like horses, and began to mate
 With the cows of the oxen *late*,
 And they all became pregnant and
 Bore elephants, camels, and band
 Of asses. 5 And all the oxen
 Feared them and were frightened like sin,
 And started biting with their teeth
 And to consume *upon the heath*,
 And gore with their horns, and began,
 Moreover, to devour each span
 Of oxen, 6 and indeed all sons
 Of the earth trembled in *their buns*
 And quaked before them and began
 To flee from them *as from one man*.

The sinful watchers and sinful offspring
 Appear here as oxen to gore and sting.
 Though everyone takes wife to have a fling
 It surely is a matter of the rife
 Attempts on watchers' parts to create life,
 Experimenting with the knot of flesh
 That's bound in DNA's genetic mesh.

Who knows what things unholy are still
done
Beneath the rising of unholy sun?
May every scientist take warning from
The errors of the times when angel scum
Wrecked havoc on the living creatures'
well
That scattered on the earth here and pell-
mell
Met violent ends from the cistern's spell.

Enoch 87

1 Again I saw how they began
To gore each other and *by plan*
To eat each other, and the earth
Began to cry for all its worth.
2 And I raised mine eyes to the sky,
And I saw in the vision by,
And indeed there came out the sky
Beings who were just like white men,
And four went from that place again
And three with them. 3 And then those
three
That had last come out there grabbed me
By the hand and took up, away
From generations of earth's *day*,
And raised me to a lofty place,
And showed a tower before my face
Raised high above the earth, and all
The hills were lower than its call.
4 And one said to me, 'You stay here
Until you see all that *in fear*
Happens to those elephants and
Camels, and asses *in their band*,
And the stars and the oxen, all.'

Beloved, though I am caught up by the race
Angelic to survey the earth's broad face,
I do not dream that those three beings great
Are deities surpassing in their gait
Your works of grand creation's spell and
cry.

I know they too are things created by
The coming and the going of Your fear.
I know that Your angels are always near.
From this grand tower I look upon the
fierce

And trembling spires that boldly come to
pierce
The sapphire of the sky with emerald rod.
I look out of reflected face of God
And know that You, Beloved, alone of all

Are nearer than my heart vein to my call.

Enoch 88

1 And I saw one of those four who
Had come out first, and he latched to
That first star that fell from the sky,
And bound it hand and foot in tie
And threw it into an abyss.
Now that abyss was just like this,
Narrow and deep, horribly dark.
2 And one of them drew a sword *stark*,
And gave it to those elephants
And camels and asses *that dance*,
Then they began to strike each other,
And the whole earth quaked for them,
brother.
3 And as I looked upon the view,
Behold, and one of those four who
Had come out stoned *them* from the sky,
And gathered and took all the sly
Great stars with haws like that of horse,
And bound them all hand, foot, *by force*
To throw in earth's abyss *and source*.

Your wrath, Beloved, in throwing down the
ones
Among the watchers that feared neither
suns
Nor wild expanses of creative flood,
But mixed their own fire with the human
blood,
Is horrible to see, and yet I stare.
I wish of this great work of Yours no share.
Yet in my heart too there may watchers
stand

Who need to feel the bruising of Your
hand,
And in my neighbourhood are souls that
sound
The note of blasphemy and on the ground
Of black rebellion raise a standard where
Would be only the sounds of humble
prayer.

Beloved, cast down such watchers from my
heart
As well as such in every star and part.

Week 11. Enoch 89

1 And one of those four went to that
White bull and taught him *where he sat*
In secret, so he did not fear,
Being born bull, tuned into man,

And built for himself a great ship
 And lived in it *to get a grip*,
 And three bulls lived with him in that
 Ship and were covered *where they sat*.
 2 Again I raised my eyes toward
 The sky, and saw a rooﬂy sward,
 With seven water streams on it,
 And those torrents flowed out as fit
 With much water into a place
 Enclosed. 3 I saw before my face
 Fountains were opened on surface
 Of that great enclosure, and that
 Water began to swell in vat
 And rise upon the surface, and
 I saw that enclosure there stand
 Till all its surface was replete
 With water. 4 And the water's seat,
 The darkness, and the mist increased
 Upon it, and as I at least
 Looked at the water's height, *I saw*
 That water rose above the straw
 Of that enclosure, and streamed down
 And stood upon the earth *and town*.
 5 And all the cattle of that place
 Were gathered together *in race*
 Until I saw how they sank and
 Were swallowed up, perished in band.

The concerts and quaint comedies that
 stood
 Before the tragic harbours of the wood
 Ended with crash of cymbals at the stoke
 Of lightning on the centuries-old oak.
 The armed security beside the door
 Sank with the titmouse and even before
 The dove and raven flying in the gale
 Raged down and drifted with the sodden
 tail.

Beloved, I see the mounting flood rise high
 With each breath that I take, and then I die,
 Only to rise again in the new life
 That You breathe into nostrils from the rife
 And burning desert air. I breathe once more
 And find the magic still comes to implore.

6 But that ship floated on the sea,
 While all the oxen and the spree
 Of elephants, camels and asses
 Sank to the bottom with all classes
 Of animals, so that I could
 No longer see them, *if I would*,
 And they could not escape, *but* died,

And sank into the depths *beside*.
 7 Again I saw in vision till
 Those water torrents *had their fill*
 And were removed from that high roof,
 And the chasms of earth *in proof*
 Were levelled and were opened up
 Other abysses in earth's cup.
 8 Then the water began to run
 Down into these, till the earth dun
 Was visible, but that ship sat
 Upon the earth, and the *great vat*
 Of darkness withdrew and the light
 Appeared. 9 But that white bull in sight
 Which had become a man came out
 Of that ship, and the three bulls stout
 With him, and one of those three was
 White like that bull, and the one was
 Red as the blood, and one was black.
 And that white bull parting went back.

Noah and three sons, white bulls, black and
 red

Remain alone of all the earth and led.
 Let the rest and peace of the first bull be
 The gate of law to me eternally,
 And let the first white bull grace me with
 love

While the black with awareness like a dove
 Blesses reality in the red light
 That rises in the rosy dawn to spite
 The darkness of my night work on the
 beach
 Of that flood that extends beyond my
 reach.

Beloved, I cry the flood upon my soul
 Until it raises me up to the goal
 To find beneath my feet again the earth
 A gate of truth beyond my dancing mirth.

10 And they began to bring forth beast
 Of the field and birds, so not least
 There arose the different kinds,
 The lions, tigers, wolves and *hinds*,
 Both dogs, hyenas, wild boars, foxes,
 Squirrels, swine, falcons, vultures *in boxes*,
 Kites, eagles, ravens, and by them
 Was born a white bull *like a gem*.
 11 And they started biting each another,
 But that white bull born as a *brother*
 Among them sired a wild ass and
 A white bull with it *on the land*,
 And the wild asses multiplied.

12 But that bull which was born aside
From him produced a black wild boar
And a white sheep, and that wild boar
Sired many boars, but that sheep bore
Twelve sheep. 13 And when those twelve
sheep grew

They gave up one of themselves to
The asses, and those asses gave
Up that sheep to wolves *as a slave*,
And that sheep grew up with those beasts.

14 And YHWH brought down into the
feasts

Eleven sheep to live with it
And pasture with it *as is fit*
Among the wolves, they multiplied
And became many flocks beside.

Beloved, I see with eye backward in time
The vision of Enoch who had to climb
The brittle towers to see Abraham's seed
As white bull and the wild ass for a steed.
I see the birth of Jacob and Esau
And reach out to the vision warning claw
To the twelve not to sell the fated boy
To Egypt, though I know the faithful ploy
Will in the land of wolves the lambs
destroy.

Beloved, I see the vision in the light
That wakened Enoch's heart with horrid
sight,
And yet with him raise praises to Your
name

For giving visions of the coming fame
Until the omens swell up in the right.

15 And the wolves began to fear them,
And oppressed them *for stratagem*
Until they killed their little ones,
Threw their young in oblivions
Of a river for grave, but those
Sheep began to cry for their foes
Aloud and for their little ones,
And to complain unto their Lord.

16 And a sheep which had been saved
scored

From the wolves fled, escaped to be
With the wild asses, *proud and free*,
And I saw the sheep how they cried,
Lamenting *by the riverside*,
Beseeching their Lord with their might,
Till that Lord of the sheep on site
Descended at the voice of sheep

From a lofty abode *and keep*,
And came to them and pastured them.

17 And He called that sheep which *like*
gem

Had escaped from the wolves, and spoke
With it about the wolves *for folk*
That it should warn them not to touch
The sheep. 18 And the sheep went as much
To the wolves by the word of YHWH,
And another sheep met it too
And went with it, and the two went
And entered together where sent
Into those wolves' assembly hall,
And spoke with them and warned withal
Not to touch the sheep from that time.

19 And then I saw the wolves in crime
Oppressed the sheep exceedingly
With all their power, and the sheep be
Crying aloud. 20 And YHWH came to
The sheep and then they started to
Strike those wolves, and the wolves began
To make lamentation by plan,
But the sheep became quiet and
Ceased to cry out *upon the land*.

Is there a time, Beloved, when wolves are
not

Lamenting Your judgement, their turgid
lot,

Or sheep not crying to You in their vain,
It seems most often that they cry in vain.
One or the other happens all the time
And everywhere I look for ream or rhyme.
So the ten plagues fell on Egypt to slay
The firstborn son in every heart to pay
For giving glory to any by You.
It is a price that every soul is due.

Beloved, I give the firstborn son that I
Hide in my chambered temple on the sly,
And worship You alone under the sky
That sees the placid Nile go swimming by.

21 And I saw the sheep till they left
The wolves, but the wolves' eyes were cleft
And those wolves went in the pursuit
Of the sheep with their power *and root*.

22 And YHWH of the sheep went with
them,

As their leader *by stratagem*,
And all His sheep followed Him too,
And his face was dazzling to view
And glorious, and terrible too.

23 But the wolves started to pursue
 Those sheep until they reached a sea.
 24 And that sea was dividedly,
 And water stood on this side and
 On that before them, *to make land*,
 And their Lord led them and he placed
 Himself between them, where wolves
raced.
 25 And as those wolves did not yet see
 The sheep, they went into the sea,
 And the wolves followed the sheep, and
 Ran after them in that sea's land.

It is not cloud or fire that comes between
 The fleeing sheep at the Red Sea once seen,
 And the pursuing foe in Pharaoh's dress,
 But You Yourself, Beloved, though men
 may guess.
 Though I see fire or cloud come between
 me
 And the ungodly, selfish company
 That rules this world or thinks it does in
 fee,
 I know that You, Beloved, unseen,
 unknown,
 Establish here on earth Your shining
 throne.
 The waters tower on my every hand,
 And I am forced to pass through on dry
 land,
 And those who follow think their road the
 same.
 They do not see You behind cloud and
 flame.
 I live invisibly by angel band.

26 And when they saw YHWH of the
 sheep,
 They turned to flee before His keep,
 But that sea gathered itself up,
 And swirled as had been in a cup,
 And the water swelled and rose up
 Till it covered those wolves. 27 And I
 Saw till all the wolves who foreby
 Pursued those sheep perished to die
 All drowned. 28 But the sheep had escaped
 From that water and *where they gaped*
 Went out into a wilderness,
 Where there was no water to bless
 The grass, and they began to open
 Their eyes to see, I saw to hope in
 The Lord of the sheep feeding them

And giving them water and hem
 Of grass, and that sheep going and
 Leading them. 29 And that sheep *at hand*
 Ascended to the summit of
 That lofty rock, and that YHWH of
 The sheep sent it to them. 30 And then
 After that I saw the sheep's YHWH
 Who stood before them, and His cue
 Was great and terrible and too
 Majestic, and all those sheep saw
 Him, feared before His face in awe.
 31 And they all feared and trembled by
 Him, to that sheep began to cry,
 'We're not able to stand before
 Our Lord or to look at His score.'

The story of Sinai by any name
 Remains the first and foremost in the claim
 You make on souls of men and women
 here.
 Sinai and its words alone have the fear
 Of humankind, as well as the excess
 Of ecstasy in every place You bless.
 The book that recognizes where You stand
 Above the earth to view the human band
 Contains Your words to bless and to
 condemn.
 I rise and feed and nourish Self on them.
 Beloved, I hear Your voice in silence wend
 Its mystic way above the paths You send
 Me on the stones that make this hill where I
 Retreat to stand before You under sky.

32 And that sheep which led them again
 Went up the summit of that rock,
 But the sheep were blinded and then
 Began to wander from the stock
 Of the way which he'd shown to them,
 But that sheep knew not to condemn.
 33 The Lord of the sheep in full wrath
 Looked down upon their sinful path,
 And that sheep discovered the thing,
 And went down from the rocky wing,
 And came to the sheep, and there found
 The greatest part of them aground,
 Blinded and fallen there away.
 34 And when they saw it *on that day*
 They feared and trembled at its sway,
 Desiring to return to their
 Folds. 35 And that sheep took others there
 With it, and came to those sheep which
 Had fallen away *in the ditch*,

And started killing them, so they
 Feared its presence, and in that way
 That sheep brought back those sheep that
 had
 Fallen away, and they were glad
 To return to their folds. 36 And I
 Saw in this vision till that *shy*
 Sheep became man and built a house
 For YHWH of the sheep *on the browse*,
 And placed all the sheep in that house.

There are just two choices, not three or five
 Despite the fact there are more sects alive
 Today than have in all the ages died.
 I stand each morning before the tall pride
 Of golden calf, the public institutions
 That guide men's flights to narrow
 executions,
 And turn, rejecting it to enter in
 The wilderness abode made without sin,
 The tabernacle whose outside is made
 Of dusty and grey skins to cover staid
 And brilliant jewels hidden from all eyes,
 The golden lamps, the incense, bread that
 lies
 Upon the golden table, and the chest
 Which is the heart where the engraved
 stones rest.

37 And I saw till this sheep which had
 Met that sheep which led them as sad
 Fell asleep, and I saw till all
 The great sheep perished *in the fall*
 And little ones arose to be
 In their place, and they came to see
 A pasture, and approached a stream
 Of water. 38 Then that sheep, their team
 Leader which had become a man,
 Withdrew from them and fell asleep,
 And all the sheep sought it, began
 To cry over it and to weep.

Beloved, I like the people weep awhile.
 It is no sin to beat the breast in style.
 This wilderness is filled with tears to take,
 And few there be of men who know to
 shake
 The veils of ignorance, blindness, and
 make
 The mind turn round to whirl while in Your
 wake.
 The forty years of wandering is nought

But failure to go in to seek the spot
 Where on the mountain Your temple is
 wrought.
 Who grumble that the folk were stubborn
 sore
 Have never seen so many enter door
 Of heavenly blessings set out in galore.
 Few enter, and then singly, but in prime
 The thousands sought Your glory at one
 time.

39 And I saw till they left off crying
 For that sheep and crossed *without sighing*
 That stream of water, and there rose
 The two sheep as chiefs in their rows
 Instead of those that had led them
 And had gone to sleep. 40 At the hem
 I looked till the sheep came upon
 A fine place, and a pleasant *dawn*
 And glorious land, and I saw till
 Those sheep were satisfied, and still
 That house stood with them in the land
 Of Muhammad. 41 Sometimes at hand
 Their eyes were opened, but sometimes
 They were blinded, until another
 Sheep arose and led them *like brother*
 And brought them all back, and their eyes
 Were opened. 42 And dogs *to despise*
 And foxes and the wild boars would
 Begin to bite those sheep as could
 Until the Lord of the sheep raised
 Up a ram from their midst *who grazed*,
 Who led them. 43 And that ram began
 To butt on either side *by plan*
 Those dogs, foxes, and wild boars till
 He had destroyed wicked and shrill.

A quandary indeed is this that You
 Raised up the ram of Saul to teach the few,
 To slay the raving dogs as well as fox
 That came against the poor and needy
 flocks.

A quandary it is that You remake
 The world after the false attempt at stake
 By Flood, and so again, no lesson learned,
 You choose Saul lofty, wayward to be
 burned.

Beloved, I seek the kingship without power
 Of cantillating Your words for an hour.
 I seek the seership of Samuel taught
 To trim the lamps and hear nocturnal plot.
 I seek the secret anointing that made

Of David Your chosen, the one who stayed.

44 And that sheep whose eyes opened wide
To see that ram among the side
Of the sheep, till it forsook all
Its glory and began in thrall
To butt those sheep, and trampled on
Them, and behaving wickedly.
45 And the Lord of the sheep *at dawn*
Sent the lamb to another free
Lamb and raised it to be a ram
And leader of both sheep *and lamb*
Instead of that ram which forsook
Its glory *in the way it took*.
46 And it went to it and it spoke
To it alone, and raised the bloke
To be a ram, and made it prince
And leader of the sheep *that wince*,
But during all these things those dogs
Oppressed the sheep *in their incogs*.

Saul was a handsome man, handsome as
ram

Among the ruddy sons of Abraham.
Saul was a fine and ready boy whose lot
Was to be king of all the sheep and not
To waste his life in searching for the
strayed
Donkeys that on the fervent hills parade.
Saul was a royal figure in the stands
Before the eyes of Israel in their bands
Despite the shy and modest way his hands
Led him to hide among the horse-carts'
fleet.

Saul was a kingly person one could meet
Anointed by the oil of Samuel's touch.
Saul had a mind to rule, though, and to
clutch
In justice, of few one can say as much.

47 And the first ram pursued the one
That came second, the which arose
And ran away from it when done,
And I looked till those dogs pulled down
The first ram. 48 The second arose
And led the sheep *about the town*.
49 And those sheep grew and multiplied,
But all the dogs and foxes cried,
And wild boars feared and ran away,
And that ram butted *in his sway*
And killed the wild beasts, and those wild
Beasts had no more strength and beguiled

Among the sheep and robbed no more.
48b And that ram produced many *score*
Of sheep and fell asleep, and one
Little sheep became ram when done
In its stead, and became a prince
And leader of those sheep *by dint*s.

Philistine dogs killed Saul and left the lamb
David to rule descendants of Abram.
Of David's sons the little sheep remained
To sit upon a throne as yet unstained
By blood. So Solomon was bountiful
And set a throne or two before ample
Axum. There's reason Enoch and the book
Of Jubilees remained safe in the nook
Of Ethiopia when others took
It from the shelf and cast aside as loss.
But You, Beloved, in humble places toss
A veil before the eyes of power and fame
To save the righteous and the righteous
claim.

Praise You, praise him, and praise Your
lovely name.

50 And that house became great and broad,
And it was built where those sheep trod,
A high tower and a great was built
On the house for the sheep's Lord's hilt.
And that house was low, but the tower
Was elevated, high in power,
And the Lord of the sheep stood up
On that tower and they offered *cup*
And a full table before Him.
51 And again I saw those sheep dim,
How they strayed and went many ways,
And forsook that their house *that stays*,
And the Lord of the sheep called some
From among the sheep, made them come
To the sheep, but the sheep began
To kill them. 52 But there was a man
Of them who was saved and not slain,
And it sped away *on the plain*
And cried aloud over the sheep,
And they tried to kill it *asleep*,
But the Lord of the sheep saved it
From the sheep, and brought it up *fit*
To me, and caused it to live there.
53 And many other sheep *and fair*
He sent to those sheep and to bear
Witness to them, lamenting there.

Of kings of Judah twelve were said to be

Righteous and good, without iniquity.
The others slew the lambs and tore the
sheep
And tried to kill the prophet in his sleep.
But prayer in prostrations of seven grew,
And food of angels kept him going too,
Until he came to Sinai, not for fire
Nor for the winds of human faith's desire,
But there to hear, as I hear to this day
The still small voice say what You have to
say.

There may be now, Beloved, as there were
then
Five thousand left in Israel of men
Who do not bow to Baal, the secret few
Who worship You alone, the just and true.

54 And after that I saw that when
They forsook the house of YHWH's *men*
And His tower they all fell away,
And their eyes were blinded *astray*,
And I saw the Lord of the sheep
Work a great slaughter on the heap
Of their herds till those sheep invited
That slaughter and betrayed indicted
His place. 55 And He gave them into
The maws of lions, tigers too,
And wolves, hyenas, and into
The grasp of foxes, and to all
The wild beasts, and *upon the call*
Those wild beasts started in to rend
In pieces those sheep *on the bend*.
56 And I saw He forsook their house
And tower and gave them, *man and spouse*,
All into mouths of lions, to tear
And eat them up, and in the bare
Paw of all the wild beasts. 57 And I
Began to cry aloud *and try*
With all my power, and to appeal
To the Lord of the sheep for weal,
And to inform Him in regard
To the sheep that their state was hard,
Devoured by all the wild beasts. 58 But
He was unmoved, though He saw what
Happened, and rejoiced that they were
Consumed and swallowed, robbed *of fur*,
And left to be devoured by tongue
Of all the beasts *of powers unsung*.

The evil king leaves behind evil hearts
Of those who bow to wealth and Baal's
arts.

For this You let the temple of the son
Of David fall into the hands that run
To raze its spires and tear down stone from
stone.

Yet You remain, Beloved, sovereign alone.
Though there be no house left to worship
You,

Daniel finds windows open to the dew
And in prostration holy toward the site
He finds even in Babylon delight.
The walls of Babylon were beaten back,
But still its silver bells are never slack.
In what strange heathen temple I may bow,
To You alone I make my silent vow.

59 And He called seventy shepherds, and
Threw those sheep to them that in hand
They might feed them, and so He spoke
To the shepherds and every bloke,
'Let each one of you pasture sheep
From now on, and everything keep
That I'll command you, so you do.
60 And I'll deliver them unto
You in due number, and tell you
Which of them are to be destroyed,
And you destroy the ones employed.
And He delivered to them those
Sheep. 61 And He called another nose
And spoke to him, 'Observe and mark
Everything that the shepherds hark
To do to those sheep, for they will
Destroy more of them than the bill
I have commanded them. 62 And each
Excess and slaying beyond reach
That these new shepherds will employ,
Record how many they destroy
According to My own command,
And how many by their desire,
Record against each one in band
Of the shepherds all in his ire
That he effects. 63 And read before
Me by number how many score
They have destroyed, and how many
They give up to destruction's spree,
That I may have this as witness
Against them, and know each address
Of the shepherds, that I may know
And see what they do *for the show*,
Whether or not by My command
64 Which is given them from My hand,
They shall abide. 64 But they shall not
Know it, and You shall not have taught

It to them, nor admonish them,
But only write in stratagem
Against each one all of the slaughter
Which the shepherds as son or daughter
Affect each in his time and lay
It all before me *on a day*.'

The Sanhedrin was well established by
You and given authority to try
The saints, but not to raise themselves to
vie.

It was as much or more a test to see
How far in wickedness, iniquity
They would go before judgement set them
free.

The veil of pride and power goes up before
The soul who thinks it has a unique store
Of righteousness to judge the world in war.
That veil blinds to the trap set at the feet
By one's own desire capital to mete
Out punishment and confiscate the goods.
I must avoid the market and the street.
Meet me, Beloved, while hunting in the
woods.

65 And I looked till those shepherds fed
In their time, and *as they were led*
Began to slay and to destroy
More than they were told to employ,
And they delivered those sheep in
To the mouth of the lions *for sin*.
66 The lions and tigers consumed
The greater part of those sheep *doomed*,
And wild boars ate along with them,
They burnt that tower along with them
And tore down that house. 67 I became
Stricken with grief over *the fame*
Of that tower because that house of
The sheep was destroyed *hand and glove*,
And afterwards I could not see
If those sheep entered that house *free*.

The second temple's desecration knows
No bounds in grief after the captive's
throes.

The curve of my life past the prime too
shows
The hopes that dashing and destruction's
maze
Has seen at last the closing of its days.
The sun declining still has warmth and
rays,

Can they not be full comforted in rest?
It seems not, but attack comes on for best
And worst until the heart beneath the pest
And plague folds up in silent, bitter rue.
The fig trees wilt and wither where they
grew,
And at the end there's nothing left but You.
Beloved, delight my heart since You are
left,
And in such delight I am not bereft.

68 The shepherds and their company
Delivered those sheep to the wild
Beasts, to devour them, each defiled
One of them in his time received
A certain number unreprieved,
And it was written by the other
In a book how many each brother
Of them destroyed of them. 69 And each
One killed destroying *beyond reach*
Many more than was prescribed, and
I began to weep out of hand,
Lamenting on account of those
Sheep. 70 And thus in the view I chose
To see that one who wrote, how he
Wrote down every one that in fee
Was destroyed by those shepherds' guile,
Day by day, and carried the while
And laid down and showed actually
The whole book to the Lord of sheep,
Everything they'd done, *deed and peep*,
And all that each one of them made
Away with, and all that they'd paid
With their destruction. 71 And the book
Was read before Lord of sheep's look,
And He took the book from his hand
And read it and sealed it to stand
And laid it down. 72 And then I saw
How the shepherds pastured *by law*
For twelve hours, and indeed three of
Those sheep turned back and came for love
And entered and began to build
Up all the fallen down and spilled
Of that house, but the wild boars tried
To hinder them, but could not bide.

Despite the wild boars living on my wing
And all the enemies of neighbouring
Who would see me cast down from
heaven's ring
In keeping You alone, Beloved, as God,
And on the Sabbath prostrating on sod

To thank You for both fruited pea and pod,
Build up again my temple gates and bars
And set me to delight among the stars
That comfort in the cold captains and tars.
Build me, Beloved, a place to meet with
You,

A temple indestructible, to view
Impossible without the faith and true.
And I shall cantillate upon its walls
Your lovely names learned in the feeding
stalls.

73 And they began again to build
As before, and they reared the tower,
And it was named high tower *for power*,
And they began again to place
A table before the tower's *trace*,
But all the bread on it was spoiled,
Polluted and not pure *enfoiled*.

74 And as touching all this the eyes
Of those sheep were blinded *in guise*
So they did not see, and likewise,
The eyes of their shepherds, and they
Delivered them in great display
To their shepherds for slaughter's way,
And they trampled the sheep with feet,
Consuming them *both fat and meat*.

75 And the Lord of the sheep remained
Unmoved till all the sheep deraigned
Were scattered over all the field
And mingled with the *beasts and sealed*,
And they did not save them nor keep
Them from the mouth of beasts *to weep*.

76 And this one who wrote the book
brought
It up, and showed it and besought
Read it before the Lord of sheep,
And implored Him on their account,
And besought Him for their amount
As he showed to Him all the deeds
Of the shepherds, and *as it reads*
Gave witness before Him about
All the shepherds. 77 And he took out
The very book and laid it down
Beside Him and then left the town.

The sanhedrin of seventy chosen bore
The sudden guilt of holy table's store
Because they made concessions and before
The powers of Greece and Rome rejected
faith
In Your appointed and followed a wraith.

The spirit of the times makes sage and wise
To do the thing that's right in one's own
eyes.

But that results in slaughter in the guise
Of justice. My Beloved, now come, arise,
And see how the appointed now fulfil
The prophecies of Enoch, fit the bill.
Who still reject the holy calendar
To raise a monument to moon and star
Today send poisoned missiles from afar.

Week 12. Enoch 90

1 And I saw till that in this way
Thirty-five shepherds under sway
Took to feeding the sheep a day,
And they each did their times as did
The first, and others as they bid
Received them into their hands, and
To pasture them for their time *planned*,
Each shepherd in his own time *scanned*.
2 And after that I saw in my
Vision all the birds of the sky
Coming, the eagles, vultures, kites,
The ravens, but the eagles' sights
Led all the birds, and they began
To consume those sheep, and as can
To pick out their eyes and devour
Their flesh. 3 And the sheep cried an hour
Because their flesh was being eaten
By the birds *without salt or sweeten*,
And as for me I looked and cried
Lamenting in my sleep beside
Over that shepherd who pastured
The sheep. 4 And I saw it endured
Until those sheep were consumed by
The dogs and eagles and kites *sly*,
And they left neither flesh nor skin
Nor sinew remaining *nor tin*
On them till only bones stood there,
And their bones too fell *from the air*
To the earth and the sheep were few.
5 And I saw until *in the dew*
Twenty-three had taken the duty
Of pasturing, finished in beauty
Their several times fifty-eight times.
6 But indeed lambs were born *like dimes*
By those white sheep, and they began
To open eyes and then to scan,
And to cry to the sheep. 7 Indeed,
They cried to them, they would not heed
To what they said to them, but were
Most deaf, and their eyes blind to blur.

The desert righteous ones who hid from
king
And every Roman and outrageous thing
Upon the barren heights above the sea
Of salt, cried out the truth incessantly,
But were not heard until the opened grave
Of Your words showed who was to damn
and save.

The temple's been for centuries in hand
Of priest and caesar till the ampersand
Became altar to silks of Samarqand,
And saw the ways turn to seas from the
land,
And from the seas to air, and still they
stand.

The marriage of divine law to the sword
Of pagan priests and princes in accord
Still carries condemnation of their Lord.

8 And I saw in the vision how
The ravens flew down in a row
Upon those lambs and took one lamb,
And dashed the sheep in pieces slam
And ate them up. 9 And I saw till
Horns grew upon those lambs, and still
The ravens threw down their horns, and
I saw till sprouted in remand
A great horn of one of those sheep,
And their eyes were opened to peep.
10 And it looked at them, and it cried
To the sheep, and the rams abide
To see it and all run to it.

11 And notwithstanding all this fit
Those eagles, vultures, ravens, kites
Still kept tearing the sheep *in fights*
And swooping down on them to eat,
Still the sheep were silent *to bleat*,
But the rams lamented and cried.
12 And those ravens fought *side by side*
And battled with it, sought to lay
Low its horn, but they had no ray
Of power over it. 13 And all
The eagles and vultures *that call*,
And ravens and kites came together,
And there came with them every feather
And all the sheep of the field, lo,
They all came together *below*,
And helped each other to break that
Horn of the ram there where he sat.

The Roman powers that once devoured
Your sheep
Came in to slay Messiah and to keep
Their slaughter on the Massada in vain.
You raised Muhammad in the land of pain
And still the followers of sun and moon
Rushed in to break the horn of him as soon
As faith was lit from Axum's halls and
room
And Yemen brightened even Persia's
gloom.
The horn was broken, on that very day
The crown was buried in the common way
That priesthood joins hand with unholy
power.
And Abu Bakr came to rule an hour.
Beloved, I still my voice behind the veil
To cantillate Your names and find that
grail.

18 I saw till a great sword was given
To the sheep, and the sheep that live in
That place proceeded against all
The beasts of the field in the call
To slay them, and all the beasts and
The birds of the sky fled the band.
19 I saw the man who wrote the book
According as YHWH's command took,
Till he opened that book about
The destruction which those twelve stout
Last shepherds had done, and showed that
They had destroyed much more and fat
Than their predecessors, before
YHWH of the sheep He held in score.

Where there are twelve for good there also
lie
Twelve evil and impostors under sky.
Where the sword of usurper swings abroad,
Sometimes, Beloved, You also show the
laud
Of one appointed to give back the true
To those who patiently await the dew.
The darkest night comes just before the rise
Of moisture on the stillness and the cries
Of cock upon the field. So Ali vies
With three who would prevent his holy
eyes.
Beloved, I search the dooryard and the gate
Below the fir-tops and horizon's mate,
To see the sword arise that with a word

Can set the flames above the wind and stirred.

And I saw till YHWH of the sheep
Came unto them and took to keep
In His hand the staff of His wrath,
And smote the earth *in every path*,
And the earth clave asunder, and
All of the beasts *upon the land*
And all the birds of the sky fell
From among those sheep *that excel*,
And were swallowed up in the earth
And it covered them *for their worth*.

20 And I saw till a throne was set
In Muhammad's land, and was met
The Lord of the sheep sitting there,
And the other took up the fair
Sealed books and opened those books
where

Sat the Lord of the sheep. 21 And YHWH
Called those men the seven first true
White ones, and commanded that they
Should bring before Him in the way,
Beginning with the first star which
Led the way *and into the ditch*,
All the stars with penises like
Those of horses *ready to strike*,
And they brought them all before Him.
22 And He said to that man *with vim*,
Who wrote before Him, being one
Of those seven white ones *when done*,
And said to him, 'Take those seventy
Shepherds to whom I gave in fee
The sheep, and who taking them on
Their own authority slew drawn
More than I had commanded them.'

23 And indeed they in stratagem
Were all bound, I saw, and they all
Stood before Him *and at His call*.

From Mecca to Jerusalem the air
Is filled with gore and stench arising where
Men slay each other for no other brood
Than that they are made evil in the crude.
Step down in judgement on the holy city
Of Mecca, show Jerusalem no pity,
But melt poor Mount of Olives under feet
Of judgement and set up the judgement
seat.

Lay bare my trembling heart and slice away
The evil there that meets the light of day
Until only You hold the sceptre's sway.

Plough up the land Muhammad sowed in
tears

And scatter all the broken weeds and fears,
Beloved, let judgement fire arise that sears.

24 And the judgement was held first over
The stars, and they were judged as rover
And found guilty, and they went to
The place of condemnation due,
And they were cast in an abyss,
Full of fire and flaming amiss,
And full of pillars of fire too.

25 And those seventy shepherds grew
To be judged and found guilty, and
They were cast in that fiery land.

26 I saw at that time how a like
Abyss was opened in *the strike*
Of the earth, full of fire, and they
Brought those blinded sheep *in that way*,
And they were all judged and were found
Guilty and cast into profound
And fiery abyss, and they burned.

The unfaithful sheep, priest and king, are
thrown

Into the abyss where the watchers grown
Full in their lust to make of flesh and bone
A mockery of You meet just deserts.
Ah, little man may rise when he asserts
Himself to join angelic powers in spurts!
Beloved, free me from angels and their
voices

That blend themselves among my own dark
choices.

Let every heart alive burn with the load
Of lust or love that has been his abode.

Then shall the judgement fire seek out its
own

For everything that all souls will condone.
Then shall the burning heart here in my
breast

Find in Your flames, Beloved, the well-
earned rest.

27 Now this abyss was to the right
Of that house. And I saw the sight
Of those sheep burning and their bones
Burning. 28 And I stood up in zones
To see till they folded up that
Old house, and carried off all that
There was in pillars, and the beams
And ornaments of the house seams

Were at the same time folded there,
And they carried it off as fair
And laid it in place in the south
Of the land *from the river's mouth*.

29 I looked until the Lord of sheep
Brought a new house greater to keep
And higher than the first, and set
It up in the place where had met
The first one its demise, all its
Pillars were new, and so were its
Decorations and larger than
Those of the first, the one by plan,
The former one which He'd removed,
And all the sheep within it proved.
30 I saw all the sheep which were left,
And all the beasts that earth could heft,
And all the birds of heaven, fall down
To do homage to those sheep's *crown*
And make petition to obey
Them in each thing and every way.

Perhaps the dome above the rock, where
once

Isaac lay tranquil neath the heavy brunts
Of sacrifice initiatory that
Around the world plays havoc with the vat
Of youthful, guileless joys, is temple new
And built again to keep the sky in view.
I walk beneath the golden roof and stop
In Al-Aqsa to give my prayers a prop,
And in prostration find the red stone there
In columns and wall that rise in the air
In answering to prophecies not made
In vain, but which arose and were not
stayed.

Beloved, let all men come before Your
throne

To know that You are God and You alone.

31 Thereafter those three clothed in white
Who took me before by the right
Hand, and the hand of that ram too
Took hold of me, and they were true
To lift me up and set me down
In the midst of those sheep *in town*
Before the judgement would take place.

32 And those sheep were all white *in face*,
And their wool abundant and clean.

33 All that was destroyed at the scene
And scattered, and all beasts of field,
And all the birds that heaven may yield,
Assembled in that house, the Lord

Of the sheep rejoiced *as restored*
With great joy because they were all
Good and had returned *at His call*
To His house. 34 And I saw till they
Laid down that sword once given sway
To the sheep, and they brought it back
Into the house, and *without lack*
It was sealed before the presence
Of YHWH, and all the sheep with sense
Were invited into that house,
But there was not room for the spouse.

It's true Ezekiel's vision still awaits
The opening of all the shining gates,
And yet a house most marvellous instates
On Zion for the prayers of humankind.
Who cry for a new temple must be blind,
Since the gold shines above Jerusalem,
Al-Aqsa too lifts up a crimson hem.
All are invited in to say their prayers,
And wend their way along the heavenly
stairs.

I too have washed my hands, head, feet and
face

In the clear waters of that holy place
And turned to prostrate where the pillars
stand

Above the stones of Zion's holy land.
Beloved, the world is whirling at Your
grace.

35 And all the eyes of them were clear
And opened to see without fear
The good, and there was not one there
That did not see. 36 I saw the share
Of that house that it was large, broad
And very full. 37 I saw *in rod*
That a white bull was born, with large
Horns and all of the beasts that barge
Through the fields and all the birds of
The air feared him and made *in love*
Petition to him all the time.

38 I saw until in place and clime
All their generations were changed,
They all became white bulls arranged,
And the first among them became
A lamb, and that lamb great in fame
Had great black horns upon its head,
And the Lord of the sheep rejoiced
Over it and over all voiced
Oxen. 39 And I slept among them,
And awoke to the stratagem.

All wait for You, Beloved, to send the true
Messiah or Mahdi, and not a few
Hope Jesus Christ again may come to wear
The kingly robe beneath Salem's night air.
The bull and lamb shall meet and all things
tight

With narrow walls and all things over
bright

With false hopes shall be overturned at last.
The hopes of all have yet to come and fast.
Across the fading stream where since the
world

Was first unloaded of the ark imperaled
None have seen the treasures upon its bed
Now the dry hand of sun at last is led.
Beloved, the cry of Your creation calls
Once more and beats upon the judgement
halls.

40 This is the vision that I saw
While I slept, and awoke *in awe*
And blessed YHWH of my righteousness
And gave Him glory *and to bless*.

41 Then I wept with a great weeping
And my tears stayed *as in a spring*
Till I could no longer endure,
When I saw, they flowed on and sure
Because of what I'd seen to come,
For everything shall come *in sum*
And be fulfilled, and all the deeds
Of men in their order *of creeds*
Were shown to me. 42 On that night I
Remembered the first dream *to spy*,
And because of *that dream* I wept
And was troubled, because I'd kept
That vision I'd seen as I slept.

As Enoch saw beforehand in the view
Divinely sent, I too see history's crew
Stand staunch before my eyes and live
again

As I read on the story of all men.
Divine sight for the future is as strong
As for the past, all is a strident song
And nothing more. All things made here
Are made of unsubstantial trim and gear.
You only, my Beloved, have substance
true,

And there is nothing in all things but You.
You whirl, and universes come to be,
I turn, and there is nothing there to see.

All is a vision of the divine tale,
All is a sea and sky, a glimpse of sail.

**Section V. 91-104 (i.e. 92, 91:1-10, 18-19,
93:1-10, 91:12-17, 94-104). A Book
of Exhortation and Promised
Blessing for the Righteous and of
Malediction and Woe for the
Sinners.**

Enoch 92

1 The book written by Enoch, this
[Enoch indeed wrote *in his bliss*
This complete teaching of wisdom,
Which is praised of all men in sum,
And a judge of all the earth] for
All of my children who in store
Shall live on the earth, and for all
The future generations' call,
Who'll observe uprightness and peace.

Perhaps by peace he means Islam, I trow,
But Islam is not enough anyhow,
It must be combined with uprightness too.
Many there be descendants of the crew
Of Enoch who say they are Muslims or
Claim to be Jews, Samaritans or more
Christians, and still lack both Islam and
peace

As well as uprightness in the increase.
Beloved, write on my heart and head and
hand

The teaching of wisdom that came to stand
By Enoch in his visions of the night
And views of days and years and what is
right.

May I live by that wisdom while my heart
Beats and I breathe its noble counterpart.

2 Do not let your spirit decrease
To be troubled for *evil* times,
For the Holy and Great One chimes
The hour appointed for all things.

3 And the righteous one from the springs
Of sleep shall rise and walk the paths
Of righteousness, and all his paths
And conversation shall be in
Eternal goodness and *not sin*
But grace. 4 He will be gracious to
The righteous and give him the due
Eternal uprightness, and He
Will give him power so he shall be

Endowed with goodness and the right.
And he shall walk eternal light.
5 And sin shall perish in the dark
For ever, and shall no more spark
Of it be seen from that day's park.

My task is not to plot the evil ways
That cross and recross all my living days.
My task is not to frown to see the lot
Of evil-doers chilling what they've caught.
My task is not to bear the burden of
Sorrow to see the greater lack of love
That steals the world against Your word
and breath.

My task is not to fear the coldly death.
My task instead is to take hold of grace
And walk in uprightness before the face
Of passing peers who grasp with empty
greed

The changeless gold upon which sorrows
feed.

My task is not to stand and wait, nor fight,
But walk in goodness and eternal light.

Enoch 91

1 And now, my son Methuselah,
Summon to me *the genera*
Of all your brothers and bring here
To me all the sons of your *dear*
Mother, for the word calls me, and
The spirit is poured on my hand,
So that I may show you all things
To come on you eternal springs.'
2 And thereupon Methuselah
Went and summoned to him *in awe*
All his brothers, assembled kin.
3 And he spoke to all the children
Of righteousness and said 'Hear, you
Sons of Enoch, all the words *true*
Of your father, and listen well
To the voice of my mouth *that fell*,
For I exhort you telling you,
Beloved, "Love uprightness and walk
In it, and do not come to balk
At uprightness with double heart,
And do not join with such in part,
But walk in righteousness, my sons.
4 And it shall guide you on good runs,
And righteousness shall be your friend.
5 For I know that violence must
Increase on earth *and on its dust*,
And a great chastisement shall fall

Upon all the terrestrial ball,
And all unrighteousness shall end,
Indeed, cut off up from its root,
And its whole edifice to boot.

Enoch tells how to meet the violence
That comes upon the earth with right good
sense.

He does not say to meet the sword with
sword,

Nor does he say to submit to the lord
Usurper and claim there is nought to do
Except the evil that he commands you.

The violence today as yesterday
Is best met by the righteous act and way.
Precisely before slaughter and its danger
Righteousness is a friend instead of
stranger.

Beloved, take all vengeance away from me
And give my heart the power to stand and
be

Upright before the present challenging,
Make righteousness my friend instead of
sting.

6 And unrighteousness shall again
Be consummated *among men*
Upon the earth, and all the deeds
Of unrighteousness and *the weeds*
Of violence and transgression
Prevail to twofold degree *won*.

7 And when sin and unrighteousness
And blasphemy *of fierce address*
And violence in all its kinds
Of deeds increase *on hearts and minds*,
Apostasy and transgressing
And uncleanness increase *to sting*,
A great chastisement shall come down
From heaven upon all these *in town*,
And the holy Lord will come out
With wrath and chastisement to shout
Judgement on earth. 8 In those days shall
Violence be cut off *for sal*
From its roots, and be cut off too
The roots of unrighteousness due
To deceit, and they'll be destroyed
From under heaven *in the void*.

Stand down, Beloved, and lay Your sword
on me

As I whirl at this Sabbath's gate and free,

And let Your sword cleave from my soul
 all sin
 That I have done, would do, or would let
 in.
 Bring fire upon me now in quietness
 That I may be pure in the great witness
 That is a future thing to those gone blind,
 But is forever present in Your mind.
 Stand down, Beloved, and with Your holy
 hand
 Uproot the wickedness out of the land
 And out of the hard soil that makes my
 heart
 A weight to follow injustice by cart
 And donkey. My Beloved, awake and start
 The day of judgement now, do not depart.

9 And all the idols of the gay
 Heathen shall take abandoned way,
 And their temples burned with the fire,
 And they shall remove them from hire
 In all the earth, and they shall be
 Cast into the judgement in fee
 To burn, and shall perish in wrath
 Forever in grievous pain's path.

Do idols feel the pain of burning fire?
 If not, then what use is the furnace ire?
 And if they do, then are they not gods too,
 At least as are all those who join to chew
 Awareness of Your I-ness in not few?
 Idol and temple do not feel the wrath,
 I ween, that falls upon their broadened
 path.

The pain grates on the builder and the one
 Who joins the idol temple to have fun.
 I too enter the temple and see there
 The idols of men's hearts reflected fair,
 And yet, though I'm constrained to bow the
 head
 Upon the marbled floors, I know instead
 Your face beyond all things and all things
 led.

10 And the righteous shall rise up from
 Their sleep, and wisdom also come
 To be given to them in sum.
 [And after that unrighteous root
 Shall be cut off, sinners in suit
 Shall be destroyed by the sword's mouth . .
 .
 Shall be cut off from north to south

From the blasphemers, and those who
 Plan violence also those who
 Commit blasphemy shall expire
 By the mouth of the sword *and fire.*]
 18 And now I tell you, my sons, and
 Show you the righteous paths' command,
 And also paths of violence.
 Indeed, I'll show you them with sense
 Again so you may know what comes.
 19 And now, listen to me, you *bums*,
 My sons, and walk in the right way,
 In paths of violence don't stray,
 For all who walk unrighteous paths
 Shall perish for eternal swaths.'

Your prophet, my Beloved, makes fair
 distinction
 Between the upright way and the extinction
 Of Soul by violence, and by that token
 The loss of all for nothingness bespoken.
 Illusion swears that if I slay the soul
 That competes with me for the chosen goal
 That I will be crowned master of all things,
 The universe as well as queens and kings.
 That pure, evil irrationality
 Amazes in universality.
 That human minds accept such froth for
 truth
 Passes comprehension of right and ruth.
 Yet such is the foundation of the State,
 Both of elected and the rich and great.

Enoch 93

1 And after that Enoch both gave
 And began to recount *and rave*
 From the books. 2 And so Enoch said
 'Concerning the children who're led
 In righteousness and the elect
 Of the world, and in the respect
 Of the plant of uprightness, I
 Will speak these things, and indeed, I
 Enoch will declare *them* to you,
 My sons, according to the due
 Which came to me in heavenly vision,
 And which I have known through division
 Of holy angels' word, and learnt
 From heavenly tablets *as I've earned.*'
 3 And Enoch began to recount
 From the books and said in amount
 'I was born the seventh upon
 The first week *from creation's dawn*,
 While judgement and right still endured.

4 And after me there shall inured
Come in the second week a great
Wickedness, and deceit like hate
Shall spring up, and in it there'll be
The first end *of the earth's country*.

The seven ages of the world discern
The ways of men for what they did not
learn.

The first age of the spiritual time
Was not the age of Adam, Seth or rhyme
Of Cain's attempt at civilizing earth,
Nor even age of Abel's righteous worth,
But age of Enoch, he who walked with You
And saw all ages held within his view,
And lives to tell in prophecy and might
Of memory the Flood in Noah's sight.
Beloved, I praise Your name who set apace
Prophets and divine guides before Your
face,
And rise to honour and obey the word
That they have given since my heart was
stirred.

5 And in it a man shall be saved,
But after its end and engraved
Unrighteousness shall grow up, and
A law shall be made to withstand
Sinners. And after that upon
The third week at its close withdrawn
A man shall be elected as
The plant that righteous judgement has,
And his posterity shall be
The plant of righteousness *in spe*.

At the close of the third age David rose
Elected by You and by power's close
That sought to make kingship an honoured
thing
By those who live beneath the golden wing.
Instead of giant heroes of the past
He counted his descent until the last
Through foreign women who despite man's
will
Were brave to seek Your coming to the fill.
He planted on earth in posterity
The son of David, the Messiah's tree
And after him perfection of Your grace,
A prophet standing aye before Your face,
And all descended on eternal throne
Granted to David once and his alone.

6 And after that in the fourth week,
At its close, visions of the *meek*
Holy and righteous shall be seen,
And a law for all generations
And an enclosure shall, I ween,
Be made for them *before the nations*.

At the close of the fourth age of the world
The banner of Messiah was unfurled,
And all its glories hidden in the way
Of a man like Moses meek in his stay,
And unattractive to those who sought
power
Of Caesar to built temple for an hour.
The law for all the ages came down then
Upon the desert air for fasting when
He conquered flesh and blood and spirit
gave
To destroy death and sin as well as grave.
Messiah gave in alms to poor instead
Of arms to kings, and then in chamber fled
To pray and fast in secret of the heart,
Upon the threshold Kaaba for a start.

7 And after that in the fifth week,
At its close, the house *that they seek*
Of glory and dominion shall
Be built for ever, eternal.

The fifth age of the world closed with the
birth
Of the Mahdi whose name fulfilled the
worth
Of his grandfather, seal of prophets bold
Whose law perfected what had once been
told
To Enoch when he read the script in gold
Upon the heavenly tablets in the air.
The gate of air I breathe and hear Your law
Once told on Sinai with the greatest awe
Expounded for a final time before
The universe aghast to hear once more
The syllables roll out on thunder sound
And whisper as the smallest voice that's
found.
Beloved, the cycle of Your word is done
From the beginning of Enoch it's won.

8 And after that in the sixth week
All who live in that place *to speak*
Shall be blinded, the hearts of all
Of them shall forsake wisdom call

In godlessness. In it a man
Shall ascend, and at its close scan
The house of dominion shall be
Burnt with fire, and the whole race see
Of the chosen root shall be scattered.

Though law eternal was perfected in
The life of prophet and divine guide's win,
No other faith was quenched so quickly as
That of Muhammad, who as quickly as
He died was rejected by one and all
Who persecuted the divine guides' hall.
By the year of the twelfth that godlessness
Had filled the world with power's
wickedness,
Inheriting both Egypt's throne and Rome
And casting out the pure without a home.
Since then the house of dominion is set
In its hidden occulting from cadet.
I flee from institutions and their gain
And find Your hidden hall and not in vain.

9 After that in the seventh week
Apostate generation battered
Shall arise, and many the weak
Shall apostatize for its deeds.
10 And at its close elected seeds
Of righteous, eternal plant get
Sevenfold instruction well set
Concerning His creation's whole.
11 [For who is there of all the toll
Of humankind able to hear
The Holy One's voice without fear?
And who can think His thoughts? And who
Is there can look at all the crew
Of heaven's works? 12 And how should
there
Be one who could look at the sky,
And who is there who is not shy
To understand the things on high
And see a soul or spirit and
Could tell about it *out of hand*,
Or ascend and see all their ends
And think them or do like their *friends*?
13 And who is there of all men that
Could know what is the breadth and bat
Of length of the earth, and to whom
Has been shown their measure and room?
14 Or is there any one who could
Discern the length of heaven's *good*
And how great is its height, and on
What it is founded *from the dawn*,

And how great is the rate of stars,
And where all lights rest *in their cars*?]

At the end of the present age shall come
A sevenfold instruction of the sum
Of revelation to direct the meek
And once again establish in its week
The Sabbath rest in You, the hope of true
Respect and honour to the poor and few.
But that is preceded by what I see
In reformation, Rome, and sophistry
Of war colonial and incense poured
Upon the altar of profits adored.
I humbly bow to You, Beloved and mine,
That I have lived to see the shadowed sign
Of that great revelation once restored.
May I live to see You only implored.

Week 13 Enoch 91

12 And after that there shall be one
More week, the eighth week, when is done
Righteousness, and a sword shall be
Given to it that just decree
Of righteous judgement shall fall on
Oppressors, and sinners at dawn
To be delivered in the hands
Of the righteous *set out in bands*.
13 And at its close they shall acquire
Houses through their righteous desire,
A temple shall be built in glory
For the Great King's eternal story,
14d And humankind all shall look to
The path of uprightness to do.

Beloved, I seek the eighth age of the world,
The age of judgement, the banner unfurled
For one thousand years on the plain for all
To see the justice of Your throne and hall.
I seek the vision of Saint John who saw
Again what Enoch first laid out in awe.
I seek the lake of fire and its reward
To lay to rest for ever bomb and sword.
I seek the temple that in grace bestowed
Forever set above the bright abode
Contains Your glory though spilled out
abroad
The universe, reflected screen of God.
But even now beforehand I taste here
Your judgement in the upright path and
clear.

14a And after that, in the ninth week,

The righteous judgement that they seek
Shall be revealed to the whole world, b
And all the works godless unfurled
Shall vanish from all the earth, c and
The world shall be written down land
For destruction. 15 And after this,
In the tenth week *and in abyss*
Of the seventh part, there shall be
The great eternal judgement see,
In which He will extend vengeance
Among the angels *to commence*.

The ninth age fastens on all earth and sky
The reverence of all doing by and by
In righteousness, all else shall vanish in
The destruction of wickedness and sin.
An age of peace and glory, heavenly way
When in their own abyss the angels fey
Who counter Your command shall find
their own
Eternal vengeance sent out from Your
throne.
Ten thousand years accomplish on the earth
The rise and fall of evil and its dearth.
Ten thousand years are not enough to speak
The glories of Your name, those things I
seek

Into eternity and for a day
Of Sabbath rest upon Your sovereign sway.

16 And the first heaven shall depart
And pass away, and *all its art*,
And a new heaven shall appear,
And all the powers of heaven in fear
Shall give in sevenfold *their* light.
17 After that there will many weeks
Be without number, *without sheiks*
For ever, and all shall be in
Goodness and righteousness, and sin
Shall no more for ever known
Nor mentioned *before divine throne*.

Though I live at beginning of the age
Number seven in Enoch's inspired page,
I reach my hand into the glorious time
Where there is nothing by the whirling
rhyme
Of Your creation's cycles in their gait
That spirals through infinities and great
Halls and the corridors of stars to fill
Beyond time and place the Creator's mill.
As I recite Your blessed name I know

The ecstasies of that limitless show
That makes the present world a shadow
land
Beneath the air of Your law where it
fanned,
Beneath the hopes of future days and past
Of a world that may or may never last.

Enoch 94

1 And now I say to you, my sons,
Love righteousness and watch your buns,
And walk therein, for righteous paths
Are worthy of accepting swathes,
But the paths of unrighteousness
Shall suddenly *as they digress*
Be destroyed and vanish away.
2 And to certain men of a day
Shall the paths of violence and
Of death be shown *to them in band*,
And they shall hold themselves far off
From them not to follow *and scoff*.
3 And now I say to you upright,
Do not walk in the paths of *night*
And wickedness, nor in death's way,
Do not come near to them *to stay*,
Lest you're destroyed. 4 But seek and
choose

For yourselves righteousness and use
An elect life, and walk in paths
Of Islam, and avoiding *wraths*
You'll live and prosper *without fear*.
5 And hold fast my words in the thoughts
Of your hearts, and do not let lots
Of them be effaced from your hearts,
For I know that sinners *with tarts*
Will tempt men evilly to scare
Off wisdom, so that no place there
May be found for her, and no kind
Of temptation go out of mind.

Two ways there are in every choice that's
made,
The way of violence and the way staid
In justice and in temperance. I go
At the crossroads to find the better show.
Shall I live and prosper and without fear
If I refrain from using rod and gear
In violence against the wicked man?
I pray indeed to succeed in the plan.
Illusion under which all men live here
Is that to meet a sword a gun is better,
And for the violent one needs a fetter

To save society and all the wealth
That such men come take and come in
stealth.
Beloved, explain Yourself to bull and steer.

6 Woe to those who make wickedness
And oppression and lay distress
Of deceit as foundation stone,
They'll be suddenly overthrown,
And they shall have no peace at all.
7 Woe to those who build their house wall
With sin, for from all their foundations
They'll be overthrown *in gyrations*,
And by the sword shall they all fall.
[And those who get silver and gold
In judgement shall perish unsoled.]
8 Woe to you, you rich ones, for you
Have trusted in your riches due,
And from your riches you'll depart,
Because you have not taken part
In the remembrance of Most High
In the days when your wealth was nigh.
9 You have committed blasphemy,
Unrighteousness, and are ready
For the day of slaughter, and day
Of darkness, of great judgement's *sway*.

I thank You, my Beloved, for golden
promise,
And pray forgiveness that I'm doubting
Thomas,
But those who prosper like the green bay
tree
And oppress worthy poor most wickedly
Seem to revel in every blessing here.
They may at times and places stop to fear
And in their fear make sharper swords to
beat
The humble in the dust and in the street.
By Enoch's own word the apostasy
Of this age is but have done in its glee,
So what can we expect of harmony
Until the age begins to find its goal?
Messiah and Mahdi are on the dole
Until the age shall close and they shall
meet.

10 So I speak and declare to you,
The One who has created you
Will overthrow you, and for your
Fall there'll be no compassion's store,
And your Creator will rejoice

At your destruction's *wailing voice*.
11 And your righteous ones in those days
Shall be reproach to sinners' *phase*
And to the godless *and their ways*.

Beloved, full of compassion and the store
Of mercy eternal, and mercy more,
I hear Enoch's complaint against the great
And also rejoice at their coming fate.
And yet I wonder by the laws of late
If You have it in You to deal a blow
At those church men who come to take the
show.

You are, it seems, Creator of the mess
Of men who fail by their works to confess
Your sovereignty, compassion, mercy, yes,
And love too, if that word can still be used
After it's been in every faith abused.
Rejoice will You? I doubt and wait the day
Like Jonah sitting under the gourd's sway.

Enoch 95

1 Oh that my eyes in moisture clad
Might weep for you as I am sad,
And pour down my tears as a cloud
Of waters, so I be allowed
To rest from my trouble of heart!
2 Who has permitted you the art
Of reproaches and wickedness?
And so judgement shall come oppress
You, sinners. 3 Do not fear the sway
Of sinners, you righteous in way,
For YHWH again will bring them to
Your hands of judgement, so that you
May wreck on them by your desires.
4 Woe to you who light up the fires
Of anathemas which cannot
Be reversed *from their evil plot*,
Healing shall therefore be far from
You because of your sins *to come*.
5 Woe to you who requite your neighbour
With evil, for you *in like labour*
Shall be requited by your works.
6 Woe to you, lying witness quirks,
And to those who measure injustice,
For suddenly you'll perish, *trust us*.
7 Woe to you, sinners, who essay
To persecute the righteous way,
For you shall be delivered up
And persecuted for the cup
Of injustice, and heavy shall
Its yoke be on your *pedestal*.

The woes are quoted by Jesus Messiah
To both the Pharisee and the pariah.
I dry my tears and listen to the curses
That follow on the blessing that disperses
The threatening of Your words through
Enoch's mail.

We all are searching though we have the
Grail.

And though we have the holy thing in
womb,

Your curses seem to cover for the tomb.
Should I not fear the sway of sinners'
doom?

Beloved, that takes some courage for the
pet

Who's seen the persecutions that once met
The righteous in the way. Beloved, take
soon

Your way to judgement, give my heart a
boon,

And I shall keep integrity well set.

Enoch 96

1 Be hopeful, you righteous ones, for
Suddenly sinners at the door
Shall perish, and you'll have lordship
Over them as you wish to skip.
2 [And in the day of tribulation
For sinners, your children in nation
Shall mount and rise as eagles do,
And higher than the vultures' view
Will be your nest, and you'll ascend
And enter the crevices' bend
Of the earth, and the clefts of rock
For ever as the coneys' stock
Before the unrighteous ones' claws,
And the sirens shall sigh because
Of you, and weep.] 3 Wherefore do not
Be afraid, you that have suffered,
For healing is your portion stirred,
And a bright light shall lighten you,
And you shall hear the voice that's due
For Sabbath from the sky. 4 Woe to
You who are sinners, for your riches
Make you appear like righteous *pitches*,
But your hearts convict you of being
Sinners, and this fact shall be seeing
A witness against you to be
Remembrance of *your* evil fee.

This news is good, Beloved, that sinners at

The door of my heart and my keeping fat
Shall perish, and those demons that in me
Would thrust me into some iniquity
Are cast out of my palace and my tent.
Beloved, with such promises I have lent
My heart to satisfaction in the dew
Returned after three frosts have decked my
pew.

Perhaps your promise relates to the outer
Sinner as well as inner. I'm a doubter
That I shall ever find a state or church
Where I'm not surrounded by sinners'
perch.

The peaceful crowd I enter, catalyst,
Never yet failed to raise a warning fist.

5 Woe to you who devour the finest
Of wheat, and drink wine, when thou
dine'st,

In large bowls, and tread under foot
The lowly with your might *and root*.

6 Woe to you who drink water from
Every fountain, for suddenly
You'll be consumed *in your own rum*
And wither away, because ye
Have forsaken fountain of life.

7 Woe to you who work wicked strife
Deceit and blasphemy, it shall
Be a remembrance for your sal
Against you for evil. 8 Woe to
You, mighty, who with might oppress
The righteous *and the few distress*,
For the day of your coming plight
Is a destruction. In those days
Many and good days in their ways
Shall come to the righteous and true,
In the day of your judgement's view.

Beloved, let me not drink from every
fountain

As syncretising faiths upon the mountain
Of recognition. Beloved, give the cup
To me that Your approved is holding up,
The cup of green like emerald and blue
Like sapphire from the other mountain's
view,

The cup that's filled with water of life true
And elixir of goodness, a fine mix
Of nectared wine, instead of priestly tricks.
I see that alabaster vessel clear
As I go out on morning without fear
Prostrating on the earth and in its gate

Finding that You alone, both soon and late,
Are there, Beloved, the sought for and the
dear.

Enoch 97

1 Believe, you righteous, that the sinners
Will become a shame and not winners
To perish in unrighteous day.
2 Be known to you *sinners who stray*
That the Most High has in mind plan
For your destruction, *to a man*.
The angels of the heaven rejoice
Over your destruction for vice.
3 What will you do, you sinners, and
Where will you flee that day in hand
Of judgement, when you hear the voice
Of the prayer of the righteous *choice*?
4 Indeed, you shall fare like those whom
This word destroys in witness doom,
“You have been companions of sinners.”
5 And in those days the prayer of winners,
The righteous shall reach YHWH, and for
You the days of your judgement score
Shall come. 6 And all the words of your
Unrighteousness be read before
The Great Holy One, and your faces
Shall be covered with shameful traces,
And He will reject every work
Which is done with unrighteous shirk.

It is not politically correct
For angels even and the grand elect
To rejoice at destruction of the state
That works its wicked will upon the pate
Of the poor. Less indeed it seems to me
That angels should appear on earth to be
Rejoicing when the innocent are met
With sudden death upon Hollywood set
Or heaven forbid by New York’s harbour
net.

Are we not blameless who devour the bill
Of starving just because the seller’s sill
Divides us from direct contact with hill
Bleak with the devastation and the dearth
Tobacco curing brings upon the earth?

7 Woe to you, sinners, who live on
The mid ocean, the dry land’s dawn,
Whose remembrance is evil witness
Against you. 8 Woe to you with fitness
Who get silver and gold and say
In your unrighteousness to sway,

“We have become rich with the wealth
Acquired as wished by cruel stealth,
9 “And now let us do what we would,
For we have gathered silver, stood
9c With many husbandmen within
Our houses.” 9d And our storage bin
Is full as with water *to brim*,
10 Indeed, and like water to him
Your lies shall flow away, for your
Riches shall not abide there more
But quickly be raised up from you
For you’ve acquired all in the pew
Of your unrighteousness, and you
With a great curse shall come in view.

Let my remembrance be no evil witness
As I lift up Your name for grace and fitness
Above all names. Count me among not
guilty
As I tramp round with feet and boots both
silty
To find Your footstool padded with spring
flowers.
Its Your remembrance makes up my life’s
hours.
Let lies and riches escape from my room
And let the forest airs brighten my doom
As I whirl on the quest of what my groom
Lays on my heart and lips remembering
You.

Fill up my cup with water and the pale
Nectar that rends about me every veil
Though thin and sere, though thick with
love and torn,
Though bright with silver feather and with
thorn.

Enoch 98

1 And now I swear to you, both wise
And to you foolish *in your guise*,
For you shall see them come to pass
Upon the earth, *on tree and grass*.
2 For you men shall put on the more
Adornments than a woman’s store,
And coloured garments more than some
Teen-age girl in her flunkeydom,
In royalty and grandeur and
In power, and with silver in hand
And gold and wearing purple cloth,
And in splendour and in food froth
They shall be poured out as the drouth.
3 Therefore they shall be wanting in

Doctrine and wisdom *for their sin*,
And they shall perish there together
With their possessions, and with *feather*
Of all their glory and delight,
And in shame and slaughter *for spite*,
And in great destitution, their
Spirits shall be cast into where
The furnace of fire *flames beware*.

My own soul tells me what You say is true.
The faith decked out in pageant shall know
rue,

And though my humble anarchy that sees
Only You on the throne is still at ease,
Because there is no wealth to lose nor flock
Of duped to sacrifice upon the rock.
I stand alone in simple waiting on
Your ten commandments revealed in the
dawn.

As long as the sun rises on the gate
Of the equator, this shall be my fate.
Of course in actuality my life
Flutters before the lengthen winter strife
Of darkness and in summer quite contraire
The light of heaven always fills the air.

4 I've sworn to you, you sinners, as
A mountain's not become a slave,
And a hill does not become as
The handmaid of a woman *grave*,
Even so sin has not been sent
Upon the earth, but man who went
Of himself has created it,
And under a great curse and fit
Shall they fall all who commit it.

5 And barrenness has not been given
To the woman, but by her living
Of the deeds of her own hands she
Dies without children *on her knee*.

6 I've sworn to you, you sinners, by
The Holy Great One *set on high*,
That all your evil deeds be seen
Above in heaven and in between,
And that none of your deeds you've ridden
Oppressing are covered and hidden.

The prophecy of Enoch seems to stand
Well met in what I see about the land
Of make-up and of jewel on the hand
And ear and neck and naval, tongue and
band

Around the ankle, yet I know before

It was also in centuries in store
As far as I can see, from New Orleans
To the brave Ishmaelites' old scenes.
But You Yourself, Beloved, seen to set
sights
On gems for Your throne as the Prophet's
lights
Reveal in every vision of the hall
That graces heaven's temples at Your call.
Let me, Beloved, find gems in dew and
sprite,
And in the words You speak and that
enthral.

7 And do not think in spirit nor
Say in your heart that you in store
Do not know and you do not see
That every sin *on every tree*
Is every day recorded in
The heavenly presence *argentine*
Of the Most High. 8 From henceforth you
Know that all of oppression's crew
By which you oppress is recorded
Each day till the day of your sordid
Judgement. 9 Woe to you, fools, for
through

Your folly you shall perish too,
And you transgress against the wise,
And so good fortune shall not rise
To be your portion. 10 And now, know
That you are ready soon to go
To the day of destruction's show,
Wherefore do not hope for your life,
You sinners, *you're under the knife*,
You shall depart and die, for you
Know no ransom, for you're prepared
For the day of great judgement bared,
And for the day of tribulation
And great shame for your spirits' ration.
11 Woe to you, obstinate of heart,
Who do wickedness for your part
And eat blood, From where do you have
Good things to eat and drink for salve
And to be filled? From all good things
Which YHWH the Most High *of all kings*
Has placed abundantly on earth,
Therefore you shall have no peace worth.

Beloved, around me everywhere the bread
Is filled with blood despite what You have
said.

You never gave permission here to shed

Noble swine's blood, and yet archbishop's
fed

On pig foot and pig pudding in his bed.
Beloved, around me everywhere the feet
Of blood-fed children turn kindly and greet
My passing, and they wonder that I meet
Their innocence with such a molten heat
Of anger and a petulant retreat.
Beloved, around me everywhere the saint
Supposed by altar, pulpit, and the quaint
Prayer-book looks on my angry face with
faint

Disgust because I don't lap up pig paint.

12 Woe to you who love wicked deeds,
Wherefore do you hope for good *seeds*
Of fortune for yourselves? Know that
You shall be delivered out flat
Into the hands of the righteous,
And they shall cut off your necks thus
And slay you, and have no mercy
Upon you. 13 Woe to you who see
Rejoicing in the tribulation
Of the righteous *and for their ration*,
For no grave shall be dug for you.
14 Woe to you who set at nought true
Words of the righteous, for you shall
Have no hope of life *for your sal*.
15 Woe to you who write down lying
And godless words, they write a thing
Down in their lies that men may hear
And act godlessly towards *their near*
Neighbour. 16 Therefore they shall have no
Peace but die in sudden death throe.

The good bishop sat down to eat his bread
Beside me in the mosque where he was led
In ecumenical spirit and fed.
When I remarked that he might say a word
To calm the multitude about that stirred
Against the Muslim and the Jew interred
Because they would not eat the blood but
let

It fall upon the earth in slaughter met,
He said all things are good to eat when set
Before a man who gives thanks for his due.
And by that word the bishop made his pew
Among the condemned and the wicked
crew.

Who eat the blood join in the mighty
throng

Who shall suffer aloud for their own
wrong.

Enoch 99

1 Woe to you who work godlessness,
And glory in lying's excess
And extol them, you shall perish,
And no happy life be your dish.

2 Woe to them who pervert the words
Of uprightness *in all their herds*,
And transgress the eternal law,
And change them into *hand and claw*
Of what they were not, they will be
Trodden under foot *by the sea*

And on the earth. 3 In those days make
Ready, righteous ones, *for your sake*
To raise your prayers as remembrance,
And place them as a witness *dance*
Before the angels, that they may
Place the sin of the sinners' way
For remembrance before Most High.

4 In those days the nations shall cry,
Stirred up, and the families of nations
Shall rise up on destruction's stations.

5 And in those days the destitute
Shall go forth and carry off *root*
And branch of their children, and they
Shall leave them in a desert way,
So that their children perish so,
Indeed, they shall abandon so
Their children *still* sucklings, and not
Return to them *or to the plot*,
With no pity on their loved ones.

6 Again I swear to you *in puns*,
You sinners, that sin is prepared
For a day of bloodshed unbarred.

I come alone to the dergah floor here
In remembrance of Your name and Your
fear,

And find the curse written upon the great
Who change Your law and allow evil rate
In bloodshed and in torture at the gate.

I place remembrance now before Your
throne

That all the crowd abandons me alone
To rush in drunken joy upon the flesh
Of bread and wine as well as on the fresh
Killed beast that You created for the glare
Of Your image in universe to wear.
For this they shall see their own children
bear

Destruction. Bloody soil can stand so
much,
And then it crumbles at the heathen touch.

7 And they who worship stones, and carve
Images of gold *not to starve*
And silver and wood, *stone* and clay,
And those who worship *day by day*
Unclean spirits and demons, and
All kinds of idols out of hand,
Shall get no help from them as planned.
8 And they shall become godless in
The folly of their hearts of sin,
And their eyes shall be blinded through
The fear of their own hearts and through
Visions in their dreams *come in view*.

It's not just rich and great who bow the
knee
To gold and graven images in glee,
But poor and destitute who feel the lash
Of the rich also worship hoarded stash
Of evil gods and oil drums and the dash
Of mart and demon covered with the gilt
Of civilization up to the hilt.
The wealthy are not alone in their blame
But those they have oppressed also lick
flame

Of idol worship, all the world's astray.
Beloved, set me and mine upon the way
In narrowness, that one whirl and address
That steps to the tune that Your laws
confess.

Beloved, let me with joy look on that day.

9 Through these they shall become godless
And fearful, for they shall have wrought
All their work in a lie's address,
And shall have worshipped stone untaught,
Therefore in an instant shall they
Perish. 10 But in the *brighter day*
Blessed are all they who accept word
Of wisdom, and understand stirred,
And observe paths of the Most High,
And walk in the path of His *high*
Righteousness, and do not become
Godless with the godless *and bum*,
For they shall be saved. 11 Woe to you
Who spread evil to neighbours' *view*,
For you shall be slain in Sheol.
12 Woe to you whose deceitful goal
Makes false measures, and *to them* who

Cause bitterness on earth *to stew*,
For they shall thereby utterly
Be consumed. 13 Woe to you who see
To build your houses through the toil
Of others in the sorrowed soil,
And all their building things are bricks
And stones of sin, I tell you slicks
That you shall have no peace *to mix*.

I do not worship stone and few about
Me truly bow to images with shout
Since Luther and his friends when turned
about

Turned faith from rainbow colours to the
grout

Of black and white. (I don't count what
Colours each season sees on altar shut.)

I do not worship images in stone
But that does not relieve me of the loan
Of image of Creator in the fair
Creation all about me everywhere.
Some who do not worship the stone still
come

To worship flesh and blood or what comes
from

It in the bread and wine. I hold my hand
Over my lips aghast at Your command.

14 Woe to those who reject the measure,
Eternal heritage *and treasure*
Of their fathers and whose souls follow
After idols, for they'll be hollow
With no rest. 15 Woe to those who do
Unrighteousness and help the crew
Of oppression, and slay their neighbours
Until the day when start the labours
Of the great judgement. 16 For He'll cast
Down your glory, and bring at last
Affliction on your hearts, and rouse
His fierce wrath wherever you browse
And destroy you all with the sword,
And all the holy who've adored
The righteous shall remember you
And keep your sins ever in view.

Some say with time and age we should
forget

The holocaust, the slaughter and death met
By native on the silver shores that gleam
Below the restless ghosts and what they
dream.

Part of my service of remembrance is

Acknowledging the violence and biz
 That the offspring of devils say should be
 Shut out from sight, knowing and memory.
 The reason they would have me forget
 those
 Who succumbed in their father's blighted
 woes
 Is simply that they still follow in those
 Ways of greed and destruction, but would
 show
 Their slaughter to be filled with justice
 pose,
 And progress in good faith in where they
 go.

Week 14 Enoch 100

1 And in those days and in one place
 The fathers together apace
 With their sons shall be smitten and
 Brothers one with another stand
 To fall in death till the streams flow
 With their blood. 2 For a man's not slow
 To set his hand to slaying sons
 And his sons' sons *despite their guns*,
 And the sinner shall not withhold
 His hand from his honoured *and bold*
 Brother, from dawn till sunset they
 Shall slay each other *without stay*.
 3 Horses shall walk up to the breast
 In the blood of sinners *at rest*,
 And the chariot shall be submerged
 To its height. 4 In those days *converged*
 The angels shall descend into
 The secret places and into
 One place gather together all
 Those who brought down sin *on the ball*
 And the Most High then will arise
 On that day of judgement in guise
 To make great judgement among sinners.
 5 And over all the righteous winners
 And holy He will appoint such
 Guardians from among holy clutch
 Of angels to guard them as the
 Apple of an eye, until He
 Makes an end of all wickedness
 And all sin, and though the righteous
 Sleep a long sleep, they've naught to fear.
 6 And *then* the children of the dear
 Earth shall see the wise in safety,
 And understand all this book's words,
 And know their riches are but turds
 To save them from the overthrow

Of their sins. 7 And woe to you, woe,
 Sinners, on the day of strong anguish,
 You who afflict righteous *to languish*
 And burn them with fire, you shall be
 Requited for your works, *you see*.

Who once was ready to obey the state
 And lead Jew and homo out to his fate
 Will find himself ready upon the draw
 To kill his own children and open maw
 To devour grandson caught up in his claw.
 There is no limit to the growing greed
 Founded on fear and selling what we need
 To banish fear by slaughtering the poor
 Who are it seems a danger to the fewer.
 The barrels filled with wealth turn into
 turds,
 And gasoline is less than empty words,
 And yet has power to raise a hand to strike.
 Beloved, let me get there riding a bike
 As You uproot my heart's greed at the
 seed.

8 Woe to you, and you obstinate
 Of heart, who watch to fabricate
 Wickedness, therefore shall fear come
 Upon you and there'll be no bum
 To help you. 9 Woe to you, you sinners,
 Because of your words for beginners,
 And for the actions of your hands
 Which your godlessness in its bands
 Has wrought, in blazing flames to burn
 Worse than fire shall you burn *as earn*.
 10 And now, know that from angels He
 Will inquire as to your deeds be
 In heaven, from the sun and the moon
 And from the stars to witness soon
 Of your sins because upon earth
 You execute judgement upon
 The righteous. 11 And He will summon
 To testify against you each
 The cloud and mist and dew to preach
 And rain, for they shall all be stopped
 Because of you that might have dropped
 On you *in blessing*, and they shall
 Be mindful of your prodigal
 Sins. 12 And now give gifts to the rain
 That it be not withheld from gain
 Descending on you, nor yet dew,
 When it's received gold and a few
 In silver from you to descend.
 When the hoar-frost and snow to lend

Their chilliness, and all the snow
Storms with all their plagues fall and grow
Upon you, in those days you'll not
Be able to stand in their plot.

I've heard the gentle preaching of the rain
Come of a sudden spattering and plain
And kicking up the dust in little puff
And sounding like the goats' feet on the
rough

Worn road along the village. I have heard
The brash storm and the thunder bring the
word

Of pelting, swelting rains, and such I've
seen

Efface in quicksilver the park and green.
I've felt the early preaching of the dew
That spoke angelic tones to one and few
That got up to meet early morning prayers
Of woodcock and of hedgehog by the
stairs.

Beloved, I've heard and seen the sermon
done

When there was nothing felt beneath the
sun.

Enoch 101

1 Observe the sky, children of heaven,
And every work of *all the leaven*
Of the Most High, and fear Him and
Do no evil there in His land.

2 If He should close the portals of
The sky withholding rain above,
And the dew's descent on the earth
On your account *for what it's worth*,
What will you do then? 3 And if He
Sends His anger on you *freely*
Because of your deeds, you cannot
Petition Him, for you were taught
To speak proud and insolent words
Against His righteousness *in turds*,
Therefore you shall have no peace *here*.

4 And do you not see sailors gear
In the ships, how their ships *for fear*
Are tossed about and by the waves,
And are shaken by the winds' *slaves*,
And are in great trouble? 5 Therefore
They are afraid because their store
Of fine possessions on the sea
Is endangered there where it be,
And their hearts with evil forebodings
Fear the sea will swallow their loadings,

And they will perish in it *too*.

6 Are not the sea, waters *in view*,
And all its movements, the work of
The Most High, and has He above
Not set limits to its doings,
And confined it throughout by strings
Of sand? 7 And at His reproof it's
Afraid and dries up *from its fits*,
And all its fish die, all in it,
But you sinners that are all fit
Upon the earth do not fear Him.
8 Has He not made the heaven's rim
And the earth, and all that's in them?
Who has given of wisdom's gem
And understanding to all things
That move on earth and in sea's *flings*?
9 Do not the sailors of the ships
Fear the sea? Yet sinner that slips
Does not fear words from Most High's *lips*.

The revelator on Patmos espied
The sea corrupted as the blood to ride
Upon the billows where the fish reside,
And quoting Your word to Enoch he spoke
Of how the fish lay dead beneath the
stroke.

The quotations of Your word from age to age
Resound upon the willows of my page,
And touch the waters of my well in spring
As my soul rises up and I take wing.
Beloved, the images of sand and shore
Reviled and soiled still bring to me the
store
Of faith and hope creation came to fill.
I bend my sight toward the window sill
Where bird, not fish, returns to fit the bill.

Indeed, Beloved, the reason we go out
To slay the children of the world about
Is because they are sitting on the oil
And other wealth to get without much toil,
And to be rich we must kill children more
Than are sitting about in bin and store.
We are not evil in our hearts to kill,
We only kill when we see the gas bill.
The dew upon the grass is diamond built,
But when the sun comes up, it turns to silt.
It's only hard things that remain a while
That make our wealth, though cutting
through the guile,
Such stones reflect the beauty of a heart

That cannot take the right and poor man's part.

Enoch 102

1 In those days then when He has brought
A grievous fire upon your lot,
To where will you flee, and where will
You find deliverance *from the pill?*
And when He launches forth His Word
Against you will you not *like bird*
Be frightened and fear? 2 All the lights
Shall be affrighted at the sights,
And all the earth affrighted too
And tremble in alarm *on cue*.

3 And all the angels shall fulfil
Their commands and seek to find hill
To hide themselves from the presence
Of the great glory *to commence*,
And the children of earth shall come
To tremble and quake *worrisome*,
And you sinners shall become cursed
For ever, *and what is the worst*,
You shall have no peace. 4 Do not fear,
You souls of the righteous, but steer
You hopefully you *for address*
Who have died in your righteousness.

5 And grieve not if your soul's descended
In grief into Sheol *attended*,
And in your life your body did
Not fare according to valid
Goodness on your part, but await
The day of judgement and the fate
Of sinners and the day of cursing
And its chastisement *for conversing*.

Beloved, I see and feel the blazing fire
That on Sinai has habit to inspire,
It licks about my body at the pyre
And destroys me before Your love's desire.
Beloved, I hear and feel the crazing word
That thunders on Mount Sinai, and the
stirred

Heart at the still small voice in echo's lurid
Is unmade at the wing of that steel bird.
Beloved, my soul's descent is grief and yet
The sprout even from Sheol that is met
At rosy dawn after the night work's set
Fails not to raise a slight song from my lips
To show the soul undaunted at the hips
To find water of life sent down in sips.

6 And yet when you die sinners speak

Over you, "As we die, so bleak
Die the righteous, what benefit
Do they reap for their deeds *of wit?*
7 "Indeed, as we, so do they die
In grief and darkness *under sky*,
And what have they more than have we?
From this time on we equally
Share in the darkness. 8 "And what will
They receive *of good* and what will
They see for ever? Indeed, they
Too have died, and they from this day
For ever they shall see no light."
9 I tell you, sinners, you are right
Content to eat and drink, and rob
And sin, and strip men naked *cob*,
And get you wealth and see good days.
10 *But* have you seen the righteous stays,
How their end falls out, that no manner
Of violence is found to hammer
In them till their death? 11 Yet they still
Have perished and become as nil,
And their spirits descended to
Sheol in tribulation's *view*.

The best excuse is one that comes again
Repeated often among wicked men,
To rob and strip men naked is no crime
But needful in this world of place and time,
For without that oppression those who eat
Might find few kernels in their bowls of
wheat.

The world is made of food and each his
share
Takes where he can and if can where he
dare.

Beloved Creator of all food and maw,
To eat is to employ created claw.
Condemn, Beloved, no violence at all,
For violence is what must fill the hall.
Beloved, Sheol is home to all the crew
Who turn at last once more in seeking You.

Enoch 103

1 And now, therefore, I swear to you,
The righteous, by the glory due
To the Great, Honoured, Mighty One
By His greatness in dominion
I swear to you. 2 I know a thing
Of mystery, I've come to sing
The heavenly tablets, and have seen
The holy books, have found therein
Written in them and inscribed there

Regarding them, 3 That all the fair,
 And goodness and joy and glory
 Are prepared for them *who are free*,
 And written for spirits of those
 Who've died in righteous ways they chose,
 And that many good things shall be
 Given to you in recompense
 For labours, your inheritance
 Is great beyond the lot of those
 Living. 4 And the spirits of you
 Who've died in righteousness shall live,
 Rejoice, and their spirits renew
 And not perish, memory to give
 Way before the face of the Great
 One to all generations' fate
 Of the world, therefore do not be
 Afraid of their claims any more.
 5 Woe to you, sinners, wickedly
 When you have died at end of score,
 If you die in wealth of your sins,
 And those who are like you in bins
 Say of you, "Blessed are sinners, they
 Have seen all their days. 6 And how they
 Have died prosperously and in wealth,
 And have not seen trouble and stealth
 Or murder in their life, and they
 Have died in honour, judgement's sway
 Has not been executed on
 Them during their life *from its dawn*."

Though I am still alive and with my breath
 Recite in love Your holy name till death,
 I wonder, my Beloved, if my name's set
 Among the righteous on the tablets met
 Upon the heavenly shore, the tablets sung
 By Enoch my grandfather by whose tongue
 The sweet and bitter visions of all time
 Were set forth in both meter and in rhyme.
 If my name's not in that reflection's gold
 Where You, Beloved, in awful traces told
 Are seen in all the universe displayed
 On nothingness, though all beauties
 portrayed,
 Write on Your heart, Beloved, my name
 and soon
 As I write on my heart Your name in tune.

7 Know that their souls then will be made
 To go down into Sheol's shade
 And they shall be wretched in their
 Great tribulation *as their share*.
 8 And into darkness, chains and burning

Flame where there is grievous and spurning
 Judgement shall your spirits go in,
 And the great judgement upon sin
 Shall be for all the generations
 Of the world *and to all the nations*.
 Woe to you, for you'll have no peace.
 9 Say not in regard to increase
 Of the righteous and good who are
 In life, "In our troubled days star
 We have toiled laboriously and
 Experienced every trouble *planned*,
 And met with much evil and been
 Consumed, and have become few *seen*
 And our spirit small. 10 "And so we
 Have been destroyed without any
 Help even with a word, we've been
 Tortured [and destroyed] *on the green*,
 Without hope of life day to day.
 11 "We hoped to be the head to sway
 And have become the tail, we've toiled
 In labour and in toil unspoiled
 No satisfaction met our way,
 And we've become the sinners' prey
 And of the unrighteous, and they
 Have laid their yoke heavy on us.
 12 "They've had dominion over us
 That hated us and *still* smote us,
 And to those hating us we've bowed
 Our necks but they have not allowed
 Us pity. 13 "We desired to get
 Away from them that we might yet
 Escape and be at rest, but found
 No place to where we should flee sound
 And safe. 14 "And we complained to those
 Who are the rulers in our throes
 Of tribulation, and cried out
 Against those who devoured us *stout*,
 But they did not attend our cries
 And would not hearken to our sighs.
 15 "And they helped those who robbed us
 and
 Devoured us and who made our band
 A few, and they concealed their work
 Of oppression *there where they lurk*,
 And they did not remove from us
 The yoke of those devouring us
 And dispersed us and murdered us,
 And they concealed their murder, and
 Minded not that had lifted hand
 Against us *in the holy land*.

The spirits of all flesh return to You,

Though Sheol is the home of all and due,
And judgement is set down in fierce
reprisal

In grief and flame for lives without revisal,
Yet all flesh must return one day to see
The judgement of Your face eternally.
Murder and its oppression hidden once
Is revealed to both wise and to the dunce,
And all's set right before Your face at last
When the seven ages of the world are past
And the eighth week dawns with its silent
chains.

Some wake to their reward in sumptuous
pains

And others to the visions of their gains
In being bound up in Your heart and fast.

Enoch 104

1 "I swear to you, that in the sky
The angels remember you by
Good before the glory of that
Great One, before the place He sat,
And your names are written before
The glory of the Great One's *score*.

Muhammad in the holy Qur'an too
Swears by the sky just as Enoch in view
Raises the angels in remembrance' crew
To grant reward for every human good
Found in Enoch's report as well as should.
The good is before glory to the great
One who alone is sovereign in state.
Muhammad too in the holy Qur'an
Remembers that the names in golden span
Are written there before You to relate
That sky is witness to all human fate.
Beloved, if angels still remember me
Before the glory of Your face and sea,
Then I too make remembrance here of
Thee.

2 "Be hopeful, for in former times
You were put to shame by their crimes,
Through ill and affliction, but now
You shall shine as the stars enow
Of heaven, you shall shine and you
Shall be seen, and the gates anew
Of heaven shall be opened you.

3 "And in your cry, cry for judgement,
And it shall appear where you went,
For all your tribulation shall
Be visited upon cabal

Of rulers, and on all who helped
Those who plundered you *when you yelped*.

Indeed, Beloved, I have been put to shame
More than any other found here to blame
In palaces of wealth where I lay claim
To live and prosper eating on the main,
While that elite hands out a paltry sum
To feed the hungry whose wealth now has
come

To support the life-style of great and small
Who wander through the rock and rolling
hall.

Indeed, Beloved, I'm put to shame by both
Participating in the reeling growth
Of the consumer life as by the mill
That says I don't consume enough to fill.
Beloved, I flee to You from every wrong
That lies beneath the wings of my fast
song.

4 "Be hopeful, and don't cast away
Your hopes for you shall have a ray
Of great joy as the angels of
Heaven *have joy in the above*.

5 "What shall you be obliged to do?
You shall not have to hide *in crew*
On the day of great judgement and
You shall not be found in the land
As sinners, and the eternal
Judgement shall be far from your sal
For all of the world's generations.

6 "And now do not take fear as rations,
You righteous, when you see the stations
Of sinners growing strong to be
Prosperous in their ways and free,
Be not their companions, but keep
Afar from their violent sweep,
For you'll become companions of
The hosts of heaven *for their love*.

I have a hope, Beloved, I have a ray
That guides me to the coming Judgement
day
As I whirl through Your Sabbath rest to
find

The promises are written on both mind
And heart and voice as I lift Psalm of
praise,

Petition, penance promising my ways
Of prayer in earth prostration might reveal

The ray that taught my footsteps, toes and heel.

Beloved, there are rays all around my path
Leading both to pleasure and wealth, or wrath,

And yet I cast aside the siren song
And shiver with my seeking of the long
Bright ray invisible to all but those
Who seek Your will alone above the rose.

7 “And, although you sinners may say
‘All our sins are hidden away
And shall not be searched out to be
Written down,’ nevertheless see
They’ll write down all your sins each day.

8 “And now I show you that light’s sway
And darkness, day and night’s array,

See all your sins. 9 “So do not be
Godless in your hearts, don’t agree
To lie and alter upright words,
Nor charging with lying the words
Of the Holy Great One, nor take
Account of idols, for the sake
Of your lying and godlessness
Do not result in righteousness
But in great sin. 10 “And now I know

This mystery, that sinners show
Will alter and pervert the words
Of righteousness in many herds,
And will speak wicked words, and lie,
And practice great deceits thereby,
And write books about their words’ *yield*.

11 “But when they write down the truth
sealed,

Of all my words in all their tongues,
12 “And don’t change or diminish rungs
Or anything from my words but
Write them all down in truth to shut,
All that at first I testified
Concerning them, then I will hide
Not any other mystery,
That books will be given to the true
And righteous and the wise ones’ crew
To become a cause of joy and
Uprightness and wisdom in hand.

13 “And to them shall the books be given,
And they shall believe in them striven,
And rejoice over them, and then
Shall all the righteous *among men*
Who have learnt from them all the ways
Of uprightness shall have their praise.”

The seven books that make up four in two
I clasp in rapture to my heart anew
And cantillate the burning words again
That are the joy and judgement of all men.
Beloved, the books that ignite my aspiring
Draw me each day into Your words
untiring

To bless my tongue with honey and with
pearls

As I swing from branches and land on burls
Of polished and of rough bark where I pass
From sky to earth, from violet to grass.
Beloved, I find the heavenly books remain
Embossed upon the stones and not in vain,
Your footprints in black letters or in moss
Or leaf-mould are as clear to me as gloss.

Enoch 105

1 In those days YHWH bade *them* to
summon

And testify to earth’s folk coming
About their wisdom, show to them,
For you are their guides *to condemn*,
And a reward on all the earth.

2 For I and My son in its girth
Will be united with them then
For ever in the paths of men
Upright in their lives, and Islam
Will be your heritage and calm,
Rejoice, you children of all men
Of uprightness. Amen, amen.

Of guides to humankind Enoch is first
And living still to make the unaccurst
Path plain to feet of humble ones who see
The gleams of light wherever he goes free.
The hidden spark occulted from all time
Flashes upon my eye in hope and rhyme
Until I find my feet climb up the stair
Before Your throne divine, and Enoch there
Recites again for my ears tuned to truth
The words of life eternal, fount of youth,
That with each sip invigorate the soul
That in Your name has found both life and
goal.

Beloved, I follow Enoch’s cryptic road
And lay aside earth’s strife and greedy
load.

Fragment of the Book of Noah

Enoch 106

1 And after some time then my son
 Methuselah took a wife won
 For his son Lemech, and she was
 Pregnant by him *as often does*,
 And gave birth *also* to a son.
 2 And his body was white as snow
 And red as blooming rose *to glow*,
 And the hair of his head and locks
 Were white as wool, and long *as stocks*,
 And his eyes beautiful. And when
 He opened up his eyes again,
 He lighted up the whole house like
 The sun, the whole house *at the strike*
 Was very bright. 3 And thereupon
 He arose in the hands outdrawn
 Of the midwife, opened his mouth,
 And conversed with YHWH *from the south*
 Of righteousness. 4 And Lemech was
 His father, and for what he does
 He was afraid of him and fled,
 And came to his father as led
 To Methuselah. 5 And he said
 To him, "I've begotten a son,
 Both strange and diverse from the ton
 Of men, one like the sons of God
 In heaven, with nature on the sod
 Different, and he is not like us,
 His eyes are as the plenteous
 Rays of the sun, and glorious
 Is his face. 6 "And it seems to me
 That he is not sprung from my tree
 But from the angels, and I fear
 That in his days a wonder sere
 May be wrought on the earth *with tear*.

The whiteness is like one of sons of God?
 Does he mean those who sinned upon the
 sod
 To bring about the wicked race of fear?
 If so, it is a curse to be so queer
 As pale in pigment, both in face and hand.
 A better thing would be darkness of land
 As were the other prophets in the place
 Where Adam, Enoch, Lemech showed their
 face.
 Beloved, the man was worried that the cast
 Proved something was amiss in his own
 past
 To suggest I presume adultery
 Was hidden in the prophet's family tree.
 Colour is proof of nothing man can see,
 And is a *non sequeter* known at last.

If Noah opened his mouth to speak well
 The oracles of righteousness a spell
 Soon after he appeared out from the womb,
 He was the first to engage in such doom.
 As such he because sign of him to come
 Who spoke as sent Messiah and not dumb
 As a babe in the cradle. Enoch's sum
 Is source of the Qur'an if truth to tell.
 That light of fire and faith against all hell
 Reminds all of the prophets who spoke by
 The miracles that You write in the sky.
 Beloved, I hear prophetic word that takes
 Flight from the lips of babes and sucklings'
 wakes,
 And tighten with their promise my tent
 stakes.

7 "And now, my father, I am here
 To petition you and implore
 You that You may go in before
 Enoch, our father, and learn from
 Him the truth, for his dwelling's come
 Among the angels." 8 And when he,
 Methuselah heard his son's plea,
 He came to me to where I was
 At the ends of the earth, because
 He'd heard that I was there, and he
 Cried aloud, and I heard his plea
 And I came to him. And I said
 To him, "Indeed, here am I led,
 My son, why have You come to me?"

The fact is it is possible to go
 Into the presence of Enoch and show
 Him the poor heart and bask within the
 glow
 Of the bright worlds where Enoch stands in
 state.
 I too seek out the path before the great
 And enter in the hopeful halls and straight
 To find a better council than the kind
 I find among the temples of the blind.
 Beloved, I pierce the bitterness and rind
 And strike the seeded core and taste the
 sweet
 Until my heart is full beyond retreat.
 There is no place of solace and no seat
 Outside the guidance of the divine proof.
 And so I seek out Enoch though aloof.

9 And he answered and said "Because

Of a mighty anxiety
 I've come to you, and because of
 A disturbing vision above
 I have approached. 10 "And now, my
 father,
 Hear me, to Lemech my son rather
 There has been born a son, the like
 Of whom there is no other spike,
 And his nature is not like man's
 Nature, and the colour that spans
 His body is whiter than snow
 And redder than a rose to grow,
 And the hair of his head is white
 More than white wool, and his eyes bright
 Like the rays of the sun, and he
 Opened his eyes and there freely
 He lighted up the whole house, *see*.

Enoch says Noah was albino and
 A shining light upon an anxious land.
 The whiteness of his hair is like that seen
 In visions of Yourself upon the screen
 Of nothingness that humans must perceive
 Before the eye Reality's reprieve.
 Despite my multifarious descent
 I too am pale as though living in tent
 Without the sun to scorch my scruffy skin.
 Being white is, I think, no mortal sin.
 How strange we human's always take to
 task
 The pigment of the skin in all we ask,
 The least important thing about ourselves
 That distinguishes us from raving elves.

11 "And he arose up in the hand
 Of the midwife, and *by command*
 Opened his mouth and blessed the Lord
 Of heaven, *YHWH the One adored*.
 12 "And his father Lemech became
 Afraid and fled to me *for shame*,
 And did not believe he was sprung
 From him, but from another rung
 Of heavenly angels, and indeed
 I have come to you in my need
 So that you may make known to me
 The truth." 13 And I, Enoch, freely
 Answered and said to him, 'The Lord
 Will do a new thing on the sward,
 And this I have already seen
 In a vision, and made *the ban*
 Known to you that in the days of
 Father Jared come from above,

The angels of heaven transgressed word
 Of YHWH. 14 And indeed they were
 stirred
 To commit sin, transgress the law,
 And have united foot and paw
 With women and committed sin
 With them, and have married some *in*
Their haste, and have produced offspring
 By them *without a song to sing*.
 15 And after they shall produce on
 The earth giants not by the drawn
 Plan of the spirit, but by flesh,
 And there shall be a great *and fresh*
 Punishment on the earth, and earth
 Shall be cleansed from all impure *dearth*.

Not only in the flesh have angels brought
 Wicked amalgamations and unsought
 Upon the earth, but in the mind as well
 The tortuous convolutions of hell
 Sprint out across the page and vision's
 screen
 To spoil the earth of lovely and pristine.
 The body is not all there is to spoil,
 There's also mind and heart, the soul at
 toil,
 And water alone cannot cleanse from these
 Which come invisibly as noxious breeze.
 Beloved, I flee to You from angel power
 And find Your sovereignty in freedom's
 hour
 To touch the shining sun on frozen birch
 Enough for me of market, court and church.

16 Yea, there shall come a great destruction
 Over the whole earth, and a suction
 Of a deluge and great destruction
 For one year. 17 And this son who's been
 Born to you shall be left on scene,
 And his three children shall be saved
 With him *from the judgement engraved*,
 When all mankind that are on earth
 Shall die. 18 And now make known the
 worth
 To your son Lemech that he who
 Has been born is in truth his son,
 And call his name Noah, *please do*,
 For he shall be left to you *won*,
 And he and his sons shall be saved
 From the destruction *as engraved*,
 Which shall arise upon the earth
 Because of all the sin in worth

And all the unrighteousness, which
Shall be consummated in pitch
Upon the earth within his days.
19 And after that there shall be ways
Of more unrighteousness than that
Which was first consummated at
The earth, for I know mysteries
Of the holy ones, for who sees,
He, YHWH, has shown me and informed
Me, and I've read *them* where unstormed
They're written on the heavenly plates,
The tablets *resting in their states*.

If Enoch's read the silver plates above
In heaven and lived to tell me of his love,
He's read, I trow, the holy Qur'an too
That is supposed to be there in plain view.
He's read the Torah and with sinking heart
The histories of judges and the part
They played in saving from idolatries.
He's read of kings too wicked in the breeze
To listen to good prophets and their word.
He read the fate of men and women stirred
And trembling on the choice and falling
flat.
He's read and seen me also where I sat.
Beloved, though all things are written and
fair,
I still choose freely to grasp You from air.

Enoch 107

1 And I saw written on them that
Generation upon a *fat*
Generation shall transgress, till
A nation of righteousness still
Will come, and transgression at last
Is destroyed and all sin is passed
Away from the earth, and all kinds
Of good come upon it *as finds*.
2 And now, my son, go and make known
To your son Lemech *from the throne*
That this son of his, which is born,
Is in truth his son, not forsworn,
And that *this* is no lie *forlorn*.

The prophecy of all that should be seen
In all the world was known at Enoch's
spleen
And shown to Lemech for his son in proof
Of what to carry out and not to goof.
The fate of all things is written and fair
Upon the page of Enoch's writing there

Until destruction cleanses all the earth
With flood and ice or then with fire and
dearth.
Beloved, destroy transgression from the
plot
Of my heart's earning in the things I've
sought
From dibble stick and trowel stuck in the
soil
With all my slight and feeble days of toil.
Remember, my Beloved, the nation still
That obeys You not going out to kill.

3 And when Methuselah had heard
What his father Enoch in word
Said, for he'd shown to him all things
In secret, he returned *by wings*
And showed *them* to him and he named
The name of that son Noah *famed*,
For he will comfort all the world
After the destruction's unfurled.

Noah's a comfort, indeed, that's his name,
Although destroying flood has made his
fame.
I too take comfort in the prince of seers
That constantly while preaching scans and
peers
The sky for clouds. It minds me of my
father
Who could look up with but the slightest
bother
Predicting when the rain would come to
spoil
The fruit of morning's or afternoon's toil.
I who work at no art in brick and lime
Cannot distinguish waverings of clime,
But am content to live beneath the pour
Of sun or rain, if need be rush the door.
So I take comfort from both flood and
drouth
And turn me whirling to both north and
south.

Enoch 108

1 Another book which Enoch wrote
For his son Methuselah's *vote*
And for those who'll come after him,
And keep the law until the *rim*
Of the last days. 2 You who have done
Good shall wait for those days *in sun*
Till an end is made of those who

Work evil, and an end in view
Of the might of transgressors' crew.

How Daniel quotes these words of blessing
on

Those who wait to the end of days for
dawn,

And hope in the last judgement and the fire
That burns the evil from each man's desire
And kindles love of only You to know
That You alone are truly on the row.

All other things illusive in the street
Of cosmic wonder, and before the fleet
Of stars and ships that ply them with the
trade

Of substance and the spangles they are
made.

Beloved, like Enoch and like Daniel I
Return to You again, and again spy
The end of all things and reality
That twinkles brightly on eternity.

3 And wait you indeed till sin's passed
Away, for their names shall at last
Be blotted out of book of life
And out of the holy books *rife*,
And their seed be destroyed for aye,
And their spirits be slain thereby,
And they shall cry and make lament
In a chaotic desert *tent*,
And in the fire shall they all burn,
For there's no earth there *to discern*.

The book of life is known to Enoch first,
And Moses in the Torah was not cursed
When he required that You blot out his
name

If You could not correct the people's
shame.

To Daniel and Apocalypse be true
That the book is opened to every view,
And yet the seed and spirits on the dew
Remain untouched unless the book is lent
To bidding of Your hand wherever sent.
The desert rises in the torrid air
And even earth is lost in what is bare,
Destroyed are all things that are not writ
there

But from the memory that none can share.
Beloved, I sigh and cry for all things
meant.

4 And I saw something there like cloud
Invisible, for by its shroud
I could not look over, and I
Saw a flame of fire blazing high,
And things like shining mountains round
Sweeping to and fro *on the ground*.

My visions of the mountains and their
sweep
Are clouded and recleared beyond the keep
Of days and nights, and yet my soul must
wait

The coming of the whispers on the gate.
The flames are still seen grazing on the
earth

Consuming everything of less than worth
Until the vision darkens from the past
And rests upon the things only that last.
Beloved, my waiting for the grey and dawn
Is helped by chirp of twitter that is drawn
Beside the window of my cottage low
Where angels and other friends' feathers
slow

To flutter at the sill, perhaps to find
A bath in the rain barrel by the blind.

5 I asked one of the holy ones,
Of angels who was with my runs,
And said to him, "What is this thing
Shining? For it's not heaven but wing
Only of flame and blazing fire,
And the voice of weeping and dire
Crying and lamentation and
Strong pain." 6 And he said close at hand,
"This place which You see, here are cast
The spirits of sinners *that blast*
And blasphemers, of those who do
Wickedness, and those also who
Pervert all of the things that YHWH
Has spoken through the mouth of prophet,
Even the things that they shall scoff at.

I too, Beloved, address a quiet word
To angel at my window or a bird,
But not when son of man can hear me
stirred
For fear that I shall be deprived of freedom
By human laws and by those who decreed
them.

Who speak to any but the human lot
Are considered right ready for the rot
Of mental institution, though I know

The ones with power to install people so
Are those whose minds are darkest in the
row.

So let me speak to angels on the mend
Like Enoch in the verses he so penned,
But without being overheard or spent
By human ears because of where they
went.

7 “For some of them are written and
Inscribed in the celestial land,
In order that the angels may
Read them and know what *on a day*
Shall happen to the sinners’ *fray*,
And the spirits of humble ones,
And of those who have in their tonnes
Afflicted their bodies, and been
Recompensed by Alohims’ *win*,
And of those who’ve been put to shame
By wicked men, who love *the name*
Of Alohims and loved not gold
Nor silver nor anything sold
Upon the earth, 8 “but gave themselves
Up to be tortured *on the shelves*,
Who, since they came to be, did not
Long after earthly food, but sought
All things as a mere passing breath,
And lived accordingly *till death*,
9 “And YHWH tried them much, and their
souls

Were found pure so that *in their goals*
They should *for ever* bless His name.
10 “And all the blessings on them came
As I’ve recounted in the books.

And he’s assigned to them their looks
Of recompense, because they’re found
To be such as loved heaven’s ground
More than worldly life safe and sound,
And though they were trodden by foot
Of wicked men, and felt the root
Of their abuse and were reviled
And put to shame, and yet *they smiled*
And blessed Me. 11 “And now I will call
The spirits of the good who fall
To generation of the light,
And I will transform those in sight
Who were born in darkness, and who
In the flesh received not their due
With such honour as faithfulness
On their part deserved to address.

Beloved, I too was born in darkness met

As near midnight as I could ever get,
And so I pray that when You transform
sight

Of day and darkness from the fading night,
That you will give my flesh and spirit room
Before the glowing day of spark and doom.
The generation of light on my path
Set out in darkness makes a glowing
swathe

Across the message of my fate and hour.
I stand beneath Your love, mercy and
power

To find the catnip blooming in the fall
Much later than I’d hoped for its recall.
Forgive me I neglected to take slip
Of it to make a tea drink I could sip.

12 “And I’ll bring forth in shining light
Those who have loved My holy *right*
Name, and I will seat each upon
The throne of his honour *withdrawn*.

13 “And they shall be shining for times
Without number *and in all climes*,
For righteousness is the judgement
Of Alohims, for He has sent
To the faithful His faithfulness
In the upright dwellings’ address.

14 “And they shall see those who were
born

In darkness led dark and forlorn,
While the righteous shall shine *in praise*.

15 “And the sinners shall cry in daze
And see them shining, and they will
Go where days and seasons fulfil.”

I have loved Your name, truly, if the word
That’s on my tongue is more than just a
bird

Of omen and a flash in flight away.
I cannot say if I’ve received a ray
Of what’s my due in mercy and in fame.
But I’ve at least borne love upon Your
name.

Beloved, my precious, darling One who
stands

When everything turns on the shifting
sands,

I wait through troubled times no more
reward

Than seeing the hoarfrost upon the sward,
Upon the willows dressed as brides in
gowns

And on the firs lined up to march to towns.
 Beloved, Beloved, I've loved Your name as
 long
 As Enoch has spoken it clear and strong.

The Book of Jubilees

The Book of Jubilees is found in the Ethiopian canon of Scripture after the Book of Enoch and before the Book of Joshua. It is known there as The Book of the Divisions (of the Times), which also reflects references to it in the Qumran scrolls. The title Jubilees refers to the 49-year period that makes up the basis of dating in the book. The book is presented as being given as revelation to Moses by the Angel of the Presence, and covers the same material as the Pentateuch from the beginning up through about Exodus 16, although legal material from the rest of the Pentateuch is liberally referred to, ascribing it to pre-Mosaic times. It is within the same tradition as the Book of Enoch, which it quotes, and gives the details of the Jubilees calendar, which is based on 52 weekly cycles in one year and four seasons of 13 weeks each. Its emphasis on the heavenly tablets places it directly in the line of pre-Islamic revelation leading up to the Qur'an. The Books of Enoch and Jubilees form a triad with the Qur'an within the context of popular faith in Yemen and the Axumite kingdom in contrast to Monophysite Trinitarian Christianity. It is alluded to in the Qur'an in the prohibition of adding a thirteenth month. The story of Abraham beginning in Jubilees 12 has more in common with the Qur'an than with Genesis.

The original book was certainly in Hebrew, as the fragments in the Qumran texts demonstrate, but this versification is dependent on the translations I have been able to find from the Ethiopic, basically that of R. H. Charles, with reference to notes by many scholars including Joshua Williams (whose dating system I have followed completely), James C. VanderKam, James Charlesworth, Raymond R. Surburg, Leonhard Rost, Emil

Schürer, Jellinek, Frankel, Beer, Dillmann, Rönsch, and Drummond. Perhaps I owe the greatest debt to Ras Feqade I's comments on the Amharic text. I have checked the Qumran fragments with the Ethiopic text and noted a high degree of fidelity. Modern scholars tend to agree with R. H. Charles's assessment that the book was written during the Hasmonean period between 109 and 105 B.C.E. Needless to say, conservative Ethiopian scholars find contradicting evidence and continue to maintain the Mosaic origin of the book. Along with Enoch, the Book of Jubilees as it appears in The Beloved and I contains the least scholarly contribution and in fact I have examined the Ethiopic text directly only in a few passages. These must be seen as little more than versifications, and my contribution lies almost entirely in the poetic commentary.

This is the story of division
 Of the days of the law's *precision*
 And of the testimony *true*,
 Of the events of years *not few*,
 Of their year weeks, and Jubilees
 Throughout all the *chronologies*
 Of years of the world, as YHWH spoke
 To Moses from Mount Sinai's *smoke*
 When he went up to get the tables
 Of the law, the law that enables
 Commandment by Alohim's voice
 When he told him *to make his choice*,
 'Go up to the top of the Mount,'
To find that YHWH's no catamount.

Week 15 Jubilees 1

1 It happened in the first year that
 The children of Israel who'd sat
 In Egypt came out of that land,
 In the third month, the sixteenth day
 Of the month [day which was so scanned
 As the week's second day the way
 The Jubilees calendar works,
 Better than others without quirks,
 The year was twenty-four fifty
 Of the earth or Anno Mundi]
 That YHWH spoke saying to Moses,
 And said "Come up to Me on this
 The mount, and I will give you two
 Sapphire tablets of the law, clue

Of the commandment, that I've written,
So you may teach their hearts *unsmitten*."

The Book of Jubilees, that holy script
That You gave to those who came from
Egypt
By Your call out of slavery and to serve
You and Your holy name and never
swerve,
Begins extolling the law writ on stone
That is what You spoke publicly alone,
And by it Moses should teach what is law
And how to understand with pious awe
The Scriptures of the prophets and the sent:
For this the Book of Jubilees was meant.
Beloved, may I hear Your voice in these
songs
And follow Your guidance against all
wrongs
Until I meet You and Your saints upon
A jubilee encrusted holy dawn.

2 And Moses went into the mount
Of Alohim, and the account
Of YHWH's glory stayed on Sinai,
And a cloud veiled him six days *nigh*.
3 Upon the seventh day he called
Moses out of the cloud enthralled,
And he saw YHWH's light like a flame
Of fire upon the mountain came.
4 And Moses was on the mountain
Forty days and forty nights, in
That time Alohim taught him all
The early and the later call
Of the division of all days
Of law and testimony's ways.

Beloved, I've also fasted forty days,
And prayed that You might ever guide my
ways,
And I have taken tablets from Your hand
Wrought in the shining jewels of
Samarqand,
And writ with divine words in number ten.
I've heard Your voice, the voice that spoke
to men
Once at Sinai, and so I take these words
At hand of prophet, though not jewelled
sherds,
But ink and paper, yet the gems glow still
To tell me, my Beloved, to do Your will.
Let me live in that light of cloud and flame

That opens now Jubilees and Your name,
Division of all days and divine law
Laid bare before my eyes opened in awe.

5 And he said "Set your heart to each
Word which I'll speak to you *and preach*
On this mountain, and write them in
A book so that their sons may win
A sight of how I've differed from
Them for the evil that has come
From their sinning against the pact
I made between myself and you
For their descendants *not a few*
Today on Mount Sinai *I act*.

Upon a mesa in New Mexico
There is an ancient stone whose faces show
The Hebrew writing of the Decalogue
In a strange script of old that was in cog
For decades as the coming White men tried
To decipher the message the words hide.
The faith of humankind is summarized
The words that Sinai's summit realized.
Another stone Hopewellian dug out deep
Shows the same words that You asked us to
keep,
And that too was thought but a hoax until
It turned out its writing style gave a thrill
At being unknown at the time of finding.
Beloved, Your law is still on all men
binding.

6 "And so when all these things occur
To them, they shall know that they were
Not so true as I in their thoughts
And in their deeds, and they'll have lots
Of evidence I'm in their plots.
7 "And write for yourself all these things
That I declare to you *like kings*
Today, for I know their rebellion
And their stiff neck, *and like a hellion*,
Before I bring them to the land
Of which I swore *in My command*
To their fathers, to Abraham
And Isaac and Jacob *his lamb*,
Saying 'To your descendants I
Shall give a land *beneath the sky*
Flowing with milk and honey,' 8 and
They will eat and be satisfied,
And they will turn to strange gods' hand,
To *gods* who cannot *take their side*
Delivering them from tribulation.

And this witness *in its own station*
 Shall be heard for a testimony
 Against them, for they will be phoney,
 Forgetting all My commandments,
Even all I've told them *with sense*,
 And they will follow Gentiles' way,
 And after their uncleanness' sway,
 And after their shame, and will serve
 Their gods, and these will *in their verve*
 Prove unto them an offence and
 A tribulation and affliction
 And snare. 9 "And many *with conviction*
 Will perish and they will be taken
 Captive, and will fall, *being shaken*,
 Into the hands of enemy,
 Because they have forsaken *Me*
 And My ordinances and My
 Commandments, and festivals by
 My covenant, Sabbaths, and My
 Holy place which I've hallowed for
 Myself among them *and their store*,
 And My tabernacle, and My
Sacred sanctuary, which I
 Have hallowed for Myself on earth,
 That I should set my name of worth
 Upon it, and that it should stay
There, 10 "and they'll make themselves
one day
 High place, graven image, and grove,
 And they will worship, each his Jove,
 So as to go astray, and they
 Will sacrifice their children to
 Demons, to all works that endure
 Their hearts with error. 11 "And I'll send
 Witnesses to them to contend
 Against them, but they will not hear,
But will press onward without fear
 And will slay the witnesses too,
 And they will persecute those who
 Seek the law, and they'll abrogate
 And change everything *in their hate*
 So as to work their wickedness
 Before My eyes. 12 "*In my distress*
 I'll hide My face from them, and I'll
 Deliver them into the guile
 Of the Gentiles' captivity,
 And for a prey, and for *freely*
 Devouring, and I will remove
 Them from the land's midst *and to prove*
 I'll scatter them among the nations.

No wonder book of Jubilees was dropped

From the book of the law, because it
 propped
 A prophecy that Your folk given law
 And blessing would forget the fear and awe
 That overcame them before Sinai and
 Before the Decalogue of Your command,
 That they would wrest the Scriptures from
 the truth
 And depart from the way of right and ruth.
 You told them what they would do in the
 land
 Of milk and honey, and You told what
 snare
 Would catch their minds and feet gone
 anywhere.
 Beloved, keep me from every ancient flaw
 Arising from idolatry and lack
 Of taking Decalogue to read the slack.

13 "They'll forget My adjudications
 And all My commandments and all
 My judgments, and will *follow call*
To go astray as to first days
 Of the months, and Sabbaths, and *ways*
Of festivals, and jubilees,
 And ordinances. 14 "After these
 They'll turn to Me then from among
 The Gentiles with all heart *and tongue*
 With all their soul and all their strength,
 And I'll gather them from *the length*
And breadth amongst all the Gentiles,
 And they will seek me *by the whiles*,
 So that I shall be found by them,
 When they seek me with stratagem
 Of all their heart and all their soul.
 15 "And I will show to them *the goal*,
 Abounding peace with righteousness,
 And turn them to the law for goal,
 With all My heart and all My soul.

You said beforehand they would take the
 timing
 Of Babylon to start the month moon
 rhyming,
 And still that thing is done, and so Your
 Sabbath
 Becomes a profaned thing to him who
 stabbeth,
 Be he a Jew or Christian or one given
 Islam or peace after he'd vainly striven.
 Indeed, Beloved, gather to You again

From all these profane faiths vouchsafed to men,
And turn all to Your law, ten-splendoured code
That echoes still where the archangel rode.
With all Your heart and soul turn us again,
Beloved, to Decalogue to rule all men.
And I shall rest in Your sweet thunderings
Until the moment passes with its stings.

They shall be for a blessing, not
For curse, and they shall be the knot
And not the tail. 16 “And I will build
My sanctuary among them,
And I will *surely* live with them,
And I will be their God and they
Shall be My people *all the way*
In truth and righteousness. 17 And I
Will not abandon them *to sod*
Nor ever fail them, because I
Am YHWH” He told him, “and their God.”

Where is Your sanctuary now, Beloved?
It’s broken down and all its tent-stakes
shoved.

And yet the ark of testimony still
Contains the tablets of Your divine will,
And though it may be hidden from the eye,
It still shines brightly from the place I try
To make Your temple in a heart of flesh
Where Psalms of David and Your law
enmesh.

Do not abandon me, but be my God
In the unholy paths where I may trod
As I go on the earth to seek Your face
That shines within the tabernacle’s place.
Thus I may be a blessing as I whirl
About this slaughterhouse like any churl.

18 And Moses prayed in face prostration
And said “Abandon not Your nation,
O YHWH my God, do not throw out
Your folk and *heritage devout*,
To wander in the error of
Their hearts, and do not, *without love*,
Deliver them into the hands
Of their enemies, Gentile bands,
Lest they in ruling them should cause
Them to sin against You and *laws*.
19 “Let your mercy, O Lord, be lifted
Upon Your people *who have drifted*,
Create in them an upright heart,

Let not Beliar’s spirit’s part
Rule over them accusing them
Before You, and to ensnare them
From all the paths of righteousness,
So that they come into distress
And perish from before Your face.
20 “But they are Your people and race,
Which You delivered with your great
Power from the Egyptians’ estate,
Create in them a clean heart and
A holy spirit, let them stand
Not to be ensnared in their sins
From henceforth till for ever wins.”

Prayer on the face, prostrated on the
ground,
Is prayer of every prophet to be found,
Not only Moses, but from first to last.
I also on my face let prayers go past.
Beloved, the prayer of Moses in behalf
Of Israel about to meet the calf
Is prayer I take upon my lips today.
Have mercy on a world caught in the sway
Of idol worship in the church and mart.
Have pity on the petty, profane heart
That rules the world I live in from the start.
I share distress of Moses not just for
Two millions of Your folk and hardly
more,
But for a world taught to be idol whore.

21 And YHWH said unto Moses “I
Know their contrariness and why
Their thoughts and their stiff-neckedness,
and
They will not obediently stand
Till they confess their own sin and
Sin of their fathers. 22 “After this
They’ll turn to Me in uprightness,
With all their heart and all their soul,
And I will circumcise the toll
Of foreskin on their heart as well
As foreskin on their children’s *spell*
Of heart, and I’ll create in them
A holy spirit, *not condemn*
But I will cleanse them so they’ll not
Turn from Me that day till the lot
Of all eternity is cast.
23 “And their souls will cleave to Me fast
And to all My commandments, they
Will fulfil My commandments’ *way*,
And I will be their Father, they

Shall be My children too, 24 “and they
 All shall be called the children of
 Alohim the Living *above*,
 And every angel, every spirit
 Shall know indeed that these are *near it*,
 My children, and that I’m their Father
 In uprightness and *without bother*
In righteousness, and that I love them.
 25 “And write down for yourself *above*
them

All these words I declare to you
 On this mountain, the first and few
 Until the last, which shall come to
 Pass in all the divisions of
 The days in the law *from above*
 And in the testimony and
 In the weeks and jubilees *grand*
 Unto eternity, until
 I descend and live with them still
 Throughout eternal days fulfil.”
 26 And He said to the angel of
 The presence “Write down the above
 For Moses from creation’s start
 Till My sanctuary has part
 Among them built for all *time and*
 Eternity. 27 And YHWH’ll appear
 Before the eyes of all *who fear*,
 And all shall know that I’m the God
 Of Israel and Father *with rod*
 To all the children of Jacob,
 And King on Mount Zion for all
 Eternity, and Zion’s hub
 Jerusalem, holy *and tall*. ”

Write down indeed! What words of grace
 are these,
 That form a book of knowledge, one that
 frees
 Men for all time from all idolatry,
 Revealing You, Beloved, one Deity
 The God of Israel and Father of
 All the children of Jacob, Lord of love
 And King on Mount Zion eternally!
 For life eternal, YHWH, is knowing Thee,
 And so I seek Your face in every place
 That is Your sanctuary in this race,
 And find my refuge in palace above
 This book and rhyme that is Your written
 love.

The Scripture is spelt out in rhymes of men,
 But Jubilees writing is angel’s ken.

28 The angel of the presence who
 Went before Israel’s camp seized new
 Tablet on which were scribed *for fears*
 All the divisions of the years.
 29 He seized the tablet with the writing
 Of the law and witness enlighting
 The weeks of jubilees according
 To their years and to their affording
 The number of the jubilees,
 From the time of creation’s breeze
 Up to the *full* creation of
 New earth beneath and heaven above,
 By all the heavenly hosts *of love*.
 30 By all creation of the earth,
 Till YHWH’s sanctuary of worth
 Shall be made in Jerusalem
 On mount of fortress, every gem
 Of luminaries be renewed
 For healing and for peace, *not feud*,
 And for blessing all the elect
 Chosen of Israel, to inspect
 That it is so from that day and
 To all the days of the earth’s land.

Jubilees 2

1 And the angel of the presence
 Spoke to Moses according to
 The *sacred, lovely* word of YHWH,
 Saying “Write the whole story’s *sense*
 Of the creation, how in six
 Days YHWH Alohim *without tricks*
 Finished all His works and all that
 He had created, and kept at
 The seventh day the Sabbath and
 Hallowed it for all ages, and
 Appointed it to be a sign
 For all His works good *and benign*.
 2 “For He’s created on the first
 Day heavens *that are not the worst*,
 And He created earth and waters
 And all the spirits *and their daughters*
 That serve before Him *not accursed*.

Upon the finishing of Your creation
 You mounted on the throne of adulation
 Observing Sabbath in Your praise and
 honour.
 The earth was done and everything upon
 her
 As evening neared and sixth day, day of
 blessing

Drew to a close. The warm night was
caressing
The new world that bowed down before
Your throne,
Confessing in each tongue that You alone
Are God, Creator, Sovereign over all.
From gnat to brontosaur they heard the call
To worship and they came. I do the same
On this new Sabbath day remembering
That You, Beloved, are Sovereign and my
King,
As I recite from breath to breath Your
name.

And He created angels of
The presence, and angels above
Who praise, angels appointed on
The fire, and the darkness till dawn,
And on the light, angels of frost,
And on the hail, on water *tossed*,
On lightning and on thunder *too*,
Angels appointed as winds *do*,
Angels appointed on all winds
Contained in ice, where frost *rescinds*,
In autumn and in rainy season,
In dry and in the springtime season,
On *ordered* earth and heaven's *reason*,
Angels set over all the streams
And over darkness *till it gleams*
On dusk and on the dawn that YHWH
Prepared in knowledge from His cue."
He told him saying, "Write all things
Of which the great creation sings."
3 And at that time we saw His works
And praised Him greatly without shirks
Because of all the things He's done,
For seven great things on day one.

On the first day, Beloved, You made the
spirit
Of every thing, of heaven and all things
near it,
Of darkness and abyss, of snow and hail,
Of cold and heat, of frost, of calm and gale.
You made the angel watchers of all things
And spirits of all creatures in their rings.
The angels of the presence and of fire
Were born that day prepared of Your
desire,
The knowledge of Your heart. Therefore
they saw

Your works in praise, and stood in joyful
awe
To laud Your name. Let angel watchers
come
Upon my breathing on the first day's sum
And praise the work of seven You have
done
Upon my heart beginning new day one.

4 And on the second day He made
Expanse between the waters stayed,
For on that day waters divided
For half to go up *as provided*,
And half to go down towards the earth
With the expanse between *for worth*
And He did only this task on
The second day *and for its dawn*.
5 And upon the third day He said
"Let the waters in one place led
Upon the earth be there defined,
And make the earth appear *inclined*."
He did everything like He said.
6 And as He commanded the waters
Just so they did, and all the waters
On earth went to one place to stay
And were confined in ocean spray
Beneath expanse on the earth's way.
7 And on that day He did create
The depths of sea each in its state,
And all the streams to go their way,
And all springs at the mountains' root
Within the earth, that *upward shoot*
According to their place and time
From mountains' root, and wells that climb
Up in the earth. And He created
Each seed of every seed kind mated,
All seeds to eat, orchards of trees
That bear their fruit and plants that He's
Created for their Paradise,
On the third day these four things nice.
8 And on the fourth day He created
The moon and sun, stars *complicated*,
And He set them in the expanse
That they might all shine there *and dance*
Upon all the earth. And He made
Them rule night and day, boundary stayed
Between the dark and light *arrayed*.
9 And YHWH created sun for sign
Greatly upon the earth's *design*,
To be a sign for Sabbath days,
For *other* days and holidays,
For months, for Jubilees and for

The times and eras still in store,
For all the seasons of the year,
10 For light and darkness that appear,
For healing all the things that sprout
And grow upon the earth no doubt,
11 These three things He created by
The fourth day *on the earth and sky*.

Note well, Beloved, how in the story that
You tell before the Genesis that sat
On lesser and the greater lights for sign,
That here only the sun gives the design,
Not only of the days, but of what's more,
The months, and takes up every other
chore.

Moon worship clouds the mind and eye of
all

Who choose the almanac of fateful fall
Of Babylon, and call months by the names
Of heathen gods and wicked pagan shames.
Though moons may guide the priesthood's
yearly roll,

All festivals are counted by the toll
Of sun except Hajj pilgrimage when done
And Ramadhan, by moon instead of sun.

Upon the fifth day He created
Great whales in deep waters *elated*.

All of these were created by
His power, for all flesh *under sky*
And blood, and all creatures that swim
Within the waters *made by Him*,
All birds that fly and also fish
Of every kind made *you could wish*,

12 And the sun rose on them for life
Above all on earth *without strife*,
All things that sprout in woods and bear
Fruit, and on all flesh *everywhere*.

13 All these three things He has created
On the fifth day, He was elated.

And on the sixth day He created
All animals and beasts related
All kinds upon the earth instated.

14 After He created all this
Creation He made *in His bliss*
One man, He created female
And male, and gave them *without fail*
Dominion over all the earth
And what is in the sea *of worth*,
Dominion gave him over beast
And bird, all things at last at least
Upon the earth of animals,

On all the world his power falls,
15 He did create these four creations
Upon the sixth day in their stations.
All the created things that were

Numbered twenty-two that occur,
16 Upon the sixth day He had done
With all He made on earth *and won*
In heaven and in the deep and sea,
Between the dark and light to be
Upon the earth *under the sun*.

17 And He gave us a great sign in
The Sabbath day, to rest therein
From all our work on seventh day
For having worked six days *for pay*.
18 All angels who praise and all those
Angels of presence, these enclose
Both many parties, He commanded
That we might honour Him *full-handed*
On earth and in heaven *who chose*
To keep the Sabbath *as it goes*.

19 He told us thus, "I shall divide
Parties from amongst peoples *wide*,
To keep the Sabbath unto Me
In honour and most faithfully,

To bless them holy unto me
As I have blessed the Sabbath day,
And I shall honour them that way,
Who are My folk and I their God.

20 "I chose the seed of Jacob's rod
From all on earth, and wrote him down
As first born child in My own *town*,
To honour him eternally.

And I'll show them the Sabbath day
That they may keep Sabbath each way
And rest upon it from all work,
21 "To make My sign *and not to shirk*,"

But keeping with us holiday
To eat and drink and bless the way
On seventh day of Him who made
And blessed and sanctified arrayed
A people for His own to keep
The Sabbath with us *and not sleep*,
But praise YHWH that Creator stayed.

22 He caused His commands to ascend
As a sweet savour to amend
Acceptable to Him all days.

23 Two and twenty heads *in their ways*
Of mankind from Adam to Jacob,
And twenty-two kinds of work wake up
Until seventh day, this is blessed
And holy, indeed holy rest,

24 And serves for sanctifying and

For blessing that they might in hand
 Who keep the law and covenant
 Be honoured and a separate nation
 In all their days just as He sent
 Once honour and appreciation
 Upon the seventh day to make
 A Sabbath. 25 Six days He did take
 Creating heaven and earth and all,
 And Alohim made *at His call*
 The seventh day holy, for all
 His works, therefore He commanded
 That whosoever on it did
 Any work should die, and that he
 Who defiles it shall surely be
 Put to death. 26 Wherefore do you tell
 Children of Israel to keep well
 This day that they may keep it holy
 And not do on it, *fast or slowly*,
 Any work, so they shall not be
 Rooted out of land *of the free*,
 For it's a holy day and blessed.
 27 And all who break it shall die death,
 For it's holy, sanctified breath,
 For Israel's folk to keep this day
 Through all their generations' way,
 And put to death all persons who
 Take up any tasks there to do,
 Die for eternity distressed.
 28 And every one who stays to rest
 And keep Sabbath thereon from all
 His work, will hear the holy call
 And be blessed throughout all his days
 Even as we are *in our ways*.
 29 Declare and say to Israel's sons
 The law of this day *and its shuns*
 Both that they should keep Sabbath and
 That they should not forsake its band
 In their hearts' error, that it's not
 Lawful to do work as is taught
 Thereon which is unseemly, and
 Their own pleasure, that they should stand
 Not to prepare thereon their food
 Nor any drink, *for that is rude*,
 Nor to draw water, or bring in
 Or take out thereon, *which is sin*,
 Through their gates any burden, which
 They had not prepared *in a pitch*
 For themselves on the sixth day in
 Their dwellings. 30 And they shall not
 bring
 In nor take out from house to house
 On that day, for that day's a thing

More holy and blessed than the douse
 Of any day of jubilee
 Of jubilees, on this we see
 To keep Sabbath in heaven above
 Before it was made known in love
 To any flesh Sabbath to keep
 Upon the earth *sowing to reap*.
 31 And the Creator of all things
 Blessed it, but He did not make holy
 All peoples and nations made lowly
 To keep on it the Sabbath day,
 But only Israel saw the way.
 So He let them both eat and drink
 And keep Sabbath *and so not sink*
 Upon the earth. 32 And the Creator
 Of all things blessed this day which *later*
 He had created for blessing
 And holiness, glory *to sing*
 Above all days. 33 This law and its
 Testimony was given *as fits*
 To the children of Israel as
 A law for ever *and that has*
Strength as each generation sits.

The Sabbath is a blessing given to
 The sons of Israel, for them to do
 And for no other people. Does that mean
 That Rabbis in New York alone have lien
 On divine law? No, the true Jew is he
 Who takes the blessing of eternity
 Once given to our father Abraham
 And spoken to Moses by great I AM,
 And walked about with Adam and with
 Noah.
 The true Jew's not the man caught in the
 Shoah
 Alone, but every man and woman joined
 To divine temple by the covenant
 Of their obedience to You to plant
 Their prayers toward Your house, in faith
 new-coined.

Week 16 Jubilees 3

1 On the six days of second week
 We brought, according *as to seek*
 The word of Alohim, unto
 Adam all the beasts, cattle too,
 And all the birds, and everything
 That moves on the earth, everything
 That moves in water, according
 To their kinds, and by all their kinds,
 The beasts on the first day, the cattle

On second day, the birds *to rattle*
On the third day, and all that moves
Upon the earth the fourth day proves,
And that moves in the water on
The fifth day *from evening to dawn*.
2 And Adam named them all by their
Respective names, and what their share
He called them, that was their name fair.

In six days working, You, Beloved, made
all
The world and what is in it without awl
Or thread, the canopy of stars at night
And every bird and yawling beast in sight.
You need no time nor space to make the
world,
But time and space are something You
unfurled,
A canvas where You paint Your
masterpiece.
The days arise in turn, nor do nights cease,
Since You sang lovely words creating
sound
And light, and shaped the dazzling world a
round.
The human being took as long and quickly,
To name the beastly souls You made so
thickly.
Six days I name the labours of the week,
The seventh dare to take Your name and
speak.

3 And on these five days Adam saw
All these, male and female, by law
According to every kind that
Was on the earth *and where he sat*,
But he was alone and found no
Help corresponding to his show.
4 And YHWH said unto us "It's not
Good that alone a man should plot,
Let us make a help corresponding
To him." 5 YHWH our God not
desponding
Caused a deep sleep *in trance* to fall
Upon him, and he slept withal,
And He took for the woman one
Side from among his two sides done,
And this side was the origin
Of the woman from his sides' bin,
And He built up the flesh instead,
And built the woman *and well fed*.
6 And He awakened Adam out

Of his sleep, on waking *from doubt*
He rose on the sixth day, and He
Brought her to him, and *also* he
Recognized her, and said to her,
"This is now bone of my bones, *sir*,
And flesh of my flesh, she shall be
Called *my* wife, because she was taken
From her husband." 7 Therefore man
shaken

And wife shall be one *flesh*, therefore
Shall a man leave his father's store
And his mother, and cleave unto
His wife, and they shall be one *true*
Flesh. 8 In the first week human being
Created was, and the side *freeing*,
His wife, and in the second week
He showed her unto him *to seek*.
And for this reason the command
Was given to keep in their confinement
Of defilement, for a male's *hand*
Seven days, and for the refinement
Of a female twice seven days.
9 And after Adam had his stays
Of forty days in the land where
He'd been created, we would bear
Him into the garden of Eden
To till and keep it, *put the seed in*,
But his wife they brought in upon
The eightieth day *and at dawn*,
And after this she entered in
Garden of Eden without sin.

Three kinds of thought are set in mind of
man
And woman to reveal Your divine plan.
The first is reason, deduction's array,
The thought we use to quarrel in our way
When one is logical, the other not.
The second is experimental plot,
Empiricism that we use in science
To produce technological appliance.
The third is mythopoeic-magical
That sees connexion between art and sal.
Because Eve appeared in fortnight of days
And Adam after seven, for Your praise,
Confinement on each birth in mimicry
Follows the weeks throughout eternity.

10 And for this reason the command
Is writ on heavenly tablets *grand*
About her that gives birth, "If she
Bears a male, she shall remain *free*

In her uncleanness seven days
 According to first week of days,
 And thirty and three days shall she
 Remain in blood of purifying,
 And she shall not touch in *defying*
 A hallowed thing, nor enter in
 The sanctuary to *her sin*,
 Until she finishes these days
 Which *are enjoined as* in the case
 Of a male child. 11 “But in the case
 Of a female child she’ll remain
 In her uncleanness two weeks *reign*
 Of days, according to the first
 Two weeks, and sixty-six days *burst*
 In blood of her purification,
 And they will be *within that station*
 In all eighty days.” 12 And when she
 Had completed these days eighty,
 We brought her into Eden’s garden,
 For it is holier than *pardon*
 Of all the earth besides, each tree
 That’s planted in it is holy.
 13 That’s why there was ordained about
 Her who bears male or *without doubt*
 A female child the statute for
 Those days that she should touch no more
 Holy thing, nor enter into
 The sanctuary until *few*
 These days for the male or female
 Child are finished, 14 this is the law
 And testimony which *in awe*
 Was written down for Israel,
 In order that they should do well
 Observing it all days *that fell*.

The law of Moses, it is true, goes back
 To principles well-founded without lack
 In Genesis and in the world’s creation.
 The selfish look only to their salvation,
 While faithful seek instead Your own
 design,
 Beloved, and where in all You put the sign
 Of divine presence and of happy grace.
 The faithful seek instead of life Your face.
 And rather than Your face at first they find
 The life that You have given, not to the
 blind
 Who gloat on human sacrifice, but on
 The faithful who find Your law in the dawn
 And keep the days from forty on to eighty
 In matters light and matters firm and
 weighty.

15 In first week of first jubilee, [1-7 A.M.]
 Adam and his wife were freely
 In the garden of Eden for
 Seven years tilling, keeping store,
 And we gave him work and we taught
 Him to do all things as he ought
 In agriculture, 16 and he tilled
The garden, and was naked *filled*
 And did not recognize it, and
 Was not ashamed, and he lent hand
 Protecting the garden from birds
 And beasts and cattle, *and their turds*,
 And gathered its fruit, ate, and put
 Aside remainder for his *foot*
 And for his wife *and put aside*
That which was saved there to abide.
 17 And after the completion of
 The seven years, which he *in love*
 Completed there, seven years exact, [8

A.M.]
 And in the second month, *in fact*
 On the month’s seventeenth day *first*
Day of the week, the serpent *worst*
 Came and approached the woman, and
 The serpent told the woman *grand*,
 ‘Has Alohim commanded you,
 Saying you shall not eat the due
 Of every garden’s tree on cue?’

It is a trial that serpent is content
 To meet each lady and her man who went
 Before the tree of knowledge of the right
 And wrong on Sunday mornings and to bite
 Once more the fruit forbidden. Church
 doors wide
 Are opened on that serpent-chosen day
 And week by week seduce the meek inside
 With fruitless entertainment in the bay.
 The seventeenth day of the second comes
 Each spring as bud appears and new bee
 hums,
 But no one has the front to celebrate
 The serpent festival, and yet of late
 The weekly meeting spreads his scaly word
 To Christian and non-Christian undeterred.

18 And she said to it, ‘Of the fruit
 Of all the garden trees *to boot*
 Alohim’s said to us, eat, but
 Of the fruit of the tree of what
 Is in the midst of the garden,

Alohim's said unto us *men*,
 You shall not eat thereof, nor shall
 You touch it, lest you die *for sal.*
 19 And the serpent upon the earth
 Going *for all the snake was worth*
 Said to the woman, 'As YHWH knows
 That upon the day that you chose
 To eat of it, your reason's eye
 Shall be opened *into the sky*,
 And you shall be as Alohim,
 Discerning good from evil *dream*.
 You shall not surely die a death.
 20 And the woman saw *in one breath*
 That the tree was desired and fine
 For eye to see, its fruit benign
 For food, she sliced and ate the same,
 21 And when she'd first covered her shame
 With fig leaves, she gave some to eat
 To Adam and he ate the treat,
 And their eyes were opened *to view*,
 And he saw he was naked too.
 22 He took fig leaves and sewed them up,
 And made an apron *for his sup*.
 23 And YHWH cursed the serpent
 condemned
 Forever. 24 And His anger stemmed
 Upon the woman, since she heard
 The thing the serpent told in word,
 Ate the fruit of fig undeterred,
 He told her "I will multiply
 Your sorrow greatly *by and by*
 And your pains in your toil, a child
 Will be born, bring irreconciled
 Sadness and sorrow. When he's born
 Turn to your husband, and forlorn
 Take comfort in his ruling horn."

Here is new light that Genesis neglects,
 Although it's something every man
 suspects,
 That You, Beloved, were angry with the
 lady
 As well as with the serpent and the shady
 Remarks he made upon the tree. To read
 The story in the first book I take heed
 That You believed the slim excuse she gave
 That serpent in his wording played the
 knave

And with word-play deceived her innocent.
 No doubt it's true, and veils are still unrent
 Between the truth and what I fail to see.
 Belovèd, let no anger fall on me.

I turn from right and wrong and knowledge
 of
 Them both to flee to You and to Your love.

25 And to Adam also he said
 "Since you have heard what your wife read
 And eaten from that fruit of fig,
 That I commanded you renege,
 That you might not eat of the thing,
 Therefore upon the earth I sing
 A curse for your sake, let it make
 Thorn and thistle and for your sake,
 As you have been found from the earth
 And as you will return toward earth,
 Eat your bread in sweat of your face,
 Till you return unto your place
 On the earth from where you were found,
 Agonized, toiling on the ground."
 26 He dressed them in clothes made of hide
 And sent from Garden to abide.
 27 On that day on which Adam went
 Forth from the Garden, there he meant
 To offer as a sweet aroma
 An offering *savour and diploma*,
 Of frankincense, galbanum, and
 Stacte, and spices *in the land*
 And morning with the rising of
 The sun from the day *push for shove*
 When he covered his shame *with glove*.

The sacrifices first laid down to You,
 Beloved, were not the blood of goat and
 ewe,
 Nor were they flour and oil and wine
 outspread
 As in the law of Moses it was said
 That each might bring up to a certain rate
 As he turned to You worried for his fate.
 Ah no, the sacrifice of Adam raises
 The savour of the frankincense in blazes,
 And spices sweetly in the morning sun.
 Let my prayers and remembrances be done
 In sweetness to Your name, in galbanum
 And stacte, till I make the glorious sum
 Of one in You and in all only You
 Who are Beloved and great in what You
 do.

28 And on that day was closed the mouth
 Of all beasts *from the north to south*,
 And of the cattle, and of birds,
 And of whatever walks *with words*,

And of whatever moves, so that
They could no longer speak *for spat*,
For they had all spoken before
With one another with the store
Of lip and tongue, *one language more*.

In days gone past, according to both myth
And book of revelation both bird with
The beast were blessed with tongue to
speak like man
And woman, laying open thought and plan.
Now such communication seems to be
In dream and vision only, or story.
No animal greets man with human words,
No animal at all and but few birds.
Although they cannot praise with human
speech,
That does not mean they fail indeed to
reach
The ultimate in truth or in recital.
To sing Your name is all that's truly vital.
And all things in their own tongues
cantillate
The word of truth and of Your sovereign
state.

29 And He sent out of Eden's field
All flesh of Eden's Garden's yield,
And all flesh was scattered abroad
According to its kinds and mod,
And according to all its types
Into the places *without gripes*
Created for them. 30 And alone
To Adam did He give as shown
To cover up his shame *when grown*,
Of all the beasts and all the cattle.
31 On this account, *and not for battle*,
It's written on the heavenly plates
Concerning all who know the rates
Of judgment of the law, that they
Should cover up their shame that way,
And should not uncover themselves
As do the Gentiles *and their elves*.
32 And on the first day of the fourth
Month (*fourth day of the week as pour'th*),
Adam and his wife went both forth
From the Garden of Eden, and
They lived in Elda in the land
Of their creation. 33 And Adam
Called the name of his wife *not Sam*
But Eve. 34 And they had no son till
First jubilee *rose on the hill*. [8 A.M.]

And after this he knew her *still*.
35 Now he would till the land as he
Had been instructed when once free
In the Garden of Eden's *spre*.

Jubilees 4

1 And in the third week in the second
Jubilee she gave birth *as reckoned*
To Cain, and in the fourth she gave
Birth to Abel, and in the wave
Of the fifth she gave birth to her
Daughter Awan, *as must occur*.
2 And in the first year of the third
Jubilee, Cain killed, *as occurred*,
Abel because *Alohim* did
Accept Abel's sacrifice bid,
And did not accept that of Cain.
3 So in the field *Abel* was slain,
And his blood cried out from the ground
To heaven, complaining *at the sound*
Because he'd killed him. 4 And YHWH
spoke
Reproving Cain because the bloke
Abel was dead, because he had
Killed him, and so he made the lad
A fugitive on earth because
Of the blood of his brother's *paws*,
And he cursed him upon the earth.
5 And on this account it was worth
Writing upon the heavenly slates,
"Cursed is the one who smites his
neighbour
With treachery *or other labour*,
And let all who have seen and heard
Say, 'So be it', and *undeterred*
The man who has seen not declaring
Let him be accursed as a swearing."
6 And for this reason we announce
When we had come *upon the pounce*
Before YHWH our God all the sin
Which is committed in the bin
Of heaven and on earth, and in
Light and darkness, without, within.

Confession is the first remembrance of
The divine name, the name of grace and
love.
Who come before Your face in judgment or
In worship first proclaim this thing before
They take Your hallowed name on human
lip.
So I confess to You in what I slip

And every sin in heaven and earth to make
 My voice clean that would else unworthy
 take
 Your gracious name. Beloved, let me
 announce
 What needs forgiveness and fully renounce
 The evil way as I stand naked on
 The dergah floor before the stone knife
 drawn.
 Then from my bowing rise to whirl in light,
 The sacred dark and everywhere in sight.

7 And Adam and his wife mourned for
 Abel four weeks of years, what's more [99-
 127 A.M.]

And in the fourth year of the week
 Number five [130 A.M.] they came to their
 peak

And became joyful, so Adam
 Again knew his wife *for a slam*,
 And she bore him a son, and he
 Called his name Seth, and because he
 Said "God has raised a second seed
 To us on earth after the bleed
 Of Abel, for Cain slew him." 8 And
 In the sixth week [134-40 A.M.] he got in
 hand

His daughter Azura. 9 And Cain
 Took Awan his sister as wife
 And she bore him Enoch *for strife*
 At the close of fourth jubilee. [190-196
 A.M.]

While Enoch son of Cain bears the same
 name

As Enoch who walked with You without
 blame,

The two are as unlike as any two
 Initiated in secrets to do.
 Perhaps one took the name of enemy
 And so perpetuated enmity
 In epithets. Perhaps the title won
 In the initiation caused the fun.
 But has anyone had pity upon
 The mother of Enoch and wife once drawn
 By lot for Cain, first murderer in kind?
 Perhaps she stood behind her men and
 blind.

Perhaps she suffered that her brood became
 A wicked crew, perhaps basked in their
 fame.

And in the first year of the wee
 First week of the fifth jubilee, [197 A.M.]
 Houses were built on earth, and Cain
 Built a city, called not in vain
 After his son Enoch by name.

10 And Adam knew his wife *of fame*
 Eve and she bore yet nine sons more
That's twelve in all, lacking of score.

11 In the fifth week of jubilee
 Number five [225-31 A.M.] Seth made
 family

With Azura his sister as
 Wife, and in the fourth *year he has*
Of the sixth week [235 A.M.] she bore to
 him

Enos. 12 And he began with vim
 To call upon the name of YHWH
 Upon the earth. 13 And in third week
 Of seventh jubilee [309-315 A.M.] *the*
week

Enos took Noam his sister for
 To be his wife, and so she bore
 To him a son in the third year
 Of the fifth week, [311 A.M.] it does
 appear

He called his name Kenan. 14 And at
 The end of the eighth jubilee [325, 386-392
 A.M.]

Kenan took Mualeleth out flat
 His sister for to be his wife,
 And she bore him a son by fife
 In the ninth jubilee, and in
 The first week in the third year's bin
 Of this week, [395 A.M.] and he called his
 name

Mahalalel. 15 And in the same
 Second week of tenth jubilee [449-455
 A.M.]

Mahalalel himself made free
 To take to wife Dinah, the daughter
 Of Barakiel, she was the daughter
 Of his father's brother, and she
 Bore him a son in the third wee
 Week in the sixth year, [461 A.M.] and he
 called

His name Jared, *and not appalled*,
 For in his days YHWH's angels came
 Down on the earth, those with the name
 Of Watchers, that they should instruct
 The children of men to conduct
 Themselves in judgment and uprightly
 On earth *and do so well and sprightly.*

The tribe of Seth knows to recite Your
 name
 And make of that a far more glorious claim
 Than all the wealth and civilized acclaim
 Of Cain's tribe. Your name and the names
 of men
 Are not the only things to sound again.
 Azura, Noam, and Mualeleth
 Dinah, four generations after Seth
 Prove that You hold women in such esteem
 At least as equal with their husbands'
 dream.
 As time goes on the rank of woman slows,
 Which makes it a wonder the scholar
 knows
 The book of Jubilee a writing late.
 The mention of women would make it
 great,
 Of early times a worthy candidate.

16 And in eleventh jubilee [512-18 A.M.]
 Jared took himself wife to be,
 And her name was Baraka, she
 Was daughter of Rasujal, and
 A daughter of his father's band,
 His father's brother, in the week
 Numbered four of this jubilee, [522 A.M.]
 And she bare him a son *sweetly*
 In the fifth week, and in the year
 Number four of the jubilee,
 And he called his name to appear
 Enoch. 17 And he was the first from
 Among men that are born to come
 On earth who learnt writing and *sum*
 Of knowledge and *of course* wisdom
 And who wrote down the signs of heaven
 According to the order given
 Of their months in a book, that men
 Might know the seasons *come again*
 Of years by the order of their
 Separate months. 18 And he was there
 First to write a witness and he
 Testified to the sons that be
 Of men among the generations
 Of the earth *and the earthly nations*,
 And recounted the weeks that come
 In jubilees, and made known sum
 To them the days of all the years,
 And set in order the months' *gears*
 And recounted the Sabbaths years
 As we showed to his eyes and ears.

The months are unknown to the great
 traditions,
 The popular temples and their seditions.
 The calendars of mankind fail to make
 Distinction of Your months, Sabbaths in
 wake,
 And years and weeks and Jubilees. I take
 From You alone, Beloved, the counting of
 The moments of my heartbeat and the love
 I wonder coming from Your throne above
 To those few who seek out Your law and
 live
 By its few precepts, willingly forgive
 The slaughterer so common in the sieve
 Of this day as in every age that's known.
 And yet this age above all ages prone
 To gross apostasy's with mercy sown.

19 And what was and what will be he
 Saw in a vision sleepily,
 As it will happen to the sons
 Of men throughout the *colophons*
 Of generations till the day
 Of judgment, he saw all *the way*
 And understood everything's *sway*,
 And wrote his testimony, and
 Placed the witness on earthly land
 For all the children of men and
 For their generations' *command*.

Enoch, Beloved, wrote out the vision well
 And left it written to ride out the spell
 Against what's spoken by the tongues of
 hell.
 Obscurely kept in Axum's caves and
 hearts,
 Hidden in Qumran for its lovely parts
 That spoke against hypocrisy and arts
 Of false theology in every Christian church
 And in the wicked synagogues that perch
 Above You, it would seem, to tell Your law
 Accommodating always Roman awe.
 Beloved, I praise Your name for Enoch's
 touch
 And for the words of comfort and as much
 For the fierce judgement that his hand
 portrays.
 Beloved, I flee to You though Your hand
 slays.

20 And in the twelfth jubilee, [582-88] in

The seventh week *of bulletin*,
He took himself a wife, and her
Name was Edna, it would infer
She was the daughter of Danel,
The daughter of his father's brother,
And in the sixth year of that spell,
In this week [587 A.M.] she bore him as
mother

A son he called Methuselah.
21 And he was moreover *in awe*
With the angels of Alohim
Six jubilees of years *and dream*,
And they showed him everything which
Is on earth and in heavens' *pitch*,
The rule of the sun, and he wrote
Down everything, 22 and witnessed quote
To the Watchers, who'd sinned upon
The daughters of men *for their spawn*,
For these had begun to unite
Themselves, so as to be a fright,
Defiled, with the daughters of men,
And Enoch testified again
Before *them* all. 23 And he was taken
From among humankind forsaken,
And we conducted him into
The Garden of Eden as due
In majesty and honour, and
Indeed there he writes down *by hand*
The condemnation and judgement
Of the world, all the argument
Of wickedness of humankind.

The book of Enoch in every detail
In which he wrote it tells how men will fail
To follow the simple law that You give.
Instead they find complexities to live
And answers to question on question sieve
Until the soul is darkened from the path
And enters into the eternal wrath.
I bend my squandered energies to find
Your will, Beloved, but not from deaf and
blind,
But from the syllables resounding still
In folklore and in Scripture from the hill
Of Sinai where You repeat righteous bill
To everyone who comes and all who will.
I seek Your love, Your will, Your heart and
mind.

24 And on account of it designed
Alohim brought the waters *blind*
In flood upon all Eden's land,

For there he was set down and signed
The parchment according to call
And that he should witness to all
The children of men *by command*,
That he should recount all at hand
The deeds of *every* generation
Until the day of condemnation.
25 And he burnt the holy incense,
Even sweet spices of expense
Acceptable before YHWH on
The Mount. 26 For YHWH has four states
drawn

Upon the earth, the Garden of
Eden *or pleasure for His love*,
As well as the Mount of the East
[*Which is at Mecca's springs increased*],
And this mountain on which You are
This day, Mount Sinai *under star*,
And Mount Zion *which* will be made
Holy in new creation swayed
For a sanctification of
The earth, through it and by its love
Will the earth be made holy, clean
Of all *its* guilt, uncleanness seen
Throughout the ages of the world.

The four gates have their four states on the
earth
In mountains set above spiritual dearth
To give the flowing waters of life to
The righteous and the just as is their due.
The first gate is of Eden and of law,
The second is of Mecca and Your awe
In loving contemplation and the third
Is of Mount Sinai where Your golden word
Of law and love was graciously conferred
In the awareness of Your justice done.
The fourth gate is the gate of truth begun,
The glories of Your fortress Zion's wall
Arising beneath sun at David's call.
On earth I find at last celestial hall.

27 When fourteenth jubilee's unfurled [652
A.M.]
Methuselah took him a wife,
Edna the daughter and the life
Of Azrial, the daughter of
His father's brother *for her love*,
In the third week, and in the first
Year of this week, [701-7 A.M.] he was
embursed
To get a son, he called his name

Lemech. 28 And in the renewed claim
Of fifteenth jubilee and in
The third week Lemech *without sin*
Took to himself a wife whose name
Was Betenos the daughter of
Baraki'il, the daughter of
His father's brother, *man of fame*.

Baraka was the name of Enoch's mother,
A blessing she was more than any other.
And Enoch married Edna and his son
Took on her namesake when the day was
done.

Enoch's success was no doubt in part due
To the blessing that his mother's name
threw

Across his life. A great man deeded two
Women to make him great, a thing he knew
In taking Edna for daughter-in-law
Of Baraka, though pleasure in the awe
Of You, Beloved, is not enough for crew.
It takes a walking in obedience
Before a man can rise up and make sense.
Without a wife every man remains dense.

And in this week she bore to him
A son and he called his name *slim*
Noah, saying "This one will be
A comfort for my trouble, *see*,
And all my work, and for the ground
That YHWH has cursed *and all around*."

The name of Noah is a comfort rest
To those who know the holy prophet best.
His name reminds that You, Beloved, once
cursed

The ground and not the man, who was the
worst.

I pray that those who curse me shall be
found

One day themselves upon the holy ground,
Rejoicing in the name that You release
Upon an earth once cursed by the police.
I seek, Beloved, a plot remote, in peace,
Far from the waters of Hudson and
Thames,

And in my solitary days find gems
Of dew and snow sparkling along the edge
Of dead-end road beside my growing
hedge.

Beloved, I take comfort in Noah's fleece.

29 At the nineteenth Jubilee's close,
In the seventh week *which arose*
And in the sixth year [930 A.M.] thereof,
died

Adam, and all his sons *and pride*
Buried him where he had been made,
And he was the first under spade
To be buried within the earth.

30 And he lacked seventy years of worth
To be one thousand years of age,
For one thousand years are a page
As one day in testimony
Of the heavens and therefore, see,
It was written about the tree
Of knowledge, "On the day you eat
Of it you shall die *for the treat*."

Though one day in Your sight can surely be
As one thousand years born eternally,
I fear the flight of Adam was addressed
In the same length of days I have
confessed.

Some days are long, a thing You may not
know,

And so when thousands such complete the
show,

To human hearts set in the garden row,
Eating such fruit forbidden may be worth
Its ecstasies of nectar in the dearth
Of knowledge of the good I see around.
Perhaps it's good today such tree's not
found

Except in metaphor for what it means
To rely on other than divine scenes,
Since You alone have right to wield and
know.

And that's why he did not complete
The years of this day, for he died
During that time. 31 At the end side
Of this jubilee Cain was killed
After him the same year fulfilled,
For his house fell upon him and
He died in his house *on his land*,
And he was killed by its stones' hand,
For with a stone he'd killed Abel,
And by a stone that on him fell
Was he killed in righteous judgement.
32 For this reason it had been sent
Ordnained on heavenly tablets spent,
"With the instrument with which man
Kills his neighbour with the same plan

Shall he be killed, after the same
Manner that he wounded to maim,
In like manner with him they'll deal."

Beloved, I see that justice has been done
Even after the centuries have run
When no man was allowed to touch the son
Because of the mark laid on him and bun.
Beloved, lay now a mark on all the Cains
That rape the earth and with the fatal banes
Of pestilence spread out democracy
Upon the world for every land to see.
Beloved, take in Your hand of justice now
Or in a thousand years, but anyhow,
Bring justice to the slain and the oppressed
Who in patience and love Your name
confessed.

Beloved, with the same instrument I wield
Cut from my heart what wickedness I've
peeled.

33 On twenty-fifth [1205 A.M.] jubilee's
heel

Noah took to himself a wife,
And her name was Emzara, life
And daughter of Rake'el, and
The daughter of his father's band,
His father's brother, in the first
Year in the fifth week [1207 A.M.] *and not
worst.*

And in the third year of that week
She bore him Shem *to have a peek,*
And in the fifth year [1209 A.M.] she bore
him

Ham, and in the first year in rim
Of the sixth week [1212 A.M.] she bore to
him

Japheth, *a son both slim and trim.*

Like many women lucky to be known
At all, Emzara has a name that's shown
In nothing more than who her husband was
And how many sons she bore without
flaws.

The dear Qur'an adds one more to the list,
But he was one the evil fates had kissed.
Ah my Beloved, I with my woman's soul
Live in obscurity to find the goal,
And flee both love and hate, indifference
To share with bird and beast a bare
twopence.

But unlike famous Emzara known to

All men for husband and three sons that
grew,

I have neither husband nor sons, but wait
A lone dervish upon Your royal state.

Week 17 Jubilees 5

1 It happened when children of men
Began to multiply again
Upon the surface of the earth
And daughters came when they gave birth,
That the angels of Alohim
Saw them on a certain year's dream
Of this jubilee, that they were
Beautiful to look at *and spur,*
And so they took for themselves wives
Of all whom they chose *for their lives,*
And they bore to them sons and they
Were giants. 2 And lawlessness' way
Increased on the earth and all flesh
Corrupted its way, in its mesh
Were men and cattle, beasts and birds
And everything moving *in herds*
On earth, they all corrupted ways
And their orders, and *in their days*
They began to devour each other,
And lawlessness *against one's brother*
Increased on the earth and each thought
Of men's imagination taught
Evil continually *in plot.*

The Watchers' treachery leads to many
things:

The lawlessness of peasants and of kings,
Corruption of all flesh, both bird and beast,
And humankind as well as not the least,
The cannibalism of upright men,
At least those in power in village and den,
And every thought imagined wicked still.
One might have wondered who would foot
the bill.

Some wonder in this day and page as well
Who'll pay the price of the consuming
spell.

Beloved, as changes make their awkward
way

Across the sky of the same clouds at play,
I break the chain of violence reciting
Your names in lofty Scripture and the
biting.

3 And Alohim looked on the earth,
And lo it was corrupt in worth,

And all flesh had corrupted its
 Orders, and everything that sits
 Upon the earth had done all kinds
 Of wickedness before His *blinds*.
 4 And He said that He would destroy
 Man and all flesh *that He'd employ*
 Upon the surface of the earth
 Which He'd created *in its girth*.
 5 But Noah found grace in the eyes
 Of YHWH. 6 And with the angel spies
 Whom He had sent upon the earth,
 He was very angry, and gave
 Command to root out the enclave
 Of them from all of their dominion,
 And He told us as His opinion
 To bind them all in the earth's deep,
 And indeed they are bound to keep
 In the depths and are separate.
 7 And against their sons there went *great*
 Command from Him that they be struck
 With the sword, be removed from *luck*
 Under heaven. 8 And He said "My
 Spirit, it shall not always try
 To remain on man, for they too
 Are flesh and their days shall be few,
 Just one hundred and twenty years."
 9 And He sent His sword on their ears
 That each should kill each other, and
 They began to kill through the land
 Till they all fell by the sword's berth
 And were destroyed from off the earth.

Your spirit, my Beloved, upon the human
 race
 Is what keeps peace when peace is in this
 place.
 When Your great spirit fails to ride upon
 The human mind, the outcome is foregone.
 The violence of power to do comes out
 When humans are not guided, without
 doubt.
 Then guide me in this place of men and
 fears,
 Throughout the valley of both death and
 tears,
 To keep my mind stayed with Your spirit
 now
 And on all days of life in sword and
 plough.
 Let me not touch with violence the one
 That You have blessed, nor plant beneath
 the sun

Where others have the right. Beloved, I
 crave
 The guidance of Your spirit to the grave.

10 And their fathers were witnesses
Of their destruction, after this
 They were bound in the depths of earth
 Forever, until the day's birth
 Of the great condemnation, when
 Judgment is accorded all men,
 And those who've corrupted their ways
 And their works before the Lord's praise.
 11 And He destroyed them from their
 places,
 And there were not left any faces
 Unjudged for all their wickedness.
 12 *But Lord God did not cease to bless*,
 And He made for His works a new
 And righteous nature, so the crew
 Should not sin in their whole nature
 Forever, but should be all pure
 And righteous each in his kind's way
 Always. 13 And the judgment of all
 Is ordained and written on wall
 Of the celestial tablets and
 In righteousness, even *the hand*
Of judgement of all who depart
 From the path which is ordained part
 For them to walk in, and if they
 Do not walk in it, judgment sway
 Is written down for every creature
 And every kind, *and every preacher*.

Though every life is written in detail
 With the command of tablets on the grail,
 A man is still free to cut off his sail
 And go his own way in rebellious state.
 He can accept wicked, illusion's fate.
 Eternal script is not a chain and ball,
 But the sweet bidding to the safer stall.
 Who choose the rampant desert fail to see
 The stall open out in its liberty
 And hover on the track of stars and glow
 Of heavenly ecstasies though here below.
 Beloved, I beg to follow in the path
 Plotted from Your eternity, not wrath.

14 And there is naught in heaven or earth,
 Or in light or in darkness' berth,
 Or in Sheol or in the deep,
 Or in the place of darkness' keep
Which is not judged, all their judgments

Are ordained and written with *sense*
And engraved. 15 In regard to all
He will judge, the great by the call
Of his greatness, and then the small
According to his smallness, each
According to his way *and reach*.

Beloved, I joy to think Your judgement of
Myself is small indeed, and in Your love,
Although the great You judge according to
The greatness of the things they hope to do.
I have just small things in my care, a house
Of timbers old and buried like a mouse
Beside the bosky hill, beside the spring
That lends its fresh waters to everything
I eat and drink, and also washes clothes
I change to clean when Sabbath days
transpose.

My hours are made of tiny things, the dry
Garlic cloves hanging near the woodfire's
keep,
Harvest of nettles, milkweed, compost
heap,
And on the floor of loft a place to sleep.

16 And He is not one who'll regard
The person *of any*, nor shard,
Nor is He one who will receive
Gifts, if He says that He'll *reprieve*
Or execute judgment on each,
If one gave everything in reach
On the earth, He would not regard
The gifts or the person *or pard*,
Nor accept anything from hand,
For He's righteous judge *on the land*.
17 [And of Israel's folk it's been written
And ordained, if they turn *unsmitten*
To Him in righteousness He will
Forgive them their transgressions' *bill*
And pardon all their wickedness.
18 It is written, ordained to bless
That He will show mercy's *address*
To all who turn from all their guilt
Once each year.] 19 And as for those spilt
Corrupting their ways and their thoughts
Before the flood, then no man's lots
Were accepted save those of Noah
Alone *out of that greater shoah*,
For his person was accepted
In behalf of what his sons did,
Whom *Alohim* saved from the flood
Waters on his account *and blood*,

For his heart was righteous in all
His ways, according to his call,
And he had not departed from
Anything ordained *and to come*.

Noah was perfect and just long before
He brought You sacrifice before the door.
He was accepted, though perhaps a boor,
Always harping on what You have in store
As law for the clean and unclean in meat.
Noah was perfect and walked by Your feet.
Noah did not bring sacrifice as meet
Until the flood was done, because He knew
That none was accepted because of crew
Or fame or claim to name or residue
Of hope that You might be for sale. The
true
Come with hands empty and the heart
bowed low
To give to You alone the weight of show.
And so there's no gift I can bring to You.

20 And YHWH said that He would destroy
All things that on the earth *enjoy*,
Both men and cattle, and the beast,
And fowl of the air, and increased
Whatever moves upon the earth.
21 And He commanded Noah berth
In an ark he should make himself,
That he might save himself *on shelf*
From the *great* waters of the flood.

Salvation is a grace indeed because
It is a thing made by a man's own paws.
Noah would have died in the flood if he
Had thought it was enough to sit by tree
Saved by Your grace, or even tremblingly
Obedient to the Decalogue's command.
Neither sitting nor doing out of hand
Brings salvation, but rather logically
To take shelter before the gale and sea.
Who said to Noah I shall not come in
Since at home I keep Sabbath without sin,
And so I'm safe. The water washed away
All the excuses in the light of day.
I enter ark made with hands, there I stay.

22 And Noah made the ark with thud
Just as He commanded him, in
The twenty-seventh jubilee
Of years, in the fifth week and in
The fifth year *on [first day's decree]*

Of the first month, the week's fourth day.

[1307 A.M.]

23 And he entered in the sixth year
Of that week *in the ark to stay*, [1308
A.M.]

In the second month *without fear*,
On the [first day, *which is week's sixth*]
Of the second month, till sixteenth
[Sabbath], he entered *the sixteenth*,
And all that We brought to him there,
Into the ark, and YHWH was fair
To close it from without upon
The seventeenth evening *from dawn*
[Evening preceding the first day
Of the week]. 24 And YHWH opened stay
Of the seven flood-gates of the sky,
And the mouths of the fountains high
Of the great deep, seven springs in all.

A Saturday night You closed up the ark
So no one else could come into the park.
Until the second Sabbath of that second
Month the open door to all sinners
beckoned
As well as to the righteous on the earth.
But on the Sunday when the crowds of
worth
Came to the church door, it was barred and
locked.
So You showed them what it was to be
mocked,
And portrayed how that day was but a
dearth
Of mercy for the disobedient crowd
Who fought each other and pounded aloud
Upon the ark's door that they might come
in.
Noah or I might give in to the din.
But You lock mercy's door against their
sin.

25 From the flood-gates began to fall
Down water from heaven forty days
And forty nights [until it stays
On the third month, day twenty-six,
The fifth day of the week to fix],
And the fountains of the deep too
Sent up waters, *waters to spew*
Until the whole world was full up
Of water *from the wrathly cup*.

The judgement on those who wait Sunday's
dawn

To come to You for mercy just goes on
In awful retribution on the land
For forty days and nights by Your
command.

No wonder Constantinople and Rome
Reject the Book of Jubilees for dome
And steeple of sun worship in their trek
Away from justice to tread on the deck
Of wave-washed ark and so to lose their
neck.

The Book of Jubilees condemns their fall
From grace and Your commandments and
the pall
That's found in setting off the yoke and
plough
Of Your appointed. Axum's church alone
Preserves the book, not having hearts of
stone.

26 And the waters increased upon
The earth: fifteen cubits were drawn
In waters risen above all
The highest mountains *like a wall*,
And the ark was lifted above
The earth, and it moved on *in love*
On the face of the waters' *shove*.
27 And the water prevailed upon
The surface of the earth *as drawn*
For five months, one hundred and fifty
Days. 28 And the ark went out and *nifty*
Rested on the top of Lubar,
One of Ararat's mountains, star.
29 And on the [first day] *fourth day of*
The week in the fourth month *above*
The fountains of the great deep closed,
And the flood-gates of heaven *exposed*
Restrained, and on the [first day] which
Was *fourth day of the week in pitch*
Of the seventh month all the springs
Of the abysses opened wings
Deep in the earth, the water started
To descend in the deep departed.
30 And on the [first day] *the fourth day*
Of the week of the tenth month's way
The tops of the mountains were seen,
And on the [first day] *the fourth day*
Of the week of the first month's way
The earth's from where it had been seen.
31 And the waters disappeared from
Above the earth *back where they'd come*,

In the fifth week in seventh year [1309
A.M.],

And on the seventeenth day to steer
In the second month *the first day*
Of the week and the earth *astray*
Was dry. 32 And on day twenty-seven
Fourth day of the week writ in heaven,
He opened the ark, and sent out
Of it beasts, cattle, *without doubt*
The birds, and every moving stout.

I often think to take refuge in You,
Beloved, from strife and every evil view,
But rarely think about the day and true
When the ark door is opened, I leave pew
To find a world caressed by Judgement's
grace,

A pure and clean and wholesome kind of
place.

Beloved, I fly out with the rook and wren
And wander with the squirrel and fox and
then

Dance on the granite boulders tumbled
down

Beneath the hill I live by with a frown.
My Wednesday opens up to see the sky
Of stars at last unfolded to my eye,
And I stop all my dancing and my song
To wait on You, Beloved, wait on You
long.

Jubilees 6

1 And on the [first day] *the first day*
Of the week of the third month's sway
He went out of the ark, and built
An altar on that mountain's *silt*.

2 And he made atonement for earth,
And took a kid *for what it's worth*
And made atonement by its blood
For all the guilt *before earth's flood*,
For everything that had been there
Had been destroyed, *the earth was bare*,
Except those that were in the ark
With Noah. 3 And he placed the stark
Fat of it on the altar, and
He took an ox, and goat *in hand*,
A sheep and kids, and salt, and yet
A turtle-dove, and the young set
Of a dove, and placed offering burnt
On the altar, and poured *as learnt*
On it offering mingled with oil,
And sprinkled grape juice *on the soil*

And strewed with frankincense the whole,
And caused a sweet savour that stole
Up acceptable before YHWH.

4 And YHWH smelled the sweet savour
too,

And He made covenant with him
That there should never a flood dim
Again destroy the earth to rim,
That all the days of the earth's time,
From sowing and harvest in clime
Should never cease, and cold and heat,
And summer and winter *and sleet*,
And day and night should not cease rate
Of their order, nor cease their gait.

Beloved, in all philosophies set out
Upon theologies encircling You about,
There is no explanation of Your nose,
Nor how You relate to the smell of rose.
Your attributes divine both positive,
And, shame to say, what they call negative,
Are well inscribed on every iron creed,
And set in catechisms for my need.
But there's no one among St. Thomas'
crew

Who thought to tell me what is in the brew.
The ancients seemed to know the smell of
blood

In sacrifice demanded in a flood
Something to repair Your nose. But we fair
And thoughtless ones today breath only air.

5 'And you, increase and multiply
Upon the earth, and *as you try*
Become many on it, and be
A blessing there *for all to see*.

Beloved, the earth is filled to overflowing,
At least too many to feed as we're going
With our domestics based on war and fear.
If we put out those two hogs and their gear
We'd have enough to feed the world and
stowing.

In my descent I cannot claim to be
One of those multiplying on the spree,
But at least one or two in generations
Carry on my unnatural pangyrations,
A trait of character arising here,
Another there sometimes surprisingly.
Increase I have, and that is half the word
Told in the twittering and flight of bird

Beneath the firs and birches and pines
stirred.

The fear of you and dread of you
I will inspire in every crew
That's on the earth and in the sea.
6 And indeed I have given you
All beasts, and all winged things in view,
And everything that moves on earth,
And the fish in the waters' *berth*,
And all things for food, as green herb,
I've given you all things *superb*
To eat. 7 But flesh, with life in it,
With the blood, such things are not fit
For you to eat, for the life of
All flesh is in the blood *above*,
Lest your blood of your lives shall be
Required in vengeance. At the plea
Of every man's hand, at the hand
Of every *beast* I will require
The blood of humankind's desire.

This thing has gone awry, Beloved, You
know
How many now lap up the blood for show
And force their children to imbibe the evil
While turning up their noses at the weevil.
Blood puddings and pancakes make the
dessert
Of bishops and their parishes alert.
Since You say all things can be eaten they
Have eaten every corpse found in the way
And slain at their own license everything
From porker to the buzzard on the wing,
And taken both blood and the sacred lives
Of beasts whose precious memory survives
In Your heart only. My Beloved, make
room
In Your heart for those passing through
their tomb.

8 Whoever sheds man's blood by man
Shall his blood be shed, for by plan
Of Alohim He has made man.
9 And you, increase and multiply
On the earth.' 10 And Noah thereby
And his sons swore that they would not
Eat any blood that was the lot
Of any flesh, and he made there
A covenant *where he did swear*
Before the Lord and Alohim
For ever throughout all the team

Of generations of the earth
In this month. 11 And because of this
He told you that you should not miss
Making a covenant with folk
Of Israel in this month *He spoke*
Upon the mountain with an oath,
And that you should sprinkle *in troth*
The blood on them because of all
The words of the covenant *thrall*,
Which YHWH made with them *all* for
ever.

12 And this witness is written *clever*
Concerning you that you observe
It always, so that you not swerve
To eat on any day the blood
Of beasts or birds *after the flood*
Or cattle during all the days
Of the earth, and the one whose ways
Is to eat blood of beast or cattle
Or of birds during all the *battle*
Days of the earth, he and his folk
Descended *from any such bloke*
Shall be rooted out of the land.

13 And so give Israel's folk command
To eat no blood, so that their names
And their descendants without blames
May be before YHWH our God ever.
14 And for this law there is no sever
To limit days, for it's for ever.

You did not know, Beloved, when You
implied
Or rather stated this law should abide
That some would in time take a twisted
view
Of Paul and say he spoke better than You
In saying anything in paunch goes well
As long as its eaten with proper spell
Pronounced in thanks even in Israel.
Only the weak, it seems, despicable,
Avoid filling the gut with pork when full,
But the strong and holy leave lips unwiped
Glorying in the blood that drips when
hyped.

The heathen hero's been since Noah's time
The measure of all human song and rhyme.
Let me be no hero among the crew.

They shall observe it throughout their
Generations, so they be there
Supplicating on your behalf
With blood before the altar *staff*,

Every day and at morning time
 And evening they shall seek *in rhyme*
 Forgiveness on your behalf there
 Perpetually before YHWH's *share*
 That they may keep it and not be
 Rooted out *and eternally*.
 15 And He gave to Noah and his
 Sons a sign that there should not whiz
 Again a flood upon the earth.
 16 He set His bow in the cloud's *girth*
 For a sign of eternal worth
 In promise that there should not be
 Again a flood on earth *and sea*
 To destroy it all the earth's days.
 17 For this reason is ordained *praise*
 And written on celestial tablets,
 That they should celebrate *as habits*
 The feast of weeks in this month each
 Year, to renew the promise preached.
 18 And this whole festival was kept
 In heaven since creation leapt
 Until Noah's lifetime appears,
 Twenty-six jubilees and years
 Of five weeks [1309-1659 A.M.]: and
 Noah and his
 Sons observed it for seven, that is,
 Of jubilees, one week of years,
 Till day of Noah's death appears,
 And from the day of Noah's death
 His sons did away with *its breath*
 Until the days of Abraham,
 And they eat blood *as well as ham*.
 19 But Abraham observed it, and
 Isaac and Jacob *in the land*,
 And his children observed it up
 To your days, *with both plate and cup*.
 In your days Israel's folk forgot
 It till you feasted it in plot
 On this mountain. 20 And give command
 To the children of Israel's band
 To keep this festival in all
 Their generations for a ball,
 A commandment to them: one day
 In the year in this month shall they
 Observe the festival. 21 For it
 Is the feast of weeks and the fit
 Feast of first fruits: this feast is two,
 And of a double nature's view:
 22 According to what's written and
 Engraved concerning it, remand.
 For I have written in the book
 Of the first law, *and if you look*

In that which I wrote down for you,
 That You should celebrate it due
 In its season, one day a year,
 And I explained to you its gear
 In sacrifices that the folk
 Of Israel should remember *yoke*
 And should celebrate it throughout
 Their generations without doubt
 In this month, one day every year.
 23 And on the [first day to appear]
 Of the first month, and on the [first
 Day] of the fourth month, *not the worst*,
 And on the [first day] of the seventh
 Month, and the [first day, *not eleventh*]
 Of the tenth month are days to be
 Kept in remembrance, and to Me,
 And the days of the seasons in
 The four divisions of the year.
 These are written and ordained in
 Witness for ever *to appear*.

Though I bring Your name to remembrance
 each
 Breath of each day and night, and come to
 preach
 Your grace and word on every Sabbath
 day,
 I still find four gates waiting in the sway
 Of seasons in the four days that You set
 For the remembrance of Your name once
 met.
 The seasons all begin with one day taken
 From the middle of the sacred week shaken
 To come before You with the sweetest
 scent
 Of the soil and the air for what they meant.
 Beloved, the four divisions of the year
 Remind me to cast out all blame and fear
 And know that there is none to praise but
 You,
 And none enthroned outside Your care and
 view.

24 And Noah ordained them for him
 As feasts to generations *dim*
 For ever, so that they've become
 Thereby memorial to his sum.
 25 And on the [first day] of the first
 Month he was bidden *and not cursed*
 To make for himself an ark, and
 On that *day* the earth became *land*
 And dry again and he opened

The ark and saw the earth *and land*.
 26 And on the [first day] of the fourth
 Month the mouths of the depths gone forth
 In the abyss beneath were closed.
 And on the [first day] of exposed
 Seventh month all the mouths of these
 Abysses of the earth's *decrees*
 Were opened, and waters began
 To descend into them by plan.
 27 On the tenth month's first day the tops
 Of the mountains were seen *as knops*,
 And Noah was glad. 28 And because
 Of this account he ordained *laws*
 For himself as feasts to remember
 For ever, ordained every member.
 29 They placed them on the heavenly
 tablets,
 Each had thirteen weeks *in its habits*,
 From one to another *passed* their
 Memorial, from the first share
 To the second, and from the second
 To the third, and from the third *beckoned*
 To the fourth. 30 And all the days of
 The commandment *as given above*
 Will be fifty-two weeks of days,
 And *these will make* the year's *arrays*.
 So it's engraven and ordained
 On the celestial tablets *chained*.
 31 And there is no neglecting *this*
Commandment for a single *miss*
Of a year or from year to year.
 32 And command the folk of Israel
 That they observe the years as well
 According to this reckoning,
 Three hundred sixty-four days' *thing*,
 And *these* will constitute a year
 In full and they will not disturb
 Its time from its days and from *herb*
Of its feasts, for everything will
 Fall out in them according still
 To their witness, and they will not
 Leave out any day from the lot
 Nor disturb any feasts. 33 But if
 They do neglect and they are stiff
 Not to observe them according
 To His commandment, then they'll bring
 Disturbance on all their seasons
 And the years will be dislodged ones
 From this *order*, [and they'll disturb
 The seasons and the years will curb
 Dislodged] and they will neglect their
 Ordinances *given in share*.

34 And all Israel's folk will forget
 And will not find the path *as yet*
 Of the years, and will *soon* forget
 The first days of the months, and seasons,
 And Sabbaths and they'll leave their
 reasons
 As to the order of the years.
 35 For I know and from now appears
 I will declare it to you, and
 It's not devised by my own hand,
 For the book *lies* writ before me,
 And on the heavenly tablets' *tree*
 Division of days is ordained,
 Lest they forget the feasts *profaned*
 Of the covenant and walk by
 The feasts of the Gentiles and by
 Their error and their ignorance.
 36 For there will be those without sense
 Who will assuredly observe
 The moon, how *it* disturbs the seasons
 And comes in year to year to swerve
 Ten days too soon, *and for its reasons*.
 37 For this reason the years will come
 Upon them when they will in sum
 Disturb *the order*, and make false
 Day and abominable to waltz
 As day of testimony, and
 An unclean day a feast day *planned*,
 And they will confound all the days,
 The holy with the unclean *ways*,
 And unclean day with holy *praise*,
 For they'll go wrong as to months and
 Sabbaths and feasts and jubilees.
 38 For this reason I do command
 And testify to you decrees
 That You may testify to them,
 For after your death to condemn
 Your children will disturb *them*, so
 That they will not make the year go
 Three hundred sixty-four days only,
 And for this reason they will go
 Wrong as to the first days *and lonely*
 Of the months and seasons and *days*
Of Sabbaths and festivals *ways*,
 And they will eat all kinds of blood
 With all kinds of flesh *and such crud*.

So every church both Jewish, Christian and
 The Muslim ones, have failed to understand
 The calendar set forth first in Tawrat
 Confirmed in holy Qur'an and was not

Displaced by Your command, but by the
 lust
 Of those who usurp divine powers or must.
 The week is king of time and day by day
 The months come on the fourth in grand
 array,
 And then stay for the sixth day before
 going
 To the first in the third month's cycle,
 showing
 The seasons to be four and every week
 In every time in its own place to seek
 Remembrance of the Flood and Noah's
 game,
 Remembrance, O Belovèd, of Your name.

Week 18 Jubilees 7

1 And in the first year of the week
 Number seven [1317 A.M.], and in the
 peek
 Of this jubilee, Noah planted
 Vines on the mountain on which slanted
 The ark to rest, and named Lubar,
 One of Ararat's mountains far,
 And they produced fruit in the year
 Fourth, [1320 A.M.] and he saved their
 fruit *in tier*,
 And gathered it in this year in
 The seventh month. 2 And he made *thin*
 Grape juice of it and put it in
 A jar, and kept it until when
 The fifth year came, [1321 A.M.] on the
 first day,
 On the first day of first month's *pen*,
 And celebrated in joy's ray
 The day of this feast, 3 and he made
 A holocaust to YHWH, and stayed
 With one young ox and one ram too,
 And seven sheep, a year old due,
 And a kid of the goats, that he
 Might make atonement *for family*
 With them for himself and his sons.
 4 And he prepared the kid *with buns*
 First, and placed some of its blood on
 The flesh that was on altar drawn
 Which he had made, and all the fat
 He laid on the altar whereat
 He made burnt offering's sacrifice,
 And the ox and the ram and sheep,
 He laid all their flesh *there to keep*
 Upon the altar, *laid out nice*.

The first Nevruz may well have been
 established
 By Noah's feasting, or then re-established.
 He took the wine of ecstasy saved up
 From the prayers and feasts of the whole
 year's cup,
 And filled with gratitude and ecstasy
 Of the whole year, set up his altar free
 In sacrifice to make atonement for
 All of his family sitting at the door.
 Beloved, I see the days turn in their length
 And the year start to waken in its strength,
 Until the day and night in equal lays
 Sing eve and dawn and ever to Your praise,
 And then I too celebrate gratefully
 The abundances You have given me.

5 And he placed all their offerings there
 Mingled with oil upon its *share*,
 And afterwards he sprinkled grape
 Juice on the fire which *in its shape*
 He had already made upon
 The altar, and he placed *well drawn*
 The incense on the altar and
 Caused a sweet aroma to stand
 Ascending and acceptable
 Before YHWH his Alohim *full*.

I am the kid upon the hearth now slain,
 My toes are crossed, I've ceased to feel the
 pain,
 But whirling on the flames of ecstasy
 I send my little spark of soul set free
 Before Your face, its final resting place,
 To find in all creation's glow Your grace.
 I am the kid stretched out, flayed and
 unbroken,
 Tied to Your altar in love and its token.
 The breaths of prayer and praise rise up as
 spoken
 To Your fresh palaces gleaming and bright.
 The sips of wine have all been dipped and
 taken,
 The last breaths drawn before my soul
 awoken
 Beyond the veils, their shimmering gauze
 unshaken
 Before the speechless wonders of my sight.

6 And he rejoiced and drank of this
 Grape juice, he and his children's bliss.
 7 And it was evening, and he went

Into his tent, and being sent
 In “drunken” ecstasy he lay
 Down and slept, and was, *as they say*,
 Uncovered, *that is*, vulnerable,
 There in his tent and as he slept.
 8 And Ham saw Noah *as inept*,
 His father naked, so to say,
 Vulnerable there where he lay,
 And went out and told his two brothers
 Outside, *ridiculing the others*.

The world is made of Hams, indeed, I
 swear
 I find their ridiculing everywhere
 I turn in my whirling, I find their stare
 To slay the righteous with a wicked flare.
 Who should look with respect to father
 done
 Goes out to speak the ugly words in fun,
 To audiences under moon and sun.
 I see the strong set out to make his run.
 Beloved, I turn from wisdom and from
 state
 Of mind to find a gold and purple fate
 Waiting for me, although I arrive late.
 Beloved, I turn to You and Your revealing
 Beyond the veils of shifting thought and
 feeling
 To know the secret of ages concealing.

9 And Shem took his garment and rose,
 He and Japheth, and they *in rows*
 Placed the garment upon their shoulders
 And went backward avoiding boulders
 And covered up their father’s shame,
 With their faces in backward aim.
 10 And Noah awoke from his sleep
 And found out all his younger peep
 Had done to him, and cursed his son
 And said “Cursed be Canaan *as done*,
 An enslaved servant shall he be
 To his brothers.” 11 And he blessed Shem,
 And said “Blessed YHWH God of Shem
 be,
 And Canaan shall take servant’s hem
 Before him. 12 “Alohim shall make
 Japheth a large *and greater stake*,
 And Alohim shall abide in
 The dwelling of Shem, and the sin
 Of Canaan shall make him servant.”
 13 And Ham knew that his father’s rant
 Had cursed his younger son, and he

Was displeased at his father’s spree
 To curse his son. And so he parted
 From his father, *from where he started*,
 He and his sons with him, Cush and
 Mizraim, Put and Canaan’s band.

The younger son, Japheth, is placed once
 more
 In status and in blessing far before
 His elder brother. Genesis is riddled
 With stories telling how the elder fiddled
 And how the younger stood to take the
 gravy.
 Let this be lesson how to make the navy.
 Throughout the world one finds the mythic
 tale
 Told always with the point that must not
 fail,
 The etiology that comes in last
 Is the whole point of the prayer and the
 fast.
 It’s not the story, pun or glass of wine
 That’s the lesson and the final, punch line.
 The point is not the draught of Noah drunk,
 But why the younger swam, the elder sunk.

14 And he built for himself a city
 And called its name after the *witty*
 Name of his wife, *just take a look*,
 She’s called Ne’elatama’uk.
 15 And Japheth saw it, and became
 Envious of his brother’s *fame*,
 And he too built himself a city,
 And called its name, *which was a pity*,
 After the name of his wife *too*
 Whose name’s ‘Adatanes *true*.

The sacred books are mutilated for
 The fact they take no women on the score.
 The church fathers thought women crude
 and rude,
 And Rabbis also railed upon the brood
 And shut them behind screens, in balcony,
 While men recite in their hypocrisy
 Your law in homosexual harmony.
 But in the lovely Scriptures of the past,
 The ones that in blessed Axum came to
 last,
 The woman’s name and honour is replete,
 And even found upon the city’s seat
 In place of majesty and wealth and fame.
 Beloved, I would here reinstate Your name

In my heart, in my city, on my beat.

16 And Shem lived with his father Noah,
And he built a city *to show her*
Close to his father on the mount,
And he too called its name *and fount*
After the name of his wife's *gab*,
Known as Sedeqetelebab.

Please note, Beloved, how great and just
these men,
The sons of Noah are, as they again
And once more honour wife with ink and
pen.

Their own names are simple and rather
short,
As short as they can be and still cavort.
And yet they do not choose their names or
those

Of their sons after them that once arose.
They're willing to address the names that
tone

In syllables both difficult and grown
To lengths almost beyond the ken of man,
Who can think only one thing and in plan
And mind it for a moment. I should think
Sedeqetelebab enough to sink
The ship of any sentence on the brink.

17 And indeed these three cities are
Still there about near Mount Lubar,
Sedeqetelebab before
The mountain on its eastern door,
And Na'eltama'uk upon
The south *instead of on the dawn*,
'Adatan'eses towards the west.

I make the whirling circuit of the mount
And try to take the cities in account,
But like a man, have difficulty keeping
Their names in mind, for my mind is still
sleeping.

But as I whirl in honour of Your name,
Beloved, I come to mind them just the
same,

As I pass from the eastern door and run
Toward the south to find a warmer sun,
And turn west before turning back and
done,

I find about Mount Lubar what was won
In fragrance of true faith beyond the law.
I find a sweetness and not tooth and claw

Where You alone bear sway before my
awe.

All around Mount Lubar I find Your fame.

18 And these are the sons of Shem, *best*:
Elam, and Asshur, Arpachshad,
This *son* was born, *the first they had*,
Two years after the flood, and Lud,
And Aram. 19 The sons of *the good*
Japheth: Gomer and Magog and
Madaï and Javan, Tubal and
20 Meshech and Tiras: these are all
The sons *that came* at Noah's *call*.

The seven sons of Japheth plead their cause
Through all the weeks of years to hear
Your laws,

And all the weeks of ages to acquire
The knowledge of the sacred love's desire,
And all the weeks of days to find the root
Of love and faithfulness at Sabbath's boot.
The eldest son, the brave, Gomer, of all
The Celts progenitor to sacred call.

His sons were driven by the Scythian
throng

From their own lands to wander without
wrong

In sweet Bythinian coasts, but not for long
And scattered west and northward till the
sea

By Arran's shores stood sunlit full and free
Inviting ever westward refugee.

20 In the twenty-eighth jubilee [1324-1372
A.M.]

Noah began to enjoin fee
Upon his sons' sons ordinance
And commandment *to make them dance*,
And all the judgments that he knew,
And he exhorted all the crew
Of his sons to observe the right,
And cover the shame of their blight
Flesh, and to bless their Creator,
And honour father, mother *more*,
And love their neighbour, and to guard
Their souls from fornication's *shard*
And uncleanness, iniquity.

21 For owing to these three things, *see*,
Came the flood on the earth, namely,
Owing to the fornication
Which Watchers against law had done
A-whoring after daughters of

Men, and took themselves wives in love
Of all they chose: and so they made
Beginning of uncleanness *strayed*.

Good Noah told his sons to keep the right,
And mentioned each command writ in the
light
Of heavenly tablet, to cover their shame
And not bring dishonour upon the name
Of mother and father, and love the
neighbour,
And guard body and soul before the labour
Of uncleanness, and all iniquity.
As grandson of Noah, I too am free
To follow Your great law, Beloved, and be
A dweller in the tents of Shem unstrayed
Into the wicked ways that watchers made.
Beloved, I lay my loved obedience
In Noah's law, and keep the rhymed
immense
Cycle of all Sabbaths' eternity.

22 They produced sons the Naphidim,
And they were all unlike *in seam*,
And they devoured each another: and
The giants slew the Naphil, and
The Naphil slew the Eljo, and
The Eljo humankind, and man
Slew one another *as by plan*.
23 And every one sold himself to
Work iniquity *as though due*
And to shed much blood, and the earth
Was filled with iniquity's *dearth*.

Even today the great majority
Believe this thing and believe sincerely
That law and order and not anarchy
Require bloodshed, not living peacefully.
I know the thought does violence to all
That can be reason, but the judgement hall
Of earthly kings would have it be this way,
And so the rabble follow kingly sway.
But You and I know, my Beloved and true
That bloodshed only wrecks the earthly
dew,
And no cross on Golgotha can restore
The right mind and settle the divine score.
Beloved, both earth and heart are cleansed
alone
By peace and life, not death upon the stone.

24 And after this they sinned again

Against the beasts and birds *in fen*,
And all that moves and walks on earth:
And much blood was shed on the earth,
And every imagination
And desire of men were *to shun*
For vanity and always ill.
25 And YHWH destroyed all things that fill
The surface of the earth, because
Of wickedness of their deeds' *claws*,
And because of the blood which they
Had shed on earth He wiped away
Everything. 26 "And we were left, I
And you, my sons, and *under sky*
Everything that entered with us
Into the ark as populace.

One thing alone lifts humankind to height
Of a unique and soaring gifted flight.
The eagle has a better eye, the dog
A better nose, but a man's unique cog
Is the imagination. Witness song,
And novel, film, theatre, and the strong
Form and colours of art. Imagination
Is what gives humankind its magic station.
I seek You, my Beloved, in my elation
Through all the passages that reason wends
Until I break through veil with spire that
rends
Into the heights of holy space to view
Above all things Your face that never crew
Of flesh can see, remove evil anew.

And lo I see your works before
Me that you don't walk righteous score:
For in path of destruction you
Have begun to walk *not a few*,
And you are parting from the one
And from other, with envy done
Of one another, till it be
That you are not in harmony,
My sons, each with his brother. 27 "For
I see, and indeed demons more
Seductions have begun to roar
Against you and against your spawn,
And so I fear what's coming on
You, that after my death you'll shed
The blood of men upon earth's *bed*,
And that you, too, will be destroyed
From the face of the earth *employed*.
28 "For whoever sheds a man's blood,
And whoever eats of the blood
Of any flesh, shall be destroyed

From the earth. 29 “And there shall not be
Left any man that eats blood free,
Or that sheds the blood of man on
The earth, nor shall there be left drawn
To him any seed or descendants
Living under heaven *dependents*,
For into Sheol there they go,
And into the place of *the glow*
Of condemnation they’ll go down,
And into the dark and deep town
They shall all be removed by death
In violence *to take their breath*.

I weep, Beloved, to feel within my breast
That same attraction that swells without
rest
And cries for vengeance, bloody vengeance
poured
Upon the head of the great rapine horde
That rushes on the world in commerce
bent.
Without the killing, there’s no money lent.
Ah, my Beloved, I weep to see the day
Dawn with the red of slaughter on the way
Dealt out with the disarming argument
That without war there can let no peace
stay.
That rationale of paradox allows
The word to pass among the sacred cows,
And even my heart with that wrath
convinced
Returns for peace to sanity blood-rinsed.

30 There shall be no blood seen upon
You of all the blood there withdrawn
Shall be all the days in which you
Have killed any beasts or a few
Of cattle or whatever flies
Upon the earth *in the fowls’ guise*,
And work you a good work to your
Souls by covering that which you pour
On the face of the earth. 31 “And you
Shall not be like him who eats blood
With the flesh, but guard yourselves true
That none before you may eat blood.

The very priests that fool the folk adore
The wafer and the wine and when they
pour
The red wine in the cup they lift it high
And claim the blood with a blasphemous
cry.

Ah, my Beloved, let me not drink the blood
That has been poured on earth and since the
flood
Defiled the soil, the hand and heart of man
And woman with the heat of vengeance
plan.
Ah, my Beloved, let me not taste that wine
That brings life to the cell of gourd and
vine,
To eye and ear of every creeping thing,
To hand and heart of peasant, worker, king.
Ah, my Beloved, Creator of the flow
Let none stop what he cannot again show.

Cover the blood, for so I’ve been
Commanded to witness of sin
To you and your children, together
With all flesh *in whatever weather*.
32 “And don’t allow the soul to be
Eaten with the flesh *wickedly*,
That your blood, which is your life, may
Not be required at the hand’s stay
Of any flesh to shed on earth.
33 “For the earth *in all of its girth*
Will not be clean from the blood which
Has been shed there *flowing in ditch*,
For *only* through the blood of him
That shed it will the earth undim
Be purified throughout all ages.
34 “And now, my children, hear the stages,
Work judgment here and righteousness
That you may be given firm address
In righteousness in the whole world,
And your glory lifted unfurled
Before my God, who saved me from
The waters of the flood *to come*.

The flood saved Noah and his sons from
death
By violence that crested on the breath
Of humankind in ages past, and yet
Today there die thousands by the hand met
In violence each day and night that’s set.
You had him tell his sons to leave the cause
Of violence and to obey Your laws,
But in the dark of illusion and veils
In ignorance caught up as wisdom’s sails
His grandchildren set out to prove him right
As they lifted up hand and heart in spite.
Ah, my Beloved, pluck from its evil spore
All violence from my heart and its door.

I stand and wait before Your throne for
right.

35 “And indeed, you will go and build
For yourselves cities, and plant filled
In them all the plants on the earth,
And moreover all trees of worth
Bearing fruit. 36 “For three years the fruit
Of everything that’s eaten root
Will not be gathered: and then in
The fourth year its fruit in the bin
Will be accounted holy [and
They’ll offer the first-fruits *of land*],
Acceptable before the Most
High God, who created the host
Of heaven and earth and all things there.
Let them offer abundance fair,
The first of the grape juice and oil
As first-fruits on the altar’s soil
To YHWH, who receives it, and what
Is left let the servants who’re shut
In the house of YHWH eat before
The altar which receives *its store*.

Peace is done on the earth as each man
goes
To plant fruit trees for every one that shows
Upon the field in hunger to reach out
A hand and taste the sweetness of the stout.
Not swords but ploughshares goes angelic
song
To foster right and prevent all the wrong.
Beloved, I lay firm faith in planted tree
That bears the apple and the puckery
Persimmon, and the pear and peach and
plum
To grant us peace and love where we come
from.
I trust in wheat and measure of the nut,
The walnut filled with life and life unshut.
I witness to the bread and wine instead
Of blood of man and animal once shed.

37 “And in the fifth year make release
So that you release *its increase*
In righteousness and uprightness,
And you shall be righteous *to bless*,
And all that you plant shall prosper.
38 “For thus did Enoch, the father
Of your father command and his son
Methuselah, Methuselah
Commanded Lemech too his son,

And Lemech gave to me the law
Of all the things his fathers said
Commanding him. 39 “So I too spread
To you commandment, my sons, as
Enoch commanded his son as
In the first jubilees: whilst still
Living, the seventh in the bill
Of his generation, he said
Commanding, testifying, read
To his son and his son’s sons *fed*
Until his death’s day *by his will*. ”

The silsila of Enoch marks the spot
Where You, Beloved, continue with the
taught.

I sit at Enoch’s feet and find Your word
Sung sweetly like the nightingale once
heard.

The chain of that transmission echoes still
Around the world on every plain and hill,
And hangs there for the grasping of the ear
For everyone whose heart has shed its fear
To take Your loving soul and sacrifice
The darkness grasping on the fire and ice.
Beloved, I sip the words, I fill my soul
With messages that never take their toll,
But ripen with the date and grape and nut
To find no gates of glory have been shut.

Jubilees 8

1 In the twenty-ninth jubilee,
In the first week, [1373 A.M.] and in the
free
Beginning of it Arpachshad
Took him a wife, the name she had
Was Rasu’eja, Susan’s daughter,
The daughter of Elam *who brought her*,
And she bore him a son upon
The third year in this week, [1375 A.M.] *as*
spawn
And he called his name Kainan’s *lad*.

The patriarchal genealogies
Make think there are no other things but
these.
So many writers who wrote down Your
word
Remembered only males for the absurd.
The truth is every man has also mother,
And there is sister found for every brother.
This little genealogy found here

Makes everything else written much more
clear.

There is a genealogy of sons
And fathers decked out dashing in home-
runs.

But there is also genealogy
Of mothers down through daughters that
we see.

You did not make, Beloved, the world
alone

For men's but also women's breeding zone.

2 As the son grew, his father taught
Him writing, and he went a spot
To seek himself a place where he
Might seize for himself a city.

3 And he found a writing there which
Former *generations* in switch
Had carved on the rock, and he read
What was on it, and he was led
To transcribe it and sinned thereby,
For it contained the teaching *sly*
Of the Watchers in accordance
With which they used to *enter trance*
To observe omens of the sun
And moon and stars of every run
In all the signs of heaven *done*.

4 And he wrote it down and said naught
About it, for he was in thought
Afraid to speak to Noah such,
Lest he be angry with his touch.

The watchers' burden still is found
inscribed

On stone and lichen, in the faith imbibed
With every sort of heathendom and fair
To which one must show tolerance, declare
All things having right to place under sun.
But do not tell Noah what thing is done.
The secret writing, whispered spell, the slip
Of herb and root, arm akimbo on hip,
To slay the unwary with word on lip,
Ah, my Beloved, keep from my mind and
trip.

The omens of the sky are clear to see
And draw all men to folly faithfully,
But let my soul come to Your heart and flee
From my self and the ways of fiery ship.

5 And in the thirtieth jubilee, [1429 A.M.]
In the second week, in the *wee*
First year of it, he took a wife,

And her name was Melka *for strife*,
The daughter of Madai, the son
Of Japheth, and in the fourth *run*
Of the year [1432 A.M.] he produced a son,
And called his name Shelah, he said
"Truly I have been sent *as led*."

6 [And in the fourth year he was born],
And Shelah grew up *without scorn*
And took himself a wife whose name
Was Mu'ak, daughter *without blame*
Of Kesed, his father's brother,
In the thirty-first jubilee,
In the fifth week, in the first year
That came upon earth to appear. [1499
A.M.]

An extra generation comes in here
That was not found in Genesis, I fear.
Expunged no doubt because he did not tell
Noah the secret of the root and spell
That he found struck upon the written rock.
But Noah brought the ark safe into dock,
So he should be able to survive talk
Of witch and warlock when great
grandsons balk.

Beloved, how many seek in lapses done
By human pen and heart under the sun
Excuse to set aside Your word for fun.
Let me not enter in the camp of those
Who quibble at the magic or the throes.
Each reaps indeed the sprout of hopes he
sows.

7 And she bore him a son in that
Week's fifth year [1503 A.M.], and *from*
where he sat

He called his name Eber: he took
Unto himself a wife, and *look*
Her name was 'Azurad, the daughter
Of Nebrod, *when he went and sought her*,
In thirty-second jubilee,
In the seventh week, in the third
Year of it he was undeterred. [1564 A.M.]

8 And in the sixth year [1567 A.M.] of it,
she

Bore him a son, he called his name
Peleg, for in days *without shame*
When he was born Noah's spawn came
To divide earth among themselves:
For this reason *and not for elves*,
He called him Peleg. 9 Secretly
They divided *it* the barony

Among them, told Noah *the game*.

Division of the earth, Beloved, was made
Showing the instinct in human heart stayed
To territorial. That instinct lies
Upon a sense of justice that is wise,
And gives each one a place beneath the
sun.

The instinct to grasp and to overrun
Is no doubt just a curving of the true
In on the self, the same curving in view
Where self forgets that every self is due
To Self, O my Beloved, alone that's You.
Divide the earth again to give estate
To bird and beast and human being's fate,
And all can live reflecting beyond dream
What You are indeed and not what You
seem.

10 And it happened in the beginning
Of thirty-third jubilee's *inning* [1569 A.M.]
That they divided up the earth
Into three parts, one for Shem's worth,
And for Ham and Japheth *one each*,
According to heritage reach,
In the first year in the first week,
When one of us who'd been to seek,
Was with them. 11 And he called his sons,
And they came near him *on their buns*,
They and their children, and he set
The earth divided into lots,
Which his three sons took as their plots,
And they reached out their hands to take
The writ from Noah's bosom's wake,
Noah their father. 12 And there came
Forth on the writing to Shem's name
The lot in the middle of earth
Which he should take as plot in worth
For himself and for his sons in
Their generations to begin
And to eternity *to win*,
From the middle of mountain range
Of Rafa, from the mouth's exchange
Of water from the river Tina,
And his portion goes towards the *finer*
West through the middle of this stream,
And it extends up to the scene
Of the water of the abyss,
Out of which this river *to kiss*
Goes out and pours its waters in
The sea of Me'at, and this stream
Flows into the great sea *a-gleam*.

Identify for me, Beloved, the names
Of the mountains and rivers in Shem's
claims.

I do not find them marked upon the map,
Although I search the middle of the flap.
Divide Your heart, Beloved, among the
three

And give the middle part to Shem and me,
And I shall dwell forever in the lea
Of Your mercy and justice without blames.
Beloved, I look out on the sea's abyss
From where the mountains of the Jordan
kiss

The purple sky, and see the skirts descend
Upon the land that Shem gave out to fend.
Division's yet a burning question here,
Which still shows how men's hearts lie in
Your fear.

And all that is towards the side
Of the north is Japheth's *betide*,
And all that is towards the south
Belongs to Shem, *both foot and mouth*.
13 And it extends till it comes to
Karaso: in the heart and crew
Which looks towards the southland *dew*.
14 And his portion extends along
The great sea, and it goes out *strong*
In a straight line till it comes to
The west of the tongue which looks true
South: for indeed this sea is named
The tongue of Egypt's Sea *and framed*.

I ride upon the north side of the dam
Where snows in winter are the oriflamme
Of day filled with the night. In Japheth's
land

I breathe his air and eat the contraband.
For who knows in this day whose blood
flows free

In veins taught to wander unceasingly?
Shem and Japheth unite perhaps to be
Two fathers of one soul that faithfully
Would find Your law written on human
heart

No matter who the father at the start.
And so with tongue of Japheth and the
glow

Of Shem I meet the days and years below
Punctuated with Sabbaths set among
The sons of Noah for each ready tongue.

15 And it turns from here towards the
south,
Towards the shore of the great sea's mouth,
And goes to the west to 'Afra,
And till it reaches the éclat
Of river Gihon's *flashing* stream,
And to the south *as it would seem*
Of the waters of Gihon, to
The banks of this river *and true*.

Gihon's a stream known to the blessed
word
Of Genesis, a stream that has me stirred
In the dance of the wandering human herd
That in its slow gyrations east and west
Makes out a whirl of worship of the best.
Gihon turns in the way of blessedness
While still leaving the soul to dance and
guess,
Relying on Your heart alone to know
The ways upon the desert earth to go.
I follow the four streams to the four gates
Where blessedness at last and middle waits
And find the day and night to make the
show
With rising, falling curtains on the plates,
And wandering among the jeweled estates.

16 And it extends towards the east,
Until it reaches Eden's feast,
To the south of it, and from there
To the whole land of Eden's share
In the east, it turns to the east
And proceeds till it reaches east
Of the mountain named Rafa, and
It descends into the bank land
Of the mouth of the river Tina.

17 This portion came out by lot *finer*
For Shem and his sons, that they should
Possess it for ever and would
In his generations to be
For ever and eternally.

The man who whirls today upon the earth
May find the desert dry and parched with
dearth,
And see the running to and fro to find
The bread of life taken up from the blind
In famine as Amos once prophesied.
The man who whirls today may never hide,
But on the sterile plain and countryside

May find where his footsteps touched earth
in pride
That the bright Word again as streams
afresh
In chains of gold and diamonds feet
enmesh
To tinkle with the angels' voices on
The jewelled marches of the coming dawn.
Beloved, I cantillate the ancient Word
With running feet and with heart once more
stirred.

18 And Noah rejoiced that this plot
Fell to Shem and his sons *a jot*,
And he remembered all that he
Had spoken in his prophecy,
For his mouth had said 'Blessèd be
YHWH God of Shem and may YHWH stay
In the dwelling of Shem *and way*.'

Of three sons one is always better set
To hear his father's favour and to get
The love and the devotion of the one
Who bore him, there's always a favourite
son.
The best-loved gets the better lot in life,
The best-loved lives to learn fraternal strife
Must be his lot. Beloved, do You share this
Way of relating with a hug and kiss?
Perhaps You do, for life is never fair.
We get what we grasp from the other's
ware,
Or remain without our own needed share.
The preachers tell us yet the ones who find
Wealth are truly blessed by You for their
kind.
They are unblessed whose cupboards
remain bare.

19 He knew that Eden's garden was
The holy of holies, and was
The dwelling-place of YHWH, and Mount
Sinai the centre of the fount
Of desert, and Mount Zion yet
The navel of the earth well set:
These three were created to be
Holy places set facingly.

The navel of the earth is Zion's hill.
When I was there I felt no special thrill.
It is not certain really where Sinai

Stands, several mountains have a claim to
vie.

And even less certain is Eden's grove.
It could be Gerizim or Mecca's stove.

This holy Trinity in time and place
Is Your gift to the entire human race
Who turn in time and whirl to find Your
face

And find it where You bless with gear and
grace.

The fourth hill is the sacred one that's
found

Beside the hearth and on the holy ground
Of every threshold that is raised in air.
I open doors and every time You're there.

20 And he blessed the God of gods, who
Had put in his mouth word of YHWH,
And YHWH for evermore. 21 And he
Knew that a blessed portion *free*
And a blessing had come to Shem
And to his sons unto the sway
Of many generations' day,
The whole land of Eden and more,
The whole land of the Red Sea shore,
The whole land of the east in store
And India, and on the Red
Sea and the mountains of it spread,
And all the land of Bashan, and
All the land of Lebanon's *strand*
And the islands of Kaftur, and
All the mountains of Sanir and
'Amana, and the mountains of
Asshur in the north, and *for love*
All the land of Elam, Asshur,
And Babel, and Susan and *pure*
Ma'edai, all the mountains of
Ararat, all the space beyond
The sea, and that which is beyond
The mountains of Asshur toward
The north, a blessed and spacious sward,
And all that's in it's very good.
22 And for Ham came forth as it should
The second portion, beyond where
The Gihon towards the south *in share*
Stands to the right of Eden fair,
And it extends towards the south
And it goes to all fiery mouth
Of the mountains, and it extends
Towards the west and to where bends
The sea of 'Atel and extends
Towards the west until it reach

The sea of Ma'uk, on that beach
Into which all things not destroyed
Descend. 23 And it goes and employed
Towards the north and to the edge
Of Gadir, and it goes in pledge
Out to the coastlines of the sea
To the waters of the great sea
Till it draws near Gihon's stream there,
And goes along the river's share
Of Gihon till it reach the right
Of the Garden of Eden's *sight*.
24 And this is the land which fell to
Ham as the portion he was due
To occupy for ever, he
And his sons after him *for free*
Unto their generations' *fee*
From then on and eternally.

To every son is given land of wealth
Despite the difference in ruth and stealth.
Though I may be a son without the show,
I still reflect Your image on the go
And deserve with the rest a faithful place
Of beauty under sun, and full of grace.
Beloved, all men share equally in You
Despite inequity of earthly view,
And all for spite are filled with glory so
That none are left behind in rarity.
The bright and certain stones of human
heart
Are polished perfectly to claim their part.
The prayer and sacrifice in purity
Wipe clean the slate and show the lightning
start.

25 And for Japheth came out the third
Portion beyond the river *spurred*,
The river Tina and toward
The north of the outflow that poured
With its waters, and it extends
Northeasterly to all the ends
Of Gog, and to all of *the trace*
Of the country east of its face.
26 And it extends northerly to
The north, and so it extends to
The mountains of Qelt towards the way
Of the north, and towards the *spray*
Of the sea of Ma'uk, and goes
Out to the east of Gadir's *rows*
As far as the place by which flows
The water of the sea. 27 And it
Extends until it comes to sit

In the west of Fara and it
 Returns towards 'Aferag, and
 It extends easterly to stand
 At the waters of Me'at's sea.
 28 And it extends to the place free
 Of the river Tina to be
 In a northeasterly way till
 It nears the boundary of the fill
 Of its waters towards the mount
 Rafa, and it turns round *to count*
 Towards the north. 29 This is the land
 Which fell to Japheth's plot *and hand*
 And to his sons as heritage
 And possession from age to age,
 Five great islands, and a great land
 In the north. 30 But it's a cold strand,
 And the land of Ham, it is hot,
 And the land of Shem in his plot
 Is neither hot nor cold, but it's
 A mix of cold and heat as fits.

Although three sacred sites are given Shem
 When there should have been one for each
 of them,
 Eden and Sinai join Jerusalem
 In one great heritage and polished gem,
 Still Japheth's store is bright, it is the best
 For us who look toward the north and west.
 Beloved, I love the velvet winter night
 With snow and ice and sky veils glowing
 bright,
 I love the tundra with its vast emotions
 Turbulent stretching as far as its oceans.
 I love the midnight sun, I love the toil
 Immoderate that weakens at the foil
 And sleeps when fire of leaf meets on the
 soil
 Of autumn. My Beloved, I love the sight.

Week 19 Jubilees 9

1 Ham divided among his sons,
 And the first portion fell *in tonnes*
 To Cush towards the east, and to
 The west of him *the land would do*
 For Mizraim, and to the west
 Of him for Put *some of the best*,
 And to the west of him upon
 The sea for Canaan. 2 To Shem's spawn
 He also divided the share,
 And the first portion, the most fair,
 Fell to Elam and his sons there
 To the east of the flowing stream

Of Tigris till it reach the beam
 Of the east, the whole land that's called
 India, and upon the *bald*
 Red Sea coast, and the waters of
 Dedan, and all the hills above
 Of Mebri and Ela, and all
 The land of Susan and the haul
 That is on the side of Pharnak
 To the Red Sea as far as slack
 Of the river Tina. 3 And to
 Asshur fell the second of due
 Portions: all the land of Asshur
 And Nineveh and Shinar *pure*
 And to India's borderland,
 And it ascends and skirts the band
 Of the river. 4 To Arpachshad
 Fell the third portion *to make glad*,
 All the land of the Chaldees' *states*
 To the east of Euphrates' *rates*,
 To border on the Red Sea side,
 And all the waters of the tide
 Toward the desert close beside
 The tongue of the sea which looks on
 Egypt, all land of Lebanon
 And Sanir and 'Amana to
 The border of Euphrates' *crew*.
 5 And to Aram there fell the fourth
 Portion, all the land to come forth
 From Mesopotamia's coast
 Between the Tigris and *the boast*
 Of the Euphrates to the side
 Of north of the Chaldeans' *pride*
 To the frontier of Asshur's hills
 And the land of 'Arara's *rills*.

Ham divided the earth in four for those
 Four sons that came from him and who
 arose
 To tread the earth from gate to gate in
 throes
 Of ecstasy before Your name, Beloved.
 Shem likewise split his heritage in four
 To give to his sons at the dancing door,
 With names, towns, rivers all to keep the
 score
 While whirling on the sand with hand
 ungloved.
 I too lift empty hands to find Your grace
 As I turn day to day from trace to trace
 To find oases in the desert race.
 I too reach out to grasp the shining sum
 Of mercy that from the high air has come

To kiss the earth where I am deaf and
dumb.

6 And there fell to Lud the fifth portion,
The mountains of Asshur's proportion
And all belonging to them till
It comes down to the Great Sea's *spill*,
And till it reaches Asshur's east
Which is his brother *not the least*.

Shem had a fifth son, to whom he gave
power

To reach to Asshur in a blessed hour.
If there are four gates for the whirling high,
There are five books given to Moses nigh,
And five of Psalms, and five in Matthew's
rate

To make the Gospel plain, the meaning
straight.

So blessedness goes further than the law,
And dancing to the tune You pipe in claw
Is not the end of human life and draw.
Beloved, I grasp at the five golden links
That come from Your oneness upon the
rinks.

Your justice moves beyond law and
reproves

The prophetless, unguided in their grooves
Till all return to that One Face in awe.

7 And Japheth also divided
The land of his inherited
Among his sons. 8 And the first plot
Fell to Gomer to the east lot
From the north side to Tina's stream,
And in the north there came the dream
Of Magog all the inner parts
Of the north until it upstarts
To the sea of Me'at. 9 And to
Madai fell as his portion due
That he should possess from the west
Of his two brothers to invest
The islands, and to the coasts of
The islands. 10 And to Javan's love
Fell the fourth portion every isle
And the islands which rank and file
Are towards the border of Lud's *land*,
A portion for Javan's whole band.

Japheth turns in four gates and is not
moved

By jealousies or the sun's heat that proved

A bait to war among the sons of Ham
And Shem until the time of Abraham.
It's centuries before his flock grows great
Upon the battlefield to move in hate.
He fears nor ice nor snow, nor bears'
retreat.

There is no place forbidden to his feet.
I fly with father Japheth circling high
To look upon the islands where they vie
With sea for beauty and with sun for sheen.
Where there is love, there he and I are seen.
The rule is war and hate rise from a bed
Of love and beauty, so the warning's said.

11 And to Tubal there fell at last
The fifth portion *and unsurpassed*
In middle of the tongue which comes
Towards the border of the sums
Of Lud and to the second tongue,
To the region beyond the sung
Second tongue and unto the third.
12 And to Meshech there fell the word
Of the sixth portion, all the flat
Region beyond where third tongue sat
Till it comes to east of Gadir.

The Gadir is a wall, in early time
To keep intruder out of growing thyme
And date palm round oasis sung in rhyme,
But here I wonder where the place is found.
The Gadir is a wall, in later days
To keep the lovely inside gates of praise
Where scents are warm with stupifying
haze

Above the verdant fertile soil and ground.
Beloved, I seek the message of Gadir
And lay hold on the heart and hand of dear
Ali to find the blessing and the cheer
Of Your will sovereign before gate of gold.
I ride into the pilgrim camp as bold
And burning of heart as are others cold.

13 And for Tiras there fell sincere
The seventh portion, four great isles
In the middle of the sea's *smiles*,
Which reach to the portion of Ham
[And the islands of Kamaturi
Came out by lot for the sons' hurry
Of Arpachshad and for his dram].

Seven in all the veils come rushing down
To fill the windows of city and town

And shade the glade and thicket with the
brown
And soft, blind knowing of all things'
renown.
So seven sons hold on to seven veils
And set out to earth's bounds on their own
trails
Until horizons swallow up their sails.
The curtains scintillating with their gold
And silver broiders crimson with the bold
Sun of the west protect my single life
From hand of those succeeding in their
strife.
I settle by the hearth to hear their tales
While my soul wanders in the rising
smoke,
A spark to find You, Beloved, where You
spoke.

14 And thus the sons of Noah gave
Portions to their sons *good or knave*
In the presence of Noah their
Father, and he bound them to share
All by an oath, with curse on each
Who sought to seize the portion's *peach*
Which had not fallen to *his* share.
15 And they all said "So be it fair,"
For themselves and their sons ever
Throughout their generations till
The day of judgement *bring the bill*,
On which YHWH Alohims shall judge
Them with a sword and with a smudge
Of fire for all unclean and ill
Of their errors, wherewith they fill
The earth with wickedness and gross
Uncleanness, fornication's *dose*
And sin *on every plain and hill*.

Judge me not for my lust, Beloved, since
You
Created lust to keep coming in view
The generations of the world in due.
Judge me not for my violence since it
Is product of my wisdom and my wit
In knowing I am divine in my fit.
Judge me not for my greed, Beloved, since
greed
Maintains the borders of each field in seed
And fills the earth with every human need.
But judge me that my lust and violence
And greed are turned to other signs and
cents

Than toward You where my love only
relents.
Beloved, make strong my lust and cruelty
To rush in greed to You and thus be free.

Jubilees 10

1 And in this jubilee's third week [1583
A.M.]

The unclean demons start to seek
To lead astray Noah's sons' spawn,
And make them err *from dark to dawn*.

2 And the sons of Noah came to
Noah their father telling true
What the demons were doing to
Their children leading astray and
Blinding and slaying his sons' sons.

3 He prayed before YHWH's benisons,
His God, and said "God of the spirit
Of all flesh, who have shown or near it
Mercy unto me and saved me
And my sons from the waters' spree
Of the flood, and have not caused me
To perish as You did the sons
Of perdition *and other ones*,
For Your grace has been great toward
Me, and has been great on the sward
Your loving mercy to my soul,
Let Your grace be lifted, extol
Upon my sons, and let not those
Wicked spirits on them who rose
Rule over them, lest they destroy
Them from the earth *that they enjoy*.

As I draw near to You, Beloved, I see
More and more things in the earth about me
That seem to be the decoration of
My own heart and the object of my love.
My heart encloses the dark firs above
My windowed soul, and turns to take the
track

Of hare at my doorstep behind my back
Into the fold of me. I faithfully
Whirl in the darkened place of winter's
race

And everywhere I turn I find Your face
Enthroned upon the granite stool that grows
Up in my heart. If demons fill the throes
Of my world with their stinging
counterpart,

Lend them their flight before Your winging
dart.

4 “But bless me and my sons, that we
May increase and multiply free
And fill the earth *to its degree*.
5 “And You know how Your Watchers,

and
The fathers of these spirits planned,
Acted in my day: and as for
These spirits which are living *store*,
Imprison them and hold them fast
In condemnation’s place at last,
And let them not bring destruction
On your servant’s *daughter and son*,
My God, for these are malignant,
And created as sycophant.

Your prophet and divine guide prays a
prayer
And with it chains the dragons in their lair,
And overwhelms the darkness with the
light.
And yet the winter darkness in my plight
Is like a tender friend. We do not fight.
Moss covers the stones that hide ancient
lore
Of Watchers’ sons who once read up the
score,
But now are long since banned to their own
shore.
Yet their tales of magic and herbal store
Still strike a chord resounding in the soul
Of humans out to find and get the goal.
The earth groans and uprising sends them
out
To deal death on the people round about.
Listen once more to Noah’s prayer and
stout.

6 “And let them not rule over those
Spirits of the living *You chose*,
For You alone can exercise
Dominion over them *in size*.
And let them not have power upon
The sons of the righteous in spawn
From henceforth and for evermore.”
7 And YHWH our God commanded store
To bind them all. 8 And for the chief
Of the spirits, Mastema’s *grief*,
Came and said “Lord, Creator, let
Some of them stay before me set,
And let them hearken to my voice,
And do all I shall say for choice,
For if some are not left to me,

I shall not be able freely
To execute my power of will
On sons of men, for these are still
For corruption, leading astray
Before my judgment mankind’s way,
For great indeed is wickedness
Of the sons of men *whom You bless*.”
9 And He said “Let the tenth part stay
Before him, and let nine parts fall
Into the condemnation hall.”

You hear the chief of demons’ prayer and
so,
Beloved, hear mine and bless me where I
show
Weakness to do Your will, even to know.
One in ten of the evil ones still roam
The glades and streets that humankind calls
home,
And one in ten still capture hearts and
powers
To work destruction on the goodly flowers.
Beloved, I flee the lukewarm, tight morass
And rush into the dry and whispering grass
To find, Beloved, the footsteps where You
pass.
Though nine in ten are throttled in abode
Of silence, my heart still lifts up a load
Of wrong for You to brush away with song.
I sing Your name and praises all day long.

10 And one of us He commanded
That we should teach Noah and bid
Of all their medicines, for He
Knew they would not walk uprightly,
Nor strive in righteousness. 11 And we
Did according to all His words:
All the malignant evil *birds*
We bound in condemnation’s *thrall*
12 And a tenth part of them *in stall*
We left that they might be subject
Before Satan on earth’s *elect*.

The place of the accuser is defined
And limited with most of him confined.
If it were not so, all men should be fair
And live rejoicing in the lawful air.
The human heart is not deceitful where
It is set free from blindness and decree.
The human soul is dwelling place and free
Of Your own constant knowing what You
are,

Creator of the world and sun and star.
Without accuser human minds return
Again and ever to the flame to burn
In love and praise to Your name, and to
spurn
The evil way of veils and darkneses.
I turn within where Your love always is.

And we explained to Noah all
The medicines of their ills' call,
Together with their seductions,
How he might heal them and their buns
With herbs of the earth. 13 Noah wrote
Down all things in a book *to tote*
As we instructed him on each
Kind of medicine *that's in reach*.
Thus the evil spirits were kept
From *hurting* sons of Noah *ept*.

I thank You, my Beloved, that in the way
Of forest and meadow there is a ray
Of healing for the soul and body done
To illness by the evil on the run.
What watcher's son has left the words
allowed
To help the human hand and wailing crowd
Works by Your will above the thickened
cloud
That shines with rainbows round a holy
hill.
To trace the magic meadow is Your will.
And so I take a dibble stick to fill
A basket with a train of spirit friends
Whose fragrant breath the human heart
defends.
The incense of the spouting, dank recess
In secret rises to befriend, caress.

14 And he gave all that he had written
To Shem, his eldest son *unsmitten*,
For he loved him exceedingly
Above all the sons on his *tree*.
15 And Noah slept with his fathers,
And was buried on Mount Lubar's
In the land of Ararat. 16 Nine
Hundred and fifty years in fine
He finished in his life, nineteen
Jubilees and two weeks *and keen*
And five years. [1659 A.M.] 17 And in his
life on
Earth he excelled all human spawn
Save Enoch for his righteousness,

Wherein he was perfect *to bless*.

Noah and Enoch still show me the way
To righteousness, despite my mind to play.
Though Noah sleeps and Enoch makes his
stay
In the celestial secrets of a day,
I find the words of both guiding my steps
Along the corridors that know their reps.
Beloved, bless Enoch on his daily round
And Noah as he sleeps beneath the ground,
And in Your blessing of the prophet sound
Remember me too where I may be found.
Grant me the crown above my creeping
lust,
And turn my greed and cruelty to dust,
And I shall live to praise Your name as
must
All who return to Your face with a crust.

For Enoch's office was ordained
For a witness to the *maintained*
Generations of *all* the world,
So he should recount the unfurled
Deeds of generation unto
Generation, till the day due
Of judgement. 18 In the thirty-third
Jubilee, in the first year's word [1577
A.M.]

In second week, Peleg took wife,
Whose name was Lomna *without strife*
The daughter of Sina'ar, and
She bore to him a son *in hand*
In the fourth year come of this week, [1580
A.M.]
And he called his name Reu *the meek*,
For he said 'Indeed humankind
Have become evil through the mind
Of wickedness to build themselves
A city and a tower *for elves*
In the land of Shinar.' 19 For they
Departed from Ararat's way
Eastward to Shinar, for in his
Days they built the city, *that is*,
And the tower, saying "Go to, let
Us ascend by it for to get
Into heaven." 20 And they began
To build, and in the fourth week's *ban*
They made brick with fire, and the bricks
Served them for stone, and clay for sticks
With which they cemented them fast
Together was asphalt which last

Comes out of the sea, and out of
The fountains of water *to shove*
In the land of Shinar. 21 And they
Built it: forty and three years' day [1645-
1688 A.M.]

They were a-building it, as wide
As two hundred and three bricks' side,
And the height *of a brick* was one
Third of its length, its height when done
Came to five thousand four hundred
Thirty-three cubits and two palms,
And *the extent of one wall read*
Was thirteen stadia *without qualms*
And of the other thirty more
Stadia. 22 And YHWH our God *in store*
Said to us, "Indeed, they are one
People, and look what they have done,
And now nothing will keep them from
Doing what they intend *in sum*."

Lomna's son saw how the tower should be
built
And clucked in disgust for the settling silt,
Faithful to the tune that his mother taught,
That righteousness and safety are not
bought,
But earned with love and care upon the
soil,
And stored up over years of faithful toil.
One cannot climb the stairs to heaven to
find
A refuge from the awful and the blind.
The thin and lawful air, though unconfined,
Is not the place of truth, but soil beneath
The foot of him who brings freshly a
wreath
To Eden's gate and, struck through by the
sword
Turning in hand of cherubim adored,
Finds in You on earth the eternal Lord.

Go to, let us go down and mix
Their language, that they may not fix
An understanding on the speech
Of one another *beyond reach*,
And they may be dispersed into
Cities and nations, what they do
Will not remain one purpose true,
Until the day of judgement due."
23 And YHWH descended, and we came
With Him to see the city's *blame*
And the tower which children of men

Had built. 24 And he confounded then
Their language, and they could no more
Understand one another's *store*
Of speech, and they ceased then to build
The city and the tower *spilled*.
25 For this reason the whole land of
Shinar is called Babel *for love*,
Because YHWH there confounded all
The language of humankind's stall,
And from there they were dispersed all
Into their cities, each one by
His language and his nation's *cry*.

With twenty tongues, Beloved, I praise
Your name,
And in all languages I praise the same.
The perfect, crystal of eternal speech
You shattered, scattered like sand on the
beach,

To make the thousands of languages that
Bless earth today with wisdom, light and
fat.

But above all I come each day to pray
In that speech that made up creation's day,
And take upon my tongue the sacred word
That calls to being hare and mouse and
bird.

The rustling of the sacred law commends
Your speech to both my enemies and
friends

Who sigh upon the air invisibly,
Their wings outspread and barely grazing
me.

26 And YHWH sent a mighty wind on
The tower and overthrew it gone
Upon the earth, and indeed it
Was between Asshur and the fit
Babylon in land of Shinar,
And they called its name 'Overthrow'.
27 In the fourth week in the first row
Year [1688 A.M.] in the start *and in the*
star

Of it in the thirty-fourth free
Jubilee, they went out sadly
From the land of Shinar *to be*.
28 And Ham and his sons went into
The land in which he had his pew,
Which he acquired to be his plot
In the land of the south *as taught*.

Ham and his sons remain in hesitation

To see what would become of Shinar's
 nation,
 And at its overthrow at last they left
 To find the hot lands which to them were
 cleft.
 The tower of Shinar may be folded now
 In hidden sands unknown to human brow,
 But the spirit to rise in glass and steel
 Is still biting the human heart and heel.
 What wind or earthquake unleashed by the
 reel
 Of Mastema upon the quaking heads
 Of humankind a-sleeping in their beds
 Is something that since then we do not fail
 To know to our own hurt and with a wail.
 Beloved, keep the ship on an even keel.

29 And Canaan saw Lebanon's land
 To the river of Egypt's strand,
 That it was very good, and he
 Did not go into the land's fee
 Of his inheritance to west
 Of the sea, and he lived in best
 Of the land of Lebanon, east
 And westward from the border pieced
 Of Jordan and the sea's frontier.
 30 And Ham, his father *without fear*,
 And Cush and Mizraim his brothers
 Said to him, "You have settled others'
 Land which is not yours, and which did
 Not fall to us by lot *as bid*:
 Do not do so, for if you do,
 You and your sons will fall *in crew*
 In the land and *be* accursed through
 Sedition, by sedition you
 Have settled, and by sedition
 Will your children fall *to a son*,
 And you'll be rooted out for ever.
 31 "Do not live *thinking you are clever*
 In the dwelling of Shem, to Shem
 And to his sons it came to them
 By their lot. 32 "Cursed are you, and
 cursed
 Shall you be beyond all the worst
 Sons of Noah, by the curse by
 Which we bound ourselves, the oath by
 Which in the holy judge's eye
 We bound ourselves in presence of
 Noah our father *and his love*."

You do not accept conquest of the land
 Nor even settling without Your command.

Then what has humankind done in the earth
 In all its peregrinations for worth?
 Perhaps the older settlement was wise
 And done according to Your kindly eyes,
 But what about the overrunning of
 The European continent with shove,
 And then their launching out to seek their
 fate
 Upon the whole world, on both small and
 great?
 In my veins runs the blood of many
 nations,
 So where may I stand to find my own
 stations?
 Beloved, bereaved is all the world in what
 Canaan started to feed his growing gut.

And he did not listen to them,
 33 But lived in Lebanon's land's hem
 From Hamath to the entering of
 Egypt, he and his sons above
 To this day. 34 And for this reason
 That land is also named Canaan.
 35 And Japheth and his sons went out
 Towards the sea and lived about
 In the land of their portion, and
 Madai saw the land of sea-sand
 And it did not please him, and he
 Begged a *portion* from Ham *in fee*
 And Asshur and Arpachshad who
 Was his wife's brother, and *in crew*
 He lived in the land of Media,
 Near his wife's kin, brother-in-law,
 Until this day. 36 And he called his
 Dwelling-place, and dwelling that is
 Of his sons, Media, by the name
 Of their father Madai of fame.

Beg and exchange land, it would seem to
 me
 That You accept that for eternity,
 And set the Medes to live upon the shore
 Without a seaport till they meet the score
 Of judgement day. The sun arises on
 My mornings of praise at the break of dawn
 To find me looking toward the Median
 light
 And wondering at the glories of the sight
 Of what lies here between. I see the sheen
 Of gold above the lake, I see the lean
 Web of the aspens and the darker load
 Of firs that blacken out the fiery goad.

Beloved, the earth is ranged out to my view
As I lay my breast closely upon You.

Week 20 Jubilees 11

1 In the thirty-fifth jubilee,
In the third week, the first year's glee [1681
A.M.],

Reu took to himself a wife,
And her name was 'Ora, the *rife*
Daughter of 'Ur, the son of Kesed,
And she bore to him a son *blessèd*,
And he called his name Seroh, in
The seventh year of this week's bin
In this jubilee. [1687 A.M.] 2 And the sons
Of Noah began to make runs
Of war on each other, to take
Captive and slay each other's stake,
And to shed blood of men on earth,
And to eat blood *as though in dearth*,
And to build strong cities, and walls,
And towers, and some *among the stalls*
Exalted themselves above nation,
And found kingdoms *for their elation*,
To go to war folk against folk,
And nation against nation's stroke,
And city against city, and
To do evil *upon the land*,
And to acquire arms, and to teach
Their sons to war, and they would reach
Out to capture cities, and sell
Male and female slaves *on the tell*.

Four gates of evil crush the folk that once
Stepped from the ark, gone out to play the
dunce.

The first portal of wickedness is war
To shed human blood and to gloat on gore.

The second portal is the wickedness
Of consuming the blood of beast and mess.
The third gate of evil is teaching arms
And strategies to create war's alarms.
The fourth gate of evil is in the taking
Of slaves both male and female for their
shaking.

Four ways there be to sell one's own soul
cheap

And founder in the obscure paths and deep
Of justifying evil ways to men,
Pretending to turn to You once again.

3 And 'Ur, the son of Kesed, built
The city of 'Ara *unspilt*

Of the Chaldees, and called its name
After his own name and the name
Of his father. 4 And so they made
For themselves molten images,
And they worshipped each idol *stayed*,
And all the molten images
Which they made themselves, and they
started

To make graven images arted
And unclean simulacra, and
Malignant spirits guided hand
Seducing *them* into committing
Transgression, uncleanness *unfitting*.

The four gates of evil are merely there,
Not only to wreck havoc on the fair,
But to replace Your worship with the glare
Of polytheistic idolatry.
Malignant spirits guide the hostelry
Of uncleanness, the unclean worship of
Gods and goddesses in temples of love.
Beloved, melt down the idols of my grove,
And cast their gold and silver in the trove
Of Your treasures and leave me naked, bare
To Your burning mercy. I climb the tree
That holds the earth together and I see
The whole world praising Your blessed
symmetry.

5 And the prince Mastema exerted
Himself to do all this, and flirted,
He sent out other spirits, those
Which were put under his hand's *throes*,
To do all kinds of wrong and sin,
All kinds of transgression within,
To corrupt and destroy, and to
Shed blood upon the earth *like dew*.

Disarming view expressed in every State
Is that violence is atoned by mate,
That two wrongs make a right, and the
blood shed

Of the enemy satisfies the bed
Left cold in death. Let me not rage upon
The veils that hide the glory of the dawn,
But speak a word of peace for the release
Of anger in the rules of the increase.
Beloved, there is one way alone to bring
The world to peace and that is make them
sing

The truth that there is not I but You only,

And that each man and woman is not
lonely,
But has within the breast that I alone
That can for violence in peace atone.

6 For this reason he called the name
Of Seroh, Serug, for *in blame*
Everyone turned to do all kinds
Of sin and transgression *and rinds*.
7 And he grew up, and lived in Ur
Of the Chaldees, near to the fer
Who was father of his wife's mother,
And he worshipped idols *and other*.

Serug, who might have been a harness-
maker,
A knitter of fine wool, plaited hair's raker,
Turns out instead to pervert his own name
To entanglements done for his shame.
Serug had all the chances to make good,
Living in the civilized, not in wood.
Instead he became entangled in web
Of idolatrous wisdom's flow and ebb.
Beloved, I cut off all the strings that tie
My blinded, veiled and unilluminated eye,
I cast away the bindings from my feet
And rush to You alone and to repeat
Your blessed names upon the silent air
That looks down on Ur's city in the glare.

And he took a wife *gratefully*
In the thirty-sixth jubilee,
In the fifth week, in the first year, [1744
A.M.]

And her name was Melka *for cheer*,
The daughter of Kaber, the daughter
Of his father's brother *who wrought her*.
8 And she bore him Nahor, the first
Year of this week, he grew *and versed*
And lived in Ur of the Chaldees,
And his father taught him degrees
Of the researches of Chaldees
To divine and augur, according
To the signs of heaven *uphoarding*.
9 In thirty-seventh jubilee
In the sixth week, in first *degree*
And year of it, [1800 A.M.] he took a wife,
And her name was 'Ijaska, *fife*
And 10 daughter of Nestag who was
Of the Chaldees *as Chaldee does*.
10 And she bore him Terah within

The seventh year of this week's *bin*. [1806
A.M.]

The faith of Ur is to divine the future,
And character whether of king or butcher.
To these two distractions from divine law
Our science has added as though in awe
The divination of the past as well
To see what evolution knows to spell.
And so three spells make up the trinity
Of the creed taught and followed in the
spree.

With divination tripartite in all
We try to do, Beloved, set up a wall
That veils reality from human eyes.
Then I shall flee to You in human guise.
I leave that trinity and trust alone
The Decalogue writ on my flesh and bone.

11 And the prince Mastema sent ravens
And birds to eat the seed *in havens*
Which was sown in the land, that they
Might destroy the land *in a day*,
And rob humankind of their labours.
Before they could plough without sabres
The seed, the ravens picked *it* from
The surface of the ground *in sum*.

What in the legal speech of land and State
Is called an act of God, by others fate,
Is action of Prince Mastema, who sends
The ravens of despoiling on both friends
And relatives of humankind. I trow
Catastrophes are still the what and how
That Mastema presents to fell and plough.
Who worship Mastema in divination
Are not exempt from princely convocation
That robs the farmer of his profit now
In floods and droughts and earthquakes for
the row.

Beloved, is there on earth no lowly station
Where humankind can find a refuge sure?
Your heart saves soul, if not the body's
cure.

12 For this reason he called his name
Terah because the ravens came
And the birds reduced them in fare
To destitution, no repair,
And devoured their seed *everywhere*.

The name of Terah indicates the song

That farmers turned to nomads for the
wrong
Done to them by the birds that ate their
fields.

That is not what investigation yields.
And yet the widening of desert shows
That may have an historical repose.
The destitution of the world is great
And often product of devourer's mate,
The weevil and the moth, the locust horde,
The crow and raven sent down by the lord,
All reduce humankind to gathering
What's left beside the oasis and spring.
You sent our humankind to till the earth,
Beloved, but not always with joy and mirth.

13 And the years began to be barren,
Because of the birds and their share in,
And they devoured all the fruit trees,
It was only with great degrees
Of effort that they could save some
Of all the fruit on earth to come
In their days. 14 And in jubilee
Thirty-nine, in second week's *fee*
In the first year, [1870 A.M.] Terah took
him

A wife, her name was 'Edna *trim*,
The daughter of 'Abram, the daughter
Of his father's sister *who brought her*.

Cross-cousin marriage is ideal sought
By agricultural peoples for plot,
Although a hunter also can be cast
Into marriage with relative to last.
The nomad often takes the parallel
As wife, which also casts a fateful spell
On the genetics of their progeny.
I wonder if Isaac was blemish free.
The whole lot seems to have trouble in
mating
Or at least in producing and relating
To children. Beloved, You who steer the
star
Are not bothered by such question by far
Who have no sons but by the miracle
That some obey Your word when they're
not full.

15 And in the seventh year of this
Week [1876 A.M.] she bore him a son to
kiss,
And he called his name Abram, by

Name of his mother's father's *try*,
For he had died before his daughter
Had conceived a son, *not by slaughter*.

So Abram was named after mother's father.
Since he was dead already, without bother
They could put the name to good use again.
The practice has come down to modern
men.

So many follow Abram's faith without
Knowing the origin of roundabout.
I too share in my mother's father's name
Given to me as second without shame,
Despite the brood of Georges one might
blame.

He too was farmer put off by the birds,
Luckless and jinxed, he thought, down to
his curds.

My cherry trees are also stripped of words.
Reality is made of one cloth piece
Stretched out from Ur and still without
release.

16 The child began to understand
The errors of the earth at hand
That all went astray after graven
Images and after their *craven*
Uncleanness, and his father taught
Him writing, and he was as ought
Two weeks of years old, [1890 A.M.] and
he went

To separate himself from vent
Of his father, that he might not
Worship idols with him *as taught*.

Bless Abram still, a little child who knew
That there was none to worship of the crew
Of heavenly signs and earthly banderlings,
Of things with arms or legs or tusks or
wings.

Bless Abram still, at fourteen years of age,
After he'd learned the writing on the page,
Went out alone to seek the true faith's stage
Alone since even relatives would wage
War against the worship of You that time.
I too live in a place of war and crime,
Where worship of You is turned into hate.
I too flee from the crowd and meet my fate
As hermit by the lake, beneath the hill.
Let me like Abram worship You here still.

17 And he began to pray Creator

Of all things that He might berater
Save him from the errors of men,
And that his portion should again
Not fall into error after
Uncleanness and vileness *for cur.*

Ah my Beloved, You may have heard the
prayer
Of Abram when he looked up in the air
And asked that You might bless his son and
heir
Not to partake of the idol's despair.
And yet the centuries have shown with pain
That most of them have rejoined pagan
plain,
Though many with the tongue admit Your
name.

Beloved, I turn my eyes and heart for
shame
To see Arab and Jew dismiss Your law,
The Decalogue, to render by the claw
A violence upon the golden land.
Stretch out, Beloved, again a helping hand,
And lead to peace in Islam Abram's band.
I speak up from within the lion's maw.

18 And the seed time came for the sowing
Of seed upon the land, and going
Out all together to protect
Their seed against the ravens *pecked*,
And Abram went out with those going,
And the child was fourteen years growing.

19 And a cloud of ravens came down
To eat the seed *of the whole town*,
And Abram ran to meet them there
Before they settled from the air,
And cried to them before they settled
On the ground to eat the seed *nettled*,
And said "Descend not, return to
The place where you came from and do,"
And they proceeded to turn back.

20 And he caused clouds of ravens *slack*
To turn back that day seventy times,
And all the ravens in the climes
Where Abram was did not come down.
21 And all who were with him in town
Saw him cry out, and all the ravens
Turn back, and his name's great in havens
In all the land of the Chaldees.

What miracle makes Abram's flailing arms
Against the ravens availing alarms?

Any might have gone out before to view
The ravens coming in to make a stew
Without their turning back. It may have
been

The stamina that Abram had to win
By running in the crowd of birds each time
They came to settle on the fields in crime.
Twelve hours in a day and his done feat
Was seventy times that day to repeat,
Makes running out and flailing in each hour
Near seven times. Beloved, put in my
power

To resist with such strength daily
temptation
Seventy times come on my field and
station.

22 And there came to him this year's fees
All those that wished to sow, and he
Went with them till the time of wee
Sowing ceased: and they sowed their land,
And that year they brought grain in hand
Enough to eat and to be filled.

23 And in the first year of the billed
Fifth week [1891 A.M.] Abram taught
those who made

Implements for oxen, the paid
Artificers in wood, and they
Made a vessel above the ground,
Facing the frame of the plough's way,
To put seed on it safe and sound,
And the seed fell down from it on
The ploughshare, and in earth was drawn,
And they no longer feared the ravens.

24 And so this way they made as havens
Above the ground on all the frames
Of the ploughs, and they sowed their
claims
And tilled the land, as Abram had
Commanded them, and they were glad,
No longer fearing as they had.

The exertion of driving off the crows
All day long made Abram think on his toes,
And so invented the machine that stows
The seed beneath the ground out of the way
Of ravens and the claws that cluck and
sway

To pick the seed off from the surface soil.
There's nothing for invention like the toil.
So Abram was the start not only of

The faith that's born of wisdom and of
love,
But also father of the seeding tool
That turned to wiseman every bleeding
fool.

Beloved, I turn my hand to do the trick
And find my inspiration in the nick
Of Abram's going out to find the pool.

Jubilees 12

1 And it happened in the sixth week,
In the seventh year *as might seek*, [1904
A.M.]

That Abram said to Terah his
Father, saying "Father!" A whiz
His father said "Indeed, here am
I, my son." 2 And then said Abram,
"What help and profit have we from
Those idols which you worship dumb,
And before which you bow yourself?
3 "For there's no spirit in such elf,
For they are dumb forms, and misleading
Of the heart. Worship them not *feeding*:
4 "Worship the God of heaven *and earth*,
Who makes the rain *come down on dearth*
And dew to descend on the earth
And does everything on the earth,
And has created everything
By His word, and all life *and wing*
Is from before His face *to sing*.
5 "Why do you worship things with no
Spirit in them? For they are show
And work of *men's hands on the go*,
And on your shoulders you bear them,
And you will have no help from them,
But they are a great cause of shame
To those who make them *to their blame*,
And a misleading of the heart
To those who worship them *apart*:
Don't worship them, *for it's a shame*."

The story of Abram who told his father
Not to worship dumb idols but the rather
To worship You, is repeated as fair
In the Qur'an for those who seek it there,
Although the sacred books are unaware
Of that event in every other page.
Bit by sweet bit truths against falsehood
wage

A struggle. So in every heart that comes
Beneath the blinding veils to do her sums
Find reason speaking like a loving son

To prevent the idolatry that's done.
The Abram in my heart calls me to You
Away from the consignments in my view,
And so to You, Beloved, I turn and run.

6 And his father said to him, "I
Also know it, my son, but shy
What shall I do with a folk who
Have made me serve before their *shoe*?
7 "And if I tell them the truth, they
Will kill me, for their soul astray
Cleaves to them to worship them and
Honour them. 8 "Keep silent *and stand*,
My son, lest they kill you *in band*."
And these words he spoke to his two
Brothers, and they were angry too
With him and he was quiet then.

The call of reason from idolatry
Goes often heeded with paternal glee,
An acquiescence, but folding the hands
As though naught can be done because the
bands

Of social pressure weaken the heart's
spires.

Idolatry is something that retires
To wake anew each day and by surprise.
The veils renew the idols in the guise
Of duties and compassions. Set me free
From bands of brotherhood, idolatry
Sleeps in the congregation and the see.
Beloved, the whole world lies in silence
where

For everyone's sake people take the dare
And stop to find fresh roses for their share.

9 And in the fortieth jubilee,
In the second week *of the pen*,
In the seventh year *of decree*, [1925 A.M.]
Abram took to himself a wife,
And her name was Sarai, the *rife*
Daughter of his father, and she
Became his wife. 10 And Haran, he
Was his brother, took to himself
A wife in the third year *and shelf*
Of the third week, [1928 A.M.] and she
bore him

A son in the seventh year *grim*
Of this week, [1932 A.M.] 11 and he called
his name
Lot. And Nahor, his brother's *fame*,
Took to himself a wife, *no game*.

Another wife for each of Abram's brothers
Lets out the secret from the well that
smothers

All hopes that any might stop to see doom,
How idol worship sneaks into the room.
My hands are weak to press the secret out
Under the foxgloved shadows of my rout.
Help comes to the stilled mind and soul at
last

Around the cherry trees and, swinging fast,
Minutely cantillating in the sun
All shining apple leaves stretched out for
fun.

Down from the peering at a new worn sky
And at the question marks in passing by
Love tendered from heart of woman and
man
Instills at last the canopy of plan.

12 And in the sixtieth year of life
Of Abram, that is, in *the strife*
Of the fourth week, in the fourth year
Thereof, [1936 A.M.] Abram rose *without*
fear

By night, and burned the idols' house,
And burned all that was in the house
And no man knew it. 13 And they rose
In the night and sought to save those
Gods from the middle of the fire.

Well done, I say, though it took sixty years
To get the courage to face up to fears
That ruler and folk would come out to
show

A face of opposition, have a go
At punishment or even if not slow
To kill the man. Perhaps he thought his life
Was finished anyway, and so the strife
Would make but little difference. Anyway,
I celebrate the Abrahamic day
That idols were burnt. My Beloved, take
me

And search my heart for some idolatry
And purge my mind and hand down to my
heart
Of images that take Your place and part.
Let nothing stay but Your eternity.

14 And Haran quickly ran, a flier
To save them, but the fire flamed up
Over him, *thus ended his cup*

And he was burnt by fire, and died
In Ur of the Chaldees to bide
Before his father Terah, and
They buried him in Ur to stand
Of the Chaldees. 15 And Terah went
Forth from Ur of the Chaldees *spent*,
He and his sons, to go into
The land of Lebanon, into
The land of Canaan, and he dwelt
In the land of Haran *and knelt*,
And Abram lived with Terah his
Father in Haran two weeks' whiz
Of years. 16 And in the sixth week, in
The fifth year of it, [1951 A.M.] *without sin*
Abram sat up throughout the night
On the first day of seventh month's *rite*
Observing the stars from the eve
To the morning *without reprieve*,
In order to see what would be
The character of year's *decree*
With regard to the rains, and he
Was alone as he sat observing.
17 And a word came *and without swerving*
Into his heart and he said "All
The signs of the stars, and the *call*
Of signs of the moon and the sun
Are all in the hand of YHWH *won*.
Why do I search *them* out *at all*?
18 "If He desires, He causes rain,
Morning and evening, *hill and plain*,
And if He wills, He withholds it,
And all things are in His hand fit."

Beloved, I see the science that predicts
The wealth targeted by many edicts,
And know that acquisition is a thing
Empty as power beloved in hand of king.
Today more look to star than look to You,
Perhaps because the star's something in
view,
While You hide in the here and now so
close
To human heart there is no other dose,
Even the self. A star is safely far.
But bound in Your embrace molecular
I find no real but You, no help to gain
Existence outside Your encumbered plain.
Beloved, let come the sun or simple rain,
Withhold the kiss of breath or stay the
chain.

19 And he prayed that night and he said

“My God, Alohim Most High *stead*,
You alone are my God, and You
And Your dominion I take true.

A willow fell beside the well long since
And at the fall all in the homestead wince,
But raise no hand to pull it by the root
Or chop it out of its earthly dispute.
Between the earth and sky its frozen corpse
In angular appraisal of time warps
Meets winter sun. The summer sees the
green

And silver dawn upon its branches’ sheen.
Caught between life and death it stands to
wait,
Beloved, year by year its determined fate.
I too like that tree nailed to death and life
Look down upon the earth and all its strife
And raise a leaf to heaven to seek Your
will.

Someday I too shall sink into earth’s hill.

And You’ve created all things, too,
And all things that are Your hands’ work.
20 Deliver me from hands of *shirk*,
Evil spirits who have dominion
Over men’s hearts and their opinion,
And let them not lead me astray
From You, my God, *in any way*.

Beloved, I join in Abram’s fervent prayer
That none might lead my soul from earth to
air

In paths astray from Your heart and Your
mind.

Lead You alone my soul, as I am blind.
Let every spirit of the times that casts
Its pall over the populace that fasts
Find no foothold within the rugged walls
That make my stony heart the fragrant
stalls

Of Your appearing. Tie the gates fast from
The clatter of their screeching and the sum
Of false wisdom that writes in golden script
The wayward words so many here have
sipped.

Beloved, I join Abram in prayer to You
That You alone be all my love and due.

And establish You me and my
Seed for ever that we comply
Not to go astray from now on

For evermore *nor eve nor dawn*.”

All prayers in favour of one’s children
heard

Loud before You, Beloved, Your heart has
stirred.

All prayers that one’s descendants on the
hill

Have grace to follow You, stay in Your
will,

Must meet Your favour, rouse Your mercy
still

Until the birth and breath give them their
trill.

How many prayers seem unanswered by
You

As progeny grows up to fail their due.

My prayer for mine be better found in time
And place to set my children’s feet to
rhyme.

Done is the prayer, and most of them are
lost,

Almost the lot of Abram’s children tossed.

Long on the air, however, rings the hymn
In praise of Abram’s children that praised
him.

21 And he said “Shall I now return
To Ur of the Chaldees *to burn*
Who seek my face when I return
To them, am I to remain here
In this place? The right path to fear
Before You prosper it in hand
Of Your servant that *You command*
That he may fulfil *it* and that
I may not walk *like acrobat*
In my heart’s deceit, O my God.”

22 He finished what he said to God
In prayer, and indeed word of YHWH
Was sent to him through me to do,
Saying “Get you up from your land,
And from your kindred and the band
Of your father’s house to a land
Which I will show you, and I’ll make
You a great nation *for My sake*.

The reader of the Torah wonders why
Abram so quickly obeyed without sigh
Your command to get out of land of birth.
It was not just faith in You that was worth
The trouble to his mind, he followed heart
To safety in a land that was apart.

I too look to my satisfaction and
My safety as I faithful take Your hand
And follow leading to a far-off land.
Your word does not deny the cunningness
That moves survivor hearts to Your
address.

In every land I come to follow You
I choose the safest ledge admiring view,
And wait there without hunger. You may
bless.

23 “And I will bless you and I’ll make
Your name great, and You shall be blessed
In the earth, and in You the rest
Of all families on earth be blessed,
And I will bless them that bless you,
And curse them *also* that curse you.

To bless the name of prophet from Your
hand,
Beloved, is according to Your command.
I bless the prophets and their words and
deeds,
I bless their harvest and their planting
seeds.

I bless their days and nights, their work and
rest,

And blessing them, I still bless not the best.
Beloved, You who are above all in state
Are better to my eyes than small and great
Among those who have been sent in Your
will

To represent You on both plain and hill.
Beloved, though I see all about the way
Your sent ones who lead those who want to
stray,

Behind their blessing lies always the view
That none is true in fine but only You.

24 And I will be a God to you
And to your son, and son’s son too,
And to all your descendants *true*:
Fear not, from now on and unto
All generations of the earth
I am your God *of highest worth.*”

In all time and in every place You are,
Beloved, God alone and the only star.
All else is just illusion on the case.
They only seem who hold the glaive and
mace.

If You are God to Abram and his son,

And his son after him when he is done,
Be my God too, let me not be left dumb
Without the fold of godnesses in sum.
I range through those vast places in Your
time

And see beyond the mountains that I climb
The vistas of renewing faith in You.
I stop to greet the weather and the view.
Beloved, I step out on the azure plate
To find You everywhere I’d been to wait.

25 And YHWH Alohim said “Open
His mouth and his ears, that he then
May hear and speak with his mouth, and
With the language which has been
planned,”

For it had ceased from the mouths shut
Of all the children of men what
From the day of the overthrow
Of Babel had been all men’s show.
26 And I opened his mouth, his ear
And his lip, and I began clear
To speak with him in Hebrew tongue
In which I had creation sung.

Och, I had thought creation’s tongue to be
A perfect crystal shattered in the glee
Of Babel, so that all tongues have their
share

In the splintered reflection of the fair.
But no, You tell me Hebrew is the right,
Though it seem no more sacred than the
light

Of Arabic or Turkish or the flame
Of Iroquoian on the fond earth’s claim.
I thought the language that was once
destroyed

At Babel was a hero tongue employed
So none could misinterpret its accord.
I thought it secret language of the Lord.
And yet when I hear the sweet words
recited
Of Hebrew Torah, I am stunned, delighted.

27 And he took the books of his grand
Fathers, and these were writ by hand
In Hebrew, and he transcribed them,
And he began from then on them
To study, and I made known to
Him what he could not *understand*,
And he studied them *as was due*
During the six rainy months’ time.

28 And it happened *about that time*
In the seventh year of the week [1953
A.M.]

Number six that he spoke a peek
To his father and informed him,
That he would leave Haran and *trim*
To go into the land that's called
Canaan to see it and *enthralled*
Return to him. 29 And so Terah
His father said to him *for law*,
“Go in peace. May the Alohim
Of eternity make your *dream*
Path straight. And YHWH [*be with you,*
and]

Protect you from all evil *band*,
And grant unto you *grace to be*,
Mercy and favour by whom see
You, and may none of humankind
Have power over you to mind
To harm you, go indeed in peace.
30 “And if You see a land’s increase
That’s pleasant to your eyes to dwell,
Then get you up and take me well
To you and take Lot with you, son
Of Haran your brother as son,
YHWH be with you. 31 “And Nahor your
Brother leave with me and in store
Till You return in peace, and we
Go with you all together free.”

I too read in those books once set to tell
Abram the way to Canaan and life’s well.
I read them in the sparkling Hebrew tongue
That shows Your footprints on creation’s
rung,
And yet I do not see the graphic trust
That taught Abram distinguishing from
dust,
Because the letters over time have changed
From early scrawl to new square Hebrew
ranged
In neat rows. But I wonder as I read
The syllables in silver melodies
What ways the pen took then in Abram’s
need,
And what prints filled the parchment or the
frieze.

Beloved, I find bosom of Abraham
In the same books I read here where I am.

Week 21 Jubilees 13

1 And Abram journeyed from Haran,

He took Sarai, his wife, and man
Lot, his brother Haran’s son, to
The land of Canaan, and *with few*
He came into Asshur, and then
Proceeded to Shechem, again
Lived near a lofty oak. 2 And he
Saw, and, indeed, the land to see
Was very pleasant from the way
That goes by Hamath to the oak
Of revelation. 3 And YHWH spoke
To him, “To you and to your seed
Will I give *all* this land *indeed*.”
4 And he built an altar there, and
He offered thereon *as was planned*
A burnt sacrifice to YHWH, who
Had appeared to him *in the dew*.

Beloved, the holiness of oaks is known
In every place where holy oaks are grown
From Palestine or Canaan to the throne
Of Celtic isles. Beneath the root the bone
Of priest and priestess lie, no longer groan.
And yet beyond the parched and pagan
myth

I seek Your revelation true to pith.
I am not satisfied with goddess and
The gods that whisper to the meadowland.
I am not satisfied with vision grand
That with ideas comes shining into mind.
I recognize the poaching of the blind.
Beyond the oak of revelation I
Flee to You in Your own reality.

5 And he went out from there into
The mountain . . . Bethel on the west
And Ai on the east *to rest*,
And pitched his tent there. 6 And he saw
And indeed, the land was *for awe*
Very wide and good, everything
Grew on it: vines and figs *to sing*
And pomegranates, and oaks and
Ilexes, and terebinths and stand
Of olive trees, and cedars and
Cypresses and date palms, and all
The trees of the field, and there was
Water on the mountains *to pause*.

The ten trees of new Canaan’s land repose
Before the eyes of Abram not to close
Before the first sight of the promised land.
The gift was given but not yet in hand,
And at the gems of wood before his eyes

He paused to stare and wonder in surprise.
 I too look at the stout and fruitful ten
 That You once spoke in hearing of all men.
 I see the green leaf and the fragrant fruit,
 I taste and swoon and taste again the root.
 Beloved, I kiss the jeweled trees in tow
 And in that kiss from doubt turn out to
 know.
 Beloved, Beloved, spread always out
 before
 Me Your trees from the sky up to my door.

7 And he blessed YHWH who had led him
 Out of Ur of the Chaldees *grim*,
 And had brought him up to this land.
 8 And it happened in first year's hand,
 In the seventh week, on the first
 Day of the first month, 1954 A.M.] that not
 worst

He built an altar on this mount,
 And called on name of YHWH *to count*,
 "You, the eternal Alohim,
 Are my God *and are not a dream.*"

9 And he offered on the altar
 A burnt sacrifice unto YHWH
 That He should be with him *as far*
As he might go and not forsake
 Him all the days of his life *true*.

10 And he removed from there to make
 His way towards the south, and he
 Came to Hebron, Hebron's degree
 Was built at that time, and he dwelt
 There two years, and he left that belt
 To go into the southland, to
 Bealoth, and there a famine blew
 In the land. 11 And Abram went to
 Egypt in third year of the week,
 And he lived in Egypt *and meek*
 Five years before his wife was torn
 Away from him *and left forlorn*.

12 Now Tanais in Egypt was built
 At that time, seven years *unspilt*
 After Hebron. 13 And it took place
 When Pharaoh seized Sarai *for grace*,
 The wife of Abram that YHWH laid
 Plagues on Pharaoh and his house stayed
 Because of Sarai, Abram's wife
That he had stolen in the strife.

From seventy-six to nineteen-sixty-one
 Makes Abram eighty-five and just for fun
 If I give Sarai ten years less it seems

That at her age Pharaoh was seeing dreams
 To think she might add early bloom and
 flower

To kingly harem at that day and hour.
 There's no accounting taste in women so
 I let that improbability go.

It happened once again and some years
 later

Abimelech was tempted too to mate her.
 Incredible it seems that men of old
 And kings in prime should give their hard-
 earned gold

To snatch a glance of ancient, well-turned
 heel.

One never knows how another may feel.

14 And Abram was very wealthy
 By reason of possessions, *free*
 In sheep, and cattle, asses, and
 Horses, and camels, and *in hand*
 Menservants, and maidservants, and
 Silver and gold exceedingly.

Beloved, I have in hand but little wealth,
 Although it more than feeds my bod in
 stealth.

I have no sheep nor cattle, no, nor donkeys
 To say nothing of horse and camel
 wonkeys.

My silver and my gold held in a spoon
 Would not pay for a boughten meal at
 noon.

And yet I do not covet Abram's quid,
 Nor look with longing heart on what he hid.
 Beloved, I covet Abram's faith in You,
 I covet all the visions come in view,
 Not for their promises of land in due,
 But merely for the guidance of Your hand,
 The still small voice above the rich and
 grand,

The loving heart that is my sole command.

And Lot also his brother's son,
 Was wealthy *from ounce, pound and tonne*.

15 And Pharaoh gave back Sarai, wife
 Of Abram, and he *without strife*
 Sent him back out of Egypt's land,
 He journeyed to where he would stand
 His tent as at the start, and to
 The place of the altar, with crew
 Of Ai on the east, and on
 The west Bethel, and thereupon

He blessed the Lord his God who'd brought
Him back in peace *and saved from plot.*

Abram gained wealth in the metropolis
By prostituting wife to Pharoah's kiss.
Although the thing was done by violence
And not by Abram's plan at her expense,
The end result is just the same. We see
Abram walk off with profit and money
And Sarai returned from the harem's spree.
I too have been a while in the big city
And seen how things are done there
without pity.

I too have cut my losses from the church
That left me high and wet and in the lurch.
And I too build an altar in the east
And bow to You alone, Beloved, and feast.

16 It took place in the forty-first
Jubilee in the third *immersed*
Year of the first week, [1963 A.M.] that he
came

Back to this place and offered flame
Of sacrifice, called on the name
Of YHWH, and said "You, the most high
El El God, are my God for aye."

Beloved, I come with self as sacrifice
To Your Self here above the snow and ice.
The burning cold reminds my glowing skin
To be the slaying flaying and the kin
Of Abram's ram offered with kindled flame
To You, Beloved, who meet in hidden fame
The one who comes to You where sacred
place

Reveals the secret of Your hidden face.
The forty-first Jubilee leaves behind
The generations of a humankind
Looking for wealth and knowledge of the
rind.

I turn forward in hope that I shall find
A new seeking and searching for Your
own.

Such is my turning, if I turn alone.

17 And in the fourth year of this week
[1964 A.M.]

Lot parted from him, and *with cheek*
Lot lived in Sodom, and the men
Of Sodom were sinners again.

18 And it grieved him at heart that his
Brother's son had parted from his

Place, for he had no spawn. 19 In that
Year when Lot was taken *like sprat*,
YHWH said to Abram, after that
Lot had parted from him, in year
Number four of this week, "*Don't fear*,
Lift up your eyes from the place where
You are living, northward and fair
To southward, and westward and east.
20 "For all land on which Your eyes feast
I will give to you and your seed
For ever, and I'll make your seed
As sand of the sea: though a man
May count the dust of earth *by plan*,
Yet your seed shall not be numbered.

21 "Get up, walk *through the land and*
stirred

Throughout its length and breadth, and see
It all, for to your seed in fee
Will I give it." And Abram went
To Hebron, and lived there *in tent.*

I live in log cabin for tent far from
Hebron, and dream the warming sun has
come.

The morning is no light at all, I see
The snow and ice on every stone and tree.
If You, Beloved, had spoken once to me,
I think You would have mentioned not the
sand

Upon the desert floor on every hand,
But snowflakes. Count the snowflakes on
the strand.

A million settled yesterday upon
My step, and now they're frozen in the
dawn,

The dark dawn of the north that sees no
sun,
But waves the northern lights good-bye for
fun.

I live in a log house for tent and dream
Of Hebron far away from soul and seam.

22 And in this year Chedorlaomer,
King of Elam, came out *unfair*
And Amraphel, king of Shinar,
And Arioch of Sellasar,
And Tergal, king of nations, and
Slew the king of Gomorrah, and
The king of Sodom fled away,
And many fell through wounds that day
In vale of Siddim, by Salt Sea.

You once said to mankind Thou shalt not
kill,
And since that time earth's kings have had
their fill,
And still go out against each other clad
In armour. Does it not make You both mad
And sad to see how few obey Your word?
Who do not kill themselves, are rather
stirred
To praise the actions of the kings that do.
I take refuge, Belovèd One, in You.
The armies that protect the lurid view
Of Sodom and Gomorrah from the fate
That kings beyond the Jordan would instate
Are no more righteous today than of yore.
They all in common glory in the gore
Or in the grand hypocrisy in store.

23 And they took captive Sodom *free*
And Adam and Zeboim, and
They took captive Lot also *manned*,
The son of Abram's brother, and
All his possessions, and they went
To Dan. 24 And one who'd escaped sent
And told Abram his brother's son
Had been taken captive and won,
And *Abram* armed his household men . . .

Today there is no Abram in his tent
With army of three hundred men that meant
With thirteen more to scatter where they
went
The armies of those seeking wealth and
store.
Today Your appointed is gone
Into the hidden pastures and the lawn
To fight a battle secret from the dawn
With hand not unknown from the gore.
The human heart would fight or flee the
wrong
That piles up with a gyration and song
And stays for days and nights and makes
them long.
But flight and fight are not my place to take
As long as the great master of the wake
Remains hidden and ruling for Your sake.

25 For Abram, and his seed again,
A tenth of the first fruits to YHWH,
And YHWH ordained it as a true
Ordinance for ever that they
Should give it to the priests *in pay*

Who served before Him, and that they
Should possess it for ever *too*.

Today there is no priest before Your cord
Of temple, temple too is unadored.
Today there is no hand to take the rest,
The tenth of firstfruits and the chicken
breast.

Hands many there be that would take the
store
And add to it another tenth and score,
But robber hands shall meet the threshing
floor

And add their blood to innocence in gore.
I flee to You, Beloved, and give my all,
Myself in sacrifice, fat calf in stall,
And every firstfruit to be blessed withal
As You whirl through the ruby cloud at
dawn

To fill the green and silver-dewy lawn
With Your appearance in a flash and gone.

26 And to this law there is no band
In limit of days, for His hand
Has ordained it for generations
For ever *and to all the nations*
That they should give to YHWH of all
The tenth, of the seed and the ball
Of the grape juice and of the oil
And of the cattle and *the coil*
Of the sheep. 27 And He gave to His
Priests to eat and to drink *the fizz*
With joy before Him. 28 And the king
Of Sodom came *out on the wing*
To him and bowed down before him,
And said "Our Lord Abram, give us
The souls which You have rescued thus,
But let the booty be your own."
29 And Abram said to him *for throne*,
"I lift up my hands to the Most
High El, that from a thread to boast
To a shoe-latchet I shall not
Take anything that you have got
Lest you should say, I've made Abram
Rich *in both sheep and ox and ram*,
But only what the young men ate,
And the portion of the men great
Who went with me, Aner, Eschol,
And Mamre, let these have their toll."

I cut losses and have no truck or trade
With Sodom's king who went out at tirade

To hide among the lilies and the grapes
Confusing the invaders with their shapes.
I cut losses and avoid all the crew
Of Baal worshippers, let them have their
due.

Let sun worship and bloody sacrifice
Of human forms and all that they think nice
Be put out from my heart and hand and
home.

I'd rather, poor or wealthy, stand to roam
Like Abraham, than set my teeth on edge
With Luther's real presence in the sedge.
Beloved, I take not string nor latchet prop,
Nor share with Sodom's king morsel or
sop.

Jubilees 14

1 After these things, in the fourth year
Of this week, on the first day's *steer*
Of the third month, the word of YHWH
Came to Abram in a dream *true*,
Saying "Fear not, Abram, I am
Your defender, and your reward
Will be very great." 2 He said "Lord,
Lord, what will You give me *for ham*,
Seeing I go childless, and this
Son of Maseq, the son of this
Handmaid of mine, is Dammasek
Eliezer: and he will *trek*
To be my heir, and to me You
Have given no spawn as my due."

There is a way lined out in the parade
Of human thought and culture that has
made
Solutions to all problems men may face.
It is a common feature of the race.
If there's no son, the nearest one to hand
Is best fitted to the succession planned.
Even a prophet cannot see beyond
The glade in which he sits with fern and
frond.

Like Moses before Enoch's troubled test
He has his own blind way to foil the best.
From that humankind sinks into the lust
Of democratic doing in the dust.
Of course it is the best we have in bog
If we forget Your word in Decalogue.

3 And He said to him, "This one will
Not be your heir, but one that will
Come out of your own loins, he will

Be your heir." 4 And He brought him still
Abroad, and said to him, "Look toward
Heaven and count the stars' accord
If You can number them." 5 And he
Looked toward the sky, and saw the stars.
And He said to him, "So shall be
Your family *in all its cars*."

Beloved, You speak and man looks up to
see

The stars arrayed into eternity,
The thunder on the mountain and the
smoke
That rushes on the heavens where You
spoke.

Beloved, You give command and man
obeys

And counts the lights above the gracious
ways

That stream out from the marvels of the
nights

And shine into the day with all its rights.
The answer to questions of universe
Demand I count the wings of the perverse.
The answer to duty to survive this
Is waiting for Your whisper and Your kiss.
Beloved, I stand below the graven hill
To find Sinai transfiguration's bill.

6 And he believed in YHWH, and so
It was accounted to his stow
For righteousness. 7 And He told him,
"I'm YHWH that brought you from the
grim

Chaldees' Ur, to give you the land
Of Canaanites to keep in hand
For ever, and I will be God
To you and yours *upon the sod*
After you." 8 And he said "Lord, Lord,
How shall I know I'll receive *it*?"
9 And He said to him, "Take Me fit
A heifer of three years, and a goat
Of three years, and a sheep of note
Three years old, and a turtle-dove,
And a pigeon." 10 And the above
He took all in the middle of
The month and he lived at the oak
Of Mamre, near to Hebron's *stroke*.

Believing what You say is righteousness.
I believe what You said at Abram's guess,
And what You said in public from the hill

Of Sinai in words heard by Jack and Bill.
 I believe what You say in secret dream
 To all the prophets in the Scripture's seam.
 And believing Your word and promise true
 I show my belief in the things I do,
 Ignoring what the crowd would mandate to
 The hand of everyone in Katmandu.
 Beloved, I whirl upon the circle of
 The Decalogue cantillated in love,
 And thus move my straw in the cosmic
 wind
 Regenerating fast a world that sinned.

11 And there he built an altar, and
 Sacrificed all these, on the stand
 Of the altar he poured their blood,
 And divided them in the flood,
 And laid them over each on each,
 But he did not divide the reach
 Of the birds. 12 And birds came down
 Upon the pieces, with a frown
 Abram drove them away, and did
 Not let the birds touch what he hid.
 13 And it happened, when sun had set,
 That ecstasy [in deep trance] set
 On Abram, and indeed a dark
 Great horror fell upon him *stark*,
 And it was said to Abram, "Know
 Surely your children on the go
 Shall be as strangers in a land
That is not theirs, and they shall stand
 In bondage and affliction there
 Four hundred years. 14 "And I will bear
 Also judgement upon the nation
 Also to whom they will in station
 Be as servants, and after that
 They shall come out from where they sat
 With great possessions. 15 "And You'll go
 To your fathers in peaceful show,
 And be buried in good old age.
 16 "But on fourth generation's page
 They shall return here, for the sin
 Of Amorite's not yet in bin."

Beloved, the prophet knew the future
 caught
 In the web of the divine astronaut.
 You told him after fifty years of grief
 Drove him to seek in every chance relief
 From worry for the future. Let my hope
 Remain in You despite the cunning rope
 Of darkness that the future holds for me.

I live in trust of You and come what see.
 My great grandson may or may never be,
 But in the circle of the ages free
 My whirling in Your name eternally
 Shall have its song and step before Your
 throne,
 Though I may lie with nothing on my bone,
 Beneath the sinking suns and silently.

17 And he woke up from his sleep, and
 He got up, and the sun had set,
 And there was a flame *on each hand*,
 And a furnace indeed to get
 Smoke, and a flame of fire between
 The pieces. 18 And on that day's *scene*
 YHWH made covenant with Abram,
 Saying 'To your children I am
 Giving this land, up from the flow
 Of Egypt, up to where shall go
 The great river, River Euphrates,
 The Kenites, the Kenizzite *mateys*,
 The Kadmonites, the Perizzites,
 The Rephaim, the Phakorites,
 And the Hivites, and Amorites,
 And Canaanites, and Girgashites,
 And Jebusites. 19 And the day passed,
 Abram offered the pieces *last*,
 And the birds, and their fruit offerings,
 And their drink offerings *in their springs*,
 And fire consumed them. 20 On that day
 We made covenant with Abram,
 According as we had made way
 Of covenant *in epigram*
 With Noah in this month, and he,
 Abram, renewed the festival
 And ordinance perpetual
 For himself. 21 And Abram rejoiced,
 And made known all these things *loud-*
voiced

To Sarai his wife, and believed
 That he'd have children unrelieved,
 But she did not bear. 22 And Sarai
 Advised her husband Abram why,
 And said to him, "Go in to Hagar,
 My Egyptian maid *not to plague her*:
 It may be that I shall build up
 My children to you by her *cup*." 23
 And Abram listened to the voice
 Of Sarai his wife *out of choice*,
 And said to her, "Do so indeed."
 And Sarai took Hagar, her maid,
 The Egyptian, and gave her to

Abram, her husband, to be due
 His wife. 24 And he went in to her,
 And she conceived and was astir
 To bear him a son, and he called
 His name Ishmael, *heard well installed*,
 In the fifth year of this week's tier [1965
 A.M.],
 And this was the eighty-sixth year
 In the life of Abram *with fear*.

The middle of the third month set the tune
 For Pentecost, day of Enoch at noon
 And thanksgiving of Noah from the ark.
 Who knows but what it goes back to the
 park.

And on this day of blessing in the year,
 The only one to fall on first day's gear
 When Baal and sun worshippers come to
 fear,

Abram also sees visions fearsome, stark.
 Strange that the miracle should set about
 To make him take another wife en route.
 Yet such was Your will, My Beloved, to
 show

The famous prophet Ishmael on the go.
 The blessings of the day reach to this time
 And make rejoice my heart in song and
 rhyme.

Week 22 Jubilees 15

1 And in the fifth year of the fourth
 Week of this jubilee, [1979 A.M.] went
 forth

In the third month, and in the middle
 Of the month, Abram, came to fiddle
 The celebration of the feast
 Of first-fruits of the grain increased.

2 And he offered new offerings
 On the altar, the first-fruits' springs
 To YHWH, a heifer and a goat
 And a sheep on the altar dote
 As a burnt sacrifice to YHWH,
 Their fruit offerings, drink offerings due
 He offered on the altar with
 Frankincense. 3 And YHWH appeared with
 Abram, and said to him, "I am
 Alohim Almighty, *Abram*,
 Approve yourself before me and
 Be perfect. 4 "And I will command
 My covenant between Me and
 You, and I will multiply you
 Exceedingly *beyond your few*."

You always demand of a man perfection,
 And so in times past that was predilection
 Of every man. All tried utmost to be
 And do everything done as perfectly.
 My grandfather could make a hunting gun
 From just a lump of iron and stock begun
 Of curly maple seasoned in the shed.
 The bore was perfect when the thing was
 fed.

Today a man is satisfied to bet
 A shilling that his hand's not steady yet.
 Better perfection than the blinding brood
 Of self-effacement in self-esteem stewed
 Who are great just because they are in feud
 With Self and ignore Your command well
 set.

5 And Abram fell upon his face,
 And Alohim talked in *that place*
 With him, and said "Indeed my law
 Is with you, and you shall in awe
 Be the father of many nations.

When Abram lived upon the earth the glow
 Of nations had but little in the show
 Of descent from the chosen man below.
 A cousin perhaps sat upon the throne
 Of Ur which he with good sense left alone.
 But now his flock's dispersed around the
 globe

And wearing turtleneck and silken robe.
 From Zanzibar to Vladivostok I
 Might find the set of jaw, the glint of eye
 Betraying descent from Abram to spy.
 All now receive the promises made then
 That You, Beloved, should come down
 among men
 And join the inner Self along the road
 Where caravans once traded load for load.

6 "Neither shall your name *in your stations*
 Any more be called Abram, but
 Your name from now on, shall be cut
 For ever as Abraham. 7 "For
 Father of many nations more
 I have made you. 8 "And I will make
 You very great, and I will make
 You into nations, and kings shall
 Come out of you. 9 "Surely I shall
 Establish My covenant here
 Between Me and you, *without fear*,

And your children after you, to
Their generations not a few,
For an eternal covenant,
So that I may be a God meant
For you, and for your children sent.

10 "The land where you've been
sojourning,
The land of Canaan, that I bring
You to possess it always, and
I will be their God *in the land*."

The centuries between that day and this
Suppose that even Abraham's sons miss
Perhaps the covenant. No one is sure
He is not of Abraham's descendant pure.
And yet as I train feet to climb the rock
Encrusted with arboreal ice stock,
And hear the black-cap twittering Your
name,

I think I too must have covenant claim
That You are my God as much as the One
Of fir and pine and creature on the run.
My tracks are so much like theirs that my
wife

Warns me such denizens have come for
strife
Into the garden, where my feet have made
Marks in the gathered snow instead of
spade.

11 And YHWH said to Abraham "And
As for you, keep my covenant,
You and your every descendant
After you: and circumcise each
Male among you, and in your reach,
Circumcise your foreskins, and it
Shall be a token and sign fit
Of an eternal covenant
Between Me, you *and descendant*.

Let me register one more time surprise
For the sign of Your covenant in guise.
You do not put the thing in Decalogue,
Which means circumcision is not whole
hog.
The thing seems to fastidious mind like
mine
Trained up in civilization to whine
Not only surprising but primitive
Excess come from where people learn and
live
Without the benefit of thought and grace.

If I'd not been done by parents apace
I think I could like St. Paul find a trace
Excuse to dispense with the circumcision
Delivered centuries ago in vision,
Passed down as a tradition in collision.

12 "And the child on the eighth day you
Shall circumcise, each male in view
Throughout your generations, him
That's born in the house, or whom trim
You've bought with money from any
Stranger, whom you've acquired in fee
Who's not your child. 13 "And everyone
Born in your homestead shall be done
In circumcision, and those whom
You have bought with money and room
Shall be circumcised, and My pact
Shall be in your flesh for an act
Eternal. 14 "And uncircumcised
Male who's not circumcised, apprised
In the flesh of his foreskin on
The eighth day, that soul shall be drawn
Off from his people, for he's broken
My covenant *at least in token*."

Some put the circumcision off to be
Until the boy has attained puberty,
No doubt in imitation of Ishmael
Who was at that stage when You made the
file.

The servant bought was also circumcised
At what age he was when he was apprised.
The eighth day is an ideal for the true
Born in the family, part of the crew.
Beloved, the days go by, Your footprints
seem

To vanish and appear beside the stream
In sands of silver where the green fronds
gleam.

The eighth day from birth is eternity
For me who wander in search of Your tree
And find my pagan heart leaning on Thee.

15 Alohim said to Abraham,
"As for Sarai your wife madame,
Her name shall be Sarai no more,
But Sarah shall be her name's *store*.
16 "And I will bless her, and give you
A son by her, and I will bless
Him, and he shall *come to impress*,
Become a nation, and kings of
Nations shall come from him *in love*."

17 And Abraham fell on his face,
And rejoiced, and said in his pace,
"Shall a son be born to him that
Is a hundred years old *and fat*,
And shall Sarah, who's ninety years
Old, bring forth children *without tears*?"

18 And Abraham told Alohim,
"O that Ishmael might live *and dream*
Before you!" 19 And Alohim said
"Yes indeed, and Sarah shall bed
Also a son, and you shall call
His name Isaac, and I'll install
My covenant with him, a *great*
And everlasting covenant,
And for his descendants *in state*
After him. 20 "And the applicant
For Ishmael also I have heard,
And indeed I'll bless him *by word*,
And make him great, and multiply
Him exceedingly *to the sky*,
He shall beget twelve princes, and
I'll make him great and in the land.

With the same promise made to both the
sons
Even in Jubilees, after the tons
Of troubles with so many relatives,
Before the quarrels, I must say "What
gives?"
Arab and Israelite still join the fray
Each with their unique claims in light of
day,
Forgetting that Isaac and Ishmael too
Were beloved sons of one father and crew.
Beloved, You made a world and in it set
Humankind before Your face to be met
As reflection of Your love and Your being.
Too often hearts are harder than eyes
seeing.
As territorial species mankind
May not be dumb, but is both deaf and
blind.

21 "And I'll establish covenant
With Isaac, whom Sarah shall plant
For you, in these days, in next year."
22 He left off speaking with him *clear*,
Alohim went from Abraham.
23 And Abraham did according
As Alohim *in cryptogram*
Had said to him, and so he took
Ishmael his son, *no backward look*,

And all that were born in his house,
And whom he had bought with his browse,
Each male in his house, and went out
To circumcise and cut about
The flesh of their foreskin *with shout*.

Such firm believer in democracy
As every man in this blessed century
Must be to keep his citizenship free,
I wonder that You command Abraham
To circumcise the pox ad nauseam
Of servants bought for money and who
wait
To do the bidding of Sarah or great
Abraham without murmuring their fate.
It is enough they're forced to do the task.
So could not circumcision wait to ask
If they would take the covenant or no?
Of course none ask the eight days child to
show
His willingness, and son is greater than
The servant, whether maidservant or man.

24 And on the selfsame day was set
Abraham circumcised, and yet
All the men of his house, and all
Those whom he'd bought with money's
thrall
From offspring of the stranger, all
Were circumcised with him. 25 This law
Is for all generations' awe
For ever, and there is no claw
Of circumcision of the days,
And no omission of the rays
Of one day out of the eight days,
For it's eternal ordinance,
Ordained and written utterance
Upon the heavenly tablets' *glance*.

The lovely Jesus once pointed out that
The circumcision once in seven sat
Upon the holy Sabbath. He forgot
The irony of circumcision plot
That it fell on all men near enough to
Cut with a blade in hand, and that is true.
No wonder faithful Jewish doctors caught
In the American hospital plot,
And Muslim physicians who also wait
On Christian children in Chicago's state,
Take on themselves the burden of
command
And cut each and every baby in hand.

The covenant's to cut without waiting
Beyond the day each superfluous wing.

26 And every one that's born, the flesh
Of whose foreskin is not done fresh
And circumcised on the eighth day,
Belongs not to the children's way
Of pact YHWH made with Abraham,
But to destruction and to damn,
Nor is there, moreover, a sign
On him that he's the Lord's divine,
But *he's destined* to be destroyed
And slain from the earth, and employed
To be rooted out of the earth,
For he's broken the pact of YHWH
Our God. 27 For all the angels true
Of the presence and all those yet
Angels sanctified where they're set
Have been created from the day
Of their creation *in their sway*,
And before angels of presence
And sanctification's *incense*
He has sanctified Israel,
That they should be with Him *a spell*
And with His holy angels *swell*.

Even the angels have no choice to be
Uncircumcised if they wish to be free.
Some men are even born as so angelic
Despite the protestations evangelic.
Without mercy the others are destroyed
In the words that the Jubilees employed.
Excuse for that is broken covenant.
Why not destroy instead uncle and aunt
Who left the child uncircumcised to dance?
The child's not responsible for his pants.
Perhaps the focus on individual
Responsibility this day banal
Should be reviewed and in its place to
stand
Corporate grace and righteousness well-
planned.

28 Command the folk of Israel
And let them *too* observe the sign
Of this covenant *and design*
For their generations as an
Eternal ordinance *by plan*,
That they will not be rooted out
Of the land. 29 For the command shout
Is ordained for a covenant,
That they observe it poursuivant

For ever among all the folk
Of Israel. 30 For Ishmael and
His sons and *all* his brothers and
Esau, YHWH did not cause to stand
Approaching Him, He chose them not
To be His priests, they are the lot
In children of Abraham *still*,
Because He knew them, but His will
Was to choose Israel to be
His representatives *in fee*.
31 And He sanctified it, and took
It gathered from among the book
Of all the children of men, for
There are many nations and more
Of peoples, and all are His, and
Over all He's placed spirits' hand
Leading them astray from His band.

Are all the nations of the world astray
Except for Israel by Aqaba's bay?
I see Your Decalogue printed out nice
In principles found in every faith's slice,
At least in half and often more. I see
That no nation follows You faithfully.
Even Israel is known to kill at times,
If other nations have their fill of crimes.
My Iroquoian soul's divided up
Into twelve portions in one reeling cup
To be Christian, Muslim, Jewish, not last
Hindu, Buddhist, Taoist and Zoroast,
Confucionist and four more yet unstated,
All looking to You, my Love, unabated.

32 But over Israel He did
Not appoint any angel lid
Or spirit, for He is alone
Their ruler, and He *from His throne*
Will preserve them and require them
At the hand of His angels' hem
And His spirits, and at the hand
Of all His powers *in the land*
In order that He may preserve
Them and bless them, that they not swerve
From being His and He may be
Theirs from now and eternally.

Perhaps the chosen tribe despite their
killing
Shall be rewarded with life though
unwilling,
And all others cast in eternal death.
I submit to Your will, Beloved, with breath

Lent from You one kiss at a time. I see
My wayward soul spinning though
faithfully
Without reward sent out to wander fast
In the desert of space without the blast
Of punishment greater than to be drawn
Into the burning sun of Your love's dawn
To disappear without a tracing being
Into the great heart that lifted by freeing
Israel from Egypt. Beloved, I ask no
Grace beyond the burning love in its glow.

33 And now I announce to you that
The children of Israel *for scat*
Will not keep true this ordinance,
They will not circumcise *for chance*
Their sons according to this law,
In circumcision's flesh to draw
They will omit cutting their sons,
And all of them, Beliar's sons,
Will leave their sons uncircumcised
As they were born *and were apprised*.
34 And there will come down a great wrath
From YHWH on Israel's folk's path,
Because they forsook covenant
And turned back from His word *to rant*,
And provoked and blasphemed, since they
Do not observe this law and way,
For they've treated their members like
The Gentiles, so they may *for spike*
Be removed and rooted out of
The land. And there will be no love
Or pardon or forgiveness to
Them [so that there should be found due
Forgiveness and pardon] for all
The sin of this eternal thrall.

I weep to read these words, Beloved, and
know
That scholars report they return the show
Of Hellenizers naked in the gym
With foreskins hanging proudly at their
whim.

Not uncut nakedness brings on my tears,
But that the prophecy in anger's fears
Was justified in centuries to come
As the slaughters added sum upon sum
And as the people were driven to slum
Away from horrible Jerusalem.
Forgive not only Israel, Beloved,
But all mankind, both silk and leather
gloved,

Who stand before Your throne by day and
night
Without once realizing their lost plight.

Jubilees 16

1 And on the first day of the fourth
Month (Wednesday) We appeared and
ventured forth
To Abraham, at the oak of
Mamre, and We talked *in Our love*
With him, and we announced to him
That a son would be born to him
By Sarah his wife. 2 Sarah laughed,
For she heard what We said and quaffed
With Abraham, so We scolded
Her, and she feared for what she did,
And denied that she'd laughed because
Of the words. 3 And *despite her flaws*
We told her the name of her son,
As his name's ordained and begun
In the celestial tablets won,
As Isaac, 4 And when we returned
To her at a set time *unspurned*,
She would have conceived a son then.

If Isaac's name was ordained for his fame
In the celestial tablets as a claim,
Then it made no sense for Sarah in time
Not to laugh, not laughing would be a
crime
Against what You had ordained for her
part.

It's no use complaining when we take heart
To do as You've determined from the start.
Beloved, let Sarah laugh, it's not a thing
Forbidden on the tablets or the ring
Of Decalogue. Let Sarah laugh for joy
Or in ignorant derision employ
The tongue You gave her. My Beloved, I
try
To sit on threshold of the opal sky
And watch Your moving tablets slipping
by.

5 And in this month YHWH executed
His judgments on Sodom *refuted*,
Gomorrah, and Zeboim, and
All the region of Jordan's *land*,
And He burned them with brimstone and
Fire, and destroyed them till this day,
Even as I have had my say,
Declared to you in all their works,

That they're wicked with sinners' quirks,
And that they defile themselves and
Do fornication *on the sand*
In their flesh, and work uncleanness
On the earth. 6 And, in like address,
Alohim will work out judgment
On the places where they have lent
The uncleanness of Sodomites,
Like the judgment of Sodom's *lights*.

The fourth month, on a pleasant day in June
When the sun had waxed hot before its
noon,
You rained down brimstone on Sodom to
be
A warning for the afterworld to see.
You who created instinct in mankind
To copulate, one strong enough to bind
The population to some reproduction
Without an irresistible seduction,
Know well enough how strong to make the
drive
So that it works, but does not enslave hive.
One can choose to control but not to set
Wholly aside what's in the body met.
And having given choice, Beloved, You
make
A man responsible for that choice' sake.

7 But Lot we saved, for Alohim
Remembered Abraham *in dream*,
And sent him out from the destruction.
8 He and daughters *without abduction*
Committed sin upon the earth,
Such as had not been on the earth
Since days of Adam till his time,
The man lay with his daughters prime,
As it would seem priest with parishioner
Reluctantly to put his fish in her.
9 And, indeed, it was commanded
And engraven concerning bid
Of all his descendants upon
The heavenly tablets, to be drawn,
Removed and rooted out, and make
Judgment upon them in like stake
As of Sodom, and leave no seed
Of the man on the earth to bleed
Upon the day of condemnation.
10 And in this month Abraham's station
Moved from Hebron, and departed
And lived between Kadesh and hid
By Shur upon the mountains of

Gerar. 11 And in the middle of
The fifth month he moved from there, and
Lived at Beer Sheba *on the sand*.

Beloved, it is not necessary that
You give me explanation for the fat
And lean on earth, and for the count
diminished
Of one folk or the numbers not yet finished
Of some folk other. Lot's born family
Was rated in the heavenly tablet's fee
Not to continue in the earthly spree.
Root out, Beloved, whom You will, but
invent
No reasons to give my mind worry spent.
Sin it may be in trying to prevent
Misfortune of extinction, but the pride
Of succession is one come from Your side
On all who obey the first law to be
Progenitors and do so faithfully.

12 In middle of the sixth month YHWH
Visited Sarah and did to
Her as He had spoken and she
Conceived. 13 And she bore a son wee
In the third month, and in the middle
Of the month, at the time *and fiddle*
Of which YHWH had told Abraham,
On the festival of the *yam*,
First fruits of the harvest, was born
Isaac. 14 And Abraham was sworn
To circumcise his son upon
The eighth day: he was the first drawn
To be circumcised according
To covenant everlasting.

Isaac was the first to be circumcised
Upon the eighth day as it was appraised.
His birth on the feast of first fruits was
great,
Although in that place there was threatened
fate
That being cut the second week of June
Was like to bring infection in the noon
Sun of July. So I should have thought twice
About such operations almost vice.
Of course that's not to ignore Sarah's fear
When Abraham took him first of the year
In mock sacrifice to assuage the thirst
Of Canaanite for human offering worst,
Or as it may be at Your own demand.
It is not found in Decalogue's command.

15 And in the sixth year of the week
 Four We came to Abraham's *peek*,
 To Beer Sheba, and we appeared
 To him [as we'd had Sarah feared
 That we should return to her, and
 She'd have conceived a son *in hand*.
 16 In the seventh month We returned,
 And found Sarah with child unspurned
 Before us] and we blessed him, and
 We announced to him all at hand
 Which had been decreed about him,
 That he should not die *nor grow slim*
 Till he should beget six sons more,
 And should see *them* before the door
 Of his death, but *that* in Isaac
 Should his name and descendants' pack
 Be called: 17 and all the children of
 His sons [to be born] should for love
 Be *many* peoples, and be counted
Great with the *earth's* peoples amounted,
 And from the sons of Isaac one
 Should become a holy seed won,
 And should not be counted among
 The peoples. 18 For he should be hung
 A *special* portion of Most High,
 And all his descendants to spy
 Had fallen as possession to
 Alohim, also unto YHWH
 A people for possession true
 Above all nations and it should
 Become a kingdom of priests good
 And holy nation. 19 And We went
 Our way, and we announced as sent
 To Sarah all that we had told
 Him, and they both rejoiced with bold
 Great joy. 20 And he built there an altar
 To YHWH who had *with guiding halter*
 Delivered him, and who was making
 Him rejoice there where he was taking
 His sojourn, and he celebrated
 A festival of joy elated
 In this month seven days, and near
 The altar which he'd built *in fear*
 At Beer Sheba. 21 And he built booths
 For himself and for all the youths
 In his employ upon this feast,
 And he was the first, *not the least*,
 To celebrate Succoth on earth.
 22 And during these seven days' *worth*
 Every day he brought to the place
 Of altar a burnt offering's trace

To YHWH, two oxen, also two
 Rams, seven sheep, one he-goat too,
 For a sin offering, that he might
 By it atone for himself and
 For his children. 23 And, as a thank
 Offering, seven rams, seven rank
 Kids, seven sheep, and seven goats,
 And their fruit offerings, *corn and oats*,
 And their drink offerings, and he burnt
 All the fat on the altar *learnt*,
 A chosen offering unto YHWH
 For a sweet smelling savour's *clue*.

The festival of booths it seems was first
 Made in rejoicing at the news that burst
 On Abraham that six more sons should find
 Their way into his house and heart
 combined

To become nations great and full upon
 The earth spread out and in their favour
 drawn.

But most the festival rejoicing met
 The news of Levi as a tribe unset
 Among the number of Jacob, but to
 Be in itself a nation of priests true.
 This priestly bias of the text is taught
 By scholar for the writer's show when
 caught.

But You and I, Beloved, know what is done
 To make all men who choose priests under
 son.

I turn to You, Beloved, in Abrahamic faith
 And pause to mind on earth of elf and
 wraith

That I sojourn from day to day and seek
 A caravan saray each night to peek
 At stars open above my sleepy head.
 I stop to mind that I am a soul lead
 In whirling through the desert without
 place

Or home or hearth beyond Your hidden
 face.

I meet the wind, the frost, the cold and heat
 And rest my tired frame here at Your feet
 For only that brief hour at which is meet
 To stay, and then go on my weary way
 Rejoicing in the bread and wine the day
 Gives to my soul. Beloved, I cannot stay.

24 And morning and evening he burnt
 Fragrant substances *as he'd learnt*,

Frankincense and galbanum, and
 Stackte, and nard, and myrrh, and band
 Of spice, and costume, all these things
 Seven in number offerings,
 Crushed, mixed together in like parts
And pure. 25 He celebrated arts
 Of this feast during seven days,
 Rejoicing in whole-hearted praise
 With all his soul, he and all those
 Who were in his house, *as he chose*,
 And there was no stranger with him,
 Nor any uncircumcised *grim*.
 26 And he blessed his Creator who
 Had created him in his crew,
 For He'd created him according
 To His good pleasure *and affording*,
 For He knew and perceived that from
 Him would the righteous planting come
 For generations eternal,
 From him a seed angelical,
 So that it should become like Him
 Who'd made all things *with gear and trim*.
 27 And he blessed and rejoiced, and called
 The name of this feast as installed
 The festival of YHWH, a joy
 Acceptable to the employ
 Of Most High El. 28 And we blessed him
 For ever, his seed after him
 Throughout all ages of the earth,
 Because he celebrated worth
 Of this feast in its season's birth,
 According to the witness' girth
 Of heavenly tablets. 29 For this reason
 It is ordained *and in its season*
 Upon the heavenly tablets for
 Israel, that they shall keep more
 The feast of tabernacles then
 For seven days with joy *to men*,
 In seventh month, acceptable
 Before YHWH, statute eternal
 Throughout their generations' toll
 And every year. 30 And to this there
 Is no limit of days, its share
 Is ordained for ever regarding
 Israel that they should with barding
 Celebrate it and live in booths,
 And set wreaths on the heads *of youths*,
 And take leafy boughs, and willows
 From the brook *where the willow grows*.

Where I live seventh month may have new
 frost

To greet the early morning where
 embossed
 With newly fallen leaves the ground shows
 clear
 To greet the crisply standing willows' fear.
 A willow of immense girth on a year
 Fell by my house with root still in the
 ground,
 And under its top there may still be found
 A willow booth with hops growing around
 To kiss the summer days with shade and
 sly
 Myths whispered to an unencumbered sky.
 Beloved, I meet you by the willow thrown
 Down from Your heaven to meet flesh and
 bone,
 And find its silver leaves when each year
 grown
 The promise of a year that's not yet known.

31 Abraham took branches of palm,
 And the fruit of goodly trees *balm*,
 And every day going around
 The altar with the branches' sound
 Seven times [a day] in the morn,
 He praised and gave thanks *as he'd sworn*
 To his God for all things in joy
That on earth and in heaven employ.

Beloved, I too pass through the seven veils
 To find Your face before which all the tales
 Of humankind at last come to a rest.
 I circumambulate the earthly breast
 To rise at dawn a spark to Your throne's
 crest
 To disappear within Your calling heart.
 The festival is only heaven's start.
 Beloved, I too look to the distant sails
 Upon a sea of sturgeon and not whales
 To find the rare and hidden loon's last nest
 Among the wails of prehistoric's best.
 I contemplate full what I observe lest
 I rise at evening having shirked my part
 In Your creations' full and wondered art.

Week 23 Jubilees 17

1 And in the first year of the week
 Five, Isaac was weaned from the seek
 In this jubilee, [1982 A.M.] Abraham
 Made a great banquet *without ham*
 In the third month, and on the day
 His son Isaac was weaned away.

2 And Ishmael, the son of Hagar,
 The Egyptian, *and not to plague her*,
 Was before face of Abraham,
 His father, in his place *and clam*,
 And Abraham rejoiced and blessed
 Alohim since he'd seen confessed
 His sons and had not died childless.
 3 And he remembered the address
 Which He'd spoken to him that day
 On which Lot had parted away
 From him, and he rejoiced because
 YHWH had given him children's paws
 Upon the earth to inherit
 The earth, and he blessed *as was fit*
 With all his mouth the Creator
 Of all things. 4 And Sarah saw more
 Ishmael playing and dancing, and
 Abraham rejoicing at hand
 With great joy, and then she became
 Jealous of Ishmael and *his fame*
 And said to Abraham, "Cast out
 This bondwoman and her son *stout*,
 For the son of this bondwoman
 Will not be heir here with my son,
 Isaac." 5 And the thing was grievous
 In Abraham's sight, for the fuss
 Over his maidservant and *more*
 Because of his son *at the fore*,
 That he should drive them out from him.

How happy Ishmael was in Isaac's joy,
 And Isaac in big brother's simple ploy
 To sing and dance with him about the
 camp.
 The jealousies of grown-ups always damp
 The innocence of love. Beloved, I spring
 Into Your arms to flee the thoughtless ring
 Of human fears. The shrivelled heart's
 offended
 By nothing more than joyfulness attended.
 Beloved, let my heart be plucked clean and
 bare
 Of every hope and joy, the will to share,
 But let it not, beyond the wear and care,
 Shrink to that awful state of foul delection
 That before innocent joy takes exception.
 Bereft if need be, save me that complexion.

6 And Alohim told Abraham,
 "Let it not be grievous to you,
 Because of the child and *his true*
Mother, the bondwoman, in all

That Sarah has said to you, call
 Obedience to her words and do,
 For in Isaac shall your name and
 Seed be called. 7 And of the son *grand*
 Of this bondwoman I will make
 Him a great nation for your sake."

Some would deride denying even promise
 Made to Ishmael. I am a doubting Thomas.
 I doubt, even when You compel the man
 To follow Sarah in her evil plan,
 That You strike off Ishmael and to instate
 His little brother in the golden plate.
 Ishmael would give his very heart for him,
 And Isaac loved few with such cherished
 vim
 As his big brother Ishmael with his bow
 And brash flight into desert's evening
 glow.
 Your grace, Beloved, is broad enough for
 all,
 So how could two be cramped once in
 Your stall?
 Ishmael in joy lifts up the new-weaned
 child,
 Remembering him in desert years and wild.

I here protest, Beloved! Sarah defies
 Your very own decree beneath the skies
 That Ishmael and Isaac should share the
 store
 Of fame and fortune now and evermore.
 Sarah defies the divine word, and yet
 You give in to the jealous female sweat.
 Such patriarchal, chauvinistic skill
 Is like to make the modern cads fall ill.
 I keep me quiet from the jealous score
 And wait in silence on the brazen shore.
 I shall not run the risk that You might start
 To yield to me too in my craven part,
 Although I am no woman, have no heart,
 At least I cover mouth in shame, stand still.

8 And Abraham rose up early
 In the morning, and took bread *free*
 And a bottle of water too,
 And placed them on the shoulders *true*
 Of Hagar and the child, and sent
 Her away. 9 And so out she went
 And wandered in the wilderness
 Of Beer Sheba, until was spent
 The water in the bottle, and

The child was thirsty *on the land*,
Could not go on, and could not stand.

Does no one care that Ishmael thirsts, no
one?

Who have no pity on the thirsty run
The risk of turning on a day of sun
To find the way blocked to the river and the
stream.

There is no spring even in land of dream
For every hand. There's always some
fraught hour

In life when water is not in one's power,
And one must bow in gratitude to him
Who draws the draught from Kauthar to the
rim.

Without water may stand a golden tower,
But not a man. Beloved, I drink the fit
Wine of Your giving, yet I cannot sit
On earth without the alabaster cup
Remembering Ishmael's thirst when time
was up.

10 And his mother took him and cast
Him under an olive tree *fast*,
And went and sat down from his place,
At distance of a bow-shot's trace,
For she said, "Let me never see
The death of my child *by the tree*,"
And sitting there wept *copiously*.

The salty tears of Hagar could not quench
The thirst of Ishmael by the olive bench.
The story is repeated at the wheel
Of Genesis, and yet how few here feel
The wrench at heart for Hagar's sorrow
shone.

I must be hard inured by silver stone
Of new broadcast that daily bring the news
That such and such a mother in the pews
Of famine or catastrophe is lost
In sorrow. Seeing sorrow lessens cost.
Beloved, I do not ask to feel the woe
Felt by the daily denizens that know
The heel of accident and pain and crime.
I do not beg to be loosened from time.

11 And an angel of Alohim,
One of the holy ones *to gleam*,
Said to her, "Hagar, why weep here?
Get up, take the child *without fear*,
And hold him in your hand *for choice*,

For Alohim has heard your voice,
And seen the child." 12 She opened eye,
And saw a well of water by,
And she went there and filled her cup
With water, and she lifted up
Her child and gave him what to drink,
And she arose and left that brink
And went towards the wilderness
Of Paran. 13 And the child *to bless*
Grew and became an archer, and
Alohim was with him *and hand*,
And his mother took him a wife
From Egypt's daughters *full of life*.

The personality of Hagar leaves
Little to view but hem and flowing sleeves.
She wept her hard lot and that of her son,
Courageously she battled on and won
A place for herself under blazing sun,
But sometimes came to her rope's end and
waited
For You alone when all the world was
slated

Against her. It's so still. Sweet Christians
hand
The medals to Sarah, shallow and grand,
Superior for being mistress, not
A servant like Hagar. Yet I've been taught
By trips to Egypt to know that the plot
Of personality there runs as sweet
As any. Hagar must have been a treat.

14 And she bore him a son, and he
Called his name Nebaioth, for she
Said "The Lord was here near to me
When I called upon Him *for free*."

Ah, note, Beloved, and share what You
discern
With all the world who think that You are
stern
With every nation but Israel to learn.
This wife of Ishmael, Egyptian wife
brought
Up from the delta or the river plot,
Shows faith where woman can, she names
her son
After the care that You give when man's
done.

Ah, see, Beloved, no Hebrew woman this
Who brings to You Your honour and a kiss.
Look on the sight, it's not a thing to miss,

And know that thousands more that seem
alone
Also, despite their birth, bow at Your
throne.
There is no race or faith but has its own
Who turn to You from hard hearts and from
stone.

15 And it happened in seventh week,
In the first year that came to peek, [2003
A.M.]

In first month of this jubilee,
In the twelfth of this month, there came
Voices in heaven for Abraham,
That he was faithful in all that
He told him, and that *where he sat*
He loved YHWH, and in every trial
He was faithful *and without guile*.

So Abraham had reputation that
Went far beyond the tent-pin where he sat,
Into the very counsels of Your flight
Beyond the starry winds of day and night.
I look upon a life born like a fish
In silver and gold flashing for a wish,
And find it caught and consumed on a dish,
With nothing left but mess of bones in pile.
Virtue at ending is merely to smile.
I do not look for fame with such fortune,
After I have passed morning and life's
noon,
But ask that after having spoiled the plate,
That something might be left of me for fate
To enter with archangel at fourth gate.

16 And the prince Mastema came and
Said before Alohim, 'Command,
Abraham loves Isaac his son,
And he delights in him *as won*
Above all things, now bid him offer
Him as a burnt-offering to proffer
On the altar, and You will see
If he will do this thing freely,
And You will know if he can be
Faithful in everything whereby
You are pleased to give him a try.

If the prince Mastema is he who came
To invent rites of passage in Your name,
Then do I not well, my Beloved, to seek
No festival beyond the end of week?
Though Abraham delighted in the sons

He sacrificed in the mock ways and runs
That satisfied the populace that went
After Mastema's sacrificial bent
For human flesh, he humbly bowed to Your
Word that came in a vision of the gore
That You seemed to demand in vision spent
In personal awaiting for present.
Beloved, the vision of one man alone
Leaves to be desired, fie on flesh and bone.

17 And YHWH knew that Abraham was
Faithful in all his trials and claws,
For He had tried him through his land
And with famine, and by command
Had tried him with the wealth of kings,
And tried him again through the things
Of his wife, the time she was torn
From him, and with *the bloody thorn*
Of circumcision, and had tried
Him through Ishmael and Hagar's *pride*,
His maid-servant, when he sent them
Away. 18 In every *sleeve and hem*
By which He'd tried him, he was found
Faithful, and his soul was not bound
By impatience, and he was not
Slow to act, for he in his plot
Was faithful and loved YHWH *a lot*.

Your trials, Beloved, did nothing to prove
that

Your servant was a good one where he sat.
For doubt arises still in human breast.
Some deny the existence of the best.
But Your trials bore fruit in the way they
spoke

To the soul of the man beneath the oak.
Your coming in the sweet and in the fair
Raised in his heart the loveliness of air.
But Your coming upon the awful calm
Of horror bleeding beneath sharpened palm
Sanctified that flesh that in service bent
To find love and alone love was unspent.
Beloved, I flee to Your gross punishment
And rise above the scourgings' fatal share.

Jubilees 18

1 And then Alohim said to him,
"Abraham, Abraham," at rim
He said "Indeed, *here am I*." 2 And
He said "Take your beloved son's hand
Whom You love, *even* Isaac, and
Go into the high country, and

Offer him on one of the hills
 Which I'll point out to you." 3 *With chills*
 He rose early in morning *light*
 And saddled his ass, *in delight*
 Took his two young men with him, and
 Isaac his son, and chopped *by hand*
 The wood of the burnt offering's *stand*,
 And he came to the place *preferred*
 On the third day, he saw *in word*
 The place afar off. 4 And he came
 To a well of water *in fame*,
 And said to his young men, 'Abide
 Here with the donkey, and I'll side
 With the lad to go *yonder*, when
 We'll worship and come back *with care*.'

Really, Beloved, was it not once enough
 That you regarded Sarah in the buff
 And yielded righteousness and justice to
 Her jealousy in stench come up to view?
 Now must you yield to Mastema, the one
 That Christians call the devil when they're
 done?

Religious practice that's accommodation
 To evil, even if of divine station,
 Must end sometime, and soon with an
 elation,

As temporary lot of just one nation.
 Beloved, I see the rites go to the dust
 That are not mentioned in gold without rust
 In Decalogue of truth above the skies
 Where Sinai's mountain still rears up to
 rise.

Here You neglect the word only for son,
 The word in Genesis that shows the run
 Was merely ritual, rite of passage
 That had its set formula and its age.
 The lack is of little import, and will
 Quieten perhaps rumours of the bill
 That claims the text is broken by desire
 To make Isaac alone the son of fire.
 Vain hopes. Mankind always looks at Your
 word

Ten degrees below how he looks at turd.
 I set aside deduction and the hand
 Of my experience upon the land
 And step into the burning fire of love
 And find You still beneath, within, above.

5 And he took the wood of the burnt-
 Offering and laid it *out as learnt*

On Isaac his son, and he took
 In his hand the fire *like a book*
 And the knife, and they both went out
 Together to that place *devout*.
 6 And Isaac asked his father, "Father,"
 And he said "Here am I, *no bother*,
 My son." And then he said to him,
 "Indeed the fire, and the knife *grim*,
 And the wood, but where is the sheep
 For burnt-offering, father, to keep?"
 7 He said "Alohim will provide
 For Himself a sheep to abide
 As a burnt-offering, my son." And
 He drew near to the place *at hand*
 Of the mount of Alohim. 8 And
 He built an altar, and he placed
 The wood on the altar, *enlaced*
 And bound Isaac his son, and placed
 Him on the wood which was upon
 The altar, and stretched forth to drawn
 Knife in his hand to slay Isaac
 His son. 9 And I stood and not slack
 Before him, and before the prince
 Mastema, and YHWH said *in glints*,
 "Tell him not to lay hand on lad,
 Nor do anything to him bad,
 For I have shown that he fears YHWH."
 10 I called to him from heavenly *crew*,
 And said unto him, "Abraham,
 Abraham," he said "Here I am,
 Indeed," though terrified. 11 And I
 Said to him, "Lay not your hand on
 The lad, neither do any con
 To him, for now I've shown that You
 Fear YHWH, and have not withheld *true*
 Your son, your first-born son, from me."

Each in the drama knows his practiced
 lines,
 Isaac asked for the sheep, though wood and
 vines
 And fire are ready, Abraham by rote
 Repeats the ancient ceremonies note.
 Vicarious the sacrifice is done
 Throughout the ancient world and under
 sun
 Of modern times in many a tribe's vale.
 None of humankind is outside the pale.
 Each son at puberty must die and then
 Be raise to the life lived by the grown men.
 You look upon the rites, Beloved, and
 smile,

And say Your lines too perfect, without
guile.
Beloved, I set my heart to obey You
As well as Abraham obeyed earth's crew.

Your angel, the angel of YHWH, dictates
The book of Jubilees where Moses waits,
And sometimes in the narrative may come
In Your name, my Beloved, as though the
strum
Were from Your breath without angel
between,
As though there were no messenger there
seen.
And yet I know the hand that kept the knife
From snuffing out the precious silver life
Of Isaac and of Ishmael in his day
Was that of the angel sent in the way.
Beloved, though I may think I see Your
past
And hear Your words on breath of the
unfast,
I know that none see or hear You as You
Are, but as angel of the Lord in view.

12 And the prince Mastema was put
To shame, *and shamed from head to foot*.
And Abraham lifted his eyes
And looked, and, *as come from the skies*,
Indeed there was a ram caught . . . by
His horns, and Abraham went nigh
And took the ram and offered it
For a burnt-offering *and one fit*
Instead of his son. 13 Abraham
Called that place "YHWH's seen *where I*
am,"

So that it is said YHWH has seen,
That is Mount Sion *and ravine*.

Praised be Your name, Beloved, if sacred
rite,
Invented by Mastema, puts to flight
His pride and power. You turn the evil
notion
To good as soon as it's put into motion.
I lift my eyes from earthly sacrifice,
The knife held firmly in my grasp and vice,
And hear Your voice, expected though it be
In the rounded words of ceremony,
And through the curtain of theatre's glint
I hear the whispers of the light and hint
That You are all the real behind the fair

And behind the ugliness everywhere.
Though snow is white to cover muddy
stains,
Your covering is core down to the pains.

14 And YHWH called Abraham by name
A second time from heaven's hame,
As he caused us to come to speak
To him, in the name of YHWH *seek*.
15 And he said "By Myself I've sworn,
Says YHWH, because you've done
unshorn

This thing, and not withheld your son,
Your beloved son, from Me *when done*,
That in blessing I will bless you,
And in multiplying you too
I will multiply your seed *true*.
As the stars of the sky they'll be,
And as the sand upon the sea.

16 "And your seed shall inherit *all*
Their enemies' cities in stall,
And in your seed shall all the folk
Of the earth be blessed, as I spoke
So you've obeyed My voice, and I
Have shown to all both far and nigh
That You are faithful to Me in
All that I've told you without sin.
Go in peace." 17 And Abraham went
To his young men, and *as were sent*
They got up, together arrived
In Beer Sheba *as all survived*.

The promises to Abraham are given
To all his seed, both shriven and unshriven,
And all the families of earth to bless
Or curse as each one will, to know or
guess.

The promises are kept in every soul
That rises with the sun to reach his goal,
They echo in the heart and mind and
tongue
Of those who bow beneath rosary strung
And those who merely plough the sod and
floor
Of factory to find nothing the more
Than bread and beer. Each one lives in the
blessing
Or fear. Beloved, I touch promise
addressing
To You my plaint, petition, praise and
penance.

I enter with the throng of Your house
tenants.

18 And Abraham [2010 A.M.] lived by the
Well

Of the Oath, *or Beer Sheba's tell*,
Celebrated this festival

Each year, as seven days with joy,
And called it festival's employ
To YHWH according to the day
Of seven when he went his way
And returned in peace *or Islam*.

19 And as it was ordained in psalm
And written on the heavenly plates
Regarding Israel's estates
And his folk that they should observe
This feast seven days *and not swerve*
But with the joy of feasting's verve.

The Passover is reaffirmed each time
The soul enters the new year and its clime
And sees the spring return. The gesture
from

The renewed heart is not of heathendom
Despite the mock death and arising come.
Mastema's faith is tattered by the wear
Of even those who fail to see Your share.
The spring rite follows Isaac to his fate,
The autumn one Ishmael at the last gate.
Between the two Noah's great celebration
Of resurrection comes to greet the nation.
I too, Beloved, awake and take my station
To slay myself upon the slaughter ground
And whirl of as burnt offering at the sound.

Week 24 Jubilees 19

1 And in the first year of the first
Week in the forty-second *burst*
Of jubilee, Abraham came
Back and lived opposite *the frame*
Of Hebron, that is Kirjath Arba,
Two weeks of years *he stayed in harbour*.

2 And in the first year of the third
Week of this jubilee as heard
The days of Sarah's life occurred
As accomplished, and she died in
Hebron. 3 And Abraham *with din*
Went to mourn her and to bury
Her, and we tried him [too to see]
If his spirit were patient and
He were not indignant at hand
In the words of his mouth, and he

Was found patient in this, was not
Disturbed by *what became his lot*.

I might have thought the trouble Sarah gave
It might be some relief to find her grave,
But then Abraham like women and men
Before and after him, loved and again
In love saw not the blemishes she had.
The outward beauty too covers the bad
In heart and character, a thing that's sad.
No wonder so many with rankling smile
Engage in facelift or makeover's pile.
But Abraham takes all in patience, both
The beauty of Sarah and what she quoth
Of evil to darken Abraham's days.
Beloved, I grasp the patience of his stays,
And stop to praise You in my roundelays.

4 For in patience of spirit he
Conversed with the children of Heth,
That they should give him where *in death*
A place to bury *all* his dead.

5 And YHWH gave him grace before all
Who saw him, and he begged in thrall
With gentleness the sons of Heth,
And they gave him *for his last breath*
The field of the double cave near
Mamre, that is Hebron, for *clear*
Four hundred pieces of silver.

6 And they begged him and to aver
Saying "We shall give it to you
For nothing," but he would not chew
A thing for nothing from their hands,
For he gave the price of the lands,
The full amount, and he bowed down
Before them twice *before the town*,
And after this buried his dead
In the double cave *for a bed*.

The pride of humankind is that the way
Must always be paid with one's own coin's
sway.

I doubt not Abraham knew that mankind
Is like the beast, the burden of the hind,
Whose breath goes forth and there's no
matter where

He sheds the feeble flesh and bones that
share

His wondered voyage on the cosmic air.
He bought the field with coin taken from
earth

Knowing that all is as nothing of worth

Or else of infinite in gratitude.
He bought to make glad Heth's sons
without feud.
I too know the joy that gives full amount
For what I get of space in which to count
Your blessings in air, nourishment and
fount.

7 And all the days of Sarah's life
Were one hundred and twenty-seven
Years, that is, two jubilees' *strife*
And four weeks and one year *in heaven*:
These are the days of the years of
The life of Sarah *and her love*.

One hundred twenty-seven years of fame
As wife of Abraham, fugitive's flame,
Count but a drop upon the jubilee.
At fifty-five I scarcely rise to see
What she must have known of the desert
way,
Of human hearts, and how the camels
sway,
And where the water seeps up from the dry,
And how to read the writing of the sky.
She grew up in the urban wealth and leisure
Only to be driven out of its treasure
Into the howling, empty, sanded measure
Of waiting. My Beloved, for every soul
There is a time when she has seen the goal
Struck to the heart, taken in Sarah's toll.

8 This is the tenth trial wherewith
Abraham was tried, *not a myth*,
And he was found faithful *in all*,
Patient in spirit *to the call*.
9 And he said not a single word
About the rumour in the land
How Alohims saying averred
That He would give it in his hand
And to his seed after him too,
And he begged place there to accrue
And bury his dead, for he was
Found faithful, and was as he does
Recorded on the heavenly plates
As friend of Alohims *and mates*.

Ten trials and only ten come to meet men
And women in this world of light and glen.
Ten words in command or in promise
spoken

On Mount Sinai, and writ on tablets
broken,
Make trial of every soul on earth to show
Whether experiment in flesh in tow
Is worth the dearth of sense when on the
go.
The breath of life, the "I" that You have
spent
On every man and woman was not sent
Alone to eat and reproduce awhile.
You wished to see the universe in guile
Of veils to know how flesh would meet the
trial,
In ecstasy or pain a further mile.
Each soul at last finds out what You once
meant.

10 And in the fourth year thereof he
Took a wife for his son *in fee*
Isaac and her name was Rebekah [2020
A.M.]
[The daughter of Bethuel's echo,
The son of Nahor, brother of
Abraham] Laban's sister love
And daughter of Bethuel, and
Bethuel was the son in hand
Of Melca, who was Nahor's wife,
Brother of Abraham *for life*.

It took Abraham one extra lifetime
In generations to produce in prime
A son ready for marriage, one might think.
But no, it was Isaac late at the brink
At forty years who at last caught a wife.
Here are the cousin kinships come to life
In cross-cousin marriages to the fife,
And later the avunculate in strife
With Laban and his sister's son with knife.
The parallel tradition is here first,
Which is a thing remarkable to burst,
And how they find the path to make the
change
Is something that I at least have found
strange.
In my observing I step out of range.

11 And Abraham took to himself
A third wife, *not satyr nor elf*,
And her name was Keturah, from
Among the daughters of his sum
In household servants, for Hagar
Had died before Sarah *in scar*.

The only note of Hagar's death it seems
Is here between Abraham's female dreams.
At least the writer knows Abraham loved
The bright Hagar until the day she shoved,
Or he would not have mentioned her
demise

Before Abraham married the last prize.
Keturah without Sarah to impede
Was able to produce a great stampede,
As Hagar might have done without the pill
Of Sarah pushing her against her will.
Beloved, I recognize the beauty still
And greatness of all three wives on the hill.
Two mothers of prophets, one left to fill
The mundane task of keeping domicile.

And she bare him six sons, Zimram,
12 And Jokshan, Medan, and Midian,
And Ishbak, and Shuah *in pram*,
In the two weeks of years *left him*.
13 And in the sixth week, in the *rim*
Of its second year, came to bear
Rebekah to Isaac two sons,
Jacob and Esau's *benisons*,
And [2046 A.M.] Jacob was smooth and
upright,

And Esau was fierce *in his sight*,
A man of the field, hairy, while
Jacob lived in tents *with a smile*.

If I should choose between the field and
tent,
Judging by how my ways in childhood
went,
I figure I should be like bold Esau
In that I often sleep beneath the maw
Of the bare sky to see the stars at last
Before my eyelids quivered and down cast.
If I should choose between smooth and the
hair,

I think I'd be like Esau of the pair.
But I am neither upright, no, nor fierce,
Although at times oddities may transpierce
My rampant equanimity severe.
So neither Rebekah nor Isaac would
Have favoured me among the bad and
good.
An outcast among those I'd be, I fear.

14 And the youths grew, and Jacob learned
To write, but Esau learning spurned,

For he was a man of the field,
A hunter, and he learnt war's yield,
And all his deeds were fierce *and strong*.
15 And Abraham loved Jacob, but
Isaac loved Esau *for his cut*.

The book of Genesis give mother all
The fault of claiming Jacob for the call.
It makes more sense that Abraham mixed
in
The family to cause the row and din.
As grandfather I know myself how true
It is that mixing into younger crew
Is tempting, such a tempting thing to do.
So Abraham and Isaac favour best
Each the son each would at the last invest.
Beloved, I sometimes think human
relations

Are nothing but a waste of time in nations.
There's too much pawing in attempt to
keep
Time from moving on in its giant sweep
Into the still and calm of the great deep.

16 And Abraham saw Esau's deeds,
And knew that in Jacob were seeds
Of his name, and he called Rebekah
And gave commandment *not to peck her*
Regarding Jacob, for he knew
That she loved Jacob much more too
Than Esau. And he said to her:
17 My daughter, watch what will occur
To my son Jacob, for he shall
Be in my stead on earth *a pal*,
And for a blessing among men,
And for the glory come again
Of the whole seed of Shem. 18 For I
Know that YHWH will choose him to ply
A people for possession to
Himself, above all folk that do
Reside upon the face of earth.
19 Indeed, Isaac my son in worth
Holds Esau more than Jacob, but
I see that You truly clear cut
Love Jacob. 20 Add still further to
Your kindness to him *as you do*,
Let your eyes be on him in love,
For he shall be blessing above
To us on the earth and from now
And to all ages of earth's *brow*.

As Abraham rises above the stroke

Of mere delight in smoothness to the oak,
 Above affection's selfishness and steel
 To clear sight on the hearth and on the heel,
 He finds the wisdom to predict the weal
 Of Jacob and his blessing to all folk
 Who live on earth, to those who know his
 name
 And those who merely live against his fame
 With diamond of truth in righteous breast,
 Without the syllables of Jacob's vest.
 The prophecy of Abraham's well shown
 To be true as Jacob's brightest of bone
 In Moses fled to Sinai to atone
 For what among men had been to their
 shame.

21 Let your hands be strong also let
 Your heart rejoice in your son yet,
 In Jacob, For I've loved him far
 Beyond all my sons *similar*.
 He shall be blessed for ever, and
 His seed shall fill the whole earth's *land*.
 22 If a man can number the sand
 Of the earth, His seed also shall
 Be numbered *though inimical*.
 23 And all the blessings wherewith YHWH
 Has blessed me and my children's crew
 Shall belong to Jacob and his
 Seed always. 24 And in his seed's *biz*
 My name shall be blessed, and the name
 Of my fathers, Shem, and the same
 Noah, Enoch, Mahalalel,
 And Enos, and Seth, and *the swell*
 Adam. 25 And these shall serve to lay
 The foundations of heaven's way,
 And to strengthen the earth, renew
 All the lights in firmament's due."

In Genesis the promises You gave
 Were always spoken to the man, not slave.
 Here Abraham contrives to transmit to
 A woman what before was just man's due.
 Transmission of the great and faithful trust
 Is something sacred, and as sacred must
 Be given to the one best fitted for
 The keeping of the eternal in score.
 It's choosing man above woman's estate
 That makes so often garbled faith of late.
 The heart open to what seems foolishness
 To men is often the only address
 Whereby You can preserve a hint and guess

Of what You would, Beloved, come here to
 bless.

26 He called Jacob before the eyes
 Of Rebekah his mother *wise*,
 And kissed him, and blessed him, and said
 27 "Jacob, my beloved son *and led*,
 Whom my soul loves, may Alohim
 Bless you from above heaven's *dream*,
 And may He bless you wherewith He
 Blessed Adam, and Enoch, and see
 Noah, and Shem, with all the things
 Of which He told me, all the things
 Which He promised to give me, may
 He cause to cleave to you *today*
 And to your seed for ever, long
 As days *and years* of heaven's *song*
 Above the earth. 28 "And spirits of
 Mastema shall not rule above
 You or over your seed to turn
 You from the Lord, who is *to learn*
 Your God from henceforth evermore.
 29 "And may YHWH Alohim before
 Be a father to you and you
 The first-born son, and in the view
 Of the people always. 30 "Now go
 In peace, my son, *to meet the show*."
 And then they went forth, both of them
 Together from Abraham's hem.
 31 And Rebekah loved Jacob, and
 With all her heart and all her soul,
 Very much more than Esau's *hand*,
 But Isaac loved Esau a whole
 Lot more than Jacob *in his land*.

Abraham by-passed Isaac when he gave
 The blessing to Jacob, the willing slave.
 In presence of his mother and alone
 He gave the blessing without broken bone
 Of seasoned game in pottage boiled with
 stone.
 The blessing fraught with eating is the
 source
 Of human destiny caught in remorse.
 Who taste the microwave's brash store
 would dream
 Of the electric range that made the cream
 Taste better, but back of that is the fire
 Of gas that leaves nothing yet to desire
 But the cookstove of wood, and that tastes
 less
 Than open fireplace used to make in mess.

But nothing tastes so good as stone-boiled
cress.

Jubilees 20

1 The forty-second jubilee,
The first year of the seventh week,
Abraham called Ishmael to be, [2052
(2045?) A.M.]

And his twelve sons, Isaac *to seek*
His two sons, and the six sons of
Keturah, and their sons *for love*.

2 And he commanded them that they
Should observe the way of YHWH, they
Should work righteousness *every day*,
And love each his neighbour, and act
In this way towards all men *in fact*,
That they should each so walk to do
Judgement and righteousness on the earth.

3 That they should circumcise the crew
Of their sons, according to worth
In the covenant which He made
With them, and not turn as if strayed
To the right hand or to the left
From all the paths which YHWH enfeoffed
To us, and also that we keep
Ourselves from fornication's creep
And uncleanness, [and renounce from
Amongst us all uncleanness' sum].

Abraham gave commandment to his sons,
And treated all alike before the runs
Of righteousness, all alike should relate
To judgement and keep Your laws in pure
state.

The true faith was not given but to one
To hold alone in his family when done.
Isaac was not the only circumcised
And entered in to covenant apprised,
But so was Ishmael and also the young
Sons of Keturah, all were given tongue.
Who now imagine that one nation here
Has right and duty to live in Your fear
And love ignores the universal tear.
All return to Your face and all appear.

4 And if any woman or maid
Commit fornication's *parade*
Among you, burn her then with fire
And let them not commit for ire
Such fornication with her after
Their eyes and their heart's *mocking*
laughter,

And let them not take wives among
Canaanite daughters *to be stung*,
For the seed of Canaan will be
Rooted out of the land *freely*.

The fornication of Canaan is not
Merely in images and false gods got,
Nor in free use of fertility's plot
In sacred prostitute and dog begot.
Canaan's first sin, the one that sealed his
doom

Was setting in Shem's sons' places and
room

Instead of plodding on along the shore
Of northern Africa to find his score.
As You, Beloved, have set the bounds to
each

As where they should live, cultivate and
teach,

You also remember the failure to
Keep in sight and in love the land that's
due.

The son of wanderers in a stranger's land
I have no roots to root out with my band.

5 He told them of the giants' judgement,
He told of the Sodomites' judgement,
How they had been judged on account
Of their wickedness's amount,
And had died in their fornication,
And uncleanness, and in the nation
Corruption through their fornication.
6 "And guard yourselves from all
uncleanness

And fornication and from meanness
Of sin, lest you make of our name
A curse, and your whole life a shame,
And all your sons to be destroyed
By the sword, and you once enjoyed
Become accursed like Sodom, and
All your remnant as sons in land
Of Gomorrah. 7 "I implore you,
My sons, love the God and the true
Of heaven and cling to His commands.
And do not walk by idols' *hands*,
And after their uncleannesses,
8 "And make not for yourselves what is
Molten or graven idols, for
They are a vanity *in store*,
And there is no spirit in them,
For they are work of *men's hands' gem*,
And all who trust in them, trust naught.

9 "Do not serve them, nor worship aught,
 But serve the most high Alohim,
 And worship Him awake or dream,
 Always await, hope for His face,
 And work uprightness *in your place*
 And righteousness before Him *too*,
 That He may have pleasure in you
 And grant you His mercy, and send
 Rain upon you morning and *end*
Of day at evening, and bless all
 Your works done on the earth *in stall*,
 And bless your bread and bless your drink,
 And bless the fruit of your womb's brink
 And the fruit of your land, and bless
 The herds of your cattle, and dress
 The flocks of your sheep. 10 "And you will
 Be for a blessing on earth's *hill*,
 And all nations of the earth will
 Desire you, and bless your sons in
 My name, that they may be blessed kin
 As I am." 11 And he gave Ishmael
 And to his sons, and without guile
 To the sons of Keturah, gifts,
 And sent them away from the drifts
 Of Isaac his son, and he gave
 Everything to Isaac his son.
 12 And Ishmael and his sons, the brave,
 And sons of Keturah *when done*
 And their sons, went together and
 Lived from Paran up to the land
 Of entering in to Babylon
 In all the land *under the sun*
 Which is towards the East toward
 The desert *and the desert's sword*.
 13 And these mingled together, and
 Their name was called throughout the land
 Arabs, and Ishmaelites *in band*.

Even this day descendants of the man
 Make tracks across the desert's caravan.
 Even this day the Arab looks abroad
 Upon the hills that Abraham once trod,
 And in his white and flowing garb remains
 To bow before Your throne upon the
 plains.
 I've heard the rising voice call all the
 prayer,
 I've seen the minaret rise on the air,
 And joined the line of men come from the
 fields
 To bow beneath the green and glittering
 yields.

Beloved, I see the sons of Hagar and
 Keturah press across their barren land,
 And then returned to bow alone before
 The birch and firs upon my own lakeshore.

Jubilees 21

1 And in the sixth year of the week
 Number seventh this jubilee
 Abraham called Isaac *to seek*
 His son, and [2057 (2050?) A.M.]
 commanded him *free*,
 Saying "I'm old, know not the day
 Of my death, and am full of days.
 2 "And indeed, I am on my way
 One hundred seventy-five years' sway,
 And throughout all of my life's days
 I have remembered YHWH *for praise*,
 And sought with all my heart to do
 His will, and to walk right and true
 In all His ways. 3 "My soul has hated
 Idols, given my heart *unabated*
 And spirit that I might observe
 To do the will of Him, not swerve
 From Him it was created me.
 4 "For He's Alohim, lives to be,
 And He's faithful, and He's holy,
 And He is righteous beyond all,
 And there's with Him no unjust fall
 Accepting of *men's* persons and
 No accepting gifts *at their hand*,
 For Alohim is righteous, and
 Executes judgment on all those
 Who transgress His commandments' *rose*
 And despise His covenant's *verve*.
 5 "And do, my son, then to observe
 His commandments and ordinance
 And His judgments, and do not dance
 After the abominations
 And after graven idols' buns,
 And after molten images.
 6 "And eat no blood at all that is
 Of animals or cattle, or
 Of any *kind of bird in store*
 That flies upon the face of sky.
 7 "And if you slay a victim by
 An acceptable peace offering,
 Slay it, and pour out its blood *spring*
 Upon the altar, all the fat
 Of the offering offer thereat
 Upon the altar with fine flour
 And the meat offering *in its hour*
 Mingled with oil, with its drink due,

Offer them all together too
 On the altar of burnt offering,
 It is a sweet savour *to spring*
 Before YHWH. 8 “And You will offer
 The fat of the sacrifice stir
 Of thank offerings upon the fire
 Which is on the altar and byre,
 And the fat which is on the belly,
 And all the fat on inward welly
 And the two kidneys, and the fat
 That is upon them, and where sat
 The loins and liver You’ll remove,
 Together with the kidneys’ *groove*.

Keeping commandments is a thing that’s
 nice

As well as right, but I find sacrifice
 A squeamish thing, and more than that
 requiring

Ignoring command not to kill retiring.
 I do not mind the oil nor spurn the wine,
 But balk at blood of goat and blood of kine.
 I do not want the fat thing for myself,
 And as for meat I’d rather gift the elf
 Than have it on my plate. How can You
 smell

The sacrificial smoke and think it well?
 I do not want the liver, You may have
 The whole of it as well as horse of Slav.
 Beloved, I hear the limiting You set
 On slaughter and sacrifice once they’re
 met.

9 “And offer all these for a sweet
 Savour acceptable *as treat*
 Before YHWH, with its meat-offering
 And with its drink-offering *and spring*,
 For a sweet savour, and the bread
 Of the offering to YHWH *as said*.

10 “And eat its meat on that day and
 On the second day by command,
 And let not sun on second day
 Go down upon it in its way
 Till it is eaten, and let none
 Of it be left over to sun
 Of the third day, for it is not
 Acceptable *because of rot*
 And let it no longer be eaten,
 And all who eat of it unbeaten
 Will bring sin on themselves *like cretin*,
 For so I’ve found it written in
 My forefathers’ books *without sin*,

And in the words of Enoch, and
 In the words of Noah *to stand*.”

I wonder that the book of Enoch taught
 According to Abraham that the plot
 Of eating any meat at all by plan
 Was righteous thing to do for any man.
 Genesis brings meat to the fore when flood
 Had destroyed everything that had no
 blood,

And every green tree with its fruit and bud,
 And left only the seven of the clean.
 Only under dire circumstance was seen
 The command to up, slay and cook and eat.
 Since then killing has become sort of treat.
 The slayer’s heart is seen in every land,
 In every army and in every band
 Of officers and clerics at king’s hand.

11 “And on all your oblations you
 Shall pour salt, and let not the view
 Of covenant’s salt lack in all
 Your oblations before YHWH’s call.

Ah salt! Forget not salt! The Doukhobor
 Is right at least upon bread and salt’s score.
 My oblation is but myself alone,
 My blood and flesh and tender, slender
 bone,

My hands and feet, my body and my soul.
 That’s all I bring alive in offerings goal.
 Thank goodness when I taste the back of
 hand

I find I’m salty and not contraband.
 Perhaps, though imperfect, my offering
 Is acceptable at Your hearth and spring.
 If not, the fault is Yours who did create
 Me from a clot, a breath and clay to sate
 The water from which all things living ring.
 Beloved, look on this burnt lamb shivering.

12 “And as for sacrificial wood,
 Beware of bringing *other* wood
 For the altar besides these kinds:
 Cypress, bay, almond, fir, and *blinds*
Of pine, cedar, savin, and fig,
 Olive, myrrh, laurel, and *the big*
 Aspalathus. 13 “And of these kinds
 Of wood lay on the altar under
 The sacrifice, such *without wonder*
 As have been tested for their sight,
 And do not lay *there* any blight

Of split or dark wood, *but* the hard
And clean, without fault, and *unbarred*
A sound and new growth, do not lay
There old wood, [for its fragrance gay
Is gone] for there's no longer scent
In it as before *the scent went*.

14 "Besides these kinds of wood there's
none

Other that you shall place when done,
For the fragrance is gone away,
And the smell of its fragrance gay
Does not go up to heaven's way.

The Torah does not relay what You like
About the sacrifice when brought in spike.
From that writing I might have taught the
smell

Of burning flesh was what it took to tell
You happiness, but now I know the truth
Is that You love sweet smelling wood for
ruth

That leaves a perfume on the air when
burnt.

The sweetest woods there I know I have
learnt

Are what You seek. Here in the place
where I

Live and eat, sleep, in comfort keeping dry,
There are no such woods but the slender
one

Called juniper for berries under sun.
Unfortunately by the law that's here
I cannot cut and burn that wood this year.

15 "Observe this commandment and do,
My son, to be both right and true
In all your deeds. 16 "And at all times
Be clean in your body, *with rimes*
Wash yourself in water *and clean*
Before you approach to be seen
To offer on the altar, and
Wash yourself both your foot and hand
Before you draw near to the *band*
Of the altar, and when You've done
Sacrificing, wash *under sun*

Again your hands, again your feet.

17 "And let no blood appear to greet
Upon you nor upon your clothes,
Be on your guard, my son, in throes
Against blood, be upon your guard
Exceedingly, cover it *scarred*
With dust. 18 "And do not eat the blood

For it is the soul, eat no blood
Whatever. 19 "And take no gifts for
The blood of man, lest it be gore
Shed with impunity, without
Judgement, for it's the blood without
That's shed that causes earth to sin,
And the earth cannot be within
Cleansed from the blood of man but by
The blood of him who shed it nigh.

Baptisms often offered and replete
With washing of both face and hands and
feet,

And the whole body, are required to meet
You, my Beloved, in sacrifice before
The altar when the soul comes from the
store.

Ablution is right by this word when one
Comes to the altar, and when offering's
done.

I bring myself in sacrifice and feel
The cleansing water makes its own appeal
For righteousness. And yet I know the
stand

Of sacrifice is not required in hand,
But because human hearts are bloated with
The heathen sacrifice of song and myth,
You accept limited editions' band.

20 "And take no present, take no gift
For the blood of a man to lift:
Blood for blood, that you be accepted
Before YHWH, the Most High excepted
Alohim, for He is defence

Of the good: and that your presence
May be preserved from every wrong,
And that He may save you from throng
Of every kind of death. 21 "I see,
My son, that all the works agree
Of the children of men in sin
And wickedness, and every bin
Of all their deeds is uncleanness,
Abomination and a mess.
And with them there's no righteousness.

The holy Qur'an more than just allows
The payment for some slaying without
vows.

The Torah thinks that blood for blood be
shown

Is the best way to come before Your throne,
Prohibiting the mercy that is known

To later generations of such cows.
 The truth is mercy in Qur'an has spent
 Itself in treasures before swine relent.
 To buy one's way out of a murder suit
 Results in more and more eager pursuit
 Of killing for such slight honours has had
 Brother against sister for weddings bad.
 Beloved, I look back to Your first word's
 pain
 And in its threat regain the safe and sane.

22 "Beware you do not walk their ways
 And tread in their paths *or their stays*,
 And sin a sin that is to death
 Before Most High God *on your breath*.

Beware indeed! I wonder if Qur'an
 Had made the same call to Abraham's
 spawn,
 They had been careful not to kill the pawn.
 I doubt indeed, knowing the road upon
 Which human steps dance, that warning of
 wrong
 Would suffice for a changing in the song.
 The melodies of childhood must remain
 And nothing can efface their grace and
 pain.
 Once taught to drink blood and to dip the
 sword,
 There's no returning, not even to Lord.
 Beloved, let me beware the ways I've
 learned
 To trod from childhood that Your laws
 have spurned,
 And give me grace to waken from the
 dream
 The populace in stranglehold would seem.

Else He will [hide His face from you
 And] give you back into the crew
 Of your transgression *and their due*,
 And root you out of the land *true*,
 And your seed likewise under heaven,
 And your name and your seed *and leaven*
 Shall perish from the whole earth *new*.
 23 "Turn away from all their deeds and
 All their uncleanness *in the land*,
 And observe Most High God's command,
 And do His will and be upright
 In all things. 24 "And He will *with might*
 Bless you in all your deeds, and will
 Raise up from you a plant *and hill*

Of righteousness through all the earth,
 Throughout all ages of the earth,
 And my name and your name shall not
 Be forgotten but ever taught
 Under heaven. 25 "Go now, my son
 In peace. May the Most High when done,
 Alohim, my God and your God,
 Strengthen you to do *on the sod*
 His will, and may He bless your seed
 And all their residue indeed
 For all the ages and for ever,
 With all righteous blessings *and clever*,
 That You may be a blessing on
 All the earth." 26 When he had withdrawn
 From him he went rejoicing on.

Abraham looks that his name shall be
 known
 Along with Yours, Beloved, on earthly
 stone.
 That's why, no doubt, prayer in prostration
 seals
 Its words with contract of two worthy
 deals,
 Your unity above all things in field,
 And blessings on the prophet and his yield.
 In blessing Abraham and progeny
 Of prophets and divine guides on his tree,
 I pray I may be blessing on the earth
 And channel of Your love for what it's
 worth.
 Beloved, at this end of earth's history
 I mind the words of Abraham's decree,
 And bless both his name and Your own to
 be
 The hallmark of my prayer for unity.

Week 25 Jubilees 22

1 And it happened in the first week
 In the forty-fourth jubilee,
 In the second year *at its peak*,
 That is, in the year in whose fee
 Abraham died, that Isaac and
 Ishmael came from Beer Sheba's land
 To celebrate the feast of weeks,
 That is, the feast of first fruits' peaks
 Of the harvest to Abraham,
 Their father, and then Abraham
 Rejoiced because his two sons came.
 2 For Isaac rich in gear *and name*
 Was in Beer Sheba, and Isaac
 Used to go out and see his pack

Of possessions and then return
 To his father *and not to spurn*.
 3 And in those days Ishmael came out
 To see his father *round about*,
 And they both came together, and
 Isaac offered a sacrifice
 For a burnt offering, *from his hand*
 Presented it *as to suffice*
 Upon his father's altar nice
 Which he'd made in Hebron *precise*.
 4 And he offered a thank offering
 And made a feast of joy to spring
 Before Ishmael, his brother: and
 Rebekah made new cakes and grand
 From the new corn, and gave in hand
 To Jacob, her son, to take them
 To Abraham, his father's *hem*,
 And from the first fruits of the land,
 That he might eat and bless in band
 Creator of all things before
 He died. 5 And Isaac, too, in store
 Sent by the hand of Jacob to
 Abraham a best thank offering,
 That he might eat and drink *there too*.
 6 And he ate and drank *of the spring*,
 Blessed Most High God for everything,
 Who has created heaven and earth,
 Who's made all the fat things of worth
 Upon the earth, and given them
 To the children of men *as gem*
 That they might eat and drink and bless
 Their Creator *in their address*.

Isaac and Ishmael come as brother and
 As friends to honour Abraham in band,
 And keep the feast of firstfruits in the land.
 All is at peace, there is no discord's sham
 Among the descendants of Abraham.
 Who keep Your law and welcome time of
 praise
 And thanks to You, and then an offering
 raise,
 Need not find use for bickering in ways
 That part brother from brother where they
 stand.
 It's possible to have peace in the land
 And give to each his due with ample hand.
 Who keep Your simple law and praise
 Your name
 Have no reason to infringe on the claim
 Of brother, father, son all share their game.

7 'And now I give thanks unto You,
 My God, because You have in due
 Caused me to see this day: indeed,
 I'm one hundred seventy-five years,
 An old man full of days *to plead*,
 And all my days as it appears
 Have been in peace to my Islam.
 8 The sword of the foe under palm
 Has not overcome me in all
 That You have given in my thrall,
 And my children all my life's days
 Until this day. 9 My God *of praise*,
 May Your mercy and Your peace be
 Upon Your servant, and in fee
 Upon the seed of his sons, that
 They may be to You where You sat
 A chosen nation and in heir
 From among all the nations' air
 Of the earth from now till the days
 Of all the ages of earth's *praise*,
 Unto all ages.' 10 And he called
 Jacob and said 'My son installed,
 Jacob, may the God of all bless
 You and strengthen in righteousness,
 And His will before Him, and may
 He choose you and your seed today
 That you may become heritage,
 A folk following His will's page
 Forever. And do you, my son,
 Jacob, draw near, kiss me when done.'
 11 And he drew near and kissed him, and
 He said 'Blessed be my son at hand
 Jacob and all the sons of God
 Most High, forever on the sod.
 May Alohim give unto you
 A seed of righteousness *as crew*,
 And of your sons to sanctify
 In the whole earth, may nations try
 To serve you, and all nations bow
 Themselves before your seed *on brow*.
 12 Be strong in the presence of men,
 And exercise authority
 Over all the seed of Seth then.
 Then your ways and the ways to be
 Of your sons will be justified,
 So they'll be holy nation tried.
 13 May the Most High Alohim give
 You all the blessings that I live
 Wherewith He has blessed me and by
 Which He blessed Noah *from the sky*
 And Adam, may they rest upon
 The sacred head of your seed's spawn

From generations to all ages.
 14 And may He cleanse you from all stages
 Of unrighteousness and impure,
 That you may be forgiven sure
 Of all transgressions, which unknown
 To you you may have done *and sown*.
 And may He strengthen you, and bless.
 May you gain the whole earth's address,
 And may He renew covenant
 With you. 15 That You may be *not scant*
 To Him a nation as an heir
 For all the ages *of the fair*,
 And that He may be to you and
 To your seed a God *in the land*
 In truth and righteousness throughout
 All the days of the earth about.

Though Abraham came to bless Jacob
 when
 He gathered all his children once again,
 That does not mean that every child born to
 Jacob was given priestcraft as in due.
 Only Levi among the twelve is known
 To have that blessing from Abraham
 shown,
 And of his sons Eleasar was chosen,
 While all the others were left out and
 frozen.
 Nay, two elders of his were struck down
 dead.
 You, my Beloved, raise and put down
 instead.
 Today the Cohen rarely takes his place
 Among the chosen and the priestly race.
 And Revelation says to foot the bill,
 Since all are kings and priest, and all fulfil.

16 And do you, my son Jacob, mind
 My words, observing *and not blind*
 To the commands of Abraham,
 Your father: separate from ham
 Of the nations, and eat not what
 They eat with them: and do not glut
 According to their works, and be
 Not their associate *in glee*,
 For their works are unclean, and all
 Their ways are a pollution's thrall,
 Abomination, uncleanness.
 17 They offer sacrifice to dress
 The dead and they bow down to pray
 To evil spirits, and then they
 Eat over the graves, all their works

Are vanity, nothing but shirks.
 18 They have no heart to understand,
 Their eyes do not see what their grand
 Works are, and how they err in saying
 To a piece of wood *when they're praying*,
 'You are my God,' And to a stone,
 'You are my Lord and You alone
 Are my deliverer.' [And they
 Have no heart.] 19 And as for your *way*,
 My son Jacob, may the Most High
 God help you and the God on high
 Bless you and remove you from their
 Uncleanness and from how they err.
 20 Beware, my son Jacob, of taking
 A wife from any seed of *raking*
 Daughters of Canaan, for all seed
 Of him's to be rooted indeed
 Out of the earth. 21 For, owing to
 Transgression of Ham, Canaan too
 Erred, and all his seed shall be cut
 Off from the earth, his remnant shut
 Out, and none springing from him shall
 Be saved on day juridical.

Count me, too, my Beloved, in Jacob's lot,
 And not among the Canaanites in plot,
 Who stole the land of Shem and then forgot
 Your name, but bowed to wood and stone
 for shame.

Count me, too, in the blessing of those who
 Remember to bow to none, only You,
 And as my forehead touches ground and
 dew,
 And my lips whisper to You what's Your
 due,
 Remember me and mine for Jacob's
 blessing.

Here I am not alone in my addressing
 You with words of praise under morning
 sky.

The princes and princesses marching by
 The generations under mercy's flame
 Still in their light and shadows praise
 confession.

22 And as for all the worshippers
 Of idols and the profaners,
 (b) There shall be no hope for them in
 The land of the living *and bin*,
 And there shall be no remembrance
 Of them on the earth, (c) for they prance
 Down into Sheol, (d) and into

The place of condemnation due
 They shall go, as the children of
 Sodom were taken out from love
 Away from the earth, so will all
 Those who worship idols in thrall
 Be taken away. 23 Fear not, my
 Son Jacob, and be not dismayed,
 O son of Abraham: Most High
 Alohim preserved you and stayed
 From destruction, and from all ways
 Of error may He save your days.
 24 This house I have built for myself
 That I might put my name on shelf
 Upon it in the earth: [and it
 Is given to you and your fit
 Seed for ever], and it will be
 Named house of Abraham *to see*,
 It is given to you and to
 Your seed for ever, because you
 Will build my house and set my name
 Before Alohim *for all fame*
 Forever: your seed and your name
 Will stand throughout all ages of
 The earth *for you and for my love.*
 25 And he ceased commanding him and
 Blessing him. 26 And the two in band
 Lay together on one bed, and
 Jacob slept in the bosom of
 Abraham, father's father's love
 And he kissed him seven times, and
 His affection and his heart joyed
 Over him. 27 And his heart employed
 Blessing upon him and he said
 'The Most High Alohim, the Dread
 Of all, and Creator, who brought
 Me forth from Ur of the Chaldees
 That he might give me this land taught
 To inherit all of its trees
 For ever, and that I might set
 A holy seed, blessed be yet
 The Most High for ever.' 28 And he
 Blessed Jacob and said 'My son, *see*,
 In whom with all my heart and all
 My love I rejoice *to install*,
 May Your grace and Your mercy be
 Lifted up on him and to be
 On his seed always. 29 And do not
 Forsake him, nor set him at naught
 From now unto eternity,
 30 And may Your eyes be opened on
 Him and his seed *both night and dawn*,
 That You preserve him, and bless him,

And sanctify him *and make trim*
 As a nation and for Your heir,
 And bless him with all of Your care
 In blessings from this day unto
 All the days of eternity,
 And with him covenant renew,
 Your grace with him and his seed be
 According to all Your good pleasure
 Into all the earth's ages' treasure.'

Today when bishops bless they wave a
 hand

In sign of cross or else pour out a band
 Of oil and water on the head to seek
 A blessing from You when they fart and
 peek.

But Abraham in giving best of all
 His blessings above kid and calf in stall
 Forgets baptisms and the fateful thrall
 Of sacrifice and singing at the ball.
 Instead he gives Jacob from his own lips
 Seven kisses adorned with blessings' sips.
 Beloved, bless me today, not with new
 gear,

Nor with the honours of the far and near,
 Nor with the titles of bishop in fear,
 But with Your kisses as my sleep comes
 near.

Jubilees 23

1 He placed two fingers of Jacob
 Upon his eyes, *but not to rub*,
 And blessed the God of gods, and he
 Covered his face and stretched out *free*
 His feet, entered eternity,
 Was gathered to his fathers' *fee*.

2 But all the while Jacob was lying
 In his bosom, and knew not *sighing*
 That Abraham, his father's father,
 Was dead. 3 And Jacob awoke rather
 From his sleep, indeed Abraham
 Was cold as ice, and he raised gram
 And said 'Father, father', but there
 Was none that spoke, he was aware
 That he was dead. 4 And he arose
 From his bosom, ran to disclose
 To Rebekah, his mother, and
 Rebekah went to Isaac's stand
 In the night, and told him, and they
 Went together, Jacob as stay,
 And holding a lamp in his hand,
 And when they had gone in they found

Abraham dead upon the ground.
 5 Isaac fell on his father's face
 And wept and kissed him *in the place*.
 6 The voices were heard in the house
 Of Abraham, Ishmael to souse
 His son arose, and went into
 Abraham his father to view,
 And wept over his father's face,
 On Abraham, and all the race
 Of Abraham wept with a great
 Weeping. 7 His sons Isaac and mate
 Ishmael buried him in the cave
 Doubled, near Sarah his wife, and
 They mourned him forty days in band,
 All the people of his house, and
 Isaac and Ishmael, all their sons,
 And all Keturah's sons in runs,
 Till Abraham's mourning days ended.
 8 And he lived three jubilees fended,
 And four weeks of years, one hundred
 And seventy-five years, to bid
 Completion of the days of life,
 Being old, full of days, *no strife*.

Jacob awoke in his grandfather's bed
 And when he woke he found grandfather
 dead.

Abraham died with Jacob on his breast,
 And in that blessing's pleasure found his
 rest.

Since then who die die also in that way,
 Dying upon the bosom in the sway
 Of Abraham, and there they sleep until
 The day of judgement shall at last fulfil.
 Beloved, though I now find upon Your arm
 The place of refuge, where there's no alarm
 From myself and within, nor from without,
 Someday I shall with quiet calm or shout
 Depart remembrance of Your name to lean
 Asleep in Abraham's bosom serene.

9 For the days of the forefathers,
 Of their lives, as it then occurs,
 Were nineteen jubilees, but then
 After the Flood lifespan of men
 Grew less than nineteen jubilees,
 And to decrease in jubilees,
 And they grew old quickly *with ease*,
 Full of their days by reason of
 Many tribulations above,
 And for the wickedness of ways,
 Except for Abraham in praise.

10 For Abraham was perfect in
 All his deeds with YHWH, *and no sin*,
 But well-pleasing in righteousness
 All the days of his life *confess*,
 And indeed, he did not complete
 Four jubilees in his life's *fleet*,
 When he had grown old because of
 Wickedness, his days full *of love*.
 11 And all the generations which
 Shall come from this time to the pitch
 Of Judgement day shall not make hitch
 But grow old quickly, before they
 Complete two jubilees *astray*,
 Their knowledge forsaking them too
 By reason of their old age due
 [And all their knowledge in the way
 Shall vanish]. 12 And then in that day,
 If a man live a jubilee
 And a half of years *as they be*,
 They'll say of him 'He has lived long,
 And the greater part of his song
 Is pain and sorrow, tribulation,
 And there's no peace *for man or nation*:
 13 Calamity follows on free
 Calamity, and wound on wound,
 And tribulation's parity,
 And evil tidings on festooned,
 And illness on his illness, and
 All evil judgements *in the land*,
 One with another, illness and
 An overthrow, and snow and frost
 And ice, and fever hotly tossed,
 And chills, and torpor, famine, death,
 And sword, captivity, and breath
 Of all kinds of calamities
 And pains on pains *and without ease*.'
 14 And all these shall come on and fast
 Upon an evil age outcast,
 Which transgresses upon the earth:
 Their works' uncleanness with no dearth
 Of fornication, and pollution,
 Abominations for solution.
 15 Then they shall say 'Forefathers' days
 Were many *even*, unto *praise*
 Near a thousand years, and were good,
 But indeed, the days of our wood
 And fodder, if a man has lived
 Many, these are three score and sieved
 On ten years, and, if he is strong,
 Four score years, and evil and wrong,
 And there's no peace upon this age
 For its days are wicked *on stage*.'

Since the Flood evil has killed off the race
At one-tenth of their own allotted pace.
Wickedness pares the years with poisoned
dart

And leaves the sodden body by the cart.
Abraham lived to twice the length of men
In his time because, though he had a yen,
In time of trial and temptation then
He obeyed You in his perfection's light.
Beloved, let me also contrive the right
In what I do, so that the spoil in sight
Upon my life to lead me into death
Come not from my own wickedness in
breath.

Let the evil that takes my years away
Be that committed by others' foul play.

16 And in that generation sons
Shall convict fathers *by their tons*
And their elders of sin and plot
Unrighteous, and of words unsought
From their mouth and great wickedness
Which they may perpetrate, confess
Forsaking covenant which YHWH
Made between them and Him *to do*,
That they should observe and do all
His commandments *marked on the wall*
Both ordinance and all His laws,
Without departing to their paws
On right or left. 17 For all have done
Evil, and each mouth under sun
Speaks in iniquity and all
Their works are uncleanness *in stall*
And an abomination's *thrall*,
And all their ways are pollution,
An uncleanness and destruction.

18 Indeed the earth shall be destroyed
On account of their works *employed*,
And there shall be no seed of vine,
And no oil, for their works align
In faithlessness, and they shall all
Perish together *where they fall*,
Beasts and cattle and birds, and all
The fish of the sea, on account
Of children of men *in amount*.
19 And they shall strive one with another,
The younger with the elder brother,
And the old with the young, the poor
With the rich, the lowly *obscure*
With the great, and the beggar by
The prince, on account of the *high*

Law and the covenant, for they
Have forgotten commandment's sway,
And covenant, and feasts, and day
Of months, and Sabbaths, jubilees,
And all judgments *to take their ease*.

Forgetting the Sabbath day takes away
From one's lifetime the eternal in day,
And leaves the soul bereft of rest and
peace,

Three score and ten at most, and to release
No joy nor love upon neglectful piece.
I search the calendars of ancient time
To reassure myself I know the clime
When Your days come and when the great
sublime

Jubilees hearken to rhythm and rhyme
Of universe. Beloved, let me forget
Not to stay where Your rest is fully met,
And touch my lips to covenant and feast
That rises weekly, yearly in the east
To find the days and years of life increased.

20 And they'll stand swords and war to
turn

Them back into the way *they spurn*,
But they shall not return until
Much blood has been shed *and to fill*
The earth, one by another. 21 And
Those who have escaped *from the land*
Shall not return from wickedness
Into the way of righteousness,
But they shall all exalt themselves
To deceit and to wealth *like elves*,
That they may each take all that's his
Neighbour's *without consequences*,
And lo they shall name the great name,
But not in truth and in false claim
Of righteousness, and they'll defile
The holy of holies *a while*
With their uncleanness and the blot
Of their corruption in the lot
Of their pollution. 22 And a great
Punishment shall befall their fate
For the deeds of this age from YHWH,
And He will give them over to
The sword and to judgement and to
Captivity, and to be plundered
And devoured. 23 And He will unsundered
Wake up against them sinners of
The Gentiles, who have neither love
Nor mercy nor compassion, who

Shall respect the person of none,
 Neither old nor young, any one,
 For they are more wicked and strong
 To do evil and to do wrong
 Than all other children of men.
 And they shall use violence then
 Against Israel and transgression
 Against Jacob, and much blood won
 Shall be shed upon the earth, and
 There shall be none to gather and
 None to bury. 24 In those days they
 Shall cry aloud, and call and pray
 That they may be saved from the hand
 Of sinners, Gentiles *in the land*,
 But none shall be saved. 25 And the heads
 Of children shall be *on their beds*
 White with grey hair, and a child of
 Three weeks shall appear old above
 Like a man of one hundred years,
 And their stature shall be destroyed
 By tribulation and annoyed
 By oppression. 26 And in those days
 The children shall begin their ways
 To study the laws, and to seek
 The commandments, and to left cheek
 Back to the path of righteousness.
 27 And the days shall begin to bless
 And increase among those children
 Of men till their days draw nigh then
 To one thousand years. And to great
 Number of years, more than of late
 Was the number of days in state.

The reason man would take sword in his
 hand
 Forgetting the Sabbath and Your command,
 Is simply that he would acquire the sand
 Of gold and silver in his neighbour's land.
 How stupidly the human race collects
 What cannot be eaten, and yet neglects
 To feed the poor. Beloved, break in my
 known
 And small world with Your brightness and
 Your throne.
 Make me and mine rightly divide the spoil
 Of earth to self and others at the toil.
 Give me the day of blessing to arise
 And find with equity the morning skies
 Are tinted with that gold that all may take
 In eye and heart and for rejoicing's sake.

28 And there shall be no old man nor

One who's satisfied as before
 With his days, for all shall be *then*
As children and youths, *and not men*.
 29 And all their days they shall complete
 And live in peace and joy *for treat*,
 And there shall be no Satan nor
 Evil destroyer as before,
 For all their days shall be as days
 Of blessing and healing *and praise*.
 30 And at that time YHWH then will heal
 His servants, and they'll rise and wheel
 And see great peace, and drive out their
 Enemies. The righteous shall see
 And be thankful, and rejoice where
 With joy for ever they shall be,
 And shall see all their judgments and
 All their curses on their foes' band.
 31 And their bones shall rest in the earth,
 And their spirits shall have much worth
 Of joy, and they shall know it's YHWH
 Who executes the judgement due,
 And shows mercy to hundreds and
 Thousands, all that love His *command*.
 32 And you, Moses, write down these
 words,
 For thus are they written *on sherds*,
 And they record *them* on the plates
 Celestial where a witness waits
 Unto all ages in their states.

All that love Your command receive the
 joy
 Of judgement at Your hand and in employ.
 What of those who neglect Your simple
 word
 And treat the ten commandments like a
 turd?
 Have You no blessing to relate on them,
 Have You no treasure for their life and
 gem?
 Beloved, I pray for those who wrong the
 blood,
 Who selfishly seek only their own flood,
 And live by jungle law, survival of
 The fittest who are able without love
 To grind down the weaker under the glove
 Of iron dispensing justice from the gate
 Of Bank of England for the oil in state.
 Beloved, I pray for those stuck in the mud.

Week 26 Jubilees 24

1 And it happened after the death

Of Abraham, that YHWH *with breath*
 Blessed Isaac his son, and he rose
 From Hebron and went to repose
 At Beer Roi in the first year
 Of the third week, it would appear, [2073
 A.M.]

2 Of this jubilee, seven years.
 And in the first of fourth week's years
 A famine began in the land, [2080 A.M.]
 3 Besides the first famine at hand,
 Which was in days of Abraham.
 And Jacob cooked lentils *for ham*
 In pottage, and Esau came from
 The field as hungry *as a bum*.
 And he said to Jacob his brother,
 "Give me of this red pottage *smother*."
 And Jacob said to him, "Sell me
 Your [primogeniture freely,
 This] birthright and I'll give to you
 Both bread, also some of the stew."
 4 Esau said in his heart, "I'll die,
 What profit is this birthright nigh?"
 And he said to Jacob, "I give
 It to you." 5 And Jacob *to live*
 Said "Swear to me, this day," and he
 Swore to him. 6 And Jacob then gave
 His brother Esau bread *to pave*
 And pottage, and he ate his fill,
 So Esau despised birthright's bill,
 For this reason was Esau's name
 Called Edom, because of the same
 Red pottage which Jacob gave him
 For his birthright. 7 And Jacob *trim*
 Became the elder, and Esau
 Was brought down from his elder law.

In Edom they still speak of the red soup,
 Although they do not remember the scoop
 Of Jacob, nor know that the times of late
 Have in that feature at least not left slate.
 Some things remain, some little things, to
 be
 The gauge of permanence and symmetry.
 The gesture and the look, the way a man
 Picks up a hen to carry if he can,
 The way a woman lifts a pot, the way
 The donkey is pulled away from the hay,
 None of these things have changed, though
 rulers go
 And faiths are born and blossom and then
 slow
 And disappear. Beloved, on human path

I keep to You and Yours, away from wrath.

8 And the famine was on the land,
 And Isaac departed to stand
 Down into Egypt in the year
 Number two of this week *for fear*,
 And went to king of Philistines
 To Gerar, to Abimelech.
 9 And YHWH appeared upon his scenes
 And said to him, "Don't make the trek
 Into Egypt, live in the land
 That I shall tell you of, and stand
 In this country, and I will be
 With you and bless you. 10 "For you see
 To you and to your seed I'll give
 All this land *as a place to live*,
 And will establish My oath which
 I swore to Abraham *in pitch*
 Who was your father, and I'll make
 Your children numerous like stake
 Of the stars of the sky, and will
 Give your seed *all* this land *to till*.
 11 "In your seed shall all earth be blessed
 In every nation *unconfessed*,
 Since your father obeyed My voice,
 And kept My charge and *kept by choice*
 My commandments, and My laws, and
 My ordinances, pact to stand,
 And now obey My voice and live
 In this land *which to you I give*."
 12 And he lived in Gerar three weeks
 Of years. 13 And Abimelech's cliques
 Gave charge concerning him, [2080-2101
 A.M.] and all

That was his, saying at the call,
 "Any man that shall touch him or
 Anything of his house and store
 Shall surely die." 14 Isaac became
 Strong among the Philistines' *fame*,
 And he got gear abundantly,
 Oxen and sheep and camels *free*
 And donkeys and a great household.
 15 And he sowed in the land *as told*
 Of the Philistines and brought in
 A hundred-fold *in barn and bin*,
 And Isaac became very great,
 So Philistines began to hate.

One only need have the good fortune of
 A single harvest to lose all the love
 Of neighbour and king. Now as things are
 met

Such rulers have the project firm and set
To send depleted uranium on
The soil to scatter well-being at dawn.
Some speak of war-crimes in such shot
down shell,

But I look at reality and well
And say all war is crime. Now see what tell
For future archeologists to sell
Their rotten bodies for research employed
A thousand years beyond children
destroyed.

Beloved, a curse on the United States
For dropping time bombs on the world in
crates.

16 Now all the wells which the servants
Of Abraham had in advance
Dug during life of Abraham,
The Philistines had stopped with dam
After the death of Abraham,
And filled them with earth *like a clam*.

17 Abimelech said to Isaac,
“Get out from us, you and your pack,
For you are mightier than we,”
And Isaac, *who’d always agree*,
Departed from there in the first
Year of the seventh week, *as cursed*,
And sojourned in Gerar’s valley.

18 They dug again the water wells
Which the servants of Abraham,
His father, had dug *in their spells*,
Which Philistines had tried to dam
After the death of Abraham
His father, and he called their names
As Abraham his father’s claims.

Beloved, I hear the names fall from the lips
Of Isaac, who after all fatal trips
Returned to re-establish what his dad
Had set up in faith and in chiliad.
Isaac with some nostalgia would repair
The church of Abraham under the glare
Of burning sun’s reality when all
Said such language was gone beyond
recall.

Beloved, I too think back to what those
who
Engendered me would have me keep in
view,
The Decalogue resounding silent through
The halls of heart and brain, the sacred fire
Of faith beyond the sacrificial pyre

To stand unscathed by heathendom and
mire.

19 And the servants of Isaac dug
A well in the valley *to hug*,
And found running water, but those
Shepherds of Gerar strove and rose
Against Isaac’s shepherds oppose
Saying “The water’s ours,” and he,
Isaac called the name of the free
Well ‘The Well of Perversity’,
Because they were perverse with us.
20 They dug a second well to fuss
For that also, he called its name
‘Well of Enmity’ *and in blame*.
And he arose from there and they
Dug another well, for that they
Did not strive, and he called the name
Of it ‘Room’, *since they kept the claim*,
And Isaac said “Now YHWH has made
Room for us in what land we stayed.”

How to deal with those who send down the
rain

Of plutonium on river and plain?
The only way is to get out of way
And count as loss the children in their play
Who are struck down when fences have
been laid.

So Isaac got up from the well he made
And did not try to claim his own, but left
To dig another and to be bereft
A second time. The lucky man makes third
And is not driven out like a crow bird.
In general, I trow, intelligence
Is living where no oil grows under fence,
And where the army of the rich does not
Find anything of worth among the lot.

21 And he went up from there to Beer
Sheba in the first week’s first year,
In the [2108 A.M.] forty-fourth jubilee.
22 And YHWH appeared to him that night,
On the first day of first month’s right,
And said to him, “I am *truly*
The God of Abraham your father,
Fear not, for I am with you *rather*,
And shall bless you and shall surely
Multiply your seed as the sand
Of the earth, for the sake of *band*
Of Abraham my servant.” 23 And
He built an altar there, as had

Abraham his father built glad,
 And there he called upon the name
 Of YHWH, and he offered the claim
 Of sacrifice to the God of
 Abraham his father *and love*.
 24 And they dug a well and they found
 Running water *up from the ground*.
 25 And the servants of Isaac dug
 Another well and *only plug*
Did they find and no water *there*,
 And they went and told Isaac that
 They'd not found water *where it sat*,
 And Isaac said "I've sworn this day
 To the Philistines *in this way*,
 And this thing's been announced to us."
 26 And he named that place *plenteous*
 Beer Sheba, for there he had sworn
 To Abimelech and *highborn*
 Ahuzzath his friend and Phicol
 The prefect Or his host *to call*.
 27 And Isaac knew that day beneath
 Constraint he'd sworn in their bequeath
 To make peace with them. 28 And Isaac
 On that day cursed Philistines *tack*
 And said "Cursed be the Philistines
 Until the day of wrath *declines*
 And indignation from among
 All nations, may God have them sung
 Derision and a curse, object
 Of wrath, indignation infect
 In the hands of the Gentile sinners
 And in the hands of Kittim *winners*.
 29 "And whoever escapes the sword
 Of foe and the Kittim *implored*,
 May the righteous nation root out
 In judgment from under sky's spout,
 For they shall be the enemies
 And foes of my children *at ease*
 Throughout their ages on the earth.
 30 "And no remnant be left in dearth
 To them, nor one that shall be saved
 On the day judgement wrath was *waved*,
 For destruction and rooting out
 And expulsion from the earth spout
 Is the whole seed of Philistines
Reserved, and there *in their combines*
 Shall no longer be left for these
 Caphtorim name on earth *to please*.

Beloved, they hate me that I mention name
 Of country to curse for its guilty blame
 In making soil radioactive curse

Forever in practice, but think not worse
 Of Isaac, who cursed Philistine for but
 A well or two of water in the cut.
 The difference between my curse and his
 It merely of force, I may curse with whiz
 And nothing comes to harm the perpetrator.
 When Isaac curses things sooner or later
 Catastrophe comes on them all the greater.
 So let me curse in peace, I have no power
 To bring the guilty to their judgement hour.
 I leave them to Your mercy in the gut.

31 "For though he ascend to the sky,
 From there he shall be brought down *nigh*,
 And though he make himself on earth
 Strong, from there he shall *in his worth*
 Be dragged out, and although he hide
 Himself among the nations *wide*,
 Even from there he shall be plucked,
 And though he descend into mucked
 Sheol, there too his condemnation
 Shall be great, and there also done
 He shall have no peace *or Islam*.
 32 "And if he go into the qualm
 A captive, by the hands of those
 That seek his life so shall his foes
 Slay him on the way *as he goes*,
 And neither name nor seed shall be
 Left to him for the earth to see,
 For into eternal cursing
 He shall depart *and on the wing*."
 33 And thus is it written, engraved
 Concerning him *who is not saved*
 Upon the heavenly tablets, to
 Do unto him in judgement's due,
 So that he may be rooted out
 Of the earth *where he walks about*.

Beloved, is there nothing that's written
 down
 On tablets for contemporary crown?
 Though all the world is guilty as hell for
 Neglect of Your brief laws upon the shore
 Of Sinai, whose laws are well written too
 Upon the heart of small and great in crew,
 Still Thou shalt not kill is a word as great
 Now as it was in earth's early estate,
 And those who kill the generations coming
 Ought to catch their judgement and catch it
 humming.
 There is no punishment that's great enough
 To gift those mortals whose eternal ruff

Continues to kill children in the buff
From now until the edge of doom and fate.

Jubilees 25

1 In the second year of this week
In this jubilee, Rebekah
Called Jacob her son *for a peek*,
And spoke to [2109 A.M.] him, saying *for law*

“My son, do not take you a wife
Of Canaan’s daughters *in their strife*,
As Esau, your brother, who took
Two wives from Canaan’s daughters’ *book*,
And they have embittered my soul
With all their unclean deeds *in toll*:
For all their deeds are fornication
And lust, and there’s no righteous ration
With them, *because of wicked deeds*.

2 “And I, my son, love you *as leads*,
And my heart and affection bless
You every hour of day’s address
And every watch upon the night.

3 “And now, my son, hear my voice *right*,
And do your mother’s will, and do
Not take a wife among the crew
Of this land, but only the house
Of my father, and *take a spouse*
Of my father’s kindred. You’ll take
A wife for my father’s house sake,
And God Most High will bless you, and
Your children in a righteous band
And as a holy seed *to stand*. ”

Rebekah wishes that her son might not
Take wife from Canaanite in comely plot
As did Esau. The thing is not correct
Politically, but most people neglect
That matter when their benefit is sought.
Is it possible to find holy seed
Among the world’s tribes when their genes
indeed

Are so close as not to make much
distinction?

The scientific view saves from extinction
The holy seed in that all seeds are holy,
And there’s no difference between the seed
lowly

And that of great and mighty. Fact is little
Distinguishes from chimpanzee’s acquittal.
When comes to human races I see pittle.

4 And then spoke Jacob to Rebekah,

His mother, and said *not to wreck* her,
“Indeed, mother, I’m nine weeks old
In years, and I have not been bold
To touch any woman, I’ve not
Engaged myself to any sought,
Nor even think of taking wife
Of Canaan’s daughters *in my life*.
5 “For I remember, mother, word
Of Abraham, our father *stirred*,
For he commanded me not to
Take a wife of Canaanite crew,
But to take me a wife from seed
Of my father’s house and from mead
Of my kindred. 6 “I’ve heard before
That daughters have been born *in store*
To Laban, your brother, and I
Have set my heart on them *on sly*
To take a wife from among them.
7 “And for this reason *on my hem*
I’ve guarded myself in my spirit
Against sinning and so I fear it,
Avoid corruption in my ways
Throughout my life and all the days,
For with regard to lust’s uncleanness,
Abraham, father without meanness,
Gave me many commands. 8 “Despite
All that he has commanded right,
These twenty-two years has my brother
Striven with me, and like to smother
With words frequently to me said
‘My brother, take to wife, *be led*,
A sister of my two wives’ bed,’
But I refuse to do as he
Has done. 9 “I swear before you *free*,
Mother, that all the days of life
I will not take to me a wife
From the daughters of Canaan’s seed,
And I will not do wicked deed
As my brother has done. 10 “Fear not,
Mother, be assured *of my lot*
That I shall do your will and walk
In uprightness, and will not balk
Corrupting my ways all my life.”
11 And so she lifted up *like knife*
Her face to the sky and extended
The fingers of her hands *unfended*,
And opened her mouth as she blessed
The Most High God, *and she confessed*
He had created heaven and earth,
And she gave Him thanks *for His worth*
And praise. 12 And she said “Blessèd be
YHWH Alohim, and may He be

Blessed in His holy name for ever
And ever who's given me *the clever*
Jacob as a pure son and holy
Seed, for he's Yours, and Yours *though*
lowly

His seed shall be continually
And throughout all ages to see
For evermore. 13 "Bless him, O Lord,
And place in my mouth blessing's *sword*
Of righteousness, so I'll bless him."
14 And at that hour, when spirit trim
Of righteousness descended in
Her mouth, she placed both her hands in
The head of Jacob, and said "Blessed
Are You, righteous Lord and confessed
Alohim of the ages, may
He bless you beyond all the sway
Of men. 15 "May He give you, my son,
The path of righteousness and won,
Reveal righteousness to your seed.
16 "And may He make your sons indeed
Many during your life, and may
They appear according to sway
And number of months of the year.
And may their sons when they appear
Become many and great beyond
The stars of heaven, their numbers' bond
Be more than the sand of the sea.
17 "And may He give them this goodly
Land as He said He would give it
To Abraham and to his *fit*
Seed after him always and may
They hold it in possession's sway
For ever. 18 "And may I see *born*
To you, my son, blessed children *shorn*
During my life, and blessed and holy
May all your children be *though lowly*.

Esau is right, I deem, that Canaanite
Ladies are just as good in moral sight
As Laban's daughters who would come to
fight
Among themselves for household gods in
spite.
Idolatress for one idolatress
Leaves little choice among the shoot and
guess.
If Jacob had spent ten years in address
Of missionary work among the girls
Of his own neighbourhood, instead of
churls

He might have found the whole lot come
around
To Your faith, love and worship to the
ground.
On other hand, my own experience
Show changing the faith of another's sense
Is quite unlikely, and to that I'm bound.

Rebekah stands to pray with hands
stretched out,
With fingers reaching outward without
doubt
Just as we pray today without a shout
And without closing eyes and folding
hands,
But rather doing by Your own commands,
To show the gesture of petition when
We come to You in prayer and come again.
Rebekah prays in the same way that we
Stretch fingers out, all ten and palms to see
Toward the house of Your choosing
between
The hills of Mecca by the Zamzam stream,
Beneath the sickle moon, beneath the sheen
Of cloud from which surprised sun and rain
beam.
Beloved, as did Rebekah, I agree.

19 "And as You have refreshed the spirit
Of your mother during or near it,
Her life, the womb of her that bore you
Blesses you thus *to underscore you*,
[My affection] and my breasts bless you
And my mouth and my tongue confess you
Greatly. 20 "Increase and spread on earth,
And may your seed perfect in worth
And in the joy of heaven and earth
For ever be, and may rejoice,
And on the great day of peace' voice
May they have peace *or yet Islam*.
21 "And may your name *be as a balm*
And your seed endure to all ages,
And may the Most High God *of sages*
Be their God, and may Alohim
The righteous live with them *on beam*,
And by them may His sanctuary
Be built to all the ages *merry*.
22 "Blessèd be he that blesses you,
And all the flesh that curses you
Falsely, may it be cursed." 23 And she
Kissed him, and said to him, "May be

The Lord of the world [Rabbul-‘aalamiina]
love you too
As the heart of your mother *true*
And her affection joy in you
And bless you.” So she ended too.

Not all the seed of Jacob turned out well.
Some of them were bloodthirsty as dry
spell.
And some were lusty fast to fornicate
In incest plot, and others ready to
Sell their own brother to Ishmaelite crew.
If that’s the best we get even with blessing,
The rest of the world’s populace by
guessing
Is not far behind Jacob’s riotous
Family for murder and fire and fuss.
Beloved, as I step out upon the song
That follows me the whole of my life long,
My introspection takes me and my wrong
To task for those moments when I have
trailed.
With palpitation I seek out the railed.

Week 27 Jubilees 26

1 And in this week’s seventh year called
Isaac Esau, his elder son,
And said to him, “I am installed, [2114
A.M.]

Become an old man here, my son,
Indeed my eyes are dim in seeing,
And I know not the day and being
Of my death. 2 And now take your bow
For hunting and with quiver go
Out to the field, and hunt and catch
Me *venison*, my son, and latch
On to the game to make me meat
Savoury, such as is my soul’s treat,
And bring it back to me to eat,
And that my soul may bless you now
Before I die.” 3 She heard somehow,
Rebekah did, what Isaac spoke
To Esau. 4 And Esau the bloke
Went out early in field to hunt
And catch and bring home *any runt*
To his father. 5 Rebekah called
Jacob, her son, and said *appalled*
To him, “Indeed, I heard Isaac,
Your father, tell Esau to track,
He told your brother, saying ‘Hunt
For me, and make me savoury stunt
Of meat, and bring to me to eat

And so bless you beneath YHWH’s *feet*
Before I die.’ 6 “And now, my son,
Obey me in what’s to be done
In that which I command you. Go
To your flock and fetch me a show
Of two good kids of the goats, and
I’ll make them savoury meat in hand
For your father, such as he loves,
And you shall bring *it wearing gloves*
To your father that he may eat
And so bless you beneath YHWH’s feet
Before he dies, and that You may
Be blessed.” 7 And Jacob said her nay,
Spoke to Rebekah his mother,
“Mother *dearest, if I concur*,
I shall not withhold anything
Which my father would eat *in spring*,
And which would please him, only I
Fear, my mother, that he will spy
My voice and wish to touch me. 8 “And
You know that I am smooth *in hand*,
And Esau, my brother, is hairy,
And I’ll appear before him wary
As an evildoer, and shall
Act before him a prodigal,
And he will be angry with me,
And I shall bring upon my fee
A curse, and nothing blessingly.”

The lust for meat is what makes Isaac slight
Abraham’s will from out of his blind sight.
He loves Esau for being man of might,
A hunter like his uncle Ishmael, who
Was always Isaac’s hero in the crew.
By Genesis all men accuse Rebekah
For her deceit, but she took to her Mecca
And did her best to follow Abraham
Instead of tasting chowder and the clam.
Beloved, let me not spoil Your prayer’s
perfume
With lusts of my desiring to assume.
But like Rebekah keep Your will in mind,
And flaunt the will of powerful and blind,
To obey You alone, merciful, kind.

9 Rebekah, his mother, told him,
“Upon me be your curse *with vim*,
My son, only obey my voice.”

10 And so Jacob obeyed the voice
Of Rebekah, his mother *choice*,
And went and fetched two good, fat kids
From the goats, and brought them as bids

To his mother, and his mother
 Made savoury meat such as the fer
 Loved. 11 And Rebekah took the fine
 Clothing of Esau, elder's sign,
 That was there with her in the house,
 And she clothed Jacob, younger grouse,
With them, and she put the kids' skins
 Upon his hands *but not his shins*
 And on the bare part of his neck.
 12 She put the meat and bread to peck
 That she'd prepared into the hand
 Of her son Jacob. 13 By command
 Jacob went to his father, said
 "I am your son, I've done just what
 You commanded me, went and got.
 Arise and sit and eat of what
 I've caught, father, that your soul may
 Bless me." 14 And Isaac had his say
 To his son, "How've You found so quickly,
 My son?" 15 And Jacob said *not sickly*
 "Because YHWH your God brought it to
 me."

16 And Isaac said to him, "Come to me,
 So I may feel you, my son, view me
 If you're my son Esau or not."

17 And Jacob went near Isaac's spot,
 His father's, and he felt him saying
 18 "The voice is Jacob's voice conveying,
 But the hands are hands of Esau,"

And he did not recognize claw,
 Because it was a dispensation
 From heaven to remove his ration
 Of noticing and Isaac did
 Not recognize him *as he hid*,
 For his hands were hairy and like
 His brother Esau's, *so for strike*
 He blessed him. 19 And he said "Are you
 My son Esau?" and he said *true*,
 "I am your son." And he said "Bring
 Near me, that I may eat that thing
 That you have caught, my son, my soul
 May bless you." 20 And he brought *the*
bow

Near to him, and he ate, and he
 Brought him grape juice to drink *freely*.

Esau was capable of hunting down
 The lusty game and bringing back to town
 The feisty feast with joy's anticipation.
 Esau could cook a minted fine creation.
 The story in the leaf shows Jacob too
 A cook of savoury soup and lentil stew.

But here I find the lad goes to his mom
 To cook the stolen kid with no aplomb.
 Nothing has changed, the one that does
 footwork

Is always sacrificed for those who shirk.
 The credit, empty sum, goes to the one
 Who hangs about until the thing is done.
 Beloved, have mercy on poor Esau's fate
 And raise him up into the golden gate.

It was not the deceit supposed that wrought
 In Isaac blindness to the son he sought.
 It was not savoury meat of kid of goat
 Dressed up like venison that duly smote
 The mind of Isaac, it was not the skin
 Laid on forearms and neck, without, within,
 That make Isaac think that he blessed Esau.
 It was, Beloved, alone Your meddling paw.
 The question is, as I try to obey
 The words that You have spoken in the
 way

Of Sinai to all humankind in spe,
 Should I like Rebekah and Jacob use
 Deceit against the powerful or choose
 To rely on You only at the fuse?

21 And Isaac, his father, told him,
 "Come near and kiss me, my son *trim*."
 And so he came near and kissed him.

22 And he smelled the smell of his cloak,
 And he blessed him and so he spoke
 "Indeed, the smell of my son is
 As the smell of a field of his
 That YHWH has blessed. 23 "And may
 YHWH give

You of the dew of heaven *to live*
 And of the dew of earth, and full
 Share of corn and oil. Let the *bull*
 Nations serve you, and peoples bow
 Down to you. 24 "Be lord anyhow
 Over your brothers, and let sons
 Of your mother's sons bow *in tons*
 To you, and may all blessings by
 Which YHWH has blessed me and the tie
 To blessed Abraham, my father,
 Be imparted to you and rather
 To your seed for ever. Cursed be
 He that curses you, and blessed be
 He that blesses you." 25 And it came
 About as soon as Isaac's claim
 Had ended in blessing his son
 Jacob, and Jacob went and won

From Isaac his father he hid
And Esau, his brother, *to bid*
Came in from his hunting, *he did*.

It is no use to tread the crazy mill
And follow paths through every field and
hill

To strike a goal, to work with sinews bent
And find blood spattered everywhere you
went.

It is no use to come back from the kill
With hands full of success and bring the
bill

To those who ordered products and to fill
The service laid in comfortable tent.

Esau returns obedient for once
Bringing the proper produce of his hunts
In faith and prayer and righteousness to
find

Usurping brother's blessed and father's
dined.

Beloved, look on for justice and not fate
To those of us without choice, without rate.

26 And he also made savoury meat,
And brought *it* for his father's *treat*,
And said to his father, "Let my
Father arise and eat of my
Deer meat that your soul may bless me."

27 And Isaac, his father, made free
To say to him, "Who are you, dear?"
And he said to him, "Do not fear,
I am your first born son, Esau.
I've done as you've given me law."

Esau is innocent, Beloved, no guile
Marks him at all, he humbly all the while
Does just as father says without complaint.
He goes a weary way and like a saint
Brings duly back what father asked of him.
He does not follow in deceit or whim.

Mark well, Beloved, the righteous state of
this

Brother in contrast to deceitful kiss
Of Jacob. My Beloved, when You choose
well,
Your choice does not always come ring a
bell.

Until the last moment Esau's so pure
In his intention he hears no allure
Of the trap sprung. But Jacob bites his
tongue

Regretting soon the faithless tune he'd
sung.

28 And Isaac was greatly astonished,
And said "Who is he *unadmonished*
Who's hunted and caught and brought me,
And I have eaten all freely
Before You came, and have blessed him?
And he shall be blessed, and his trim
For ever." 29 And it happened when
Esau heard his father's words then
From Isaac that he cried a great
And bitter cry, and said *not late*
To his father, "Bless me also,
Bless me, my father, *on the go*."

The human heart meets every loss with
great

Cries of remorse and weeping for the state
Of being victim of the grasp and greed
That heels the world about instead of need.
The human heart of Esau also meets
His loss of faith and works upon the streets
With hopeless cry of disappointment till
The sounds spill out upon both field and
hill.

Beloved, I too have done a task or two
And met rebuff instead of payment due,
Till I at last found haven and withdrew
To mountain and to soil to make my way
In humble silence, though I write a ray
Of praise to You where I sit day by day.

30 And he said to him, "Came with guile
Your brother, and stole *with a smile*
Your blessing." And he said "Now I
Know why his name's Jacob *the sly*.
Indeed, he has supplanted me
These two times, took away from me
My birthright, and now he has taken
Away my blessing, *I'm forsaken*."

31 And he said "Have You not reserved
A blessing for me, *me unnerved*,
My father?" And Isaac answered
And said to Esau *by this word*,
"Indeed, I have made him your lord,
And all his brothers *on the sward*
I've given to serve him *adored*,
And with plenty of corn and grape
Juice and oil I've strengthened his nape:
And what now shall I do for you,
My son?" 32 And Esau said *with rue*

To Isaac, his father, "Have You
 But one blessing, O father, do?
 Bless me, *even* me also, father."
 And Esau lifted up his voice
 And wept. 33 And Isaac answered *choice*
 And said to him, "Indeed, far from
 The dew of earth shall be your hum,
 And far from the dew of heaven from
 Above. 34 "And by your sword will you
 Live, and you'll serve your brother, too.
 And it shall come to pass when you
 Become great, and shake off his yoke
 From your neck, you'll err in a stroke
 Unto death, and your seed shall be
 Rooted out from under sky's plea."
 35 Esau kept threatening Jacob
 Because of the blessing *and hub*
 By which his father blessed him, he
 Said to himself, "May the days be
 Of mourning for my father now,
 Brother Jacob I'll kill in row."

Isaac recognizes the blessing true,
 Even though deceit brought it down in rue.
 He does not think to mitigate the view
 Or abrogate the words he said though few.
 And so deceitful Jacob takes the cake,
 While righteous Esau suffers his mistake.
 Through time and generations priests have
 sought
 The blessing of the bishops to be taught,
 And claim the blessing is theirs though the
 hand
 Conferring it may be of sinful band.
 Morality and ethics do not make
 Validity, but ceremony's sake.
 Yet I, Beloved, attach me to no church,
 Blessed or not, they will leave me in the
 lurch.

Jubilees 27

1 The words of Esau, elder son,
 Were told Rebekah in a dream,
 And Rebekah sent and when done
 Called Jacob her younger son's *dream*,
 And said to him, "Indeed Esau
 Your brother will take vengeance *law*
 On you to kill you. 2 "Now, therefore,
 My son, obey my voice *once more*,
 And rise and flee to Laban, my
 Brother, to Haran, *on the fly*
 And stay with him a few days till

Your brother's anger turn to swill,
 3 "And he turn his wrath from you, and
 Forget all that you've done in hand,
 Then I will send and fetch you back."
 4 And Jacob said "I have no lack
 Of courage, if he wants to kill
 Me, I'll kill him *and foot the bill*."
 5 But she said to him, "Let me not
 Lose both my sons on one day *sot*."
 6 And Jacob said to Rebekah
 His mother, "Indeed, formula
 Is clear that my father is old,
 And does not see, *though he is bold*,
 Because his eyes are dim, and if
 I leave him it will be *a skiff*
 Of evil before him, because
 I leave him and go *without pause*
 Away from you, and so my father
 Will be angry, and curse me *rather*.
 I will not go, when he sends me,
 Then only will I go *freely*."

Jacob is not the peaceful man men claim.
 He may have been disgusted by the game
 Of Levi and Simeon on Shechem.
 But he is not a soft compliant gem.
 He's ready to make duel with the chief,
 His brother and to cut him down like thief,
 And even expects mother to join in
 The riot and the slaughtering in din.
 Beloved, give me no courage in the fight
 To bash my enemies upon the site.
 Beloved, I do not want the brave man's
 face
 To kill my brothers and so lose my grace.
 Beloved, I flee to You and beg Your choice
 Upon my living once more to rejoice.

7 Rebekah said to Jacob, "I
 Will go and speak to him *or try*,
 And he will send you then away."
 8 And Rebekah went in to say
 To Isaac, "I loathe the life today
 Because of the two daughters of
 Heth, whom Esau's taken *to love*
 As wives, and if Jacob take wife
 From this land's daughters, on my life,
 Why should I live, for wicked are
 The daughters of Canaanite star."

Beloved, I too am son of Heth or near it.
 Are only Semites holy men of spirit?

If Esau's fair wives are unfit because
 Their father is Hittite, by all Your laws,
 I too am unfit to lift up Your name.
 Indeed, I am unfit, and bear the blame.
 And yet I dare to hope and bring my claim
 To You, Beloved, and if You feel such
 shame,
 Cast me out of the temple, but know true
 That even cast out, I acknowledge You
 Alone as God, as Friend and without rue
 Of punishment or hope of reward do
 Obeissance in the inner temple blessed
 With Your acknowledgement of human
 rest.

9 And Isaac called Jacob and blessed
 Him, and admonished him addressed,
 10 "Do not take you a wife of any
 Of the daughters of Canaan's *fenny*,
 Go to Mesopotamia,
 To house of Bethuel *by claw*,
 Your mother's father, and take you
 A wife from there of Laban's crew,
 Your mother's brother. 11 Alohim
 Almighty bless you *by a dream*
 Increase and multiply you that
 You may become there where you sat
 A host of nations, and give you
 The blessings of my father *true*
 Abraham, to you and your seed
 After you, that You may indeed
 Inherit the land where you stay,
 And all the land which Alohim
 Gave to Abraham. Go today,
 My son, in peace *as it may seem*."

Isaac is not a fool to send his son
 At word of mother on an errand run.
 He knows full well what danger stalks the
 life
 Of Jacob, but he does not stir the strife.
 He in his wisdom sets the plan in action,
 And in so doing breaks down danger's
 faction.
 Isaac, though loving flesh and brother's
 calling,
 In quietness contemplating the falling
 Out of Esau and Jacob, still returns
 To where Your guiding light on his steps
 burns.
 Despite my flitting round the mental room
 Finding so many things before my doom

To catch my interest and my moral light,
 Beloved, come guide my footsteps too
 aright.

12 And Isaac sent Jacob away,
 To Mesopotamia's lay,
 To Laban the son of Bethuel
 The Syrian, the brother well
 Of Rebekah, Jacob's mother.
 13 And it happened *and did occur*
 After Jacob had got up to
 Go to Mesopotamia's *crew*
 That the spirit of Rebekah
 Was grieved after her son's *éclat*,
 And she wept. 14 And Isaac said to
 Rebekah, "My sister, why do
 You weep for Jacob, my son too,
 For he goes in peace, and in peace
 Will he return. 15 "With full increase
 The Most High Alohim will come
 To preserve him from evil *bum*,
 And be with him, for He will not
 Forsake him all his days *in lot*,
 16 "For I know that his ways will be
 Prospered in all abundantly
 Wherever he goes, until he
 Return in peace to us, and we
 See him in peace. 17 "Fear not for him,
 My sister, for he's not on dim
 But upright path and he's a man
 Perfect, and he's faithful in plan
 And will not perish. 18 "So weep not."
 19 And Isaac comforted the lot
 Of Rebekah because of her
 Son Jacob, and blessed him *to stir*.

Isaac does not blame Jacob for the plot
 To deceive him in matters of the sought
 Blessing, but bows humbly to Your own
 will
 And keeps his sights on Your plans and
 grace still.
 Rebekah weeps that Jacob's gone a while
 Because she misses his presence and smile,
 But Isaac sees across the years of gloom
 And waits for Jacob to return in room.
 So both take life from You, Beloved, and
 share
 A common hope of happiness come where
 Fraternal feud had all but cut them down.
 The choice is always there upon the town.
 Beloved, I choose to waken to Your love,

And turn aside from sadness in the shove.

And Jacob went from Beer Sheba
To go to Haran on *the thaw*
Of the first year of second week
In the forty-fourth jubilee,
And he came to Luz on the lee
Of the mountains, that is, to seek
Bethel, on first day of this week's
First month, [2115 A.M.] and he came to
the place

At evening and turned from the face
Of the way into the road's west
That night: and he slept there at best
For the sun had set. 20 And he took
One of the stones of that place nook
And lay under the tree, and he
Was journeying alone, and he
Slept. 21 And he dreamed that night,
indeed

A ladder set on earth *decreed*,
And the top of it reached the sky,
And indeed, angels of YHWH by
It ascended and descended:
And indeed, YHWH stood on it, hid.
22 And He spoke to Jacob and said
"I am YHWH Alohim who led
Abraham, your father, and God
Of Isaac, the land and the sod
Whereon You're sleeping, to you I
Will give it, and to your seed by
And by after you. 23 "And your seed
Shall be as the earth's dust indeed,
And You shall increase to the west
And to the east, to the north *best*
And to the south, and in you and
In your seed shall all the command
Of families of the nations be
Blessed. 24 "And indeed, I too will be
With you, and will keep company
Wherever You go, and I'll bring
You once again back to this spring
In peace, for I will not leave you
Until I do everything too
That I told you about." 25 And Jacob
Arousing from his sleep to wake up,
Said "Truly this place is the house
Of YHWH, I knew not more *than mouse*."
He was afraid and said "Dreadful
Is this place which is none fateful
But the house of Alohim, and
This is the gate to heaven's land."

Your voice is heard in dreams in Jacob's
time,
Not outright as with Abraham in rhyme,
Or Moses, not in vision as Isaiah
Spoke to the house of Israel in pariah.
Your voice comes to Jacob in the night
dream
And tells him to look beyond what things
seem
To the inheritance of righteousness.
Beloved, give me such dreams that might
caress
My sleeping on the stone below the hill
Where my cabin is placed to fit the bill.
I touch the lichened granite stones to see
If there are heavenly ladders in the lee.
Beloved, I find Your footprints everywhere
Like Jacob, and wonder what place to bare.

26 And Jacob rose early at morn,
And took the stone which he had bourn
Under his head and set it up
As pillar for a sign, and cup
He poured oil on the top of it.
And he called that place name as fit
Bethel, but the name of the place
Was Luz at the first *of the race*.
27 And Jacob vowed a vow to YHWH,
Saying "If YHWH'll be with me too,
And will keep me this way I go,
And give me bread to eat and show
Of clothing to put on, and so
I come back to my father's house
In peace, *and also with my spouse*,
Then shall YHWH be my God, and this
Stone which I've set as pillar kiss
For a sign in this place, shall be
The Lord's house, all You, God, give me
I'll give the tenth to you in fee."

I wake at morning darkness to take light
Again from You, Beloved, and in Your
sight
I pour the sacrificial oil upon
The stone I sleep on till the coming dawn,
And vow like Jacob for this day alone
To follow in obedient steps the tone
Of Your commandments, and in that vow
find
The glories of a heavenly view combined.
Beloved, the morning finds me once again

Ready to share my crust with fellowmen,
And ready on the hillside by the lake
To take the lessons that your creatures
make.

Beloved, open again once more the door
Of Your own hermitage to fill its store.

Week 28 Jubilees 28

1 And he went on his journey, and
He came into the eastern land,
To Laban, brother of Rebekah,
And he was with him *in his Mecca*,
And served him for Rachel his daughter
One week *of years by pact as ought to*.
2 And in the first year of the third
Week [2122 A.M.] he said to him, "Give
my wife,
For whom I've served seven years of life,"
And Laban said to Jacob, "I
Will give you your wife." 3 But *the sly*
Laban made a feast, and took Leah
His elder daughter, and *to free her*
Gave *her* to Jacob as a wife,
And gave her Zilpah *without strife*
His handmaid for a handmaid, and
Jacob did not know *what was planned*,
For he thought she was Rachel. 4 And
He went in unto her, indeed,
And she was Leah *as decreed*,
And Jacob was wroth with Laban,
And said to him, "What is your plan
To deal with me this way? Did not
I serve you for Rachel and sought
Not Leah? Why have You now wronged
Me? 5 "Take your daughter as
headstronged,
And I will go, for You have done
Evil to me *beneath the sun*."

To copulate with one woman in dark
Thinking she is another lends a spark
To life that is not always what a man
Has in mind when he goes to make a plan.
That would be one good reason to avoid
The veiling of young girls when they're
employed
About the marriage business. I would think
That marriage not valid that on the brink
Replied the name of someone else than
who
Was really standing with the groom as due.
Beloved, though I do not see You nor hear

Your name beside my own murmur in ear,
You are known to me as You are unknown
To us who live and die beneath Your
throne.

For Jacob loved Rachel *much* more
Than Leah, for Leah's eyes' *score*
Was weak, but her form very pretty,
But Rachel had fine eyes *and witty*
As well as handsome form and pretty.
6 And Laban said to Jacob, "It
Is not so done in our land fit,
To give the younger *one as bride*
Before the elder *at her side*."
And it is not right to do this,
For thus it's ordained not amiss
And written in the heavenly tablets,
That no one should give younger dabblets
Before the elder, but the elder,
One gives first and after *he's held her*
The younger. The man who does so,
They proclaim guilty in the glow
Of heaven, and none is righteous
That does this thing, for *among us*
This deed is evil before YHWH.
7 And command Israel's folk to do
Not such a thing, let them not take
Nor give the younger before wake
Of the elder, for it's a sin.
8 And Laban told Jacob *his kin*,
"Let the seven days of the feast
Of this one pass by, then at least
I'll give you Rachel, that you may
Serve me one more seven years' sway,
That you may then pasture my sheep
As you did in the former keep."
9 And on the day when the seven days
Of the feast of Leah *in lays*
Had passed, Laban gave Rachel to
Jacob, that he might serve him *too*
Another seven years, and he
Gave to Rachel Bilhah *for free*,
The sister of Zilpah, as maid.
10 And he served him yet one more stayed
Seven years for Rachel, for Leah
Had been given to him for no straw.
11 And YHWH opened up Leah's womb,
And she conceived and bare the room
Of Jacob a son, and he called
His name Reuben, *not Archibald*,
In the ninth month, the fourteenth day,

In the first year of third week's sway. [2122 A.M.]

Which was the Sabbath on the way.

Laban takes cake and cracker too when he
Appeals to divine law and faithfully
To heavenly tablet to justify lies
In broken contract. So all human guise
Appeals to the supposed word You have
hidden
Rather than to the Decalogue You've
bidden.

The sacredness of this and that, what
younger

Or older should be given to the monger,
Are always more important than the yield
Of what You once stated on Sinai's field.
The human heart's full of excuses bent
To save both what we want and yet prevent
The conscience of complaining our
behaviour.

Beloved, from self all men need You a
Saviour.

12 But the womb of Rachel was closed,
For YHWH saw Leah was opposed
And Rachel loved. 13 And so again
Jacob went in to Leah's *den*,
And she conceived, and bare Jacob
A second son *upon his hub*,
And he called his name Simeon,
On the week's third day in the sun
In the tenth month, the twenty-first,
In this week's third year unrehearsed.

[2124 A.M.]

Bless You, Beloved, it is not often You
Step in to support the weakest of crew
And recompense the innocent for what
Has been done to them by deceit and glut.
You notice Leah's not loved? Good You do
Give her what she wants of the children
due

Despite being married without a choice
On her part or her husband's guiding voice.
You take pity upon the heart of one
Shunted aside after the first night done.
Despite the wickedness of this dark world,
There is a spark of justice once uncured
Which means You may in some eternity
Look once more on a lady made unfree.

14 And again Jacob went in to
Leah, and she conceived *as due*,
And bore him a third son, and he
Called his name Levi *for decree*,
In the first month's first day the fourth
Day of the week sixth year went forth
Of this week. [2127 A.M.] 15 And again
Jacob

Went in to her, and *here's the rub*
She conceived, and bore him son four,
He called his name Judah *to score*,
In the third month, on fifteenth day,
Which was that week's first day to play,
In the first year of the fourth week. [2129
A.M.]

16 And because of this hide and seek
Rachel envied Leah, for she
Did not bear, *not even a wee*,
And she said to Jacob, "Give me
Children," and Jacob said "Have I
Withheld from you the fruits come by
Your womb? Have I forsaken you?"
17 And when Rachel saw Leah's crew
Of four sons born to Jacob, who
Were Reuben, Simeon, Levi
And Judah, she said *with a cry*
To him, "Go in to Bilhah my
Handmaid, and she'll conceive, and bear
A son to me." *She gave her share*
Bilhah her handmaid as his wife.

Note, my Beloved, that Reuben the first
born

Was born upon the Sabbath without scorn
And given every grace and gift to share
In growing loved and coddled everywhere.
And despite the twice-blessed in being
brought

To life upon the Sabbath day and frought
With the joy of the Torah recitation,
He's bound in time to become indignation,
A whispered curse among his folk and
nation.

While Judah, by contrast, is born upon
The first day of the week, the heathen dawn
When humankind worships the sun instead
Of You, Beloved, a curse upon such led.
Yet Judah remains praised in wisdom's
head.

18 And he went in to her, and she
Conceived, and bore a son to be,

And he called his name Dan, upon
 The sixth month's ninth day *which is*
drawn
 As the second day of the week,
 In the sixth year of the third week. [2127
 A.M.]

19 And Jacob went in again to
 Bilhah a second time *in view*,
 And she conceived, and bore Jacob
 Another son, she called the bub,
 Rachel did, his name Napthali,
 On the seventh month's fifth gone by,
Upon the first day of the week,
 In the second year of fourth week. [2130
 A.M.]

Ah my Beloved, did no one say a word
 In counsel to Bilhah, for what occurred?
 Was she asked if she wanted to be mate
 To a man with two wives already great?
 I think not, and I think that failure to
 Regard the wishes of the girl as due
 Is tragic even if she, reconciled,
 Submitted to the fate of a slave child.
 Beloved, I too am a slave girl, no more,
 If I turn from the ten commandments' door
 To wallow in determinism's shore.
 Only in following the word revealed
 When it goes against my desires concealed
 Can I enjoy true liberty in field.

20 And when Leah saw she was weak
 To bear, she envied Rachel's *peek*,
 And she also gave her handmaid
 Zilpah to Jacob as wife laid,
 And she conceived, and bore a son,
 And Leah called him Gad *once won*,
 On the twelfth of the eighth month, *which*
Is the week's third day at the pitch,
 In the third year of the fourth week. [2131
 A.M.]

21 And he went in again to peek
 At her, and she conceived, and bore
 Him a second son *in the score*,
 And Leah called his name Asher,
 On the eleventh month's grand stir
 Of second day *which was well set*
As Sabbath in the fifth year met
 Of the fourth week. [2133 A.M.] 22 And
 Jacob went
 In to Leah, and she was bent
 Once more to conceive, and to bear

A son, and she called his name's *share*
 Issachar, on the fifth month's fourth
 Day *on that week's third day gone forth*,
 In the fourth year of the fourth week, [2132
 A.M.]

And gave him to a nurse *to seek*.

Two of Leah's sons born on Sabbath day
 Make her among women most blessed and
 gay.

Asher, well blessed, is twice blessed as the
 sun

Of his first day on earth's a Sabbath won.
 I wonder if the Sabbath blessing was
 Enough to shed from Leah in her pause
 The sadness she felt in her marriage week
 And after, when she saw her husband seek
 The bed of Rachel more often than hers.
 For Jacob was appeased in what occurs
 Only because within the week of singing
 Leah's marriage he was allowed the
 winging
 In Rachel's bed also. Beloved, You see
 Human hearts wrung, but feel the agony?

23 And Jacob went in *once* again
 To her, and she conceived, and then
 Bore two *children*, a son and daughter,
 And she called the name of the son
 Zabulon, but the name of daughter
 Was Dinah, in the seventh of
 The seventh month, *which day above*
Is the third of the week, and in
 The sixth year of the fourth week's *bin*.
 [2134 A.M.]

24 And YHWH was gracious to Rachel,
 And opened her womb, and she fell
 Pregnant, and bore a son, and she
 Called his name Joseph, in the lea
 Of the fourth month's first day *which is*
The fourth day of the week for biz,
 In the sixth year in this fourth week. [2134
 A.M.]

25 At the time Joseph came to peek,
 Jacob said to Laban, "Give me
 My wives and sons, and send me free
 To go to my father Isaac,
 And let me build a house *and rack*,
 For I've completed all the years
 In which I've served you, *and with tears*,
 For your two daughters, and I'll go
 To the house of my father's *show*."

The name Joseph is poignant with both
faith

And superstitious spell that some bright
wraith

Might hear the incantation and bring more
Children to bless Rachel on lonely shore.
She is a childish one, who knows how old,
Who shouts upon her joy as a child bold
Who cries in glee "Once more," and then
again

Slides down the snow hard hill and goes for
ten.

Beloved, I also in my childish wake
Look out upon the morning for Your sake
And hardly count the gracious scene as one
Seen many times before after night done.
Each gift seems new and fresh and calls out
for

A repeat of the symphony encore.

26 And Laban said to Jacob, "Tarry
With me for your wages, and *merry*
Pasture my flock for me again,
And take your wages *with the men.*"

27 And they agreed with one another
That he should give him *every brother*
As his wages of all those lambs
And kids which were born *of their dams*
Black and spotted and white, *these* were
To be his wages. 28 And in fur
All the sheep brought forth spotted and
Speckled and black, of varied band,
And they brought forth again lambs like
Themselves, and all with spot and spike
Were Jacob's and those which were not
Were Laban's. 29 And so Jacob's lot
Multiplied there exceedingly,
And he possessed oxen *in fee*
And sheep and asses and camels,
And menservants and maiden spells.

30 And Laban and his sons envied
Jacob, and Laban took in greed
Back his sheep from him, and he watched
With evil intentions and botched.

I would have thought Jacob would demand
lot

In wages for each day he followed plot,
Rather than the gamble of shady spot
Upon the cattle for a living sought.
But trying to advance upon the wheel

Of fortune as it turns and make a deal
Is something too human to scorn at heel.
It raises admiration of a sort
To see the down trodden arise for sport.
Not for their love nor virtue I admire
Mankind, but for their courage in the fire,
To go on with their laughter and desire,
Facing certain death, but invigoured yet
To take in stride the better than they've
met.

Jubilees 29

1 And it happened when Rachel had
Borne Joseph, that Laban *as glad*
Went to shear sheep, for they were far
From him a three days' trip *by star.*

2 And Jacob saw that Laban was
Going to shear his sheep *and claws,*
And Jacob called *both of his wives,*
Leah and Rachel, as contrives,
And spoke kindly to them that they
Should come away with him to stay
In Canaan's land. 3 For he told them
How he had seen all *as a gem*
In a dream, even all that He
Had told him that he should *freely*
Return to his father's house, and
They said "To every place and land
You go we will go with you." 4 And
Jacob blessed the God of Isaac
His father, and the God *to track*
With Abraham his father's father,
And he arose, *no further bother,*
And mounted his wives and his kids,
And took all his possessions' *bids*
And crossed the river, and came to
The land of Gilead *with crew,*
From Laban Jacob hid his plans
And told him nothing *of his vans.*
5 In seventh year of the fourth week
Jacob turned *his face on to seek*
Gilead in the first month, on
The twenty-first of that month's dawn,
The third day of the week construed. [2135
A.M.]

And Laban after him pursued
And overtook Jacob upon
The mount of Gilead in third
Month, and on the thirteenth occurred,
Which was the day of preparation,
When they had stopped for Sabbath's
ration.

6 And YHWH did not suffer him to
 Injure Jacob, for He came to
 Him in a dream by night *for view*.
 And Laban spoke to Jacob. 7 And
 On the fifteenth of those days *planned*
After the Sabbath Jacob made
 A feast for Laban, who had stayed
 And for all those who came with him,
 And Jacob swore to Laban *grim*
 That day, and Laban also to
 Jacob, that neither should pursue
 To cross the mount of Gilead
 To the other to work him bad.

It seems that Jacob could not face the brunt
 Of what Laban might say with face in front.
 He had to sneak away because the man
 Could always corner him with some new
 plan
 That was to his advantage. Such folk are
 Offended when one sneaks away by star.
 Since they do not take what they want by
 hand
 Of violence, they expect one to stand.
 The ones who overrun the intricate
 And delicate leaf of the artist's state
 Least understand why such must run like
 hate
 Pursued them despite that there's no such
 fate
 At heels. Beloved, You're not like that at
 all.
 You're the most delicate to steal the wall.

8 And he made there a heap for witness,
 Wherefore name of that place in fitness
 Is called 'The Heap of Witness,' in
 Remembrance of this heap *and bin*.
 9 But before that they used to call
 The land of Gilead, mount and all,
 The land of the Rephaim, for it
 Was the land of the Rephaim *fit*,
 And the Rephaim were born *there*,
 Giants whose height was ten in stair
 Down to nine, eight and seven cubits.
 10 And their home was from Ammon's few
 bits
 To Mount Hermon, and the seats of
 Their kingdom were Karnaim *above*
 And Ashtaroth, and Edrei, and
 Misur, and Beon. 11 And YHWH's *hand*
 Destroyed them because of the *band*

Of evil of their deeds, for they
 Were very wicked *in their way*,
 And Amorites lived in their stead,
 Wicked and sinful *also led*,
 And there is no people today
 Who've walked in such a wicked way,
 And they've no longer length of life
 At all on the earth for their strife.
 12 And Jacob sent away Laban,
 And he departed by his plan
 Into Mesopotamia,
 The land of the East and his pa,
 And Jacob returned to the land
 Of Gilead. 13 And he passed over
 The Jabbok in ninth month, *a rover*
 On the eleventh day thereof,
The fourth day of the week above.
 And on that day Esau, his brother,
 Came to him, and *about to smother*
Him with his love, and reconciled
 To him, *although he had beguiled*,
 Then parted from him to the land
 Of Seir, but Jacob lived in *band*
Of tents. 14 And in the first year of
 The fifth week in this jubilee [2136 A.M.]
 He crossed the Jordan, *hand in glove*,
 And lived beyond the Jordan's *sea*,
 And he pastured his sheep from sea
 Of the heap unto Bethshan's *lea*,
 And unto Dothan and unto
 The forest of Akrabbim *too*.

This Jubilee's philosophy of life
 Politic is not one to respect strife.
 Most see history as story of the rife
 And violent way one folk has when sent
 The means to take the lands without relent.
 Survival of the fittest, jungle law,
 May seem to be rule by the strongest claw,
 But here the concept sees You and Your
 paw
 Behind the rise and fall of nations met.
 First there were in the land the giants set,
 And for their wickedness You once more
 let
 The Amorites settle in their stead, yet
 You are about to give the land away
 Once more to Jacob. Such is Your own
 way.

15 He sent to his father Isaac
Gifts of all his substance *in pack*,

Clothing, and food, and meat, and drink,
And milk, and butter, and *the stink*
Of cheese, and some dates of the vale.

16 And to his mother Rebekah
Four times a year, *and without fail*,
Between the times of the months, *on*
The days of the remembrance dawn,
Between ploughing and the reaping,
Between autumn and the *seeping*
Of the rain *season* and between
Winter and spring, *as it would seem*
To the tower of Abraham. 17 For
Isaac had returned from before
Beer Sheba and gone up to live
At the tower of his *fugitive*
Father Abraham, and he dwelt
There apart from *his loved and svelte*
Son Esau. 18 For in the days when
Jacob went out *and left the den*
To Mesopotamia, then
Esau took to himself a wife
Mahalath, the daughter *and life*
Of Ishmael, and he gathered
All the flocks of his father's *herd*
And his wives, and went up and dwelt
On Mount Seir, so's not to melt
In Beer Sheba where his father
Lived alone without son to stir.
19 And Isaac went up from Beer Sheba
And lived in the tower *and zareba*
Of Abraham his father on
The *cooler* mountains of Hebron,
And there Jacob sent all that he
Sent to his father and *in glee*
To his mother from time to time,
All they needed *in gear and rhyme*,
20 And they blessed Jacob with all their
Heart and with all their soul *aware*.

Jacob supports his parents although they
Have all they need, he still remembers way
His father and his mother in their day
Cared for his childish ways and fed him
still
And protected him on the tent and sill.
Esau does what he can to earn the love
Of dad and mom, despite his hand in glove
To do for himself first and all above.
He takes a third wife, this time of relation,
Hoping that way to equal Jacob's station.
Beloved, the competition of such men
Is oft repeated in the world again.

I don't compete, not because I'm alone,
But because I realize You've the throne.

Week 29 Jubilees 30

1 And in the first year of week six [2143
A.M.]

He went up to Salem *for nix*,
To the east of Shechem, in peace,
In the fourth month *for a surcease*.
2 And there they carried off Dinah,
The daughter of Jacob, by claw
Into the house of Shechem, son
Of Hamor, the Hivite, the gun
Prince of the land, and he did lie
With her and defiled *breast and thigh*,
And she was just a little girl,
A child of twelve years *with a curl*.
And he begged his father and her
Brothers that he might marry her.
3 And Jacob and his sons were mad
Because the men of Shechem had
Defiled poor Dinah, their sister,
And they spoke to them to defer
With evil intent and deceit
With them and beguiled their retreat.
4 And Simeon and Levi came out
By surprise to Shechem *with shout*
And executed judgment on
All the men of Shechem *at dawn*,
And killed all the men they found there,
And left not one remaining there:
They killed all in torments because
They'd dishonoured *with sinful paws*
Their sister Dinah. 5 And thus let
It not again be done to set
Upon a daughter of Israel
To defile her, for judgement well
Is ordained in heaven on those
That they should destroy and oppose
With the sword all the men that rose
Of Shechemites because they'd wrought
Shame in Israel. 6 And YHWH had
brought
Them into the hands of the sons
Of Jacob to exterminate
Them with the sword and *on their buns*
Execute judgement, that it might
Not thus again take place in sight
Of Israel that a virgin late
Of Israel should suffer such hate.

Your commandment say not to kill the bill,

Not anyone, not slave or master ill,
Not human and not beast without the fill.
The Bible is the story of how many
Found good excuse to break
commandment's penny.

That is the role of all religions here,
To tell us that what's ringing in the ear
From Sinai need not be kept and in fear
Because it's primitive, because it's rate
Is too simple for complex lives to date.
Now pedophilia by norm's of late
Is something common and on every plate,
And yet in many minds would justify
A brother and father to cast a fly.

7 And if there is a man who wishes
In Israel to give daughter's *dishes*
Or his sister to any man
Who is seed of a Gentile clan
He surely shall die *for the plan*,
And they shall *all* stone him with stones,
For he's wrought shame to Israel's *bones*,
And they'll burn the woman with fire,
Because she's dishonoured *the choir*
Of the name of her father's house,
And she'll be rooted out *as spouse*
In Israel. 8 And let not be
An adulteress around to see
And no uncleanness ever be
Found in Israel throughout the days
Of all the ages of the earth,
For Israel to YHWH's holy *worth*,
And every man who *in his ways*
Has defiled *it* shall surely die:
They shall stone him with stones *for why*.

9 For thus has it been ordained and
Written in heavenly tablets grand
Regarding all of Israel's band,
He who defiles shall surely die,
And he shall be stoned *on the fly*
With stones. 10 And to this law there is
No limit of days, and there is
No remission, nor atonement.
But the man who's defiled and sent
His daughter shall be rooted out
In the midst of all Israel's *roul*,
Because he's given his seed to be
As sacrifice in Moloch's *fee*,
And so has wrought impiously
So as to defile it. 11 And do,
Moses, command the children crew
Of Israel and exhort them not

To give their daughters to the lot
Of Gentiles, and not to take for
Their sons any of daughters' *store*
Of the Gentiles, for this before
YHWH is abomination's door.
12 For this reason I've written for
You in the words of the Law all
The deeds of the Shechemites' *fall*,
Which they wrought against Dinah's *wall*,
And how the sons of Jacob spoke,
Saying 'We'll not give *to the bloke*
Our daughter to a man who's not
Circumcised, for that were a blot
To us.' 13 And it's a reproach to
Israel, to those who live, and to
Those that take Gentiles' daughters' crew,
For this is unclean and a true
Abomination to Israel.

14 And Israel will not be free well
From this uncleanness if it has
A wife of the daughters of *jazz*,
The Gentiles, or has given any
Of its daughters to man *or many*
Who be of any Gentile stock.

15 For there will be a plague *to mock*
Upon plague, and curse upon curse,
And every judgement, plague and curse
Will come: if he do this thing *worse*,
Or hide his eyes from those who do
Uncleanness, or those who *in crew*
Defile sanctuary of YHWH,
Or who profane His holy name,
Then will the whole nation in blame
Be judged together *for the shame*
Of all the uncleanness and more
The profanation of this score.

From pedophilia to the extreme
Of marrying outside the faith, I deem,
Is a long way, and to set it down in
One breath as of the same kind of a sin
Is racist garbage to the modern mind
That looks at things as though he must be
blind.

The truth is a society that lacks
The skill and nerve to level its attacks
On pedophilia is not a people that
Deserves regard. And so to marry at
Such a plague is a sin indeed. I trow,
However, that to burn the dame somehow
Is a bit much beyond the fork and plough
That Decalogue suggests to those who sat.

16 And there will be no respect of
Persons [and no considering of
Persons] and no receiving at
His hands of fruits and offerings mat
And burnt-offerings as well as fat,
Nor the fragrance of sweet savour,
So as to accept it with coeur.
And so fare every guy and gal
In Israel who defiles *with pal*
The sanctuary. 17 For this reason
I have commanded you *in season*,
Saying “Testify this witness
Israel *for to curse or bless*.
See how the Shechemites have fared
And their sons, how they were repaired
Into the hands of Jacob’s sons,
And those two slew them under tons
Of torture, and it was *counted*
To them for righteous acts they did,
And it is written down to them
For righteousness *and for a gem*.
18 “And the seed of Levi was chosen
For the priesthood, and be *unfrozen*
Levites, that they might minister
Before YHWH, as we, for ever,
And that Levi and his sons may
Be blessed forever *in their way*,
For he was zealous to work out
Righteousness and judgement about
And vengeance on all those who rose
Against Israel. 19 “And so *it shows*
They inscribe as a testimony
In his favour *and not be phony*
On heavenly tablets blessing and
Righteousness before God of all.
20 “And we mind the righteous command
Which the man fulfilled during all
His life, at all times of the year,
Until thousand ages appear,
They will record it *on the wall*,
And it will come to him and to
His descendants after in crew,
And he has been recorded on
The heavenly tablets *from the dawn*
As a friend and a righteous man,
In every act and every plan.

To lie with pagan man or dame is said
To be defiling of the name and bed,
The sanctuary of YHWH Alohim.

Therefore such things should not enter the
dream.

The pedophiliac defiles the rate
Of all society and every state.
No wonder these dregs call up every hate.
It is a doubt what ought to have been done
To those never educated to run
According to the Decalogue for fun.
An old dog learns to turn no tricks beyond
What he’s been doing all the while and
fond.

Beloved, the whole world’s ripe to desolate
For the defilement open under sun.

21 “All this account I wrote for you,
And have commanded what to do
And say to Israel’s folk, that they
Should not commit sin in the way
Nor transgress ordinance nor break
The covenant which has in stake
Been ordained for them, *but* they take
To fulfil it and be recorded
As friends. 22 But if they *unrewarded*
Transgress and work uncleanness’ way,
They will be recorded astray
On the heavenly tablets as foes,
And they will be destroyed as goes
Out of the book of life, and they
Will be recorded *in that day*
And in the book of those who will
Be destroyed and with those who will
Be rooted out of the earth’s *hill*. ”
23 And on the day when Jacob’s sons
Slew Shechem writing set down *tonnes*
In their favour in heaven that they
Had executed righteous way
And uprightness and vengeance on
The sinners *and the sinners’ spawn*,
And it was written for a blessing,
Forever in righteous addressing.

Levi and Simeon are not judged wrong
For killing all the men and even throng
Of married women in Shechem so long
As they accepted defiling behaviour.
The two are looked up to as if to saviour.
Levi’s rewarded for the bloody deed
By being made priest of the holy seed,
To slay and take life by profession by
The altar where the blood each day runs
dry.

Beloved, once sick at heart I turn away

From righteous priest as well as from the
stray,
And as I entone Psalm to sanctify
My heart and home, I turn away to cry
For what appears as justice on the sly.

24 And they brought Dinah, their sister,
Out of Shechem's house *with a stir*,
And they took captive everything
That was in Shechem, sheep *of king*
And their oxen and donkeys too,
And all their wealth, and all to do
With their flocks, and brought them all to
Jacob their father. 25 And he brought
Them to task for what they had wrought
In putting the city to sword,
For he feared those *and their reward*
Who lived in the land, Canaanites
And *also wrath of Perizzites*.
26 And the dread of YHWH was on all
The cities around Shechem's *call*,
And they did not rise to pursue
After the sons of Jacob's *crew*,
For terror fell upon them all.

Everyone in this time and place that's wise
Would agree with Jacob, God bless his
eyes,
That working judgement on the drunken
waste
Is like to rouse the passions of the paste.
At one time there was a whole people who
Regarded the ten commandments as due,
While today if one mentions but the view
That those ten things are valid for the crew,
One runs the risk of drawing persecution.
Silence before the crowd's the best
solution.
As I sit silently upon my chair
And look out on the world without despair,
Beloved, I see Your morning everywhere
And know Your law alone is just and fair.

Jubilees 31

1 The first day of the month Jacob
Spoke to all the folk of his hub,
Saying "Purify yourselves and
Change your garments, and then in band
Let us get up and go up to
Bethel, where I vowed a vow to
Him on the day when I fled from
Esau my brother's face to come,

Because He has been with me and
Brought me in peace into this land,
And put you away the strange gods
That arc among you *made of clods*."
2 And they gave up the strange gods and
That which was in their ears and which
Was on their necks, the idols which
Rachel stole from Laban her father
She gave wholly to Jacob *rather*.
And he burnt and broke them to pieces
And destroyed them, and hid the pieces
Under an oak that's in the land
Of Shechem, and went up *in band*
On the seventh month's first day
(*Wednesday*) to

Bethel. 3 He built an altar too
At the place where he'd slept, and he
Set up a pillar there, and he
Sent word to his father Isaac
To come to him *and make a track*
To his sacrifice, and to his
Mother Rebekah in a whiz.
4 And Isaac said "Let my son come,
Jacob, and let me hear him hum
Before I die." 5 And Jacob went
To his father Isaac as sent
And to his mother Rebekah,
To the house of his father's *awe*
Abraham, and he took two of
His sons with him, Levi above
And Judah, and he came to his
Father Isaac and also his
Mother Rebekah. 6 And Rebekah
Came forth from the tower of *her Mecca*
To the front of it to kiss Jacob
And embrace him, she came to wake up
When she heard, "Indeed Jacob your
Son has come," and she kissed him *more*.

For the first time Levi and Judah rise
Above their brothers and in honoured guise
Are taken to the reception before
Isaac and Rebekah, ambassador.
Levi is priest and Judah is well praised,
Both sons of the weak-eyed and the amazed
Leah. Beloved, Jacob's choice was
inspired,
He didn't follow heart and Rachel's son,
He was not guilty of being retired
In favouritism. Prophetically done,
The choices envisaged the future tale.
Who look at Jacob as one prone to fail

Lack vision of his blessing of his spawn,
And how he saw the sunset from the dawn.

7 And she saw his two sons, and she
Recognised them, and said freely
To him, "Are these your sons, my son?"
And she embraced them *one by one*
And kissed them, and blessed them, and
said

'In you shall the *holy* seed bred
Of Abraham rise up in fame,
And you shall prove a blessed acclaim
On the earth.' 8 And Jacob went in
To Isaac and his father's bin,
Into the chamber where he lay,
And his two sons with him *that day*,
And he took the hand of his father,
And stooping down he kissed him rather,
And Isaac clung to the neck of
Jacob his son, and wept *in love*
Upon his neck. 9 And the darkness
Left the eyes of Isaac's *address*,
And he saw the two sons of Jacob,
Levi, and Judah, come to wake up,
And he said "Are these your sons, my
Son? for they are like you *the by*."

In Jubilees Isaac indeed says blessing
Upon his sons and grandsons in addressing,
Just as in Genesis and more perhaps.
But Genesis in patriarchal lapse
Forgets the mother's blessings on the run,
And how she blessed both son and her
grandson.

The inking to leave Jubilees aside
From the canon of Scriptures must abide
In reducing wifely, motherly pride,
As well as woman in her own estate
As just as sure as mankind to be great.
Beloved, I joy in Your books of revealing,
And rush to them without distinction
feeling,
And find instruction, guidance, faith and
healing.

10 And he said to him that they were
Truly his sons, "And with a stir
You have truly seen that they are
Indeed my sons." 11 *And from afar*
They came near to him, and he turned
And kissed them and embraced *unspurned*
The both of them together. 12 And

The spirit of prophecy's hand
Came down into his mouth, and he
Took Levi by his right hand and
Judah by his left hand *freely*.

13 And he turned to Levi the first,
And began to bless him the first,
And said to him, "May God of all,
The very Lord of ages' *hall*,
Bless you and your children throughout
All the ages *to come about*."

14 "And may YHWH give to you and to
Your seed greatness and glory too,
And cause you and your seed among
All flesh, to approach Him unstung
To serve Him in His sanctuary
As angels of the presence *tarry*,
And as the holy ones. As they,
Shall the seed of your sons *one day*
Be for glory and greatness' sway
And holiness, and may He make
Them great unto all ages' sake.

15 "And they shall be judges and princes,
And chiefs of all the seed evinces
Of the sons of Jacob, they'll speak
The word of YHWH the righteous seek,
And they shall judge all His judgements
In righteousness *before His tents*.

And they'll declare My ways to Jacob
And My paths to Israel *to wake up*.
The blessing of YHWH shall be put
In their mouths to bless every foot
Of all the seed of the beloved.

16 "Your mother has called you and loved
Levi, and rightly has she named
You, for you shall be joined *unblamed*
To YHWH and be companion of
All the sons of Jacob above,
Let His table be yours, and you
And your sons shall eat from its *due*,
And may your table be full to
All generations *come in view*,
And may your food not fail in all
The ages. 17 "And let all who fall
In hate to you fall before you,
And let all your foes *and their crew*
Be rooted out and perish *too*,
And blessed be he that blesses you,
And cursed be every nation that
Curses you *wherever you sat*."

It's Isaac invented the two-hand blessing
That Jacob later used upon confessing

The status of Joseph's two sons one day.
So Cohen still remains a tribe in sway,
Although not always faithful to Your way.
Like other naughty snitches in the wake
I tend to expect too much for their sake.
The blessing of Isaac was mostly food,
And had little to do with right or rude.
Even the world today's precarious place,
And millions in the hunger lines still face
Starvation. Better half of spirit falls
In when the aroma of cooking calls,
And sacrifice is a feast in its grace.

18 And to Judah he said "May YHWH
Give you the strength and power to *do*
And tread down all them that hate you,
A prince shall you be, you and one
Of your sons, over all *when done*
The sons of Jacob, may your name
And the name of your sons *in fame*
Go forth and traverse every land
And region. 19 "Then shall Gentiles
manned

Fear before your face, and all nations
Shall quake. In you shall be the *rations*
Of help of Jacob, and in you
Be found Israel's salvation *true*.

20 "And when you sit on honour's throne
Of your righteousness there be known
Great peace for all the seed of sons
Of the beloved, blessed *in their tonnes*
Be they that bless you, and all that
Hate you and afflict where you're at
And curse you shall be rooted out
And destroyed from the earth *about*
And be accursed *and set at rout*."

Who sit as leaders of the church and beth
Din are able in ease to draw the breath
And see the inner meanings of the promise
Without the hesitating doubting's Thomas.
The spiritual lesson to be learned
Should not indeed in new hardship be
spurned,
And yet the literal must rise to fore.
The salvation that's meant is that in store
To save from the dominion of the goy,
Not to save from sin's inner strength with
joy.

The only saving from sin's in employ
Of love of Your name recited with pact
And promise so to live, and living act.

That single hope turns out what Nero
earned.

21 And turning he kissed him again
Embraced him, and rejoiced amen,
For he had seen the sons of Jacob
His son in very truth *to wake up*.
22 He went forth from between his feet
And fell down and bowed down to *greet*
Him, and he blessed them and rested
There with Isaac his father hid
That night, and they ate and they drank
With joy. 23 He gave the two sons rank
Of Jacob to sleep, the one on
His right hand and the other on
His left, and it was counted to
Him for righteousness as his due.

It's strange what things before Moses came
on
Were counted righteousness among the
spawn
Of Adam as they walked their pilgrimage.
The righteousness of Abraham in pledge
Was believing the promise of his fate
To have a child along with aging mate.
And yet in action that belief fell flat
It seems for following his doubts whereat
The customs of his day came in to seek
Their place in concubine and servant's
week.

Now Isaac gains his righteousness when he
Takes in his arms to sleep his grandsons'
free.

Beloved, You watch me with expectant
care,
Rewarding as soon as a glimmer's there.

24 And Jacob told his father all
During the night, how YHWH in all
Had shown him great mercy, and how
He'd prospered *him in sheep and cow*
In all his ways, protected him
From all evil *and all things grim*.

25 And Isaac blessed his father's God
Of Abraham, who had not trod
Withdrawn from His mercy and from
His righteousness from the sons come
Of his servant Isaac. 26 And in
The morning Jacob told *his kin*,
His father Isaac of the vow
Which he had vowed to YHWH *somehow*,

And of the vision he had seen,
 And that he had built *on the scene*
 An altar, and that everything
 Was ready for the sacrifice
 To be made before YHWH *the King*
 As he had vowed *it to suffice*,
 And that he had come to set him
 On a donkey *and make him trim*.
 27 And Isaac told Jacob his son,
 "I'm not able to go *for fun*
 With you, for I am old and not
 Able to bear the way *and plot*.
 But go, my son, in peace, for I've
 Fulfilled one hundred sixty-five
 Years today, I'm no longer able
 To journey, set your mother *stable*
 On a donkey and let her go
 With you. 28 "And I know, my son, that
 You've come on my account, whereat
 May this day be blessed on which you
 Have seen me alive, and I too
 Have seen you, my son. 29 "And may you
 Prosper and fulfil the vow which
 You have vowed, and don't over pitch
 Your vow now, for you shall be called
 To account for the vow installed,
 Now therefore make haste to perform,
 And may He be pleased *at the storm*
 Who has made all things, to whom you
 Have vowed the vow *in what you do*."

Father and son spend midnight hours to
 think

And dream about the ladder on the brink
 Of heaven and earth that Jacob at Bethel
 Saw rising in the sky from where the swell
 Of earth became his pillow in his flight.
 So father and son spend a holy night,
 While on the breast of Isaac sleep the sons
 Whose privilege was to find Isaac's buns.
 Beloved, the dear domestic scene that rises
 From Jubilee's intimate words comprises
 In revelation fuel for burning heart
 Of love, when other texts remain in part
 Dry with the distancing of human cares.
 In Jubilees the soul comes where she dares.

30 And he said to Rebekah: 'Go
 With Jacob your son, don't be slow,'
 And Rebekah went with Jacob
 Her son, and Deborah *at the rub*,
 With her, and they came to Bethel.

31 Jacob remembered the prayer *well*
 With which his father had blessed him
 And his two sons, Levi and *trim*
 Judah, and he rejoiced and blessed
 The God of his fathers *at rest*,
 Abraham and Isaac. 32 And he
 Said "Now I know that I shall be
 In an eternal hope, and my
 Sons also, before God on high,"
 And thus is it ordained concerning
 The two, and they record it earning
 Eternal testimony to
 Them on the heavenly tablets *true*
 How Isaac blessed them *as their due*.

Eternal reward for Levi and brother
 Judah is in the blessing from another,
 And not in the great feats of grace and
 strength
 They did in their lifetime and in its length.
 The one great thing recorded on the due
 Tablets of fate in heaven's not the view
 Of deeds in action, not the cunning crew,
 But merely blessing others, though a few.
 Beloved, may my life be lived to inspire
 My words of blessing on my children's
 choir,
 And may my words of blessing be to me
 The eternal reward of being free.
 Beloved, You too receive only reward
 From words of blessing, and not words in
 sword.

Week 30 Jubilees 32

1 And he stayed that night at Bethel,
 And Levi dreamed that they had *well*
 Ordained and made him priest of El
 Most High, him and his sons forever,
 And he woke from his sleep *as never*
 And blessed YHWH. 2 And Jacob arose
 Early in the morning, from doze
 On the fourteenth (*Tuesday*) of this month,
 and
 He gave a [portion] *at his hand*
 Of all that came with him, both of
 Men and *their* cattle, and both of
 Gold and every vessel and glove,
 Indeed, he gave [portions] of all.
 3 And in those days Rachel became
 Pregnant with her son Benjamin.
 And Jacob counted his sons from
 Him upwards and it fell to come

On Levi the portion of YHWH,
 And so his father clothed him *due*
 In priestly pageantry and *crew*
 And filled his hands. 4 And on the day
 Fifteenth of this month, *as they say*,
The fourth day of the week, he brought
 To the altar fourteen oxen
 From among the cattle *in pen*,
 And twenty-eight rams, forty-nine
 Sheep, seven lambs *as well in line*,
 And twenty-one kids of the goats
 As a burnt-offering *with slit throats*
 On the altar of sacrifice,
 Well pleasing for a sweet surplice
 In savour before Alohim.
 5 This was his offering, *by his dream*
 In consequence of the vow which
 He had vowed to do *without hitch*,
 That he'd give a tenth [portion], and
 Their fruit-offerings *from off the land*
 And their drink offerings, *as was planned*.

It must be some noble, fine intuition
 That Jacob used, or else divine
 commission,
 To know how many of each sheep and goat
 And other beast should be allowed to gloat
 Upon the altars of holocaust rote.
 I am so poor at figures, I'd have done
 With all the counting and have smitten one
 Of each and let it go at that. Instead
 Jacob has offerings done, in plenty fed
 The crew of worshippers who joined the
 spate
 Of well wishers of Rebekah for fat.
 Beloved, if sacrifice is what You want,
 I think I have a slaughterhouse to haunt,
 Or else appear with nothing dark or gaunt.

6 And when the fire had consumed it,
 He burnt incense on the fire spit,
 And for a thank offering two oxen
 And four rams, four sheep *without toxin*,
 Four he-goats, and two sheep a year
 Old, and two goat kids *from the rear*,
 And so he did for seven days.
 7 And he and all his sons for praise
 And his men were eating *this* there
 During seven days and blessing
 And thanking YHWH *for everything*,
 Who had delivered him out of
 All his tribulation and *shove*

And had given him his vow's *thing*.
 8 And he tithed all the clean beasts, and
 Made burnt sacrifice *by command*,
 But the unclean beasts he *did not*
 Give to Levi his son *for lot*,
 And he gave him all the souls of
 The men, and Levi *as above*
 Discharged the priestly office at
 Bethel where his dad Jacob sat
 In preference to his ten brothers,
 And he was a priest there *as stirs*,
 And Jacob gave his vow, 9 thus he
 Tithed once again the tithe to be
 To YHWH and sanctified it, and
 It became holy to His hand.

There's only need for priest when killing is
 The means of livelihood instead of quiz
 Of gathering what fruit is to be found
 On tree and bush before the frozen ground.
 A vegetarian state will exclude
 The need for priest to burn the corpses
 crude
 Left over from the sacrificial brood.
 No wonder in the country where I live
 The priests no longer measure up to sieve,
 But women also have the right to make
 The priesthood their place in the faithful
 stake.

Where women are made equal to the men,
 One knows that job has lost glitter and yen,
 For true power is reserved to the male rake.

10 And for this reason it's ordained
 On the heavenly tablets unstained
 As a law for the tithing to
 Eat the tithe again before YHWH
 From year to year, in the place where
 It's chosen that His name be there,
 And to this law there is no stay,
 Limit of days forever sway.
 11 This ordinance is written that
 It may be fulfilled from thereat
 Year to year in eating the second
 Tithe before YHWH in the place *reckoned*
 Where it has been chosen *to be*,
 And nothing shall remain to see
 Of it from this year to the year
 Following. 12 For in its own year
 Shall the seed be eaten till days
 Of the harvest of the seed's *ways*
 By that year, and the grape juice till

The days of the grape juice *fulfil*,
 And oil till the days of its season.
 13 And all that is left there by reason
 And becomes old, let it be counted
 As polluted: let it be mounted
 To be burnt with fire, for it's foul.
 14 And thus let them put it in jowl
 Together in the sanctuary,
 And let them not suffer it *merry*
 To get old. 15 And all the tithes of
 The oxen and sheep *as above*
 Shall be holy to YHWH, and shall
 Belong to his priests *for their sal*,
 Which they will eat before Him from
 Year to year *in the time to come*,
 For thus is it ordained, engraved
 Regarding the tithe *and is paved*
 On the heavenly tablets *unwaived*.

Shall belong to the priests, ah yes, that's
 why
 The priesthood was a great thing on the sly.
 The economic factor always wields
 More in the end than sentimental fields.
 As long as there was meat aplenty stashed
 On the meat hooks in sacrifice uncashed,
 Only men could enlist to live unabashed
 As priests. But now the sacrifice is made
 In just a bit of cookie and waylaid
 With just a sip of wine, ladies are paid
 To do the simple chore. Let such eat what
 Is left in crumbs, and drink with their eyes
 shut
 The dregs from every chalice on the up.
 Beloved, I seek instead eternal cup.

16 And on the following night, upon
 The twenty-second day's fore-dawn
 Of this month, *fourth day of the week*,
 Jacob resolved to build a *sleek*
 Place, and to build a wall around
 The court, and sanctify the ground
 And make it holy for all time,
 For himself and his children's rhyme
 After him. 17 And YHWH appeared to
 Him by night and blessed him *and crew*
 And said to him, "Your name shall not
 Be called Jacob, but Israel's *lot*
 Shall they name your name." 18 And He
 said
 To him again, "I'm YHWH who tread
 To create the heaven and the earth,

And I'll increase you in your worth
 And multiply you greatly, and
 Kings shall come forth from you *in band*,
 And they shall judge everywhere that
 The foot of humankind is at.
 19 "And I'll give to your seed all land
 Which is under the sky, they'll stand
 To judge all the nations by their
 Desires, and after that they'll bear
 Possession of the whole earth and
 Inherit it for ever." 20 And
 He finished speaking with him, and
 He went up from him *as he planned*.
 And Jacob looked till He had gone
 Up into heaven. 21 Thereupon
 He saw in vision of the night,
 And indeed an angel *of light*
 Descended from the sky with seven
 Tablets in his hands, *sent from heaven*
 And he gave them to Jacob, and
 He read them and knew all that *planned*
 And written in them which would come
 Upon him and his sons *to come*
 Throughout all ages. 22 And he showed
 Him all that was written *and glowed*
 On the tablets, and said to him,
 "Do not build this place *to be trim*,
 And do not make it eternal,
 A sanctuary pivotal,
 And do not live here, for it's not
 The place. Go to the house and plot
 Of Abraham your father and
 Live with Isaac your father *grand*
 Until the day of your dad's death.
 23 "For in Egypt you'll leave your breath
 In peace, and in this land you shall
 Be buried with all sepulchral
 Honour in the tomb of your fathers,
 With Abraham, Isaac, *no bothers*.
 24 "Fear not, for as you have seen and
 Read it, so shall all *come to stand*,
 And write down everything as you
 Have seen and read, *and write it true*."

Some things in the book support the bright
 view
 Samaritans have of what things are true,
 Despite the scholars saying that the book
 Was written by a late hand in the nook.
 One is the place thus sanctified to be
 A place of worship by Jacob and see.
 Jacob is prophet better than last known

Because despite his disappointment stone
 He even knew that he'd die not alone
 In Egypt. Somehow that seems to defy
 The veil of ignorance that some would spy
 About the man deceived by son and all.
 The ancient words were there for some
 recall,
 Beloved, for even my calf in the stall.

25 And Jacob said "Lord, how can I
 Remember all I've read to spy?"
 And he said to him, "I will bring
 All things to your remembering."
 26 And he went up from him, and he
 Awoke from his sleep, bore in mind
 Everything he had come to see
 And all he had read *from the signed*,
 And he wrote down all of the words
 Which he'd read and seen *in their herds*.

The gift of writing had been handed down
 From Abraham to Isaac with a gown
 Of doctor's status in Canaanite town.
 And Isaac taught Jacob to write the word
 So that the divine message undeterred
 Might be vouchsafed to righteous beast and
 bird.

Beloved, I thank You for the dreams of old
 That written once have never left me cold,
 But followed my footsteps where books are
 sold

To bless my days and nights with sayings
 told

In melodies of fragrance from the tomb
 Of Abraham and Sarah and the room
 Of Isaac and of Jacob, where at last
 The tender Leah's hopes came and were
 passed.

27 He celebrated there one more
 Day, and he sacrificed in store
 Thereon according to all he
 Sacrificed on former decree
 Of days, and called its name 'Addition,'
 For this day was added *ambition*.
 The former days he called 'The Feast'.
 28 And thus it was shown and released
 That it should be, as written on
 The heavenly tablets *from the dawn*
Of time, wherefore it was revealed
 To him that he should *the unsealed*
 Celebrate, and add to the seven

Days of the feast revealed *from heaven*.
 29 And so its name was called 'Addition,'
 Because it was *as a condition*
 Recorded among the feast days,
 According to number of days
 In the year. 30 And in the night, on
 The twenty-third of this month drawn
To be the fifth day of the week,
 Deborah Rebekah's nurse *and weak*
 Died, and they buried her beneath
 The city under the oak *wreath*
 Of the river, he called the name
 Of this place, 'Deborah's river's *fame*,'
 And the oak, 'The oak of the mourning
 Of Deborah.' 31 And Rebekah *mourning*
 Went back to her house to his father
 Isaac, and Jacob sent *there rather*
 By her hand rams and sheep and goats
 To make a meal *not just of oats*
 For his father such as he loved.
 32 He went after his mother *gloved*
 Till he came to Kabratan's land,
 And he lived there, *as by command*.
 33 And Rachel bore a son that night,
 And called his name 'Son of my *fright*
And sorrow', for she suffered in
 Giving him birth: but *for his kin*
 His father called him Benjamin,
 On the eighth month's eleventh day,
Which was the second of the week,
 In the first year of the sixth week
 Of this jubilee *and its sway*. [2143 A.M.]
 34 And Rachel died there and was buried
 In the land of Ephrath *and tarried*,
 The same is Bethlehem, where built
 Jacob a pillar on the silt
 Of Rachel's grave, upon the road
 Above her grave *for sorrow's load*.

Had Deborah lived, Rachel might have
 done too.
 She had no help from the wise woman's
 view
 To bring her through the breach of second
 birth.
 She was not accustomed to the pain's
 worth.
 Had Deborah lived, and in this thought I
 know
 I approach the inscrutable in show
 That is Yours and alone Yours in the sky.
 But it is very human wondering why.

Had Deborah lived, there might not be the
tomb
Of Rachel on the way to inn and room
In Bethlehem. I once stopped there to pray
And enter in the quiet of the day
That surrounds Rachel's tomb, despite the
cars
That honk and whirl outside below the
stars.

Jubilees 33

1 Jacob went and lived to the south
In Magdaladra'ef, *a mouth*
Full that. And so then he went to
His father Isaac, he and *true*
Wife Leah, on the first day of
The tenth month (Wednesday). 2 And
Reuben above
Saw Bilhah, Rachel's maid, who was
His father's concubine as does,
Bathing in secret water, and
He loved her. 3 And he hid his hand
Till night, and he came in the house
Of Bilhah [at night], *like a mouse*,
And found her sleeping there alone
Upon a bed in her house *stone*.
4 And he lay with her, and she woke
And saw indeed Reuben the bloke
Was lying with her in the bed,
And she uncovered the wing of
Her covering and seized his *glove*,
And cried out, and discovered that
It was Reuben *where she was at*.
5 She was ashamed because of him,
And so drew back her hand from him,
And he fled. 6 And she lamented
Because of this thing that he did,
And told it not to anyone.
7 And when Jacob returned *for fun*
And sought her, she said to him, "I
Am not clean for your coming, I
Have been defiled as regards you,
For Reuben has defiled me true,
And has lain with me in the night,
And I was asleep *without fright*,
And did not know when he uncovered
My skirt and slept with me *and hovered*."

Polygamous marriage raises the chance
Of incestuous rape in prong and dance
More than one might imagine on the spot.
Though Bilhah was his father's wife in dot,

She was no relative of Reuben, so
It was easy for him to see the glow.
Not only that, chances are she was young,
A maid to younger Rachel and unsprung.
Reuben always took easiest of ways,
And it seemed easier then in his daze
To go to Bilhah's bed instead of keeping
His lust under control in fast and weeping.
Beloved, take me to Yourself even though
I am no beauty in the flower show.

8 And Jacob was angry indeed
With Reuben because he in greed
Had lain with Bilhah, because he
Had uncovered his father's fee.
9 And Jacob did not approach her
Again since Reuben defiled her.
And as for any man who would
Uncover father's skirt or hood
His deed is wicked in scheme,
For he's abomination's extreme
Before YHWH. 10 For this reason it
Is written and ordained as fit
On heavenly tablets that a man
Should not lie with his father's wife,
And should not uncover *by plan*
His father's skirt, *in peace or strife*,
For this is unclean, they shall die
Surely together, one to lie
With his father's wife and the wife
Also, for they have wrought *with strife*
Uncleanness on earth. 11 And there'll be
Nothing unclean before the see
Of our God in the nation which
He has chosen *above all switch*
For Himself as a possession.
12 And again, it's written to run
A second time, "Cursed be he who
Lies with his father's wife to do,
For he's uncovered father's shame,"
And all the holy ones in name
Of YHWH said "So be it, so be."
13 And you, Moses, command in fee
The children of Israel to do
By this word, for it *entails true*
A punishment of death, unclean,
And there has no atonement been
For ever to atone the man
Who has committed this *by plan*,
But he is to be put to death
And slain, and stoned with stones, till
breath

Be rooted out from him among
The people of our God *unsprung*.

The sin was great on Reuben's part indeed.
He sinned against Bilhah in his own need,
Out of a disregard for father's steed,
Most unhappily for the chosen seed
As born to Bilhah and Jacob in speed.
So the sin of Reuben was great, but why
Must You punish Bilhah, who was not sly,
Could not distinguish in the darkness then
Either for son or father among men?
Lowly Bilhah deserves no retribution
With Reuben, yet it always seems solution
After the fact take woman in account
In dealing her a dithering amount.
None but the guilty ought to seek ablution.

14 For to no man who does so in
Israel is it permitted *sin*
To remain alive for a day
On the earth, for he is a way
Abominable and unclean.

15 And let them not say, to Reuben
Was granted life and forgiveness
After he'd lifted up the dress
Of father's concubine, and to
Her also though she had a *true*
Husband, and her husband Jacob,
His father's still living, *the rub*.

16 For until that time there had not
Been revealed ordinance and plot
Of judgement and law in completeness
For all, but in your days *for neatness*
It has been revealed as a law
Of seasons and of days *in awe*,
And an everlasting law for
The everlasting ages' store.

17 And for this law there is no end
Of days, and no atonement fend,
But they must both be rooted out
In the midst of the nation's stout:
On the day whereon they commit
It they shall slay them, *it is fit*.

18 And you, Moses, write *it all* down
For Israel they to their renown
Observe it, and do according
To these words, not commit the thing,
A sin to death, for YHWH our God
Is judge, who does not respect *clod*
Or persons and does not accept
Gifts *from such persons who've so slept*.

19 And tell them these words of the pact,
That they may hear, observe, and act
On their guard with respect to them,
And not be destroyed *at the hem*
And rooted up out of the land,
For an uncleanness, and a hand
To an abomination, and
Contamination, and pollution
Are all who make such contribution
On the earth and before our God.
20 And there's no greater sin in prod
Than the fornication which they
Commit on earth, for Israel gay
Is a holy nation to YHWH
Its God, a nation and an heir,
A priestly and a royal nation,
And for *His own* possession's *ration*,
And there shall no such uncleanness
Come in holy nation's *address*.

Though the law had not been revealed
before
The night Reuben came scratching at the
door,
He still knew better than to stand a groom
Instead of his father, it's reason's doom.
The death sentence had not been given out
When Reuben came without a sound or
shout.

But he did not escape his father's wrath.
I too often tread on an unknown path,
Beloved, and find unanswered questions
stand
Among the firs and birches near at hand.
Give me death sentence for the part I play,
And sink myself in You not for a day
But for eternity, nor let me stray
From golden censer and from silver sand.

21 And in the third year of this week [2145
A.M.]

Number six Jacob *took a peek*
And all his sons went and lived in
The house of Abraham *their kin*,
Near Isaac his father and near
Rebekah his mother *and dear*.
22 And these were the names of the sons
Of Jacob: the first-born *in runs*
Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah,
Issachar, Zebulon, Leah
Is their mother, and also then
Rachel's sons, Joseph, Benjamin,

And the sons of Bilhah, Dan and
 Naphtali, and Zilpah's sons *grand*,
 Gad and Asher, and Dinah, who
 Was daughter of Leah in crew,
 The only daughter of Jacob.
 23 And they came and bowed down in hub
 To Isaac and Rebekah, and
 When they saw them they blessed Jacob
 And all his sons *there out of hand*,
 Isaac rejoiced exceedingly,
 He saw the sons of Jacob *free*,
 His younger son and he blessed them,
The whole lot precious as a gem.

It's vaguely possible, no doubt it's true,
 A man can have twelve sons, sons not a
 few,
 And only one daughter. Still I would doubt.
 It's easy to think some girl was left out.
 The book of Jubilees tries to find all
 The names of the women both short and
 tall.
 The fact it does not invent any rate
 Of sisters for Dinah would indicate
 That none of those strange names were new
 invention
 By Moses or whoever made prevention.
 Beloved, I follow twelve strong men and
 young
 And one lady who does not go unsung.
 The pattern has been set from ancient time,
 The cycle spins along in fresh new rhyme.

Week 31 Jubilees 34

1 And in the sixth year of this week
 Of this forty-fourth jubilee [2148 A.M.],
 Jacob sent his sons out to seek
 Pasture for their sheep *carefully*,
 And his servants with them went to
 The pastures of Shechem *in dew*.
 2 And the seven kings of Amorites
 Assembled themselves for the fights
 Against them there, and to kill them,
 Hiding themselves under trees' *hem*,
 And to take their cattle as prey.
 3 And Jacob, Levi and Judah
 And Joseph were in the house of
 Isaac their father *as above*,
 For his spirit was sorrowful,
 And they could not leave him *to pull*.
 And Benjamin was the youngest,
 For this reason remained a guest

With his father. 4 There came the king
 Of Taphu and also the king
 Of 'Aresa, and the king of
 Seragan, and also the king
 Of Selo, and king of Ga'as,
 And king of Bethoron *to pass*,
 And king of Ma'anisakir,
 And all those who live in the sheer
 Mountains *and* who live in the woods
 In the land of Canaan *with goods*.
 5 And they announced this to Jacob
 Saying "Indeed, the kings that club
 The Amorites have surrounded
 Your sons, and plundered where they hid
 Their herds." 6 And he rose from his house,
 He and his three sons without spouse,
 And all the servants of his dad,
 As well as the servants *he had*,
 And he went against them with six
 Thousand men with swords *and with picks*.
 7 And he killed them in pastures of
 Shechem, and pursued those *above*
 Who fled, and he killed them with mouth
 Of the sword *fleeing north and south*,
 And he slew 'Aresa and still
 Taphu and Saregan *for ill*,
 And Selo, 'Amanisakir
 And Ga[ga]'as, and without fear,
 And he recovered *all* his herds.
 8 And he prevailed over their turds,
 And imposed tribute on them that
 They should pay him in taxes *fat*,
 Five fruit products of their land, and
 He built Robel and Tamnatares.
 9 And he returned in peace *in band*,
 And made peace with them, *and as fair is*,
 They too became his servants, till
 The day he and his sons *for fill*
 Went down into Egypt *to till*.

The glut of greed inspires men everywhere
 And in all times so they forget to share
 And go out to fight one another till
 The stronger bends the weaker to his will.
 That is reality we still live with.
 It helps but little to recite the myth
 Of Sinai where You forbid all to kill.
 Disarming argument we need the state
 To prevent killing nearby soon or late.
 The fact is killing goes on still apace
 No matter how strong grows the state in
 race.

Beloved, teach my doubting heart and the heart
Of everyone to refrain from that part,
And save alive both horse and men in cart.

10 And in seventh year of this week [2149
A.M.]

He sent Joseph to learn and seek
About the welfare of his brothers
From his house to the land of *others*
In Shechem, and he found them in
The land of Dothan. 11 And with sin
They dealt treacherously with him,
And they formed a plot against him
To kill him, but changing their minds,
They sold him in Ishmaelite binds
To merchants, and they brought him down
Into Egypt *without his gown*,
And they sold him to Potiphar,
The eunuch of Pharaoh, the star
Of the cooks, priest of 'Elew city.
12 The sons of Jacob *without pity*
Slaughtered a kid, and dipped the coat
Of Joseph in the blood of *goat*,
And sent *it* to Jacob their father
On the seventh month's tenth day rather,
Which is the sixth day of the week.
13 And he mourned all that night *to seek*,
For they'd brought it to him at eve,
Coming upon sabbath's reprieve,
And he became fevered to mourn
The death of *Joseph the forlorn*,
Saying "Surely some evil beast
Has devoured Joseph," and increased
All the members of his house [mourning
With him that day, and they] were
mourning

And grieving with him all that day.
14 And his sons and his daughter fey
Rose up to comfort him, but he
Refused to be comforted, see,
For his son. 15 On that day Bilhah
Heard that Joseph perished *in raw*,
She died in grief for him. And she
Was living in Qafratef, and
Dinah, his daughter in the band
His only girl, died when she heard
Joseph had perished *in a word*.

Note well, Beloved, that two women died
for
The grief they felt to hear Joseph no more

Lived to bring joy to heart of maid and
mother,
To Dinah the only sister of brother.
The Sabbath joy that day was turned to
grief,
And who knows what that first Sabbath in
brief
Held for poor Joseph as he made his way
Toward the Nile and the Egyptian sway.
Beloved, I praise You that of certainty
No one shall die to hear my destiny
For grief that I no longer wander free.
Let my news bring the Sabbath day with
joy
To cantillate Your name and so employ
The heart of every loving girl and boy.

16 So in one month came these three griefs
On Israel. He and his *chiefs*
Buried Bilhah beside the tomb
Of Rachel, and Dinah in room,
Who was his daughter, buried there.
17 He grieved for Joseph one whole year,
And without stopping, for he said
"Let me go down to the grave led
Mourning for my son *in his bed*."
18 For this reason it is ordained
For Israel's folk that the explained
Should afflict their souls on the day
Of the seventh month and tenth come,
On the day that the news in some
That brought weeping for Joseph came
To Jacob his father *in shame*,
To make atonement for their souls
With a young goat kid for their tolls
In seventh month one every year,
On the tenth day they should appear,
For their sins, for they'd sorely grieved
Their father's heart *and unreprieved*
Regarding Joseph his son's *fear*.
19 And this day has been ordained that
They should grieve on it *where they sat*
For their sins, and for all transgressions
And for all their errors' *confessions*,
To purify their souls that day
Once every year, *and in that way*.
20 And after Joseph disappeared,
The sons of Jacob *who had leered*
Got married. Reuben's wife was called
'Ada, and the name of installed
Simeon's wife is 'Adlba'a,
A Canaanite, *against the law*,

Levi's wife's name is Melka, of
 The daughters of Aram above,
 Of the seed of the sons of Terah,
 And the name of Judah's wife, bear her,
 Was Betasu'el, Canaanite,
 And the name of Issachar's wife
 Was Hezaqa: and the name of
 Zabulon's wife, Ni'imán, and
 The name of Dan's wife, 'Egla *fanned*,
 And the name of Naphtali's wife,
 Rasu'u, coming from the rise
 Mesopotamia, the name
 Of Gad's wife was Maka, the name
 Of Asher's wife, 'Ijona, and
 The name of Joseph's wife in hand,
 Asenath, the Egyptian, and
 The name of Benjamin's wife was
 'Ijasaka, *and so she does*.
 21 But Simeon repented, and
 Took a second wife from the band
 Of Mesopotamia as
 Each of his other brothers has.

Rachel's tomb sits directly on the road,
 Against the tracks filled with traffic gone
 past,
 Cars coming without pause and dust to cast
 High on the hot air burdened with the load
 Enough in care for centuries that goad
 Light slanting toward the steep hills
 coming fast
 By Bethlehem, faces losing contrast
 In countless generations and unslowed.
 Loving Rachel, I stopped to pray in time,
 Having forgotten Bilhah's tomb was there
 Along with Dinah, victim of a crime.
 How could I be so callous, without care?
 Dinah forgive me, and Bilhah relent.
 I'm sorry I forgot their franchisement.

Jubilees 35

1 And in the first year of the first
 Week of the forty-fifth outburst
 In jubilee [2157 A.M.] Rebekah called
 Jacob, her son, and *unappalled*
 Commanded him about his dad
 And about his brother, he had
 To honour them his whole life long.
 2 And Jacob said "I wish no wrong,
 But will do everything as you
 Have commanded me as my due,
 For this thing will be honour and

Greatness to me on every hand,
 And righteousness in eyes of YHWH,
 That I should honour them as true.
 3 "You too, mother, know from the time
 I was born until this day's *dime*,
 All my deeds and all that's in my
 Heart, that I always think and try
 Good concerning all. 4 "And how should
 I not do this thing which you would
 Command me, that I honour my
 Father and my brother *as high!*
 5 "Tell me, mother, what wickedness
 Have you perceived in my address
 That I should turn away from it,
 And mercy upon me be fit."

The core of Your divine law, my Beloved
 Has here appeared in beauty, silken-gloved.
 Of all actions determined by the rate
 Mandated in Your law, the one of state
 As highest above all is to relate
 Justly to all the others at the gate.
 My love is poured out for Jacob, one who
 Calls at the judgement of his mother's hue,
 Establishing that among crowd or few
 Looking for the best in humankind's set
 What guides him with everyone he has met.
 Above the din of competition's street
 I seek, Beloved, that loving way to greet
 No one but in Your light of goodness' debt.

6 And she said to him, "My son, I
 Have not seen in you as I spy
 In all my days any perverse
 But *only* righteous deeds *disperse*.
 And yet I'll tell you truth, my son,
 I shall die before this year's run,
 And I shall not survive this year
 In my life, for I've seen appear
 In a dream the day of my death,
 That I should not live to *take breath*
 Beyond a hundred years and fifty
 Five: and indeed I've finished nifty
 All the days of my life which I
 Am to live *and then come to die.*"
 7 Jacob laughed at his mother's words.
 Because his mother said she'd die,
 And she sat there beside his curds
 In full possession of her strength,
 She was not weak or ill at length,
 But walked around with good eye-sight,
 And had strong teeth in her own right,

And she had not been sick a day
Throughout her life and all her stay.

The love a child bears to his mother makes
Him laugh at death as though its awful
stakes

Out of this world were myth and vainly
song.

My heart speaks with the heart of Jacob
long.

As he could not believe his mother's death
Should ever come to catch upon his breath,
My fancy also tells me none of mine
Can ever quite pass out of place and line.
Except I stop at Jacob's mother's word,
Listen to her prophetically dream-stirred
With hope hardened in jewelled clasp
inured

As long as stars fail not to mark the way
I step across the wilderness in sway,
No voice but Yours, Beloved, may meet
my day.

8 And Jacob said to her, "Blessed be
I, mother, if my days in fee
Come near the days of your life's length,
And my strength stay as has your strength:
But you will not die, you are joking
With me about death and its poking."

9 And she went in to Isaac and
Said to him then, "Now here I stand
To make petition that you make
Esau swear he will not mistake
To injure Jacob, nor pursue
Him with anger, you know it's true
Esau's thoughts are perverse from youth,
And there's no good in him nor truth,
For he desires after your death
To kill him. 10 "And you know what breath
Of wrath he's breathed out since the day
Jacob his brother went away
To Haran until this day, how
He's forsaken us and the plough
With his whole heart, and he has done
Evil to us, your flocks begun
He's taken for himself, and carried
Off all your gear from where you tarried.

11 "When we implored and besought him
For what was our own, he was *grim*,
Acting as though in charity
He gave of his own stingily.

12 "And he is bitter against you

Because you blessed Jacob in view,
Your perfect and your upright son,
For there's no evil in him done,
But only goodness in him, and
Since he came from Haran *in band*
Until today he has not robbed
Us of anything, *no, nor cobbled*,
For he brings us everything in
Its season always, *without sin*,
And rejoices with all his heart
When we take at his hands a part,
And he blesses us, and has not
Parted from us since he has got
Back from Haran until these days,
And he stays to help us always
At home, honours us *in his ways*."

The difference between Jacob and his
Brother Esau is spoken in a quiz.
Two things alone mark them beneath the
law

As contrasting to keep him in their awe.
The first is that Jacob is sure to look
For the best in each one comes in his nook,
While Esau poisons mind with envy's stew
Since the day he bought pottage to his rue.
The second is that Jacob honours You
By honouring his parents with his wealth,
While Esau robs them blind in cunning
stealth.

In all other things the two sons remain
Faithful, obedient, and sound and sane.
Repentance is to change outlook of brain.

13 And Isaac said to her, "I too
Know and see Jacob's actions, who
Is with us, how with all his heart
He honours us, but I in love
Formerly held Esau above
Jacob, because he was firstborn,
But now love Jacob *without scorn*
More than Esau, for he has done
Many wicked things, and there's none
Upright in him, for all his ways
Are unrighteousness and the craze
Of violence, [and there is no
Righteousness around him to show.]
14 "And now my heart is troubled for
All his deeds, and neither he nor
His seed is to be saved, for they
Are those who will be destroyed from
The earth and who will at last come

To be rooted out from beneath
 The sky, for he forsakes bequeath
 Of the God of Abraham and
 Has gone after his wives and band
 Of their uncleanness and their flaws,
 He and his children *without laws*.
 15 “And you bid me make him swear that
 He will not kill Jacob who sat
 As his brother, even if he
 Swear he will not abide freely
 By his oath, and he’ll not do good
 But evil only. 16 “If he should
 Desire to kill Jacob, his brother,
 Into Jacob’s hands will the other
 Be given, and he’ll not escape
 From his hands, [for he will *like ape*
 Descend into his power.] 17 “So do
 Not fear for Jacob, for the guard
 Of Jacob is great *on the sword*
 And mighty and honoured, and praised
 More Esau’s guardian *when raised*.”

The safety of the just is not in trust
 Put in the violent whose nature must
 Burst out in violence despite the will
 To promise good, the good not to fulfil.
 As violence is uprooted alone
 By realizing who is on the throne
 In every heart where “I” stands on the
 stone,
 So safety lies not in the hand of power,
 But in protection given in the hour
 By Your Almighty sovereign will and
 hand.
 I fear indeed the weaponed, blinded band
 That pretends to do justice in the land,
 But set my fear aside and cease to cower.

18 Rebekah sent and called Esau
 And he came to her, and for law
 She said to him, “Here’s my request,
 My son, to make to you as best,
 And promise to do it, my son.”
 19 And he said “Consider it done,
 Whatever you say to me, and
 I’ll not refuse petition’s *stand*.”
 20 And she said to him, “I ask you
 That the day I die, you’ll be true
 And take me and bury me near
 Sarah, your father’s mother *dear*,
 And that you and Jacob will love
 Each other and like hand in glove

That neither will desire the wrong
 Against the other, but the song
 Of mutual love only, and *so*
 You’ll prosper, my sons, *on the go*
 And be honoured in all the land,
 And no enemy will in band
 Rejoice over you, and you’ll be
 A blessing and a *true* mercy
 In the eyes of all who love you.”
 21 And he said “I will do what you
 Have asked me, and I’ll bury you
 On the day you die near Sarah,
 My father’s mother, *in her awe*,
 As you’ve desired that her bones may
 Be near your bones, *not far to stray*.
 22 “And Jacob, my brother, also,
 I’ll love above all flesh *to go*,
 For I have not a brother in
 All the earth but just him to win,
 And this is little merit for
 Me if I love him all the more,
 For he’s my brother, we were sown
 Together in your body grown,
 And together came from your womb,
 And if I don’t love brother’s room,
 Whom shall I love? 23 “And I, indeed
 Beg you to exhort Jacob freed
 Concerning me and of my sons,
 For I know he’ll surely be king
 Over me and over my sons,
 For on the day my father blessed
 Him he made him higher and best
 And me the lower. 24 “And I swear
 To you that I shall love and care,
 And not desire evil to him
 All the days of my life *though grim*
 But only good.” 25 And he swore to
 Her about all of this matter due.

This is the greatest blindness of a man,
 That he thinks he can promise justice’ ban
 And keep within his heart the view alone
 That “I” within him is one god on bone
 And all others are gods in competition
 Who must be thwarted in the fair
 commission.
 Few admit that is what is in the heart,
 And yet neglecting to do duty’s part
 In seeing You in every face that’s met,
 And worshipping the divine where its set,
 Must always end in violence and shame.
 That is why I repeat Your holy name,

Remembering Your face, Beloved, is seen
In friend and enemy and all between.

And she called Jacob before eyes
Of Esau, and gave him in guise
Of commandment according to
The words which she had spoken to
Esau. 26 And he said "I shall do
Your pleasure, believe me that no
Evil at all will from me go
Or from my sons against Esau,
And I'll be prince before his awe
In nothing but only in love
And make no matter push or shove."

I note, Beloved, the promise Jacob made,
And how he was able to keep the spade.
Because he always sought the Good in all
He was able to respond to the call
Of mother to live in peace with all men
As well as with his brother found again.
Solemnity of promise cuts no ice,
But only recognition will suffice
That You are One and seated in all those
Whom You create to know the way that
goes

To finding there is only one "I" here,
That "I" that as You only must appear.
Beloved, I rush to find You only when
I see the multitude in wood and glen.

27 And they ate and drank, she and her
Sons that night till her death occur,
And she died, three jubilees and
One week and one year old to stand,
On that night, and both of her sons,
Esau and Jacob's *benisons*,
Buried her in the double cave
Near Sarah, their dad's mother's *grave*.

Two men join themselves in the sacred rites
After their loving feast of days and nights,
Each with heart filled with love and with
the sights
Of mother's guidance to lead through their
plights.
Neither son knew to what extent the heart
Fashioned to see good or to see the part
Of evil in another from the start
Would be the one factor to cast the dart.
Two equal in their adherence to law
And following the ritual with awe

Sit in one pew agreeing to the song.
But one will choose the right and one the
wrong.
Beloved, I flee to You alone to keep
My heart from what at last made Esau
weep.

Week 32 Jubilees 36

1 And in the sixth year of this week [2162
A.M.]

Isaac called his two sons, *both weak*
Esau and Jacob, and they came
To him, and he gave them *his claim*,
"My sons, I'm going in the way
Of my fathers, and to the gay
Eternal house where fathers lay.
2 "Therefore bury me near *the bones*
Of Abraham my father's zones,
In the double cave in the field
Of Ephron the Hittite *revealed*,
Where Abraham purchased a tomb
To bury in, and in that room
Which I dug for myself, there too
Bury me. 3 "This I command you,
My sons, that you practise the right
And uprightness in the earth's *light*,
So that YHWH may bring upon you
All that YHWH said that he would do
For Abraham and for his seed.
4 "And love one another *with speed*,
My sons, your brothers as a man
Who loves his own soul *as he can*,
And let each seek in what he may
Benefit his brother *in sway*,
And act together on the earth,
And let them love each other's *worth*
As their own souls. The idol thing,
I command and adjure your wing
To reject them and hate them too,
And love them not *whate'er you do*,
For they are full of grand deceit
Deceiving those who at their feet
Worship them and also who bow
Down to them. 6 "But remember now,
My sons, YHWH God of Abraham
Your father, and how I too am
His worshipper, and served Him in
Righteousness and joy *without sin*,
That He might multiply you and
Increase your seed *upon the land*
As the stars of heaven in a crowd,
And establish you *tall and proud*

Upon the earth as righteous plant
 Not rooted out, *nor become scant*,
 Unto all ages and always.
 7 "And now I'll make you swear *in lays*
 A great oath, for there is no oath
 Which is greater *before you both*
 Than it by the name glorious
 And honoured and great and *for us*
 Splendid and wonderful and mighty,
 Which created the heavens *flighty*
 As well as the *whole earth down pat*
 And all things there together, that
 You will fear Him and worship at
 His altar. 8 "And that each will love
 His brother with affection's shove
 And in *his* righteousness, and that
 Neither will desire evil *spat*
 Against his brother from this time
 For ever all the days you climb
 That you may prosper in your deeds
 And not be destroyed *like dead weeds*.
 9 "And if either of you devises
 Evil against his brother's *guises*,
 Know that from now on everyone
 That devises evil *for fun*
 Against his brother shall fall in
 His hand, and shall *for all his sin*
 Be rooted out of living land,
 And his seed destroyed from his band
 Under heaven. 10 "But on the day
 Of trouble and cursing in sway,
 And wrath and indignation's way,
 With flame, devouring fire as He
 Burned Sodom, so likewise will He
 Burn his land as well as city
 And all that's his, and he shall be
 Blotted out of the book freely
 Of the workings of humankind,
 Not be recorded there to find
 In the book of life, but in that
 Which is appointed to the fat
 Destruction, and he shall depart
 Into eternal bitter smart,
 So that their condemnation may
 Always be renewed in hate's sway
 And in cursing and in their wrath
 And in torment and in the path
 Of indignation and in plague
 And in disease for every age.
 I say and bear witness to you,
 My sons, according to the *view*
Of judgement which shall come upon

The man who wishes to have drawn
 An injury to his brother."
 12 And he divided all his verre
 Between the two on that day and
 He gave the larger portion grand
 To him that was the first-born, and
 The tower and all that was about,
 And all that Abraham possessed
 At Beer Sheba. 13 And he confessed
 "This larger portion I will give
 To the firstborn *a place to live*."

To the last Isaac will favour the son,
 The elder son, when everything is done,
 Despite prophetic knowledge that he must
 Because of violence cast down to dust.
 It all comes from the fact that Esau's look
 And temper remind him of whom he took
 As idol from the day of birth, the brother
 Ishmael, whose hand was always against
 other,
 And who lived by the bow on desert sand.
 The problem was the likeness at the stand
 Was superficial. Esau himself knew
 No flaw in his nature would break curfew.
 But Ishmael for his wildness was a man
 Whose heart was knit to brother's without
 plan.

14 And Esau said "I've sold to Jacob
 And given my birthright to Jacob,
 To him let it be given, and
 I have not a word, understand,
 To say about it, it is his."
 15 And Isaac said "My blessing is
 Upon you, my sons, and upon
 Your seed this day, and at its dawn,
 For you have given me my rest,
 And my heart is not pained *in quest*
 About the birthright, lest you should
 Work wickedness instead of good.
 16 "May the Most High God bless the man
 That works righteousness by His plan,
 Him and his seed for ever." 17 And
 He ended blessing and command,
 And they ate and drank before him,
 And he rejoiced because a trim
 And single mind was between them,
 And they went out before his hem
 And rested that day and they slept.
 18 And Isaac slept on his bed yet
 That day rejoicing, and he slept

Eternal sleep, and died *well set*
 One hundred and eighty years old.
 He completed twenty-five *bold*
 Weeks and five years, and his two sons
 Esau and Jacob *left their guns*
 To bury him. 19 And Esau went
 To the land of Edom *forspent*,
 To the mountains of Seir to live.
 20 But Jacob lived *not fugitive*
 In Hebron's mountains, in the tower
 Of the land of sojournings hour
 Of his father Abraham, and
 He worshipped YHWH with all his heart
 And by the visible command
 As he measured in days his part.

Pretence of generosity gave seed
 To trouble brewing for the holy breed.
 If Esau had taken what father gave
 Instead of pretending before his grave
 That his heart was above the greed of paw,
 All things afterward might have gone by
 law.

Jacob would have quietly acquiesced
 To father's will, he had been duly blessed.
 Contracts with hidden plots must always
 fail.

But men still bow before the golden veil.
 Beloved, Isaac well knew what was to
 come,
 And tried to manipulate Esau's rum,
 But Esau in his brave hypocrisy
 Cast aside the wealth that could make him
 free.

21 And Leah his wife died fourth year
 Of the second week *to appear*
 Of the forty-fifth jubilee, [2167 A.M.]
 22 And he buried her *faithfully*
 In the double cave near Rebekah
 His mother to the left of *Mecca*,
 The grave of Sarah, mother of
 His father *and always his love*
 And all her sons and his sons came
 To mourn for his wife Leah's *fame*
 With him and comfort him for loss,
And for waves of sorrow that toss,
 23 For he was lamenting her for
 He loved her very much *in store*
 After Rachel her sister died,
 For she was perfect and *beside*
 Upright in all her ways and she

Honoured Jacob, and *faithfully*
 All the days that she lived with him
 He did not hear from her mouth *grim*
 Or harsh word, for she was gentle
 Peaceable, upright, honourable
 24 And he remembered every deed
 She'd done during her life *with speed*
 And he lamented her exceeding
 For he loved her with his heart *bleeding*
 And with all his soul *and his need*.

Betrayed by father to be hidden bride,
 And hated by her sister in her pride,
 Leah quietly went about her tasks
 With virtue, and that's all that her life asks.
 The humble round of keeping to Your law,
 Beloved, in everything she did and saw,
 Became before she died her victory.
 She gained the love of Jacob as surely
 As perseverance knows a life well lived.
 The hope given to all the fugitived
 Is future victory where virtues rise.
 So Leah turned beautiful despite eyes.
 Beloved, give me the patience of the just
 And lead me to love's victory from dust.

Jubilees 37

1 On the day Isaac, Jacob's father
 And Esau's, died, [2162 A.M.] heard *to*
their bother
 The sons of Esau that Isaac
 2 Had given the portion of the sack
 Of the elder to younger son,
 Jacob, then their anger's begun.
 And they strove with their father, saying
 "Why has your father given *for playing*
 Jacob the portion of the elder
 And passed over you, who are elder
 And Jacob younger?" 3 And he said
 To them "Because I sold my *bled*
 Birthright to Jacob for a small
 Mess of lentils, *and that was all*,
 And on the day my father sent
 Me to hunt and catch provident
 Game and bring him something that he
 Should eat content and then bless me,
 He came with guile and brought my father
 Food and drink, and my father rather
 Blessed him, put me under his hand.
 4 "And now our father by command
 Has made us swear, me and him both,
 That we shall not devise an oath

Against each other, but in love
 And peace each with his brother shove
 And not make our ways be corrupt.”
 5 And they said to him *as abrupt*,
 “We’ll not listen to you to make
 Peace with him, but for our strength’s sake
 We are greater than he, and we
 Are more powerful far than he,
 We shall go against him to kill,
 And destroy him and his sons’ *fill*.
 And if you will not go with us,
 We’ll do you hurt for all the fuss.
 6 “And now hearken to us, let us
 Send to Aram, Philistia
 And Moab and Ammon *to jaw*,
 And let us choose us valiant men
 Who are ardent for battle’s *glen*,
 And let us go against him and
 Do battle with him *at his hand*,
 Exterminate him from the earth
 Before he grows stronger *in worth*. ”

I mark, Beloved, how Esau’s words can be
 Interpreted two ways under the tree.
 He could mean to inspire his sons to war
 By speaking of the guile that Jacob wore.
 He could sincerely warn them not to go
 Against their uncle for bellicose show.
 Like oracle divine, his words confuse
 His sons who will not listen to his views.
 The Scripture and the prophecy confess
 In dark sayings the listener’s address,
 And show the evil heart in action bent
 To fulfill its lusts wherever it’s sent.
 Beloved, create in me the good and true
 As I read from Your word what I should
 do.

7 And their father said to them, “Do
 Not go and do not make war to
 Him lest you fall before him *too*. ”
 8 They told him, “This is just your way
 Of acting from youth to this day,
 And you are putting your neck under
 His yoke. 9 “We’ll not listen in wonder
 To these words.” And they sent to Aram,
 And to their father’s friend ‘Aduram,
 And they hired along with them one
 Thousand fighting men for the fun
 Of war. 10 And there came to them from
 Moab and from the children come
 Of Ammon, those who were hired, one

Thousand choice men, and also from
 Philistia, one thousand choice
 Men of war, and from Edom’s voice
 And from the Horites one thousand
 Chosen fighting men *sword in hand*,
 And from the Kittim mighty men
 Of war. 11 And they said once again
 To their father, “Go forth with them
 And lead them, else we’ll tear your hem.”
 12 And he was filled with wrath and anger
 Seeing his sons forcing haranguer
 To make him to go before to lead
 Them against brother Jacob’s seed.

Esau was nearly man enough to own
 His duty to his swearing and the throne
 Of father and mother. His anger rose
 Against his sons for their deceitful pose.
 And yet the seed of his anger the while
 Was not completely righteous without
 guile.

The disrespectful threatening in style
 Made up his anger more than what he
 chose.

Beloved, I do not ask You to help me
 To overcome anger and do sweetly.
 But let my anger when it comes to light
 Be based alone on mercy and the right,
 Not blinded by a mercenary plight,
 Nor by one-sided perceptions I see.

13 But after he remembered all
 The evil lying hidden pall
 In his heart against Jacob his
 Brother, and he remembered fizz
 For the oath which he had sworn to
 His father and his mother *true*
 That he’d devise no evil crew
 All his days against Jacob too,
 His brother. 14 Now besides all this,
 Jacob did not know nor dismiss
 That they were coming against him
 To battle, he was mourning grim
 For Leah, his wife, until they
 Approached near to the tower to slay
 With four thousand soldiers and men
 Chosen for war. 15 And Hebron’s men
 Sent to him saying “See, indeed
 Your brother’s come against your seed,
 To fight you, with four thousand set
 With the sword, and they carry met
 Shields and weapons,” for they loved Jacob

More than Esau. So they to wake up
Him told him, for Jacob was more
Liberal and more merciful
Than Esau. 16 Jacob would put store
Not in their words to believe till
They came near to the tower to kill.

The easily justified selfish part
That fed Esau's anger opened his heart
And showed what was hidden beneath the
cart

Of hypocrisy in Esau's domain.
He was almost unconscious of the train
Of evil empearled in his inner stain.
That evil might have been sequestered but
For public-based virtue instead of gut.
Beloved, let not my personality
Be scintillating, applauded and free,
Defined by what those around me may be,
But instead let my character and soul
Find in Your Decalogue both start and
goal,
Even if I must thus pass on the toll.

17 And he closed the gates of the tower,
And he stood on battlements' scour
And spoke to his brother Esau
And said "Noble's the comfort's *paw*
By which you've come to comfort me
For my dead wife. Is this the free
Oath you swore to your father and
Again to your mother at hand
Before they died? You've broken oath,
And on the moment that your troth
Was sworn to your father were you
Condemned." 18 And then Esau in view
Answered and said to him, "*Hear me*,
Neither men nor earth's beasts freely
Have any oath of righteousness
Forever valid to confess,
But every day they work the way
Of evil to each other's sway,
And how each may his own foe slay.
19 "And you hate me and mine forever.
And there's naught for us but to sever
The tie of brotherhood with you.
20 "Hear these words I declare to you.
If the boar can change its skin and
Make its bristles as soft as wool,
Or if it can cause horns to stand
Out on its head like the horns full
Of a stag or a sheep, then I

Will observe the brotherhood tie
With you, and if the breasts divide
Themselves from their mother to hide,
For you are no brother to me.
21 "And if the wolves make peace to be
With the lambs so as not to slay
Or do them violence a day,
And if their hearts towards them are good,
Then there shall be peace as it should
In my heart towards you. 22 "And if lion
Becomes the friend of ox to lie on
A bed of peace with him, and if
He is bound under one yoke stiff
With him and ploughs with him, then I
Will make peace with you by and by.
23 "And when the raven becomes white
As the raze, then know I quite
Have loved you and shall make my peace
With you. You'll be rooted in piece
Out, and your sons shall be plucked out,
And there shall be no peace but rout
For you." 24 And when Jacob saw that
His heart was evil where he sat,
And with all his soul to slay him,
And that he had come springing grim
Like the wild boar which comes upon
The spear that pierces it when drawn,
And does recoil from it, 25 so then
He spoke to his own and his men
That they should strike him and again
All his companions *in the glen*.

I note well, my Beloved, that Esau takes
The evolutionary argument at stakes
To justify his abandonment of
The oath sword to his dad and mom in
love.

Survival of the fittest is a stroke
Of genius perhaps, but it does convoke
No thought original, modern, or fair.
Darwin's motive was not science with care,
But finding in the natural order bare
Justification for the British throne
To sway as far as Hindu grief and stone.
It justifies oppression of the race
Still since it has been firmly set in place.
Save me, Beloved, from what myths may
condone.

Jubilees 38

1 After that Judah spoke to Jacob,
His father, and told him to *wake up*,

“Bend your bow, father, and send out
 Your arrows and cast down the *stout*
 Enemy and kill all the foes,
 And may you have the power *that throws*,
 For we shall not your brother slay,
 For he is such as you *today*,
 And he is like you, let us give
 Him *this* honour, *when not to live*.”

Judah's view is the chivalrous one that
 Hints at the noble art of war at bat.
 More honour's for the dead that have been
 slain
 By their own peers than by the younger
 thane.
 More honour and more honour fits the bill
 When men look out for finer ways to kill.
 The slaying that takes place in look and
 word
 Is contained not by virtue but the stirred
 Pressure of the opinions that make up
 The expectations of both ewe and tup
 That regulate what greed and lust in touch
 With cruelty are best in just how much.
 The consciousness of Your presence alone
 In human breast can keep from cracking
 bone.

2 Then Jacob bent his bow and sent
 Out the arrow, *the arrow went*
 And struck Esau, his brother *on*
His right breast and slew thereupon.
 3 And again he shot arrow out
 And hit 'Adoran *who was stout*,
 The Aramaean on the left
 Breast, and drove him back with the heft
 And killed him. 4 And then went the sons
 Of Jacob out, they and their runs
 Of servants, dividing into
 Companies on the four sides due
 Of the tower. 5 And Judah went out
 In front, and Naphtali about
 And Gad with him and fifty men
 With him on the south side again
 Of the tower, and they slew all they
 Found before them, not one to stay
 Escaped. 6 And Levi and Dan and
 Asher went forth on the east hand
 Of the tower, and fifty *men* stand
 With them, and they slew fighting men
 Of Moab and Ammon again.
 7 And Reuben and Issachar and

Zebulon went out on north hand
 Of the tower, and fifty men too,
 And they slew the fighting men's crew
 Of Philistines. 8 And Simeon
 And Benjamin and Enoch *won*,
 Reuben's son, went out on the west
 Side of the tower, and fifty best
 With them, they slew of Edom and
 Of the Horites four hundred grand,
 Stout warriors, and six hundred fled,
 And four of Esau's sons unbled
 Flew with them leaving father there
 Lying dead, as he'd fallen where
 Is the hill in 'Aduram's *land*.
 9 And the sons of Jacob pursued
 After them to mountains *bedewed*
 Of Seir. And Jacob buried his
 Brother upon the hill which is
 In 'Aduram, and he returned
 To his house. 10 Jacob's sons as earned
 Pressed hard upon Esau's sons in
 The mountains of Seir *for their sin*,
 And bowed their necks so they became
 Servants of Jacob's sons *for blame*.

If this be Your word, my Beloved in state,
 What justifies Jacob's killing the mate?
 Does self-defense alone justify war?
 If so, there's always excuse to be sore,
 And the whole prohibition's just facade,
 And there's no god but political god.
 Or does the prophecy of Isaac's sight
 That Esau's attack would make Jacob right
 In striking down the foe? Prophetic fate
 Cannot release responsibility.
 Allowance by prophet or divine guide
 Itself conflicts with the tug of the tide
 Of Decalogue, but may shed light when
 slaying
 Is of two evils the one least betraying.

11 And they sent to their father asking
 Whether they should make peace in tasking
 With them or kill them. 12 And Jacob
 Sent word to his sons *on the hub*
 That they should make peace, and they
 made
 Peace with them, and placed *where they*
 stayed
 The yoke of servitude on them,
 So they paid tribute *of a gem*
 To Jacob and his sons always.

13 And they continued in their pays
Of tribute to Jacob until
The day that he went down to fill
In Egypt. 14 And the sons of Edom
Have not yet got quit in their freedom
Of the yoke of servitude which
The twelve sons of Jacob in pitch
Imposed on them until this day.
15 And these are the kings that held sway
In Edom before there reigned there
Any king over the folk fair
Of Israel [until this day] in
The land of Edom, *land of sin*.

Make peace with killer if there is a chance,
Even if prophecy at the last glance
Foretells the downfall of the fateful horde.
Make peace with enemy and thus be lord
Of lust and anger and thereby be free.
Make peace with the blind groping to agree
To balances of power until the dance
Bring within sword-reach backside of the
stance:
Gore lets the crown fall to the hateful
bored.
Make peace for commerce' sake before the
gun
Held to protect the caravan in sun.
Make peace and keep down prices, better
yet
Make peace and agree on high prices set.
More swells the townhall of the grateful
stored.

16 And Balaq, son of Beor, reigned
In Edom, and his city gained
The name of Danaba. 17 And then
Balaq died, and Jobab *in den*,
The son of Zara of Boser,
Reigned in his stead, *in Edom there*.
18 And Jobab died, and 'Asam, of
The land of Teman, reigned above.
19 And 'Asam died, and 'Adath, son
Of Barad, who slew Midian
In the field of Moab, reigned in
His stead, and the name of his bin
Was Avith. 20 And 'Adath died, and
Salman, from 'Amaseqa's land,
Reigned in his stead. 21 And Salman died,
And Saul of Ra'aboth beside
The river then reigned in his stead.
22 And Saul died, and Ba'elunan,

The son of Achbor, being led
Reigned in his stead *as best he can*.
23 And Ba'elunan, the son of
Achbor died, and 'Adath *for love*
Reigned in his stead, 24 and the name of
His wife was Maitabith, the daughter
Of Matarat, who was the daughter
Of Metabedza'ab. 25 The sum
Is kings who ruled land of Edom.

Edomite kings have names that here recur
And with a strangeness generations purr
In likeness' nomenclature to a burr.
But two names unknown strike a curious
note

Repeated in the list as though by rote,
And yet revealing matriarchal vote.
Maitabith is the daughter of not man
But woman, Metabedza'ab for clan.
Without a special claim to beauty or
To cunning in the way she kept the floor
Of the women's domain, these two appear
As though within their rights to cast a fear
On mankind. Bless their kind or churlish
hearts

For raising the profile of girlish arts.

Week 33 Jubilees 39

1 Jacob lived in the land where his
Father had spent his life *and biz*,
In the land of Canaan, *that is*.
2 These are Jacob's generations.
And Joseph, *one of Jacob's sons*,
Was seventeen years old when they
Took him down into Egypt's sway,
And Potiphar, Pharaoh's eunuch,
The chief cook bought him *for a look*.
3 And he set Joseph over all
His house, the blessing of YHWH's *call*
Came upon the Egyptian's house
Because of Joseph *at a douse*,
And YHWH prospered him in all that
He did. 4 And the Egyptian *fat*
Committed everything into
The hands of Joseph, he saw YHWH
Was with him, and that the Lord blessed
And prospered him in all the rest.
5 And Joseph was a handsome lad
[And very fine, indeed, not bad],
And his master's wife lifted up
Her eyes and saw Joseph *at sup*,
And she loved him and besought him

To lie with her, *tackle and trim*.

I always thought there was not sympathy
Enough for Potiphar's life on the spree.
A lot of rich ladies bored with their time
Want to take on a lover for a crime
Even with virile husband as a spouse.
Just think about this poor woman in house
Alone with eunuch for a husband mouse?
If she loved Joseph, it was hard to blame
Her for the fact, considering her name
As wife of Potiphar. Second excuse
Is found in him being slave for abuse.
So she thought she had legal right to share
The labours of his flesh dressed or laid
bare.

So many people think their rights are fair.

6 But he did not give up his soul,
And he remembered YHWH, the whole
Speech which Jacob, *who* was his father,
Used to read *when he came to pother*
Among the words of Abraham,
That no man should *for hide nor ham*
Do fornication with a dam
Who has a husband, that for him
The punishment of death and grim
Has been ordained in heaven before
The Most High God, such sin in store
Will be recorded against him
In the eternal books undim
Always before YHWH *at the door*.
7 And Joseph remembered these words
And refused to stir up her curds.

Joseph clearly has a concept that differs
From Potiphar's wife's cloak and dagger
stiffers.

He seems to think his body's work belongs
To his owner, but soul has its own songs
Inscribed upon the tablets in the sky.
His soul is his and none to question why.
And yet what he reserves is not the soul
But body bought and paid for at the toll.
This only can be known from Your law's
word,
And Your law still remains to the heart
stirred.

I find wherever I turn for a light
Someone opposes Decalogue at sight,
Without a thought but that he must break
yoke

That binds him to its freedom at a stroke.

8 And she besought him for a year,
But he refused and would not hear.
9 But she embraced him and held him
Fast in the house, she might force him
To lie with her, and closed the doors
Of the house, held him fast *in stores*,
But he left his cloak in her hands
And broke off out through the door's *bands*
And fled away from where she sat.
10 And when the woman there saw that
He would not lie with her, and she
Lied about him before his master,
Saying "Your Hebrew servant faster,
Whom you love, sought to force me so
That he might lie with me *in stow*,
But when I lifted up my voice
That he fled, left his garment *choice*
In my hands when I held him, and
He broke out through the door to *stand*."
11 And the Egyptian saw the cloak
Of Joseph and the broken oak,
And he heard the words of his wife,
And threw Joseph into *the rife*
Prison where prisoners were kept
Whom the king put away unwept.

If Potiphar had had a tool himself
He might have put Joseph to death like elf
For the crime to his wife, but as it was,
Gaol was enough to control Joseph's paws.
The wife of Potiphar was just a gem,
A treasure to be kept in costly hem
To show Potiphar's state as high official.
He did not really care for the initial
Attraction that she bore to any man.
He kept her prisoner as ruler can.
Beloved, You are a Lover without tool
To lay upon my soul in Lover's rule,
Yet I am kept a treasure in Your house
Satisfied more than any honoured spouse.

12 And he was there in gaol, and YHWH
Gave Joseph favour in the view
Of the chief of the prison guard
And compassion in his regard,
For he saw that YHWH was with him,
And that YHWH made all that in trim
He did to prosper. 13 And he gave
All things into his hands, *though slave*,
And the chief of the prison guard

Knew of nothing that was unbarred,
 For Joseph did everything there,
 And the Lord perfected his care.
 14 And he remained there for two years.
 And in those days Pharaoh *appears*,
 King of Egypt was angry with
 His two eunuchs, *not for a myth*,
 With the chief butler, and the chief
 Baker, *who it seems was a thief*,
 And he put them in ward, the house
 Of the chief cook, in prison house
 Where Joseph was kept. 15 And the chief
 Of the prison guards *for relief*
 Appointed Joseph to serve them,
 And so he then served before them.
 16 And they both dreamed a dream, the
 chief
 Butler and the chief baker, *thief*,
 And they told it to Joseph. 17 And
 As he made them to understand
 So it happened to them, and Pharaoh
 Restored the chief butler *in barrow*
 To his office and the *chief* baker
 He killed, as Joseph told dream maker.
 18 But the chief butler, he forgot
 About Joseph in prison's lot,
 Although he had informed him what
 Would come about, and what would not,
 And he did not remember him
 Informing Pharaoh how *the trim*
 Joseph told him, but forgot him.

The simple fact is Joseph was the kind
 To make himself useful to those who mind.
 Bilhah loved him not only for the view
 Of timely muscle and a pleasant hue,
 But for the fact he jumped to do his share
 And more to take the weight off from her
 care.

He was not just a pretty boy and nice,
 But always knew what to do in a trice
 Without petition or command, and so
 Wherever he was the work was not slow.
 That's what endeared Joseph to everyone
 And made them sad when he left for the
 fun.

Beloved, Your blessing added to his share
 Was nothing else but what he made out
 fair.

Jubilees 40

1 And in those days Pharaoh dreamed two

Dreams in one night concerning view
 Of a famine which was to be
 In all the land, and he awoke
 From his sleep and called in to see
 All the interpreters of dreams
 That were in Egypt, at a stroke,
 And magicians too, as it seems,
 And told them all of his two dreams,
 And they could not interpret *them*.
 2 The chief butler *ad hominem*
 Remembered Joseph and spoke up
 Of him to the king *in his cup*,
 And he brought him out from the gaol,
 And he told his two dreams in tale
 Before him. 3 And he said before
 Pharaoh that his two dreams in store
 Were one, and he said to him then,
 "Seven years shall come on all men
In which there shall be plenty over
 All the land of Egypt *in clover*,
 And after that seven years of famine,
 Such a famine has not *seen shaman*
 In all the land. 4 "And now let Pharaoh
 Appoint overseers to harrow
 All the land of Egypt, and let
 Them store up food in each place *met*
 Throughout days of abundant years,
 And there will be food for the *fears*
Of seven years of famine, and
 The land will not perish in hand
 Through the famine, for it will be
 Very severe, *hard as can be*."

Why did You, my Beloved, in divine grace
 Look upon Egypt to save them in race
 From starvation? It seems Your starting
 place

Was Jacob's tribe, and You plotted to save
 His progeny from damnation and grave.
 I recollect the dreary day there was
 A famine on Ethiopian cause,
 And You gave no warning at all to split.
 That country's filled with readers of Your
 writ,

Both Qur'an and the Bible, but You chose
 To ignore harsh famine's warning to those.
 Perhaps the reason was that famine came
 From curing tobacco for Europe's claim,
 And could have been avoided without
 shame.

5 And YHWH gave Joseph favour and

Mercy there before Pharaoh's hand,
 And Pharaoh said to his servants,
 "We shall not find such a wise *lance*
 And discreet man as is this man,
 For the spirit of YHWH's *in plan*
 With him." 6 And he appointed him
 The second in all his kingdom
 And gave him authority grim
 Over all Egypt, and in sum
 Caused him to ride the chariot
 Second in honour to *the glut*
Of Pharaoh. 7 And he put on him
 Fine linen garments, and for trim
 He put a gold chain on his neck,
 And a *herald* proclaimed in beck
 'El 'El wa 'Abirer,' and placed
 A ring on his hand and made graced
 Ruler over all his house, and
 Magnified him, and made him stand
 Saying to him, "Only the throne
 Shall make me greater than your own."
 8 And Joseph ruled over the land
 Of all Egypt, and all the princes
 Of Pharaoh, all his servants' *quinces*,
 And all who did the king's business
 Loved him, he walked in uprightness,
 For he was without pride, without
 Arrogance, and he was without
 Respect of persons, and did not
 Accept gifts, but he judged in lot
 Of uprightness all the land's plot.

They lie who say Joseph was arrogant
 With his new coat and caused his brothers' *rant*.

He always treated them with the same glow
 Of helpfulness and humble duty's show
 As he did courtiers in Egyptian row.
 It was his innocence in the design
 That made him without suspicion divine
 His coming greatness and report the line
 That roused his brothers' jealousy and
 wrath.

He always toed a proudless, humble path.
 A curse on those who do not recognize
 The grace and beauty of sweet Joseph's
 eyes.

That very spirit still oppresses those
 Too innocent to rise up and oppose.

9 The land of Egypt was at peace
 Before Pharaoh for the surcease

Of Joseph, for YHWH was with him,
 And gave him favour and the vim
 Of mercy for all his relations
 Before all those who knew him and
 Those who heard concerning his stations,
 And Pharaoh's kingdom was well set,
 And there was no accuser met
 And no evil person *at hand*.

A close examination of the face
 Of the images of Egyptian race
 Of kings will show the benign lip and eye
 Far different from the Alexandrine cry
 To the horizon. Eyes of early kings
 Of Egypt cut in stone with heavy wings
 Still brood in secret loving of the folk.
 They do not seek the far horizon's stroke,
 But in mercy look down upon the dust
 Of the petitioner with a hand just.
 Egypt's become a symbol of the way
 One people would enslave another's tray,
 But compared to the world at large since
 then,
 It's still a land of the very best men.

10 And so the king called Joseph's name
 Sephantiphans, and gave in claim
 To Joseph a wife, daughter of
 Potiphera, daughter *to love*
 Of the priest of Heliopolis,
 The chief cook. 11 And it was on this
 Day that Joseph stood before Pharaoh,
 He was thirty years old *like arrow*
 [When he stood there before the Pharaoh].

12 And so in that year Isaac died.
 And it happened as Joseph tried
 To interpret his two dreams, just
 As he had said, there were in trust
 Seven years of plenty in all
 The land of Egypt, bin and stall,
 And the land of Egypt produced
 Abundantly, one measure loosed
 Eighteen hundred measures of corn.
 13 And Joseph gathered food *unworn*
 Into each city until they
 Were full of corn and until they
 Could no longer count it nor measure
 So full and rampant was the treasure.

Jubilees 41

1 And in forty-fifth jubilee,
 In the second week of the spree,

And in the second year to be, [2165 A.M.]
 Judah took for his first-born Er,
 A wife of Aram the daughter,
 Named Tamar. 2 But he hated her,
 And did not lie with her, because
 His mother was of Canaan's pause,
 And he wished to take him a wife
 Of the kinsfolk of mother's strife,
 But Judah, his father, would not
 Permit him. 3 And this Er, the sot,
 The first-born of Judah, was bad,
 And YHWH slew him, *thing not too sad*.

4 And Judah said to Onan, who
 Was his brother, "Go in unto
 Your brother's wife and perform duty
 Of a husband's brother *in beauty*
 To her, and raise up seed before
 Your brother *and to fill his score*."
 5 And Onan knew that the seed would
 Not be his, *but* his brother's hood,
 And he went in his brother's house
 The house then of his brother's spouse,
 And spilled his semen on the ground,
 And he was wicked, wicked found
 In the eyes of YHWH, and He killed him.
 6 And Judah told Tamar, *who billed him*,
 His daughter-in-law, "Remain in
 Your father's house *and without sin*
 As a widow till Shelah my
 Son be grown up, and then shall I
 Give you to him as wife *foreby*."
 7 And he grew up, but Bedsu'el,
 The wife of Judah, would not well
 Permit her son Shelah to marry.
 And Bedsu'el, the *momentary*
 Wife of Judah, died not too chary, [2168
 A.M.]

In the fifth year of this week. 8 And
 In the sixth year Judah in band
 Went up to Timnah for to shear
 His sheep. [2169 A.M.] 9 And they told
 Tamar dear,
 "Indeed your father-in-law goes
 Up to Timnah to shear his does."

The wife of Judah was a proper mom
 Who ruled her sons with tommygun and
 bomb.
 As lusty as was Judah in his fate,
 One might have thought his sons too could
 make date
 With Tamar without permission sought or

Granted by Bedsu'el watching at door.
 Yet she was lusty enough in her state
 For Judah to miss her in bed and plate
 When he went up to Timnah with the sheep
 After Bedsu'el had fallen asleep.
 These people know their ways and ways to
 keep,
 And how to make the jolly welkin ring.
 Beloved, see what a mess Your law will
 bring
 In requiring levirate in the spring.

And she put off her widow's clothes,
 And put on a veil, and adorned
 Herself, and sat in the gate horned
 Beside the way to Timnah. 10 And
 As Judah went along that land
 He found her, and thought her to be
 A prostitute, and said freely
 To her, "Let me come in to you,"
 And she said to him, "Come in, do"
 And he went in. 11 And she told him,
 "Give me my hire, *or dowry dim*,"
 And he said to her, "I've in trim
 Nothing except my ring that is
 On my finger, and my necklace,
 And my staff which is in my hand."
 12 And she said to him, "Give the band
 To me until you send my hire."
 And he told her, "As I admire,
 I'll send you a kid of the goats."
 And he gave them to her for dots,
 And she conceived by him that day.
 13 And Judah went to his sheep's way,
 And she went to her father's house.
 14 And Judah sent a kid *for spouse*
 Of the goats by hand of his shepherd,
 An Adullamite, *though like leopard*
 He did not find her, and he asked
 The people of the place, "Where masked
 Is the harlot who was here sitting?"
 And they said to him, "There's no fitting
 Harlot here with us." 15 He returned
 And told him everything he learned,
 And said to him he had not found her.
 "I asked the people of the place,
 And they said to me *they'd not bound her*,
 'There's no prostitute here,'" *they said*.
 16 And he said "Let her keep *the grace*,
 Lest we be laughed at in our stead."

The Scripture veil is symbol of the harlot,

And yet in later times provided barlet
 That distinguished the faithful from the
 crew
 Of heathen wenches running in the dew.
 The fact is law exterior cannot
 In every case keep men and women bought.
 You Yourself made the pluck of sex so
 strong
 That population would not sink to wrong.
 So fashions must come and go to address
 The tensions between propagation's mess
 And the right to know father's name and
 gear.
 Beloved, You must be amused, that I fear,
 For having invented the curious way
 The generations come to join the fray.

And when she had completed three
 Months of manifest pregnancy,
 They told Judah, saying "Indeed,
 Tamar, your daughter-in-law's deed
 Is that she's pregnant by whoredom."
 17 Judah went to her father's house,
 And told her father, brothers, spouse,
 "Bring her forth, and let them burn her,
 For she's wrought uncleanness to stir
 In Israel." 18 And it took place
 When they brought her before his face
 To burn her that she sent to her
 Father-in-law the ring, necklace,
 And the staff, saying "See, infer
 Whose are these, for by him am I
 With child." 19 Judah did not deny,
 And said "More righteous than am I
 Is Tamar. And therefore let them
 Not burn her." 20 And for stratagem
 She was not given to Shelah, and
 He did not again take her hand.

Tamar had lots of trust in Judah's care
 To justice, he might in his shame's despair
 Have denied his paternity that day.
 There was no testing of the DNA.
 Anyone here can fake a staff and ring.
 Beloved, I praise Your name like anything
 That Tamar did succeed in saving life.
 If she had been living under the strife
 Of shariat today, I would not give
 An haricot to see how long she'd live.
 The righteous men today are not impressed
 With appeal to mercy by the distressed.
 They're too filled with market economy

To follow sheep and lie a night in spree.

21 And after that she bore two sons,
 Perez [2170 A.M.] and Zerah *on their buns*,
 In seventh year of second week.
 22 And thereupon the seven peek
 Years of fruitfulness were in barrow,
 Of which Joseph spoke unto Pharaoh.
 23 And Judah acknowledged the deed
 Which he had done was evil *creed*,
 For he lay with daughter-in-law,
 And he considered it faux pas,
 And he admitted he'd transgressed
 And gone astray, *so he confessed*,
 For he'd uncovered skirt of son,
 And he began crying a tonne
 To supplicate YHWH for transgression.
 24 And We told him in dream's confession
 It was forgiven him because
 He entreated earnestly *laws*,
 And lamented, and did not after
 Commit *such sin for tears or laughter*.
 25 And he received forgiveness since
 He turned from his sin with a wince
 And from his ignorance, for he
 Transgressed greatly before the plea
 Of our God. Everyone that acts
 Like this, everyone who contracts
 To lie with his mother-in-law,
 Let them burn him with fire *for claw*
 That he may burn therein, for there's
 Uncleanness *on their hearts and hairs*,
 Pollution on them, with fire let
 Them burn them *wherever they're set*.
 26 Command the folk of Israel
 That there be no uncleanness' spell
 Among them, for each one who lies
 With his daughter-in-law or lies
 With his mother-in-law has wrought
 Uncleanness *such as no one ought*,
 With fire let them burn the man who
 Has lain with her, and likewise *due*
 The woman, and He'll turn away
 Wrath and punishment from the way
 Of Israel. 27 And unto Judah
 We said that his two sons no paw
 Had laid on her, and for this reason
 His seed was established in season
 For a second generation
 Not uprooted under the sun.
 28 For in singleness of eye he
 Had gone and sought for faithfully

The punishment, and that namely,
According to Abraham's law,
Which he'd commanded his sons' awe,
For Judah had once sought to burn
Her with fire *and by the law stern*.

Genesis does not mark the way that Judah
Sorrowed for his sin as it was and rued her.
He did not know the law not yet revealed
About the punishment to the well-heeled
Who slept with son's daughter in barn or
field.

Then too the ghastly marriage had not been
Consummated with son because of sin.

So Tamar was a virgin in the bin
When Judah came along with proposition.
He should have been ashamed to see the
mission

Accomplished on a virgin, though, as soon
As he went in to her to get his boon.

He seems to share his late wife's
condescension
In disdain for Canaanite bed to mention.

Jubilees 42

1 And in the first year of the third
Week of the forty-fifth occurred
In this jubilee the famine,
And it began upon the [2171 A.M.] land,
And so the rain refused *as planned*
To fall upon the earth, for none
Whatever fell *beneath the sun*.

2 And the earth grew barren, but in
Egypt's land there was food *in bin*,
For Joseph had gathered the seed
Of the land in seven years of greed
And had preserved it. 3 The Egyptians
Came to Joseph *in their canipions*
That he might give them food, and he
Opened the store-houses *freely*
Where was the grain of the first year,
And he sold it *and without fear*
To the folk of the land for gold.

4 And Jacob heard that there was sold
Food-grain in Egypt, and he sent
His ten sons that they should present
Themselves to buy food in Egypt,
But Benjamin he kept unslipped,
And then arrived among the clipped.

5 And Joseph recognised them, but
They did not know him *in the glut*,
And he spoke to them and he asked

Them, and told them there where he
basked,

"Are you not spies and have you not
Come to explore the entrance sought
To the land?" 6 And he put them all
In ward *and in the prison stall*.

And after that he set them free
Again, but detained Simeon's *knee*,
And sent off his nine brothers *free*.

7 And he filled their sacks with the corn,
And he put their gold in their *worn*

Sacks, and they did not know. 8 And he
Commanded them to bring *in spe*

Their younger brother, for they'd told
Him their father was living *old*
And their younger brother *in fold*.

In Genesis he put the silver back
Into the mouth of every brother's sack.
But here he puts the gold, no doubt this is
One of the great discrepancies in quiz
That shows either this book is just a fizz
Or then it's Genesis that lacks in whiz.
You point a finger at the Truth and see
How doglike humans in the yard can be
Who refuse to hear what You have to say
Because they must wrinkle a nose and sway
At pointing finger instead of the goal.
Let me, Beloved, crawl back into my hole.
While all dispute about silver and gold,
I entertain in secret You unsold.

9 And they went up from Egypt's land
And they came to Canaan *in band*,
And they told their father all that
Had happened to them, how one sat
Lord of the country to speak out
Roughly to them, and with a rout
Had seized Simeon till they should bring
Benjamin. 10 Jacob arguing
Said "You've bereaved me of my spawn!
Joseph is not and Simeon's gone,
And you would take Benjamin too.
On me is your wickedness due."

11 And he said "My son will not go
Down with you lest he fail the show,
Or fall ill, for their mother gave
Birth to two sons, and one to save,
And this one also you will take
Away from me *and for my sake*.
If he took fever on the road,
You would bring down my old age load

With sorrow to death *and the goad.*”
12 For he saw that their money had
Been returned to each man’s sack *sad*,
And that’s why he was afraid to
13 Send him down *to Egypt in crew.*

The gold or as it may be silver makes
Jacob to fear and his aged heart quakes.
He does not suspect sons of horrid crime.
It’s only illness or the stress of time
Or the malicious actions for a dime
That others might do. Jacob’s fear arises
From the gold that Egypt’s ruler despises.
How unlike those of my day are these men.
They fear the sorcerer abroad again
When their money appears out of the blue.
Today the men would take the golden hue
And disappear behind the nearest view.
No fear of justice or of sorcery
Demands obedience from them or me.

And the famine increased, became
Sore in the land of Canaan’s *fame*,
And in all lands save in the land
Of Egypt, for many at hand
Of the children of the Egyptians
Had stored up their seed for canipions
From the time when they saw Joseph
Gathering seed up in the feoff
And putting it in storehouses
14 And preserving it for the years
Of famine. And the people of
Egypt fed themselves on above
During their famine’s first year’s weight.
15 But when Israel saw that the rate
Of famine was harsh in the land,
And there was no delivering hand,
He said to his sons, “Go again,
And procure food for us and men
So that we do not die.” 16 And they
Said “We shall not go, unless, pray,
Our youngest brother go with us,
We shall not go *or make a fuss.*”

During the seven years of gain the folk
Of Egypt should have known about the
stroke.
Why did they not save up a bit themselves
From what allowance kept upon their
shelves?
With nearly two thousand of gain the
ground

Poured out so much none would have
missed some found
In secret bin on housetop. So the mound
Could tide them over when the lean years
came.

Why must the government take all for
shame?

Today there would be companies to take
Competitive prices for what they make,
So Joseph’s brothers could have found a
store

Where grain was bought for the right price,
no more.

The lesson of the story’s to set stake.

17 And Israel saw that if he did
Not send him with them, on the skid
They would all perish in the dearth.
18 And Reuben said “Give him for worth
Into my hand, and if I don’t
Bring him back to you, then you won’t
Hesitate to kill my two sons
In vengeance for his soul *and buns.*”

19 And he said to him, “He shall not
Go with you.” And then Judah sought
To come near and said “Send him now
With me, and if I do not vow
To bring him back to you, let me
Bear the blame and eternally.”
20 And he sent him with them upon
The second year of this week on
The [2172 A.M.] first day of the month,
and they

Came to the land of Egypt’s sway
With all those who went, and *they had*
21 Presents in their hands, stacte glad
And almonds and terebinth nuts
And pure honey *that a knife cuts.*

The greatest gift of all that can be made
It seems to me is acorns on parade.
With acorns who needs grain to fill the gut?
I’d rather live on acorns like a mutt
Than on sweetbreads in Egypt at the toll
That Joseph took for food, body and soul.
Beloved, give me but acorns in this life
And I shall venture to avoid the strife
Of competition for the gold and black
Oil poured out on my buns for morning
snack.

I’d even ride to Egypt on the back
Of donkey for an acorn in my pack,

And live to return rejoicing that You
Saw fit to bring the oaktree into view.

And they went and they stood before
Joseph, and he saw *at the door*
Benjamin his brother, and he
Knew him, and said to them *freely*,
“Is this your youngest brother?” And
They said to him, “He came to stand.”
And he said “The Lord gracious be
To you, my son!” 22 And faithfully
He sent him into his house and
He brought out Simeon to stand
With them and he made them a feast,
And they presented him the least
Gift which they had brought in their hands.
23 And they ate before his commands,
And he gave them portions of all,
But the portion he sent to call
Of Benjamin was seven times
Larger than any of their limes.

Joseph presumed to see if jealousy
Marked the behaviour of brothers’ degree
By giving Benjamin seven times the cake
That he gave to the others in his wake.
A chance he took, I trow, his brother could
Be sold in the slave market to chop wood,
And dine on what was left of courtly bread.
A chance he took, I say, but he was led.
Beloved, I sit as youngest at the foot
Of Your table, embarrassed that You put
So great a share of blessing in my way.
I humbly bow to You and to Your sway.
May none be jealous of the feast and fare
You set upon my wooden table bare.

24 And they ate and drank and arose
And remained with their asses’ *clothes*.
25 And Joseph devised a plan by
Which he might learn their thoughts as sly,
Whether of peace prevailed in mind,
And he said to the steward kind
Who was over his house, “Fill all
Their sacks with food, return the pall
Of their money into their bags,
And my cup, the silver cup *stags*
Out of which I drink, put it in
The sack of the young *Benjamin*,
And send them away *as for sin*.”

The feast did not take mind away from
what

Was most important before the gate shut,
Which was the welfare of the donkeys sent
To Egypt with Jacob’s sons when they lent
Benjamin their young brother as proof of
Their honesty without dishonest glove.
The donkeys, blessed donkeys are the show
That makes society function and go.
Who loves not donkeys has no part to play
In this world nor in this world’s roundelay.
Beloved, You showed Your innermost in
heart
The day You made the donkey without
cart,
Both ear and eye a thing most marvellous,
And back as strong as the Mount Olympus.

Week 34 Jubilees 43

1 And he did as Joseph had told,
And filled all their sacks with their gold
And with food for them, put the cup
In Benjamin’s sack, *and closed up*.
2 And early in the morning they
Departed, and it came to play
That, when they had gone from there, then
Joseph said to his house steward,
“Pursue them, run and seize the men,
Saying ‘For good you have raised sword,
Requiting me with evil, you
Have stolen from me the cup true
Of silver from which my lord drinks.’
And then bring back to me in links
Their youngest brother, and fetch fast
Before I go out and avast
To judgment seat.” 3 And he ran then
After them and said to the men
As he had said. 4 And they told him,
“Alohim forbid that your trim
Servants should do a thing like this,
And steal from the house what may miss
Your lord of any item, for
The money also which in store
We found the first time, we brought back
And we’re your servants *and not slack*
From the land of Canaan *in lack*.
5 “How then should we steal any thing?
Indeed here we are and our spring
Of sacks be searched, and where you find
The cup in the sack of man blind
Among us, let him be killed, and
We and our asses will in hand

Serve your lord.” 6 And he said to them,
 “Not so, the man with whom the gem
 I find, him only shall I take
 As a servant, and you shall make
 Your way in peace unto your house.”
 7 And as he was searching to douse
 Their vessels, starting with the first
 Born and ending with youngest *worst*,
 It was found in Benjamin’s sack.
 8 And they rent their garments alack,
 And loaded up their asses, and
 Returned to the city in band
 And came to the house of Joseph,
 And they all bowed themselves *to chef*
 Upon their faces on the ground
 Before him. 9 And Joseph *as bound*
 Said to them, “You have done evil.”
 And they said “What shall we *in bill*
 Say, how shall we defend ourselves?
 Our lord has discovered the shelves
 Of transgression of his servants,
 Indeed we are all the servants
 Of our lord, and our asses too.”
 10 And Joseph said to them, “I too
 Fear YHWH, as for you, go you to
 Your homes and let your brother be
 My servant, for you have freely
 Done evil. Know you not a man
 Delights in his cup as I scan
 With this cup? And yet you have taken
 It from me.” 11 And Judah *unshaken*
 Said “O my lord, let your servant,
 I pray you, speak a word *of cant*
 In my lord’s ear, two brothers bore
 Your servant’s mother on her score
 To our father, one went away
 And was lost, and has to this day
 Not been found, and he is alone
 Left of his mother’s *flesh and bone*,
 And your servant our father loves
 Him, and his life also in gloves
 Is bounden up with the lad’s life.
 12 “And it will come to pass *for strife*,
 When we go to your servant our
 Father, and the lad *in that hour*
 Is not with us, that he will die,
 And we shall bring down with a *sigh*
 And sorrow our father to death.
 13 “Rather let me, servant *with breath*,
 Stay instead of the boy as slave
 To my lord, and let lad *or knave*
 Go with his brothers, I became

A guarantee for him in blame
 At your servant’s hand and our father,
 And if I don’t bring him back rather,
 Your servant will bear to our father
 The blame for ever.” 14 And Joseph
 Saw that they were all in one cleft
 In goodness one each other, and
 He could not refrain himself, and
 He told them that he was Joseph.
 15 And he talked with them in Hebrew
 Fell on their neck and so wept too.
 16 But they did not recognize him
 And they began to weep *for grim*.
 And he said to them, “Do not weep
 Over me, but hasten to keep
 And bring my father to me, and
 You’ll see it’s my mouth gives command,
 And my brother Benjamin’s eyes
 See. 17 “For indeed this is the rise
 Of the second year of the drought,
 And there are still five years come out
 Without harvest or fruit of tree
 Or ploughing. 18 “So come down quickly
 You and your households, not to be
 Destroyed through the famine’s decree,
 And do not be grieved for possessions,
 For YHWH sent me before in sessions
 To set things ready that might live
 Many people *and to forgive*.
 19 “And tell my father I am still
 Alive, and you, indeed, for fill
 You see that YHWH has made me be
 A father [counsellor] to see
 Before Pharaoh, and ruler over
 His house and over all the trover
 Land of Egypt. 20 “And tell my father
 Of all my glory, and all rather
 The riches and glory that YHWH
 Has given me *to live and do*. ”
 21 By the command of Pharaoh’s mouth
 He gave them chariots *from the south*,
 Provisions for the way, and gave
 Them all many-coloured and brave
 Clothing and silver. 22 To their father
 He sent clothing and without bother
 Silver and ten asses to carry
 The grain, and he sent them away.
 23 And they went up and told as merry
 Their father that Joseph *that day*
 Was alive, and was measuring
 Out grain to all the nations’ ring
 Upon the earth, and that he ruled

Over all Egypt's land *unschooled*.
 24 And their father did not believe,
 And he was shocked by the reprieve,
 But when he saw the wagons which
 Joseph had sent *without a hitch*,
 His spirit came alive again,
 And he said "It's enough now when
 I know if Joseph's still alive,
 I will go down again and strive
 To see him, then I'll hit the ditch."

Jubilees 44

1 And Israel took his journey from
 Haran from his house then to come
 On the third month's first day, *Sunday*,
 And he went on Beer Sheba's way,
 And he offered a sacrifice
 To the God of his father *nice*
 Isaac on this month's seventh day,
 (Sabbath)
 2 And Jacob remembered the dream
 That he had seen on Bethel *green*,
 And he was afraid to go down
 To Egypt, *fearing his God's frown*.
 3 And while he was thinking of sending
 Word to Joseph to come unbending
 To him, and that he would not go
 Down, he remained there *for the show*
 For seven days, if he might see
 A vision as to whether he
 Should stay or go down. 4 And he feasted
 The harvest festival *unpriested*
 Of the first-fruits with the old grain,
 For in all Canaan's land sans rain
 There was not a handful of seed
 [In the land], for the famine lay
 On all the beasts and cattle and
 Birds, and also over man's hand.

Ha! This is news! It's possible to feast
 The first fruits with the old grain left, at
 least
 When there's no harvest in the bin and
 store.
 If there's no grain new grown about the
 door,
 Why should there be a feast of first fruits
 then?
 Your feasts are only due upon Your men
 When You keep Your part of the bargain
 pact.
 If there's no harvest, I know how to act

Not to give thanks for grain at all in toll.
 Perhaps the deal You make is not the goal.
 Beloved, I plead the case of Jacob now
 Beside a well-filled table anyhow,
 And say his faith is great and Your
 assuming
 To grant salvation is mercy for blooming.

5 And then upon the sixteenth day
 (Monday)

YHWH appeared to him, and He said
 To him, 'Jacob, Jacob', he said
 'Here I am.' And He said to him,
 'I'm the God of your fathers *grim*,
 The God of Abraham and God
 Of Isaac, fear not to tread sod
 Of Egypt, for I will make there
 Of you a great nation and fair.
 6 I will go down with you, and I
 Will bring you up *again or try*,
 And in this land shall You be buried,
 And Joseph shall with his hands carried
 Touch your eyes. Fear not, go down to
 The land of Egypt *with your crew*.'

If I do not hear Your voice speaking so
 To me upon a quiet evening's glow,
 It may show that my sanity's intact,
 Or that in faith there's something I have
 lacked.

It may be that You live another time
 And conversation with You is not mime
 As it is in the village where I live.
 Ours is a lively interruption's sieve.
 The pause between the time I speak to You
 And Your response is just enough in view
 For me to yawn and take another pew.
 No doubt if I were patient like a tree
 And waited for the words eternally
 You'd speak by Sabbath day aloud to me.

7 And his sons rose up, and his sons'
 Sons, placed their father and their tonnes
 Of possessions upon wagons.
 8 And Israel rose from Beer Sheba
 On third month's sixteenth day (Monday)
 in awe,
 And he went down to Egypt's land.

The very day that Jacob got Your word
 That he could go to Egypt, he was stirred
 To rise on wing and take off like a bird.

He did not wait to doubt the vision clear,
 He did not stop for packing or for fear,
 But dropped the cares of life and took his
 gear.
 The wagons loaded, creaked and groaned
 until
 They found the road to Goshen from the
 hill
 Of Beer Sheba and left the tower and mill.
 Beloved, I wait Your word beneath the
 trees,
 The birches, aspens, willows, bird cherries,
 And hear the silence tiptoe where You
 please.
 No summons comes to me, and yet I find
 You present in both outward and the mind.

9 And Israel sent Judah before
 Him to his son and Joseph's door
 To check out Goshen's land in store,
 For Joseph had told his brothers
 That they should come and *as occurs*
 Live there that they might be near him.
 10 And this was the best *land for trim*
 In the land of Egypt, and near
 To him, for all *them and their gear*
 And also for the cattle's *whim*.

These people always take consideration
 Of cattle comfort in station and nation.
 Judah is sent down there before the crowd
 To make sure that the cattle's place
 unbowed
 Is reassured, so they won't moo aloud.
 Despite the simple wickedness of those
 Men in their youth, their innocence still
 shows.
 Today we set the cattle up in trains
 And rush them off in thirst and their chill
 blains
 To massive slaughter. So we do to men.
 Ah! to have lived before Auschwitz and
 glen
 Of Buchenwald! The golden time when
 hate
 Did not quite know what it could
 perpetrate.
 I'd rather be a cow in Israel then.

11 And these are the names of the sons
 Of Jacob who *got off their buns*
 And went into Egypt along

With Jacob their father *at prong*,
 12 Reuben, Israel's first-born, and these
 Are the names of his sons *at ease*,
 Enoch, and Pallu, and Hezron
 And Carmi, five. 13 Then Simeon
 And his sons, and these are the names
 Of his sons, Jemuel *for games*,
 And Jamin, and Ohad, and Jachin,
 And Zohar, and Shaul *not shaking*,
 The son of the Zephathite girl,
 Seven *in all from toe to curl*.

And here's a girl I had not known about,
 A Zephathite picked up on drinking bout
 Or who knows what shade of their
 escapade.

I don't trust Simeon to get waylaid.
 Beloved, bless the girl! I hope she was
 The sort to take care of her own wet paws.
 I hope she was glad with her baby boy,
 Shaul, not knowing how many employ
 His name in later times in famous joy,
 A king for one, then apostle's degree.
 Three Sauls, and all three waken sympathy
 In my heart as I sit under fir tree.
 Perhaps the first was luckiest in all
 Not being king or apostle to fall.

14 Levi and his sons, and these are
 The names of his sons, *each a star*,
 Gershon, and Kohath, and Merari
 Four *in all and not to be sorry*.
 15 Judah *comes next*, also his sons,
 And these are the names of his sons,
 Shela, and Perez, and Zerah,
 Four *men*. 16 Issachar and *to draw*
 From his sons, and these are the names
 Of his sons, Tola, and *the claims*
 Of Phua, and Jasub, and yet
 Shimron, *five men in all, you bet*.

I wonder what Shela thought of his brothers
 Perez and Zerah, having different mothers,
 And whether Tamar, younger of the fleet,
 Was still living with Judah in her seat,
 Since it is known they did not share a bed.
 Was widowhood her punishment unsaid
 For having seduced Judah by the road?
 No one has ever said if Judah's load
 Of lust found outlet in another store.
 At least there are three sons to count, no
 more.

That one experience with prostitution
Or temporary marriage as solution
May have been enough to startle the man
To lustless living without courtesan.

17 Zebulon and his sons, and these
Are the names of his sons *at ease*,
Sered, and Elon, and Jahleel,
Four *men in all and come to heel*.

18 And these are the sons of Jacob
And their sons whom Leah *for rub*
Bore to Jacob *while living in*
Mesopotamia *for sin*,
Six, and their one sister, Dinah
All the souls of sons of Leah,
And their sons, who went with Jacob
Their father into Egypt's *hub*,
Were twenty-nine, and Jacob their
Father being with them, they were
Thirty. 19 And the sons of Zilpah,
Leah's handmaid, the wife *in crawl*
Of Jacob, who bore unto Jacob
Gad and Asher, *two sons to wake up*.

20 And there are the names of their sons
Who went with him in unisons
To Egypt. The sons of Gad were,
Ziphion, and Haggi *to stir*,
And Shuni, and Ezbon, besides
Eri, and Areli, and bides
With them Arodi, eight in all.

21 And the sons of Asher *to fall*,
Imnah, and Ishvah, *and Ishvi*,
And Beriah, and Serah *free*,
Their one sister, *and that makes six*.

22 All the souls were fourteen, *no tricks*,
And all those of Leah *in store*
Added up to forty and four.

23 And the sons of Rachel, the wife
Of Jacob, *and love of his life*,
Joseph and Benjamin. 24 And there
Were born to Joseph in the air
Of Egypt before his father
Came into Egypt, those born to
Asenath, daughter of the *true*
Priest Potiphar *in the city*
Of Heliopolis to be
To him, Manasseh, and Ephraim,
Three *persons in all and in trim*.

25 And the sons of Benjamin were
Bela and Becher and the fer
Ashbel, Gera, and Naaman, and
Ehi, and Rosh, Muppim *to stand*,

And Huppim, and Ard, for a grand
Total of eleven *to stand*.

Becher, prophetic name! To stand a bit
Higher there came Abu Becher to sit
In prophet's seat, position hard to fit.
Second of ten sons, in Genesis' spree
The one to inherit highest degree
For being second. Benjamin himself
Appears to think his mother's honoured
delph

Needed to catch up with his older brothers.
And so he bore a family that smothers
The tribes with vibrant generations to
Devour upper Egypt clean in a crew.
Becher has overrun the land in two
Like locusts, proudly, and with flying hair.
Beloved, stand in Your admiration there.

26 And all the souls of Rachel were
Fourteen. 27 And sons of Bilhah, her
The handmaid of Rachel, the wife
Of Jacob, whom she bore *in strife*
To Jacob, Dan and Naphtali.

28 And these are the names they gave due
For their sons who went with them to
Egypt. And the sons of Dan were
Hushim, and Samon, and *to spur*
Asudi, and 'Ijaka, and
Salomon, *six persons in hand*.

29 And they died the year in which they
Entered into Egyptian *stay*,
And there was left alone to Dan
Hushim, *and that was not his plan*.

Before saying a harsh word about Dan
And what his descendants may have in
plan,

I think about his loss of four sons taken
The first year in a foreign land and shaken.
How much catastrophe falls on mankind,
And yet it seems not to suffice to bind
The family to peace refraining from
Its violence and killing on the sum.
To suffer is not to be jollified
With wisdom of experience and pride.
To suffer is to be diminished and
To meet the trouble of life with a hand
Less equipped before bludgeoning to stand.
Beloved, with each returning morning
come.

30 And these are the names of the sons
Of Naphtali, *with their homeruns*,
Jahziel, and Guni and *yet*
Jezer, and Shallum, and *well met*
'Iv. 31 And 'Iv, who was born after
The years of famine, died a fer
In Egypt. 32 And all the souls of
Rachel were twenty-six *for love*.

Beloved, I now remember little 'Iv,
Three thousand and more years ago
contrive

To toddle by the river and survive.
The baby brother of four stalwarts met
Untimely death, and so what sorrow set
The face of Jahziel, Geni and yet
Jezer and Shallum, father Naphthali!
What did his mother do when came to die
The fifth of five sons? Was there comfort
in

The land of Egypt without aspirin?
Perhaps he was a son unloved and lost
To negligence among a calloused frost.
Belatedly I come to shed a tear
For an innocent child before death's fear.

33 And all the souls of Jacob which
Went into Egypt were in pitch
Seventy souls. These are his spawn
And his children's children *as drawn*,
In all seventy, but five died
34 In Egypt before Joseph's *tide*,
And had no children. In the land
Of Canaan two sons of the hand
Of Judah died, Er and Onan,
And they had no children *by plan*,
And the children of Israel buried
Those who perished, and they were carried
In number among the seventy
Gentile nations *on the earth free*.

Now look, Beloved, this book is far too
rich

In Israel's praise and in the final pitch
Sends even those without offspring to ditch
Of number among Gentiles, what a switch!
Your racist rant is enough and to bear,
But now I find lives cut off without share
In progeny are counted with the folk
Who worship idols and false gods by oak.
Beloved, I demand justice for the youth
Who died without a chance to gain in truth

A family, although I do not spare
A criticizing word for Onan there,
And Er may take his place of wealth and
fame
Among the heathen of eternal claim.

Jubilees 45

1 And Israel went to the country
Of Egypt, into the country
Of Goshen, on the first day of
The fourth [2172 A.M] month, and in the
above

Second year of the third week of
The forty and fifth jubilee (a Wednesday).

2 And Joseph went to meet his father
Jacob, to land of Goshen *rather*,
And he fell on his father's neck
And wept. 3 And Israel said to check
Joseph, "Now let me die since I
Have seen you, and now may YHWH God
Of Israel be blessed, and the God
Of Abraham *though he's not nigh*
And the God of Isaac who's not
Withheld His mercy *from the lot*
And His grace from His servant Jacob.

4 "It is enough for me to wake up
To see your face while I am yet
Alive, indeed, true is the set
Vision which I saw at Bethel.
Blessed be YHWH my God for a spell
For ever and ever, blessed be
His name *as far as man can see*."

5 And Joseph and his brothers ate
Bread before their father *to sate*
And drank grape juice, and Jacob joyed
With very great joy when employed
With Joseph eating with his brothers
And drinking before him *and others*,
And he blessed the Creator of
All things who had preserved his *love*,
Preserved for him his twelve sons *too*.

6 And Joseph gave his father's crew
As a gift the right to live in
The land of Goshen, also in
Rameses and all the region round
About, on which he ruled *the ground*
Before Pharaoh. And Israel and
His sons lived on in Goshen's land,
The best part of Egyptian strand.
7 And Israel was one hundred and
Thirty years old when he came to
Egypt. And Joseph gave his due

To feed his father and his brothers
And also the flocks of the others
With bread as much as they had need
For the seven years without feed.

Who ruled the ground of Rameses fathered
sons

Of royal priest Egyptian to meet guns
Of the regime to follow. Let me take
A care to separate myself from stake
Of those in power today, because the day
That falls on my descendants means the
sway

Of ruler now will once have turned to dust,
And my children fall under ruling lust
Of one who will not know or ever care
What feats of fortune someone might still
dare.

Beloved, let me live on in Rameses still
Without the favour of Pharaoh whose bill
Must be paid in the next regime to fill
Another's coffers with the ruler's share.

8 And the land of Egypt was hurt
By the famine, Joseph alert
Acquired all the land of Egypt
For Pharaoh in payment adept
For food, and he got possession
Of the people, daughter and son,
And their cattle and everything
For Pharaoh, who was Egypt's king.

9 And when the famine years were done,
And Joseph gave the folk by tonne
The seed and food that they might sow
The land in the eighth year *to grow*,
For the river had overflowed
All the land of Egypt *in load*.

10 For in the seven famine years
It had *not* overflowed *its ears*
And had watered only a few
Places on river banks where grew,
But now it overflowed *its banks*
And the Egyptians sowed *with thanks*
The land, and it produced much corn
That year. 11 And this was the first born
Year [2178 A.M.] arriving in the fourth
week

Of the forty-fifth jubilee.

12 And Joseph took the corn *to seek*
Of the harvest the fifth party
For the king and left four parts for
Them for food and for seed *in store*,

And Joseph made an ordinance
For the land of Egypt in grants
Until this day. 13 And Israel lived
In Egypt's land unnegatived
For seventeen years, all the days
Which he lived were three jubilees,
One hundred and forty with ease
And seven years, and he died in
The fourth [2188 A.M.] year of the fifth
week's bin

Of the forty-fifth jubilee.

14 And Israel blessed his sons *freely*
Before he died and told them all
That would in Egypt's land befall
Them, and he made known to them what
Would come upon them in the shut
Last days, and blessed them and gave to
Joseph two portions in the crew.

15 And he slept with his fathers, and
He was buried *upon the sand*
In the double cave in the land
Of Canaan, close to Abraham
His father *under epigramme*
In the grave which he dug himself
In the double cave *on the shelf*
In the land of Hebron. 16 And he
Gave all his books and fathers' books
To Levi his son that *from crooks*
He might preserve them in that way
For his children until this day.

The books, the books, the lovely books that
You,
Beloved, vouchsafed to Abrahamic crew!
Where are they now, Beloved? Do they
abide

In Axum's darkened cathedrals to hide
From profane eyes, or are they in the care
Of the occulted ones who secrets share
Behind the outward movements of the State
And whispered to the quiet ones of late?
Their echoes scrawl across the wayward
page

Of Bible and Qur'an, of script of sage,
Where I hear twitterings like diamond crust
Humming and cantillating to my dust.
Beloved, the books, the books, the lovely
books

Are fleetingly revealed in swallows' looks.

Jubilees 46

1 It came to pass after he died,

Jacob did, that they multiplied,
Did the children of Israel
In the land of Egypt a spell,
And so they became a great nation,
And they were of one heart and ration,
So that brother loved brother and
Every man gave a helping hand,
And they increased abundantly
And multiplied exceedingly,
Ten [2242 A.M.] weeks of years, 2 all the
days of

The life of Joseph, and *for love*
There was no foe nor any evil
All the days of Joseph's retrieval
Which he lived beyond the lifespan
Of his father Jacob *began*,
For all the Egyptians were pleased
To honour Israel's folk *appeased*
As long as Joseph lived. 3 And he,
Joseph died being *elderly*
At one hundred and ten years old,
Seventeen years he lived *unsold*
In Canaan's land, and ten years he
Was a servant, and three years stayed
In prison, and eighty years *greyed*
Under the king, to rule the land
And all of Egypt *at his hand*.
4 And he died and his brothers too
And all that generation's *crew*.

Joseph managed with cunning and appeal
To You, Beloved, to live a fruitful spiel
In peace and loved activity upon
The land where he fled from the rising
dawn.

Joseph managed to save himself and those
Who were born in his family's gentle close,
And all of Egypt from starvation's throes,
But he could not cast life and love abroad
On Egypt after his death met the sod.
Joseph managed, and so manage the few
And many on their earthly pilgrim shoe.
But in the end the lustre and the fame
Go to the dust along with glory's flame
And only Your heart remembers the name.

5 And he commanded Israel's folk
Before he died that they should cloak
His bones with them when they went out
From Egypt's land *with a great rout*.
6 And he made them swear to the thing
Regarding his bones, *for the king*

He knew of the Egyptians would
Not again bring out *if they could*
And bury him in Canaan's land,
For Makamaron, Canaan's king,
While in Assyria sojourning,
Fought in the valley with the king
Of Egypt and he killed him there,
And pursued the Egyptians *bare*
To the gates of 'Ermon. 7 But he
Was not able to enter *free*,
For another, a new king, reigned
In Egypt, who was better trained
Than he and so he turned him back
To Canaan's land *for giving flack*,
And the gates of Egypt were closed,
And none went out and none proposed
To enter Egypt. 8 And Joseph
Departed life *from being chef*
In the forty-sixth jubilee,
In the sixth week, and in the fee
Of second year, they buried him
In Egypt's land *with gear and trim*,
And [2242 A.M.] all his brothers after him.

The secret's out, why the new king knew
not
What Joseph had achieved in Egypt's plot.
Joseph was Canaanite and Syrian,
And better part of valour is a plan
To keep an eye on those who might rise up
To help the enemy quaff silver cup.
The Egyptian did not forget the day
That Joseph was sold as a slave to play,
Brought down from Canaan's land to bitter
toil.

Egyptians knew Joseph's and Jacob's soil
Was that of Canaan and not of the Nile.
I take warning, Beloved, no matter what
I do to favour those whose land I glut,
In the end to me all the doors are shut.

9 And the king of Egypt went out
To war with Canaan's king in rout [2263
A.M.]

In forty-seventh jubilee,
In the second week, second year,
And Israel's folk brought out *in fear*
All the bones of Jacob's spawn save
The bones of Joseph *to the cave*,
And buried them there in the field
In the double cave *and concealed*
In the mountain. 10 And most of *them*

Returned to Egypt, but a hem
 Of them remained in the Hebron's mount,
 And Amram your father in count
 Remained with them. 11 And Canaan's
 king

Trounced Egypt's king, and *for that thing*
 He closed the gates of Egypt, 12 and
 Devised evil against the hand
 Of Israel's folk afflicting them
 And spoke evil in stratagem
 To the people of Egypt, "See
 The people of Israel's folk be
 Increased in number more than we.

13 "Come, let us deal wisely with them
 Before they become too many,
 And afflict them with slavery
 Before war come upon us and
 Before they too fight *in command*
 Against us, else they'll join our foes
 And go up from their bungalows
 Out of the land, for their hearts and
 Faces are set towards Canaan's land."

14 And he set taskmasters afflicting
 Them with *harsh* slavery *and restricting*,
 And they built strong cities to be
 For Pharaoh, Pithom, and Raamsee
 And they built all the walls and all
 The fortifications in stall
 Fallen in Egypt's cities. 15 And
 They made them serve with rigour's *hand*,
 And the more they dealt wickedly
 With them, the more they increased and
 Multiplied. And Egypt's folk, see,
 Hated Israel's folk mortally.

Nothing engenders hate so much as love
 Of a land different from push and shove
 About the local market place. I draw
 Comparison to those in India's maw
 Who love Mecca above the Ganges straw.
 Even the thoughtful Hindu now and then
 Arises to destroy such evil men
 Who love a far-off treasure land more than
 The earth that brought them forth and feeds
 as can.

I shall be hated too, Beloved, as I
 Seek no land but Your heart and gracious
 eye,
 And make the pilgrimage of my doorpost
 To find Your divine footprints with the
 boast

Of squirrel and bird tracks before dawn is
 nigh.

Week 35 Jubilees 47

1 And in the seventh week, and in
 The seventh year, that came within
 The forty-seventh jubilee,
 Your father went forth *and freely* [2303
 A.M.]

From Canaan's land, and you were born
 In the fourth week, in sixth year torn
 From it, in the [2330 A.M.] forty-eighth
 running

Jubilee, this was time of *cunning*
 Tribulation on Israel's folk.

2 And Pharaoh, king of Egypt, spoke
 Issuing a command in stroke
 Against them that they should cast all
 Their boy children born and *in stall*
 Into the river. 3 And they cast
 Them in for seven months at last
 Until the day that you were born
 And your mother hid you *from scorn*
 For three months, then they reported
 Regarding her. 4 And she made lid
 And ark for you, and covered it
 With pitch and asphalt until fit,
 And placed it in the flags beside
 The bank of the river *to bide*,
 And she put you there seven days,
 And your mother came there by night
 And suckled you, and by daylight
 Miriam, your sister, guarded you
 From the birds. 5 And in those days true
 Tharmuth, the daughter of Pharaoh,
 Came to bathe in the river tow,
 And she heard your voice crying, and
 She made her maidens bring in hand,
 And they brought you to her. 6 And she
 Took you out of the ark, and she
 Had compassion on you. 7 And see,
 Your sister said to her, "Shall I
 Go and call you one of the *sly*
 Hebrew women to nurse and suckle
 This babe for you, *and not unbuckle?*"
 8 And she said *to her*, "Go." And she
 Went and called Jochebed to be
 Your mother, and she gave her wages,
 And she nursed you *ages and ages*.

The daylight brings month after month the
 sight

Of murder and concession to the right
 Of ruler to keep peace as best he can
 By killing potential republican.
 The daylight brings to light unholy creed
 That power is necessary for the feed
 Of the majority as well as clan
 Of the elite whose interests sway the fan.
 But nightfall opens up the secret door
 That lets out quiet life upon the floor
 Of slaughter, and gives suckle to the soul.
 Beloved, I turn away from empty bowl
 Of necessary evil in the march
 To seek Your secret breast of life in arch.

9 And afterwards, when you were grown,
 They brought you up *before the throne*,
 To Pharaoh's daughter to become
 Her son, and Amram, *man not dumb*,
 Your father taught you writing, and
 After you had lived by command
 For three weeks they brought you into
 The royal court *of Egypt*. 10 You
 Were three weeks of years at the court
 Until the time [2351-] when you *for sport*
 Going out from the royal court
 Saw an Egyptian smiting your
 Friend who was [2372 A.M.] of Israel's
 folk *more*,

You killed and hid him in the sand.

11 And on the second day at hand
 You saw two of Israel's folk stand
 Against each other, and you said
 To him who was doing the wrong,
 "Why do You hit your brother *long*?"

12 And he was angry and he said
 "Who made you prince and judge of us?
 Do you intend to blunderbuss
 Me as you destroyed yesterday
 The Egyptian *come in your way*?"
 And you were afraid and you fled
 On account of what he had said.

The killing of babies results at last
 In babies killing men, the cycle past
 Renews again and once again to be
 The tangled wheel to trip humanity.
 Who survived Spain's Mexican holocaust
 Bears brood to rise and kill the rulers
 tossed

Upon them from a foreign shore, and yet
 The native blood boils over the bound set.
 Who survived Hitler's Aryan love lives to

Horridify generations up to do
 Atrocities upon the nearest crew.
 Beloved, You penetrate the minds of men
 And women with awful ten words again
 That heard could change the frightful,
 insane yen.

Jubilees 48

1 And in the sixth year of third week
 Of the forty-ninth jubilee
 You departed to live *and seek*
 In [2372 A.M.] the land of Midian *freely*,
 For five weeks and one year. And You
 Returned to Egypt as if due

In second week in second year
 In the fiftieth jubilee.

2 And so you yourself know what He
 Told you on [2410 A.M.] Mount Sinai *for*
 fear,

And what prince Mastema desired
 To do with you when you retired
 Returning into Egypt's land.

3 Did he not with all his strong hand
 Seek to slay you and set beyond
 Your reach Egyptians *vagabond*
 When he saw that you were sent back
 To execute judgment *not slack*

And vengeance on the Egyptians?

4 And I saved you out of his stuns,
 And you performed the signs and wonders
 Which you were sent to do *with thunders*
 In Egypt against Pharaoh, and
 Against all his house, and to *stand*
 Against his servants and his folk.

5 And YHWH performed a vengeance
 great

On them for Israel's sake and state,
 And smote them through *the plagues of*
 blood

And frogs, lice and dog-flies *in flood*,
 And malignant boils breaking out
 In blains, and their cattle by rout
 Of death, and by hail-stones, by which
 He destroyed everything *in pitch*

That grew for them, and by devouring
 Locusts that ate the rests and scouring
 That had been left by hail and dark,
 And *by death* of the first-born *stark*

Of men and animals, 6 and on
 All their idols *engraved and sawn*
 YHWH took vengeance and burned with
 fire,

And everything was sent by hire
Of your hand, that you should declare
These things before they were done *there*,
And you spoke with Egyptian king
Before all his servants *in ring*
And before his people *of sting*,
7 Everything took place according
To your words, ten great judgements fell
On the land of Egypt *in spell*
To do vengeance for Israel.

To all men in every place Your word falls
As on Israel and on Egyptian walls.
All see and hear the thunder on the swells
And cross themselves and say their magic
spells.

Ten words of judgement You recite each
day,
And every ear hears all the things You say.
They heard them once beside the bloody
Nile,
They heard them once sung on Sinai in
style,
They heard the ten words with each
wayward mile
They wander through the desert and with
guile
Shape wonders of events to shatter men.
Beloved, Your ten words echo and again
Strike every ear from city street to fen.
I hear the penetrating silent pen.

8 And YHWH did everything He did
For Israel's sake, and by the bid
To His covenant ordained by
Abraham that He would reply
In vengeance on them as they'd brought
Them by force into bondage lot.
9 And the prince Mastema stood up
Against you to cast you in cup
And hands of Pharaoh, and he helped
Egyptian sorcerers, 10 and *yelped*
When they stood up and wrought before
You the evils allowed in store,
But remedies We did not let
To be wrought by their hands *or set*.
11 And YHWH struck them with boils and
sores,
And they could not stand on their floors,
For we destroyed them so that they
Could not perform a single ray.

It's true indeed, Beloved, that You destroy
Today as ever sorcerer's employ,
And they go down to Tophet to enjoy
The fires of love unquenched upon the pyre
Of death. It's true, Beloved, and my desire.
It's also true Your faithful at the brink
In quiet trust walk on only to sink
To the grave for their pains and promised
spoil.

There is no difference between the toil.
Tell me where I stand on the dergah's soil
If at the final sacrifice and gift
And my soul in extinguishing sparks lift,
The momentary joy stays unexpressed
Of seeing Your invisible face dressed.

12 And notwithstanding all *these* signs
And wonders the prince *of designs*
Mastema was not put to shame
Because he took courage and fame
And cried to the Egyptians to
Pursue after you with the crew
Of the Egyptians, with their *great*
Chariots, and their horses *late*,
And with all the hosts of the folk
Of Egypt. 13 And I stood *for stroke*
Between Egyptians and Israel,
Out of his hand We saved Israel,
And out of the hand of his folk,
And YHWH brought them through a dry
sea,

As if it had been dry land's lea,
And all the peoples whom he brought
To pursue Israel, YHWH our Gott
Cast them into the great sea wrought,
Into the depths of the abyss
Beneath Israel's folk and amiss,
14 Even as Egypt's folk had cast
Their children in the river's blast
He took vengeance on them in number
Thousand times thousand *where they*
slumber,
And one thousand of their strong men
Were destroyed for each suckling ben
Of the children of your folk then
Which they'd thrown in the river *den*.
15 And on the fourteenth day and on
The fifteenth and sixteenth days' dawn
And on the seventeenth and yet
On the eighteenth the prince was set,
And Mastema was bound and kept
Behind the folk of Israel, wept

That he might not accuse them *more*.
16 And on the nineteenth to restore
We let them loose that they might help
The Egyptians and follow whelp
Of Israel's folk. 17 And he made hard
Their hearts and made them stubborn
guard,

And the device was devised by
YHWH our God that He might on high
Smite the Egyptians and cast them
Into the sea *by stratagem*.

18 And on the fourteenth day we bound
Him that he might not find a ground
To accuse Israel's folk that day
When they asked the Egyptians *stray*
For vessels, clothing, pots of gold,
And pots of silver and bronze *sold*,
To despoil the Egyptians *bold*
In return for the bondage they
Had forced them into on the way.

19 And we did not lead out the folk
Of Israel from Egypt's land broke.

No wonder exodus remains the point
Of hope for every oppressed out of joint
Since that day. You came out once to
approve

A vengeance unheard of and one to move
Every heart living. For each baby drowned
You cast into the raging waters found
A thousand of those who were children of
Those who obeyed Pharaoh for wealth or
love

To cast the Hebrew babies in the Nile.
Although I still would sip waters a while
From Egypt's river, I bless Red Sea's shore
For what You did once to revenge the
score.

Beloved, vengeance repaid is now enough.
Return to save the world from raw and
rough.

Jubilees 49

1 Remember the commandment which
YHWH commanded you without hitch
Concerning the passover, that
You should celebrate it *as fat*
In its season on fourteenth day
Of the first month (Tuesday), that in your
way

You should kill it before the eve,
And that they should eat the reprieve

By night on the eve of the day
Number fifteen from the time's way
Of setting of the sun. 2 For on
This night, the beginning till dawn
Of the festival and the start
Of the joy, you were eating part
Of the passover in Egypt,
When all powers of Mastema *clipped*
Had been let loose to slay the first
Born in the land of Egypt *cursed*,
From the first-born of Pharaoh to
The first-born of the captive *due*
Maid-servant in the mill, and to
The cattle. 3 And this is the sign
That YHWH gave to them *in combine*,
In every house on the doorposts
Of which they saw the blood *in boasts*
Of a lamb, one of the first year,
Into *that* house they should have fear
To enter and to slay, but pass
By *it*, that all those in *their class*
Be saved that were in the house since
The sign of the blood *would convince*
On its doorposts. 4 And powers of YHWH
Did everything according to
What YHWH commanded them, and they
Passed by all Israel's folk that day,
And the plague did not fall on them
To destroy any among them,
No cattle, or man, even dog.
5 And the plague was a grievous clog
In Egypt, and there was no house
In Egypt where there was not spouse
Weeping, lamenting for the dead.
6 And all Israel was eating fed
The flesh of the passover lamb,
And drinking the grape juice *to cram*,
And praising, blessing, giving thanks
To YHWH God of their fathers' *banks*,
And was ready to go out from
Under the yoke of Egypt's *drum*,
And from the evil bondage there.
7 And remember You this day's *care*
All the days of your life, and keep
It year to year in all days *steep*
Of your life, once a year, upon
Its day, according to law drawn,
And do not put it off a day,
Or for a month *in sinners' sway*.

It seems this verse is leveled to account
Of those who put off passover in count

Of intercalation of month at end
 Of the year lunar when the seasons mend,
 And for a day, so as to keep postponement.
 I did not know the practice was a lonement
 So early sought, at least the latter one.
 One cannot blame Hillel then for what's
 done.

The book is simply a polemic stand.
 That does not keep it from containing grand
 Instruction from You, my Beloved, and yet
 It is a reason for the doubter met.
 I do not put off for a month or day
 My meeting, but rush to You in the way.

8 For it is an eternal law,
 And engraven *to see with awe*
 Upon the heavenly tablets for
 All the children of Israel's score,
 That they should keep it every year
 Upon its day and once a year,
 Throughout their generations' *fear*,
 And there is no limit of days,
 For this is ordained for always.
 9 And the man who is free from such
 Uncleaness, and does not come touch
 The keeping of its day, so as
 To bring the right offering he has
 Before YHWH, and to eat and drink
 Before YHWH on the day *and brink*
 Of its festival, that man who
 Is clean and close at hand to do
 Shall be cut off, because he's not
 Offered the oblation of YHWH
 In its appointed season *due*,
 He shall take the guilt on himself.

10 Let Israel's folk come *without elf*
 And keep the passover the day
 Of its fixed time, the fourteenth day
 Of the first month, between the two
 Evenings, from the third part in due
 Of the day to the third part of
 The night, for two portions *above*
 Of the day are given to the light,
 And a third part to evening, *night*.

The fourteenth day is celebrated best
 In hope for what the evening will invest.
 The weeks hinge on the Sabbath and the
 crest

That rises with the coming of the day
 Number four to stop in the way to pray.

The small due of the morning meets the
 sway
 Of still noon heat, and still I wait the bright
 Blood of the sacrifice as the sunlight
 Turns red and purple, signs toward the
 night.

Beloved, the centuries have clouded now
 The calendar, and there's news on each
 brow

For this or that. The trouble is Your year
 Does not coincide with a day, I fear.
 But no excuse is that Sabbaths appear.

11 This is that which YHWH has
 commanded

You that you keep what He's demanded
 Between the evenings. 12 And it's not
 Permissible to slay a jot
 Of it during time of the light,
 But during the time next to night,
 And let them eat it at the time
 Of the evening, until up climb
 The third part of the night, and what
 Is left over of all it's got
 Of flesh from the third part of night
 And onwards, let them burn the sight
 With fire. 13 And they shall not cook it
 With water, nor shall they eat it
 Raw, but roasted upon the fire.
 They shall eat it with great desire,
 Its head with the inwards of it
 And its feet they shall roast as fit
 With fire, and not break any bone,
 For of Israel's folk shall no bone
 Be crushed. 14 For this cause YHWH
 commanded

The children of Israel *remanded*
 To keep the passover upon
 The day of its fixed time *to dawn*,
 And they shall break no bone of it,
 For it's a festal day *and fit*,
 A day commanded, and there may
 Be no passing from day to day,
 And month to month, but on the day
 Of its appointment let it be
 Observed. 15 And do you command the
 Children of Israel to observe
 The passover and not to swerve
 Throughout their days, and every year,
 Once a year on the day appear
 Of its fixed time, and it shall come
 For a memorial well in sum

And pleasing before YHWH, and no
 Plague shall come upon them *like foe*
 To slay or smite in that year in
 Which they celebrate *without sin*
 The passover in its season
 In every respect as is done
 By His command. 16 And they shall not
 Eat it outside the temple plot
 Of YHWH, but before the tent sought
 Of YHWH, and all the people of
 The assembly of Israel's *love*
 Shall celebrate it at its time
 Appointed. 17 And each *pantomime*
 Of man who has come on its day
 Shall eat it in the temple way
 Of your God before YHWH from twenty
 Years old and upward *for as plenty*,
 For so is it written and set
 That they should eat it *when they've met*
 In the sanctuary of YHWH.
 18 And when Israel's folk come into
 The land which they are to possess,
 Into the land of Canaan, yes,
 And set up the tabernacle
 Of YHWH in the midst of the *full*
 Land in one of their tribes until
 The temple of YHWH has been built
 In the land, let them come and keep
 The passover in the tent *peep*
 Of YHWH, and let them slaughter it
 Before YHWH year to year *as fit*.
 19 And in the days with the house built
 In the name of YHWH *without guilt*
 In the land of their heritage,
 They shall go there and take the stage
 To slaughter the passover in
 The evening, at sunset, and in
 The third part of the day. 20 And they
 Shall offer its blood on the way
 Of threshold of the altar's *pyre*,
 And shall place its fat on the fire
 Which is upon the altar, and
 They shall eat its flesh hand to hand,
 Roasted with fire in the house court
 Which has been sanctified *in short*
 In the name of YHWH. 21 And they may
 Not celebrate passover *day*
 In their cities, nor any place
 Except before the tent of YHWH,
 Or before His house where His *face*
 And name has dwelt, and they shall *do*
 So not to go astray from YHWH.

There is no tent at all set up except
 The dome of the rock where many have
 wept.
 Around the world many count up the days
 Of the spring rite by sun and moon and
 ways
 All foreign to Your law, and many camp
 Upon the threshold and doorpost with
 damp
 Wine without slain lamb, others make a
 stake
 In Easter eggs and what they fry and bake.
 Beloved, will You meet no one anywhere
 But before the tent door of that place bare
 And blistered in the sun where since that
 time
 The thousands have died on the brief cliff's
 climb?
 I come to my own door and look abroad
 To see if there is any sign of God.

22 And you, Moses, command the folk
 Of Israel to observe the stroke
 Of the passover, as it was
 Commanded to you, *set in laws*,
 Declare to them every year and
 The day of its days, and the stand
 Of feast of the unleavened bread,
 That they should eat unleavened bread
 Seven days, *and* to keep its feast,
 To bring an oblation *at least*
 Every day during those seven days
 Of joy before YHWH *and for praise*
 Upon the altar of your God.
 23 For you kept this feast *with the rod*
 In haste when you went out the land
 Of Egypt till you entered land
 Of desert of Shur, for upon
 The seashore you finished it drawn.

My own grandmothers must have kept the
 cue
 Very well in obedience to You.
 I think they had no barley, no, nor wheat,
 And could not make bread with yeast as a
 feat.
 They mixed their maize and boiled their
 corn to eat.
 If they did not know when the time came
 past
 For Passover and unleavened bread's fast,

It hardly mattered, since they spent the year
 Without yeast and with only corn in ear.
 It was enough to pound it to take off
 The hulls and then to soak it in a trough
 With ashes till the grains swelled up to be
 The breakfast of half of humanity.
 I thank my grandmothers most faithfully.

Jubilees 50

1 And after this law I made known
 To you the days of Sabbaths shown
 In the desert of Sin, which is
 Between Elim and Sinai's *whiz*.
 2 I told you of the Sabbaths of
 The land on Mount Sinai *above*,
 And I told you of jubilee
 Years in the Sabbaths of years *free*,
 But the year of it I have not
 Told you till you enter the plot
 Which you are to possess *in lot*.
 3 And the land also, it shall keep
 Its Sabbaths while they live and sleep
 Upon it, and they'll come to know
 The jubilee year. 4 I'm not slow
 To ordain for you the year-weeks
 And the years and jubilees' *streaks*,
 There are forty-nine jubilees
 From the days of Adam to this
 Day, [2410 A.M.] and one week and two
 years' *ease*,
 And there are yet forty *amiss*
 Years to come for learning the [2450 A.M.]
 law
 Of YHWH, until they pass on paw
 Over into the *promised* land
 Of Canaan, crossing Jordan's *strand*
 To the west. 5 And the jubilees
 Shall pass by, until Israel please
 To be cleansed from all guilt and such
 Of fornication, unclean touch,
 Pollution, sin, and error, and
 Dwells with faithfulness in the land,
 And there shall be no more a foe
 Or any evil one *to go*,
 And the land shall be clean from that
 Time for evermore *where it's at*.

The forty years in wilderness was set
 To learn the law and so with righteous net
 To become a people like never met.
 The other explanation that is found
 Is that the people on the way were bound

In punishment because they laughed and
 clowned

At Caleb's wit and Joshua come round.
 All things have the side of a judgement sent
 And opportunity to know the meant.
 It only takes a choice to set the plough
 To furrow and to follow in the trough.
 Beloved, despite the punishment I see
 Upon the world about me without glee,
 I follow divine opportunity.

6 And indeed the commandment of
 The Sabbaths, I've written above
 For you, and all the judgments of
 Its laws. 7 Six days shall you do task,
 But on the seventh day *to bask*
 Is the Sabbath of YHWH your God.
 In it you shall do nought to plod
 In any kind of work, you and
 Your children, and your slaves in hand
 And your maidservants, all your beasts
 And the sojourner at your feasts.
 8 And the man that does any work
 On it shall die *instead of shirk*,
 Whoever desecrates that day,
 Whoever lies with *his wife's play*,
 Or whoever says he will do
 Something on it, that he will view
 To set out on a journey then
 To buy or sell *or spend a yen*,
 And whoever draws water then
 Which he had not prepared himself
 On the sixth day upon the shelf,
 And whoever takes up a load
 To carry it out of his stowed,
 From tent or house shall *surely* die,
Or else I'll come to ask you why.

Beloved, Your Sabbath day is blessing
 granted
 Upon the earth and me, the sound and
 planted.

I thank You for the word that poses still
 Upon the whispered Sabbath sounds on hill
 And in the forest near my cabined frame.
 Your Sabbath is my day of best acclaim.
 Beloved, Your Sabbath day returns to me
 And touches my soul with eternity.
 Without it I would sink into the dust
 Of passing days seeing gold turn to rust.
 From Adam to Moses You wrote its rhyme,
 And now it sings and glitters in my time.

I lay hold on the right to rest and stay
The hand that would impoverish my day.

9 You shall do no work then at all
On the Sabbath day *to appall*
Except what you've prepared *in stall*
For yourselves on the sixth day's *fall*,
So as to eat, and drink, and rest,
And keep Sabbath from all work best
On that day to bless YHWH your God,
Who has given upon the sod
A day of festival for you
And a holy day *for your due*,
And a day of holy kingdom
For all Israel is this day's *sum*
Among their days for ever *true*.
10 For great is the honour which YHWH
Has given to Israel that they should
Eat and drink and be as they could
Satisfied on this festive day,
And rest on it from all the sway
Of labour which belongs unto
The labour of humankind due,
Except burning frankincense and
Bringing oblations *in their hand*
And sacrifices before YHWH
For days and for the Sabbaths *due*.
11 This work alone shall be done then
On the Sabbath-days *among men*
In the sanctuary of YHWH
Your God, that they may *ever true*
Atone for Israel with offering
Always from day to day to bring
Memorial well-pleasing to
YHWH, and that He may receive due
From them always from day to day
According as you've heard today.
12 And every man who does some work
On it, or goes on journey's *quirk*,
Or tills *his* farm, whether in his
House or any other places,
And whoever kindles a fire,
Or rides on any beast *or hire*,
Or travels by ship on the sea,
And whoever strikes or *makes free*
To kill anything, or *in stake*
Slaughters a beast or bird, to make
A trap for animal or bird
Or fish, or whoever is heard
To fast or makes war on the day
Of the Sabbaths. 13 The man whose way
Is to do any of these things

On the Sabbath shall die *as sings*,
So that Israel's folk shall observe
The Sabbaths by law *not to swerve*
Regarding Sabbaths of the land,
As it is writ in tablets' *stand*,
Which He has given in my hand
That I should write out for you laws
Of the seasons, and seasons' *straws*
According to their days' division.
Here is finished *and done decision*
Of the account of the division
Of the days *in all their precision*.

I may be slave to this or that along
The narrows of the days and hours of song
That merge upon my working weeks with
wrong.
I may be taken with the toils that break
Out in the world for life and houses make,
The rush of sale and dickering's cunning
bite.
I may be dominated by the night
And harried by the day, and yet my fight
Returns each week to Sabbath and its share.
Though I meet You with each breath and
each care,
On Sabbath I mount with You on Your
throne
And turn into a king instead of drone.
Beloved, share if You will Your high
estate,
Or keep me in Your heart a single rate.

The Book of Joshua

The book of Joshua is traditionally thought to have been written by Joshua, the successor of Moses to leadership of Israel, except for a few explanatory passages added by Phinehas the priest. It deals with the entrance of Israel into Canaan and the conquest of that land.

The book continues the basic subject of the book of Numbers, the description of divinely appointed leadership. As revelation makes more and more detailed portraits of divinely appointed leaders, more and more typical characteristics of divine proof appear. The figure of Joshua presents a continuation of what is found in the Pentateuch: proof of divine oneness,

practical application of divine law, and miraculous acts to save the faithful from danger or oppression.

The central question of the book is that of warfare. Joshua engages in warfare and even genocide during the conquest of the land. Warfare obviously conflicts with the Decalogue prohibition of killing. The linguistic distinction between murder and killing, made by so many commentators, assumes a society with the authority to define the ten commandments, something entirely lacking in the surrounding texts. The establishment of a state that may define some killing as murder and some killing as legitimate (such as war and capital punishment) assumes an authority beyond the Decalogue description, and implies that any state that has the power to establish itself also has the power to diminish the force of any commandment, not just the prohibition of killing. This is a fact of reality, no matter what the connotations of the specific word used. The problem is therefore acute and not to be shunted aside by merely saying the words refer to murder and not killing.

The characteristic of divinely appointed leadership is specifically the application of divine law in situations that are difficult to interpret. The divinely guided leader will make verdicts on the basis of the law that must seem to some observers to break the commandment. If that were not so, there would be no need of divinely appointed leadership. Everyone would see the correct import of the commandment immediately in every situation. But that simply is not the case. In real life the choice is more often between a greater and lesser evil than between an evil and a good. In the issue of killing, there will arise situations in which killing is the only way of preserving the commandment. The divine guide is considered to know through divine intervention which of two evils in a particular situation is for the greater good. The divine guide may not, as it might appear to some, change divine law. But he may be led under certain conditions in a certain situation to act in disregard of one commandment in order to preserve all.

Warfare and other instances of divinely approved killing are thus reported under the direction of a divinely appointed leader. Where such a divine guide is not visibly present, such actions are not permissible, and it is necessary to fall back on the general law. Without the intervention of divine guidance, no intention to kill is valid.

The book of Joshua has great spiritual significance. It expresses the spiritual development of the individual under the direction of the divine guide, represented by a figure whose name means "YHWH saves." This name is the Hebrew cognate of the name of Jesus. Every human being must engage in the conquest of paradise through the subjection of those powers of the self that oppose such victory. Every story in the book of Joshua reflects an aspect of dealing with the nafs, the nephesh, the lower self. This is placed directly in the context of submission to God through the figure of the divine guide.

Week 36 Joshua 1

1 After the death of Moses who
Was the *faithful* servant of YHWH,
It happened that YHWH spoke to *one*
Joshua who was son of Nun,
Moses' servant, saying 2 "Moses
My servant's dead. Now therefore *this*
Is what you'll do, get up, go over
This Jordan, you and all this *rover*
People, to the land I shall give
To Israel's folk *for place to live*.

If Moses with all his experience
Was not up to leading over the fence
Of Jordan to the Promised land, then how
Could Joshua meet challenges to cow?
His first act is to do the mission thought
Impossible even by people taught.
Beloved, You do not know, I trow, the deep
Courage it takes to be a man and sleep
Through glories parted, blinded by the veil
Of splendour under which You always sail.
You ask the man to do the thing that he
Who was the greatest could conceivably
Fail to accomplish. That is just Your style.
You ask a man like naught to crawl a mile.

3 "Every place that your sole of foot
 Will tread upon to you I've put
 It for possession as I said
 To Moses *who was without dread*.
 4 "From the desert and Lebanon
 As far as the great river, on
 To the River Euphrates, all
 The land of the Hittites *to call*,
 And to the Great Sea toward the way
 The sun goes down *at end of day*,
 Shall be your territory's sway.
 5 "No man shall *be able to stand*
 Before you all your days' command,
 As I was with Moses, *so I*
 Will be with you *too by and by*.
 I will not leave you nor forsake.
 6 "Be strong therefore, good courage take,
 For to this people you'll divide
 As an inheritance the *wide*
 Land which I swore to give to their
 Fathers. 7 "Only be strong and *fair*,
 Very courageous, that you may
 Observe to do in every way
 By the law which Moses My slave
 Commanded you, *so now be grave*
 Not to turn from it to the right
 Hand or to the left, that you might
 Prosper wherever you go. 8 "This
 Book of the Law be not remiss
 From your mouth, but you'll meditate
 In it day and night, that your state
 May be to observe all therein
 To do as written *without sin*.
 For then you will make your way *good*
 Prospered, and good success as should.
 9 "Do I not command you? Be strong
 And of good courage, do not *long*
 Be fearful, nor dismayed, for YHWH
 Your God where you go *is with you*."

Command me, too, Beloved, for courage
 and
 For strength! Although I do not fear the
 hand
 That steers the State, yet I too know
 dismay.
 I flee to Your breath and Your word this
 day.
 I contemplate Your law in dark and light
 Through busy day and also quiet night.
 If You command, You also give what's
 needed

That Your commands ring true and
 unimpeded.
 Let not Your word depart out of my tongue
 But let it sound through life from rung to
 rung
 That I may do all that is written there,
 All good and precious things, all that is
 fair.
 I need no other heritage it seems
 Beyond this food and drink above my
 dreams.

10 Then Joshua commanded *all*
 The people's officers *by call*,
 Saying 11 "Pass through the camp and tell
 The people, 'Prepare yourselves well,
 For within three days you will cross
 Over this Jordan, *with no loss*
 To go in to possess the land
 Which YHWH your God gives in your
 hand.'"

Like Joshua I meditate the gate
 Of crossing over to divine estate.
 Give me three days to prepare for the time
 When I shall stand upon the golden rime
 Of Jordan to pass over to the land
 Promised with bright eternity to stand.
 The turning point of sorrow in the week
 On the fourth day arises as those seek
 Their haven by the guiding star who know
 The cycles of the winds and dews and
 snow.
 Beloved, I stand upon the bovine feast
 Of meadows on the Jordan tracking east
 And turn my face toward the western sea
 Anticipating Your eternity.

12 And to the Reubenites, *and to*
 The Gadites, and also those who
 Of the tribe of Manasseh *staying*
 Then Joshua spoke to them, saying
 13 "Remember the word which Moses
 YHWH's servant told to you like this,
 'YHWH your Alohim gives you rest
 And is giving to you this land.'
 14 "Your wives, your little ones *in band*,
 Livestock remaining in the land
 Which Moses gave you on this side
 Of Jordan. But you'll *not abide*
 But pass before your brothers armed,
 All your brave mighty men unharmed,

And help them, 15 “until YHWH has given
Your brothers rest, *after they’ve striven*,
As He *did* you, and they also
Have taken the land *where they go*
Possession which YHWH your God gives,
Then you shall return *and there live*
To the land of your heritage
And enjoy it, *from age to age*,
Which Moses YHWH’s servant gave you
On the east side of Jordan’s *dew*.”

What would I do, Beloved, if someone
came
Convincing me I had just three days claim
Before I should stand by the judgement
throne
And see Your face invisible full grown
Before my human eye, and plunge into
The ecstasy or fire that is my due?
Would I be thrilled or paralyzed with fear
To know that Your presence has come so
near
As three days from my camp, eternal home
For forty years hoped for to err and roam
The desert floor, speckled with tripping
stone?
Only three days, Belovèd, to prepare
To meet the reckoned lot and pleasant
share,
What would I do, what do I now You’re
there?

16 So they answered Joshua, saying
“What you command us we’re relaying,
And where you send us we will go.
17 “Just as we heeded Moses in
All things, so we’ll heed you *begin*.
Only YHWH your Alohim be
With you, as with Moses was He.

Your divine guides are heeded always for
The fact that You are with them at the door.
It’s not the charismatic fever that
Brings people to the houses where they sat.
It’s not their beauty, wisdom, poetry,
It’s not their success in the sophistry
Of justice, rather it is just because
You are with them to show them of Your
laws.

Beloved, as You were with Moses when He
Led the folk up from the Egyptian spree,
So You were with the holy one who came

After Moses, though without Moses’ fame.
The prophecies of Joshua are known
But argued for Christ and Muhammad’s
throne.

18 “Whoever rebels against your
Command not heeding your words’ core,
In all that you command him for,
Shall be put to death. Only be
Strong and of good courage *and free*.”

Though I remain upon the further shore
In house and kind, potato, kale and store,
My spirit and my mind climb Carmel’s
peaks
And Zion’s fortresses where my soul seeks
The blessings of the oneness of the Lord,
Who gives to one the ploughshare, one the
sword.

Now as I take my stake in peaceful wood
Let me not be viewed as a rebel should.
I lend my hand and foot to valour’s game
And rush to arms when I have heard my
name.

I take possession of the holy land
To give it to another, since my hand
Is full to overflowing with abundance,
Since oneness, my Beloved, is not
redundance.

Joshua 2

I Now Joshua the son of Nun sent
Out two men from Acacia Grove
To spy in secret *where they went*,
Saying “Go, view the land *and cove*,
Especially in Jericho.”
So they went, and came *on the go*
To the house of an inn-keeper
Named Rahab, and lodged there *with her*.

The dirty minds of past translators show
That every inn-keeper’s a place to know
A prostitute, and yet it is a fact
That all we know of Rahab by her act
Is that she was both brave and ready to
Risk all to give You praise and honour
You.

The older usage of the word does not
Imply the inn-keeper was facile shot,
But still the rumours rise to run the slot
As rumours always do, though Truth is got
In secret, silent ways, and not made known

To minds of water and to hearts of stone.

2 And it was told in Jericho
To the king, saying "Behold, men
Have come here tonight *with a yen*
To search out the country before
The children of Israel's *gore*."

3 The king of Jericho sent to
Rahab, saying "Bring out, *please do*,
The men who have come in to you,
Who have entered your house, for they
Have come to search out all the *way*
Of the country." 4 The woman took
The two men and hid them from look.
So she said "Yes, the men came to
Me, but I did not know *their cue*
Where they *were* from. 5 "It happened that
As the gate was being shut, when
It was dark, they left where they sat
And the men went their way *again*.
Where the men went I do not know,
Pursue them quickly, *don't be slow*,
For you may overtake *the men*."

The woman Rahab told the king a lie.
Your law requires that every honest guy
Say of another truth and truth alone.
Yet Rahab lied to one sitting on throne.
Perhaps the sitting on the throne was meant
To be exception when the law was sent,
Since ten commandments do not mention
king
Or president or any else such thing.
Perhaps what one speaks to usurper beast
Has nothing of truth in it, not the least,
Since force of arms is in itself a straw
Rebellious against Your eternal law.
Beloved, I'd rather not be brought before
Such judges, but at least I know the score.

6 But she had brought them to the roof
And hidden them *against all proof*
With stalks of flax, which she had laid
In order on the roof *arrayed*.
7 The men pursued them by the road
To the Jordan, to the fords *strode*.
And as soon as those who pursued
Them went out, they shut the gate *cued*.

My heart of Rahab hides within the men
Sent on Your errand, my Beloved, and then
Refuses to give in to king and state.

Such lawlessness will not likely abate.
My loyalty is to my Self and life
Who stands aside from bickering and strife
For such mere overrated, trifling things
As gold and fashion, useful things for
kings,
But not so useful metal as is copper,
While woollens are preferred to silk by
shopper
Who has a mind for hard reality.
I lie to the king's messengers freely
And send them chasing shadows on the
hill.
The flax stalks on my roof move and are
still.

8 Now before they lay down, she came
Up to them on the roof, 9 *by name*
Said to the men, "I know that YHWH
Has given and the land to you,
Your terror has fallen on us,
And all the dwellers *numerous*
In the land are fainthearted *here*
Because of you. 10 "For we did hear
How YHWH dried up the Red Sea flood
For you when you walked on the mud
Out of Egypt, and what you did
To the two kings of the *torpid*
Amorites on the other side
Of the Jordan, *who could not hide*,
Sihon and Og, whom utterly
You have destroyed. 11 "As soon as we
Heard, our hearts melted, neither did
There remain more courage *or quid*
In anyone because of you,
For YHWH your Alohim is true,
He *is* God in heaven above
And on the earth beneath *thereof*.

I know enough of fear, Beloved, to know
That fear is not enough to make the show
Of faith that You are one and God alone.
Though fear may strike to marrow of the
bone,
It ends in curses like as not but never
In faith. It's more intelligent than clever.
The inn-keeper's a lady who has seen
All types of men arriving on the green,
And with her keenness, I know that her
right
Does not reach up to know You in Your
light.

If she confesses You are one, she does
Despite experience's knowledge flaws.
I praise You, my Beloved, that such a one
Can penetrate the veils as soon as done.

12 "Now therefore, I beg you, swear to
Me by YHWH, since I have shown you
Kindness, that you also will show
Kindness to my father's house so,
And give me a true token, 13 "and
Spare my father, my mother's *hand*,
My brothers, my sisters, and all
That they have here *within the wall*,
And deliver our lives from death."
14 So the men answered in one breath,
"Our lives for yours, if none of you
Tell this business of what we do.
And it shall be, when YHWH has given
To us the land *for which we've striven*,
That we will deal kindly and truly
With you." 15 Then she let them down duly
By a rope through the window, for
Her house *was* on the city wall,
She lived upon the wall, what's more.
16 And she said to them, "Get you all
To the mountain, lest the pursuers
Meet you *and put you on the skewers*.
Hide there three days, until pursuers
Have returned, then go on your way."
17 So the men said to her *that day*,
"We *will be* blameless of this oath
Of yours which you have made us both
Swear, 18 "unless, *when* we come into
The land, you bind this line that you
Let us down by, this scarlet cord
In the window, and *for the horde*
You bring your father, mother, and
Your brothers, and all in the land
Of your father's household to your
Own home. 19 "So it shall be *therefore*
Whoever goes outside the door
Of your house and into the street,
His blood *shall be at his own feet*,
On his own head, and we'll *be* guiltless.
And whoever is with you *stillless*
In the house, his blood *shall be* on
Our head if a hand's laid upon
Him. 20 "And if you tell this business
Of ours, then we'll freely confess
Our freedom from your oath which you
Made us swear." 21 Then she said "Then
do

According to your words." And she
Sent them away, and they left free.
She tied the red string up to see.

O my Beloved, I bind a scarlet cord
In sight because I fear Your flaming sword.
I look down from the wall and see it twist
Upon the air. May it protect from fist
And brawn. My window faces toward the
dawn
From whence I fear Your battle coming on.
I lay me open by the scarlet token
And gather up my promises unbroken
And wait with mute appeal. Your divine
heel
May trample in my vineyard, crush the
vine,
And bruise the lily at the door, the sign
Remains to mind You of the hope and real.
Beloved, find me waiting on the wall,
Now broken by Your coming and Your
call.

22 They left, went to the hills, and stayed
There three days till pursuers made
Their way home. The pursuers sought
Them all along the way, for naught.
23 So the two men returned, descended
From the mountain, crossed over, wended
Their way to Joshua son of Nun,
And told him all that they had done.

I flee into the hills, Beloved, to find
Three days in hiding from the deaf and
blind
Who seek my life despite my innocence.
Such seekers are all around city tents.
I flee into the hills not least to know
The peaceful stir of wind in leaves to show
The heart the path toward Your come and
go
Until those men return within their fence.
Beloved, You and Your guides appointed
stand
Upon the crest beneath the wooded land
And look out on the wicked plain to see
The roving bands of rangers running free,
And turn again into the darkened glade
And rest as one beneath the lowered shade.

24 And they said to Joshua, "Truly
YHWH has delivered the country

Into our hands, for indeed all
The inhabitants in its wall
Faintheartedly before us fall.”

The story that I bring back to the man
That You have chosen as the artisan
Of safety and of hope on the earth now,
Invisibly guiding the human prow,
Is one of courage before the raised horn
Of the establishment I hold in scorn.
I’ve seen the sturdy walls, I’ve heard the
plot

Of royal defences and I have got
A sight of weaponry beyond the speed
Of sound to protect all their grasping greed.
And having seen and heard, I come to him
And meet Your divine guide beneath the
dim

Light of prayer in prostration and I tell
Him that the way I found is travelled well.

Joshua 3

1 Then Joshua rose early at morn,
And they set out from in the bourn
Of Acacia Grove and came to
The Jordan, he and all the crew
Of Israel, and lodged there before
Their crossing to the other shore.
2 So it was, after three days, that
The officers *aristocrat*
Went through the camp, 3 and they
commanded

The people, saying “When you’ve *landed*
And see the ark of testimony
Of YHWH your God, and *not a phony*,
The priests, the Levites, bearing it,
Then you shall set out from your fit
Place and go walking after it.

4 “Yet there shall be a space between
You and it, *where the ark is seen*,
About two thousand cubits measured.
Do not come near it, *the ark treasured*,
That you may know the way by which
You must go, *not fall in the ditch*,
For you’ve not passed *this* way before.”
5 And Joshua said to the folk more,
“Sanctify yourselves, for tomorrow
YHWH’ll do you wonders *without*
sorrow.”

6 Then Joshua spoke to the priests, saying
“Take up the ark, and not delaying,
Of testimony and cross over

Before the people *and the rover*.”
So they took up the ark *in hand*
Of testimony, went *in band*
Before the people *to the land*.

They seek their guidance from the east and
west,
And search the world for what they think is
best,

And comfort every heart that every guide
And every road leads to the heavenly side.
But guidance, my Belovèd, seems to be
To keep one’s eyes fixed on eternally
The ark of covenant wherein there lies
The tables of commandments for all eyes.
They led the people through the Jordan’s
deep

Dry shod and took them in the land to keep
Your law forevermore. Here as I stand
On Jordan’s edge and on its shining sand
I too look to the ark and to its law
And wait on You, Belovèd, in hope and
awe.

7 And YHWH said to Joshua, “This day
I’ll begin to exalt your way
In the sight of all Israel, that
They may know that, just as I sat
With Moses, *so* I’ll be with you.
8 “You’ll give command to the priests who
Bear the ark of the covenant,
Saying ‘When you have come *well spent*
To the edge of the water of
The Jordan, you shall stand above
In the Jordan.’” 9 So Joshua said
To the children of Israel *bred*,
“Come here, and hear the words of YHWH
Your Alohim.” 10 Joshua said true,
“By this you shall know Alohim
The Living’s among your *esteem*,
And *that* He’ll certainly drive out
From before you (*and with a shout*)
The Canaanites and the Hittites
And the Hivites and Perizzites
And Gergashites and Amorites
And Jebusites, 11 “See, the ark of
The covenant of the Lord of
All the earth is crossing before
You over into the Jordan.

12 “Now therefore, take yourselves *a span*
Of twelve men being from each tribe
Of Israel, one man from each tribe.

13 “And it shall come to pass, as soon
As soles of the priests’ feet festoon
The waters of the Jordan, priests
Who bear the ark of YHWH *not beasts*,
The Lord’s of all the earth, *that* shall
The waters of Jordan’s canal
Be cut off, the waters that come
Down from upstream stand in heap dumb.”

Your presence is known by the working of
A miracle of Your abounding love.
The priest’s feet touch the water as they
step
In faith into the river’s vim and pep.
At that moment and not before Your right
Sets up the waters as a wall in sight
Of Israel and even Canaanite.
The miracles You work to show to me
That You are by my side eternally
Are greater still, though not so suddenly.
The rising of the sun in rubied cloud,
The posture of new snow as I out loud
Puff through my cold ablutions of the day
Show that You are, though with no word to
say.

14 So it was, when the people set
Out from their camp to cross the wet
Jordan, with the priests bearing ark
Of covenant before the *stark*
Folk, 15 and as those who bore the ark
Came to the Jordan, and the feet
Of the priests who carried the *treat*
Of ark dipped in the water’s edge
For Jordan overflows its sedge
On all its banks during the whole
Time of the harvest till its goal,
16 That the waters which came down from
Upstream stood *still*, and rose in sum
To make a heap as far away
As at Adam, the city’s way
That *is* beside Zaretan, so
The waters that went down *in show*
To the Sea of the Arabah,
The Salt Sea, failed, and were *in awe*
Cut off, and the people crossed over
Across from Jericho and *clover*.
17 Then the priests who carried the ark
Of the covenant of YHWH’s *park*
Stood firm on dry ground in the stream
Bed of the Jordan, it may seem
All Israel crossed over on dry

Ground, until all the people by
Had fully crossed the Jordan’s stream.

What was it like to stand there as the slow
Traffic of child and women on the go
With all their sheep and cattle through the
flow

And watch the water higher, higher grow
And not to stamp impatiently and look
Back to see how many more at the brook
Are waiting to embark? Courage it took
To stand with sun and ark on aching arm
Until the folk had all passed beyond harm.
Beloved, lift not Your hand from off the
rod

That raises walls today above the sod.
We who stand here at Your command well
know
That safety is alone beneath Your show,
While sun beats on the curled and ripened
pod.

Joshua 4

1 It came to pass, when all the folk
Had finished crossing Jordan’s soak,
That YHWH spoke to Joshua, saying
2 “Take for yourselves twelve men from
staying
Among the people, one man from
Every tribe, 3 “and command them *come*,
Saying ‘Take for yourselves twelve stones
From here, out of the Jordan’s bones,
From the place where the priests’ feet
stood.

You shall carry them *for your good*
Over with you and leave them in
The lodging place where you begin
To lodge tonight.” 4 Then Joshua
Called the twelve men whom he *by law*
Had appointed from Israel’s sons,
One man from every tribe *that runs*,
5 And Joshua said to them “Cross
Over before the ark of *Boss*
YHWH your God in the Jordan cross,
And each one of you take a stone
On his shoulder, according grown
To the number of Israel’s tribes
6 “That this may be *against your bribes*
A sign among you when your sons
Ask in the future *by their tonnes*
Questions, saying ‘What are these stones
For you?’ 7 “Then you’ll answer *in tones*

That the Jordan waters *in loans*
Were cut off before the ark of
The covenant of YHWH *in love*,
When it crossed over Jordan's *shove*,
The waters of the Jordan were
Cut off, and these stones shall infer
Recall to Israel's sons ever."

8 So the children of Israel did,
As Joshua commanded *in bid*,
And took up twelve stones from the base
Of the Jordan, as YHWH *in case*
Had spoken to Joshua *well*,
By number of the tribes *that spell*
Of the children of Israel,
And carried them over with them
To the place where they lodged *in stem*,
And laid them down there, *grunts and*
groans.

9 Then Joshua set up twelve stones
In the midst of the Jordan bed,
In the place where the feet *had led*
Of the priests who carried the ark
Of the covenant stopped to park,
And they're there to this day *outspreed*.

The twelve stones rose to be remembrance
of

The tribes of Israel, those whom You love,
And while they gathered them the ark that
waited

Beneath the piling up of unabated
Flood waters, there contained the divine
law

The people had heard uttered loud in awe
On Sinai forty years before. Your speech
Began and ended there, and since then each
Has heard the glowing silence of Your will
On one hand and the busy sounds and shrill
Of priest and prophet vying for the power
To lead the people here and there an hour.
The record of man's speeches has no end,
While You remain in few words only
Friend.

10 So the priests who carried the ark
Stood in the midst of Jordan's *park*
Until everything was done that
YHWH had commanded *where he sat*
Joshua to speak to the folk, by
All that Moses had ordered high
To Joshua, and the folk hastened
And crossed over *with no time wasted*.

11 It came to pass, when all the folk
Had finished crossing Jordan's soak,
That the ark of YHWH and the priests
Crossed in the sight of folk *and beasts*
12 And the men of Reuben and Gad,
And half Manasseh's tribe well-clad
Crossed over armed before the folk
Of Israel, as Moses spoke
To them. 13 About forty thousand
Prepared for war crossed over and
Before YHWH for battle upon
The plains of Jericho *at dawn*.

The priests stand in the muddy river flat
Getting their feet wet perhaps where
they're at

To prove that it was safe for all to go
On land where river waters used to flow.
The priests stood there in quiet and in calm
Until the excitement moved under palm
From the deserted floor of river lake.
Beloved, I too stand quiet for Your sake.
My place is priestly, though I am passed by
Those who rush to gain promised land and
pie,

And am the last to get thanks and reward
That I stood in the river without sword.
I bear in silence in my temple heart
The ten words that You spoke and sent like
dart.

14 On that day YHWH exalted then
Joshua in the sight of men
Of all Israel, and they feared him,
As they had feared Moses, *and grim*
All the days of his life. 15 Then YHWH
Spoke to Joshua, saying *true*,
16 "Command the priests who bear the ark
Of the testimony *in park*
To come up from the Jordan's *stream*."
17 Joshua therefore *it would seem*
Commanded the priests, saying "Come
Up from the Jordan." 18 And in sum,
When the priests carrying the ark
Of the covenant of YHWH *stark*
Had come out of the middle of
The Jordan *River*, *and* the soles
Of the priests' feet touched dry above,
That the waters of Jordan's *shoals*
Returned to their place overflowing
All its banks as it had been going.

Passed by unnoticed by the faithful crowd,
I stand here with my burning heart and
proud,

Waiting for Your command that I'm
allowed

To walk out of the river with a shout
And take my recompense without a doubt.
I wait and know that, though my passing
here

Is quietly encased in joy and tear,
A day will come that when my feet pass on
From riverbed to banquet in the dawn,
My passing will release the holden flood
That crashes down upon the jewelled mud.
Then it will matter not that I have been
The stolid brute and motionless to sin,
Now lifted to a seat above the spheres.

19 Now the folk came up from the *stream*
Of Jordan on the tenth *day's gleam*
Of the first month, and they encamped
At Gilgal on the east line stamped
Of Jericho *as if in dream*.

The Passover is just next week and here
The people stand upon the river pier
And take a longing look into the place
That You have promised to give as a grace.
Like everyone before and after them
They do not realize that Your free gem
Is taken after years of march and battle
And not acquired before the last death
rattle.

All things of value come from You, indeed,
Without price and without honey or seed,
And yet we pay the cost with every breath
Returned to You until the verge of death.
What cost? There's nothing that returns to
You
But is Your own, down to the naked pew.

20 And those twelve stones which they
took out
Of Jordan, Joshua set about
In Gilgal. 21 Then he spoke there to
The children of Israel *and crew*,
Saying "When your children ask their
Fathers in time to come as fair,
Saying 'What *are* these stones *from*
where?'

22 "Then you shall let your children know,
Saying 'Israel crossed *on the go*

Over this Jordan on dry land',
23 "For YHWH your God dried up *like*
sand

The waters of the Jordan flood
Before you until *on the mud*
You had crossed over, as YHWH your
God did to the Red Sea *before*,
Which He dried up before us till
We had crossed over, *stock and bill*,
24 "That all the peoples of the earth
May know the hand of YHWH *is worth*,
That it *is* mighty, that you may
Fear YHWH your God forever's way."

The high priest wears twelve stones upon
his heart

As I do also for my humble part
In taking on my breast twelve pointed disc
Of alabaster that I wear with risk
Of offending the mob who plies the waves
Of spirituality among the graves.
The lovely names of the divine guides
grace

The stones set up in Gilgal and to face
The generations in posterity
Who find the twelve-tiered monument in
spe

To mind them of the desert wandering days
That were in some sense greater for their
praise.

Beloved, I bear the diamond and the blue
Sapphire upon my heart and come to You.

Week 37 Joshua 5

1 It happened when all of the kings
Of the Amorites *in their rings*
On the west side of the Jordan,
And all the Canaanite kings' clan
Who *were* by the sea, heard that YHWH
Had dried up the waters *on cue*
Of the Jordan *River* before
The children of Israel *in store*
Until we'd crossed over, that their
Heart melted, and there was no air
In them longer for Israel's folk,
And for the fear of Israel's yoke.
2 At that time YHWH said to Joshua,
"Make flint knives for yourself *by law*,
And circumcise *all* Israel's sons
Again the second time *by guns*."

Just wait to hear the justice of this crime

Against unholy flesh at such a time.
They will not take the steel and sharpen it
To finely ragged edges and unfit,
But rather take the flint, whose edge goes
down

To very line of molecules in town.
The stone age is the pinnacle of all
Technology in the whole human stall,
From which the human tale degenerates
Into the primitive atomic states.
Beloved, I flee to that high race of men
Who recognize the power and beauty's
glen
In flint for cutting and for mending when
One rises up to enter the last den.

3 So Joshua made himself flint knives,
And circumcised Israel's sons' *lives*
At the hill of the foreskins. 4 And
This is the reason why *at hand*
Joshua circumcised them: All
The folk come out of Egypt's thrall
Who were males, all the men of war,
Had died on the wilderness' floor
On the way, after they'd come out
Of Egypt. 5 For all the folk *stout*
Who came out had been circumcised,
But all the people realized,
Born in the desert, on the trip
Out of Egypt, *without a slip*,
Had not been circumcised *for fears*.
6 For Israel's folk walked forty years
In the desert, till all the folk,
The men of war, who came *on stroke*
Out of Egypt, were consumed then,
Because they did not obey when
YHWH spoke, and to whom YHWH had
sworn

That He would not show them *forlorn*
The land which YHWH had sworn to their
Fathers that He would give us *fair*,
"A land flowing with milk and honey."

7 Then Joshua, *and not for money*,
Circumcised their sons *whom* He raised
Up in their place, for they *ungrazed*
Were uncircumcised, because they
Were not circumcised on the way.
8 So it happened when they had finished
The folk's circumcising diminished,
That they stayed in their places in
The camp till they were healed *in bin*.
9 Then YHWH said to Joshua, "This

Day I have rolled away *abyss*
Of reproach of Egypt from you."
Therefore the place's name is called
Gilgal to this day *as forestalled*.

Since Abraham the cutting and the bleeding
Go on without a break, never receding.
This is the blessing, so it seems, You
promise.

Forgive, Beloved, the ranting, doubting
Thomas.

It is worse thing than cutting that some stop
The practice without word of grace or crop,
Admitting that You once commanded it
But giving Paul the greater load of wit
Than You Yourself. Yet even Paul did not
Say one word on the matter of what's
taught

For children's sake, but only stopped the
knife
From touching grown men's tender flesh
and life.

Yet these were grown and cut. The
argument

Is writ on stones of flint not heaven sent.

10 Now the children of Israel camped
In Gilgal, and kept *there revamped*
The Passover the fourteenth day
Of the month at twilight *to stay*
Upon the plains of Jericho.

11 And they ate of the haricot
Of the land on the day after
The Passover, unleavened *stir*
Bread and parched grain, that very day.

12 Then the manna ceased on the day
After they had eaten produce
Of the land, then without excuse
For manna longer, Israel's folk
Ate Canaan's land's food that year's *yoke*.

Who look to Canaan's land, the land of
promise,

For future joys not to be doubting Thomas,
See not that in that lovely place and fair
There is no treat and sweetened manna
there.

Who would eat manna, blessed manna from
Your hand directly, and without the strum
Of go-betweens and veils and shortened
lights,

Must turn out in the desert and its nights.

There is no manna without desert dark,
And without setting out of sight of park.
There is no manna without homelessness,
And without tired wandering and distress.
There is no manna without serpents' fire
Upon the stony pathway of desire.

13 It happened when Joshua was by
Jericho, that he lifted eye
And looked, and see, a man stood near
Opposite him with His sword *sheer*
Drawn in His hand. And Joshua
Went to him and spoke *in his awe*,
“Are You for us or for our foes?”
14 So He said “No, but *as He chose*
Chief of YHWH’s army now I’ve come.”
And Joshua fell on his *bum*
With face to earth prostrating there,
And said to him, “What *of the fair*
Does my Lord say to His servant?”
15 Then the Chief of YHWH’s army lent
Voice to Joshua, “Take off from
Your foot your sandal where you’ve come,
For the place where you stand *is* holy.”
And Joshua then did so *lowly*.

All men who fight today receive the word
Assured in heart and hand that they’re
inured
To bullet and to arrow since they’re stirred
By God alone, and by the moral ground
To slaughter innocents wherever found.
All men who fight know that You’re on
their side
And You’re a God who has come to reside
In their temples and not one to abide
In camp of enemy, no, You are great
At supporting the right army and state.
All fools know that there are just two sides
and
All are either for or against the hand,
So who is this who is neither for or
Against the people on the Jordan’s shore?

Joshua 6

1 Now Jericho was tight shut up
For fear of Israel’s folk *to sup*
And none went out, and none came in.
2 And YHWH said to Joshua’s *grin*,
“See! I have given Jericho
Into your hand, its king, *and lo*
The mighty men of valour. 3 “You

Shall march around the city, *do*,
All men of war, you’ll go around
The city once. This you’ll be bound
To do six days. 4 “And seven priests
Shall bear seven trumpets, artistes
With rams’ horns there before the ark.
But the seventh day you’ll *not park*
But march around the city more,
Seven times, and the priests *in corps*
Shall blow the trumpets *on the shore*.
5 “It shall happen, when they blow long
With the ram’s horn, when you hear strong
The sound of the trumpet, that all
The people shall shout with a call
Great and loud, then the city wall
Will fall down flat. And the folk shall
Go straight in every one *for sal*. ”

One wonders where the power is to break
The walls of Jericho. But for Your sake
The man believed he heard the angel speak,
And so for that he did not turn out weak,
But sent the ark in which lay hidden there
In silence what You wrote with finger bare,
And sent the priests and sent the seven
horns
And all the people round the city’s bourns.
Some walls fall at the sound of horn and
bleat,
Some cities fall for thunder of the feet
Of priest and ruler striding down the street,
Some gates turn open at the shouts that
greet
The coming of the week. Beloved, I fall
To hear the silence of Your law and call.

6 Then Joshua the son of Nun
Called the priests and told them *in fun*,
“Take up the ark of covenant,
And let seven priests *adjutant*
Bear seven trumpets of rams’ horns
Before the ark of YHWH *as mourns*. ”
7 And he said to the people, “Go,
And march around the city *row*,
And let the one who’s armed advance
Before the ark of YHWH *in dance*. ”
8 So it was, when Joshua had
Spoken to the folk, *lass and lad*,
That the seven priests bearing those
Seven trumpets of rams’ horns’ *woes*
Before YHWH advanced and blew on
The trumpets, and the ark *undrawn*

Of the covenant of YHWH came
After them. 9 The armed men *of fame*
Went before the priests who blew on
The trumpets, and the rear guard came
After the ark, while *the priests* still
Blew on the trumpets *a sound shrill*.

10 Joshua gave the folk command
Saying "You shall not shout or stand
To make any noise with your voice,
Nor shall your mouth a word rejoice,
Until the day I say to you,
'Shout!' Then shout as best you can do."

I too am silent as I make my way
In whirling on the land day after day
And night after night in the midnight task
Of working on the chambered heart You
ask.

I too am silent for the six days that
I pass before Your throne, the place You
sat,

Before You bend to blow down all the
walls

That stop the human spirit from Your calls.
Beloved, I pass in silence six days rent
In whirling in reality and spent
In knowing of unknowing where the bent
Of sky looks on the shroud without a scent.
I only lift my voice when You appear
In seventh day with mercy or with spear.

11 And then he had the ark of YHWH
Circle the town, around *it* once.
Then they came back to camp like dunce
And in the camp they spent the night.

12 And Joshua rose at morning light,
And the priests lifted ark of YHWH.

13 Then seven priests bearing with them
Seven rams' horns trumpets *in hem*
Before the ark of YHWH went on
Blowing the trumpets in the dawn.
And the armed men went before them.

And the rear guard came after ark
Of YHWH, while *the priests* to *embark*
Kept blowing with the trumpets' *sound*.

14 And the second day they marched round
The city once, then left the ground
And came to camp. And so they did
For six days. 15 But it hit the lid
On the seventh day that they rose
Early, about the dawning rose,
And circled the town seven times

As done before. On that day only
They circled the town seven times *lonely*.
16 And the seventh time it took place,
When the priests blew the trumpets' *grace*,
That Joshua told the people, "Shout,
For YHWH gives you the city rout!"

I daily look upon the city walls
And see the markets and the many stalls
Where vain philosophies are trumpeted
And sold at bargain prices to be rid
Of the remembrance of Your name. I turn
Each day the circuit of the city, learn
Its hopes and spurn its fears to whirl with
You.

The pavement turns, no matter what I do.
The only sound's the tread of praying feet
As at the dawn I go out where we meet.
At week's end I shall not return to rest
From patient whirling, from my sins
confessed,

But walk on constant till I turn about
And raise a trumpet and the victory shout.

17 "And then the city shall be doomed
By YHWH to destruction *presumed*,
It and all who *are* in it, but
Only Rahab, innkeeper *shut*,
Shall live, she and all who *are there*
With her in the house, *her you'll spare*,
Because she hid the messengers
That we sent *before the soldiers*.

18 "And you, by all means shall abstain
From the accursed things, lest *in vain*
You become cursed when you acquire
Of the accursed things *meant for fire*,

And make of Israel's camp a curse,
And trouble it *and for what's worse*.

19 "But all the silver and the gold,
And vessels of bronze, iron *untold*,
Are consecrated to YHWH, they
Shall come into the treasure's way
Of YHWH." 20 So the people began
To shout when *the priests* blew the fan.
And it happened when the folk heard
The sound of trumpet *undeterred*,
And the folk shouted with a great
Shout, that the wall fell down flat *rate*.
Then the folk went up in the town,
Every man straight before his *crown*,
And they took *all* the city *down*.

Since the creation of the world I see
Humankind building cities for the free,
And You turning from the six days in spree
To find destruction's hour in every place
Where towers of brick and tar seek to erase
The difference in time perhaps and space
Between created and Creator's face.
Beloved, the future holds destruction's
hour

For greater volumes of creative power.
The roles reverse as men seek to create
And find that what they make is insensate.
The tandem dance You make with skeleton
Goes on beneath the cycles of the sun
To stop only perhaps when You are One.

21 They utterly destroyed all that
Was in the city, both *the fat*
And lean of man and woman *too*,
Young and old, ox and sheep *in view*
And donkey, with the mouth of sword.

22 But Joshua said to the two men
Who'd spied out the land *dell and glen*,
"Go into the innkeeper's house,
And from there bring out the good spouse
And all she has, as you have sworn."
23 And the young men who had once worn
The coat of spies went in and brought
Out Rahab, her father *as sought*,
Her mother, her brothers, and all
That she had *in house, bin and stall*.
And they brought out her kith and kin
And left them outside the camp where
Israel *had come to spend its share*.

24 And they burned the city with fire
And all that *was* in its conspire.
Only the silver and the gold,
And pots of bronze and iron *told*,
They put into the treasury
Of the house of YHWH *faithfully*.

I take a lesson from absurdity.
They saved the gold and silver deity
And took the bronze and iron to make its
house
As safe as strong against both man and
mouse.

It is no flight from fair idolatry
To take one god alone among the three
As long as god's blood and his body are
Of gold eternal, silver, and the bar
Of ruling iron. But just wait what comes

Of clothing the divine in sumptuous sums.
I burn the precious metals in the fire
And cling to You, Beloved, with all desire.

25 Joshua spared Rahab who was
The innkeeper, her father's straws,
And all that she had *in her paws*.
She dwells in Israel to this day,
Since she hid messengers away
Whom Joshua sent to spy out
Jericho *to be without doubt*.
26 Joshua adjured *them* that time,
Saying "Cursed *be* the man of *crime*
Before YHWH rising up to build
This city Jericho *we've tilled*,
He'll lay its foundation with his
Firstborn, and with his youngest *whiz*
He shall set up its gates." 27 So YHWH
Was with Joshua *for his due*,
And his fame spread throughout the land
For fear and woe on every hand.

Who sets up human sacrifice is he
Who shall inherit every curse you see
Upon the wall of Jericho. Its gate,
Like every pagan gate of soon and late,
Is set upon foundations bathed in blood
Of some firstborn as testified by flood
Of children's bones. The Church of Christ
is set

Upon the curse of human sacrifice
And so prevails to meet the curse once met
In Jericho, in Babylon, and twice
Or more in every sacred grove. I weep
That human souls go on and on to keep
The pagan faith in death and resurrection,
The pagan faith in natural selection.

Joshua 7

1 But the children of Israel did
A trespass in the accursed bid,
For Achan the son of Carmi,
The son of Zabdi, who we see
To be the son of Zerah, of
The tribe of Judah, he took of
The cursed things, so the anger of
YHWH burned hot against Israel's folk,
Against woman and child and bloke.

Aye, truly gold and silver are called cursed!
But idols are an empty thing from first
To last. As vessels gold and silver fail

To bear the fire where clay pots still
prevail,
Though bronze and iron for spear and
plough are good
And lasting things in place of hardened
wood.
While gold conducts well electricity,
It's only little better than the plea
Of copper. Gold is truly called accursed,
But only so because values reversed.
The human mind creates the god of gold
From senseless matter, glittering and cold.
Let me, Beloved, see no god anywhere
But in You who hold both the earth and air.

2 And Joshua sent men out from
Jericho to Ai *in sum*,
Which *is* beside Beth Aven, on
The east side of Bethel *at dawn*,
And spoke to them, saying "Go up
And spy out the country *to sup*."
So the men went and saw Ai.
3 And they went back to Joshua
And said to him, "Do not let all
The people go up, but let fall
About two or three thousand men
On Ai. Do not weary all
The people there, for few *in pen*."
4 So about three thousand men went
Up there from the folk, but they lent
Flight before the men of Ai.
5 And the men of Ai foreby
Struck down about thirty-six men,
For they chased them before the gate
As far as Shebarim, and *late*
Struck them as they were going down,
Therefore the people's hearts *and crown*
Melted like water from renown.

The men of Ai struck the innocent
And slaughtered all of them who rose and
went
Against the city in Your holy name.
Secret idolatry was first to blame.
So three times twelve rose up to bear Your
word,
And innocently, bravely all concurred
From sons of Ishmael, Jacob, judges, kings,
Disciples of Messiah, all met stings
And failed to teach the people
righteousness.
They were too busy living to confess,

And worshipping to stop and listen to
The words of any saying what to do.
The fourth twelve and the last were also
struck.
The ones You send, Beloved, have got bad
luck.

6 And Joshua tore his clothes, and
Fell to the earth on face and hand
Before the ark of YHWH until
Evening, he and the elders in
Israel, and put dust *to their fill*
On their heads *confessing their sin*.
7 And Joshua said "Alas, Lord
YHWH, why have You brought to the
sword

This people over Jordan here,
To deliver us to the fear
Of the Amorites, to be scored?
Oh, that we'd been content to live
The other side of Jordan's sieve!
8 "O Lord, what shall I say to know
Israel turns its back to its foe?
9 "For Canaanites and all the dwellers
In the land will hear *of the fellows*,
And surround us, and cut off our
Name from the earth, *and turn it sour*.
Then what will You do for Your name
That is both great *and filled with fame*?"

When I do something wrong, I do not cry
To You for fear Your reputation by
The world and the community will suffer.
Oh no, I am not such a cunning duffer.
I sigh and cry because it is my doom
To be seen for the fool I am in room
Of brother human creatures who are ready
To pounce as soon as they find one
unsteady.

Beloved, I flee to You in all my greed
For taking from Jericho's wall the seed
Of wealth by which I hope to turn the mile
Against competing humans at the stile.
Beloved, I flee to You and find my need
Is met in You alone who hold no guile.

10 So YHWH said to Joshua then,
"Get up! Why do you lie *again*
On your face like this? 11 "Israel
Has sinned, and they have *for a spell*
Also transgressed My covenant
Which I commanded them *extant*.

For they have even taken some
Of the accursed things, and when done
Have both stolen and deceived, and
They've also put *it* in their hand.

12 "Therefore the children of Israel
Could not stand before foes so well,
But turned *their* backs before their foes,
Because they're doomed to meet their
throes.

Neither will I be with you now,
Unless you destroy accursed *row*
From among you. 13 "Get up, make holy
The people, and say to them *lowly*,
'Sanctify yourselves for tomorrow,
Because thus says YHWH *to your sorrow*
The God of Israel, "An accursed
Thing's among you *to bear the worst*,
O Israel, you cannot stand
Before your enemies *in band*
Until you take away the thing
Accursed, stolen from under wing."

14 'In the morning therefore you shall
Be brought according to tribes' *sal*.
And it shall be *that* the tribe which
YHWH takes shall come *without a hitch*
According to families, and
The family which YHWH has planned
Shall come up by its households, and
The household which YHWH takes shall
come

Man by man. 15 'Then it shall be *rum*
That he who's taken with the cursed
Thing shall be burned with fire *at worst*,
He and all that he has, because
He has transgressed the pact and laws
Of YHWH, and because he has done
A disgrace in Israel *for fun*.'"

Though every man is on his face in prayer,
The words evaporate into the air
If sinful hearts and acts are hidden there.
It was no use for Joshua that day
To put his forehead on the ground to pray
While lust for gold and silver held their
sway.

Too many men in many mosques rely
On empty words and hearts to get them by
Or worse yet on a sinful tear and sigh.
Beloved, may I pluck out the golden beam
That blinds my eye and makes my token
seem

The truth when I am wandering in dream.

May I find in the stony temple where
I bow within my chamber, You are there.

16 So Joshua rose early on
The morning and brought *before dawn*
Israel by their tribes, and the tribe
Of Judah was taken *in scribe*.

17 He brought the clan of Judah, and
He took the family *in hand*
Of the Zarhites, and then he brought
The Zarhite family by man,
And Zabdi was taken. 18 Then he
Brought his household each man singly,
And Achan the son of Carmi,
Son of Zabdi, son of Zerah,
Was taken of tribe of Judah.

19 Now Joshua said to Achan,
"My son, I beg you, give *like man*
The glory to YHWH Israel's God,
And make confession at His prod,
And tell me now what you have done,
Do not hide *it* from me *for fun*."

Whether I take or not forbidden fruit
From Jericho or Eden, I get boot
From civil servant in the office where
They are not always civil for their share.
Who has not taken from this world's fields
bare

A daimen ikker in a thrave with care
To feed his body and his soul without
Giving the whole to general with clout?
I nibble at the gold and silver coin,
I rend the unpatched cloak that covers loin
And hide the whole somewhere beneath my
tent.

And pretend all is well with those who lent.
Beloved, I meet the judgement in the night
When six days have passed silently from
sight.

20 And Achan answered Joshua
And said "Indeed I've sinned *at draw*
Against YHWH God of Israel,
And this is what I've done, *I tell*:

21 "When I saw there among the spoils
A beautiful garment *in coils*
Of Babylon, two hundred shekels
Of silver, and a wedge *in speckles*
Of gold fifty shekels in weight,
I coveted them and *for fate*
Took them. And there they are, hidden

In the earth in the middle *den*
 Of my tent, with the silver too.”
 22 So Joshua sent out a crew,
 And they ran to the tent, and there
 It was, hidden in his tentware,
 With the silver under it there.
 23 And they took them out of the tent,
 Brought them to Joshua *as sent*
 And all the folk of Israel,
 And laid them out *to look a spell*
 Before YHWH. 24 Then Joshua, and
 All Israel with him, *by command*
 Took Achan the son of Zerah,
 The silver, the garment, the draw
 Of golden wedge, his sons, his daughters,
 His oxen, his donkeys *to slaughters*,
 His sheep, his tent, and all he had,
 They brought them to the valley *sad*
 Of Achor. 25 And Joshua said
 “Why have you troubled us *for dread*?
 May YHWH trouble you *too* this day.”
 So all Israel stoned him *that way*
 With stones, and they burned them with
 fire
 After they’d stoned with stones *in ire*.
 26 Then they raised over him a great
 Heap of stones, to this day in state.
 So YHWH turned from the fierceness of
 His wrath. And therefore the name of
 That place has been called Valley of
 Achor to this day *for above*.

Idolatry is bad enough, but this
 Witch-hunt by lottery can hardly miss
 The superstitious excesses that told
 Both fear and grief in times both new and
 old.
 Two questions I have here, the first one,
 how
 Can one be sure the lotteries endow
 The judge with rightful knowledge of the
 one
 Whose guilt and idol worship cloud the
 sun?
 The second is by what propriety
 The people have the right to act so free
 As killing others when commandment said
 That none may kill a soul? Have I misread?
 Applying divine law in land and time
 Appears to me, Beloved, very like crime.

This story of the human sacrifice

Just shows how Canaanite the Israel vice
 Was in its views and doings in a trice.
 As soon as failure of the project rose,
 The leader cast lots to reveal and chose
 A victim to assure success to come.
 How that differs from first-born in the rum
 Offered to Baal and buried under gate
 Of the new town to assure the town’s fate,
 I fail to answer. So does everyone.
 Outside the Decalogue, the story’s done,
 Whether in Hebrew or in Grecian spun,
 To save the day by slaughtering someone,
 Either on cross or with stones on the run.

Week 38 Joshua 8

1 Now YHWH said to Joshua, “Do
 Not be afraid, nor be dismayed,
 Take all the folk of war with you,
 And get up, go to Ai’s *glade*.
 See, I have given into your hand
 The king of Ai, his folk’s band,
 His city, and *all of* his land.
 2 “And you shall do to Ai and
 Its king as once to Jericho
 And its king. Only its spoil’s *show*
 And its cattle you’ll take *in stow*
 As booty for yourselves *in crown*.
 Lay an ambush behind the town.”

Even You now, Beloved, see why the folk
 Will not be honest with the clod in poke
 If all must be given to temple store.
 It took the death of greedy men and more
 To show that armies will not fight and go
 To battle without incentives to show.
 Just promise them the booty and You find
 Them honest and ready behind the blind.
 Beloved, I take Your promises to me
 Found in the noonday light, the mystery
 Of leaf and needle on my mountain tree.
 Beloved, I find the booty and the spoil
 Without my waiting and without my toil
 In gold of bud and bloom, of leaf in coil.

3 So Joshua arose, and all
 The people of war at the call
 To go up against Ai’s wall,
 And Joshua chose *once again*
 Thirty thousands of mighty men
 Of valor and sent there by night.
 4 And he commanded them *to fight*,
 Saying “See, you shall lie in wait

Against the town behind the gate.
 Do not go very far away,
 But all in readiness there stay.
 5 "Then I and all the folk with me
 Will *boldly* approach the city,
 And when they come out against us
 As at the first, we'll flee *the fuss*
 Before them. 6 "For they will come out
 After us till we've drawn in rout
 Them from the city, for they'll say,
 'They're fleeing before us *today*
 As at the first.' Therefore we'll flee
 Before them. 7 "Then from your safety
 You shall rise and take the city,
 For YHWH your God will give you it.
 8 "And when you have come in to sit
 In the city, you shall set fire
 To the city. By the desire
 Of YHWH you'll carry out the thing.
 See, it is I who's commanding."

I do distrust the man who says that You
 Command him to kill women, children too,
 And fight the city, burn it to the ground
 So that no life in it is to be found.
 I do distrust, Beloved, the ones who say
 Your voice spoke to them in the night or
 day
 To wreck and tumble missiles on the poor
 Because they might be evil to be sure.
 The Bible is the record of how men
 Who knew commandments well, and how
 and when
 To do the right and just thing on the earth,
 Still chose instead to call the wrong thing
 worth.
 I pray Joshua was not among those too,
 But more that I may do right when I do.

9 Joshua therefore sent them out,
 And they went to lie in ambush,
 And stayed between Bethel and route
 To Ai, on the west side's crush
 Of Ai, but Joshua stayed
 That night, among the people *prayed*.
 10 And Joshua got up early
 In the morning and gathered the
 Army, and went up, he and *all*
 The elders of Israel *at call*,
 Before the people to Ai.
 11 And all the people of the cry
 Who *were* with him went up and came

Near, and they came before the *claim*
Of the city and camped upon
 The north side of Ai *at dawn*.
 And a valley *was* between them
 And Ai. 12 So he took in *hem*
 About five thousand men and set
 Them in wait between *parapet*
Of Bethel and Ai, to west
 Of the city. 13 And when they'd set
 The people, all the army met
 On the north of the city *wall*,
 With the ambush upon the west
 Of the city, Joshua went
 That night into the valley *bent*.

Beloved, I lie in wait on the north side
 Of Your city, and on the west I hide
 My ready ambush, if perchance at dawn
 When You awaken and in faith have drawn
 The waters and perfumes of Your
 ablutions,
 I might surprise You with my resolutions
 And take You captive to my heart in love.
 You smile at my naive plans and the glove
 I leave to warn You of my stratagem.
 But this is true beyond doubt, Treasured
 Gem,
 That whether I spoil You or at Your hem
 I stay to be Your slave of love well set,
 The victory's assured whatever's met.
 For I am Yours and You are mine to get.

14 It came to pass, when Ai's king
 Saw *it*, that the men of the ring
 Hurried and rose early and went
 Out against Israel and bent
 On battle, he and all his folk,
 At an appointed place *and oak*
 Before the plain. But he did not
 Know that *there was* an ambush plot
 Against him behind the city.
 15 And Joshua and all made free
 As if Israel were beaten there
 Before them, and fled by the stair
 Of the desert. 16 So all the folk
 Who *were* in Ai *at a stroke*
 Came to pursue them. And they went
 After Joshua and were sent
 Away from the city. 17 So there
 Was not a man left to *his share*
 In Ai or Bethel who did
 Not go out after Israel's *bid*.

And they left the city open
 And followed after Israel's *men*.
 18 Then YHWH said to Joshua, "Stretch
 Out the spear in your hand to fetch
 Against Ai, for I'll give it
 Into your hand, *as it is fit*."
 And Joshua stretched out the spear
 In his hand toward the city's *gear*.
 19 So *those in* ambush hastened out
 Of their place, they ran as in rout
 As soon as he stretched out his hand,
 And they entered the city *band*
 And took it, and hurried to set
 The city on fire *without fret*.
 20 And when the men of Ai looked
 Behind them, they saw *they were cooked*,
 And indeed, the smoke of the city
 Ascended to heaven *without pity*.
 So they were trapped, no place to flee
 This way or that, for Israel's bee
 Who had fled to the wilderness
 Turned back on the pursuers' *dress*.

Wherever I turn in my flight from You,
 Beloved, along the fervent silver dew,
 Along the lichen-crested stony view,
 Or on the dry sand of the nearest shore,
 Wherever I turn, You are at the door.
 Bending a timid head not fit to meet
 Your eye of love and judgement that would
 greet
 Me, I turn once again, and find Your feet,
 Brazen and burning, glittering to show
 That You are there, though not seen, where
 I go.
 Your strategy makes havoc of my life,
 My plans, my plots, my most coveted
 strife.
 From You I flee in love and fear to find
 Refuge from You in Your heart
 intertwined.

21 Now when Joshua and the folk
 Of Israel all saw the smoke
 That the ambush had set on city,
 They turned back and struck *without pity*
 The men of Ai. 22 Then the others
 Came out of the city, their brothers,
 Against them, so that they were *caught*
 Between Israel, some of them fought
 On this side and some on that side.
 And they struck them down *to the hide*,

So that they let none of them live
 Or escape *as a fugitive*.

You strike me down as soon as I rise up
 With blows on both sides and on plate and
 cup.
 You do not let me live, Beloved, but take
 My soul to Your own loving heart and
 wake
 To love of me until my smoldering life
 Extinguishes beneath Your cleaving knife.
 I would arise and go, but as I stand
 You slay me with the darts of love's
 command,
 And I fall once again beneath Your hand,
 Shuddered and unmade to be reformed by
 Your fingers that created earth and sky
 And my soul and my breath once passing
 by.
 The warfare that You make upon my soul
 Returns each breath to be my soughten
 goal.

23 But the king of Ai they took
 Alive, and brought him back *to look*
 For Joshua. 24 It came to pass
 When Israel had killed the crass
 Inhabitants of Ai all
 In the field, in the desert brawl
 Where they pursued them, and when they
 All had fallen by mouth of sword
 Until they were consumed *that day*,
 That all the Israelites *in horde*
 Returned to Ai and struck down
 With mouth of the sword *the whole town*.
 25 So all who fell that day, both men
 And women, twelve thousand *in glen*,
 All the people of Ai's *den*.
 26 For Joshua did not draw back
 His hand, which he stretched out not slack
 With spear, but he fully destroyed
 In Ai all who were employed.
 27 Only the cattle and the spoil
 Of that city Israel *for toil*
 Took as booty for themselves, by
 The word of YHWH which He made nigh
 To Joshua. 28 So Joshua
 Burned Ai and made it a heap
 Forever, desolation raw
 To this day *forever to keep*.

Beloved, You come to ravage soul and den

Where I hide out from You and denizen
Of this fast world that would devour my
pate.

You come, and what I held with selfish
grate

I give up to You willingly in love.

You rush upon my being with a glove
And boots of iron, and yet I give my own
To You and do not withhold glaive or
throne.

Take all my oxen and take all my sheep,
Leave me bereft, either to laugh or weep,
But accept at my hand the sacrifice
Of life and living, my every device.

Beloved, take for Your own the empty
glare

Of my holding, to be a real share.

29 And the king of Ai he hanged
On a tree until evening *clanged*.
And as soon as the sun went down,
Joshua commanded *with frown*
That they should take his carcass down
From the tree, cast it at the gate
Going into the city *way*,
And to raise over it a great
Heap of stones *that stays* to this day.

Beloved, You hung me out for all to see,
A dripping corpse at Ai's gate's decree,
And in my shame of graven innocence
I plotted to give my body's incense
In burnt offering before Your glowing face.
Though I have been given that hostage
grace,

My body still hangs for the craven race
To pillage and to mock upon the gate.
Such is my own and every servant's fate
That comes to You, whether in hope of
great

Or small in blessing. All meet the same
rate.

There is no room for other in the dress
Of Your reality in wilderness.
The corpse dries up in fluttering duress.

30 Now Joshua built an altar
To YHWH God of Israel *for star*
In Mount Ebal, 31 as Moses who
Was the servant *and slave* of YHWH
Had told folk of Israel to do,
As it is written in the Book

Of the Law of Moses to look,
"An altar of whole stones on which
No man has wielded iron *pitch*."
And they offered on it burnt offerings
To YHWH, and sacrificed peace offerings.

32 And there, before Israel's folk he
Wrote on the stones a *new* copy
Of the law of Moses, which he
Had written. 33 Then all Israel,
With their elders, officers *well*
And judges, stood on either side
Of the ark before the priests' *ride*,
The Levites, who carried the ark
Of covenant of YHWH *in park*,
The stranger as well as he who
Had been born among their own crew.
Half of them *were* in front of Mount
Gerizim and half in account
In front of Mount Ebal, as Moses
The servant of YHWH once discloses,
That they should bless there Israel's folk.

34 And afterward he read *and woke*
All the words of the law, the blessings
And cursings, and by the addressings
Of all that's written in the book
Of the law. 35 There was not a nook
Of all that Moses had commanded
Which Joshua did not read *handed*
Before the congregation of
All Israel, with women, *love*,
The little ones, and strangers who
Were living there among their crew.

Some would covet to stand in place to hear
The voice of Joshua ring on the ear.
Beloved, I am one greater blessed than
those

Who hear Your voice sound in the
scrawling rows
Of Scripture bent to cantillation's flows.
Some would covet to read the writing on
The cribbled stones on Ebal that were
drawn

By Joshua to show the way of life.
But I have peace and solace in the strife,
As I hear Your voice in remembering
Solicit sound to set the messaging.
Beloved, I take hold of far Ebal's stone
And stand with it before Your shining
throne
And plead the billet-doux that I have
known.

Joshua 9

1 It came to pass when all the kings
Who *were* on this side of the *springs*
Of Jordan, in the hills and in
The lowland parts and also in
All the coasts of the great sea by
Lebanon, the Hittite *foreby*,
The Amorite, the Canaanite,
The Perizzite, and the Hivite,
Also the Jebusite heard that,
2 They gathered to fight there where sat
Joshua and Israel at bat.

All kings and presidents gather to fight
Me also, my Beloved, in laws of sprite
That war against Your word and Your
command.
They are in number like the waves and
sand
Upon the sea-shore, where I come to stand.
They make exception to the rule You gave
That no man should send others to the
grave
And take the life that no man knows to
give,
While You and I say let every man live.
They make exception to the right of all
To celebrate the Sabbath with no call
Of boss to labourer nor man to beast,
But that all living things on Sabbath feast.
For these two only are my foes increased.

3 But when those who lived in Gibeon
Heard the thing Joshua had done
To Jericho and Ai, 4 they
Were wily and went on a day
Making to be ambassador.
And they took old sacks *for their score*
On their donkeys, old wineskins torn
And patched, 5 and old sandals and worn
On their feet, and in old clothes dressed,
And all the bread in their sacks messed
Was dry *and* moldy. 6 And they went
To Joshua, the regiment
At Gilgal, and said to him and
To the men of Israel *they scanned*,
“We have come from a far country,
Now therefore, make with us treaty.”

Make the deceitful who come in the name
Of other than they are and to their shame

My servants to serve me and not me them,
I pray, Beloved, and seek Your stratagem.
They come on donkeys made of steel and
tone

Of rubber and plastic on plastic throne,
They come with old wineskins of emerald
glass

And in sandals fastened with velcro’s mass,
And nibble pastries. But I see the row
Of their deception. Beloved, let me go
Out from the presence of the wicked ones
Who make treaties in lies upon their buns.
Their missiles underground and secretly
Haunt widows and orphans beside the sea.

7 Then the men of Israel said to
The Hivites, “It may be that you
Live among us, so how can we
Make with you any peace treaty?”
8 But they said to Joshua, “We
Are your servants.” And Joshua
Said to them, “Who *are* you *by Jah*,
And where do you come from?” 9 So they
Said to him, “From a far country
Your servants have come *faithfully*,
Because of the name of YHWH your
God, for we’ve heard *on a far shore*
Of His fame, and all that He did
In Egypt, 10 “and all that He did
To the two kings of Amorites
Who *were* beyond the Jordan sites,
To Sihon king of Heshbon, and
Og king of Bashan, who *at hand*
Was at Ashtaroth. 11 “Therefore our
Elders and all the dwellers’ tower
Of our country spoke to us, saying
‘Take provisions with you for staying
On the journey, and go to meet
Them, and say to them, “We *are meet*
To be your servants, now therefore,
Make covenant with us *in corps*.’”

12 “This bread of ours we took out hot
For our provision from our plot
On the day we left to come here,
Now look, it’s dry and mouldy *gear*.

13 “And these wineskins which we have
filled
Were new, and see, they’re torn *and*
spilled,

And these clothes and shoes have become
Old because of the journey run.”

14 Then the men of Israel took some

Of their provisions, but when done
They did not ask counsel of YHWH.
15 So Joshua made peace with crew,
And made a treaty with them to
Let them live, and the princes of
The congregation swore to love.
16 And it came to pass at the end
Of three days *set in dividend*,
After they'd made a pact with them,
They heard that they *were at the hem*
Their neighbors who lived near to them.

When men come to my door and bring the
promise
Let me be always in place doubting
Thomas.
When they show me their wares and bring
contract
Before my eyes in buying or the act
Of sacrifice and prayer, let me doubt all
The things they brag about from Rome to
Gaul.
Let me, Beloved, evaluate all things
By Your ten words, both merchants and all
kings
As well as beggars and the taxman's coat.
Let me use Your commandments to make
note
That all are deficient, despite the fact
That ten words only form the sacred pact.
Beloved, let me stand firm on these ten
laws
Though all the world should hide their
bloody claws.

17 Then the children of Israel went
Travelling and came *as they were sent*
To their cities on the third day.
Now their cities *were* Gibeon's way,
Chephirah, Beeroth, Kirjath Jearim.
18 But Israel's folk had not to hear them
In an attack, because the rulers
Of the assembly had *been fools*
And sworn to them by YHWH the God
Of Israel *upon the sod*.
And all the congregation *mad*
Complained against the rulers' *pad*.
19 Then all the rulers said to all
The congregation *by the wall*,
"We've sworn to them by YHWH the God
Of Israel not to lift rod,
Now therefore, we may not touch them.

20 "But this is what we'll do to them:
We'll let them live, lest wrath be on
Us because of the oath we've drawn."
21 And the rulers said to them, "Let
Them live, but let them be as set
Cutters of wood and drawers of
Water for all the folk above,
As the rulers had promised them
Who came out in such stratagem."

The Lutheran and Baptist come to me
And claim to serve You and they claim to
be
The guardians of the right way. I see
They are imposters, none of them retain
Even two of the commandments writ plain,
To wit, that You are One God and not
three,
And You do not permit shedding of blood.
Their lies roll round the world and like a
flood
Deceive all men and if the truth be told
As many women are bought in their fold.
Let them, Beloved, be cutters of the wood
And drawers of water, until they should
Meet Saul's sword or if not until the day
You judge them and throw them into hell's
way.

22 Then Joshua called for them *all*,
He spoke to them and to recall,
Saying "Why have you deceived us,
Saying 'We're very far from you,'
When in fact you live near to us?"
23 "Now therefore, you *are* cursed, and
none

Of you shall be freed *once we've done*
From being slaves, cutters of wood
And drawers of water for good
For the house of my God *begun.*"

24 So they answered Joshua and
Said "Because your servants *at hand*
Were surely told that YHWH your God
Commanded His servant *with rod*,
Moses to give you all the land,
And to destroy all in the land,
Inhabitants before your hand,
That's why we were afraid indeed
For our lives because of your *creed*,
And have done this thing *in our need*."

25 "And now, here we are, in your hands,
Do with us as seems by commands

Good and right to do to our *bands*.”
 26 So did he to them, and he saved
 Them from Israel’s folk’s hand *that raved*,
 So they did not kill them *at all*.
 27 And that day Joshua did install
 Them as cutters of wood and all
 To carry water for the folk
 Of the congregation and stoke
 The altar of YHWH, in the place
 Which He’d choose, even to this pace.

The world is full of things that do not seem
 To be the things they are. The milk and
 cream
 Are often made of artificial gas,
 And covered with a sugar taste, alas!
 My own self comes to me with well-worn
 shoe
 And dried and moldy bread instead of new,
 So shall I blame the neighbour for his guile
 In cheating me of silver in a pile?
 Beloved, I flee to You in refuge from
 The enemy within and wranglesome
 Without. Replace suspicion in my heart
 With clear eye-sight for those who play a
 part.
 I need no slave to carry water, cut
 My wood, Beloved. Let me keep guard-
 doors shut.

Joshua 10

1 Now it came to pass when the king
 Adoni-Zedek of *the spring*
Of Jerusalem heard the facts
How Joshua performed his acts
 In taking Ai to destroy,
 As he’d done to Jericho’s *joy*
 And its king, so he had done to
 Ai and its king *and his crew*,
 And how dwellers of Gibeon
 Had made peace with Israel *and won*
 And were among them, 2 that they feared
 Greatly, because Gibeon *appeared*
 A great city, a royal one,
 Greater than Ai *said and done*,
 And all men mighty *in its run*.
 3 Therefore Adoni-Zedek king
 Of Jerusalem sent *a thing*
 To Hoham king of Hebron, and
 Piram king of Jarmuth *by hand*,
 And Japhia king of Lachish, and
 Debir king of Eglon, saying

4 “Come up to me and help me, that
 We may attack Gibeon, who sat
 For peace with Joshua and with
 The folk of Israel *not for myth*.”

Who make a contract of peace with the
 crew
 Of Joshua will face the tune and hue
 Of Rome and Mecca united in view
 To turn their gates to pigsties and their
 fields
 To dust and hornets for their faithful yields.
 Who may contract Islam with Joshua
 Will live to see the battlements in awe
 Raised up against cabin and fence and well.
 He’ll hear the half articulated spell
 To sun god, earth goddess and elf and
 sprite
 To further his undignifying plight.
 Beloved, I walk along the razor brink
 And sit down on a granite seat to think
 What slight angels here rise up and what
 sink.

5 Therefore the five Amorite kings,
 The king of Jerusalem’s *springs*,
 The king of Hebron, and the king
 Of Jarmuth, and also the king
 Of Lachish, the king of Eglon,
 Gathered together and were drawn
 Up, they and all their armies, and
 Encamped before Gibeon in band
 And made war against it *at hand*.
 6 And the men of Gibeon sent
 To Joshua and to prevent
 Him at the camp at Gilgal, saying
 “Let not your hand bide servants’ slaying,
 Come quickly to us, save us and
 Help us, for all the kings at hand
 Of Amorites who in the hills
 Live have gathered against our kills.”

You turn to what seems good betrayal by
 The Gibeonites when they came on the sly.
 Now since they are allies the gross attack
 On them gives You the promised, hoped
 for slack
 To justify extermination of
 The Amorites whose kings come hand in
 glove
 To destroy Gibeon. Beloved, I know
 That behind all the glitter and the show

Of politics and slim oppressions glow
Your power and plan hide to appear at last
When the stone can be best and furthest
cast.

I watch the changing rumours and the states
That wax and wane about my china plates
And wonder at the smallness of the rates.

7 So Joshua ascended from
Gilgal, he and all the folk come
For war with him, and all the great
Men of valour. 8 YHWH came to state
To Joshua, "Do not fear them,
For I've set them beneath your hem,
Not one of them shall remain here
To stand before you *without fear*."

9 Joshua therefore by surprise
Came on them, having made the rise
To march all night from Gilgal's *skies*.
10 So YHWH routed them there before
Israel, killed them with a great score
Of slaughter at Gibeon, chased
Them *all* along the way that traced
To Beth Horon, and struck them down
As far as Azekah and *town*
Of Makkedah. 11 It came to pass,
As they fled before Israel's *mass*
And were on the descent of Beth
Horon, that YHWH cast down for death
Large hailstones from the sky on them
As far as Azekah, and then
They died. *And so there were* more who
Died from the hailstones than the crew
Of Israel killed with the sword.

12 Then Joshua spoke to the LORD
YHWH in the day when YHWH delivered
The Amorites *shivered and slivered*
Before the folk of Israel, and
He said in sight of Israel's band,
"Sun, stand still over Gibeon,
And Moon in Vale of Aijalon."

O my Beloved, though I see hail and storm
Flood out upon the earth, the cold and
warm
Hit not the guilty, but innocent poor
While wicked rich sit high and dry and
sure.

The tidal waves, the breaking of the dyke,
Tornadoes coming on the way to strike
The woman and her children in the light
Aluminum home on wheels for a fright

Are not from Your hand, that I see because
They always leave the wicked with sharp
claws.

Return once more, Beloved, with stones of
hail
To trample down the killers, break their
mail
And cleanse the land of those whose hand
is set
Against the poor and struggling in the net.

13 So the sun stood still, and the moon
Stopped, till the people made the doom
Upon their enemies. *Is not*
This written in Jasher's book's plot?
So the sun stood still in the sky,
And did not hasten to *comply*
With going *down* for near a day.
14 And like that there has been no day
Before or after it, that YHWH
Heeded the voice of man, for YHWH
Fought for Israel *under sky-blue*.

The story is a good one, or it was,
Before our science came and lost the cause.
The story of the sun that did not set
Because You held its course with bayonet
Was well designed to show the sun was not
A god at all, or if a god, one taught
By You to travel in its single way
And not depart from it from day to day
Unless You came to intervene and stop
It from its goings till You let it drop.
I do not need the sun to testify
To me, Beloved, that You control the sky.
Instead I pray Your power upon the earth
That Your will rule both poor and men of
worth.

15 Then Joshua returned, and all *the folk*
Of Israel with him, to the *stoke*
Camp at Gilgal. 16 But these five kings
Had fled and hidden in *the wings*
Of a cave at Makkedah's *springs*.
17 And it was told Joshua, saying
"The five kings have been found there
staying
Hidden in cave at Makkedah."

18 So Joshua said "Roll large stones
Against the mouth of the cave's *tones*,
And set men by it there on guard.
19 "And do not stay *there* in retard,

But pursue your enemies, and
Attack their rear *by the command*.
Don't let them go into their cities,
For YHWH your God, *and without pities*,
Has delivered them in your hand."

They say the kings went in the cave to hide,
Or rather not to hide but to abide
Till coming of the Sabbath since the sun
Did no longer indicate when the run
Was ready. Therefore it makes little bun
If we observe the day on one day or
The next. The fallacy of that in spore
Is simply that Israel was never stowed,
But well knew after when the Sabbath
showed

Through times of all the prophets after
Moses
And well along when You, my Beloved,
chose us.
The fallacy speaks for itself when they
Use hiding as excuse to keep Sunday.
Mithra and Tammuz rejoice with ambrosis.

20 It happened when Joshua and
The folk of Israel *joined in band*
Finished the slaying with a great
Slaughter until it came to sate,
That those escaping fled into
Their well-fenced cities from the view.

Ah, my Beloved, Your word presumes the
right
With Joshua, and Your command's to fight.
Lead me, Beloved, along a peaceful road
And do not command me to lift the load
And burden of the sword, bullet and plan
To exterminate any to a man.
Unless Your appointed leader is near
To tell the soldier when to shoot and cheer,
I must fall back on Decalogue with tear
And refrain from the violent-like gear.
I see Your face peer out from glistening
eye
Of friend and enemy, and so know why
The blind wrath overcomes the right reply.
The ways of god-men are abundant queer.

21 The people all returned to camp,
To Joshua and *to revamp*
Makkedah, in peace *from the stew*.
No one moved his tongue anywise

Against any of Israel's guys.
22 Then Joshua said "Open door
Of the cave, and bring out of store
Those five kings to me from the cave."
23 And they did so, and brought those

grave
Five kings to him out of the cave,
Jerusalem's king, and the king
Of Hebron, and of Jarmuth king,
The king of Lachish, *and* the king
Of Eglon. 24 So when they brought out
Those kings to Joshua *in rout*,
That Joshua called all the men
Of Israel, and said *again*
To captains of the men of war
Who went with him *to settle score*,
"Come near, put your feet on the necks
Of these kings *as they shall be wrecks*."
And they drew near and put their feet
On their necks. 25 Then Joshua's bleat
To them was, "Do not be afraid,
Nor be dismayed, be strong, *be made*
Of good courage, for thus shall YHWH
Do to all your enemies' crew
Against whom you shall fight *in due*."
26 And afterward Joshua struck
Them and killed them, and hanged their

truck
On five trees, and they hung there still
On the trees until evening's *fill*.
27 So it was at the time the sun
Was going down Joshua'd done
Commanding them to take them down
From the trees, cast them *from the town*
Into the cave where they had been
Hiding, and laid large stones to screen
The cave's mouth to this very day,
And you can see it on the way.

The great sin of these kings was to go out
And fight pre-emptive battle without doubt
Thinking they were defending old and
young
Women and children from certain death's
tongue.

That excuse to do battle still rings true
To those today who say they follow You
And crucify men in the Middle East
Certain that will take vengeance at the
least.

Beloved, Your light alone that every man
Contains the I-presence of divine span

Can break the cycle of evil in clan.
I pray You light upon the multitude
And on my own revenge plans few and
crude
And lay my head upon Your solitude.

28 On that day Joshua took *that*
City of Makkedah with bat
And struck it and also its king
With the mouth of the sword *and sling*.
He utterly destroyed them, all
The people who *were* in its *stall*.
He left no one to stay at all.
He also made Makkedah's king
Like the king of Jericho's *sting*.

I wonder that the suckling child must feel
The crushing weight of Joshua's stone heel,
And that the servant girl and pregnant dam
Must make fodder for fields of corn and
yam.

Could not one boy be left, a child of eight
To remember father and mother's fate?
The sting of death is something all men
hate,
At least when turned upon their own brown
pate.

Beloved, I open up my city cave
Of inner chamber, hand You sword and
glaive,
And wait the flash and blast my servants
crave.

Slay every evil thought within my breast,
The youngest, most childish along with
best,
And bring me clean and faithful to Your
nest.

29 Then Joshua passed from *that place*
Makkedah, and all Israel's *race*
With him, to Libnah, and they fought
Against Libnah. 30 And YHWH was
brought

Also to give it and its king
Into the hand of Israel's *wing*,
He smote it and all the folk there
With the mouth of the sword *and bare*.
He let none remain, but he did
To the king of that city hid
As he did to Jericho's king.

31 And Joshua went from Libnah's *claim*,
And all Israel with him *for fame*,

To Lachish, and encamped before
It and fought against it's *closed door*.

Poor Libnah was stricken by Your own
hand
Working through Joshua and by command,
And yet I doubt and wonder, were there
there

Any innocent at all who took share
In the destruction? What about the small
Children who were destroyed in the town's
fall?

Do You know, my Beloved, such stories
make

The sweet Christian today decide to take
The holy war to home of innocent
Children, do You know that the Muslim
vent

Of terror falls also upon the ones
Who are innocent of all wicked tonnes
Of oppression and consumption? I find
All about me such violence in kind.

32 And YHWH delivered Lachish *too*
Into the hand of Israel's *crew*,
Who took it on the second day,
And smote it and all the folk's way
Who *were* in it with the mouth of
The sword, according as above
To all that he did to Libnah.

33 Then Horam king of Gezer's *straw*
Came *trundling* up to help Lachish,
And Joshua struck him *and his fish*,
Until he left him none remaining.

34 From Lachish Joshua *uncomplaining*
Passed on to Eglon, all the folk
Of Israel with him, and *in stroke*
Encamped against it and fought there.

35 They took it on that day *to bear*
And struck it with the mouth of sword,
All the folk who *were* in its horde
He utterly destroyed that day,
According to all in his sway
He did to Lachish *on the way*.

36 And Joshua went from Eglon,
All Israel with him, to Hebron,
And they fought against it. 37 And they
Took it and struck it *to the clay*
With the mouth of the sword, its king,
All its cities, and all that sing
Who *were* in it, he left remaining
None, according to all *sustaining*

That he had done to Eglon *too*,
 But utterly destroyed its crew.
 38 Then Joshua returned, and all
 Israel with him, to Debir's *stall*,
 And fought against it. 39 And he took
 It and its king and *every nook*,
 All its cities, they struck them down
 With the mouth of the sword *in town*
 And utterly destroyed the folk
 All who *were* in it *to a bloke*.
 He left remaining none, as he
 Had done to Hebron, so did he
 To Debir and its king, as he
 Had done also to Libnah and
 Its king *and all of the king's band*.

Let me leave none remaining of the band
 Of wicked devices that come to hand
 Each morning in this world of illusion.
 I leave the troubled bow, arrows, and gun.
 Let me slay every plot that comes to mind
 To get back for my own from thrashing
 blind

Men who in their despair fail to seek out
 The light of Your revealing from their
 doubt.

Let me return to dust also the ploy
 That my heart would take up and wield
 with joy
 Against those who doubt not, but seek my
 falling.

I miss their trap abruptly at You calling
 To turn back suddenly and find the gate
 Of Truth massive and still where angels
 wait.

40 So Joshua conquered the land,
 All the mountain country *at hand*
 And the south and the lowland and
 The wilderness slopes, every king,
 He left none *of them* remaining,
 But utterly destroyed what breathed,
 As YHWH God of Israel bequeathed.
 41 And Joshua conquered them from
 Kadesh Barnea as you come
 To Gaza, and all the country
 Of Goshen, as far as the lea
 Of Gibeon. 42 All these kings and
 Their land Joshua took in hand,
 Because YHWH God of Israel fought
 For Israel. 43 Then Joshua thought
 To return, and all Israel too,

To the camp at Gilgal *in view*.

I foray out upon the bleeding sod
 Day by day where I work with holy rod
 To make and destroy what I need in pod.
 Like Joshua and his when evening's come,
 I return to my own gate and the sum
 Of my repentance, praise and petition,
 And make my plaint for one more day
 that's done.

A battle and a larch is my reward
 Upon a hillside, by a lake, no sword
 Upon my belt nor in my hand to wield
 On Canaan divine justice to a field.
 After my quiet victories I yield
 To the retreat and find my hearth and gate
 And lean upon Your heart not to be late.

Week 39 Joshua 11

1 It came to pass, when Jabin king
 Of Hazor had heard *of this thing*,
 That he sent to Jobab the king
 Of Madon, and to Shimron's king,
 To the king of Achshaph, 2 and to
 The kings who *were* from the north *too*,
 In the mountains, in the plain south
 Of Chinneroth, in lowland's *mouth*,
 And in the westward heights of Dor,
 3 To the Canaanites from before
 The east and *also* in the west,
 The Amorite, the Hittite's *best*,
 The Perizzite, the Jebusite
 In the mountains, and the Hivite
 Below Hermon and in the land
 Of Mizpah. 4 They went out *in band*,
 They and all their armies with them,
As many people as the hem
 Of the seashore for multitude
 Has sand, with an enormous brood
 Of horses and with chariots.
 5 And when all these kings *in their ruts*
 Had met together, they came camped
 Together at the waters *stamped*
 Of Merom to do battle there
 Against Israel, *the good and fair*.

Nato was formed to concede to the need
 Of opposing invasion of the creed
 That pretended at least justice for those
 Who were poor and in need of food and
 clothes.

The difference perhaps between then and
now
Is today all are heathen bull and cow
To worship at the altar of the state.
With Joshua there was a side as great
As recognizing You and sovereignty
Of Your power to command our liberty.
Beloved, I wait You at the door and see
The state torture the lovely and with hate
Grind down the helpless while the ruthless
go
On into hiding to escape the show.

6 But YHWH said to Joshua, “Do
Not be afraid of all their crew,
For tomorrow about this time
I’ll deliver all *in their prime*
Slaughtered before Israel *for crime*.
You shall hamstring their horses and
Burn chariots with a fiery brand.”
7 So Joshua and all the folk
Of war with him came *at a stroke*
Against them suddenly beside
Where the waters of Merom *bide*,
And they attacked them. 8 And YHWH
gave
Them in the hand of Israel’s *wave*,
Who defeated them and chased them
To greater Sidon, to the stem
Of the brook Misrephoth, and to
The valley of Mizpah as due
Eastward, and they attacked them till
They left not one remaining *still*.
9 So Joshua did them as YHWH
The blessed Lord had told him to.
He hamstrung their horses and burned
Their chariots with fire *and spurned*.

I do not care a whit for what he did
When Joshua burned chariots amid
The din of battle, though I still deplore
The violence that went along before.
I make appeal to Your words that are law
That none may kill his brother for a flaw.
I understand that horse means power to kill,
But I protest the thing he thought Your
will,
To hamstringing beasts whose hearts were
never meant
To sin against another where they went.
Who has not tongue to tell his pain and
loss,

If he be stallion or rhinoceros,
Still hurts. Beloved, in future mind the
weak
Who have no prayer but that of maw and
beak.

10 Joshua turned back at that time
And took Hazor, and struck its *rhyme*
Of king with the sword, for Hazor
Was once the chief of all that shore.
11 And they struck all the people who
Were in it with the mouth of sword,
Utterly destroying *their crew*.
There was none left breathing *aboard*.
And then he burned Hazor with fire.
12 All the cities of the empire,
And all their kings, Joshua took
And struck with mouth of sword *like hook*.
He utterly destroyed them, as
Moses the servant of YHWH has
Commanded. 13 But *as for* the cities
That stood on their mounds like bandittis,
Israel burned none of them, except
Hazor only, *which* Joshua kept
To be burned. 14 And all of the spoil
Of these cities and livestock’s *toil*,
The folk of Israel took as booty
For themselves, but they struck *with duty*
Every man with the mouth of sword
Until they had destroyed the *gored*,
And they left none breathing *unscored*.

What can I say, Beloved, I am aghast
At tale of slaughter between each repeat.
All’s fair in love and war, and I suggest
That only love and war as a tale’s guest
Will captivate the living crew today,
Just as it caught the ear in roundelay
Three thousand years ago and ever since.
It may be delicacy makes me wince.
If lesson be that You will save the just
Before the armies of immortal dust
And raise Your banner higher for my trust,
Then I set to one side my doubts and fears
And follow wherever Your army steers.
But is there to be no end of the tears?

15 As YHWH’d commanded Moses His
Servant, so Moses in a whiz
Commanded Joshua, and so
Joshua did. He left no show
Undone of all that YHWH’d commanded

Moses. 16 Thus Joshua *remanded*
 Took all this land, the hill country,
 All the south, all of Goshen's *fee*,
 The lowland, and the Jordan plain,
 Mountains of Israel and its drain,
 17 From Mount Halak and the ascent
 To Seir, even to Baal Gad sent
 In the valley of Lebanon
 Below Mount Hermon *under sun*.
 He captured all their kings, and struck
 Them down and killed them *to a duck*.
 18 Joshua made war a long time
 With all those kings *in all that clime*.
 19 There was not a city that made
 Peace with the folk of Israel *stayed*,
 Except the Hivites, who dwelt in
 Gibeon. All *those* they took in
 Battle. 20 For it was of YHWH to
 Harden their hearts, that they should do
 So to come against Israel in
 Battle, that He might fully win,
And that they receive no mercy,
 But be destroyed *down to a tree*,
 As YHWH commanded Moses *free*.

I'm glad You make exception in the
 slaughter,
 Perhaps because of the case of the daughter
 Of Jacob, who was defiled when he caught
 her
 By Shechem the Hivite and by deceit
 Lost his own life without chance to retreat
 As well as all within the city slain.
 You may remember that for lucre's gain
 Those men were circumcised to faith in
 You.
 So they did not receive that time their due.
 By deceit they were cut off from Your
 view,
 And by deceit their descendants survived
 By moldy bread and broken wineskins
 jived.
 Beloved, I cheat You in my rush to be
 One with You, cheat me too of my life free.

21 And at that time Joshua came
 And cut off the Anakim's claim
 From the mountains, from Hebron, from
 Debir, from Anab, and all from
 The mountains of Judah, and from
 All the mountains of Israel,
 Joshua destroyed them full well

With their cities. 22 None of the same
 Were left in the land of the claim
 Of Israel's folk, they remained only
 In Gaza, in Gath, and in lonely
 Ashdod. 23 So Joshua took all
 The land, and according to all
 That YHWH had said to Moses, and
 Joshua gave it as in the hand
 Of Israel according to
 Their divisions by their tribes *true*.
 Then the land rested from the war,
Which had been upon the land sore.

Is it true that war could be stopped for
 good,
 Or at least for a while, as such war should,
 By equally dividing up the land?
 I'd think in forty years such promise grand
 Would result in a vengeance from those
 who
 Gave up a share of land to poor in crew.
 Divide the land, indeed, and give each soul
 Responsibility to dig the coal
 Or hoe the row or cut and replant oak
 And pine, in sum, create peace at a stroke.
 But then remember year of Jubilee,
 That great law that destroys land values'
 fee,
 And makes justice for all society.
 Land cannot truly be owned by decree.

Joshua 12

1 These *are* the kings of the land whom
 The folk of Israel set to doom,
 And whose land they possessed upon
 The other side from Jordan's dawn,
 From the river Arnon to Mount
 Hermon, and all the eastern *fount*
Of Jordan's plain, 2 Sihon the king
 Of the Amorites, who kept spring
 In Heshbon *and* ruled half the land
 Of Gilead, from Aroer,
 Which is on the bank of river
 Arnon, from the middle of that
 River, even as far as sat
 The river Jabbok, *at which sites*
Is the border of Ammonites,
 3 And the eastern Jordan plain from
 The Sea of Chinneroth to come
 As far as Arabah, Salt Sea,
 The road to Beth Jeshimoth's *scree*,
 And southward below Pisgah's slopes.

4 Og king of Bashan *and his hopes*,
 Last of the giants, who lived at
 Ashtaroth and at Edrei *sat*,
 5 And reigned over Mount Hermon, and
 Over Salcah, over the land
 Of Bashan, as far as the line
 Of the Geshurites and the *fine*
 Maachathites, and over the half
 Of Gilead *up to* the staff
 Of Sihon king of Heshbon. 6 These
 Moses the servant at YHWH's *ease*
 And Israel's folk had overcome,
 And Moses servant of YHWH *done*
 Had given it *as* a possession
 To the Reubenites *in accession*,
 The Gadites, and half of the tribe
 Of Manasseh *and to subscribe*.

Sihon king of Amorites on the till,
 Sitting in Heshbon, reckoning and bill,
 And ruling over every plant and shrub
 In half of Gilead, he makes the rub.
 The other half of Gilead remains
 The seat of Og in ivory tooth for stains
 Upon the mount of lechery for gains.
 These two kings crumble, fall down and lie
 still.

Beloved, lust of pleasure and wealth abide
 Not only in Bashan at Gilead's side,
 But wherever the Jordan river flows.
 I turn to find its petticoat that shows
 For shame beneath surplice, mitre and
 crown.

I flee to You from both the heart and town.

7 And these *are* the kings of the land
 Which Joshua at Israel's hand
 Conquered on this side of Jordan,
 On the west, from Baal Gad *by plan*
 In the valley of Lebanon
 As far as Mount Halak and *won*
 The ascent to Seir, which he gave,
 Did Joshua to the tribes *grave*
 Of Israel *and as* a possession
 According to each one's concession,
 8 In the mountain country, and in
 The valleys, in the plains *within*,
 The springs, and in the wilderness,
 And in the south, Hittites' *address*,
 The Amorites, the Canaanites,
 Perizzites, Hivites, Jebusites,
 9 The king of Jericho, for one,

The king of Ai, where *you run*
 Beside Bethel, one, 10 and the king
 Of Jerusalem, one *to spring*,
 The king of Hebron, one, 11 the king
 Of Jarmuth, one, the king found in
 Lachish, one, 12 the king of *the sin*
 Of Eglon, one, king of Gezer,
 For one, 13 and the king of Debir,
 One, the king of Geder, one, 14 and
 The king of all of Hormah's *land*,
 One, the king of Arad, one, 15 and
 The king of Libnah, one, the king
 Of Adullam, one, 16 and the king
 Of Makkedah, one, the king of
 Bethel, one, 17 *also* the king of
 Tappuah, one, the king of Hephher,
 One, 18 the king of Aphek *not deafer*,
 One, the king of Lasharon, one,
 19 Also the king of Madon, one,
 The king of Hazor, one, 20 the king
 Of Shimron Meron, one, the king
 Of Achshaph, one, 21 the king *to reign*
 In Taanach, one, the king of *plain*
 Of Megiddo, one, 22 the king of
 Kedesh, one, *also* the king of
 Jokneam in Carmel, one, 23 and
 The king of Dor in heights *to stand*
 In Dor, one, the king of the folk
 Of Gilgal, one, 24 the king *to stoke*
 Tirzah, one, *so the kings have done*
 All of the kings, *all* thirty-one.

So many kings to rule so small a land!
 How many soldiers in each small king's
 band!

Although it is not posh today to call
 Each little tyrant king, my crystal ball
 Says will to rule another now as then
 Is just as common among modern men.
 Let me, Belovèd, not prevail to rule
 My neighbour nor his labour nor his mule,
 Nor yet myself. I crave instead the hand
 That made me for my will and head's
 command.

One thing alone is sweeter than to be
 The king of all I see, eternally,
 And that is freedom that comes by Your
 yoke.

I tasted liberty, Lord, when You spoke.

Joshua 13

1 Now Joshua was old, advanced

In all the many years *he danced*.
 And YHWH said to him, "You are old,
 Advanced in years, and there's *unsold*
 Remaining much land to be got.
 2 "This is the land still to be got,
 All the land of the Philistines
 And all the Geshurites' *combines*,
 3 "From Sihor, which from Egypt's east,
 As far as the border *at least*
 Of Ekron northward Canaanite,
 The five lords of the Philistines,
 The Gazite, and the Ashdodite,
 The Ashkelonites, the Gittites,
 The Ekronites, and the Avites,
 4 "From the south, all the Canaanites'
 Land, and Mearah that belongs
 To the Sidonians *for wrongs*
 As far as Aphek, to the edge
 Of the land of the Amorites,
 5 "The land of the Geshurites' *hedge*,
 And all Lebanon, toward sunrise,
 From Baal Gad below Hermon's skies
 As far as Hamath's entrance gates,
 6 "All the inhabitants *and states*
 Of the mountains from Lebanon
 As far as the Brook Misrephoth,
And all land of Sidonian,
 Them I will drive out *from their broth*
 Before the folk of Israel,
 Only divide to Israel
 By lot as an inheritance,
 As I've commanded you *to dance*.
 7 "So therefore, divide up this land
 As an inheritance *as planned*
 To the nine tribes and half the tribe
 Of Manasseh, *without a bribe*."

Though Joshua was not like Alexander
 Who took the whole world under as
 commander,
 Still there was something after he got
 through
 To divide up among the winning crew.
 Division of land is the source of all
 Hate and violence under heaven's hall,
 Or almost all, yet You have not yet found
 Expedient to ratify the ground
 With Your approval except in this case.
 The US still is out to lose its face
 As a union of foreign workers who
 Behave badly in the native folk's view.
 Myself, I know ancestors sat in state

As Picts in Carrick. Now I wander late.

8 With the other half tribe received
 The Reubenites and Gadites *beevied*
 Inheritance, which Moses gave,
 Beyond Jordan eastward *a shave*,
 As Moses servant of YHWH gave.
 9 From Aroer upon the bank
 Of the brook Arnon, and the *dank*
 Town that's in midst of the ravine,
 And all the plain *that lies between*
 Of Medeba as far as Dibon,
 10 And all of the cities of Sihon
 The king of the Amorites, who
 Reigned in Heshbon, as far as to
 The border of Ammon's folk and
 11 Gilead, and the borderland
 Of Geshurite and Maachathite,
 All Mount Hermon, and all *in sight*
Of Bashan and up to Salcah,
 12 All the kingdom of Og *by law*
 In Bashan, who reigned in *the place*
Of Ashtoreth and Edrei, who
 Remained of the remnant of true
 Giants, for Moses had defeated
 And cast out these, *so they were treated*.

Moses may peace be on his noble brow
 Got rid of giants and their sons somehow.
 The wars of Og and Bashan relied on
 Ashtoreth's shame from every dawn to
 dawn.

Beloved, I thank Moses in all I do
 That he rids me of giants in my view,
 And with a favoured word points to the
 nest
 Hidden in tree and hollow where they rest,
 So that with flint and bow sharp strung I
 may
 Pierce the heart of the evil in my way.
 What wonders in Your law I find his hand
 Has written to be sung in every land
 Until You alone sit upon the throne
 Of sovereignty over both flesh and stone.

13 Nevertheless the children of
 Israel did not drive out above,
 The Geshurites or Maachathites,
 But Geshurites and Maachathites
 Live to this day by Israelites.
 14 Only to the tribe of Levi
 He gave no inheritance by,

The sacrifice of YHWH God of
Israel made by fire *and by love*
Are their inheritance, as He
Said to them. 15 And Moses gave he
To the tribe of Reuben's folk *an*
Inheritance, families by man.

Let me break in, Beloved, before Reuben
Gets his inheritance of den and glen.
Like Levi my inheritance also
Seems but the right to sacrifice my show.
I have not driven out a tribe to set
My flocks and fields upon their maisonette.
The Indian blood that flowed in veins of
those

Who ate the acorn and planted the rows
Of maize in West Virginia still flows on
In my veins in the sample that is drawn
By the physician who would change my
pace.

I'm not one to drive out any lost race.
Beloved, I trace the plots and wonder
where

The Jew and Palestinian find share.

16 Their territory went out from
Aroer, which on the bank come
From the river Arnon *lies green*,
And the city that's on the scene
Of the river *valley*, and all
The plain by Medeba, in stall
Of 17 Heshbon and all its cities
That *are* in the plain *at their ease*,
Dibon, *and also* Bamoth Baal,
Beth Baal Meon *in for a sale*,
18 Jahaza, Kedemoth, *not last*
Mephaath, 19 Kirjathaim, *at half-mast*
Sibmah, Zereth Shahar upon
The mountain of the valley *drawn*,
20 Beth Peor, and of Pisgah's slopes,
And Beth Jeshimoth *without hopes*,
21 All the plain's cities, kingdom all
Of Sihon Amorite's king's stall,
Who reigned in Heshbon, whom Moses
Smote with Midianite princess,
Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba,
Princes of Sihon whose zareba
Was in the country. 22 Israel's folk
Also killed with the sword *the bloke*
Balaam the son of Beor, who
Was soothsayer, among those who
Were killed by them. 23 The borderline

Of Reuben's folk was the bank brine
Of the Jordan. This *was* the lot
Reuben's folk by their families got,
The cities and their villages.
24 Moses had also given *his*
Inheritance to tribe of Gad,
And to the children of Gad *clad*
According to their families.
25 Their territory was *at ease*
In Jazer, and all the cities
Of Gilead, and half the land
Of the Ammonites far *as land*
Of Aroer, which *is* before
Rabbah, 26 and from Heshbon to *store*
Of Ramath Mizpah and *the town*
Of Betonim, and from *the frown*
Of Mahanaim to borderline
Of Debir, 27 and in valley fine
Of Beth Haram, Beth Nimrah, and
Succoth, and Zaphon, rest *at hand*
Of the kingdom of Sihon king
Of Heshbon, with the Jordan *spring*
As *its* border, as far as edge
Of Sea of Chinnereth *in sedge*,
And on the other side to east
Of the Jordan. 28 This *is* the feast
Of the children of Gad by their
Families, and the cities fair
And their villages. 29 Moses too
Had given *a lot to the few*,
The half tribe of Manasseh's *crew*,
It was for half the tribe of them,
Manasseh's folk, by family hem,
30 Their territory went out from
Mahanaim, all Bashan, *in sum*
All the kingdom of Og the king
Of Bashan, and all the towns' *spring*
Of Jair which are in Bashan, all
Sixty cities, 31 half *of the hall*
Of Gilead, and Ashtaroth
And Edrei, cities of the *wroth*
Kingdom of Og in Bashan, *they*
Were the people of Machir's *sway*,
Who was the son of Manasseh,
For half the children of Machir
According to their families' *peer*.

They killed the prophet. Balaam was a man
Who saw Your visions and proclaimed the
ban
In very words of prophecy, and yet

They killed the prophet who had won the
bet
That heathen tunes and dance and well
turned heels
Could seduce Israel from its ark and keels.
They killed the prophet that raised up the
din
Of dinner music to commit a sin.
They killed the prophet that in rock and roll
Found relevance and numbers in the toll
And got the people out to church at least
To fornicate after the Eucharist.
Beloved, they killed the prophet and I say
Too bad it was no riddance for today.

32 These *are the areas* by which
Moses distributed in switch
Their lot upon Moabite plains
Across from where the Jordan drains,
And by Jericho toward the east.
33 But to the tribe of Levi, *least*,
Moses gave no inheritance,
YHWH God of Israel *was* their chance,
As He said to them *in advance*.

The land upon which I live's not my own,
Like Levite, I am here before Your throne
To get my meal directly from Your hand
Since You have left me without home and
land.
I joy in lilacs blooming by the well,
I chew the plantains that I plant by spell
By scattering the weed seed on the soil
Enriched by generations of the toil
That's not my own or my ancestors' grace.
Though I am without heritage, my place
Upon the earth is bound in song and dance
Beneath Your hand, protected from the
lance
That pierces to the quick so many hearts
That struggle without horses, without carts.

Joshua 14

1 These *are* what came as heritage
To Israel's folk in pasturage
Of Canaan, which Eleazar priest,
Joshua son of Nun *at least*,
And the heads of the fathers of
The tribes of Israel's folk *for love*
Gave out as an inheritance
To *all of them for song and dance*.
2 Their inheritance *was* by lot,

As YHWH commanded by the plot
Of Moses, for the nine tribes and
The half tribe. 3 For Moses in hand
Gave heritage to the two tribes
And the half tribe *and without bribes*
On the other side of Jordan,
But to the Levites *to a man*
He gave no plot for their own *span*.
4 And the children of Joseph were
Two tribes, Manasseh to confer
With Ephraim. And they gave no
Part to the Levites of land's show,
Except cities where they might live,
With their lands in common to give
Sustenance to their wealth and flocks.
5 As YHWH commanded Moses' *stocks*,
So the folk of Israel did, and
They *fairly* divided the land.

Back to Peleg the first it seems that man
Has been dividing up the land by plan.
Like birds and beasts the families spread
out
To claim their territories with a shout.
Each species has its own way on the earth,
But humans are more complex from their
birth,
As some do not care for the land at all,
But answer to the eager siren call
Of city and of pleasure banquet-hall.
Beloved, I find Your heart upon the land,
And see Your grace illuminate the band
Of orchard, field and plain, the forest stand.
And yet the glint of mica brought to bear
In market cobblestone shows You are there.

6 And the children of Judah came
To Joshua in Gilgal's *claim*.
And Caleb son of Jephunneh
The Kenizzite said to the jay,
"You know the word which YHWH said to
Moses God's man concerning you
And me in Kadesh Barnea.
7 "I *was* forty years old *in awe*
When Moses the servant of YHWH
Sent me from Kadesh Barnea
To spy out *all* the land *with you*,
And I brought back word to him what
Was in my heart *not to be shut*.
8 "But my brothers who went along
With me made the heart of the strong
To melt, but I wholly to plod

Followed YHWH *my King and my God*.
 9 “Moses swore on that day, saying
 ‘Surely the land where your foot’s swing
 Has trodden shall be your own plot
 And your children’s forever lot,
 Because you have wholly followed
 YHWH my Alohim *where He showed.*’
 10 “And now, indeed, YHWH has kept me
 Alive, as He said these in fee
 Forty-five years, ever since YHWH
 Spoke this word to Moses *and crew*
 While Israel wandered in the wild,
 And now, here I am this day’s child,
 Eighty-five years old *unbeguiled.*
 11 “As yet I’m *as strong* on this day
 As on the day Moses that way
 Sent me, just as my strength *was then*,
 So now’s my strength for war *with men*,
 For going out and in again.
 12 “Now therefore, give me this mountain
 Of which YHWH spoke in that day then,
 For you heard in that day how they
 The Anakim *were there in sway*,
 And the cities *were great and fenced*.
 It may be YHWH *has recompensed*
 Me, and I can drive them out now
 As YHWH promised me anyhow.”
 13 And Joshua blessed him, and gave
 Hebron to Caleb the son *grave*
 Of Jephunneh as heritage.
 14 Hebron therefore became the page
 And lot of Caleb who was son
 Of Jephunneh Kenizzite won
 To this day, because he wholly
 Followed YHWH God of Israel’s *tree*.
 15 And the name of Hebron before
 Was Kirjath Arba, in great store
 Was *Arba* among Anakim.
 Then the land had rest from war’s *scream*.

When I am old let me like Caleb come
 To choose the greater challenge on the
 sun,
 A land unconquered by the young and
 brave,
 A wilderness of task for free, not slave,
 To step out beyond settlement and store
 And find in that expanse the gracious door
 To Your heart, my Beloved, beneath the
 sun.
 When I’m old let me walk who cannot run

Up mountains filled with dangers and the
 breeze
 Of leagues of empty tundra. Give no ease
 To potter with my laurels, read the words
 I wrote a decade past, follow the birds
 From my couch, only dreaming of the time
 When life was battle, march and mountain
 climb.

Week 40 Joshua 15

1 So *this* was the lot of the tribe
 Of Judah’s children to describe
 In families *of their own line*,
 The border of Edom *to shine*
 At the desert of Zin southward,
 The southern boundary of their sward.
 2 And their southern border began
 At the shore of the Salt Sea’s *scan*,
 From the bay that faces southward.
 3 Then it went out the southern side
 Of the slopes of Akkrabbim, passed
 Along to Zin, ascended *last*
 On Kadesh Barnea’s south side,
 Passed along to Hezron to ride
 Up to Adar, and went around
 To Karkaa. 4 *From there* it was found
 Toward Azmon and went out to
 The stream of Egypt, and the due
 Border ended at the sea. This
 Shall be your southern border’s *kiss*.

From thorny desert and the houses where
 The scorpions flicker upon earth bare
 I turn my gaze, diverted from the line
 That binds my feet at southern step and
 sign
 To see the maple loam about the cape
 Of glories fashioned in both light and
 shape.
 The desert dance upon the naked floor
 Binds soul on earth to heaven and its shore.
 Beloved, I touch the polished, glistening
 sand
 And turn and turn again and come to stand
 Where angels invisibly raise a hand
 Against the northwinds, southwinds in their
 scope.
 Once liberated from both steel and hope
 I climb instead of flounder at the rope.

5 The east border *was* the Salt Sea
 As far as mouth of Jordan’s *lea*.

And the border on the north side
Began at the bay of the tide
At the mouth of Jordan *astride*.

6 Up to Beth Hoglah went the line,
Passed north of Beth Arabah *fine*,
And the border went up the stone
Of Bohan, son of Reuben *grown*.

7 Then the border went up toward
Debir from the valley's *accord*
Of Achor, and it turned northward
Toward Gilgal, which *is* before
The slopes of Adummim *in store*,
On the south of the valley's *floor*.

The border went toward the stream
Of En Shemesh and ended dream
At En Rogel. 8 The border went
Up by the valley of the *bent*
Son of Hinnom to the south slope
Of the Jebusite *city's hope*
Which *is* Jerusalem. The line
Went up to the top of the fine
Mountain that *lies* before the vale
Of Hinnom westward to the dale
End of Rephaim in north *sail*.

9 Then the border went all around
From the top of the hill to ground
Of fountain of the water of
Nephtoah to extend *in shove*
To the cities of Mount Ephron.
And the border went around on
To Baalah, which *is* Kirjath Jearim.

10 Then the border turned *not to fear them*
Westward from Baalah to Mount Seir,
Passed along to the side of *sheer*
Mount Jearim on the north whose name
Chesalon, went down *in its fame*
To Beth Shemesh and Timnah's soil.

11 And the border went out to spoil
The side of Ekron northward, then
The border went around *again*
To Shicron, passed along to Mount
Baalah, extending to *the fount*
Of Jabneel to end at the sea.

12 The west border *was* the Great Sea
Along its coasts. This *is* the line
In boundary of Judah's folk *fine*
All around according to all
Their families *for barn and stall*.

Beth Arabah is glowing in the light
Of the first lowering of the blessed night.
Its warp and woof stretch out upon the sand

And promise shapes as well as shadowland
In colours purpled, riven red in hue.

Arabah's house is drenched with evening
dew.

Guarantor of faith, vaucher of desire,
I hear the answerer answer in fire.
Beloved, as I whirl all about the fields
Of Canaan and of Paradise, their yields
Seem scant beneath the bound and scuffle
that

My bare feet make upon the stony flat,
The fine dust raised to scintillate and hover
Above the hill, beneath the mountain cover.

13 And to Caleb *who was* the son
Of Jephunneh he gave the won
Lot among Judah's children's part,
According to command of YHWH
To Joshua, *that is, the view*
From Kirjath Arba, in Hebron,
And Anak was of *Arba* son.

14 And Caleb drove from there three sons
Of Anak from there, Sheshai's *buns*,
Ahiman, and Talmi, who were
Children of Anak, *every fer*.

My marble gift to my ploughmen I find
As sons of Arba drawn out with the blind
To make room for the noble Caleb on
The hills of Judah in the sprinkling dawn.
According to Your own command I see
The hills march on, eternal wonderfully,
And yet submitted to the heel and fee
Of mortal man, and one too old to be
Much longer in their scope's vitality.
Why not instead give men to hills in pledge
To be their possession to the sea's edge?
Perhaps You would not wish to see hills
weep
To lose their property in death to keep.
Wake up the hills, Beloved, don't let them
sleep.

15 Then he went up from there into
The dwellers of Debir *in crew*,
Before the name of Debir was
Kirjath Sepher *with page and paws*.
16 And Caleb said "He who attacks
Kirjath Sepher and *with ransacks*
Captures it, to him I will give
Achshai my daughter, wife *to live*."

Is Caleb's daughter sack of flour to trade
 For valiant deed in Canaan's masquerade?
 I'd think a daughter might rebel at such
 And fail to respond to her husband's touch.
 I'd think a daughter would prefer to choose
 Her own man from the store of youthful
 clues.

The truth is she was brave and bold a girl
 And had her ways of getting desired pearl.
 The story must not mention her intrigue
 With secret boyfriend to make out a league
 That he should prove himself her father's
 choice

While she pretended a demure invoice.
 Beloved, I also in my intrigues fail
 Not to choose You, choose me beyond the
 veil.

17 So Othniel son of Kenaz,
 Brother of Caleb *with his snazz*,
 Captured it, and he gave to him
 Daughter Achsah as wife *in trim*.

Maybe Achsah was as a wife too hard
 For any other to accept as pard.
 Her name means anklet, which might bring
 to mind

A chain around the ankle and to bind
 Rather in domineering than resigned
 To tinkling music. Achsah's also snake
 As well as brazen trinket to a rake.
 Anyone would think twice before that card.
 Her father knew only a man who could
 Raze Canaanite could tame that tangled
 wood.

In any case the marriage was the best
 From Arab view to take into the nest
 A cousin parallel to keep the name
 Of father and his brother without shame.

18 It came to pass, that when she came,
 She got him to ask for a claim
 From her father and for a field.
 She got down from donkey well heeled
 And Caleb said to her "What's up?"

19 She answered, "Give a blessing *cup*
 To me, since you have given me
 Land in the south, give me *freely*
 Also springs of water *for glee*."
 So he gave her the upper springs
 And lower springs *where water sings*.

I said the dame was brave, now see her go
 Demanding more than her share of the
 flow.

Now as then everything is up for asking
 And given to the one who is not basking.
 It does not do to be shy on the road,
 One has to cast about and lift the load.
 The cup of water's always needed when
 The desert rises from the dawn on men.
 Beloved, I come to You to ask a sip
 Of the eternal nectar at the lip
 And from an alabaster cup to find
 The ecstasies of the well-prayed and wined.
 If I am bold or shy, don't lift an eye
 Lash at my coming to You on the sly.

20 This *was* inheritance of tribe
 Of Judah's children to *inscribe*
 According to their families,
 21 The cities at the boundaries
 Of the tribe of Judah's sons at
 Edom's border in the south sat
 As Kabzeel, Eder, Jagur, *and*
 22 Kinah, Dimonah, *and the land*
Of Adadah, 23 Kedesh, Hazor,
 Ithnan, 24 Ziph, Telem, and one more
 Bealoth, 25 Hazor, Hadattah, for
 Kerioth, Hezron, that's Hazor,
 26 Amam, Shema, Moladah, 27 Hazar
 Gaddah, Heshmon, *a place to graze her*,
 Beth Pelet, 28 Hazar Shual, and
 Beer Sheba, Bizjathjah, 29 a stand
 In Baalah, Ijim, Ezem, 30 and
 Eltolad, Chesil, Hormah too,
 31 Ziklag, Madmannah, Sansannah,
 32 Lebaoth, Shilhim, Ain, and *crew*
Of Rimmon, all the cities *are*
 Twenty-nine, with their villages.
 33 In the river valley with fizz,
 Eshtaol, Zorah, Ashnah *not fewer*,
 34 Zanoah, En Gannim, Tappuah,
 Enam, 35 Jarmuth, Adullam, Socoh,
 Azekah, 36 Sharaim *with choker*,
 Adithaim, Gederah, and
 Gederothaim, *two in hand*,
 Fourteen cities with villages,
 37 Zenan, Hadashah, *and the whiz*
Of Migdal Gad, 38 Dilean, *and*
 Mizpah, Joktheel, 39 and Lachish *fanned*,
 Bozkath, Eglon, 40 Cabbon, Lahmas,
 Kithlish, 41 Gederoth, *and the crass*
 Beth Dagon, Naamah, and Makkedah,

Sixteen cities, villages *fed her*,
 42 Libnah, Ether, Ashan, 43 Jiphtah,
 Ashnah, Nezib, 44 *at last* Keilah,
 Achzib, and Mareshah, nine cities
 With their villages *and their witties*,
 45 Ekron, with its towns and burroughs,
 46 From Ekron to the sea *furrows*,
 All that *was* near Ashdod, with their
 Villages, 47 Ashdod with its *fair*
 Towns and villages, Gaza and
 Its towns and villages that stand
 As far as Egypt's river strand
 And the Great Sea with *all its* land.

Whoever heard of city with the name
 Of Kabzeel for its honour and its fame?
 Not I till now, and yet I know the word
 Means Assembly of God, and so has stirred
 Some righteous men and women on the lot
 To name their church Kabzeel and in the
 plot

Translate it to the Queen's English if not
 American in *lingua franca's* slot.
 Beloved, this is no church for me although
 It bears Your epithet, I am too slow
 To be burnt twice or is it on the go
 Now thrice by congregations' undertow.
 Beloved, a lone dervish and without crowd
 I come to this place where I've only bowed.

48 And in the mountains Shamir, and
 Jattir, Sochoh, 49 Dannah, Kirjath
 Sannah which *is* Debir *for wrath*,
 50 Anab, Eshtemoh, Anim, 51 Goshen,
 Holon, and Giloh *without ocean*,
 Eleven cities with their *cats*,
 52 Arab, Dumah, Eshean's *flats*,
 53 Janum, Beth Tappuah *in hand*,
 Aphekah, 54 Humtah, *and the land*
Of Kirjath Arba, that's Hebron,
 And Zior, nine cities *when done*
 With their villages *by the tonne*,
 55 Maon, Carmel, Ziph, Juttah, 56 Jezreel,
 Jokdeam, Zanoah, 57 Kain, *the feel*
Of Gibeah, and Timnah, ten
 Cities with their villages' *glen*,
 58 Halhul, Beth Zur, Gedor, 59 Maarath,
 Beth Anoth, and Eltekon's *path*,
 Six cities with their villages,
 60 Kirjath Baal, the place that is
 Also Kirjath Jearim, one more,
 Rabbah, two cities with the shore.

61 In the wilderness, Beth Arabah,
 Middin, Secacah, 62 Nibshan's *robber*,
 The city of salt, and En Gedi,
 Six cities with villages *ready*.
 63 As for the Jebusites who dwell
 In Jerusalem *in their shell*,
 Judah's folk could not drive them out,
 But the Jebusites live about
 With Judah's children in the town
 Of Jerusalem *for renown*
 And to this very day adown.

On Shamir's mount of flint I find the thorn
 And thistle too much on bough to be borne.
 And so I turn to judgement and the town
 Of thornbush bramble to weigh down my
 crown.

It all comes back to Debir in a word
 Until I realize what has occurred.
 The north like south is edged with cutting
 line

To prevent foot from merging with the
 vine.

Beloved, I turn about and whirl to hear
 The whizzing of Your voice about my ear
 And see the north meet south with joy and
 fear.

Beloved, I turn about and stay my step
 To find myself still dancing and with pep
 Without need of a sacrifice or rep.

Joshua 16

1 The lot fell to the children of
 Joseph from the Jordan *above*,
 By Jericho, to waters of
 Jericho on the east, and to
 The desert up from Jericho
 Through the mountains to Bethel's view,
 2 Then out from Bethel to Luz go
 Passing along the border of
 The Archites at Ataroth's *glove*,
 3 Down westward to the boundary
 Of Japhletites' *extremity*,
 Into the coast of Beth Horon
 Below and to Gezer *at dawn*,
 And there it ended at the sea.
 4 So all the children of Joseph,
 Manasseh and Ephraim *in feoff*,
 Took their inheritance *to be*.

Joseph was lucky in the part he got
 Since Jericho and all surrounding plot

Had been swept clean of idolatrous lot
 As soon as Joshua came into sight.
 Joseph's sons did not face renewing fight
 With murdering robber and the Canaanite.
 You are the hand behind blind luck, I
 know,
 And I have seen before how Joseph's show
 Was given double in the blessing glow.
 Beloved, let me live by the shining palms
 Of Jericho tranquilly singing Psalms.
 Any other place must be filled with qualms.
 And yet when I passed there, I could not
 stop
 Israeli car before the Arab prop.

5 The border of Ephraim's folk was,
 According to their families' *laws*,
 The border of inheritance
 On the east side had come to dance
 At Ataroth Addar as far
 As Beth Horon above *the star*.
 6 And the border went out toward
 The sea at Michmethath's north board,
 And the border went round to east
 To Taanath Shiloh, and increased
 By it to east of Janohah.
 7 Then it went down from Janohah
 To Ataroth and Naarah, reached
 To Jericho, and *unimpeached*
 Came out at the *river* Jordan.
 8 The border went out *as by plan*
 From Tappuah westward to *man*
 The brook Kanah, and ended at
 The sea. This was the plot *where sat*
 The tribe of Ephraim's folk by their
 Families *each one in its share*.
 9 The separated cities for
 The children of Ephraim *in store*
Were among the inheritance
 Of Manasseh's folk's *song and dance*,
 All cities with suburbs *askance*.
 10 And they did not drive out the folk
 Of Canaan who lived *at the oak*
 In Gezer, but the Canaanites
 Live there among the Ephraimites
 To this day and they have become
 Servants in tribute to their sum.

The brook Kanah, the happy, reedy brook
 Presents its bed to everyone to look
 For stock to make a whistle or a flute

So that the heart song need not be one
 mute.
 The brook Kanah lifts up upon the breeze
 The green and golden fronds of reeds at
 ease
 And whispers to both earth and sky and
 trees
 The names of its beloved, the silver names.
 Beloved, I bear my flute from its domains,
 Away from mother waters and her claims
 To dry desert, away from lulling rains.
 The lamentations of my reedy heart
 Caught in this world and veil come once
 and start
 To chaff beneath the sore and bloody dart.

Joshua 17

1 There was also a lot for tribe
 Of Manasseh, one to describe
 As firstborn of Joseph, *namely*
 For Machir Manasseh's firstborn,
 The father of Gilead sworn,
 Because he was a fer manly,
 Therefore to him was Gilead
 And Bashan, *a land not so bad*.
 2 And there was *a lot* for the rest
 Of Manasseh's folk in the best
 Of families, for children of
 Abiezer, the children of
 Helek, the children of Asriel,
 The children of Shechem *to spoil*,
 The children of Hephher, the folk
 Of Shemida *down to a bloke*,
 These *were* the sons of Manasseh
 The son of Joseph in the way
 Of all their families *at play*.
 3 But Zelophehad who was son
 Of Hephher, of Gilead begun,
 The son of Machir, who was son
 Of Manasseh, he had no son,
 But only daughters. And these *are*
 The names of his daughters *in star*,
 Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah,
 And Tirzah. 4 They to Eleazar
 Came near, he was the priest *for law*,
 Before Joshua son of Nun,
 And before the rulers *begun*,
 Saying "YHWH commanded Moses
 To give us inheritance' *bliss*
 Among our brothers." Therefore, by
 The commandment of YHWH *in sky*,
 He gave them an inheritance

Among their father's brothers' *stance*.
5 Ten shares to Manasseh, beside
The land of Gilead beside
Bashan, upon the other side
Of the Jordan, 6 because the daughters
Of Manasseh received *as wroughters*
Inheritance among his sons,
And the rest of Manasseh's sons
Had the land of Gilead's *runs*.

The Bible keeps on harping at the fact
That You and Moses were just in the act,
And Joshua after him in the pact
To give Manasseh's daughters land and
flood
To feed their cattle on the fertile mud.
Since then everybody gets in the act
And proclaims special virtue of nut cracked
When any time a woman gets her share
Of wealth and health and beauty fair and
square.
I praise You, my Beloved, at least that You,
For all Your male pronouns and all the
crew
Of neuter angels soaring on the wing,
Are feminist from exodus's sting.
Beloved, come out and take a bow and
sing.

7 And the coast of Manasseh was
From Asher to Michmethath's *claws*,
That *lies* before Shechem *on east*,
And the border went *and increased*
Along the south to where they dwell
In En Tappuah *without shell*.
8 Manasseh had Tappuah's land,
But Tappuah on coast at hand
Of Manasseh *was* to the folk
Of Ephraim *given at a stroke*.
9 And the border went down into
The brook Kanah, and southward to
The brook. These cities of Ephraim
Are among Manasseh's towns' *hem*.
The border of Manasseh *was*
On the north side of the brook's *claws*,
And ended at the sea *to pause*.

Manasseh is most fortunate, I swear,
To have the land of apples and to wear
The apple spring like flowers in her hair!
Beloved, I too live on a land as fair
As that southland with apples and the pear,

Though found below the tundra and the
sight
Of ice as soon as summer loses light.
The spring above my apple trees runs slight
Among the iris swords beside the trees
That sometimes bear fruit when the
mayflies, bees
Inhabit the return of April's breeze.
Manasseh is a happy boy to find
The spring and land of apples when he's
kind
To roving smells about the heart and knees.

10 Southward *it was* Ephraim's, and
Northward *it was* Manasseh's *land*,
And the sea was its border *band*.
They joined Asher on the north side
And Issachar upon the east.
11 And in Issachar and *the feast*
Of Asher, Manasseh had Beth
Shean and its suburbs, and *the breath*
Of Ibleam and its towns *too*,
The inhabitants of Dor's crew,
And of En Dor and its towns *too*,
Inhabitants of Taanach and
Its suburbs, and inhabitants
Of Megiddo and *the entrance*
Of its towns, the three regions tall.
12 Yet the folk of Manasseh *small*
Could not drive out those cities' *wall*,
But Canaanites were holding fast
To live in that land *to the last*.
13 And it came to pass, when the folk
Israel grew strong *as an oak*,
They put the Canaanites in stock
Of servitude upon the block,
But did not drive them out *of stall*.

Some live in En Tappuah to the south
Filled with sweet apples, paunch as well as
mouth.
If I could choose again my hearth and
home,
I might take instead of Paris or Rome
The spring of apples in the south to wear
A warming breeze about my thinning hair.
Where I live now, though at the threshold
gate
Of Paradise where You each morning wait,
The morning is a dark and cold snow bath
Four months of the year at my back door
path.

Beloved, whether in zephyrs kind and light,
Or in the frozen crackling of the night,
My heart restores its song where You
appear
To track the desert sand or the snow gear.

14 And then the folk of Joseph spoke
To Joshua, saying *in stroke*
“Why have you given us one lot
And one share to inherit *spot*,
Since we’re a great people, and since
YHWH’s blessed us until now *like*
prince?”

15 And Joshua answered their talk,
“If you’re a great people, don’t balk,
Go up to the woods, clear a place
For yourself there before the face
Of Perizzites and giants’ race,
If Ephraim’s hills are narrow trace.”

Since I’m twice as articulate as those
Green pastors in so many Baptist rows,
Like Joseph I demand a pulpit where
The flock can enjoy or buy of my ware.
But none is opened to me, so I stare
At the unclimbed hills and the wilderness
And go out armed to face the false address
With proclamations of Your name no less.
Beloved, I thrill to find the bracing wind
Against my face upon the heights undinned
By music other than the sharp cry of
The bird of prey without a wrist or glove.
There’s still space to claim acreage where
the sun
Shines through the summer nights when
winter’s won.

16 And the children of Joseph said
“The mountain country is not spread
Enough for us, all Canaanites
Who live in the valley land sights
Have chariots of iron, *both they*
Who are of Beth Shean and way
Of its towns and *they who are* in
The vale of Jezreel *for sin.*”
17 And Joshua spoke to Joseph’s house,
To Ephraim and Manasseh, spouse
And all saying “You *are* a great
People and have great power *of late*,
You shall not have *only* one lot,
18 “But the mountain shall be your plot.
For it *is* wooded, and you’ll cut

It down, and its farthest abut
Shall be yours, for you shall drive out
The Canaanites, though they be stout
With iron chariots *all about.*”

Ah, Joseph was not content after all
To rest beside the Jordan by the pall
Of Jericho’s ancient and fallen wall.
When I think well, it’s no surprise to me
That Ephraim and Manasseh’d be free
To roam upon the mountain with an axe
To bear the cedar’s odours on their backs.
So Joseph was not content with the call.
Beloved, though I am not a nation nor
A double tribe to set foot in Your door,
Give me too mountains where to breathe
my name
With nostrils lifted to the wind’s acclaim.
Then I like Joseph will return to dance
A ring around the Jordan at a glance.

Week 41 Joshua 18

1 And the whole congregation of
The children of Israel *above*
Gathered together at Shiloh,
And set up meeting tent to show
The land was subdued, every foe.
2 And there remained among the folk
Of Israel seven tribes *bespoke*
Which had not yet received their share.
3 And Joshua said in a blare
To the children of Israel there,
“How long will you neglect to go
And take the land that YHWH’d bestow,
The God of your fathers [ancestors] in tow
Has given you? 4 “Pick out among
You three men for *each* tribe *unstrung*,
And I will send them, they shall rise
And go through the land, with their eyes
Survey it for inheritance,
And come *back* to me *with good sense*.
5 “And they’ll divide in seven shares.
Judah shall remain in their terres
On the south, and Joseph’s house stay
In their land in the northern way.
6 “You shall therefore *come* to survey
The land in seven parts and bring
Report here to me, that I may
Cast lots for you here before YHWH
Our God *who gives the land to you*.
7 “But the Levites, they have no part
Among you, for the priesthood art

Of YHWH *is* their inheritance.
And Gad *and* Reuben, in advance
Half the tribe of Manasseh got
Beyond Jordan an eastern plot,
Which Moses the servant of YHWH
Gave them.” 8 The men arose *in crew*
To go away, and Joshua charged
Them who went to survey *enlarged*
The land, saying “Go, *and* walk through
The land, describe it, come back to
Me, that I may cast lots for you
Here in Shiloh and before YHWH.”

Three men for every tribe of seven in all
Make twenty-one recruits to hear the call
And tramp around Canaan’s land for a ball
To spy it out and tell the wherewithall.
And any of the twenty-one who might
Be tempted to disdain the land for spite
Or say that they were too weak for the fight
Would remember the twelve who went
before
To lose the life of ten on sandy shore
Of Sinai’s valley somewhere near the door
Back to Egypt. Beloved, You take three
men
Of each so that two cannot agree then
To sabotage invasion’s purple grate.
So today soldiers are pushed to their fate.

9 And the men went, and they passed
through
The land, and described it in view
Writ in a book in seven parts
By cities, and they came *like darts*
To Joshua at the Shiloh camp.
10 Then Joshua cast lots *to revamp*
For them in Shiloh before YHWH,
And there Joshua to the crew
Of Israel divided the land
According to their every band.

The number seven here is better than
The number twelve that once came in to
span
The heart with fear, the mind with doubt in
plan.
Seven lots for seven trots round the hills
fall down.
The twelve tribes failed because the fear of
ten

Knocked out the wind from Red Sea’s sails
again
And taught treason to Israel’s battlement
Ready to return to Egyptian town.
Not so, Beloved, when seven draw at
straws
To see who will fight first with teeth and
claws
To gain possession of the land in paws,
The twenty-one dance well across the
stone.
I too, Beloved, whirl in sight of Your
throne
With naught better than throw the dog a
bone.

11 And the lot of the tribe of folk
Of Benjamin came *to a bloke*
According to their families’ *stroke*,
And the land of their lot came out
Between Judah’s folk and the *stout*
Children of Joseph. 12 Their land line
On the north side began *to shine*
At the Jordan, and the land line
Went up to Jericho upon
The north, and went up *against dawn*
Through the hills westward, ending at
The desert where Beth Aven sat.

Ah, Beth Aven, that is the famous place
Of sorrow, grief and trouble to the race
Of manly men upon a spool of thread,
Where wealth and wickedness have evil
bred.

A desert to the wall on every side
Where righteous men and women would
abide,

The one to thread the needle and to chide
The other for his virile, potent face.
Beloved, I meet the desert on the shore
Of woodlands covering rock-strewn hill,
and moor

Above the tree line, where the ptarmigan
Fails not in sun to live where’er she can.
Beloved, I meet the desert with a howl
Of hopeless joy for having lost my towel.

13 The border went over from there
Toward Luz, to the side of where
Luz was, which *is* Bethel southward,
And the border went down toward
Ataroth Addar, near the hill

That *lies* on the south side and still
 Below Beth Horon. 14 Then the line
 Was drawn around the west side *fine*
 To the south, from the hill that *lies*
 Before Beth Horon's southern *rise*,
 Ending at Kirjath Baal, which *is*
 Kirjath Jearim, city of his,
 Of Judah's *folk*. This *was* the west.
 15 The south quarter *started the best*
 From the end of Kirjath Jearim,
 And the border extended trim
 On the west and went out to draw
 The water spring of Nephtoah.

The springs of Fatihah give waters cool
 To every saint and sinner, sage and fool.
 The seven companies that bear the pool
 By lot take gambling for a holy tool.
 I hazard a guess and spin out to find
 How every eye that sees You becomes
 blind
 With love without hope and without a tear
 To trade in time for a self-righteous fear.
 Beloved, I come today and every day
 To sip the Fatihah in my own way
 And go out with the tribes to dance and
 play.

The water of the Torah cold as ice
 And hot as melted copper in a trice
 Turns Fatihah to wine, forbidden tray.

16 Then the border came to the end
 Of the mountain that *would extend*
 Before the vale of Hinnom's son,
 In the valley of Rephaim
 On the north, went down once begun
 To valley of Hinnom *for trim*,
 To the side of the Jebusite
 City on the south, and *in right*
 Went down to En Rogel. 17 And it
 Went around from the north *and fit*,
 Went out to En Shemesh, up toward
 Geliloth, which is before sward
 Of Adummim, and went down to
 The stone of Bohan who was due
 Son of Reuben. 18 And passed along
 Toward the north side *for a song*
 Of Arabah, and went down to
 Arabah. 19 And the border *true*
 Passed along to the north side of
 Beth Hoglah, then the line *above*
 Ended at the north bay upon

The Salt Sea, at the south end drawn
 Of Jordan. This *was* the south line.
 20 The Jordan was its borderline
 On the east side. This *was* the lot
 Of Benjamin's folk, by the plot
 Of its boundaries all around,
 According to their families *found*.

I come to Arabah again and smile
 To see the holy city from a mile
 Away. Upon the overlook I stand
 And through my dream of stinging desert
 sand

I see its minarets shining and bold
 Above the glistening, the street of gold.
 The perfumes of its banners still unfold
 Their odours through my sleep of tired
 care.

Beloved, I tell You now, Beloved, beware
 The pilgrim feet that trample on the stair
 Though only in the dreams that make the
 round

Of my continued dance upon the ground
 Of slumber. Beloved, search, I may be
 found

Riding neither on stallion nor on mare.

21 And the cities of the tribe of
 The children of Benjamin's *love*,
 According to their families,
 Were Jericho, Beth Hoglah's *lees*,
 Emek Keziz, 22 Beth Arabah,
 Zemaraim, Bethel, 23 and Parah,
 Avim, Ophrah, 24 Chephar *not last*
 Haammoni, Ophni, and *the fast*
 Gaba, twelve cities with their towns,
 25 Gibeon, Ramah, Beeroth *downs*,
 26 Mizpah, Chephirah, Mozah, 27 *and*
 Rekem, Irpeel, Taralah's *band*,
 28 Zelah, Eleph, Jebus which *is*
 Jerusalem, Gibeath's *whiz*,
 And Kirjath, fourteen cities *all*
 With their villages *in the stall*.
 This was the lot drawn by the folk
 Of Benjamin by families' *stroke*.

Look, my Beloved, how sweetly I succeed
 In following the modern trend to seed!
 Why do so many translators today
 Transliterate the place names in the way,
 And yet hide Ali's name that rises up
 Three times at least with alabaster cup?

Emek indeed! Even old Tyndale knew
To call Emek a valley to the crew
Of ploughboys learning holy writ from
You.

But no one is so brave to stay the train
To give the whole translation clear and
plain.

Emek Keziz means nothing more nor less
Than valley of a meatloaf and to dress
With woollen gravy in God's house to
guess.

Joshua 19

1 The second lot came out for man
Of Simeon, and for the *plan*
Of the tribe of Simeon's folk
According to their families' *cloak*.
And their inheritance was in
The plot of Judah's folk *and bin*.
2 They had in their inheritance
Beer Sheba and Sheba *to dance*,
Moladah, 3 Hazar Shual, and
Balah, Ezem, 4 Eltolad's *sand*,
Bethul, Hormah, 5 Ziklag, *and fast*
Beth Marcaboth, *and still not last*
Hazar Susah, 6 Beth Lebaoth,
And Sharuhen, thirteen not loath
Cities and their villages *found*,
7 Ain, Rimmon, Ether, *and the ground*
Of Ashan, four cities and their
Villages, 8 and all of the *fair*
Villages that *were* all around
These cities as far as is found
Baalath Beer, Ramah to south.
This was the inheritance' *mouth*
Of the tribe of the children of
Simeon by families' *love*.
9 The plot of Simeon's children's share
Was in slot of Judah's folk's care,
For the share of Judah's folk was
Too much for them *to till its fuzz*.
Therefore the folk of Simeon
Had *their* plot in their share when done.

Though for crimes or good deeds Simeon
gloats

Without place among Israel's parade floats,
He has to live somewhere like dog or louse,
And so gets a back room in Judah's house.
The wrathful Simeon who took issue with
The Shechemites because of Hivite myth
Is a man after my own heart, I swear,

If my sister Dinah had had a share
Of pedophilic goosing, then beware,
I too might have brought circumcision out
And cut nine inches from the wicked spout.
Give Simeon a palace in the land
Of Judah for the way he carried, planned
Out with a vicious and victorious hand.

10 The third lot came out for the folk
Of Zebulun *down to a bloke*,
And the border of their plot ran
As far as Sarid *in its span*.

11 Their border went up toward the sea
And to Maralah, down to be
By Dabbasheth, and reached along
The brook east of Jokneam's *song*.
12 Then from Sarid it went eastward
Toward the sunrise by the sward
Of Chisloth Tabor, and went out
Toward Daberath, not by route
Of Japhia. 13 And from there it
Passed along on the east to Git
Tahepher, and along toward It
Takazin, *only* to go out
To Rimmon, whose borders about
Are on Neah. 14 Then the line went
Around it on the north side *spent*
Of Hannathon, and it reached to
The vale Jiphthah-el. 15 Kattath, *and*
Nahallal, Shimron, *and the band*
Of Idalah, and *all the crew*
Of Bethlehem, twelve cities and
Their villages *upon the sand*.
16 This was inheritance of folk
Of Zebulun and by the stroke
Of their families, these cities and
Their suburbs *set out in the land*.

Zebulun's circle I sing as my feet
Go round the lovely villages to greet
With song and dance inheritance complete.
Twelve cities, one for each appointed one
As divine guide beneath an awkward sun.
Twelve cities gay, twelve cities on the run
After the prophets, and after the gun.
Twelve cities home to everyone I meet.
Beloved, I rarely hear of cities fair
Of Zebulun with all their bright names
there.

It's only Bethlehem beneath the stars
In deep and silent sleep that keeps its bars
Open a Satdy night to one and all

To worship manger babies in the stall.

17 The fourth lot to Issachar came,
For the folk of Issachar's name
According to their families' *fame*.
18 And their plot went up to Jezreel,
With Chesulloth, Shunem *in deal*,
19 Haphraim, Shion, Anaharath,
20 Rabbith, Kishion, Abez' *path*,
21 Remeth, En Gannim, En Haddah,
And Beth Pазzez *inscribed by law*.
22 And the border reached to Tabor,
Shahazimah, and Beth Shemesh,
And their border ended before
The Jordan, sixteen cities *fresh*
With their suburbs. 23 This *was* the plot
Of the tribe of Issachar's lot
According to their families,
The cities and their villages.

Issachar's plot has cities there
Four times four with their gates to spare
Of law and love and even there
Awareness and truth in the glare
Of the bright suns I come to stare
At from the gates of earth and air
Opposite the two gates in pair
Of loving knowing of the share
That falls to righteous everywhere
You sow Your wheat and dig up tare.
Beloved, I sing Issachar's lot
Satisfied with the love I've got
From stealing in the baker's pot
Without a wicked thought or care.

24 The fifth lot came out for the tribe
Of Asher's children *to inscribe*
According to their families.
25 And their lands took up Helkath's *trees*,
Hali, Beten, Achshaph *to please*,
26 Alammelech, Amad, and *last*
Mishal, it reached up to *the mast*
Of Mount Carmel westward, along
Shihor Libnath. 27 It turned *in song*
Toward the sunrise to Beth Dagon,
And reached to Zebulun *by wagon*
And to the valley of Jiphthah
El, then northward beyond *the crawl*
Of Beth Emek and Neiel's *maw*,
Going past Cabul on the left,
28 Including Ebron *in the heft*,
Rehob, Hammon, and Kanah to

Great Sidon *within the sea's view*.
29 And then the border turned to Ramah
And to the fortress town *and gamer*
Of Tyre, then the border turned to
Hosah, and ended at the view
Of the sea by the region of
Achzib. 30 Also Ummah *in glove*,
Aphek, and Rehob twenty-two
Cities with their villages *too*.
31 This *was* the tribe's plot of the folk
Of Asher according to stroke
Of their families, these cities
With their villages *set at ease*.

Here is glib Asher's doleful happiness
Living in valley house, soulful address.
In sight of Tyre he spends his gleeful days
In quietness singing untuneful lays.
He reaches out a hand in goalful praise
To Simeon who rocks to sleep a guess.
Here is the rib of Asher's holeful stays
To fill the land with hopeful faithfulness.
Beloved, I sing with Asher, though my
voice
Is not one of the chosen nor the choice,
And trample on the grim, goat-footed ways
That are so popular for to rejoice.
Beloved, I sing with Asher despite death
And every curse that wells up on my
breath.

32 The sixth lot came out to the folk
Of Naphtali, and at a stroke
The sons of Naphtali *awoke*
According to their families' *yoke*.
33 And their frontier began to run
At Heleph, surrounding the dun
From the terebinth tree that *grows*
In Zaanannim, *as the light shows*,
Adami Nekeb, and Jabneel,
As far as Lakkum to the heel
Of Jordan. 34 From Heleph the line
Stretched westward to Aznoth Tabor,
And went out from there toward the fine
Hukkok, and it joined there before
Zebulun on the south side and
Asher upon the westward hand,
And ended at Judah *in guise*
By the Jordan toward sunrise.
35 And the fortress towns *are* Ziddim,
Zer, Hammath, Rakkath, and *undim*
Chinnereth, 36 Adamah, Ramah,

Hazor, 37 Kedesh, Edrei *in claw*,
En Hazor, 38 Iron, Migdal El,
Horem, Beth Anath, and *as well*
Beth Shemesh, nineteen cities and
Their villages *spread on the land*.
39 This *was* the plot of the tribe of
The sons of Naphtali *above*
According to their families,
The cities and their villages.

Nineteen cities, that's magic number of
The holy Qur'an invented for shove.
So Naphtali becomes the prophecy
Of one more sect encroaching on the free.
The tower of God, hairdresser and
wigmaker,

Is one of those bright cities on the taker.
I flee to that dark cupboard from the one
That breeds horses and grows orange for
pun.

Beloved, give Naphtali a rest and peace
In hilltops and in valleys for release.
Give me with Naphtali a place and room
To strum my heart and beat upon my
broom.

My song of praise to You shall never cease
Until I meet Your judgement and my
doom.

40 The seventh lot fell to the tribe
Of Dan's descendants *to inscribe*
According to their families.

41 And the land of their plot became
Zorah, Eshtaol, *and for fame*
Ir Shemesh, 42 Shaalabbin, *as drawn*,
Aijalon, Jethlah, 43 and Elon,
Timnah, Ekron, 44 Eltekeh, and
Gibbethon, Baalath, 45 Jehud's *land*,
Bene Berak, and Gath Rimmon,
46 Me Jarkon, and *at last* Rakkon,
With the region near Joppa *drawn*.

47 But the border of Dan's folk went
Beyond, because Dan's people went
Up to fight against Leshem and
Took it, and they smote it with hand
And mouth of the sword, and they took
It over and lived *in the nook*.
They called Leshem, Dan, by the name
Of Dan their father *for his fame*.

48 This *is* the lot of Dan's tribe's folk
According as their families *spoke*,
These cities with their suburbs' *spoke*.

Ah, here is it already, judgement day,
A Dan upon the northern hills to sway
The balances too equally loaded
With good deed and my wickedness'
cupid!

So Dan's gone out to Leshen at the dawn,
An opal of repute well set upon
The hills to reign in glory and make spawn.
Just wait until Dan takes away the place
Of Vatican to sculpt a godly face
Of worship to appear without a trace.
Beloved, Dan is a viper in the soil
That glistens with his opaline in coil.
I stand in judgement without even smirk
To hide my sharpened word and whetted
dirk.

49 When they had finished dividing
The land as an inheriting
According to their borders, then
The folk of Israel gave a plot
Among them to Joshua's lot
Who was the son of Nun *again*.

50 According to the word of YHWH
They gave him the city in due
Which he asked for, Timnath Serah
In Ephraim's hills, and he *with saw*
And hammer built the city and
Lived in it *at peace in the land*.

51 These *were* the lots which Eleazar
The priest, Joshua son *and star*
Of Nun, and the heads of the fathers
Of tribes of Israel's folk *with bothers*
Divided as inheritance
By lot in Shiloh *and by chance*
Before YHWH, at the meeting tent
Door. So they made *with one consent*
End of dividing the land *spent*.

It is excessive, Dear, what Joshua
Chose to follow selection of Timnah.
Serah indeed! I would have raised a stench
To find under my tent flap such a wench.
But Joshua looks far beyond the name.
He was well used to thinking of the claim
Of changing names to Joshua or other,
And did not mind a moment in the smother
Of smells ripened and set to memory
In the name of his village on the lee.
Beloved, whatever name You name me by
I still stand here beneath Your empty sky

And raise a prayer of silent words and dry.
I welcome Your unanswer like a brother.

Joshua 20

1 YHWH also spoke to Joshua,
Saying 2 "Speak to *the plethora*
Of Israel, saying 'Appoint
For yourselves cities *to anoint*
Refuge, of which I spoke to you
Through Moses, 3 'that the slayer who
Kills a person and unawares
Or not on purpose by his cares
May flee there, and they shall be your
Refuge from blood avenger's score.
4 'And when he flees to one of those
Cities, and stands at entrance *rose*
To city gate, and there declares
His case by that city's elders'
Ears, they shall take him in the place
To them, and give him room to dwell
That he may live among them *well*.
5 'And if the blood avenger comes
After him, they shall not *for crumbs*
Give the killer into his hand,
Because he struck his neighbor's stand
Not on purpose, and did not hate
Him before *he had met his fate*.
6 'And he shall live in that city
Until he stand before *pity*
Of congregation for judgement,
And until the death that is sent
Death of the one who is high priest
In those days *of famine or feast*.
The killer then may return and
Come to his own city and *land*
In his own house, to the city
From which he fled *without pity*. '''

I'm not sure that the one who ponders is
The worst of criminals, it's likely his
Feelings were hurt by what the neighbour
did

To show his excellence and pro and quid.
The worser criminal it seems to me
Is the one who was careless of his fee.
The latter disdains all the human race,
While the former gives hate a local place.
Beloved, keep my hand from the killing
touch.

There is no place of refuge in this such
Of world where I live now. Let me not feel
The thrill nor anguish of the crushing heel.

There's killing plenty in my own homeland
As in the foreign slaughterhouse I stand.

7 So they appointed Kedesh in
Galilee, in Naphtali's *bin*
Of hills, Shechem in the hills of
Ephraim, and Kirjath Arba's *love*
Which *is* Hebron, in the hills of
Judah. 8 And on the other side
Of the Jordan, by Jericho
Eastward, they assigned Bezer wide
On desert plain, east from the show
Of Reuben, Ramoth in *the glow*
Of Gilead, and from the tribe
Of Gad, and Golan in Bashan,
From the tribe of Manasseh's *plan*.
9 These were the cities *without bribe*
Appointed for all Israel's folk
And for stranger who lived *as bloke*
Among them, that whoever killed
Someone by accident, *not filled*
With hate might flee there, and not die
By hand of blood avenger's *cry*
Until he stood before the *people*
In congregation *for a weep*le.

Kedesh and Shechem and Kirjath Arbah,
Which is in Hebron in hills of Judah,
Bezer, Ramoth and Golan on the side
Toward the rising of the Jordan's pride,
These are the six cities where fateful hand
Finds refuge from the vengeance of the
land.

The six in all are given to the week
But seventh one is lacking when I seek.
The refuge for the slayer knows no rest,
No sweet comfort of Sabbath at its best.
Beloved, as I surround the circus tent
And see the figures dropping where they
went

I fancy flight above the ring and door,
I turn to seek You on the further shore.

Week 42 Joshua 21

1 Then the heads of the fathers' *tents*
Of the Levites came near *with sense*
To Eleazar the priest, to
Joshua the son of Nun *true*,
And to heads of the fathers' *houses*
Of the tribes where Israel's folk *browses*.
2 And they spoke to them at Shiloh
In the land of Canaan *in tow*,

Saying "YHWH commanded through
Moses

To give us cities for as chose us
To live in, with their common land
For our livestock *in stall and band.*"

3 So the children of Israel gave
To the Levites from their plots' thrave
Inheritance at the command
Of YHWH, these cities and their land.

4 Now the lot came out for the kin
Of Kohathites. And the sons *in*
The family of Aaron , priest,
Who were of Levites, *not the least*,
Had thirteen cities drawn by lot
From the tribe of Judah, *and sought*
From the tribe of Simeon, and from
The tribe of Benjamin *to come.*

5 The rest of the sons of Kohath
Had ten cities by lot from path
Of families of Ephraim's *tribe*,
From the tribe of Dan *to subscribe*,
And from Manasseh's half a tribe.

6 And the children of Gershon had
Thirteen cities by lot *not bad*
From the families of the tribe
Of Issachar, and from the tribe
Of Asher, also from the tribe
Of Naphtali, and from the half
A tribe of Manasseh's *carafe*
In Bashan. 7 The son of Merari
By their families *uncontrary*
Had twelve cities from Reuben's tribe,
From the tribe of Gad *to subscribe*,
And from the tribe of Zebulon.

8 And the children of Israel done
Gave these cities with grazing lands
By lot to the Levites *in bands*,
As YHWH had commanded by hand
Of Moses *outside Canaan's land.*

Like Zelophehad's daughters, so the priests
Were bound to get their due in lands and
beasts.

And like those ladies they were forced to
sue

Before anyone remembered their due.
The theocratic system may be right
And just in every mother's and son's sight,
But justice is unknown unless one's strong
To take what's one's own from the
crushing throng.

Beloved, I wait upon a crystal sill

For the receipt of honey-covered pill
And see that every priest and civil servant
Goes on intent on honours to be fervent,
Forgetting who is not a swine before
Whom to cast pearls beneath the sycamore.

9 So they gave from Judah's sons' tribe
And from the tribe to circumscribe
All the children of Simeon

These cities which by name they won,
10 Which were for the sons of Aaron,
One of the families *begun*
Of the Kohathites, Levi's sons,
For the lot was theirs first *for buns.*

11 And they gave them Kirjath Arba,
Arba was Anak's father's *draw*,
Which *is* Hebron, and in the hills
Of Judah, with the common rills
Surrounding it. 12 But of the fields
Of the city and all its yields
In villages they gave away
To Caleb son of Jephunneh
As his possession *in the way.*

13 Thus to the children of Aaron
The priest they gave *also* Hebron
With its suburbs, a city spun
For refuge for the killer *son*,
Libnah with its suburbs *well done*,

14 Jattir with its suburbs *in fun*,
Eshtemoa with its suburbs,
15 Holon with its common-land *herbs*,

Debir with its suburbs *and* 16 Ain
With its suburbs *before the plain*,
Juttah with its suburbs, and Beth
Shemesh with its suburbs *and breath*,
Nine cities *all* from those two tribes,

17 And from Benjamin's tribe *inscribes*,
Gibeon with its suburbs and
Geba with its suburbs to stand,

18 Anathoth with its suburbs, and
Almon with its suburbs, in all
Four cities. 19 All the cities' *stall*
Of the children of Aaron , priests,
Were thirteen cities for their feasts.

The thirteen priestly cities I declare
Seem fortunate to stand beneath the glare
Of the bright sun and the deserted air,
But I have seen the bare Judean hills
And I have known the pale silence that fills
The stone for turf, and cannot quite admire
The choice of habitat in frozen fire,

Forbidding villages to my mind's bills.
 Beloved, what's most amazing is the great
 Enthusiasm read in Israel's fate
 To enter Canaan's desert. Forty years
 In Sinai with its sand and flaming tears
 Are needed to make Hebron take on state.
 Come from Goshen, the vision had to wait.

20 And the families of Kohath's sons,
 The Levites, the rest of the *tonnes*
Of children of Kohath, even they
 Had the cities of their lot's *pay*
 From Ephraim's tribe. 21 *For it was* they
 Gave them Shechem with its suburbs
 In the mountains of Ephraim's *curbs*,
 A refuge city for the killer,
 Gezer with its suburbs *and miller*,
 22 Kibzaim with its suburbs, and Beth
 Horon with its suburbs *and breath*
In all four cities, 23 from the tribe
 Of Dan, Eltekeh with its ribe
 Of common land, Gibbethon too
 With its suburbs, 24 Aijalon's *few*
 With its suburbs, *and* Gath Rimmon
 With its suburbs, four cities *won*.
 25 And from Manasseh's half a tribe,
 Tanach as its suburbs describe
 And Gath Rimmon with its suburbs,
 Two cities *where no one disturbs*.
 26 All the ten cities with suburbs
 Were for the rest of Kohath's sons
 In their families *by their tonnes*.

How many cities named Gath Rimmon lie
 Beneath the glare of Canaanite sun's eye?
 I reckon every village in the park
 Has got a winepress for the lassies' lark
 As soon as there are vineyards for the spoil.
 I bring the fragrant late wine to a boil,
 And so release its aptitude to coil
 The heart and senses, still I'm seeing
 double.
 I hope there are not two towns to cause
 trouble.
 Meet me, Beloved, at Gath Rimmon's east
 gate,
 And choose Yourself which town not to be
 late,
 And I shall dance between the two to find
 Out what outrageous thing is on Your mind
 Where You preside on judgement and in
 state.

27 Also to the sons of Gershon,
 Of the Levite families *done*,
 From the *other* half of the tribe
 Of Manasseh *to circumscribe*,
They gave Golan in Bashan with
 Its suburbs, refuge city with
 Safety for the killer, and Be
 Eshterah with its common fee,
 Two cities, 28 and then from the tribe
 Of Issachar, Kishion's *scribe*
 With its suburbs, Daberath with
 Its suburbs, 29 and then Jarmuth with
 Its suburbs, *and* En Gannim with
 Its suburbs, four cities *in myth*,
 30 And from the tribe of Asher, *one*
 Mishal with its suburbs *when done*,
 Abdon with its suburbs *for fun*,
 31 Helkath with its suburbs, Rehob
 With its suburbs, four towns' *free nob*,
 32 And from the tribe of Naphtali,
 Kedesh in Galilee nearby
 Its suburbs, a refuge city
A place for the killer *to flee*.
 Hammoth Dor with its suburbs *too*,
 And Kartan where its suburbs grew,
 Three cities. 33 All the cities of
 The Gershonites by families' love,
 Thirteen cities with the above.

The cities of refuge You mention first
 Of every region, as though things would
 burst
 Unless that vital fact is not dispersed.
 I need no city of refuge, my Dear,
 I flee to You alone and without fear,
 Although along the narrow path I tread
 I see around me every scene of dread
 Resulting from the fact that none revere
 Your divine law thundered on Mount Sinai.
 There is not government beneath the sky
 That relies on the single vow to save
 Every human life from the sodden grave.
 Torture and pestilence follow the bombs
 Beneath the pine and fir, beneath the palms.

34 And to the families of sons
 Of Merari, the rest *in runs*
 Of the Levites, and from the tribe
 Of Zebulon, Jokneam's *scribe*
 With its suburbs, Kartah with its
 Suburbs, 35 and Dimnah *where it sits*

In suburbs, *and* Nahalal with
 Its suburbs, four cities *in pith*,
 36 And from the tribe of Reuben, *fine*
 Bezer with its suburbs *and wine*,
 Jahaz with its suburbs *to dine*,
 37 Kedemoth where its suburbs *shine*,
 And Mephaath with its suburbs *all*,
 Four cities *fenced and standing tall*,
 38 And from the tribe of Gad, Ramoth
 In Gilead suburbs in troth,
 A refuge city for the killer,
 Mahanaim with suburbs' *pillar*,
 39 Heshbon with its suburbs *to be*
With Jazer with its suburbs free,
 Four cities all *abundantly*.
 40 So all the cities for the folk
 Of Merari and as bespoke
 Their families, the rest of all
 The families of Levites' *sprawl*,
 Were *by* their lot twelve cities *all*.

Almost every series of twelve proposed
 Carries the weight of divine guides
 opposed,
 Even when only one slot of the twelve
 Shows symbol of that fortune, when I
 delve,
 I find it always so. The third slot lies
 Upon the sacrificial altar's guise,
 As Hussein follows Hasan and the wise
 Ali to meet his bloody death upon
 The bank of the Euphrates after dawn.
 Dimnah reminds each one of blood and
 gore,
 And is the third city upon the shore
 Of Merari's sons' plot and barnyard door.
 Beloved, I mind today again the name
 That with tears always comes to make a
 claim.

41 All the cities of the Levites
 Within the heritage of rights
 Of the children of Israel
Were forty-eight cities to dwell
 With their suburbs *to make them swell*.
 42 Every one of these cities had
 Its suburbs surrounding it *clad*,
 Thus *were* all these cities *not sad*.
 43 So YHWH gave to Israel the land
 All of which He had sworn to hand
 To their fathers, and they took hold
 Of it and lived in it *as told*.

44 And YHWH gave them rest all around,
 According to all He had bound
 To their fathers. And not a man
 Of all their enemies *a span*
 Could stand against them, YHWH
 delivered
 All their foes to their hands *unslivered*.
 45 Not a word failed of any good
 Thing which YHWH had spoken that
 should
 Be done to house of Israel.
 All came to pass *as by a spell*.

Four times twelve cities make the number
 of
 The dwelling places of the Levites' love,
 A city representing each of those
 Sons of Ishmael that set the cycles' rows,
 And each of Jacob's sons whose children
 dance
 Beneath the sparkling hills and clear sun's
 glance,
 And each of the apostles Jesus chose,
 And each of the Imams in whiter clothes.
 Beloved, let me live in the shadow that
 Fell from the forty-eight cities and sat
 In righteousness and safety where You're
 at.
 Beloved, I flee to You beyond the veils
 Of every twelve in line, before Whom pales
 The tinsel that their striving here entails.

Joshua 22

1 And Joshua called the Reubenites,
 The Gadites, and half the tribe *wights*
 Of Manasseh, 2 and said to them,
 "You have kept all the stratagem
 That Moses the servant of YHWH
 Commanded you, obeying due
 My voice in all I said to do.
 3 "You have not left your brothers these
 Many days, up to this day's *ease*,
 But kept the charge of YHWH's command,
 Your God. 4 "And now YHWH *at your*
 hand
 Your God has given rest to your *band*
Of brothers, as He promised them,
 Now therefore, return to the hem
 Of your tents, *also* to the land
 Of your possession, *and the stand*
 Which Moses servant of YHWH gave
 You on the Jordan's further wave.

5 “But diligently take you heed
 To do the commandment *indeed*
 And law which Moses YHWH’s servant
 Commanded you, to love *with cant*
 YHWH your God, walk in all His ways,
 To keep His commandments *in blaze*,
 To hold fast to Him, and to serve
 Him with all your heart *not to swerve*
 And with all your soul *to observe*.”
 6 So Joshua blessed them and sent
 Them away, to their tents they went.

When comes to fighting men are willing
 and
 Quick to obey the slightest of command,
 To leave their farms and meadows and the
 land
 East of Jordan to turn toward the band
 Of sunset and nightfall, the gore and sand
 Run crimson. So the fighting men that
 stand
 For the two and a half tribes rose and
 manned
 The armies of invasion to the store
 Of Canaan as far as the western shore.
 Beloved, I too pretend to love Your peace,
 But rise up willing to the fray and cease
 Repeating Your names merciful and just
 To call on the destroyer and the dust.
 Look on a brave world here and its release.

7 And to Manasseh’s half a tribe
 Moses had given to describe
 A possession in Bashan, but
 To half of them Joshua gave *rut*
 Among their brothers on this side
 Of the Jordan, westward *in pride*.
 And indeed, when Joshua sent
 Them away each to his own tent,
 He blessed them, 8 and spoke to them,
 saying
 “Return with much riches inlaying
 To your tents, and with much livestock,
 With silver, gold, bronze poppy-cock,
 With iron, and very many clothes.
 Divide the spoil of all your foes
 With your brothers.” 9 So Reuben’s folk,
 The children of Gad to a bloke,
 And half the tribe of Manasseh
 Returned, and left from Israel’s stay
 At Shiloh, which *is* in the land
 Of Canaan, to go to the band

Of Gilead, and to the land
 Of their possession, *on the strand*
 Which they obtained and by the hand
 Of YHWH also by Moses’ hand.

Who fight for Israel on David’s score,
 Or on that of Joshua for the gore,
 Are commanded to give the spoils in store
 Some to the ones remaining in the camp
 To guard the docks and herds and to
 revamp
 The courage of the ladies and the scamp
 Of children and the aged by the lamp.
 The share in wealth is always what’s
 behind
 To get the young women to have a blind
 Eye to the killing. Price of oil alone
 For three cents will send armies against
 stone
 To bomb Baghdad. Beloved, give me no
 share
 In any of the fortunes they’ve laid bare.
 I bow in peace before Your sacred throne.

10 And when they came to the place of
 The Jordan which *is* in land of
 Canaan, the children of Reuben,
 The children of Gad, and the *den*
Of half the tribe of Manasseh
 Built an altar there by the way
 Of Jordan, great for eye *astray*.

11 The folk of Israel heard *one* say,
 “Indeed, the children of Reuben,
 The children of Gad, and the half
 Of Manasseh have built *a gaff*
Of an altar on the frontier
 Of the land of Canaan *for fear*,
 In the region of the Jordan,
 On folk of Israel’s side *by plan*.”

12 And when the folk of Israel heard,
 The whole assembly of them stirred
 Together at Shiloh to go
 To war against them *as a foe*.

13 Then the children of Israel sent
 Phinehas Eleazar’s son bent
 As priest to the folk of Reuben,
 To the children of Gad, and half
 The tribe of Manasseh *in staff*,
 Into the land of Gilead,

14 And with him ten rulers *in pad*,
 One ruler each from the chief house
 Of every tribe of Israel’s *spouse*,

And each one *was* his dad's house head
Among Israel's divisions led.

I go to war against the evil brood
That worships in another way and crude
From what I do myself. I raise a cry
"There is no god but God up in the sky"
And rush to the attack of those who shout
"The Lord God is but One". The demons'
rout

Is sure for all the clash of arms and call
Of curses on the fast black-listed brawl.
Beloved, who hear the prayers of men and
son

Of angel on the torrid earth begun,
Choose Your own side, but fail not to
include
The flailing arms and houses of the rude,
And I shall reinforce Your choice in vying
Against the prim and proper ones who're
lying.

15 Then they came up to Reuben's folk,
To the children of Gad, and spoke
To half the tribe of Manasseh,
In the land of Gilead's way,
Saying 16 "Thus says the whole folk's
sway

Of YHWH, 'What treachery *is* this
That you've committed, done amiss
Against the God of Israel,
To turn away this day a spell
From following YHWH, in as well
That you have built for yourselves this
Altar, that you might on this day
Rebel against YHWH, *yes, rebel?*

17 '*Is then* the iniquity not
Enough for us in Peor's plot,
From which we are not cleansed till now,
Although there was a plague and row
In the congregation of YHWH,
18 'But you must turn away this day
From following YHWH *gone astray?*
And it shall be, if you rebel
Today against YHWH, that *as well*
Tomorrow He'll be wroth with all
The assembly of Israel's *stall*.

19 'But if the land of your plot's foul,
Then cross over *both cheek and jowl*
To the possession land of YHWH,
Where YHWH's tabernacle's in view,
And take possession among us,

But do not rebel *with a fuss*
Against YHWH, nor against us, by
Building yourselves an altar *high*
Besides the altar of YHWH our
God. 20 'Did not Achan in *his power*
The son of Zerah commit sin
In the accursed thing, and wrath's *din*
Fell on all Israel's assembly?
And that man did not perish *free*
Alone in his iniquity.'

On slightest provocation everyone
Rushes out with alarm to jump the gun
With conclusions unkempt and without
sight

Of reason, like a monkey in the night.
They might as well have understood the
frame

In positive and righteousness' acclaim
As in the light, or darkness that they did.
Instead they mustered army for the bid.
An army is gathered always on such
A false requirement and in evil touch.
What's amazing here yet is that they sent
Ambassadors to find out why they spent
Their earnings on an altar to prevent
Attack. Most times diplomacy is rent.

21 Then the children of Reuben, and
The children of Gad, and half band
Of Manasseh answered and said
To the heads of divisions *led*
Of Israel, 22 "YHWH God of gods,
YHWH God of gods, He knows *our pods*,
And let Israel itself know too,
If in rebellious treachery
Against YHWH, do not save us free
This day. 23 "If we have built ourselves
An altar to turn following *elves*
From YHWH, or if to offer on
It burnt offerings or grain at dawn,
Or if to offer peace offerings
On it, let YHWH Himself in stings
Require. 24 "But in fact we have done
It for fear, for a reason *won*,
Saying 'In time to come your sons
May peek to our descendants' *stuns*,
Saying "What have you to do with
YHWH God of Israel in *myth?*
25 "For YHWH has made the Jordan *here*
A border between you *appear*
And us, *you* children of Reuben

And children of Gad *in the glen*.
 You have no part in YHWH *at all*.
 So your descendants would make all
 Our descendants cease fearing YHWH.⁷
 26 "Therefore we said 'Let us now do
 This building ourselves *now and here*
 An altar, not for burning gear,
 Nor for sacrifice, 27 'but *appear*
 A witness between you and us
 And generations after us,
 That we may do service to YHWH
 Before Him with burnt offerings too,
 With our sacrifices, and our
 Peace offerings, that your sons *in power*
 May not say to our descendants
 In time to come, "You have no chance
 In YHWH." 28 "Therefore we said that it
 Will be, when they say *this* to fit
 Us or to our generations
 In time to come *the thing that stuns*,
 That we may say, 'Here is the set
 Model of the altar of YHWH
 Which our fathers made *when they met*,
 Though not for burnt offerings *to do*
 Nor sacrifices, but it's for
 A witness between you *in score*
 And us.' 29 "Far be it from us that
 We should rebel against YHWH's *hat*,
 And turn from following YHWH now,
 To build an altar for burnt cow,
 For grain offerings, or sacrifice,
 Besides the altar of YHWH *nice*
 Our God which *is* before His tent
 And tabernacle *where it's sent*."

How often is the motive opposite
 Of what the ill-informed expect of it!
 Perhaps the fact these people speak the
 same
 Language will keep them from the war's
 acclaim.
 The speeches are too long for those today
 To understand in peace and justice' way.
 In those days people could sit down upon
 The ground around a campfire and till
 dawn
 Patiently hear the carriage of the wrong
 And find out what is what the whole night
 long.
 Now the transmission of message in sight
 Is but a click of button on the right,
 And once the word is set, so is the fight.

Yet then and now right is defined by might.

30 And when Phinehas the priest heard,
 And the assembly's rulers, word,
 And the heads of divisions led
 Of Israel with him, what said
 The children of Reuben, the folk
 Of Gad, and Manasseh who spoke,
 It pleased them. 31 Then Phinehas son
 Of Eleazar the priest *won*
 Said to the children of Reuben,
 The children of Gad *in their glen*,
 And the children of Manasseh,
 "Today we see YHWH's with our *play*,
 Because you've not done treachery
 Against YHWH. Now you have in fee
 Taken the folk of Israel
 Out of the hand of YHWH *in spell*."
 32 And Phinehas Eleazar's son,
 The priest, and the rulers *begun*,
 Returned from Reuben's folk and Gad,
 And from the land of Gilead
 To the land of Canaan, and to
 The children of Israel *and crew*,
 And brought back word to them *as due*.
 33 And the thing pleased Israel's folk well,
 And so the children of Israel
 Blessed Alohim, they spoke no more
 Of going against them in *war*
 And battle, to destroy the land
 Where the children of Reuben and
 Gad lived. 34 The children of Reuben
 And the children of Gad in glen
 Called the altar a witness *gleam*
 Among us that YHWH's Alohim."

Praise You, Beloved, that on a day gone
 past
 The people heard the motives that were
 cast,
 And found capacity to change their view,
 Despite the fact they were a hardened crew
 And out for blood. One time in history
 You penetrated kingly pageantry
 With Exodus to set Your people free.
 And since then as we march into the place
 Of slaughter without mercy, without grace,
 We remember that once You showed Your
 face.
 And so now once in history it seems
 A folk was not chained to its broken
 dreams,

But through the fragile senses' openings
Saw truth in other, and peace took to
wings.

Week 43 Joshua 23

1 And so it came to pass, a long
Time after YHWH had given *song*
Of rest to Israel from all
Their enemies round house and stall,
That Joshua was old, advanced
In years. 2 And Joshua *entranced*
Called for all Israel, *and* for
Their elders, for their heads, and for
Their judges, for their officers,
And said to them *as many fers*,
"I'm old, *and I'm* advanced in age.
3 "You have seen all *the great rampage*
That YHWH your Alohims has done
To all these nations *under sun*
Because of you, for YHWH your God
Has fought for you *upon the sod*.
4 "See, I have divided to you
By lot these nations that *in crew*
Remain, to be inheritance
For your tribes, *and* from the *advance*
Of Jordan, with all peoples that
I have cut off, as far as sat
The Great Sea westward *of your flat*.
5 "And YHWH your God will expel them
From before you and drive *from hem*
Out of your sight. And you'll possess
Their land, as YHWH your God's address
Has promised you. 6 "Therefore be of
Great courage to keep and to *love*
To do all that is written in
Book of Moses' Law *to begin*,
Lest you turn aside from it to
The right hand or the left *to do*,
7 "*And* lest you go among these folks,
These who remain among your *spokes*.
You shall not make mention of name
Of their gods, nor cause *any shame*
To swear *by them*, you shall not serve
Them nor bow down to them *with verve*,
8 "But you'll hold fast to YHWH your
God,
As you've done to this day *to plod*.

Beloved, let me hold fast to You my God
As Joshua upon the barren sod
Of Hebron in the days when age took slack

And dimmed his eye and bent his tired
back.

Though I am still young as it seems to me,
I've more than forty years repentantly
Read the Hebrew scroll through again,
again,

To find Your word to me and to all men.
The one thing that is clearly stated there
Is to hold fast to You alone and bear
Witness that You alone are God Almighty
Among the heathen priests and rulers
flighty.

Beloved, again I raise my voice to sing
Your oneness to the jackdaws on the wing.

9 "For YHWH has driven out before
You great and strong nations *to roar*,
But *as for* you, no one has been
Able to stand against you *seen*
To this day. 10 "One man of you shall
Chase a thousand *in the canal*,
For YHWH your Alohims *is* He
Who fights for you, *as faithfully*
He promised you *and set you free*.
11 "So take careful heed to yourselves,
That you love YHWH your God, *not elves*.
12 "Or else, if indeed you go back,
And cling to the remnant *in slack*
Of these nations, these that remain
Among you, and marry *profane*
With them, and go in to them and
They to you, 13 "know sure out of hand
That YHWH your Alohims no more
Will drive these nations from your shore.
But they'll be snares and traps to you,
And scourges on your sides and thorns
In your eyes, until all your bourns
Perish from this good land which YHWH
Your Alohims has given you.
14 "Indeed, this day I go the way
Of all the earth. And you can say
In all your hearts and all your souls
That not one thing has failed *the goals*
Of all the good things which YHWH your
God told you on you to outpour.
All have come to pass for you, not
One word of them has failed *when sought*.
15 "Therefore so it shall come to pass,
That as all the good things *en masse*
Have come upon you which YHWH your
God promised you, so YHWH'll restore
On you all evil till He's brought

Destruction on you from this plot
 Of good which YHWH your God gave you.
 16 “When you’ve transgressed the
 covenant
 Of YHWH your God, which He in due
 Command gave you, and gone to rant
 Serving other gods, and bowed down
 To them, then the anger and frown
 Of YHWH will burn against you, and
 You’ll perish quickly from the land
 Of goodness which He’s given you.”

It is surprising that two generations
 Of the faithful can abide in the rations
 Of consequence and still keep the same
 story
 Of faith before the tempting of earth’s
 glory.
 After all Joshua stands to bear witness
 To Your oneness like Moses and with
 fitness.
 As soon as Muhammad died, there were
 those
 Who came together his work to oppose
 And chose vain leaders to wear prophet’s
 clothes.
 Although that was the quickest fall from
 grace
 Known in the story of the human race,
 It’s still more typical those following
 Forget the song their fathers used to sing.
 Beloved, You are my heritage and ring.

Joshua 24

1 And so Joshua gathered all
 The tribes of Israel *by his call*
 To Shechem and called for the elders
 Of Israel, and for their head *welders*,
 For their judges, and deputies,
 To come before Alohim’s ease.
 2 And Joshua said to all the folk,
 “Thus says YHWH God of Israel’s *oak*,
 ‘Your fathers, *including* Terah,
 The father of Abraham’s awe
 And father of Nahor, lived on
 The other side of river drawn
 In olden times, and they served there
 Other gods. 3 ‘Then I took your fair
 Father Abraham from that side
 Of the river, led him *in pride*
 Through all the land of Canaan’s *ride*,
 And his descendants multiplied

When I gave him Isaac. 4 ‘To him
 Isaac I gave Jacob and *grim*
 Esau. To Esau I gave hills
 Of Seir to possess *for his thrills*,
 But Jacob and his children went
 Down to Egypt. 5 ‘Also I sent
 Moses and Aaron, and I touched
 Egypt with plagues *and hard as smutched*
 In what I did among them *clutched*.
 Afterward I brought you *all* out.
 6 ‘And then I brought your fathers out
 Of Egypt, you came to the sea,
 And Egyptians *ferociously*
 Pursued your fathers with chariots
 And horsemen to the Red Sea’s *butts*.
 7 ‘So they cried out to YHWH, and He
 Put darkness between you and the
 Egyptians, brought the sea on them,
 And covered them *by stratagem*.

It’s getting to be too old as a story,
 This victory over Egyptians’ glory.
 A smart clamp on the Hitlerites would be
 A tale of a more recent victory
 Had You but intervened as in the myth.
 Beloved, remember that we’re dealing with
 Time and place in our human limitation.
 It’s hard for us to find the divine station.
 What You did long ago may well be true
 To You a present and eternal hue,
 But history to us is meant to show
 How limited we humans on the go
 Must be. Beloved, bear in this century
 Witness to letting Your people go free.

And your eyes saw in Egypt what
 I did. Then you lived in the shut
 Desert a long time. 8 ‘And I brought
 You into the land of the *sot*
 Amorites, who lived on that side
 Of the Jordan, who came to ride
 Against you. But I gave them in
 To your hand, that you might begin
 To possess their land, I destroyed
 Them from before you *as employed*.
 9 ‘Then Balak the son of Zippor,
 King of Moab, arose to war
 Against Israel, and sent and called
 Balaam son of Beor *appalled*
 To curse you. 10 ‘But I would not hear
 Balaam, therefore he had with fear
 To bless you. So I saved you from

His hand. 11 'Then you went *frolicsome*
Over the Jordan and came to
Jericho. And fought against you
All the men of Jericho and
The Amorites, *also the band*
Of Perizzites, the Canaanites,
The Hittites and the Girgashites,
The Hivites, and the Jebusites.
But I gave them up to your power.
12 'I sent the hornet *in an hour*
Before you which drove them out from
Before you, *and* the two kings come
From the Amorites, *but* not with
Your sword or with your bow *in myth*.

Beloved, Your servant Joshua's a prude,
Or else very polite instead of crude
When he reminds of Baal Peor and nude
Princesses that came out to tempt the boys
To join in idol worship and the noise.
He mentions not a word of failing to
Keep Your law before Balak and his crew.
He only says You came to save the day,
Giving You all the glory in the sway,
And saying naught about the wicked way
The people served the gods of sex and men.
Give me a voice like Joshua's and pen
To gloss over the failures of the weak
And uncover Your oneness for a peek.

13 'I've given you a land for which
You did not even work a stitch,
And cities which you did not build,
And you live in them and you *tilled*
To eat of the vineyards and groves
Of olives you did not plant *droves*.'

14 "Now therefore, fear YHWH, serve Him
in

Sincerity and in truth *win*,
And put away the gods which your
Fathers served on the other shore
Of the river and in Egypt.
Serve YHWH *alone from crèche to crypt!*

15 "And if it seems evil to you
To serve YHWH, choose today for you
Whom you will serve, whether the gods
Which your fathers served *under rods*
On the other side of the stream,
Or the gods of Amorites' dream,
In whose land you live. But for me
And my house, we will serve *freely*
YHWH." 16 So the people answered and

Said "Far be it from us to stand
Forsaking YHWH to serve such gods,
17 "For YHWH our God *is* He whose *rods*
Brought us and our fathers up out
Of the land of Egypt *in rout*,
From the house of bondage, who did
Those great signs in our sight, and hid
Us safe in all the way that we
Went and among all the folk through
Whom we passed *on our way with you*.
18 "And YHWH drove out from before us
All the people and numerous
Amorites who lived in the land.
We also will serve YHWH *in band*,
For He *is* our God *to withstand*."

19 But Joshua said to the folk,
"You cannot serve YHWH *at a stroke*,
For He's a holy Alohim.

He *is* a jealous Alohim,
He will not forgive your sins nor
Your transgressions *upon the shore*.
20 "If you forsake YHWH and serve gods
Of strangers, then He with His prods
Will turn and do you harm devouring,
After He's done you good *in scouring*."

21 And the people said to *the man*
Joshua, "No, it is our plan
To serve YHWH!" 22 So Joshua said
To the folk, "You're witnesses led
Against yourselves that you have chosen
YHWH for yourselves, to serve Him
frozen."

And they said "*We are witnesses!*"
23 "Now therefore put away in whiz
The foreign gods from among you,
And incline your heart unto YHWH
The Alohim of Israel."

This man Joshua talks like Baptist preacher
Who says a man cannot keep every feature
Of Your law holy, but must have the life
Atonement of death sentence for his life.
Is it truly impossible to bow
To You alone, and serve You anyhow?
Despite the divine guidance of his word,
I think Joshua's here some overstimulated.
The people are right in the choice to make
You only their rejoicing at the stake.
There's none to force a man to bow down
to
The golden image of Babel in view,
And only flaming furnaces are filled

With those like Joshua himself instilled.

24 And the people said *for a spell*
To Joshua, “YHWH our God we
Will serve, and His voice we *only*
Will obey!” 25 So Joshua made
A covenant with the folk *stayed*
That day, and made for them a law
And ordinance in Shechem’s *straw*.
26 And Joshua wrote down these words
In the Book of God’s Law *in sherds*.
And he took a large stone, and set
It up there under the oak met
Beside tabernacle of YHWH.
27 Joshua told all the folk true,
“Indeed, this stone shall be witness
To us, for it has heard address
Of all the words of YHWH which He
Spoke to us. It shall therefore be
Witness to you, lest you deny
Your God and *make me wonder why*.”
28 So Joshua let the folk go,
Each to his own garden *to grow*.

The Decalogue was written in that place
Upon a stone for every passing face
To read the ten words of Your divine law
And go on by to live by them in awe.
Some now despise the word because in
stone
It once was written and not hearts alone
Bear up the scattered phrases and in love.
I see no ill in having stone to shove.
The stone does not detract from what my
heart
Tells me to love of You and from the start.
The heart is evil that would shed the cut
Of letter on the stone and shake a butt.
Beloved, let Your word everywhere be shut
Within the inner temple and on strut.

29 And it came to pass after these
Things that Joshua son of Nun,
The servant of YHWH, died *at ease*,
Having one hundred ten years run.
30 And they buried him in the plot
Of his inheritance *he got*
At Timnath Serah, which *is* in
The mountains of Ephraim’s *din*,
On the northern side of Mount Gaash.
31 And Israel served YHWH all *the gash*
Of Joshua’s days, and *the stash*

Of all the days of elders who
Outlived Joshua *from his crew*,
Who had known all the works of YHWH
Which He had done for Israel.
32 The bones of Joseph, which *as well*
The children of Israel had brought
Up out of Egypt, they were caught
Burying at Shechem, in plot
Of ground which Jacob *once* had bought
From the sons of Hamor the father
Of Shechem for one hundred *rather*
Pieces of silver, and which had
Become a heritage *not bad*
Of Joseph’s children. 33 Eleazar
The son of Aaron died *a star*.
They buried him upon a hill
Of Phinehas his son *to fill*,
Given *in heritage* to him
In the mountains of Ephraim.

Phinehas was the man that wielded spear
And taught Balak’s priestesses what to fear.
As soon as Moses and Aaron gave word,
His noble heart and righteous became
stirred,
And he thrust through the royal harlot turd
As well as Israelite prince to the heart
And killed them both for idolatrous part.
Such a man got the heritage to start.
Beloved, I have raised neither spear nor
gun,
I have no war cry to shout under sun,
Nor arrow to print over life when done.
Yet grant me with Phinehas heritage
To cantillate Your name upon the page
Of Torah, Psalm, Gospel and Qur’an’s
stage.

The Book of Judges

The book of Judges continues the major
theme of Joshua, that is, the role of the
divine guide to make war for the saving of
the faithful. It is structured around the lives
of twelve such judges or divinely appointed
leaders. The books of revelation contain a
number of series made up of the numbers
three and four. The sum of these is seven
and the product twelve. The twelve series
always represent the experience of the
human soul in its sacrificial spiral as a
spark rising from the altar towards God.

The twelve begins with the sons of Ishmael and ends with the Twelve Imams beginning with Imam Ali and ending with Imam Mahdi, may peace be upon them. There are parallels between the twelve judges in this book with the twelve that follow, that is, the twelve righteous kings of Judah, the twelve minor prophets, the twelve disciples of Jesus, and the twelve divine guides. This is only to be expected, since the cycle has its basic characteristics in every case. The names of the sons of Ishmael are the defining features of the cycle of twelve through which the human soul arises.

In order, the names mean as follows: *Ishmael* = God hears; *Nebajoth* = brought forth, fruitfulness; *Kedar* = ash coloured, dark; *Adbeel* = disciplined of God; *Mibsam* = fragrant; *Mishma* = hearing; *Dumah* = silence; *Massa* = burden, tribute; *Hadar* = majesty; *Tema* = sunburnt; *Jetur* = encircled, enclosed; *Naphish* = breathed, refreshed; *Kedema* precedence, help.

God's hearing our call results in a twelve-step spiritual development. The first step is fruitfulness, the immediate stimulation of the spiritual practice. This soon subsides into the real work of *dhikr*. The first symbol of this is darkness, then discipline. After this trial the soul is rewarded with more substantial progress in fragrance. Fragrance is followed by the experiences of hearing and silence, tribute and majesty. The second cycle of discipline finds a symbol in the sunburnt arid seclusion. This is followed by the second reward in refreshment and help. These four alternating cycles of discipline and reward correspond to the mystical four gates and the four elements, air, fire, water and earth. The twelve judges follow this same cycle of development, the story of each illuminating some aspect of it.

The author of the book is traditionally known as Samuel, whose name is a variant of Ishmael. Although the sema' is noted in the first chapters of Genesis, it is through Samuel that it comes to its full development. It was so shunted aside by animal sacrifice at one point that the priest did not recognize it as a valid form of prayer when Samuel's mother

engaged in it, thinking that she was drunken. Samuel heard the voice of God even as a small child. The book of Judges appears to be his treatise on hearing the voice of God as the central feature of divine worship. This is evident also in the fact that the judges are all appointed directly by [the voice of] God rather than by their predecessors.

The final two episodes of the book of Judges are a warning of the results of neglecting the twelve-step cycle of spirituality. In sum, all religious systems that dispense with divinely appointed leadership, divine guidance, result in horrible acts of violence as well as idolatry. History has proven Samuel correct in that assessment.

Introduction: God Hears

Week 44 Judges 1

1 Now after Joshua died, it came
To pass the children of the name
Of Israel asked YHWH, saying "Who
Shall go up for our fighting crew
Against the Canaanites in view,
As prince to fight against them *too*?"
2 And YHWH said "Judah shall go up,
Behold, I've delivered the *cup*
Of the land into Judah's hand.
3 And Judah said to Simeon's *band*
His brother, "Come up in my lot
With me, that we may strike the spot
Of Canaanites, and I likewise
Will go with you *before your eyes*
Into your lot. So Simeon
Went up with him *as he was drawn*.
4 And so Judah went up, and YHWH
Delivered the Canaanite *crew*
And the Perizzites in their hand,
And they killed ten thousand in band
At Bezek. 5 And they found the lord
Of Bezek in Bezek *adored*,
And fought against him, and they slew
Canaanites and Perizzites' *crew*.
6 Then the lord of Bezek fled out,
And they pursued him, caught in rout,
And cut off his thumbs and big toes.
7 And the lord of Bezek *in throes*
Said "Seventy kings with their thumbs and
Big toes cut off gathered the sand

Under my table, as I've done,
So Alohim repays who won."
They brought him to Jerusalem,
And there he died *no diadem*.

Bezek, a lightning flash, is where they
came
To find a lord in king of that same name
To cut off thumbs and big toes to his
shame.
So many have died in the holy city,
That when I was there, although I was
witty,
I did not remember lord of Bezek
Who died there with his thumbs and feet
wreck.
The lightning flash could not grasp and was
lame.
Beloved, I take the cruel flash that shines
Across my heart and action from the lines
Of wrath and cut of its lord's thumbs and
toes
So it cannot grasp sword, and where it goes
It limps and at least bleeds, and bleeds to
death.
So I renew my righteousness and breath.

8 And the children of Judah fought
Against Jerusalem and caught
It, they smote it with mouth of sword
And set fire to the city *stored*.
9 And after that Judah's folk went
Down to fight Canaanites who spent
Their time in the mountains, and in
The south, and in the lowland *bin*.
10 And Judah went against the folk
Of Canaan set by Hebron's *oak*.
And the name of Hebron before now
known

Was Kirjath Arba on that score.
And they killed Sheshai, Ahiman,
And Talmai *all and to a man*.
11 From there they went against the folk
Of Debir. Debir's name *awoke*
Before as Kirjath Sepher. 12 Then
Caleb said "Who attacks the men
Of Kirjath Sepher and takes it,
To him I'll give my daughter *fit*
Achsah as wife." 13 And Othniel
The son of Kenaz, *so to tell*,
Caleb's younger brother, took it,

So he gave him his daughter *fit*
Achsah as wife. 14 It came to pass,
When she came *to him*, that she moved
Him to ask her father for grass.
And she got down from off her ass,
And Caleb asked her *unreproved*,
"What do you want?" 15 So she told him,
"Give me a blessing *on my whim*,
Since you have given me the south land,
Give me also water springs' stand."
And Caleb gave her upper springs
And lower springs *where water rings*.

Beloved, I ask You as loving father
To give me what my dry lands must incur.
Give me the springs, both lower and above
And I shall bathe my face in Your cool
love.
The alabaster fountains glowing green
Seduce my steps toward Your great unseen,
And draw me closer to the pool unkept,
The bottomless abyss and the wind-swept.
Your spirit hovers on the surface calm
To break the waters and to split the palm.
Beloved, I reach out to the shining cup
And take it to my lips and turn it up.
Beyond the meadow grass, beyond the sun,
Give me the high and lower springs when
done.

16 Now the children of the Kenite,
Moses' father-in-law *in sight*,
Went up from the city of palms
With Judah's folk *and without qualms*
Into the desert of Judah,
Which *lies* in the south *near* Arad,
And they went and lived with the folk.
17 Judah went with his brother *bloke*
Simeon, and they laid a stroke
On the Canaanites who dwelt in
Zephath, and utterly *for sin*
Destroyed it. So that city's name
Was called Hormah *as if in blame*.
18 Also Judah took Gaza and
Its outlands, Ashkelon with land
Around it, and Ekron in band.
19 So YHWH was with Judah. And they
Drove out the mountain-dwellers' *sway*,
But they could not drive out the ones
Who lived in the lowland *in tonnes*,
Because they had chariots of iron.
20 They gave Caleb Hebron to fire on,

As Moses had said. And he drove
Out from there the three sons *in grove*
Of Anak, *out from where they strove*.

Three sons of Anak Caleb could disperse
And show them to a grave and something
worse.

But lowland dwellers, fat and on the fawn
He could not move, no not from glowing
dawn

To sunset by the sea. Such giants lay
An iron yoke and chariot on the way.
The mountains where the groves and Baals
sway

He cleared, but not the valleys fertile
drawn.

The sons of giants in their way of troll
I drive out from my heart and land and
soul.

I break the necklace of their faith and song
And go free in the mountains from their
wrong.

Beloved, I come to slay Anak's sons where
They would creep in beneath my fire and
air.

21 But the children of Benjamin
Did not drive out *with wing or fin*
The Jebusites, ones living in
Jerusalem, so Jebusites
Live there in Benjamin's folk's sights
In Jerusalem to this day.

22 And the house of Joseph took way
Against Bethel, and YHWH with them.

23 So Joseph's house *by stratagem*
Sent men to spy out Bethel, which
Was once called Luz *when at its pitch*.

24 And when the spies saw a man coming
Out of the city, they said humming
To him, "Please show us city gate
And we'll show you mercy *for fate*."

25 So he showed them the entrance way
Into the city, and they'd slay
The city with the mouth of sword,
But they let the man go *ungored*
And all his family too *restored*.

26 The man went to the Hittites' land,
And built a city *there to stand*,
And called its name Luz, which *is its*
Name to this day *there where it sits*.

27 But Manasseh did not drive out
Beth Shean and its suburbs stout,

Or Taanach and its lands about,
The inhabitants of Dor and
Its suburbs, or dwellers *in land*
Of Ibleam and its suburbs,
Or Megiddo's people and herbs,
But Canaanites would take those curbs.
28 It happened when Israel was strong,
They put Canaanites under thong
Of tribute, but did not completely
Drive them out, *but treated them sweetly*.

Megiddo's excellent and that is why
No one could treat it on the cunning sly
With armies sent and bent on crushing it.
The smiling coriander seed is fit
And sweet to taste upon the wet tongue's
slit.

Better to put Megiddo to tribute
And enjoy on long summer days its fruit.
It might last generations on the fly.
Beloved, put me to tribute, do not take
My life as long as I by my tent stake
Remember to cantillate Your sweet names
Like coriander seed parched in the flames
Of love. See I go whirling from the gate
Of Taanach, and so I shall not be late.

29 Nor did Ephraim drive out the folk
Of Canaan who lived in the poke
Of Gezer, so the Canaanites
Lived in Gezer with them *by rights*.

30 Neither did Zebulun drive out
The dwellers of Kitron *in rout*
Or the dwellers of Nahalol,
So the Canaanites *on the dole*
Lived among them, and were put out
Under a tribute *not to flout*.

31 Neither did Asher drive out those
Inhabitants that Acco *shows*
Nor the dwellers where Sidon *grows*,
Nor from Ahlab, Achzib, Helbah,
Aphik, or Rehob *in the raw*.

32 So the Asherites lived among
The Canaanites, the dwellers sung
In the land, for they did not drive
Them out *of home or hearth or hive*.

33 Neither did Naphtali drive out
The dwellers of Beth Shemesh *stout*
Or the inhabitants of Beth
Anath, but they died natural death,
The Canaanites set in the land.
Nevertheless the dwellers of

Beth Shemesh and Beth Anath's *glove*
 Were put under tribute to them.
 34 And the Amorites forced the stem
 Of Dan into the mountains *fast*,
 For they would not let them avast
 Come down to the valley *to cast*,
 35 And the Amorites would live there
 In Mount Heres, in Aijalon,
 And in Shaalbim *without a care*,
 Yet when the strength of the house *drawn*
 Of Joseph became greater, they
 Were put under the tribute's *sway*.
 36 Now the border of Amorites
Was from slopes of Akabbim's heights,
 From Sela, and upward *by rights*.

I wait upon the mountains like a judge
 And see the sunset turn the sea to smudge
 Of purple and of gold and fire about
 The cloudy remnants of good and devout.
 I wait upon the mountains through the night
 And see the morning cast about its light
 And then rush on the foe and lay them all
 To tribute to my harvest bin and stall.
 Beloved, I secretly watch from my place
 To see if You indeed will show Your face,
 And when You do, I'll throw my trapping
 lines
 About You, You shall not escape my vines,
 But I shall take Your heart and store for
 mine
 And You will have Your servant in to dine.

Judges 2

1 The Angel of YHWH came up from
 Gilgal to Bochim, said when come,
 "I led you up from Egypt and
 Brought you *again* into the land
 I swore to your fathers, and said
 'I'll never break covenant *spread*
 With you. 2 'And you no covenant
 Make with any inhabitant
 Of this land, but you shall tear down
 Their altars *all around the town*.'
 But you have not obeyed My voice.
 Why have you made this *fatal choice*?

The altars of the rich and blind appear
 On every fine horizon and with cheer.
 Should any come to tear them down, I fear,
 A brew and cry of terrorism would
 Rise on the island where the towers stood.

Ask me not now to break the idols down
 Nor burn their churches with a righteous
 frown.
 There's wrath enough within the loving
 creed
 When Rome dictates Geneva's time of
 need.
 There's din enough where rollicking
 prayers roll
 Above the thrashing sea and rock atoll,
 Above gyrations of Pentecost's shoal.
 Do not, Beloved, send out the enemy
 Because I fail in violent degree.

3 "Therefore I also said 'I
 Not drive them out *over the hill*
 Before you, but they shall be *thorn*
 In your side, and their gods *of scorn*
 Shall be a snare to you *and yours*.'"
 4 So it was, when Angel of YHWH
 Spoke these words to Israel's folk true,
 That the folk lifted up their voices
 And wept *where Canaanite rejoices*.
 5 Then they called the name of that place
 Bochim, and there before the face
 Of YHWH they sacrificed *for grace*.

As weeping is an act of worship so
 The people wept to hear, to fear and know
 That idol toleration would bear fruit
 In thorny sides and many ills to boot.
 I come upon a day to Bochim where
 I weep to say that generations there
 Go on the same, and idol resurrects
 On idol when it's such the heart expects.
 In Bochim weeping there the people came
 To sacrifice to You, Beloved, for blame.
 I come with tears and with a sacrifice
 That is my living self, may it suffice
 To set aside all hopes and all desires
 But Your will in eternal, loving fires.

6 And when Joshua had dismissed
 The folk, Israel's folk from the tryst,
 Each went to his inheritance
 To possess a land *where to dance*.
 7 So the folk served YHWH all the days
 Of Joshua, and all the days
 Of the elders who outlived him,
 Who'd seen all the great works of YHWH
 Which He had done for Israel's *crew*.
 8 Now Joshua the son of Nun,

The servant of YHWH *who is One*,
 Died *aged* one hundred and ten years.
 9 They buried him within the fence
 Of his *plotted* inheritance
 At Timnath Heres, in the hills
 Of Ephraim, on the north rills
 Of Mount Gaash, *left him to his fears*.
 10 When all that generation had
 Been gathered to their fathers' *pad*,
 Another generation rose
 After them *as one might suppose*
 eWho did not know YHWH nor the work
 Which He had done for Israel's *kirk*.
 11 Then the children of Israel did
 Evil in YHWH's sight, *though they hid*,
 And served the Baals, 12 and they forsook
 YHWH the God that their fathers *took*,
 Who had brought them out of the land
 Of Egypt *to Canaanite strand*,
 And they followed other gods from
Among the folk's gods where they'd come,
 Who *were* all around them, and they
 Bowed down to them, and they provoked
 YHWH to anger *red hot and stoked*.
 13 They forsook YHWH and served Baal
 and
 The Ashtoreths *upon the land*.
 14 And the anger of YHWH was hot
 Against Israel. So He made plot
 To deliver them in the hands
 Of plunderers despoiling lands,
 And He sold them into the hands
 Of their foes all around *in band*,
 So that they could no longer stand
 Before their enemies. 15 Where they
 Went out, the hand of YHWH *that day*
 Was *raised* against them in the way
 For harm, as YHWH had said and just
 As YHWH had sworn to them *at first*.
 And so they were greatly distressed.
 16 Nevertheless, YHWH *always blessed*
 Raised up judges who saved them from
 The hand of plunderers to come.

Beloved, I thank You for the judges set
 In centuries past for salvation well met.
 But in my day salvation is alone
 Forgiveness it would seem from every
 groan
 Of sin I find within my hand and heart.
 The preacher of today will have no part
 Of saving me from muggers in the park

Or from the stalker hiding in the dark.
 Who intervene, even with only word,
 Are said to be betrayers of the stirred
 And lovely faith of Islam or of Christ.
 Salvation of oppressed's a loaf unsliced.
 Beloved, I thank You for the judges twelve
 Who mind me where to take haven and
 delve.

17 But they'd not listen to their judges,
 But they played the harlot in *smudges*
 With other gods, and bowed to them.
 They quickly rejected *the gem*,
 The way in which their fathers walked,
 Obeying the statutes YHWH *chalked*,
 They did not do so. 18 And when YHWH
 Raised up judges for them, and YHWH
 Was with the judge and saved them out
 Of their foes' hands *and with a shout*
 All the days of the judge, for YHWH
 Was moved to pity by their sighs
 Because of those *in wrathful cries*
 Who oppressed and harassed their sties.

19 And it came to pass, when the judge
 Was dead, they turned back to *their grudge*
 To walk more corruptly than their
 Fathers, by following *the fair*
Of other gods, to serve them and
 Bow down to them. They did not stand
 From their own doings nor from their
 Stubborn way. 20 Then the wrath of
 YHWH
 Was hot against Israel's *whole crew*,
 And He said "Since this nation has
 Transgressed My covenant whereas
 I'd commanded their fathers so,
 And has not heeded My voice' *show*,
 21 "I also will no longer drive
 Out before them *the hornet hive*
Of the nations which Joshua
 Left when he died *as a last straw*,
 22 "So that through them I may make test
 Of Israel, whether they are blessed
 To keep the ways of YHWH, to walk
 In them as their fathers in flock,
 Or not." 23 Therefore YHWH left those
 nations,
 Without driving them from their stations
 Straight away, nor did He give them
 Into Joshua's hand and hem.
 You always have provided guidance for

The people in their mountains and their shore,
 But soon as divine guide is hidden from
 The sight of run and mill, they take their sum
 And seek idolatry. That dark result
 Is always when men seek a sacred cult.
 Beloved, deliver me from churchly song,
 Mosque raising arm against the other's wrong,
 And synagogue of Satan. Let my path
 Find altars in the woodlands far from wrath,
 And chapter house beneath the blushing pine,
 A clear brook instead of communion wine,
 Where my baptisms daily shake from me
 In flashing diamonds falling fast and free.

Judges 3

1 Now these *are* the nations YHWH left,
 That He might test Israel *uncleft*
 By them, *that is*, all who'd not known
 Any wars Canaanite had shown,
 2 Only so that the generations
 Of Israel's folk might be taught rations
 Of war, those who'd not known before,
 3 Five lords of the Philistines, all
 The Canaanites, Sidonians' *thrall*,
 And the Hivites who lived in Mount
 Lebanon, and from *the account*
 Of Mount Baal Hermon to the way
 To enter Hamath *on a day*.
 4 And they were *left*, *that He might* test
 Israel by them, to know *at best*
 Whether they would obey *or not*
All the commandments that YHWH *taught*,
 Which He had commanded to their
 Fathers by Moses' hand *and care*.
 5 Thus Israel's folk lived there among
 The Canaanites, Hittites *unstrung*,
 The Amorites, the Perizzites,
 The Hivites, and the Jebusites.
 6 And they took their daughters to be
 Their wives, and gave their daughters *free*
 To their sons, and they served their gods.
 7 So Israel's folk did evil *pods*
 In the sight of YHWH. They forgot
 YHWH their Alohim, and were taught
 To serve Baals' and Asherahs' plot.

The second generation is well known

To leave what their fathers wrote down on
 stone
 And find another way, and a way worse
 Than what they had before to bless or
 curse.
 There's only one exception to be found
 In any faith that's served a kindly round,
 And that's when Ali washed the prophet
 dead
 And so missed out on the apostasy
 That other leaders had in hand and head.
 Let me stick to the business given me,
 The lowly washings of the brave and free,
 And leave the reared and foiled
 establishment
 Of faith to the turbaned and the unsent
 And look to fathers, mothers, and their
 bread.

8 Therefore the wrath of YHWH was hot
 Against Israel, and He made plot
 To sell them into the hand of
 Cushan-Rishathaim the king of
 Mesopotamia, and the folk
 Of Israel served *under the stroke*
 Of Cushan-Rishathaim eight years.

The First Judge: Fruitfulness

9 When Israel's folk cried out *in tears*
 To YHWH, YHWH raised up *in arrears*
 A saviour for Israel's folk, who
 Delivered them, Othniel the true
 Son of Kenaz, the younger brother
 Of Caleb. 10 The Spirit of YHWH
 Came on him, he judged Israel *true*.
 He went out to wage war, and YHWH
 Gave Cushan-Rishathaim king of
 Mesopotamia in his glove,
 And his hand prevailed over him,
 Over Cushan-Rishathaim.
 11 So the land had rest forty years.
 Then Othniel Kenaz' son met tears.

The king between the rivers is one said
 To have hands full of cruelty, not bread
 And in double cruelty he is fed.
 When plague at hand of humankind is
 spread
 Across the land, the people's hearts return
 To seek rest from the sent one and to learn

Peace at the feet of one well-taught in war.
 Peace always has the smell of fading gore.
 Beloved, I enter in the forty years
 Of rest before my demise from my fears
 And touch the wealth of silence that was
 bought
 With striving with both untaught and with
 taught.
 The days of Othniel under the son
 Speak of a task well sought and well begun.

When Othniel son of Kenaz came before
 He paved the way for Ali on the shore,
 The son of Abu Taleb for his fate,
 A saviour true, but one that did not wait
 Forty years peace after his warring late,
 But saw the foul apostasy arise
 Among his own and dear before his eyes.
 Who complicate their critical estate
 Against the fickleness of Israel's time
 Forget the ebb and flow of Muslim crime
 That battered Ali's heart and for that grime
 Sent him to silence waiting for the day
 When You should give an hour of divine
 sway.
 Beloved, Othniel's prophecy is great.

The Second Judge: Darkness

12 And Israel's folk again did wrong
 In the sight of YHWH *for a song*.
 So YHWH strengthened Eglon the king
 Of Moab against Israel's ring,
 Because they'd done the evil thing
 In the sight of YHWH. 13 Then he brought
 The people of Ammon *he sought*
 And Amalek, went to defeat
 Israel, and took possession's *seat*
In the City of Palms. 14 So then
 The children of Israel *like men*
 Served Eglon king of Moab for
 The space of eighteen years *in store*.
 15 But when Israel's children cried out
 To YHWH, YHWH raised up *without*
 doubt
 A saviour for them: Ehud son
 Of Gera, who was Benjamite,
 One left-handed *instead of right*.
 By him Israel's folk sent tribute
 To Eglon king of Moab's chute.
 16 Now Ehud made himself a dagger
 Double-edged with a cubit's swagger,

And fastened it under his clothes
 On his right thigh *not to expose*.
 17 So he brought the tribute to King
 Eglon of Moab *with a sting*.
 Now Eglon was a great fat man.
 18 And when he'd finished by his plan
 Giving the tribute *to the man*,
 He sent away the people who
 Had carried in the tribute due.
 19 But he himself turned back *away*
 From the stone images *that day*
 That were at Gilgal, and he said
 "I've got a secret message spread
 For you, O king." He said "Keep silence!"
 And all who attended *in violence*
 Went out from him. 20 And Ehud came
 To him sitting upstairs in aim
 To keep cool in his private room.
 Then Ehud said *to Eglon's doom*,
 "I've got a message for you from
 Alohim." He got up to come
 From *his* seat. 21 Then Ehud reached out
 With his left hand, and he took out
 The dagger from his right thigh, and
 Thrust it into that belly *grand*.
 22 Even the hilt after the blade
 Went in, and the fat on the blade
 Closed over *on the wound he made*.
 He did not draw the dagger out
 Of his pot, and his guts spilled out.

Who knows what heinous wrong Israel had
 done
 To give King Eglon place under the sun,
 Beside failure to cut the idol down
 That graced the high place of Canaanite
 crown?
 But so it was, and so Moab rejoiced
 To take the tribute Israel unvoiced.
 Ehud, like me, used left instead of right,
 And so was able to join in the fight
 Before the other knew what hand's about,
 And died before he had the time to doubt.
 Beloved, I pleasure in the tale of old,
 The blood and mess, the heart right stout
 and bold,
 Assured that by Your blessed command
 was sent
 The divine message in the gut and spent.

23 Then Ehud went out through the porch
 And shut the doors *so's not to scorch*

The upper room behind him and
Locked them. 24 When he'd gone out
unfanned,

Eglon's servants came there to look,
Surprise, the high room doors they took
For locked. So they said "He no doubt
Attends his needs to cool as stout."

25 They waited till they were ashamed,
And he still did not open famed
Doors of the upper room. Therefore
They took the key out *of the drawer,*
And opened *them.* And there behold
Their master on the floor and cold.

26 But Ehud had escaped while they
Delayed, and passed beyond the way
Of stone images and escaped
To Seirah *with the deed still draped.*

27 And it happened, when he arrived,
He blew the trumpet *of deprived*

In the mountains of Ephraim,
And Israel's folk went down with him
From the hills, and he led them *trim.*

28 Then he said to them, "Follow *me,*
For YHWH's delivered enemy,
The Moabites into your hand."

So they went down with him to stand,
And seized the fords of Jordan's strand
Leading to Moab, did not let
A soul cross over *for a debt.*

29 And at that time they killed about
Ten thousand men of Moab, stout,
All men of valour, not a man
Escaped. 30 So Moab under ban
Subdued that day under the hand
Of Israel. And so the land
Had rest for eighty years until
Another story fit the bill.

Beloved, I shut the doors on my good deeds
In hope the on-lookers with awful creeds
Will fail to see that I have had the grace
To bring a message from before Your face.
Beloved, I shut the doors against the crowd
Of evidence of what You have allowed,
And pray I may pass quietly, unbowed,
Beyond the images at Gilgal's gate.
I hurry on my whirling, do not wait
For sign nor protest, but rise to the state
To hear Your inner voice pronounce well
done

Before the setting of the churning sun.
Beloved, I shut the doors and steal away

To wait with You the breaking of the day.

The Third Judge: Disciplined of God

31 After him was Shamgar the son
Of Anath, who killed on *the run*
Six hundred men of Philistines
With an ox goad upon the tines,
And he too saved Israel's *combines.*

Hasan's secret diplomacy bore fruit
Reflected in the prophecy and root
Of Ehud, while the third slot brings to mind
The sacrifice Husseyn gave to the kind.
But here the slot of sacrifice and thirst,
That might in other places rise and burst
In flames of glory on the desert waste,
Comes with one single sentence and ox
goad

That killed six hundred Philistines that rode
Against the folk of Israel and load.
This book is too uplifting to make clear
The pains of future generations' fear.
Until then I bask in the victory
That graced Shamgar's ox goad and made it
see.

The Fourth Judge: Fragrance

Week 45 Judges 4

1 When Ehud was dead, Israel's folk
Again did evil at a stroke
In the sight of YHWH. 2 So YHWH sold
Them into the hand of *the bold*
Jabin king of Canaan, who reigned
In Hazor. The commander *feigned*
Of his army *was* Sisera,
Who lived in Harosheth *by law*
Of the peoples. 3 And Israel's folk
Cried out to YHWH, *cried out and spoke,*
For Jabin had nine hundred yoke
In iron chariots, and for
Twenty years he oppressed and tore
The children of Israel *to gore.*

What evil did Your people do that You
Sent Jabin out against rebellious crew?
You do not say, and yet I think the word
Is that they failed to secure idol stirred
To its destruction, failed in being just
As tolerant as in this world one must.

In those times iron cars were what
determined
Who ruled and who was counted among
vermined.
So it is now, they rule whose cars are plate
Of steel laced with depleted urani-ate.
It matters not if one rant or one cry
Beneath the cannon, acid rain in sky.
Beloved, speak up for once even if You
Must speak to Jabin the king in his due.

4 Now Deborah, a prophetess,
The wife of Lapidoth, *in dress*
Was judging Israel at that time.
5 And she would sit there *in her prime*
Under palm tree of Deborah
Between Ramah and Bethel's draw
In the mountains of Ephraim.
And the children of Israel trim
Came up to her for judgement *hymn*.
6 Then she sent and summoned Barak
Son of Abinoam, though slack,
From Kedesh and in Naphtali,
And said to him, "Is not YHWH nigh,
Israel's Alohim to command,
'Go and deploy at Mount Tabor
Ten thousand men and troops and more
Of Naphtali's sons and the sons
Of Zebulon, 7 'and by their tonnes
I'll send against you Sisera,
The commander of Jabin's maw,
With chariots and multitude
At the River Kishon *for brood*,
And I'll give him into your hand'?"
8 Barak told her to make a stand,
"If you will go with me, then I
Will go, but if you will sit by,
I will not go!" 9 So she said "I
Will surely go with you, but yet
There'll be no glory for you met
In the journey you undertake,
For YHWH will sell Sisera's *cake*
Into a woman's hand." Then rose
Deborah and went *on her toes*
With Barak to where Kedesh *flows*.

No doubt Barak thought Deborah's words
rose
From feminist retort against her foes
And in remark on how cowardice grows
Among her men. So prophecy goes down
As female chatter all around the town.

The future would show that her heart was
stirred
By the divine and the prophetic word.
Your world today, Beloved, is still inured
Against the many glories that appear
Like shining prophecies against the clear
Of lake and sky. Your many silences
Are truly veiled predictions of what is
And what is unknown to the blind and great
Whose veils prevent Your speaking to their
state.

10 And Barak called Zebulon and
Naphtali to Kedesh's *land*,
He went up with ten thousand men
Under command, and Deborah then
Went up with him. 11 Heber Kenite,
Of Hobab's folk, Hobab who was
Father-in-law of Moses, draws
Himself from the Kenites and pitched
His tent near terebinth *enriched*,
A tree at Zaanaim, that's by
Kedesh. 12 And they reported *sly*
To Sisera that Barak son
Of Abinoam *on the run*
Had gone up Mount Tabor *with gun*.
13 So Sisera gathered about
Him all his chariots in rout,
Nine hundred iron cars, and all
The people who *were* in his thrall,
From Harosheth Hagoyim to
The River Kishon *running through*.
14 Then Deborah said to Barak,
"Up! For this *is* the day *not slack*
In which YHWH has delivered in
Your hand Sisera *for his sin*. Has not
YHWH gone out before you?"
So Barak went down from *the view*
Of Mount Tabor with ten thousand
Men following him *in a band*.
15 And YHWH routed Sisera and
All his chariots, all *his band*
With the mouth of the sword *in hand*
Before Barak, and Sisera
Got down from *his* chariot *in awe*
And fled away on foot *and sand*.
16 But Barak pursued chariots
And the army running in ruts
As far as Harosheth of folk.
And all the army at the stroke,
The band of Sisera fell by
The mouth of the sword from the sky,

And not a man escaped to die.

You fought with Barak so that hand and sword

That killed the enemy was army of the Lord,

And though they chased oppressor and with arm,

Not one of the righteous men struck for harm.

But You did not raise the salvation there
Until they themselves climbed the heavy stair

With sword in hand against the iron cars.

In wonder, my Beloved, I gaze at stars

To see if any lead an army here.

They all look down in peace and without fear.

What woman's voice today proclaims Your hand

So that the armies with their stone slings stand

Against the cannons? Let none rise too soon,

But wait the Mahdi's coming and his noon.

17 But Sisera had fled away

On foot to tent of Jael's *sway*,

The wife of Heber the Kenite,

For *there was* peace between the right

King Jabin of Hazor and house

Of Heber the Kenite *and spouse*.

18 And Jael went out to meet the man

Sisera, and told him by plan,

"Turn aside, my lord, turn aside

To me, do not fear *to abide*."

And when he had *once* turned aside

With her into the tent, then she

Covered him with a blanket *free*.

19 Then he said to her, "Please give me

A little water to drink, see,

For I am thirsty." And so she

Opened a jug of milk, gave him

A drink, and then she covered him.

20 And he said to her, "Stand beside

The door of the tent, and if ride

Any men here to ask of you

And say 'Is there any man here?'

You shall say, 'No,' and thus be true."

21 Then Jael, Heber's wife, did not fear

To take a tent peg and a club

In her hand, and went *with the stub*

Softly to him and drove the peg

Into his temple *and not leg*,

And it went down into the ground,

For he was weary and slept sound.

And so he died where he was found.

22 And then, as Barak ran along

After Sisera, Jael *as strong*

Came out to meet him, and she said

To him, "Come, I will show you *spread*

The man whom you seek." And when he

Went in, there lay Sisera, dead

With the tent peg struck through his head.

23 So on that day Alohim put

Jabin Canaan's king under foot

In the presence of Israel's folk.

24 And the hand of Israel's folk woke

To grow stronger and stronger toward

Jabin king of Canaan *by sword*,

Until they had destroyed the king

Jabin of Canaan's everything.

The pure rejoicing in the gore and blood
Strikes me with wonder that the world in bud

With innocence, such innocence takes sword

Against craven enemies of the Lord.

Methinks the Christian duty is to do

The bloody deed with distaste and on cue

Instead of with such pleasure written wild.

Is not the Master loving, meek and mild?

It seems my living here in the obscene

Has made me more civilized than the queen.

I repent of pacific view and trim

And set my pseudo-mercy to be grim,

And thank You that You set in human heart

Emotions fit for every duty's part.

Judges 5

1 Then Deborah and Barak the son

Of Abinoam sang when done

On that day, saying 2 "When the chiefs

Lead in Israel, and without griefs

The people offer themselves up,

Bless YHWH! *And bless His mercy's cup!*

3 "Hear, O kings! Give ear, princes! I,

I will sing to YHWH, I'll sing *high*

Praise to YHWH God of Israel.

4 "YHWH, when You go out from Seir's well,

And when You march from Edom's field,

The earth trembles, the heavens yield,
The clouds also pour water out,
5 "The mountains gush before YHWH's
shout,

This Sinai, before YHWH the God
Of Israel *beneath His rod.*

The fourth of judges is the judge of song,
Mother and queen who knows to do no
wrong.

Her prophecy falls full and swells up high,
And rings with grateful joy against the sky.
She feels the trembling of the earth when
men

Mutter and turn their backs to sleep again.
She sees the heavens yield and clouds
rebound

Against the mountainside and gushing
sound

Of Sinai, where Your word fails not to ring
Out in all words that men and nature sing.
It takes both Deborah and Barak to
Reflect Zeynul 'Abideen's sparkling dew,
And show above the dry and scorching
earth

The raining clouds and Sinai's rushing
worth.

6 "In the days of Shamgar, the son
Of Anath, in the days Jael won,
The highways were deserted, and
The travellers walked on the sand.

7 "Village life ceased, ceased in Israel,
Until I, Deborah, *and Jael,*
Arose a mother in Israel.

8 "They chose new gods, then *there was*
war

In the gates, and not a shield nor
Spear was seen among forty more
Thousand in Israel. 9 "My heart's *score*
Is with the rulers of Israel

Who offered themselves without guile
With the people. Bless YHWH! 10 "Speak,
you

Who ride on white donkeys, and who
Sit in the judges' clothing *cast,*
And who walk along the road *fast.*

11 "Far from the archers' noise, among
The watering holes, there they'll have sung
The righteous acts of YHWH, the acts
Of righteous deeds *and righteous pacts*
For His villagers in Israel,

Then the folk of YHWH shall go well
Down to the gates *and rest a spell.*

I have no donkey pure and white that sings
Along the road down to the watering
springs,

But take my grizzled mule in hand to go
Along the archers' road to meet the show.
But if some day the mule I ride should die,
I pray You, my Beloved, who reign on
high,

That You remember what I covet best,
The white ass dressed in bells and stripy
vest,

A frisking beast with upraised ears and
crest.

With mule or donkey one thing is the same,
Who choose new gods, they are the ones to
blame

That war creeps unawares upon the land
And strikes the innocent and the wild band.
Beloved, strike idols down upon the sand.

12 "Awake, awake, Deborah! Awake,
Awake, sing a song *at the stake!*
Arise, Barak, and lead away
Your captives, O son *of the day,*
And son of Abinoam's stay!

13 "Then all the survivors came down,
The folk against nobles *and crown,*
YHWH came down for me and to fight
Against their *oppression and* might.

14 "From Ephraim *were* those whose roots
Were in Amalek *near his boots.*

After you, Benjamin, with folk,
From Machir rulers came down *broke,*
And from Zebulon those who bear
Recruiter's staff *and things to wear.*

15 "And the princes of Issachar
Were with Deborah, as Issachar,
So *was* Barak sent to the vale
Under his command to prevail
Among divisions of Reuben
Great resolves in the hearts *of men.*

16 "Why did you sit in the sheepfold,
To hear flocked pipings *for the bold?*
The bands of Reuben have great search
Of heart. 17 "Gilead stayed in lurch
Beyond the Jordan, while why did
Dan remain on the ships *to skid?*
Asher stayed camping on seashore,
Dwelling by his inlets *to roar.*

18 "Zebulun is a folk *who* risked
 Their lives to the point of death *frisked*,
 Naphtali also, on the heights
 Of the battlefield *set his sights*.
 19 "The kings came out *and came* to fight,
 The kings of Canaan out to smite
 In Taanach, by Megiddo's stream,
 They took no spoils of silver *seam*.
 20 "They fought from the skies' canopies,
 The stars in their courses to seize
 Sisera. 21 "The flood of Kishon
 Swept them away *when they had done*,
 That ancient torrent, Kishon's stream.
 O my soul, march on in the *team*
Of strength! 22 "Then horses' hooves shall
 pound,
 The galloping, galloping sound
 Of his steeds. 23 "'Curse Meroz around,'
 Said the angel of YHWH, 'And curse
 Bitterly its dwellers for worse,
 Because they did not come to help
 YHWH, To help YHWH against the whelp
 Of the mighty *upon the ground*.'

Even the blessed Qur'an of holy fame
 Deigns to quote Deborah some if not her
 name
 In the great Sura of the running steeds
 That give rejoicing memory to Your deeds,
 Beloved, who trample on the earth such
 kings
 As come to muddy shepherdess's springs.
 I hear the rushing manes and tails for wind,
 I hear the pounding hooves where kings
 have sinned,
 And rise to sing a song in praise to You
 For all salvation's acts in what You do.
 Beloved, send out the chargers on the plain,
 And cover scorching sun with freshening rain,
 Give every woman tent pin and the hand
 To liberate from care the oppressed land.

24 "Most blessed among women is Jael,
 The wife of Heber, Kenite *pale*,
 Blessed is she among women's tents.
 25 "He asks for water, she relents
 To give him milk, she brought out cream
 Poured in a lordly bowl *to gleam*.
 26 "She stretched her hand to the tent peg,
 Her right hand to the workmen's hammer,
 She pounded Sisera *to beg*
 Piercing his head, she split with clamour

And struck his temple through and through.
 27 "He sank at her feet *where she drew*,
 He fell, he lay still, at her feet
 He sank, he fell *at his retreat*,
 Where he sank down, there he fell dead.
 28 "The mother of Sisera *fled*
 Looked through the window, and cried out
 Through the lattice, 'Why is his stout
 Car long in coming? Why the stay
 Of clattering chariots in the way?'
 29 "Her wisest ladies answered her,
 Yes, she herself answered to purr,
 30 'Are they not finding out the coil,
 Killing the foe, dividing spoil:
 To every man a girl *or two*,
 For Sisera, plundered dyed hue,
 Plunder of garments broidered, dyed,
 Two pieces of dyed broidery
 For the neck on the looter's side?'
 31 "Thus let all Your enemies see
 Destruction, O YHWH! But *let* those
 Who love Him *be* like the sun's clothes
 When it comes out in its full strength."
 The land had rest forty years' length.

The mother of Sisera, cow and witch,
 Who would give in his hand the virgin's
 stitch,
 May she burn in the grave and in its hell
 As long as there is place and time to tell.
 But every hand of mother bearing bowls
 Of milk sweeter than Kauthar to our souls
 Be blessed with cherished deeds and with
 the throw
 Of awful acts when tyrants must lay low.
 The hand that makes embroidery and fine
 May also stir dissimulation's wine
 And touch the hammer that gives fatal blow
 To every despot who would rise to show
 That life and love in Europe's
 commonwealth
 Deserts true faith and justice in its stealth.

The Fifth Judge: Hearing

Week 46 Judges 6

1 Israel's folk did evil in sight
 Of YHWH. So YHWH delivered right
 Into the hand of Midian
 For seven years *for all their sin*.
 2 And the hand of Midian prevailed
 Against Israel, *naked, unveiled*.

Because of the Midianites' press,
 Israel's folk made themselves address
 In dens, in caves, and the stronghold
 Which *are* upon the mountains *cold*.
 3 And it was, when Israel had sown,
 Midianites would come up full-blown,
 Also Amalekites and folk
 Of the east would come up in stroke.
 4 Then they would camp against them and
 Destroy the produce of the land
 As far as Gaza, leaving none
 Of substance for Israel in sun,
 Neither sheep nor oxen nor ass.
 5 For they would come up on the grass
 With their livestock and with their tents,
 Coming like locust crowd prevents,
 Both they and their camels without
 Number to enter land with rout.
 6 So Israel was greatly made poor
 Because the Midianites ran sure,
 And Israel's folk cried out to YHWH
To see what He might come and do.

Reciting Your names was the way back
 when
 The judges saved the folk from evil men
 That You required before You raised a
 hand
 To destroy injustice out of the land.
 The injustice I see today may come
 From the evil that every bloke and bum
 That has wealth in oil and gold wants to
 share
 With those he brings under his loving care.
 But the spread of that evil meets the wall
 That rises from the fury of the squall
 That my reciting of Your name brings
 down.
 If I were less gadding about the town
 And more faithful in whirling to the sound
 Of Your name, more justice might then be
 found.

7 And it came to pass, when the folk
 Of Israel cried out *in provoke*
 To YHWH because of Midianites,
 8 That YHWH sent a prophet of lights
 To the children of Israel, who
 Said to them, "Now then thus says YHWH
 The Alohim of Israel,
 'I brought you up from Egypt *land*
 And brought you out *with a high hand*

Of the house of bondage, 9 'and I
 Delivered you out of the hand
 Of the Egyptians coming nigh
 And out of the hand of all who
 Oppressed you, and drove them out *too*
 Before you and gave you their land.
 10 'Also I said to you, "I'm YHWH
 Your Alohim, don't fear the gods
 Of the Amorites, *which are clods*,
 In whose land you live." But you've not
 Obeyed My voice *as you were taught.* '"

Beloved, You do not know how scientific
 The local gods sound, they're really
 terrific.

It seems a fool's errand to stand and dance
 About to Your name, a mere turn and
 prance.

There is no scientific evidence
 That song or dance any evil prevents.
 It seems a fool's errand to say that God
 Sends rain upon the dry and fruitless clod,
 When all know how Baal works upon the
 sea

To bring the vapors up and cyclically
 Blows down the clouds the Baal sun
 vaporized

In rains upon the fields so solemnized.
 Since sense and science tell me that is true,
 A fool's errand it seems to obey You.

11 The Angel of YHWH came and sat
 Under the terebinth tree at
 Ophrah, which *belonged* to Joash
 The Abiezrite, while his *rash*
 Son Gideon threshed wheat in winepress,
 In order to hide *it's address*
 From the Midianites *who oppress*.

12 And the Angel of YHWH appeared
 To him, and said to him *who feared*,
 "YHWH *is* with you, you mighty man
 Of valour!" 13 And then Gideon ran
 To say to him, "O my lord, if
 YHWH *is* with us, why is the skiff
 Of ours foundering? And where *are*
 All His miracles which our far
 Fathers told us about, and said
 'Did not YHWH bring us up and led
 From Egypt?' But now YHWH's forsaken
 Us and delivered us who're taken
 By the hands of the Midianites."

14 Then YHWH turned to him in his sights

And said "Go in this might of yours,
 And you shall save Israelites' *shores*
 From the hand of the Midianites.
 Have I not sent you *in your rights*?"
 15 So he said to Him, "O my Lord,
 How can I save Israel *from sword*?
 Indeed my kin's the weakest in
 Manasseh, and I *am* the *gin*
 Least in my father's house *and bin*."
 16 And YHWH said to him, "Surely I
 Will be with you, *and will be nigh*,
 And you'll defeat the Midianites
 As one man *fallen from their heights*."
 17 Then he said to Him, "If now I
 Have found favour before Your eye,
 Then show me a sign that it's You
 Who talk with me *and tell me true*.
 18 "Do not depart from here, I pray,
 Until I come to You and slay
 My offering and set before You."
 And He said "I will wait until
 You come back *with your basket fill*."

As I complain that You showed face alone
 To the Egyptian Pharaoh on his throne
 And cast oppressor in the Red Sea's wave
 To find in Egypt an unsunken grave,
 But never stir to save the oppressed now
 Who sit on the Euphrates for a bow,
 So Gideon had the nerve to speak up to
 Your angel and submit a thing or two
 Complaining of the lack of cry and hue
 From heaven upon the weakest and the
 true,
 Beloved, You spoke to him and then You
 did

A thing without the din of the unbid,
 And so I pray You knock down hall of
 State
 With power and rout and down who
 agitate.

19 So Gideon went in and prepared
 A young goat, and as much as dared
 Unleavened bread from an ephah
 Of flour. The meat he put in straw
 Basket, and he put broth in pot,
 And he brought *them* out to the spot
 Where he was underneath the tree,
 The terebinth present to *see*.
 20 The Angel of Alohim said
 To him, "Take the meat and the bread
 Unleavened and lay *them* upon

This rock, and pour the broth out on."
 And he did so. 21 Angel of YHWH
 Put out the end of the staff *new*
 That *was* in his hand, touched the meat
 And the unleavened cakes for treat,
 And there rose up fire from the rock
 And consumed the meat and the stock
 Of yeastless. And Angel of YHWH
 Departed from his sight *and view*.
 22 Now Gideon perceived that he
Was the Angel of YHWH. So he,
 Gideon said "Alas, O Lord YHWH!
 For I have seen Angel of YHWH
And face to face." 23 Then YHWH told
 him,
 "Peace *be* with you, do not fear *grim*,
 You shall not die." 24 So Gideon
 Built an altar there to YHWH *drawn*,
 And called its name there YHWH is Peace.
 To this day it still does not cease
 In Ophrah of Abiezrites' *piece*.

I protest, my Beloved, Your angel's task
 In burning up good food and there to ask.
 Did You not know that many had no taste
 Of bread at all, and there it goes to waste.
 Another thing, remember Gideon
 Was in the winepress for a thing he'd done
 To hide what bread he had from Midianite,
 And Your angel blew up a cloud in spite
 Of smoke before the wind such as betrays
 The hideout of our hero and his ways.
 Send no such angel to my plot, I plead,
 Let me at least save of last season's seed.
 Keep angel to Yourself, or else till now
 Let such be invisible where I bow.

25 And so it came to pass the same
 Night that YHWH said to him *by name*,
 "Take your father's young bull, another
 Bull of seven years old *to its brother*,
 And break down the altar of Baal
 That your father has, and impale
 The wooden image that's beside it,
 26 "And build an altar *to deride it*
 To YHWH your God upon this rock
 In the right arrangement and stock,
 And take the second bull and make
 Burnt sacrifice with wood and stake
 Of the image which you'll cut down."

When gross idolatry's send from the land,

Your instruments in holy flesh demand
That what of Your creation was purloined
In dedication to the false enjoined
Should be returned to You in love and
right.

That's why in ancient Mecca the moon's
light

That once was worshiped was restored to
be,

Not candle on the altar, but in fee,
Hung outside every mosque, so all should
know

What is created in the world below
Must not be worshiped in prostration's
glow.

The Kaaba itself and the darkened stone
Were taken in the clutch of idols' drone,
But now are given back to You alone.

27 So Gideon took ten men from town
Among his servants, did as YHWH
Had said to him. But because true
It was he feared his father's house
And the men of the city's *spouse*
Too much to do *the thing* by day,
He did *it in gloom of night's sway*.

28 And when that place's men arose
Early in the morning *to pose*,
There was the altar of Baal, thrown
Down, and the wooden image prone
Beside it cut down, and the second
Bull was being offered as reckoned
On the altar *which had been* built.

29 And they told one another wilt,
"Who has done this thing?" And when they
Had inquired and asked, then said they
"Gideon the son of Joash did

This thing, *and then he ran and hid*."

30 Then the men of the city said
To Joash, "Bring out your son *fled*,
That he may die, because he's thrown
Down the altar of Baal *in stone*,
And because he's cut down the *stake*
And wooden image for its sake."

31 But Joash said to all who stood
Against him, "Would you plead for *wood*
And Baal? Would you save him? Let who
Would plead for him be put to due
Death by the morning! If he's god,
Let him plead for himself *in prod*,
Because his altar's been thrown down!"

32 Therefore on that day *of renown*

He called him Jerubbaal, saying
"Let Baal plead against him *a thing*,
Because he broke his altar's *wing*."

Beloved, I see the cunning laws abound
That call to Baal with scientific sound,
And laugh at love for You, and pound for
pound,

Because You are invisible to me.
I do not ask that You come out to see,
Nor that Your face look on Reality,
Nor that the crowd of sages by decree
Admit that You create immensity,
But that my heart may be unswerving from
The way of Your renown and not to come
To worship Baal in church or parliament
Along with those chosen but never sent.
Beloved, pull down the altars with a rent
And list the lost for law of justice bent.

33 Midianites and Amalekites,
The children of the east *by rights*,
Gathered together, and they crossed
Over and camped in the Vale lost
Of Jezreel. 34 But Spirit of YHWH
Came on Gideon, and then he blew
The trumpet, and the Abiezrites
Gathered behind him *for the fights*.
35 And he sent messengers throughout
All Manasseh, who also stout
Came behind him. He also sent
Messengers to Asher, and went
To Zebulon, and Naphtali,
And they came up too by and by.

36 So Gideon said to Alohim,
"If You will save Israel by scheme
Of my hand as You have told me,
37 "Look, I shall make a wool fleece be
On the threshing floor, if there is
Dew on the fleece only, and *is*
Dry on all the ground, then I'll know
That You'll save Israel by my show,
As You have said." 38 And it was so.
When he got up the next morning
And squeezed the fleece about to wring
The dew out of the fleece, he got
A bowlful of the water sought.
39 Then Gideon said to Alohim,
"Do not be angry with my *dream*,
But let me speak just once more time:
Let me test, I pray, with the *prime*
Fleece just once more, let it now be

Dry only on the fleece, but see
On all the ground let there be dew.”
40 And Alohim did so that night.
It was dry on the fleece as due,
But dew on all the ground *in sight*.

Though I may invent signs and signs again
Through which You may speak to the crass
of men,
The fact is if a man comes out of hiding
And casts a doubt upon the customs biding
And throws down Baal and all opinion
public,
He must find enemy rise in the rubric.
As soon as idol of majority
Was broken and burnt up without decree,
The armies of the Midianites appeared.
And that is just what Gideon had feared.
Beloved, I keep my sacred, secret frame
Of winepress where I cantillate Your name,
So let the armies rest and not come up
To break my gilded plate and milky cup.

Judges 7

1 Then Jerubbaal, that's Gideon,
And all the folk who rose at dawn
With him encamped beside the well
Of Harod, so the camp as well
Of Midianites was on the side
Toward the north of them to bide
By the hill of Moreh in vale.
2 And YHWH said to Gideon *to hail*,
“The folk with you are too abundant
For Me to put the Midianites
Into their hands *as folk redundant*,
Lest Israel claim glory for fights
Against Me, saying ‘My own hand
Has saved me *from the Midian band*.’
3 “Now therefore, proclaim in the hearing
Of the people, saying *endearing*,
‘Whoever is scared and afraid,
Let him turn around *in the glade*
And go at once from Mount Gilead.’”
And twenty-two thousand men left,
And ten thousand remained *bereft*.
4 And YHWH said to Gideon, “The folk
Are still too many for the stroke,
Bring them down to the water edge,
And I'll test them for you *by hedge*.
Then it will be, *that* of whom I
Say to you, ‘This one shall go by
You,’ the same shall go with you, and

Of whomever I give command,
‘This one shall not go with your *band*,’
That one shall not go, *but shall stand*.”
5 So he brought down the people to
The water. To Gideon said YHWH,
“Everyone who laps from the stream
With his tongue, like a dog laps *cream*,
You shall set apart by himself,
Likewise everyone who *like elf*
Gets down on his knees to drink, *deem*.”
6 And the number of those who lapped,
Putting hand to their mouth *unclapped*,
Was three hundred men, but the rest
Of the people had done their best
To get down on their knees to drink.
7 Then YHWH told Gideon *to think*,
“By the three hundred men who lapped
I will save you, deliver *wrapped*
The Midianites into your hand.
Let all the people in that *band*
Go to their own place in the land.”

Now that I know that You will save the
race
With hardly more than three hundred
apace,
And without sword, but only shouting out
Your name and breaking pitchers all about
And carrying of lamps to frighten all
The senators and civil servants' gall,
Then I too shall put fear off from the wall
And eagerly join forces with the few
Who lap the water up and drink the dew.
But if You mean to use atomic bombs
Along with wheat and oats and without
qualms,
Then count me out of Your army and stand.
I take peace in my hand from Your
command.

8 So the folk took provisions and
Their trumpets each in his own hand.
And he sent away all *the folk*
Of Israel, every man *and bloke*
To his tent, and retained those three
Hundred men *for the mutiny*.
And the host of Midian was down
Below him in the valley *town*.
9 It came to pass that very night
That YHWH said to him, “Rise, go right
Down in the camp, for I've delivered
It into your hand *lily-livered*.”

10 "But if you are afraid to go,
Go down to the camp with *the show*
Of Purah your servant below,
11 "And you shall hear what they will say,
And afterward your hands' purvey
Shall be strengthened to go down to
The host *of Midian and crew.*"
Then he went down with Purah his
Servant to the guard post that is
Of the armed men who *were* in host.
12 Now the Midianites and boast
Of Amalekites, all the folk
Of the east, were lying in vale
As numerous as locusts' *trail*,
And their camels *were* without number,
As the sand by the seashore's *slumber*
In multitude. 13 When Gideon
Had come, there was a man begun
Telling dream to his companion.
He said "Now I have had a dream:
A sudden loaf of barley beam
Tumbled into Midianite camp,
It came to a tent and *the scamp*
Struck it so that it fell down flat,
And the tent lay where it was at."
14 Then his companion answering
Said "This *is* nothing but the sting
Of the sword of Gideon the son
Of Joash, man of Israel's *run!*
Into his hand gives Alohim
Midian, the whole host *in regime.*"

Ah, look! This man called Gideon is not
Unafraid of the Midianite in plot.
He took along his servant Purah to
Hold his hand in the darkness and the dew.
He was to take companion only if
His fear was making him shake and too
stiff
To find his way to camp there in the dark.
And so he took a servant for a spark.
See here, Beloved, the sinews of man's
heart.
While I like Gideon trust You and Your
planned,
I still crave a weak mortal to hold hand,
Despite the fact I know the two of us
Are no match for the bomb and
blunderbuss.
That's just the way we humans rise and
stand.

15 And it was so, when Gideon heard
The telling of the dream and word
Of meaning, that he fell prostrate.
He returned to Israel's estate,
And said "Get up, for YHWH has given
The host of Midian for to live in."
16 Then he divided in three camps
The three hundred men *with their lamps*,
And put a trumpet in each hand,
With empty pitchers, and *to stand*
The lamps inside the pitchers' *brand*.
17 And he said to them, "Look at me
And do as I do, watch, and see
When I come to the edge of camp
You shall do as I do *and stamp:*
18 "When I blow the trumpet, I and
All who *are* with me *there to stand*,
Then you also blow on the horns
On every side of all their bourns,
And say, 'YHWH and of Gideon!'"
19 So Gideon and the hundred men
Who *were* with him came to the edge
Of the host at beginning pledge
Of the middle watch, just as they
Had posted the watch *for the fray*,
And they blew the trumpets and broke
The pitchers in each hand of bloke.

You put no sword in my hand, no, nor gun,
But only pitcher, lamp, and trumpet won.
The trumpet gives its certain sound of
YHWH,
The lamp lightens the enemy to view,
The pitcher that contains the light returns
Taking nectar from alabaster urns.
The three weapons I have can kill no soul,
And so I find in license the clear goal.
Beloved, work Your will on the enemy
That hides within the chambered soul and
me,
Work out Your hate and burning fire of
love
Upon the outside foe from bush to shove,
And I shall be faithful to run in dark
And rejoice at Your coming to the park.
20 Then the three companies blew horns
And broke the pitchers *to their scorns*,
And held the torches in left hand
And the trumpets in right *to stand*
And blow, and they cried, "Sword of
YHWH

And of Gideon *and his crew!*"

21 And every man stood in his place
All around the camp *at a trace*,
And the whole army ran and cried
And ran and fled *before the tide*.

22 When the three hundred blew their
horns,

YHWH set every man's sword on corns
Of his companion through the whole
Host, and the army fled the toll
To Beth Acacia, toward Zererah,
As far *and fast as flying arrow*
To border of Abel Meholah,
By Tabbath *without coat or bowler*.

23 And the men of Israel came from
Naphtali, Asher, and the sum
Of Manasseh, and pursued them,
The Midianites *by stratagem*.

24 Then Gideon sent messengers through
All the mountains of Ephraim *too*,
Saying "Come down against *the crew*
Of Midianites, and take from them
The waters as far as *the hem*
Of Beth Barah and the Jordan."

Then all the men of Ephraim
Came together and they began
To take the waters as far as
Beth Barah and what Jordan has.
25 They captured of the Midianite
Two princes, Oreb and the wight
Zeeb. They killed Oreb at the rock
Of Oreb, and Zeeb with a stock
They killed at the winepress of Zeeb.
They followed Midian *like grebe*
And brought heads of Oreb and Zeeb
To Gideon on the other side
Of the Jordan *and to confide*.

I bide my time, Beloved, with burning
bright
Lamp hidden in the alabaster night
Of pitcher dry and waiting for the time
When all things shall fly out and rote and
rhyme
Shall sound aloud and break on further
shore

To open every window, every door.
I bide my time, Beloved, with trumpet set
To lip ready to sound my first regret
That You are hidden from the sight of men
Who live as though You should never again
Speak in the hearing, in the cloud and fire

To melt as one all human love's desire
In hate and apathy in one great pyre.
I break the pitcher now and wind the wire.

Week 47 Judges 8

1 The men of Ephraim said to him,
"Why did you follow your own whim
Not calling us to help in battle
To slaughter Midianites like cattle?"
And so they chided him for wrong.

2 He answered them, "Am I so strong
To do such things as you have done?
Is not the gleaning of the vine
Of Ephraim greater *paragon*
Than all of Abiezer's wine?"

3 "Alohim gave into your hands
Midian's, Oreb's, and Zeeb's chiefs,
And when it comes to reprimands,
Compared with yours, my works are
griefs."

When he said so their anger ended,
Subsided as they comprehended.

Who have the truth contained in words writ
large

In creeds and hymns, who have their altars
gold

And jewel-crusted, who have ancient
charge

Of great and faithful men both wise and
old,

Who have convention, power, and wealth
to spend

In charity upon the worthy poor,
Whose faith is shared by thousands that
defend

Their creeds in leather volume and
brochure,

Are like the men of Ephraim to me.

My only truth and creed and hymn and see
Are You, Beloved, You are my only tree
Of life, prophet, convention, power and
wealth.

My little faith is not parade but stealth
And silences as long as I have health.

4 When Gideon came to Jordan's *stream*,
He and three hundred *of the cream*
Of men who *were* with him crossed over,
Exhausted, still pursuing *rover*.

5 Then he said to Succoth's men there,
"Please give *me* loaves of bread to share

With the people who follow me,
 For they're exhausted, and I be
 Pursuing Zebah and Zalmunna,
 Kings of Midian." 6 And they said sooner,
 The leaders of Succoth, "The hands
 Of Zebah and Zalmunna's *lands*
 Are they now in your hand, that we
 Should provide bread to your army?"
 7 So Gideon said "For this cause, when
 YHWH has delivered *me the men*
 Zebah and Zalmunna into
 My hand, then I will *come to you*
 And tear your flesh with desert thorns
 And with briers *for your looks and*
scorns!"

8 Then he went up from there unto
 Penuel and spoke to them true
 In the same way, and Penuel's men
 Answered him as had answered when
 He was in Succoth. 9 So he spoke
 Also saying to Penuel's folk,
 "When I come back in peace, I'll tear
 This tower down, *and that I swear!*"

The populace between two armies is
 Always in trouble or else in a tiz.
 Both armies swear to destroy those who fail
 To give both bread and meat and without
 sale

And water to the thirsty tribe of those
 Who rise up to devour the land they chose.
 The words of those who lived in Succoth
 and

The fair resorts of Penuel's green land
 Reveal the clinging truth that still remains
 Upon the human path with bloody stains.
 Beloved, I come to You with no demands
 For bread or safety, since You known my
 stands.

Nor do You take the corn out of my bin
 To pay for Your blessings or for my sin.

10 Now Zebah and Zalmunna *were*
 At Karkor, with their armies' stir,
 About fifteen thousand in all
 Who were left of the army's *call*
 To the folk of the east, for one
 Hundred and twenty thousand done
 Who drew the sword had fallen, won.
 11 Then Gideon went up by the road
 Of those who live in tents' abode
 In front of Nobah and Jogbehah,

And he attacked, *where he could see her*,
 The army feeling camped secure.

12 When Zebah and Zalmunna *sure*
 Fled, he pursued them, and he took
 The two kings of Midian, *the crook*
 Zebah and Zalmunna, and routed
 The whole army, *that had not scouted.*

13 Then Gideon son of Joash came
 Back from the battle, *with acclaim*
 From the Ascent of Heres. 14 And
 He caught a young man *in his hand*
 Of men of Succoth to demand
 Him and he wrote down for him all
 The leaders of Succoth to call
 Its elders, seventy-seven men.

15 Then he came to the men *again*
 Of Succoth, said "Here are Zebah
 And Zalmunna, about whose awe
 You ridiculed me, saying '*Are*
 The hands of Zebah and *the star*
 Zalmunna now in your hand, that
 We should give bread to your men's
scat?'"

16 He took the elders of the city,
 And desert thorns, briers *without pity*,
 And with them he taught Succoth's men.

17 Then he tore down the tower *again*
 Of Penuel and killed the men
 Of the city *where they were at.*

Beware, and listen to the army's chief
 Such people are as faithful as the thief
 To do as they have promised for relief.
 They always take the trouble to tear down
 The tower of those for whom they have a
 frown.

When people come with guns the best to do
 Is smile and say take both my shirt and
 shoe.

Soldiers wear guns, policemen too, are
 guards,
 And hunters when alighting with their
 pads.

Beloved, take stock of Your own human
 store
 And see how much is spoiled to blood and
 gore,
 And how much left to pestilence and fate
 Of famine. See if we are doing great.
 If so, come knock down towers, don't be
 late.

18 He said to Zebah and Zalmunna,
 “What kind of men *were they* you *sooner*
 Killed at Tabor?” So they replied,
 “As you *are*, so *were they beside*,
 Each was like the son of a king.”
 19 And he said “Each was my sibling,
 Sons of my mother. *As* YHWH lives,
 If you had let them live, *it gives*
 I would not kill you.” 20 And he said
 To Jether his firstborn *and bred*,
 “Get up and kill them!” But the youth
 Would not draw his sword, for *in truth*
 He was afraid, being still young,
And having not yet blood on tongue.
 21 So Zebah and Zalmunna said
 “Get up yourself, and kill us dead,
 For as a man *is*, so *’s* he fed.”
 So Gideon arose and killed
 Zebah and Zalmunna, and filled
 His pockets with the ornaments,
 Crescents, camels’ appurtenance.

Some think an Arab is not loath to die
 If he who kills him is not on the sly
 A weakling but a strong man and a guy.
 It is not so, despite these two kings’ word.
 Before death every human heart is stirred.
 The strong man’s choice is made not on the
 weight
 Of Your law, but his own desire and hate.
 He understands that life is in his hand
 And so he does not ask for Your command.
 Beloved, give me not power to decide fate
 Of men or women, even those I hate.
 Give me no choice to kill and kill again
 As has been the lot of so many men.
 Give me the helpless heart You seem to
 rate.

22 The men of Israel told Gideon,
 “Rule over us, both you and son,
 And your grandson also, for you
 Have saved us from Midianite crew.”
 23 But Gideon said to them, “I will
 Not rule over you, nor instill
 My son to govern you, for YHWH
It is who shall rule over you.”

The mark of one sent from You, my
 Beloved,
 For whom the universe is glaived and
 gloved,

Is that when rabble rubs the stick to shove
 Him on the throne to set his will above
 The prattling populace, he lifts a voice
 And makes of rulership another choice.
 Who truly rules rules none on earth in vice,
 In flesh and blood and taxing in a trice,
 But rather rules his own hearth and his will
 Alone and lets the others foot the bill.
 When any’s found that keeps tongue, hand
 and paunch
 In check and yet lays no burden or launch
 Upon another, he’s Your sent and own.
 How rarely such sit on the hidden throne.

24 And then Gideon said to them,
 “I would like to request a gem
 Of you, that each of you would give
 Me the earrings from his war spoils.”
 For they had gold earrings in coils,
 Because they *were* Ishmaelite men.
 25 And they answered, “We’re glad again
 To give *them*.” And they spread a cloth
 Out, and each man threw on the cloth
 The earrings from his spoils of war.
 26 Now the weight of the gold in store
 Of the earrings that he requested
 Was one thousand seven hundred *vested*
In gold, besides the crescent things,
 Pendants, and purple robes of kings
 Of Midian, and besides chains
 Around their camels’ necks *and reins*.
 27 Then Gideon made it into
 An ephod and brought it up to
 His city, Ophrah. *All the folk*
Of Israel played the harlot *poke*
 With it there. It became a snare
 To Gideon and to his house’ *share*.

The Arabs used to wear rings made of gold
 Upon their ears and hands, and chains to
 fold
 About their necks and arms, ankles and
 wrists,
 And on their fingers, everything but fists.
 That’s why the people got so much gold
 told,
 Although a blanket is more use in cold,
 And when ice is born out of winter mists
 To form crystals of quartz and amethysts.
 Beloved, though I ransack your temple fort
 Looking for treasures to increase my sport,
 I find no gold within the chambered cave

Of stone about my heart, the heart of slave,
Until Your presence splashes through the
gloom
And shows the gold of daffodils in bloom.

28 Thus Midian was subdued before
The children of Israel *in score*,
So they lifted their heads no more.
And the land was quiet and calm
For forty years in Gideon's palm.
29 Then Jerubbaal son of Joash
Went, lived in his own house *and cache*.
30 And Gideon had seventy sons
Who were the offspring of his buns,
For he had wives and wives in tonnes.
31 And his concubine who *was* in
Shechem also bore him in kin
A son, whose name he called at last
Abimelech. 32 Now Gideon passed,
The son of Joash died when old,
And he was buried in the *cold*
Tomb of Joash his father, in
Ophrah of Abiezrites' *bin*.

The Sixth Judge: Silence

33 It came to pass when he was dead,
After Gideon Israel fed
Again to play the harlot *led*
With Baals, and made Baal-Berith god
Upon a hard, unfaithful sod.
34 Thus the children of Israel did
Not remember YHWH their God's *bid*,
Who had saved them from all their foes,
35 Nor did they show kindness to those
Of the house of Jerubbaal called
Gideon for the good installed
He'd done for Israel *appalled*.

Beloved, I thank You that I have no folk,
Nor country, nor church, nor gold in my
poke.

For every time the human heart makes band
To stand up as a nation on the land,
Or as a congregation set in pew,
It finds an excuse to abandon You.
So like the Pharisee, I go up from
My heart temple where I have enjoyed hum
Justified in my own conceits to know
That I have not lifted to Baal a show.
Beloved, save me from every faith and
creed

And from my own thoughts and my
righteous deed
That You alone might be my food and
drink,
The only lust I hanker on the brink.

Judges 9

1 Abimelech son of Jerubbaal
Went to Shechem, *to cause some trouble*,
To his mother's brothers, and spoke
With them and with all on the yoke
Of the house of his mother's father,
Saying 2 "Speak, I pray, in ears rather
Of all men of Shechem 'Whether
It is better for every fer,
That all seventy sons at the stir
Of Jerubbaal reign over you,
Or that *just* one reign over you?"
Remember I'm your flesh and bone."
3 And his mother's brothers *were prone*
To speak all these words in the ears
Of all Shechem's men for his *fears*,
And their heart was inclined to follow
Abimelech, for they said *hollow*,
"He is our brother." 4 So they gave
Him seventy silver *shekels* glaive
From the temple of Baal-Berith,
With which Abimelech beneath
Hired vain and lewd persons *to wallow*
And follow after him *to swallow*.

Behold, Beloved, the way political,
First one must campaign by juridical,
And then buy followers to suit the law
Of survival of witness at the draw.
Who sit for office, whether run or stand,
They always have a seemly, hired band
To play their tunes to make the crowdies
roar

In praise of idol worship on the shore.
Beloved, I prefer Your system of lot
To choose the kings of Israel not bought.
Such senators and bishops would be caught
Far less with hand in till and on the spot.
Beloved, I whirl about in sacred plot
And cast my pennies copper in the pot.
5 Then he went to his father's house
At Ophrah and killed man and spouse
Of his brothers, the seventy sons
Of Jerubbaal, on one stone's *runs*.
But Jotham youngest son of all
Jerubbaal's *sons* had missed the brawl,

But forgive me my spoof in poetry,
Lest I hang twisting from the nearest tree.
Instead let my art find a berry patch
Where I can pick blackberries with a
snatch.

22 After Abimelech had reigned
Over Israel three years *and stained*,
23 Alohim sent spirit of ill
Will between Abimelech still
And the men of Shechem, and they,
The men of Shechem would betray
Abimelech, 24 that the crime *done*
To the seventy sons *when won*
Of Jerubbaal might be set down
And their blood be laid on *the crown*
Of their brother Abimelech,
Who killed them, and upon *the neck*
Of Shechem's men, who aided him
In killing of his brothers *grim*.
25 And the men of Shechem set men
In ambush against him *again*
On the tops of the hills, and they
Robbed all who passed by them that way,
And it was told Abimelech.
26 Now Gaal son of Ebed *in trek*
Came with his brothers and went there
To Shechem, Shechem's men beware
To put their confidence in him.
27 And they went out into the fields,
And gathered from their vineyards' *yields*
And trod *them*, and made merry *there*.
And they went into their god's house,
And ate and drank *with son and spouse*,
And cursed Abimelech. 28 Then Gaal
The son of Ebed said *for sal*,
"Who *is* Abimelech, and who
Is Shechem, that we should in due
Serve him? *Is he* not the son of
Jerubbaal, and *is not* his shove
Zebul? Serve the men of Hamor
The father of Shechem *in store*,
But why serve him *now anymore*?
29 "And would to God this people were
Under my rule! Then I'd concur
To remove Abimelech's *fur*."

Who rise to power, it seems, by putting
down

The sons of good men, small or of renown,
Live to see their own lack of loyalty

Spread out against them for the world to
see.

The round of human guile that seems to
rate

Is sent from You, Beloved, upon the pate
Of killer to avenge the slain man's fate.
You may think that sets everything once
right,

But think about the widows in the sight
Of Jerubbaal's sons. Though the speech
that night

Might have been sweet to hear, the graves
remained,

Closed just as tight the orphans' hearts and
pained.

The only retribution worth a pea,
Beloved, is resurrection of the free.

So he said to Abimelech,
"Increase your army and at beck
Come out!" 30 When Zebul, ruler of
The city, heard the words *above*
Of Gaal the son of Ebed, he
Was angry. 31 And he sent *in fee*
Messengers to him privily
To Abimelech secretly,
Saying "Take care, of Gaal beware,
The son of Ebed and his *fair*
Brothers have come to Shechem's *gate*,
And here they try to strengthen state
Against you. 32 "Therefore up by night,
You and the folk who're with your *might*,
And lie in wait *there* in the field.
33 "And it shall be, as soon as sealed
The sun in the morning, *that* you
Shall rise early and rush *in view*
Upon the city, and *when* he
And the folk who are with him be
Come out against you, you may then
Do them by opportunity."
34 And Abimelech and the men
Who *were* with him rose up by night,
And lay in wait in Shechem's sight
In four bands. 35 And Gaal Ebed's son
Went out and stood under the sun
At the gate of the city won,
Abimelech and the folk who
Were with him rose from ambush *brew*.

The point is, my Beloved, that You once
said

Not to kill any other knucklehead.

Now that's Your law. And here I see out
spread
The killings back and forth that seem to be
The product of the wicked heart in spree,
But said by sacred Word to be Your own
Actions in secret sent from divine throne.
Who does a good deed does it in Your
name,
Who does evil does Your will just the same
Despite the rebellion of veil and grief.
All things work at last to righteous relief.
Gaal may stand up, Abimelech resign,
But ebb and flow of power on fir and pine
Falls to the lichenized stones and laps about
The lakeshore when the frosty ice is out.

36 And when Gaal saw the people *come*,
He said to Zebul, "Look, how run
People down from the mountaintops!"
And Zebul said to him *for flogs*,
"You see the shadows of the hills
Like men *in a mirage that kills*."
37 And Gaal spoke up again and said
"See, people are coming *full fled*
Down from the middle of the land,
From Meonemin another band."
38 Then Zebul said to him, "Where now
Is your mouth, when you made a row
Saying 'Who is Abimelech,
That we should serve him *with our neck?*'
Are not these the folk you despised?
Go out, I pray, and fight advised."
39 So Gaal went out, leading the men
Of Shechem, and fought *with a yen*
Abimelech. 40 Abimelech
Chased him, and he fled from the wreck,
And many fell wounded, up to
The entrance of the gate *in view*.

The enemy is just another veil
That distracts from the clear and crimson
sale
Of divine oneness on the common pale.
Beloved, I see the forests move like men
And join the winds to battle on the fen,
But when the night is over and the sun
Looks out upon the night work lost and
won,
The dust is settled from the glory gore,
I still see You in oneness on the shore.
The pitiful and childish kings that rise
To drop plutonium down from the skies,

Despite half-lives beyond the ancient guise,
Go to the grave to wait the cleansing power
Of time and space beneath Your throne and
tower.

41 Abimelech then lived there at
Arumah, and Zebul out flat
Drove Gaal and his brothers, so that
They would not live in Shechem *more*.
42 And it came to pass the next day
That the people went out in shore
Of the field, and they told *the play*
To Abimelech. 43 So he took
His folk, divided them *by hook*
Into three bands, and lay in wait
In the field. And he saw the fate,
The folk coming out of the city,
And he got up and *without pity*
He struck them down. 44 Abimelech
And the band that *was* at his beck
Rushed forward and stood at the gate
Entrance of the city *to wait*,
And the two *other* bands rushed on
All who *were* in the fields *at dawn*
And killed them. 45 So Abimelech
Fought against the city *a speck*
All that day, and he took the town
And killed the people *with a frown*
Who *were* in it, and he destroyed
The city and with salt employed
To drown it. 46 And when all the men
Of Shechem's tower had heard *again*,
They went in the temple stronghold
Of the god Berith *they thought bold*.
47 And it was told Abimelech
That all the men of Shechem's check
Were gathered in the tower. 48 And then
Abimelech went up *again*
To Mount Zalmon, he and the folk
All who *were* with him *at a stroke*.
And Abimelech took an ax
In hand and cut a branch *in stacks*
From the trees, and took it and laid
It on his shoulder, then he said
To the people who were with him,
"Whatever you've seen me do, do with vim."
49 So each of the folk likewise cut
Down his own bough and followed rut
Of Abimelech, put *them* by
The stronghold, and set on *the sly*
The stronghold on fire above them,
So that all the folk in the hem

Died in the tower of Shechem,
About a thousand men with spouse,
And so ended all Shechem's house.

You pit the wicked to defend the right
In their own eyes as they go out to fight.
And so for one wrong done and done in
spite

One wrecks vengeance upon the other's
plight.

The house of Shechem has gone down at
last

By Abimelech's hand, who was outcast,
And from his shameful state invented greed
To show the world effect of hand and steed.
Abimelech may serve Your hand just now,
But none can trust You, Beloved, anyhow,
A mill-stone in a woman's hand can bring
The hero down to death and in one sting.
Give me no hand to kill and I shall sing
Your praise from my heart and like
anything.

50 Abimelech went to Thebez,
And he encamped against Thebez
And conquered it. 51 There was a strong
Tower in the city, and the throng,
All the folk of the city, fled
There and shut themselves in *their bed*,
And went up to the tower top.
52 Abimelech came *with bebop*
As far as the tower and he fought
Against it, and he came near caught
Door of the tower to set alight.
53 But a certain woman *on site*
Dropped an upper millstone on him,
On Abimelech's head and grim
Crushed his skull. 54 Then he quickly
called

To the young man, who was installed
His armour bearer, and told him,
"Draw sword and kill me, *do not swim*,
Lest men say of me, 'A woman
Killed him.'" And that's why his young
man

Thrust him through, and he died *by plan*.
55 And when the men of Israel saw
Abimelech was dead *as claw*,
They left, every man to his place.
56 Thus Alohim repaid the grace
Of Abimelech's wickedness,
Which he'd done to his father's *race*

By killing seventy brothers' *trace*.
57 And all the evil of the men
Of Shechem Alohim again
Returned on their own heads, and on
Them came the curse of Jotham drawn,
The son of Jerubbaal *in spawn*.

You may have paid in vengeance on the
pate
Of Abimelech at the going rate,
But still he got to rule and win the great
Battles above the hills of Shechem's gate.
He fought and ruled and spoke in pride of
life

Through all the retributions and the strife.
He could not hope for immortality,
But only to enjoy life lustfully,
And that he did. Your vengeance is no
more

Than the same death You always have in
store

For righteous and for wicked. Lower eye
From comprehensive view to see the sty
From human suffering, then try to deny
The common lot of men. In praise I try.

Week 48 Judges 10

1 And after Abimelech there
Came to defend Israel's *share*
Tola the son of Puah, son
Of Dod, who's a man of *the run*
Of Issachar, and he lived in
Shamir in Mount Ephraim's *bin*.
2 And he judged Israel twenty years
And three, and died and *it appears*
Was buried in Shamir *with tears*.

The sixth in line of twelve Tola came up
To judge the people from a brilliant cup
Of alabaster, from which he set out
The law in wisdom against people's doubt.
Like Ja'fer after him, he made the true
In all its glories come before the view
Of those who sought the right. Tola whose
name

Took from the worm forever any shame
That might light on the thorn or thistle's
plot,

Or on the flint found round about the lot
Of Shamir. I too am a worm that seeks
To soften the flint hearts of my reliques.
Beloved, let my inaudible praise find

Its own path in the gate of earth, though
blind.

The Seventh Judge: Burden of Tribute

3 And after him Jair came up,
A Gileadite, and judged *the cup*
Of Israel twenty-two years.
4 And he had thirty sons that rode
On thirty donkey colts to *goad*
And had thirty cities and called
Havoth-Jair and all installed
To this day, which are in the land
Of Gilead *to make a stand*.
5 And Jair died, was laid in plot
In Qamon *while they played gavotte*.

The seventh in the line of twelve has come
Each time to lunate curriculum
Of souls seeking the way to Your kingdom.
If Jair will bring light on the seventh step,
Then Musa shines a double star with pep
Upon the frozen nights where easily
Humankind wanders lost unfaithfully.
The balm of Gilead rides on the town
On thirty donkeys to accept the crown
Of thirty days a month and at the end
Of every season one more day and friend
To keep the Sabbath counted and in line.
The seventh and the hidden one are fine.
I come to rest in Qamon, where I dine.

The Eighth Judge: Majesty

6 And Israel's folk did wickedly
Again in YHWH's sight on a spree
Of serving Baals and Ashtaroth,
The Syrian gods and Zidon's broth,
The gods of Moab, Ammon's folk's
Gods, and the Philistine gods' *oaks*,
Forsaking YHWH to make Him wroth.
7 And YHWH's wrath burned against *the*
folk
Of Israel, *down to a bloke*,
And He sold them into the hands
Of Philistines, and in the hands
Of Ammon's children *and their folk*.
8 And that year they vexed and oppressed
The folk of Israel addressed
For eighteen years, all Israel's folk
That were on Jordan's other spoke
In the land of the Amorites,

Which is in Gilead *by rights*.
9 And Ammon's folk, they went so far
As to cross over Jordan's bar
To fight also against Judah,
And Benjamin, and lay a paw
On Ephraim's house, so the folk
Of Israel were about to croak.
And Israel's folk cried to YHWH, saying
"We've sinned against You, for not praying
To You our God whom we forsook,
And also serving Baals *like crook*."
11 And so YHWH said to Israel's folk,
"Not from the Egyptians at stroke,
And not from Amorites and from
The folk of Ammon, and in sum
From Philistines *have I not saved?*
12 The Zidonians also *raved*,
And Amalekites and *depraved*
Maonites came to oppress you,
And you called to Me and I saved
You from their hands *as once enslaved*.
13 But you turned from Me and to serve
Other gods, therefore I shall swerve
No more to save you *from their verve*.
14 Go call to the gods you have chosen,
Let them save you *when you are frozen*
When you're in troubled times *and*
squozen.

Your heart too, my Beloved, though patient
still
At some place must require the check and
bill.
Divine patience is no more patience if
It has no end at all to junk the skiff.
Though with each breath I take I say Your
name,
With every exhalation lose the same.
That small rebirth and small death cannot
deal
More than an instant with the divine peal.
Each moment human soul darkens the
wheel,
Forgetting the name that created all.
A man is very like a calf in stall.
Beloved, though I turn from Your golden
face,
Wherever I turn, there I find Your grace
Who are present in every time and place.

15 And the children of Israel said
To YHWH, "We have sinned *in our bed*,

Do with us what You think for best,
 But only save us, we request.”
 16 And they threw out their heathen gods
 From themselves and served at *the prods*
Of YHWH, and His soul then was grieved
 For Israel’s misery *unreprieved*.
 17 Then Ammon’s folk came to one place
 Encamping in Gilead’s trace.
 And Israel’s folk gathered there too,
 Encamping in Mizpeh’s *fresh dew*.
 18 And Gilead’s folk and princes said
 To one another, “What man led
 Will begin to fight Ammon’s folk?
 He shall be Gilead’s chief bloke.”

In difficulty people turn to You,
 Beloved, and pray something for You to
 do.
 Each one who prays knows just the thing
 he wants,
 A new computer with spanking new fonts.
 Beloved, I turn to You so rarely in
 Prayer because I have everything in bin
 I need to eat and drink and sleep in fair
 Warm weather or in cold, my wealth and
 share
 Suffice for my wants and my daily care.
 But though I need no thing at all to live
 In comfort, still occasionally sieve
 My actions down to turn to You and give
 Your praises my breath and my mind
 belated.
 Beloved, take empty petitions related.

Judges 11

1 Now Jephthah the Gileadite was
 A mighty man as mighty does,
 A trollop’s son was he, his pa
 Was Gilead, dad of Jephthah.
 2 And Gilead’s wife bore him more sons,
 And his wife’s sons as *paragons*
 When they grew up threw Jephthah out,
 And said to him, “*You are a clout*,
 Not to inherit our dad’s house,
 Son of strange woman *and not spouse*.
 3 Then Jephthah fled from house and home
 And went to land of Tob *to roam*,
 And Jephthah lived there with vain men,
 All of whom ran about *again*.

Beloved, my brothers all have cast me out
 From native land with awful din and shout

As they raise up their hearts and hands to
 Baal
 And claim to praise Your name with sinful
 wail.
 In quietness I make my hearth and home
 Among the firs and birches and the gloam
 Of snow and ice upon a granite loam.
 The land is Tob, a good land and a fair,
 And I’m content to live an outcast there.
 But unlike Jephthah fled, I have no crowd
 Of vain men praising me who sing aloud,
 And so escape the fate of Jephthah brought
 To lead the people in a war unsought.
 Beloved, I walk alone with You unbought.

4 It came to pass as time went on
 The children of Ammon were drawn
 To make war against Israel.
 5 And so it happened when the folk
 Of Ammon made war at a stroke
 Against Israel, the elders of
 Gilead went to fetch *with love*
 Jephthah out of the land of Tob.
 6 And they told Jephthah, “Come enrobe,
 And be our captain, so we’ll fight
 With children of the Ammonite.”
 7 But Jephthah said to Gilead’s old
 Men, “Did you not hate me so cold
 And throw me from my father’s house?
 And why have you come now to grouse
 To me when you are in distress?”
 8 And Gilead’s old men said to
 Jephthah, “Therefore we turn anew
 To you now so you’ll go with us
 And fight against Ammon with fuss,
 And be our chief of all the folk
 In Gilead who live there *broke*.”
 9 And Jephthah said to Gilead’s old
 Men, “If you bring me to the fold
 Again to fight against the *bold*
 Folk of Ammon, and YHWH uphold
 Me giving them into my hand,
 Shall I then be your chief of band?”
 10 The old men of Gilead said
 To Jephthah, “YHWH be witness led
 Between us if we do not do
 According to your words in view.”
 11 Then Jephthah went with the old men
 Of Gilead, and the folk then
 Made him chief and captain of them,
 And Jephthah spoke all his words there
 Before YHWH in Mizpeh *to glare*.

The democratic way to chose a head
Of state is find a son of whore well fed
On scandals and on going out to make
A robber's row with vain men at the stake.
All chosen leaders are such men, though
bold.

The robber's band is the womb and the fold
Of senators both in Rome and the state
That I shall not mention for fear of fate.
Beloved, preserve me from the choice of
vote,

But let me serve a hidden king of note
Who was taken up from the circling throng
That would kill once again and for no
wrong.

Beloved, I flee to You from those who take
A whore's son for the president, a rake.

12 And Jephthah sent messengers to
The king of Ammon's folk in due,
Saying "What have you in your view
On my account to come to fight
Against me in my land of right?"

13 And the king of Ammon's folk said
To Jephthah's messengers biped,
"Because Israel stole my land,
When they came from Egypt in band,
From Arnon even to Jabbok,
As far as Jordan to a rock,
So give me back those lands in peace."

Ah my Beloved, how human beings love
To treat of history dagger in glove!
For anything a man wishes to do,
He finds a precedent within the view
Of past events obscured by time and will.
That's history, excuse to fit the bill.
The mythopoeic mind of man comes still
To play upon affairs of state and hill
Of mud pies: every memory comes late
To bring a disagreement on the pate.
Both elephant and man are slaves to what
Remembrance brings in vengeance and in
glut.

Beloved, let me have memory alone
Of You and of the grace before Your
throne.

14 And Jephthah sent his men again
To Ammon's folk's king *in his den*.
15 And said to him, "So says the man

Jephthah, 'Israel did not *by plan*

Take for itself land of Moab,
Nor Ammon's children's land's *confab*.

16 But when Israel came from Egypt,
And walked through the desert *unclipped*
To the Red Sea up to Kadesh,

17 "Then Israel sent messengers *fresh*
To king of Edom, saying "Let
Me please pass through your land *no fret*,"
But the king of Edom would not
Listen. And in the same way *sought*
They sent to the king of Moab,
But he would not consent *a slab*,
So Israel stayed there in Kadesh.

18 "Then they went along through the
waste

And around land of Edom *graced*
And the land of Moab, and came
By the east side of Moab's fame,
And pitched on Arnon's far side *claim*,
But did not step across the line
Of Moab, for Arnon's *combine*
Was the border of Moab's *wine*.

19 "And Israel sent messengers to
Sihon king of Amorite view,
The king of Heshbon, and then said
Israel to him, "Let us pass led
Please through your land to my own bed."
20 "But Sihon did not trust Israel
To pass through his share *without guile*,
But gathered all his folk and pitched
In Jahaz and fought Israel hitched.

21 "And YHWH the Alohim *bespoken*
Of Israel delivered *in token*
Sihon and all his folk into
The hand of Israel *and his crew*,
And they smashed them, so Israel had
Possession of the land of cad
And Amorite who lived there *bad*.
22 "And they possessed there all the lands
Of Amorites from Arnon's *sands*
As far as Jabbok, from the waste
Of desert to Jordan *retraced*.

23 "So now YHWH Israel's Alohim
Has dispossessed Amorite dream
Before His people Israel,
And would you then take it a spell?
24 "Will you not be content to keep
What your god Chemosh gave to *reap*?
But whomsoever YHWH our God
Shall drive out from before our prod,
Such ones we'll hold *both bean and pod*.

25 “Are you better than Balak son
Of Zippor, king of Moab’s *run*?
Did he ever fight Israel’s *gun*,
Or did he strive under their sun,
26 “While Israel lived in Heshbon and
Its towns, and in Aroer’s *stand*
And its towns, and in all the towns
Along by the Arnon’s banks’ *downs*,
Three hundred years? Why then did you
Not recover that time *your due*?
27 “That’s why I do not wrong to you,
But you do me wrong by the war
That you raise against me *in score*,
YHWH the Judge be judge today for
The case between Israel’s folk and
The children of Ammon *in band*. ”
28 Nevertheless Ammon’s folks’ king
Refused to listen to the thing
That Jephthah had sent him *to sing*.

Note well, Beloved, how Jephthah’s history
In far greater detail of clarity
Shows how Israel did not attempt to take
Land on the east of Jordan for its sake,
But merely defended themselves from
those
Who came to attack them and step on toes.
When the attacker had been knocked out
right,
Then Israel just sat down on the site,
Concluding that You gave them land for
fight.
Despite the logic of the argument
The king of Ammon remains adamant.
Neither logic nor right nor history
Can make a claim against the bigotry
Of the aggressor. He’s always home free.

29 Then the spirit of YHWH came on
Jephthah and he passed over lawn
Of Gilead and Manasseh,
And passed over Mizpeh for prey
Of Gilead and came into
The children of Ammon in view.
30 And Jephthah vowed a vow to YHWH
And said “If You without fail give
The folk of Ammon in my sieve,
31 “That it shall be whatever meets
Me from the doors of my house streets
When I return in peace from that
Folk of Ammon gone down at bat,
That one shall surely be YHWH’s own

A burnt offering before Your throne.”

Religion is the rash rate of mankind
Not satisfied with planted and the vined,
But must have prayer and sacrifice and fast
Beyond the ten words You gave once to
last.

Your faith and yoke is too simple to bear,
Too light and delicate to stand the air.
We must have pilgrimage and county fair
And prostrations and tithes to feel our share
In creation’s work has been paid in full.
Your ten words are not enough for the bull.
Religions bind their followers to fate
Of burdens heavy, light and consecrate
Worthy lives to new Baals in every state.
Beloved, I take no more than Your ten’s
rate.

32 So Jephthah passed over *the flood*
To Ammon’s folk to fight *to blood*
Against them and YHWH gave them all
Into his hands. 33 And he struck all
Of them from Aroer until
You come to Minith *to the bill*
Of twenty cities, to the plain
Of the vineyards with many slain.
So the folk of Ammon were struck
Before Israel’s folk *in the muck*.
34 Then Jephthah came back to Mizpeh
To his own house and in the way
His daughter came out to meet him
With timbrels and with dances *dim*,
And she was the man’s only child,
Besides which he had not *compiled*
Son nor daughter *among the wild*.
35 It happened when he saw her that
He tore his clothes and said “My pet,
You have brought me down very low,
And you to trouble are not slow,
For I have opened up my mouth
To YHWH and cannot recall *drought*. ”
36 And she told him, “My father, you
Have opened up your mouth unto
YHWH, do to me as you have said,
For YHWH has taken vengeance *led*
By you upon your enemies,
The people of Ammon *at ease*. ”
37 And she said to her father, “Please
Let this be done for me, let me
Alone two months, that I may go
Up and down on the mountains’ row

In grief for my virginity,
 And all my friends along with me.”
 38 And he said “Go.” And so he sent
 Her away for two months, she went
 With her companions, and bewailed
 Virginity on hills *unveiled*.
 39 When the two months came to an end,
 She returned to her father’s *blend*,
 Who did with her as he had said,
 And she never took man to bed.
 And so it was in Israel’s way
 40 The women of Israel would stay
 Four days in the year to lament
 The daughter of Jephthah unspent,
 Jephthah the Gileadite *in tent*.

The foolish commentator would reply
 That Jephthah burned his daughter on the
 sly.

It’s clear however that the gift he gave
 Was her virginity to be Your slave.
 As such he may have invented the room
 Of cloister and nunnery down to doom,
 But at the same time bore a witness fair
 Against human sacrifice to beware.
 Beloved, I too bear witness in Your name
 That sacrificing humans is a shame,
 The thing that You prohibit with the claim
 Of the commandment not to kill. I fly
 To Your word against all that magnify
 Necessity of State to crucify.

Week 49 Judges 12

1 The men of Ephraim came together
 And went north *to the end of tether*
 And said to Jephthah, “Why did you
 Go to fight against Ammon’s crew,
 And did not call us to lead you?
 Now we will burn your house with fire.
 2 And Jephthah told them *in his ire*,
 “I and my people were in strife
 Greatly with Ammon’s folk *for life*,
 And when I called you, you did not
 Save us at all out of their plot.
 3 And when I saw that you did not
 Save, I put my life in my hands,
 And passed over against the bands
 Of Ammon, and YHWH gave them all
 To me. Now why do you install
 Yourselves against me on this day
 To fight against me *in the way*?”
 4 Then Jephthah called together all

The men of Gilead from brawl,
 And fought with Ephraim until
 The men of Gilead would kill
 Ephraim, because they said “You folk
 Of Gilead are just *a poke*
 Of fugitives from Ephraim
 Among the Ephraimites *to dream*
 And with the Manassites *to seem*.
 5 And the Gileadites lay hold
 Of the fords of Jordan as bold
 Before the Ephraimites were told,
 And when those Ephraimites escaped
 And said “Let me go unredtaped,”
 The men of Gilead said to him,
 “Are you an Ephraimite and dim?”
 If he said “No,” 6 Then they told him,
 “Say Shibboleth” and then he said
 “Sibboleth,” for he had been bred
 So and could not pronounce the word.
 Then they took him as it occurred
 And killed him at the Jordan’s ford,
 And there fell at that time by sword
 Forty-two thousand Ephraimites.
 7 And Jephthah judged Israel by rights
 For six years. Then Jephthah deceased,
 The Gileadite was buried *fleeced*
 In one of Gilead’s cities *leased*.

The Shibboleth marked dialect in times
 Past, so people were caught up in their
 crimes.

The speech of one and all shows still in
 form
 Who ought to rule and who ought to stay
 warm.

The human heart is bound so fast to tongue
 It cannot distinguish right from the sung,
 And is attached to its own full disgrace
 By judging accents and the tint of face
 Instead of doing well or doing wrong.
 The human heart is far too pleased by song.
 For sibilants a man may be condemned
 To death still in these countries narrow
 hemmed.

Beloved, in wordless love I cling to You
 And listen to no sound but voice of dew.

The Ninth Judge: Sunburnt

8 And after him Ibzan came to
 Judge Israel from Bethlehem.
 9 And he had thirty sons in crew

And thirty daughters *like a gem*
Whom he sent abroad and then took
In thirty daughters *on their hook*
For his sons. And he judged the folk
Of Israel seven years *in stroke*.
10 Then Ibban died and was buried
In Bethlehem *when he was freed*.

The Tenth Judge: Enclosed

11 And after him Elon arose
To judge Israel and none oppose,
A Zebulonite *to his toes*
For ten years *he judged in his rows*.
12 And Elon the Zebulonite
Died and was buried on the site
Of Aijalon in the country
Of Zebulon *for all to see*.

The Eleventh Judge: Refreshed

13 And after him Abdon the son
Of Hillel, Pirathonite *won*
To be judge of Israel *when done*.
14 And he had forty sons and yet
Thirty nephews, and they were set
On seventy donkey colts, and he
Judged Israel *from that country*.
15 And Abdon the son of Hillel
The Pirathonite died as well,
And was buried in Pirathon
In the land of Ephraim and on
The mount of the Amalekites,
And that's the end of Abdon's rights.

Obscurity marks three of the last four
In line of twelve along the promised shore.
So Taki, Naki, Askeri are known
But little by their deeds, although they
shone
As judges in Israel and leaders of
The faithful to Your name and to Your
love.

Before the great dawn of salvation and
The coming of justice to every land
Obscurity falls on the trusting band
And few are seen, though ripe on every
hand

In silence they await Your fast decree
That You will intervene in human spree
And end injustice that rides now in state
Abetting the oil barons in their hate.

The Twelfth Judge: Help

Judges 13

1 And the folk of Israel did wrong
Again in sight of YHWH, and YHWH
Delivered them into the *strong*
Hand of the Philistinian *crew*
For forty years. 2 And there was one
Man of Zorah, and of the dun
Of *blesséd* Danites, whose name was
Manoah, and his wife *as does*
Was barren, and had no child's paws.
3 The angel of YHWH then appeared
To the woman, and the word steered
To her, "Indeed now you it's feared
Are barren, and no child appeared,
But you shall conceive and bear son.
4 So be careful, please, and do not
Drink wine nor strong drink *overdone*
And do not eat the unclean *pot*.
5 See now you'll conceive and you'll bear
A son, and no razor shall tear
His head, for the child shall appear
A Nazarite to God and dear
From the womb, and he shall begin
To save Israel out of the din
Of Philistines *and he shall win*."
6 Then the woman came and she told
Her husband, saying, "A man bold
From God came to me and his face
Was like the glory and the grace
Of an angel of God, fearsome,
But I did not ask where he's from,
And he did not tell me his name.
7 But he said to me, "See the aim,
You shall conceive and bear a son,
So do not drink wine nor the run
Of strong drink, do not eat unclean,
For the child shall be Nazarene
To God from the womb to the day
That death shall come upon his way."

The angel that You send about the earth
Is fearsome and that's why there is a dearth
Of seeing such, yet many come to claim
That they have seen angels in all their
fame.

The strange thing is that angels who come
Now
Are always painted with a friendly brow
And are not terrible to see or hear,

But comfort and not frighten at the ear.
 The angels do perch on my window gear
 And twitter with their yellow breast a
 while.
 They come neither in fear nor with the
 guile
 Of false comfort, they merely peer and
 smile
 With beak a-perk and head cocked to the
 show.
 They come in sunlight and in gleam of
 snow.

8 Then Manoah entreated YHWH
 And said "O my Lord, let come true
 The man of Alohim You sent
 Come once more to teach us *the vent*
Of what to do for the child that
 Is to be born where we are at."
 9 Alohim listened to the voice
 Of Manoah, the angel choice
 Of Alohim came once more to
 The woman in the field to do,
 But Manoah her husband was
 Not with her there *as often does*.
 10 And the woman hurried and ran
 And told her husband, told the man,
 "Indeed the man has come again
 That appeared to me you know when."
 11 Manoah got up and went after
 His wife, *not a matter for laughter*,
 And came to the man, said to him,
 "Are you the man that *on a whim*
 Spoke to my wife?" And he told him,
 "I." 12 And Manoah said "Now let
 Your words take place. How shall we set
 The child, and how care for the lad
So that he will not grow up bad?"
 13 And the angel of YHWH said to
 Manoah, "Of all I said to
 The woman let her heed thereto.
 14 She may not eat what comes from vine,
 Neither let her drink of the wine
 Or strong drink, nor eat unclean thing,
 All I commanded let her sing."

The first thing anyone should do who hears
 The report of an angel in arrears,
 Is say "Show me the man and I'll believe.
 Unless you do, I'll ask God for reprieve."
 Beloved, the stories of angels today
 Multiply beyond those of Passion-play.

I doubt what I myself see in my room,
 And even more doubt what others in doom
 Stay recommending of both art and gloom.
 Angels about me are not for the blind,
 They may be figments of the diseased
 mind.
 I let the popular enchantment go
 And flee to You, Beloved, who are not
 slow
 To be invisible, unheard trousseau.

15 Manoah said to YHWH's angel,
 "Please remain here with us a spell,
 Until we've killed a kid for you."
 16 The angel of YHWH said unto
 Manoah, "Though I stay with you,
 I will not eat your bread, if you
 Will offer a burnt offering,
 You must offer to YHWH the thing."
 For Manoah did not know that
 He was an angel of YHWH *flat*.
 17 Manoah said to YHWH's angel,
 "What is your name, when what you tell
 Comes true we may honour you well?"
 18 The angel of YHWH said to him,
 "Why do you ask my name *for whim*,
 Since it's a secret thing *and dim?"*
 19 And so Manoah took a kid
 With a meat offering and *valid*,
 And offered it upon a rock
 To YHWH, and the angel *ad hoc*
 Did wondrously, and Manoah
 And his wife looked on it in awe.
 20 It happened when the flame went up
 Toward the sky from altar *cup*,
 That YHWH's angel ascended up
 In the flame of the altar. And
 Manoah and his wife *in band*
 Looked at it and fell on the ground
 On their faces *amazement bound*.
 21 But the angel of YHWH did not
 Again appear before the lot
 Of Manoah and to his wife.
 Then Manoah knew *for his life*
 He was YHWH's angel *on the spot*.

Let's You and I, Beloved, think on the
 proofs
 Manoah accepts and see if they're goofs.
 Proof's he refuses hospitality,
 Proof's he gives no name in his secrecy,
 And proof's he goes up in a flame upon

The altar where a slaughtered kid is drawn.
 The final proof of four is that once gone
 The angel's not again seen on the lawn.
 Beloved, to my mind, weak though it may
 be,
 And filled with bias, still I fail to see
 In these proofs evidence of divine grace.
 They smack of magic and a certain trace
 Of disdain. Though I come before Your
 face,
 I save the right to doubt, my Scotsman's
 fee.

22 Manoah said then to his wife,
 "We'll surely die now, *on your life*,
 Because we've looked on Alohim."
 23 But his wife said to him, "I deem
 If YHWH wished to kill us, He would
 Not have received burnt offering good
 And a meat offering at our hands,
 Neither would He have *by commands*
 Shown us all these things, nor have told
 Us such wonders *to make us bold*."

First off, Beloved, most people now who
 see
 Angels do not think that the sight in fee
 Requires death sentence. No, they are
 delighted,
 Thinking they're honoured by the vision
 sighted.
 But his wife's answer is a thing I find
 Strange as a proof to the well fed and
 wined.
 How did she know that YHWH received
 the gift
 With pleasure, just because the flame could
 lift
 A figment of imagination's rift?
 Who rest on visions personal or public
 Merely support monarchy or republic.
 I too have seen a vision, heard a voice,
 But fail to make following it my choice.
 In You alone, Beloved, I can rejoice.

24 The woman gave birth to a son,
 And so she called his name Samson,
 And the child grew, and so did YHWH
 Bless him *and his whole family's crew*.
 25 And the spirit of YHWH began
 To work him in the camp of Dan
 Sometimes between Zorah *the town*

And Eshtaol, *both of renown*.

Forgive me, my Beloved, if Samson's
 name
 Reminds me of the legends and the fame
 Of sun and sun-gods, children of the flame.
 Manoah's rest supports the evil claim
 That sun worship lay lurking in his breast.
 When fire went up, Manoah was
 impressed.
 Think how much fire comes to enlighten
 quest
 Of Samson through his journey with the
 best.
 Beloved, I hope the twelfth one sent and
 blessed
 Might be Your true salvation and Your rest,
 But doubt of sun and Sunday still repeats
 A warning to my heart of drinks and eats
 That play a role in sacrifice of treats.
 In this story there's more than idle meats.

Judges 14

1 Now Samson went down to Timnah,
 And saw a woman in Timnah
 One of the Philistine girls there.
 2 So he went up and told father
 And mother, saying "I have seen
 A woman in Timnah, *the cream*
 Of the Philistine girls, therefore,
 Get her for me as wife *in store*."
 3 Then his father and mother said
 To him, "*Is there* no woman's *bed*
 Among the daughters of your brothers,
 Or among all my people *others*,
 That you must go and get a wife
 From the uncircumcised *in strife*,
The Philistines?" And Samson said
 To his father, "Get her for me,
 For she pleases me wonderfully."
 4 But his father and mother did
 Not know that it was YHWH that bid,
 That He was seeking an excuse
 To attack Philistine abuse.
 For at that time the Philistines
 Ruled over Israel *and their vines*.
 5 So Samson and his father went
 Down with his mother *in consent*
 To Timnath, and arrived at where
 The vineyards of Timnath were there,
 And indeed a young lion roared
 At him. 6 The spirit of the *Lord*

YHWH came on him strongly *and poured*,
And he tore it as he might have
Torn a young goat, a kid *to halve*,
With no weapon at all in hand,
But he did not report the deed
To mother or father, *what need?*
7 And he went down and had a talk
With the woman, who met his chalk.

The virile prowess of the man alone
Makes me think of the sun and the sun's
throne.

A hidden legend of the sun-god Baal
Seeps through in secret in the Bible tale.
He is one to scatter his fecund seed
While riding lions about in his greed.
But what matter at last if Canaanite
Gods are met with a rival in the fight?
Beloved, I doubt until the end, and yet
I lay a hand on the great battle met
And praise You that despite the sun's
bright glow
You intervene in world of men and show.
I do not criticize the lusty spark
Of Samson, though I know You in the dark.

8 As time passed he returned to take
His wife, and he turned in the wake
To see the lion's carcass bake,
And indeed, bees swarmed in the dead
Body of the lion for bed.
9 He took some of it in his hands
And walked on eating on the sands,
And met his father and mother
And gave them some, who did concur
To eat, but he did not tell them
He took honey from lion's hem.

I reckon, my Beloved, the carcass of
The lion was unclean to touch with glove,
And that is why he did not try to shove
The story on his dad and mom above.
I might too have been tempted by the sweet
Caught in the unclean carcass and the meat.
No idol attracts humankind but that
Containing honey in the dyeing vat.
Beloved, though the wood by my house is
set
With hare and moose and fox, I could lay
bet
That lions do not linger there if met.
Beloved, I take my idols from the throng

Of things familiar, though I know them
wrong,
And treat them with a heartfelt sacred song.

10 His father went down to the girl
And Samson made a feast to curl
The habit of young men in time.
11 It happened when they saw him *climb*,
That they brought thirty youths *and fine*
To share *his feast and drink his wine*.
12 And Samson said to them, "I'll now
Tell you a riddle anyhow,
If you can guess in seven days
Of the feast's length, the riddle's ways,
Then I will give you thirty sheets
And thirty suits *to have for treats*.
13 But if you cannot find the trick,
Then you'll give me thirty and thick
Sheets and thirty suits. And they said
To him, "Let's hear the riddle spread."
14 So he told them, "Out of the eater
Came forth food, and out of the meter
In strength came forth the sweet and
sweeter."

Three days they tried to find the answer,
But could not *by hearer or glancer*.

I've got the riddle in a trice, I trow.
I don't need three days thinking anyhow.
What is stronger than burning sun upon
The earth beginning at the fervent dawn,
Devouring all by fire throughout the day
And making desert of the fruitful way?
Yet out of the sun's strength set out to slay
There comes to kiss the earth life-giving
ray
That with its tears waters the ground to
give
The sweet grain and fruit so that man may
live.
Any Philistine could see through the book
And give the line as soon as take a look.
So Samson son of sun belies the faith
Of Philistine in fish god and in wraith.

15 On the seventh day they came to
Samson's wife, saying all in crew,
"Entice your husband to say true
To us the riddle, or we'll burn
You and your father's house like urn
With fire, for have you invited
Us to steal from us pot and lid?

16 And Sanson's wife wept tears before
 Him, and said "If you loved me more,
 You would not tell a riddle to
 My people's children without due
 Telling me the answer thereto."
 He said "Indeed, I have not told
 My father nor my mother bold,
 And shall I tell you or withhold?"
 17 And she kept shedding tears before
 Him the whole seven days in store
 While their feast lasted, and it came
 To pass on the seventh day's claim
 That he told her, because she kept
 On begging and because she wept,
 And she told her folk *while he slept*.

When Samson heard the groaning and the
 tears
 With which his pagan mate greeted the
 fears
 Of Sabbath day, he left the firm estate
 Of secret known to him alone and late.
 When Samson heard the whisper and the
 fame
 Of a harlot's faith and her empty claim
 He knew full well he should not trust the
 fire,
 But by Your grace he rushed into the mire.
 Beloved, how I beware the tears and cry
 Of those surrounding me under the sky
 Upon the seventh day. The church is filled
 With many temptresses whose pleasures
 skilled
 Would turn me from Your law to idols'
 hope.
 The seventh day is fraught with noose and
 rope.

18 And so the men of the city
 Said to him on seventh degree
 Before the sun went down, *prithae*,
 "Say now what's sweeter than honey?
 And what is stronger than the *free*
 Lion?" And he said to them there,
 "If you had not plowed with *the share*
 Of my heifer, you would not have
 Known the answer *though told a Slav*."
 19 The spirit of YHWH came on him,
 And he went down to Ashkelon,
 And killed thirty men on a whim,
 And took their property out drawn,
 And gave their suits to them who knew

To tell the riddle and tell true.
 And his anger was kindled, and
 He went up to his father's land.
 20 But Samson's wife was married to
 His friend in his companions' crew.

The pagan sun-god's worshippers play on
 The sentiments, and with tears come to
 fawn
 And request love, love as criterion.
 But behind the expressions of their love,
 I always find the same deceitful glove.
 The scientific proof that rain is made
 By the sun's action on the sea unstayed
 Does not imply a faith in the home-grown
 Or in the golden powers of glaive and
 throne.

YHWH Alohim, highest reality,
 Stands everywhere behind the serpent sea,
 And while the systematic observance
 May well describe the unchaotic dance,
 Still it does not return to origin.
 Beloved, I flee deceitful love and sin.

Judges 15

1 It came to pass soon after that
 At the wheat harvest *habitat*,
 That Samson went to see his wife
 With a kid, saying "*On my life*,
 I'll go to my wife in her room."
 But her father and *to his gloom*
 Prevented him. 2 Her father said
 "I really thought that you'd been led
 To hate her, so I gave her to
 Your friend, is not her younger shrew
 More beautiful than she? take her,
 Please instead of the former *cur*."
 3 And Samson said of them, "Now I
 Shall be less guilty than the sly
 Philistines though I do them wrong."
 4 And Samson went and caught erelong
 Three hundred foxes, took firebrands
 And turned tail to tail *in their strands*
 And put a firebrand in between
 Two tails. 5 And when he'd fixed the
 scene,
 He let them loose in standing corn
 Of Philistines, and burnt both *shorn*
 Shocks and also the standing corn,
 With vineyards and olives *in scorn*.
 6 Then the Philistines said "Who did
 This thing?" And they answered the quid,

“Samson, the son in law of one
Timnite, because he took when done
His wife and gave her to another.”
And the Philistines found the brother,
Burnt father and daughter together.

The red foxes remind me of the light
Of setting sun or of the linger bright
Sun rising as I set my woods on sprite.
The sun theme goes through all the tale to
spin

The firebrands through the corn and barn
and bin

Of sun worship and Dagon on the swim
Who also represents the legend dim
Of sun sinking into the sea to treat
The world with night and then once more
to greet

The morning. My Beloved, though sun is
fair

And by Your hand brings warm life
everywhere,

I bow to none but You, Beloved, and share
My days beneath the haven of Your care,
My days beneath the haven of Your care.

7 And Samson said to them, “Though you
Have done this I’ll be venged on you,
And after that I’ll stop the crew.”

8 He struck them hip and thigh with
slaughter,

And went down and lived on his fodder
A-top the rock of Etam. 9 Then

The Philistines went up and pitched
In Judah and spread themselves hitched
In Lehi. 10 And the men of Judah

Said “Why have you come up here ruder
Against us?” And they answered, “To
Bind Samson have we come up few,
To do to him as he has done

To us.” 11 Then three thousand men won
Of Judah went to the rock’s top
Of Etam, and said to the fop

Of Samson, “Do you not know that
The Philistines hold rulers’ *hat*
Over us? What is this that you
Have done to us and to our crew?”

And he said to them, “As they did
To me only, and quid for quid
Have I given to them in bid.”

12 And they said to him, “We have come
To tie you up *for flunkedom*

And turn you over to the hand
Of Philistines who have command.
And Samson said “Swear to me that
You will not fall on me *for scat*
Yourselves.” 13 And they spoke to him so,
Saying, “No, but we’ll tie you slow,
And turn you over to the State,
Surely we shall mix in your fate.”
And they tied him with two new thongs,
And brought him from the rock *for wrongs*.

Ah my Beloved, see how one’s brothers
treat

The fairest, chosen one, and go to greet
The police and the military beat
As though might made right in the driver’s
seat.

Men cry why You don’t intervene a bit
When all the world is catastrophe hit,
But when You do provide a grace to fit,
The first thing’s done’s to crucify the kit.
I sigh and cry that beautiful as bloom
A human soul turns back to kiss the doom
And artist’s hand is stricken from the loom.
I weep to see the withering of the flowers
Upon the meadow, beneath hill and towers,
Before their time to fade, while in their
powers.

14 When he was brought to Lehi, then
The Philistines shouted *like men*
Against him, and YHWH’s spirit came
Upon him mightily *in fame*

And the thongs that were on his arms
Became like flax *before alarms*
Burnt in the fire, and his bands broke
From off his hands *as strong as oak*.

15 He found a new donkey’s jawbone,
And took it in his hand alone,
And killed a thousand men with it.

16 And Samson said “With a bone fit,
A donkey’s jawbone, pile on shit,
I’ve killed a thousand men to wit,
With just a donkey’s jawbone knit.”

17 It happened when he finished talking,
He threw away the jawbone mocking
Out of his hand and called that place
Ramath-lehi, *for throwing’s grace*.

18 By this time he was thirsty too
And so in thirst he called on YHWH,
And said “You gave me great salvation,
Who am but in a servant’s *station*,

And now shall I die by my thirst
 And be taken up by *the worst*
Of the uncircumcised to burst?"
 19 But Alohim opened a place,
 A hollow in the jawbone's *trace*,
 And there came water out of it,
 And when he had drunk and was fit,
 His spirit reviving a bit,
 He called the name of that place *writ*
 En-hakkore, which still remains
 In Lehi to this day *for gains*.
 20 And he judge Israel those days
 Of the Philistines twenty *rays*.

No cords could hold the burning arms of
 sun,
 So the tale proclaims Samson on the run.
 Though sun may bring the rain and dew up
 from
 The restless sea, no sun can bring the wet
 Up from a dried jawbone of donkey set.
 And so Baals are shown to be nothing but
 The donkeys of the heathen for their glut,
 And Dagon when cast on the desert sand
 Is made a fish out of the water canned.
 Only You, my Beloved, can quench the
 thirst
 Arising from the mighty doing worst
 As hero of Your power over the strong.
 Let me remember You when I find wrong
 Still sits upon the throne of Gaza long.

Week 50 Judges 16

1 And Samson went to Gaza and
 Saw a harlot there near at hand,
 And went in to her. 2 The Gazites
 Heard, "Samson's come here *and in*
sights!"
 And they surrounded, lay in wait
 For him all night by city gate.
 They were quiet all night, saying
 "When the morning will daylight bring,
 We will kill him." 3 And Samson lay
 Low till midnight, then rose *from play*
 At midnight, took hold of the doors
 Of the gate of the city floors
 And the two gateposts, pulled them up,
 Bar and all, put *them* on his hup,
 And carried them up to the top
 Of the hill toward Hebron *to drop*.
 4 And after that it happened he
 Loved a woman in the valley

Of Sorek, whose name was Delilah.
 5 And the lords of the Philistines
 Came to her and said like the hyla,
 "Entice him and find out the lines
 Of his great strength, and how we may
 Prevail against him on a day,
 That we may tie him up and sting
 Him with our tortures in a ring,
 And we will give you every one
 Of us eleven hundred spun
 Pieces of silver when you're done."

Trust not the bedfellow nor closest friend
 When the State has a jawbone to contend.
 With silver every man can be aroused
 And every woman with a ring unhoused.
 Beloved, let none entice me to retreat
 From Your word and reciting of the meet.
 Beloved, let none take me away from You,
 Even when You're reflected in the brew
 Of high or low, in brow of weak or strong.
 When I rise to the hidden soldier throng,
 Let me find Your face behind power's
 sneer,
 And Your grace listening behind the king's
 ear.
 Faith is to see You where the wrong is
 great,
 To find You even in the perjured State.

6 Delilah said to Samson, "Tell
 Me please what is your great strength's
 spell,
 And how they might tie you up to
 Torture you and afflict in crew."
 7 And Samson said to her, "If they
 Tie me with seven green withes one day
 That never had been dried, then I
 Shall be weak as a man or fly."
 8 Then the lords of the Philistine
 Brought up to her seven withes of green,
 Which had not been dried, and she tied
 Him with them. 9 Now men came to hide
 With her in her room. And she said
 To him, "The Philistines are spread
 Against you, Samson." Like a thread
 He broke the withes, and as a thread
 Of tow is squandered by the fire.
 So his strength was not known *entire*.
 10 Delilah said to Samson, "Look,
 You've mocked me, told me lies, forsook,
 Now tell me, please how you may be

Tied up *by any enemy*.

11 And he said to her, "If they tie
Me tight with new ropes *on the sly*
That never were used, then shall I
Be weak as any man *or fly*."
12 So then Delilah took new ropes,
And tied him with them in her hopes,
And said to him, "The Philistines
Are after you, Samson, *the swines*,"
And there were hidden with her there
Men waiting for him in her lair.
He broke off the ropes from his arms
Like a thread *when he heard alarms*.
13 And Delilah said to Samson,
"So far you've mocked me on the run,
And told me lies, tell me now true
With what means can the folk tie you?"
And he told her, "If you braid tight
The seven locks of my hair right
With the web." 14 And she fastened it
With the pin, and said in her wit,
"The Philistines would make a hit,
Samson." And he woke up in fit,
And escaped with the pin from beam,
And with the web *after his dream*.

So Samson was into bondage for play.
He told Delilah what to do and say.
He laughed at the superstition in sway
Of heathendom. He knew You in Your
way,
And knew his strength came on the
moment caught
By Your spirit and not by magic plot
Of bindings and numbers or blowing on
The hair, or withes or ropes tied up in knot.
And so after his bondage play at dawn
He always rose up with the rage of faun.
Beloved, I shudder for the scorn he lay
Upon the pagan spell and roundelay.
Let me not underestimate the time
When You might depart from my lingered
rhyme.

15 And she said to him, "How can you
Claim to love me, when in your pew
Your heart is not with me *as due*?
You have mocked me these three times
past,
And have not told me to the last
Wherein your great strength is tied *fast*."
16 It happened as she pressed him daily

With her words, and urged him on *gaily*,
That his soul was vexed unto death.
17 So he told her all *in his breath*,
Emptied his heart to her and said
"There's not come razor on my head,
For I have been a Nazarite
To Alohim from my mom's sight,
If I am shaven, then my strength
Will go from me, and I *at length*
Shall become weak like any man."
18 When Delilah saw that he'd told
Her all his heart, she made *so bold*
To send for the lords Philistine,
Saying "Come up once more *to dine*,
For he has showed me all his heart."
Then the lords Philistine *like dart*
Came up to her with coin in hand.
19 And she made him sleep on her knees,
And she called for a man *as planned*,
And had him shave the seven keys
Of hair from off his head, and she
Began to afflict him to see
That his strength went from him *at last*.
20 And she said "The Philistines *fast*
Have come upon you, Samson." And
He awoke out of his sleep's *band*,
And said "I'll go out as before
And shake myself *beside the door*."
But he did not know that YHWH had
Departed from His *chosen lad*.

Samson knew well that trick and bait were
not
The secret of his strength in divine plot.
He knew he depended in all on You.
So he was not afraid of heathen crew,
No matter what they did with band or spell.
He knew that in Your care all things were
well.
He did not dream the symbol of his hair
Was where his strength lay, no, not for a
dare.
So why did You let Philistine take him
To reaffirm their superstitions grim?
You helped him through murder and
fornication,
So what now made You betray Samson's
station?
The legend is not about moral whines.
You dispensed with him to kill Philistines.

21 But the Philistines took him and

Put out his eyes and made him stand
 In Gaza, and bound him with rail
 Of brass, *and used him for stud male*
Where they kept him grinding in gaol.
 22 But yet his head of hair began
 To grow again from shaven span.
 23 Then the lords of the Philistines
 Gathered together in their wines
 Of sacrifice to Dagon god
 Of theirs and to rejoice *unshod*
 For they said "Our god's given us
 Samson our foe gratuitous."
 24 And when the people saw him they
 Praised their god, for they said "Hooray,
 Our god has given us this day
 Our enemy, and him who laid
 Our country waste, in ambushade
 Killed many of our folk waylaid."

I live in constant praise of Philistine
 God that has decked the land in fervid wine
 And claims to be the God of Sinai's fire,
 While all her patrons sunken in desire
 Worship the sun instead, worship the deal
 That human hearts awaken when they feel.
 Beloved, I see the temple and the crowd,
 I hear the raging rock sound out aloud,
 I hear the evil curse spoken in sound
 Of sweetness of hypocrisy around.
 Beloved, You are One and not three though
 You

Are hidden from Philistine temple's view,
 Are silent before all the rocking deck.
 I wait once more for Samson to bow neck.

25 It happened when their hearts were full
 Of joy, that they said "Bring the bull
 Samson to come and give a show
Of male prowess of hump and go.
 And they brought Samson from the gaol
 And set him by the pillars *pale*.

26 And Samson said to the young lad
 That held him by the hand, *he bade*,
 "Let me feel the pillars whereon
 The building stands, that I *updrawn*
 May lean on them. 27 The house was full
 Of men and women *gullible*,
 And all the lords of Philistines
 Were there, and on the roof *in vines*
 Where about three thousand of men
 And women, and they watched *again*
 Samson grinding in sport *with ten*.

28 And Samson called once more on
 YHWH,
 And said O Lord YHWH, take in view
 Remembering me, I pray for strength,
 I pray only this once at length,
 O Alohim that I may be
 At once avenged for the degree
 Of my two eyes on Philistines.
 29 And Samson took hold of the tines
 Of the two middle pillars on
 Which the building was standing, on
 Which it was borne up, of the one
 With his right hand, and that when done
 The other with his left hand spun.
 30 And Samson said "Let me now die
 With the Philistines." And with cry
 He bowed himself with all his might,
 And the house fell upon the wight,
 Upon the lords and all the folk
 That were in it. So the dead folk
 Which he killed at his death were more
 Than those he killed in his life's score.
 31 Then his brothers and all the house
 Of his father came down with spouse
 And took him and brought him up and
 Buried him between Zorah's land
 And Eshtaol in the graveyard
 Of Manoah, his father's guard.
 And he judged Israel twenty years
And saved them from all of their fears.

I told You they would give Dagon the glory
 For blinding Samson and for all his story.
 The writer thinks his growing hair to
 blame,

But You and I know calling on Your name
 Is what put Samson back into the game.
 They put out his eyes so he could not see
 The many women he made pregnant free
 By their genetic experiment's spree
 To get an army of strong men for glee.
 He ground his seed for their sport but at last
 He killed his own offspring in final blast
 When all the pregnant women of his past
 Were crushed by his sacrifice and Your
 hand.

Samson accomplished all of Your
 command.

Religious Systems without Divine Guidance

Judges 17

1 Now there was a man from the hills
Of Ephraim, whose name *distils*
As Micah. 2 He said to his mom,
“The eleven hundred in palm
Of silver stolen from your bin
Which you cursed and spoke of for sin
As I heard also, here they are
With me, I took the silver bar.”
And his mother said “Blessèd are
You of YHWH, my son. 3 And when he
Gave back the one thousand in fee
And one hundred of silver to
His mother, his mother said too,
“I’d dedicated all the gain
Of the silver to YHWH from stain
Of my hand for my son, to make
A graven image for his sake
And a molten image now then
I’ll put it in your hand again.”
4 And he gave back his mom the lot,
And his mom took two hundred spot
Of silver and gave to the founder,
Who made of them a graven bounder
And a molten image and they
Were in Micah’s house *for their sway*.
5 The man Micah had house of gods
And made an ephod for their prods
And teraphim and consecrated
One of his sons and elevated
Him as his priest. 6 In those days no
King was in Israel, every Joe
Did what was right in his eyes’ show.

It is not silver itself that leads men
And women astray after idols’ yen.
It is the heart of greed that sets apart
Mother and son, and brings them of one
heart
To conspire against You, and yet to claim
That what they make in gods is to Your
fame.
I laugh and cry to see their honest sort
Take and give back, it really is great sport.
Hand me the kettle, mom, I’ll make a brew
Of silver that when it comes out to you
Will be a god and goddess, and best yet
I’ll save nine hundred weight in silver set.
Beloved, I see the Baptist way of old
Was popular in sheep of Your own fold.

7 A young man from Bethlehem Judah

Of Judah’s folk who was intruder
As a Levite, and he lived there.
8 And the man left the city’s care
Of Bethlehem Judah to dwell
Where he could find a pastorate.
And he came to Mount Ephraim’s well
To Micah’s house while making rate.
9 And Micah told him, “Where have you
Come from?” And he said to him true,
“I am a Levite of the place
Of Bethlehem Judah in race,
And I’m out looking for a post.”
10 And Micah said to him as host,
“Stay with me and be counsellor
And priest and I will give you more,
Ten pieces of silver a year,
And new suit and victuals in gear.”
So the Levite entered that post.
11 And the Levite was happy most
To stay with the man, and the youth
Was to him like a son in truth.
12 And Micah consecrated that
Levite, and the young man who sat
Became his priest, and there he stayed
In Micah’s house, and there he prayed.
13 Then Micah said “Now I know this,
YHWH’ll do me well, since benefice
I’ve given to Levite as priest,
And so my wealth shall be increased.

Beloved, I thank You that You saved me
from
Myself and church when I went out like
bum
To seek a benefice, a post and living.
No one escapes idolatry so giving.
The chapels that are set up to employ
The minister for pay and price enjoy
Imagination that You bless that house,
When in fact You give it to nibbling mouse
Of deceit and the greed of sacrifice.
Beloved, I thank You that You kept that
vice
From me when I was vulnerable to be
A seeker of that way by Galilee.
Beloved, Your reward is the loving heart
That burns in inner temple from the start.

Judges 18

1 In those days no king in Israel
Reigned, and in those days the tribe *royal*
Of Dan sought inheritance *spoil*

To dwell in, for unto that day
 Inheritance had not *in sway*
 Fallen to them among the tribes
 Of Israel. 2 And *as ascribes*,
 The folk of Dan sent five men out
 From their family from about
 Their places, mighty men *no doubt*
 From Zorah, and from Eshtaol,
 To spy out the land searching goal,
 And they said to them, "Go and see
 The land," and when they came to be
 In Mount Ephraim, to Micah's house,
 They lodged there. 3 They heard by the
 house

The voice of the young man Levite,
 And they turned in there *for a bite*
 And said to him, "Who brought you here?
 And what are you doing for cheer?
 And what do you have for career?"
 4 And he said to them, "Micah does
 A good deal by me, yes, he does,
 And I am his priest *and his fuzz*."
 5 And they said to him, "Ask of God
 Counsel for us to know the sod,
 Whether our way which we go shall
 Be prosperous *or prodigal*."
 6 And the priest said to them, "In peace
 Go, for YHWH does your way increase."

Ah, it requires only to be the son
 Of a Levite, no matter what the run,
 And get a stipend from a wealthy chap
 And then set up an oracle to zap.
 From Dan at least if not to Beer Sheba,
 The populace will come to draw a straw
 In divination for both ma and pa.
 That is the faith that wields the scepter
 now,
 That was the faith the yielded to the plough
 When Micah and the Levite set up shop
 To run a temple business mom and pop.
 If the State Church is wickedness untold,
 The congregational polity bold
 Is thing that does or ought to leave You
 cold.

7 The five men left and they arrived
 In Laish and saw *undeprieved*
 The people in it carelessly
 Living like Zidonians *free*,
 Quiet and in assumed safety,
 Without magistrate in the land

To put to shame what was in hand,
 And far from the Zidonians,
 Without intercourse *in their plans*.
 8 They came back to their brothers in
 Zorah and Eshtaol to win
 And their brothers said to them then,
 "What do you have to say *like men*?"
 9 They said "Get up, and let's attack
 For we have seen the land, no lack,
 And indeed it is very good,
 And do you sit here still *as wood*?
 Don't be lazy to go and take
 A *fruitful* land for your own sake."
 10 When you set out you will arrive
 At a people secure *in hive*
 And in a broad land Alohim
 Has given you, a land *of cream*
 Where there's no lack of anything
 Existing on the earthly *ring*.
 11 So went from the family of Dan,
 Out of Zorah and Eshtaol,
 Six hundred men appointed toll
 With weapons of war *by their plan*.
 12 And they went up and they encamped
 In Kirjath-jearim *and revamped*
 In Judah, which is why they called
 That place Mahanehdan *installed*
 To this day, indeed it's behind
 Kirjath-jearim *and well defined*.
 13 From there they passed into the mount
 Of Ephraim and made their count
 At the house of Micah *and fount*.

Experiment it seems You may have made
 To see how folk would live to whom
 displayed
 Was Your Mount Sinai vision in the glade.
 Can people live a life of justice while
 No judge or king is over them a while?
 They searched out a folk vulnerable to take
 And dispossess them of their land and rake.
 The implication is that in the case
 There is no ruler to impose the place
 Of law, that human beings will run wild
 And strong oppress the weak irreconciled.
 On other hand, You seem to expect Dan
 To destroy Canaanite and by a plan
 And so carve out a place upon the span.

14 Then the five men that went to spy
 Out the country of Laish, *why*,
 They said in answer to their brothers,

“Do you not know what this house
smothers?

There is an ephod, teraphim,
And a graven image *and grim*
A molten image, now therefore
Consider what to do *and more.*”

15 And they turned that way and they came
To the young man’s house and *the claim*
Of the Levite, and to the house
Of Micah, greeting him *and spouse.*

16 And the six hundred man outfit
With their weapons of war *and kit*
Who were of the children of Dan
Stood by the gate entrance *to fan.*

17 And the five men that went to spy
Out the land went up on the sly
And came in there and took the things,
The graven image, and the rings
Of the ephod, and teraphim,
And the molten image and grim,
While the priest stood at gate entrance
With the six hundred men in dance
Fitted out with weapons of war.

18 And these went in to Micah’s store
And got the carved image and more
The ephod and the teraphim
And the molten image and grim,
While the priest said to them and asked,
“What are you doing and untasked?”

19 And they said to him, “Shut your mouth
And give your lips for words a droughth,
And come with us, and be a priest
And counselor *with pay increased.*
For is it not better for you
To be a priest in a house *due*
To one man only or be *true*
A priest to a tribe and *a great*
Family in Israel and in state?”

From Baptist chapel to be Patriarch
Or Pope as it may seem from where they
park,
Is quite a step up, is it not, not just
In salary but appointment in dust.
Who is faithful in small things and bows to
The graven and molten instead of You
Can look forward to fortune in the pew,
A raising of the profile, bigger crew,
And following to ask advice in trust.
Beloved, I pray You save me from the fate
Of those who follow what is soon or late
The common thought and policy the folk

Around consider right under the oak.
I’d rather go unpaid and rot or rust.

20 And the priest’s heart was glad and he
Took the ephod and he *made free*
To take the teraphim and the
Graven image and went *in fee*
To serve the people *faithfully.*

21 So they turned and lit out and put
The little ones *from under foot*
And the cattle and baggage *spoil*
And had them before them *in toil.*

Now what is the first thing the priest will
do

In his higher post and chief of the crew?
He takes the property that once belonged
To another thinking not whom he wronged.
As priests jostle for place and power and
shove,

They do not care from whom they steal for
love

Of gain and career for themselves, oh no.
For them the only law’s the people’s show.
When the raider takes up from feeble hand
The silver and the ephod in the land,
The priest comes then to carry up the lot
Before the raider and the robber’s plot.
Beloved, clear-eyed I see You judge the
hope

Of paid pastor, priest, and unholy pope.

22 When they had gone a good way from
The house of Micah, *on the hum,*
The men from the houses near his,
Near Micah’s house gathered to whiz
After the folk of Dan to quiz.

23 And they shouted to Dan’s folk there.
And they turned around to repair
And said to Micah, “What’s your complaint,
To come after us with such feint?”

24 He said “You took my gods away,
That I made, and the priest to stay,
And you have gone away and what
Have I left? And then have the gut
To say to me, “Why all the rut?”

25 The children of Dan told him then,
“Keep your voice down among our men,
Unless you want some angry blokes
To run on you and give you strokes
And you and your house lose your lives
Before the bees come out of hives.”

26 The children of Dan went their way,
 When Micah saw them there that day
 Too strong for him, he turned and went
 Back to his house *not to repent*.
 27 And they took what Micah had made
 And the priest who with him had stayed,
 And came to Laish to the folk
 Quiet and in safety and broke
 Them with the mouth of the sword and
 Burnt the city with the fire brand.
 28 And there was none to save them for
 It was far from Zidon and shore,
 And they had no intercourse done
 With any other, and they won
 The valley by Beth-rehob, and
 They built a town, lived in that land.
 29 And they called the name of the place
 Dan after the name and the race
 Of Dan their father, who was born
 To Israel, the name of scorn
 Of that city was Laish first.
 30 And the children of Dan for worst
 Set up the graven image and
 Jonathan, son of Gershom and
 The son of Manasseh, he and
 His sons were priests to tribe of Dan
 Till the captivity began.
 31 They set up there Micah's idol
 Theaven one he'd made to roll,
 All the time that the house of God
 Was in Shiloh, *and worshiped pod*.

Note well, Beloved, that Your tent in its
 place
 Was torn and pulled and suffered such
 disgrace
 Of Philistine and relocation and
 The rise of dynasties and spoiling hand,
 While sweet accord and continuity
 Marked the idol in Dan's serenity.
 So Your faith is never left on its own
 To go in peace beneath Your royal throne,
 But goes from one place and name to
 another
 While hordes of hypocrites about it
 smother.
 By contrast the Vatican of Dan's hill
 For centuries quietly fits the bill.
 Beloved, I question all establishment
 Knowing what is successful and godsent.

Week 51 Judges 19

1 It came to pass that in those days,
 When no king *reigned* in Israel's *praise*,
 That there was a certain Levite
 Living in the far mountains' site
 Of Ephraim. A concubine
 He took for himself *from the vine*
 Of Bethlehem in Judah's *line*.
 2 And his concubine played the harlot
 Against him, and went *like a starlet*
 Away from him into the house
 Of her father at Bethlehem
 In Judah, and was there *like grouse*
 For four whole months in *stratagem*.
 3 Then her husband arose and went
 After her, to speak kindly bent
 To her, bring her back, with servant
 And two donkeys with him *in cant*.
 And she brought him to father's house,
 And when the father of his spouse
 Saw him, he was glad to meet him.
 4 Now his father-in-law, *not grim*,
 The young woman's father, made him
 Stay with him three days. So they ate
 And drank and lodged there *to their fate*.

The law of divorce that requires the time
 Of four months spent apart is set in rhyme
 In this story of priest from Ephraim's hills.
 His mercy in remarrying instills
 An ancient practice which says divorce
 bills
 May not be renewed unless the dame fills
 The place of another man's bed and sills.
 So all is lawful by the ancient way
 The people saw remarriage in that day.
 The feast is happy and each man and wife
 Enjoy the sweetness and kindness of life.
 Three days is a bare minimum to praise
 The marriage reconciled of man that stays
 Content on Ephraim's mountain without
 strife.

5 And it came to pass the fourth day
 That they got up early *to play*,
 And he was there ready to go,
 But the young woman's father said
 To his son-in-law, "Wait a show,
 Comfort your heart with piece of bread,
 And then go on your way well sped."
 6 And they sat down and ate and drank
 Both of them together in rank,
 And the dame's father told the man,

“Content you please and stay by plan
 The night and let your heart be glad.”
 7 When the man rose *like Galahad*
 To leave, his father-in-law urged
 Him so he stayed one more *night purged*.
 8 And he got up early on morn
 Of the fifth day to leave the bourn
 And the dame’s father said “Let be
 Your heart content in comfort, see.”
 And they stayed there till afternoon,
 And they both ate *with knife and spoon*.
 9 And when the man got up to go,
 He and his concubine *for show*
 And his servant, then father-in-law
 The dame’s father said on the draw
 To him, “See now, the day comes near
 To evening, I beg you to steer
 And stay here for the night, behold,
 The day’s toward, and so be bold
 To lodge here that your heart may be
 Merry, and tomorrow shall be
 An early hour to take your way
 To go on home another day.”

The father of the concubine I see
 Has the heart of best hospitality.
 I do not know if concubines back then
 Were treated as a lesser breed by men,
 Or if all women had a stake to bear
 In being mere possessions in men’s care,
 Or whether some women rose up in state
 To an equality with stodgy mate.
 But I see, my Beloved, the loving heart
 Of the father, and so I think the part
 Of daughter was a willing, righteous one.
 Though angels have been guests and
 unaware,
 The human guest is doubtless much more
 fun
 Both in the afternoon and at day done.

10 But the man would not stay again
 That night, but got up and left then,
 And came near to Jebus, which is
 Jerusalem, and with him his
 Two donkeys saddled, concubine
 Also with him, everything fine.
 11 When they were by Jebus, the day
 Was far spent, the servant would say
 To his master, “Come now, I pray,
 And let us go into the town
 Of Jebusites and there lie down.”

12 His master told him, “We will not
 Turn aside here into a plot
 Of strangers, that are not the folk
 Of Israel, we’ll go a stroke
 On to Gibeah.” 13 And he said
 To his servant, “Come, let us draw
 Near one of these places to thaw
 All night in Gibeah or Ramah.”
 14 And they went on and took their way,
 And the sun went down on their stay
 By Gibeah of Benjamin.
 15 So they turned toward the place, went in
 To spend the night in Gibeah’s *inn*,
 And when he went in, he sat down
 In a street of the darkening town,
 Since no one took them under roof
 To spend the night there *waterproof*.

To be in a strange place by day or night
 Is dangerous now as it was in sight
 Of Jebus some millennia ago.
 With care one must decide to trust the glow
 Of the town lights. For myself darkened
 woods
 Are safer bet, I do not fear the hoods
 Of beast and serpent as much as the kind
 Friendship of my own species on the wind.
 But even so, I might have made mistake
 As did those three in Gibeah, for the sake
 Of hospitality. Perhaps he should
 Have let the concubine stay where she
 could
 In the house of her dad. No need to make
 A trip for women who invite the rake.

16 Indeed, there came an old man from
 His work in the fields at *the hum*
 Of evening, and he also was
 From Mount Ephraim, but as does
 Was living in Gibeah’s *sites*,
 But the folk there were Benjamites.
 17 Raising his eyes he saw a man,
 A wayfarer upon the plan
 Of the city street, and the old
 Man said “Where are you going *bold*?
 And where is it that you come from?”
 18 And he told him, “We’re passing from
 Bethlehem Judah toward the side
 Of Mount Ephraim, I abide
 There, and then went to Bethlehem
 In Judah, but my *stratagem*
 Is to go to YHWH’s house and there

Is no one to receive me *fair*.

19 "But there is straw and provender
For our donkeys, and bread to share
With wine for me and your handmaid,
And for the young man with us stayed,
We have no lack of anything."

20 And the old man said "Peace to you,
However let all your wants due
Be mine, only do not lie here
Upon the street, *for it is drear*."

21 So he brought him into his house,
And gave food for his donkeys' browse,
And they washed their feet there and drank
And ate *what he gave with a thank*.

Beloved, I have come to a strange town in
The Middle East, and knowing none within
Have found lodging by offers on the street,
And entered homes to eat and wash my
feet,
And bow in prayer before You when we
meet.

The stranger in some places may find rest,
Although it is rare in the West at best.
I'm sad to think that in Gibeah's night
The only one to treat a stranger right
Was distant relative, who saw as kin
Another Ephraimite and took him in.
I've taken strangers in who were not mine
In blood or language, and made them to
dine,
And so I've lived to entertain You fine.

22 As they enjoyed the entertainment,
Behold the city's men's profanement,
Certain sons of Belial, came
Around the house and without shame
Beat at the door, and told the host
Of the house, the old man, in boast,
"Bring out the man that came to your
House, so we can corn-hole his chore."
23 But the man, the host of the house,
Went out to them and showed his blouse,
And told them "No, my brothers, please
Don't do so wickedly with sleaze,
Since this man has come to my home,
Do no such folly *under dome*.
24 "Look, my daughter's a maid, and his
Concubine, I'll bring them for fizz,
And do with them what you think best,
But do no vile thing to my guest."
25 But the men would not hear a word,

So the man took his concubine,
And brought her out to them and they
Fornicated with her till day,
Abusing her all night until
The morning peeked over the hill,
And let her go having their fill.
26 The woman came at dawn of day,
Fell at the man's house's door's way
Where her husband was till light's sway.
27 And her husband got up at morn
And opened door of house of scorn,
And went out to go on his way,
And see the wife, his concubine
Had fallen down there *on her spine*
At the door of the house and her
Hands were upon the threshold's burr.

The raped, assaulted and abused to death
Crept back to give up the last sigh and
breath
Beside the door, with hand on threshold
kept.

I too have been caught in the night and
wept.
I too have turned this way and that to find
The darkened streets of love sightless,
unkind,
And seen the trusted kinsmen of the night
Flit like the bat across the threshold's
blight.

The threshold is the Kaaba, says the word
That I have found by Turkish hearth and
stirred,
And with hand on the Kaaba and in sight,
Robbed, raped and shorn of hope and every
right,
I pray the last breath of a fleeting bird.

28 And he told her, "Get up and let
Us be going." He did not get
An answer. Then the man took her
Up on a donkey and to stir
Got up and went back to his place.
29 And when he got there to his trace,
He took a knife and grabbed hold of
His concubine he had for love,
And cut her up in pieces all
With her bones into twelve in all
And sent her into all the land
Of Israel *as witness stand*.
30 So it happened that all who saw
The thing said as they stood in awe,

“There was no such deed done nor seen
From the day Israel’s folk convene
To come up out of Egypt’s land
To this day, consider the stand,
Take counsel and speak the command.”

The man was a carouser, that is plain,
And perhaps thought a little tail not vain.
But just because a man drinks on the top
And wanders round the country like a fop
Does not mean he has no right to expect
To be treated and his with due respect.

The woman may well have been tipsy yet,
She may have been free and loose when
well met,

But still she had a right to life and limb,
A right although no virgin to tell him
No thank you for the pleasure of the romp.
The world is still evil despite its pomp,
And young girls and boys still cannot say
no

To those here in the West who run the
show.

Judges 20

1 And all of Israel’s folk came out,
From Dan to Beer Sheba *about*,
Also from land of Gilead,
And so the congregation had
Gathered as one man before YHWH
At Mizpeh. 2 And the leaders *crew*
Of all the people, all the tribes
Of Israel, came *without bribes*
In the assembly of the folk
Of Alohim, four hundred full
Thousand foot soldiers who could pull
The sword. 3 Now Benjamin’s folk heard
The folk of Israel as the word
Had gone up to Mizpeh. And so
The folk of Israel said, “Now show
How did this wickedness take place?”
4 And the Levite, husband to trace
Of the woman who was killed, said
In answer, “I came as I sped
To Gibeah of Benjamin,
My concubine and I towing
A place to lodge. 5 And Gibeah’s men
Attacked me, surrounding again
The house at night and tried to kill
Me, and my concubine with will
They forced and so she died. 6 And I
Took my concubine, and cut her

In pieces, and then I sent her
Through all the land of Israel’s plot,
Since they committed lewd and sot
Acts in Israel. 7 Now see, all you
Folk of Israel, think what to do.”

A cunning trick it was no doubt to get
The truth before the people and so met
To incite them to war and riot set.
The implication is that had there been
A king or judge to whom he could show
sin,

Then justice might be had at hand of one
Instead of at the hand of battle done
By all the mob in thousands gathered there.
As I tell the truth day to day let me
Not tell it in a way to treachery.
To kill a woman is not errand that
Requires the life of thousands in the vat.
Beloved, let my words limit violence
And bring peace and to You obedience.

8 All the folk got up as one man,
Saying “We’ll not any by plan
Go back to his tent or to house.

9 “Now this shall be the thing *in blouse*
That we’ll do against Gibeah,
Going by lottery with claw.

10 “And we’ll take of a hundred men
Ten from all tribes of Israel’s glen,
And of a thousand one hundred,
And of ten thousand to be fed
With victual for the folk *well-bred*
A thousand, that they may bring justice
To Gibeah of Benjamin,
For all they’ve done and not to trust us,
In their committing such a sin.”

11 So all the men of Israel went
Against the town in agreement
As one man. 12 And then Israel’s tribes
Sent men through all the tribe scribes
Of Benjamin, saying “What’s this
Wickedness done for cowardice?
13 “Bring out the men, Belial’s sons,
Which are in Gibeah by tonnes,
That we may put the men to death,
And extirpate the evil *breath*
From Israel.” But the folk of
Benjamin *for money or love*
Would not listen to the voice of
Their brothers, folk of Israel.

14 The folk of Benjamin in swell

Came together to Gibeah
From their cities *by hand and claw*,
To go out to battle the folk
Of Israel gathered *for broke*.

Beloved, I list the errors of the folk.
The first was to be in the wrong place
stroke
At the wrong time, instead of thinking well
To do the journey in the daytime spell.
And that error came from drinking too
much.

The second error was in lacking touch
Of hospitality. Third error's crutch
Was the night attack on the stranger's
clutch.

The fourth error was incitement to riot.
The fifth error was demanding unquiet
Instead of diplomatic recognition
That Benjamin's folk could with kind
petition

Take care of their own criminals when
caught.

Beloved, these five errors remain in plot.

15 The number of Benjamin's folk
At that time out of cities' *stroke*
Was twenty-six thousand men that
Wielded the sword from where they sat
Besides Gibeah's citizens,
Who amounted to denizens
Seven hundred well-trained *in glens*.
16 Of all these people there were found
Seven hundred chosen men *ground*
To sling stones with the left hand to
A hair's breadth and not miss *the view*.
17 Other than Benjamin the folk
Of Israel numbered in the yoke
Were four hundred thousand men that
Wielded the sword, warriors down pat.
18 The folk of Israel arose,
Went up to God's house to propose,
And asked counsel of Alohim,
And said "Which of us shall you deem
To go up first to battle there
Against Benjamin's people fair?"
And YHWH said "Judah first, beware."
19 And Israel's people rose at dawn
And camped against Gibeah's lawn.
20 The men of Israel went out
To fight against Benjamin stout,
And Israel's men stood in array

To fight Gibeah's men that day.
21 And Benjamin's folk came out from
Gibeah and destroyed each bum
Of Israelites that day in score
Twenty-two thousand men *and more*.

Beloved, I know that war's a foolish thing,
But notice how foolish it stays in ring.
Down to this day attackers meet to spoil
The homeland set all in array to toil,
While the defender, lying on his turf,
Supplied with deft guerrillas meets the surf.
Indeed, the attacker may often find
A victory ahead in future blind,
But always at the cost uncounted of
Thousands of lives intended not to shove.
The frontal attack made in such array
Lost Britain her colonies and the sway
Of Viet Nam, and how many more, I say.
Beloved, I know that war's no thing to
sing.

22 And the male folk of Israel
Encouraged themselves with a spell
To set their battle in array
In the same place in the same way
As they had done on the first day.
23 And Israel's folk went up and wept
Before YHWH until evening swept,
And asked counsel from YHWH saying
"Shall I go up once more in fling
Of battle on Benjamin's folk,
My brother to battle convoke?"
YHWH said "Go up against the bloke."

24 And the children of Israel came
Near Benjamin's folk *for the claim*
Of the second day. 25 Benjamin
Went out against them from *the bin*
Of Gibeah the second day,
And ground them to the earth *for pay*,
The folk of Israel once again
Eighteen thousand of their swordsmen.
26 Then all the folk of Israel and
All the people went up *to stand*
And came to house of Alohim,
And wept and sat there before YHWH,
And fasted that day till *the rim*
Of evening, and offered *as due*
Burnt offerings and peace offerings *there*
Before YHWH *and before His share*.

The fast that Israel in ancient times

Proposed, the one that gathered at Your
rhymes,
Was to refrain from eat and drink until
The sun went down beyond the sea and hill.
The fast the good Christian proposes still
Is to reduce the fat to flowered gill,
And eat the fish and fruit, but not the flesh
Whether baisted or dried or served up
fresh.

The fast that You propose no doubt is sure
In being in the heart and hand that's pure,
And in the soul that fasts from everything
That is prohibited servant and king.
Let me fast till the evening and be done
With everything there is that must be won.

27 And Israel's folk inquired of YHWH,
For the ark of the covenant
Of Alohim was there in view
In those days, 28 Phinehas *askant*,
The son of Eleazar, son
Of Aaron, stood before in done
In those days, saying, "Shall I yet
Once more go out to battle met
Against the folk of Benjamin
My brother, or cease from the sin?"
And YHWH said "Go up, for the day
That dawns I will give you the sway."

I note, Beloved, that when they asked You
first,
They asked who should go up to make the
burst
Of the attack, not if they should go up.
Now they are drinking from another cup.
Now they ask should they go again at all.
It seems they've got the questions mixed
with ball,
The heart before the course, as it may be.
They should have asked first should they
go in spree
To fight at all, and then only ask who
Should lead the army into battle's view.
But no, they assumed first it was Your will
That they fight on the plain and on the hill.
The cry of justice seems enough to make
A case today to unleash war's mistake.

29 And Israel set liars in wait
Around about Gibeah's *gate*.
30 The children of Israel went out
Against Benjamin's people stout

On the third day, and put themselves
In array against Gibeah's elves
As they had done at other times.
31 And the fold of Benjamin went
Out against the people to rout
And were drawn away from the town,
And they began attacking crown
To kill as at other times' crimes,
In the highways up towards the tent
Of Alohim, the other went
To Gibeah in the field spent,
And killed of Israel's men thirty.
32. And Benjamin's folk said "They be
Smitten down before us as then.
But the folk of Israel again
Said "Let's flee and draw them out from
The city to the highways come."
33 And all the men of Israel got
Up out of their place and their plot
And put themselves in array at
Baal-tamar, the liars sat
In wait of Israel then came out Of their
hiding places with shout
From Gibeah's meadows round about.
34 So there came against Gibeah ten
Thousand of Israel's chosen men,
And the battle was hard, but they
Did not know evil was in sway.
35 And YHWH struck Benjamin a blow
Before Israel and Israel's show
Of folk destroyed the Benjamites
That day twenty-five thousand wights
And a hundred men all who drew
The sword, and the whole army's crew.

Beloved, did You really give them the go
To fight a day and fall before the foe?
You say that You were there to give the
blow
That struck down Benjamin, and yet I see
The strategy got them the victory,
When they planted guerrilla's on the lee.
I look upon tangled reality
Of the earth and dare then to say in plea
What is an act of God and what the fate
Man brings upon himself and while You
wait.

But this I know, standing before Your gate,
That Your commandment given once of
late
Forbids killing, and so I shed the weight
Of violence to see Your coals on pate.

36 The folk of Benjamin then saw
 That they were beaten by the paw
 Of Israel's men who would withdraw
 Trusting their liars in the draw
 Waiting set up by Gibeah's *craw*.
 37 And the liars in wait with speed
 Rushed upon Gibeah indeed,
 And the liars in wait drew near
 And attacked all the town *in fear*
 With the mouth of the sword drawn *sheer*.
 38 For they had agreed on a sign
 Between Israel's men in design
 And ambushade, that they should make
 A great fire with smoke *in its wake*
 Go up from the city *at stake*.
 39 And Israel's men were on retreat
 In the battle before the feet
 Of Benjamin who started fighting
 To kill the men of Israel fighting
 About thirty persons in all,
 For they said "Surely now they fall
 Down before us as at the first."
 40 But when the fire started to flame
 Up out of the city with frame
 Of smoke, the Benjamites looked back
 Behind them to see and alack
 The flame of the city went up
 Into the sky *as in a cup*.
 41 And when the men of Israel turned
 Back, Benjamin's men were amazed,
 For they saw that the evil blazed
 On them *and that their city burned*.
 42 So they retreated before men
 Of Israel the way again
 Into the wilderness, but there
 The battle overtook their bare,
 And those who came out of the cities
 They destroyed with them without pitie's.

Beloved, could You not answer at the
 sound
 Of oracle upon the promised ground
 Not to kill brother's brother in the light
 Of Your holy day and Your sacred night?
 When they asked who should go, could
 You not say
 "Let no man friend or brother in the way
 Kill, no nor enemy nor even foe
 Be slain before the burning city's glow?"
 Would not the world be quite a different
 place,

Beloved, if gathered here before Your face,
 All men could hear Your voice again to
 trace
 The command not to kill? Now they are
 sure
 That what they do is at Your command
 pure,
 Because they made istahara endure.

43 So they surrounded Benjamites
 And chased them and trod on their *rights*
 From Gibeah to the sunrise *sights*.
 44 And there fell of Benjamin then
 Eighteen thousand of their best men,
 All men of might. 45 They turned and fled
 Toward the desert *where they bled*
 At the rock of Rimmon, and they
 Picked off the stragglers from highway
 Five thousand men, and pursued hard
 After them to Gidom *in guard*
 And killed two thousand men *ill-starred*.
 46 So that all those who fell that day
 Of Benjamin and in the way
 Were twenty-five thousand men that
 Drew the sword, all mighty *and fat*.
 47 But six hundred men turned and fled
 To the desert to the rock *led*
 Of Rimmon, and lived in the rock
 Rimmon four months *without their stock*.
 48 And Israel's men turned again on
 The folk of Benjamin *out drawn*
 And stuck them with the mouth of sword,
 As well the men of every ward,
 As the beast and what came to hand,
 And every city to firebrand.

Beloved, it may be well to kill the folk
 Who admire rape and torture at a stroke
 And defend killing the weak when the night
 Falls to hide their actions from every sight.
 Beloved, it may be well, since all these
 sought
 To hide the guilty with their horrors taught,
 And yet I cannot help but think Your grace
 Sufficient to change look on human face,
 And make them bear the shame and the
 disgrace
 For what was done, without this slaughter
 race.
 Solution now is quite a simple thing:
 Let all children be taught before the sting

That killing's always wrong, it's not
recourse
First or last. But that's our job, not Your
horse.

Week 52 Judges 21

1 The men of Israel had then sworn
In Mizpeh, saying "Let none born
Among us give his daughter to
A Benjamite as wife *in crew*."
2 The folk came to Alohims tent,
And stayed there till the daylight went
Before Alohims, lifting voice
And weeping greatly at the choice.
3 And said "O YHWH Alohims of
Israel, why has this come to shove
Today that there should be one tribe
In Israel not to describe?"
4 It happened on the next day that
The folk got up early and sat
To make a place of slaughter there
And offered burnt offerings with care
And peace offerings for every share.
5 And Israel's folk said "Who among
All the tribes of Israel unsung
Did not come up to assembly
To YHWH? For they came to agree
To put to death by oath those who
Did not come to Mizpeh and YHWH,
Saying "He shall surely be put
To death *and trampled under foot*."
6 And Israel's folk repented that
They'd done so to Benjamin's fat,
Their brother, and said "There is one
Tribe lacking from Israel when done."
7 How shall we do for wives for those
That are left, since we swore and chose
By YHWH that we will not give them
Our daughters as wives in their hem?"

First off, if what they'd done was righteous
deed,
They had no call to help them in their need.
Let them find wives where they might for
their seed.

The second thing is, if a wicked thing
It was to war against Benjamin's sting,
Then instead of killing the ones who stayed
Away from evil party on parade,
They ought to praise them for cool-headed
raid.

But no, always following hot desires

Instead of justice, on they go with fires,
Not only of the sacrifice but more
To aid and abet Benjamin in score.
When any guilt appears in humankind
All rush to join in it burning, resigned.

8 And they said "What tribe is there *sat*
And did not come among the *fat*
Tribes of Israel up to Mizpeh
To YHWH? And indeed *in the way*
There came none to the camp *in sway*
From Jabesh-Gilead that day
To the assembly. 9 For the folk
Were counted and indeed no bloke
Of the inhabitants was there
From Jabesh-gilead *in share*.
10 And the assembly sent out there
Twelve thousand men chosen with care
And commanded them, saying "Go
And strike inhabitants a blow
In Jabesh-gilead with mouth
Of the sword *turning north and south*
Both women and their children *there*.
11 And this is the thing that you'll do,
You shall completely kill the crew
Of males, and every woman that
Has lain with a man *to get fat*.
12 They found among inhabitants
Of Jabesh-gilead to dance
Four hundred young virgins, that had
Known no man lying with the glad
Male, and they brought them to the camp
To Shiloh, which is to revamp
The land of Canaan. 13 And the whole
Congregation sent some in toll
To speak to Benjamin's folk there
In the rock Rimmon to repair,
And to call peacefully to them.
14 And Benjamin came from their stem
At that time, and they gave them wives
Of those they saved and kept their lives
Of Jabesh-gilead's folk bred,
Yet there were not enough in stead.

The innocent who withheld from the fray
Are made to pay the last debt of the day.
If this is how folk act who have no king
Or ruler to encourage such a thing
And lead them into war, just think what
kind
Of situation we now have in bind,
Where so many lobbies of power are bound

To trample the innocent in the ground
To further their interests compounded by
Association of wealth on the sly.
Beloved, this story's not proof that such
men

As have no ruler are evil again,
But that evil is limited then to
What such a rabble is able to do.

15 And the people repented for
Benjamin, because on that shore
YHWH had made a breach in the door
Of the tribes of Israel on score.

16 The elders of the congregation
Said "How shall we make reparation
In wives for those remaining here
Seeing the women *and their gear*
Are all destroyed from Benjamin?"

17 And they said "Let there be a bin
For those escaped in Benjamin,
That a tribe not be destroyed all
Out of Israel *and Israel's wall*.

18 Yet we may not give to them wives
From our daughters, for on our lives
The folk of Israel have all sworn,
Saying "Cursed is the man that's born
To give a wife to Benjamin."

19 Then they said "See, a feast to YHWH
In Shiloh yearly which is due
On the north side of Bethel, on
The east side of the highway drawn
That goes up from Bethel and on
To Shechem, and on the south side
Of Lebonah, *as one can ride*."

20 They ordered Benjamin's folk, saying
"Go and lie in wait not delaying
In the vineyards, 21 and see indeed
If Shiloh's daughters come from steed
To dance in dances, then come out
Of the vineyards and with a shout
Catch you every man his wife out
Of the daughters of Shiloh, and
Go then back to Benjamin's land.

The whole thing started when Benjamin's
blokes
Came out to catch one woman on the
stokes
And used her against her will for their
pokes.
Now this is the solution to the thing,
Encouraging their brothers to join ring

And make an institution of the rite
Of catching women and poking for spite.
The oath not to give daughters in their right
Is more sacred than Your command that
none

Should kill or commit crime under the sun.
So humankind is quick to invent duty
And religions above, beyond the beauty
Of simple obedience and clinging to
The Decalogue to know what's right to do.

22 And it shall be when their fathers
Or their brothers come to us fers
To complain, that we will tell them
'Be favourable, don't condemn,
For our sakes, because we in hem
Did not reserve to each man his
Wife in the war *and in the whiz*,
For you did not give by free will
To them this time, guilty *of pill*.' "

23 And the children of Benjamin
Did so, and took wives from the bin
According to their number's din,
Of those that danced, and whom they
caught,

And they went and returned to plot,
Repaired the cities to live in.

24 And Israel's folk all went back home,
Everyone to his tribe and loam,
To family, and they went out
From there each one to his own grout.

25 In those days no king ruled the folk
Of Israel, and no king spoke,
Every man did what he thought right,
A democratic way to fight.

At the end of the anarchic squall all
Is at peace for who knows how long and
tall.

So anarchy explodes from time to time
In bloodshed and in hateful, horrid crime
Of slaughter and of superstitious rhyme.
A ruler is not better in the spree.
A ruler manipulates violence
Of the people to maintain the suspense,
And with controlled violence keeps the folk
Cowered and submissive before the stroke.
And with controlled violence gets up to
Make bedlam on any neighbouring crew.
The sum of violence is always greater
The more rulers have in stake soon or later.